

THE AGILE LONDON SYSTEM

NEW IN CHESS

A Solid but Dynamic
Chess Opening Choice
for White



ALFONSO ROMERO & OSCAR DE PRADO

The Agile London System

by Alfonso Romero and Oscar de Prado

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New In Chess 2016

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Published by New In Chess, Alkmaar, The Netherlands www.newinchess.com

This is an extended and updated edition of *El Sistema Londres* (Editorial Chessy, 2014).

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ISBN: 978-90-5691-689-3

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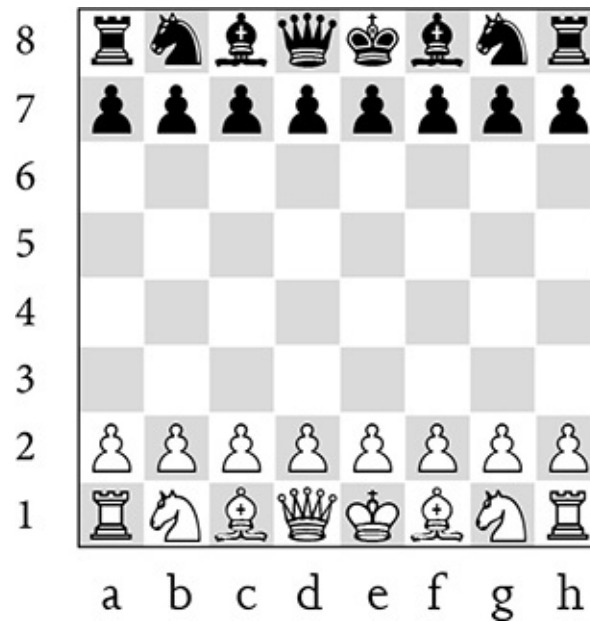
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Explanation of Symbols

The chessboard with its coordinates:



-  White to move
-  Black to move
-  King
-  Queen
-  Rook
-  Bishop
-  Knight

-  White stands slightly better
-  Black stands slightly better
-  White stands better
-  Black stands better
-  White has a decisive advantage
-  Black has a decisive advantage
-  balanced position
-  the position is unclear
-  with compensation for the material
-  good move
-  excellent move

?	bad move
??	blunder
!?	interesting move
?!	dubious move
↔	with counterplay
→	with attack
↑	with initiative
#	mate

Preface

The moves 'd4-♘f3-♙f4' constitute the 'London System', an opening which, despite a fully deserved reputation for solidity and simplicity, conceals a system of play which is much more profound than appears at first sight.

This system, which sets up the same pawn structure as in other Queen's Pawn openings – generally with c4 or c3, d4, e3, f2 etc.– and allows a natural development of the white pieces, has the great virtue of being playable versus almost any black defensive set-up. After the opening moves, the different plans and ideas mould the theory of the variation in each resulting position. This is when the game acquires a strategic direction, forcing each side to understand the opponent's intentions and rewarding understanding more than concrete calculation.

Perhaps this is why some players, generally those who prefer quiet positions, resort to this system when faced with Black's most aggressive defences, such as, for example, the Dutch, the King's Indian or the Grünfeld, seeking positions in which manoeuvring play predominates and thus avoiding the sharp exchange of blows that takes place in the main lines. Yet, despite what one be tempted to think, the London System has an aggressive side to it, arising from its similarity to the Torre Attack.

When Black selects a Queen's Gambit Declined set-up – 1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 e6 3.♙f4 ♘f6 – White can choose between two options: the first is to put pressure on the centre by playing c2-c4, developing the queen's knight to c3 and bringing the rook to c1, while Black tries to solve the problem of developing his queen's bishop. The second plan is to place our light-squared bishop on the b1-h7 diagonal and develop our queen's knight to d2, preparing to support our centre with c2-c3 and attack on the kingside.

In the following examples we shall see how, versus one and the same black set-up, we can choose between different schemes as White, leading to widely differing plans. This versatility can be very useful, enabling us to adapt our play versus different types of opponent.

All this explains why for me, with more than fifteen years of experience playing the London System in all kinds of tournament and versus every type of player, the London System is not so much an opening as a whole system of play, in the widest possible sense.

King's Indian Example Struggle for the e-file

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f4 g6 3.e3 ♙g7 4.♗f3 d6 5.h3 0-0 6.♙e2 ♗bd7

We have reached a fairly standard King's Indian set-up versus the London System. Here Black needs to decide which central break to select, ...e7-e5 or ...c7-c5.



7.♙h2!

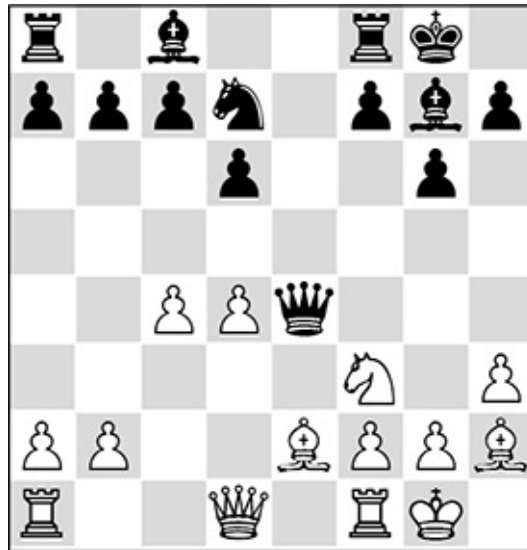
The first important point. It is important to understand that sooner or later this move will be necessary and that now it is up to Black to commit himself in the centre. Castling would be somewhat premature, since it would give Black enough time to establish his centre.

7.0-0 ♔e8 (7... ♖e8 does not threaten 8...e5, as we shall see further on) 8.c4 e5 (White must retreat the bishop) 9.♙h2 ♗e4! (Black plays this before White can develop his queen's knight) 10.♗c3 ♗xc3 11.bxc3 with equality, since now it is White who is on the back foot. But note that 11...f5 would not be good in view of 12.c5!

7...♔e8

We see that Black has opted for the ...e7-e5 break.

8.c4 e5 9.♗c3 exd4 10.exd4 ♗e4 11.♗xe4 ♙xe4 12.0-0



By delaying castling as long as possible, we have succeeded in bringing the black queen to a square from which it will quickly be driven back and we have gained an advantage in space. Now it would not be good for Black to continue with his queenside development...

12...b6 13. ♖d3 ♗e7 14. ♜e1 ♗d8 15. ♘e4 ♜b8 16. ♗a4

With advantage, since White can exploit the weak light squares, especially c6.

The weakness on d6

1.d4 ♘f6 2. ♘f3 g6 3. ♘f4 ♘g7 4.e3 0-0 5. ♘e2 d6 6.h3 c5



This time Black decides to put pressure on White's centre with the advance ... c7-c5.

7.c3 b6

Planning natural development with ... ♖b7 and the knight will emerge at c6 or d7.

8.0-0 ♗b7 9. ♘bd2 ♙bd7 10. ♗h2

This is always an important move to reduce the impact of a possible ...e7-e5 break.

10... ♜e8 11.a4

It is important for us to control the b5-square, to give our knight a better chance of stability on c4.

11...e5?

Black fails to appreciate the weakness of his d6-square, which White will quickly exploit.

12. ♘c4



White gains a positional advantage. Here 12... ♜c7 would not help much: 13.dxe5 dxe5 14. ♜d6!. Now the only way to avoid defeat is the modest queen move 14... ♜c8!.

Black's best reply is definitely 12... ♗e4! but after 13.a5! b5 14.a6! (a thematic idea) 14... ♗c8 15.dxe5 bxc4 16. ♜d5 ♜b8 17. ♜xe4 ♜xb2 18. ♗xc4, White has the advantage.

A Typical Mistake by Black

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♘f3 g6 3. ♗f4 ♗g7 4.e3 d6 5.h3 0-0 6. ♗e2 ♙bd7 7.0-0?! ♜e8

In this case Black wants to break with ...e7-e5 with the support of his rook, but he overlooks a very simple tactic, one that is curiously common in practice.

8.c4

Against this set-up White prefers to play aggressively.



8...e5?!

Black fails to appreciate the connection between the queens and is in for a surprise.

9.dxe5 dxe5 10.♘xe5 ♗xe5 11.♙xd8 ♖xd8 12.♙xe5

with an extra pawn.

I think the publication of this book is very opportune, not only because of the exposure this system has been receiving lately at the level of the world's elite, but also in view of the structure of the book, the practical advice offered in certain positions and the useful exercises that are presented throughout. I am sure that it will be welcomed not only by many club players but also by experienced tournament players, in both cases especially if they have little time for studying openings.

IM Enrique Alvarez

Chapter 1

Introduction and historical evolution

Introduction

The London System, which also includes the line known as the Pereyra Attack in Argentina, is characterised by the solid set-up for White of d2-d4, ♖f3, ♙f4, e2-e3, c2-c3, h2-h3. It is a universal system, valid against almost any black response and one of the safest for White. It is very popular with club players who want to avoid the more theoretical lines or having to study the whole range of their opponent's defences, but it is also played regularly by strong grandmasters, such as Kamsky or Grachev. The French grandmaster Eric Prié is possibly the greatest specialist in it, world-wide. It is also played more sporadically by Ponomarev, Eljanov, Bacrot, Dreev and Bauer, and in the past it was used by such strong players as Spassky, Keres, Bronstein, Jussupow and Kasparov. Nowadays Carlsen is a role-model for many players, since he plays secondary lines, or lines which do not promise an opening advantage, and concentrates on the middlegame or the endgame. It is very common to see elite players playing the Réti or the English with white, quiet openings which are based on schemes or ideas rather than very complex or concrete theoretical lines.

The idea of writing a book on the London System arose from the need to fill a gap with regard to this opening. There have been very few books on the London and none of them are completely up to date. Oscar de Prado has been using the London System ever since he realised that he had little time to study openings. He looked for an opening system which would be useful against everything and in which he would not need to memorise a large number of variations. And he came across the London System, via the so-called Pereyra Attack, known by this name in Argentina in honour of the master Manuel Pereyra Puebla, who played it regularly and with his own attacking ideas, which differed in some lines from the pure London System. The opening is easy to understand, and with it De Prado began to obtain good and pleasing victories and to achieve good results, including against strong players. In this way he accumulated more experience, studying and improving the system. In our work as trainers – for many years – both of us have also begun to teach this opening to our students. And thus was born the idea of this book. The Spanish edition (from 2014) was for the major part written by Oscar de Prado, with various contributions by Alfonso Romero.

The English version has been updated until 2016 by Romero, and this update includes, among others, five crucial new games: two by Magnus Carlsen, two by Gata Kamsky, and the important game Grischuk-Nakamura.

The London System is ideal for players who do not have much time to study openings or who like to play solidly. Although in many variations it is necessary to be accurate with the move order, in general we shall base our play on general concepts and common themes, rather than very concrete or complicated variations. With this opening it is very difficult to end up in a bad position with white or to be surprised at an early stage; the aim is not to gain an advantage right from the first moves, but to play a quiet set-up and to choose the path to follow according to the opponent's response. In many variations the position opens up and White wins many games with strong attacks on the enemy king; the fact that it is a solid system does not mean that we renounce the attack or the initiative. Rather it is that sometimes we shall play positionally and at other times aggressively. The advantage over his opponent that someone who plays the London on a regular basis will have is greater experience in the majority of the positions reached; this confers an advantage from the start, because frequently opponents do not come up with the best plans, owing to their lack of experience with these positions. In addition, the belief that this is a harmless or drawish opening leads opponents to be too nonchalant and to prepare inadequately against it. The London System is going to be valid for us against almost all our opponents' possible responses, but we have to know a little more, because at times we shall play positions from the Queen's Gambit, the Slav or the Caro-Kann. The c-pawn usually goes to c3 but in some lines it goes to c4. The same thing applies to the move h2-h3; you have to know the right moment to play it. As a rule the bishop on f4 is a good piece and we must not allow its exchange, while the other bishop goes to e2 or d3, depending on the defence chosen by our opponent. We shall be looking at all these subtleties as we go through the book.

The Evolution of the System

The London System was first played in the nineteenth century. The first recorded game was Labourdonnais-McDonnell, London 1834, a game which began with the moves 1.d4 d5 2.♘f4 c5 3.e3 ♘c6 4.♙f3 ♗g4 5.♗e2 ♗xf3 6.♗xf3 e6 7.c4, and despite the fact that it ended in defeat, White gained a slightly better position. Then came several more games, such as Zukertort-Munk, Berlin 1869. The first player to begin to play it regularly was the Irish master Mason, who first played it in 1880 in Wiesbaden, and a year later it was also played by the English master Blackburne, who had already been using it as an attacking line since he took up the game. It gained a certain amount of renown in the New

York tournament in 1889. Let us now look at two of the earliest London System games, played by Mason and Blackburne.

Game 1

James Mason

Alexander Wittek

Vienna 1882 (18)

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

1.d4 d5 2.♘f4

At that time it was very common to play 1...d5 with black. In fact it was the usual reply to 1.d4.

The move ♘f4 was played quite frequently in those days, but after e2-e3 White nearly always followed up with c2-c4, transposing to positions from the Queen's Gambit.

2...e6 3.e3 ♘f6 4.♗f3 ♘e7 5.♘d3 b6 6.♗bd2 ♗b7 7.♗e5

A very interesting idea and one which is still topical today: White delays castling in favour of planting his knight on the strong square e5, in preparation for an attack on the black king.

7...a6 8.c3 ♗bd7 9.0-0 0-0 10.♞f3



Another plan which is still relevant today is the transfer of the queen to the kingside via f3-h3, to attack the black king and at the same time prevent ...♗e4.

10...♞e8 11.♞h3 ♗f8

A typical defensive manoeuvre: the knight defends h7 and can go to g6, blocking the diagonal b1-h7 against the white bishop, without weakening the kingside pawns.

12. ♖df3 ♗e4 13. ♜h5 ♗g6 14. ♜ad1

There was an interesting sacrifice here with 14. ♗xf7!? ♜xf7 15. ♗e5+ ♜g8 16. ♗xg6 hxg6 17. ♜xg6 ♘d6 18. f3 ♜f6! (18... ♗f6 19. ♘g5 with compensation) 19. ♜h5 ♘xf4 20. exf4 ♗d6 21. ♘g6 ♗f7 22. g3 ♜f8 and White has some compensation, with two pawns for the piece.

14... ♜f8 15. ♗d2 ♜e8 16. f3 ♗xd2

16... ♗f6 is better.

17. ♜xd2 f5 18. ♜h3

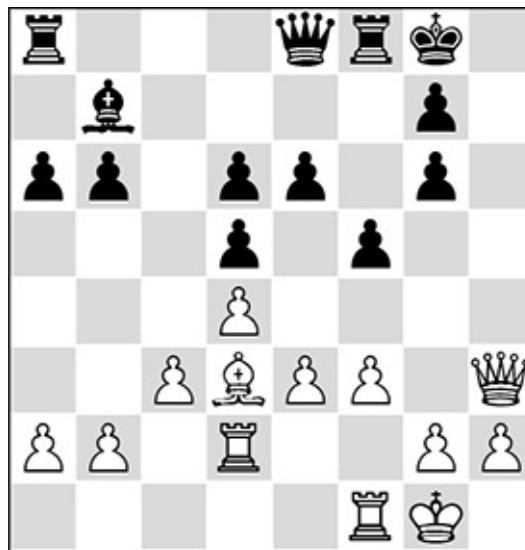
Or 18. ♗xg6 hxg6 (18... ♜xg6 19. ♜xg6 hxg6 20. ♘xc7±) 19. ♜h3 with a slight advantage to White.

18... ♘d6 19. ♗xg6 hxg6

Again 19... ♜xg6= is better.

20. ♘xd6 cxd6

The white position is advantageous; he has the better bishop and the superior pawn structure and he can break with g2-g4, followed by ♜g2, and attack Black's castled position.



21. f4

This is not best, since he might want to break with e3-e4 but now he will be unable to support it with the pawn on f3. It was better to play 21. g4, or 21. ♜h1 ♜f7 22. g4 ♜h8 23. ♜g3±.

21... ♜f7 22. g4 ♜h8 23. ♜g3 ♜e7 24. ♜g2 ♜f6 25. ♜h1

It was better to move the king towards the centre with 25. ♜f2.

25... ♜h7 26. g5

Closing the position is not White's best course of action; the position remains slightly better for Black. It was appropriate to return with 26. ♜g1, planning to

play ♔f2, where the king would be safer.

26... ♖e7 27.h4 ♖e8

Black himself takes the opportunity to send his king to the other wing.

28. ♜h2 ♖d7 29. ♙e2 ♜ah8 30. ♖g2

White realises his mistake and rectifies it by removing his king from the h-file.

30... ♙c6 31. ♜fh1



White now has everything ready to play h4-h5 at an opportune moment.

31... ♖c7 32. ♜f2

The pawn break leads to equality after 32.h5 gxh5 33. ♜xh5 ♜xh5 34. ♜xh5 ♜xh5 35. ♙xh5 ♙e8=.

32... ♖d7 33. ♙f3 ♜c8 34. ♜g3 ♙e8 35. ♖e2 ♖d8 36. ♜c1 ♙c6?!

It was necessary to play 38...b5. Now White rightly switches to the other flank. Once again we should remind ourselves of the importance of playing on both wings, in order to create weaknesses. In this case the black rooks are a long way from the queenside.

37.c4! ♙b7

37...dxc4 loses to 38. ♙xc6 ♜xc6 39. ♜xc4 ♜xc4 40. ♜xc4 ♖d7 41. ♜hc2.

38. ♜g2?!

38. ♜c3! would have given White a decisive advantage.

38... ♖d7 39. ♜c3 ♖a8 40. ♜h1!

The other rook now heads for the queenside.

40... ♜b8?

It was necessary to play 40... ♜c8 41. ♜hc1 ♜hh8 42.a4, but White retains the advantage.

41.cxd5 ♙xd5 42. ♜hc1

The invasion of the rooks on the seventh rank is decisive. Notice the black rook, out of play on h7.

42... ♖e8 43. ♘xd5 exd5

If 43... ♖xd5 44. ♖c2 wins.

44. ♖c6

1-0

What I like best about this game is how White used the plan of transferring the queen to the kingside, which is typical nowadays. I also like how White switched his attack to the other wing when he saw that the h4-h5 break would bring him no advantage and realised that the black rooks could not arrive in time.

Game 2

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Joseph Blackburne

Max Harmonist

Breslau 1889 (7)

1. ♘f3 d5 2. d4 ♘f6 3. ♘f4 e6 4. e3



Here we have the standard formation of the London System.

4... ♗e7 5. ♗d3 0-0 6. ♗bd2 b6 7. ♗e5

Blackburne copies Mason's idea and improves it. He delays castling and launches an attack by occupying the e5-square, one of the key squares for the white knight.

7... ♗b7 8. ♖f3!

With this move White prevents the enemy knight from jumping to e4 and brings his queen into the attack against the black king. We saw how Mason castled

early, but Blackburne has another idea in mind and will play without castling for a good part of the game.

8...c5 9.c3 ♖bd7 10.♗h3

This position could have easily arisen today. White is now taking aim at h7 with ideas such as g2-g4-g5 or ♖f3-g5. The white king can castle queenside or stay in the centre.

10...♜e8

Other options are 10...g6 and 10...h6.

11.♖df3



With the threat of 12.♖xf7, followed by 13.♖g5+. Black should have exchanged on e5 now.

11...♗e4?! 12.♖xd7! ♜xd7 13.♖e5 ♜d8 14.f3 ♖f6 15.♖g4

Or 15.g4 g6 16.♜b5, with clear advantage to White.

15...g6

On 15...h6?, 16.♖xh6 is stronger than 16.♜xh6, and White wins.

16.♜b5

It was better to play 16.♖h6+ ♜g7 17.♜e5, with a clear advantage.

16...♖d7?

16...♜f8! was better, since after 17.♜h6 (17.0-0) 17...♖xg4! 18.fxg4 (18.♜xg4 f5 19.♜h3 ♜f7 with equality) 18...♜h4+ 19.g3 (19.♜d1) 19...♜g5 20.♜xf8 ♜xf8 Black has excellent compensation.

17.♖h6+ ♜g7



18. ♖xf7!

A thematic sacrifice which leaves White with a decisive advantage.

18... ♗h4+

If 18... ♔xf7 then 19. ♕xh7+ ♔f6 20.g4 with mate in four moves.

19. ♖g3 ♖xf7

Or 19... ♖xg3+ 20.hxg3 ♔xf7 21. ♕xh7+ ♔f6 22. ♖h4, and White wins.

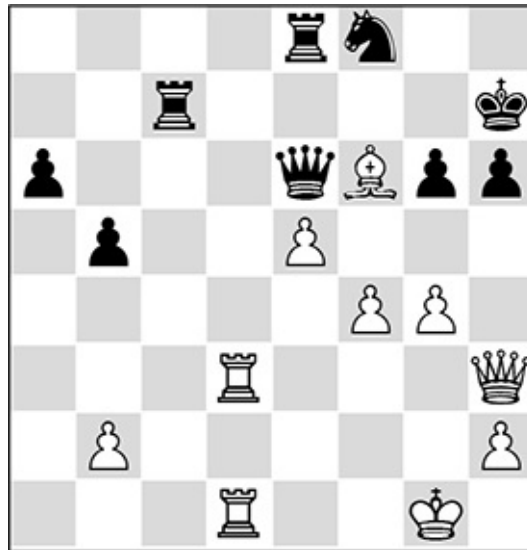
20. ♖xh4

20. ♕xh4! was quicker.

20... ♖c8 21. ♖g3 ♖g8 22.0-0 a6 23. ♖d3

The game is decided; White has an extra pawn, the bishop pair and an attack on the black king.

23...e5 24. ♖ae1 ♖c6 25.e4 cxd4 26.exd5 ♖c8 27.cxd4 ♖xd5 28.dxe5 ♖c5+ 29. ♖f2 ♖e7 30.f4 ♖xa2 31. ♖h4 ♖g7 32. ♖c2 ♖ac8 33. ♖b3+ ♖xb3 34. ♖xb3+ ♖h8 35. ♖d1 h6 36. ♖h3 ♖c7 37. ♖d6 ♖h7 38. ♖fd1 ♖f8 39. ♖f6 ♖f7 40. ♖6d3 ♖e6 41.g4 b5



42. ♔xh6+!

1-0

It's mate next move. A good start, with an attractive attacking game.

At the beginning of the twentieth century most of the strong players of the time played this opening: Tartakower, Rubinstein, Nimzowitsch, Marshall, Maroczy, Janowsky, Schlechter, Sämisch, Tarrasch and even Capablanca, who played it for the first time against Tital in London. But it was in the strong London tournament of 1922 that it became important, since it was used by several players, such as Watson, Rubinstein, Alekhine and Capablanca, and it became known as the London System, the name by which it is still known today.

Game 3

...d7-d5 without an early ...e7-e6

José Raul Capablanca

Otto Tital

London 1911

1.d4 d5 2. ♘f4 c5 3.e3 ♘c6 4. ♘f3 ♘f6 5. ♘bd2 ♘g4

In view of previous games in which White played ♘e5 and this bishop remained passive, Black develops it quickly.

6.c3 e6 7.h3

A good move, forcing the black bishop to commit itself and at the same time opening an escape route for White's own bishop on f4.

7... ♘h5 8. ♘b3

The usual plan for White (which remains applicable today) when Black's bishop is not on c8 is to put pressure on the b7-pawn. Black can do likewise with ... ♘b6, attacking b2.

8... ♖b6 9. ♗e5

9. ♖xb6 axb6 10. ♕b5 was a good alternative, with a slight advantage to White.

9... ♗xe5 10. ♕xe5

Again it was good to play 10. ♖xb6 axb6 11. dxe5 ♗d7 12. ♕b5±.

10... ♗d7?!

It was better to play 10...c4 11. ♖xb6 axb6 12. e4 b5 13. g4 ♗g6 14. ♕xf6 gxf6 15. exd5 exd5 16. ♕g2 0-0-0 with possibilities for both sides. White has the better structure, while Black has doubled pawns and a weakness on d5, but the bishop pair and the open character of the position provide more than sufficient compensation.

11. ♕b5 f6 12. ♕h2 c4 13. ♖a4

The pin is unpleasant and the bishop on h5 plays a passive role.

13... ♖d8 14. b3!



The typical break when Black plays ...c5-c4. This plan is still considered the correct one today.

14...a6?!

It was better to play 14...cxb3 15. ♖b1!? (15. axb3 a6 16. ♕d3±) 15... ♕g6 16. ♖b2 (16. ♖xb3 ♕c2) 16...a6 17. ♕e2 e5 18. ♖xb3 ♖c7 19. 0-0±.

15. ♕xd7+ ♖xd7 16. bxc4± ♖b2?

Here it was better to play 16... ♕g6 17. e4 dxe4 18. ♖b1 ♖c6 19. ♖xc6 bxc6 20. ♖b8+ ♖f7 21. ♗b3±.

17. ♖b1+- ♖xc3 18. g4 b5

If 18... ♕g6 then 19. ♖xb7+-.

19. cxb5 ♕g6



20.bxa6!

An attractive finish; the white pawn will soon queen.

20... ♖xb1

If 20... ♕c2 then 21.a7 ♕xa4 22.a8 ♖+ ♔f7 23. ♖xa4+–.

21.a7 ♕d3 22.a8 ♖+ ♔f7 23. ♖xd7+ ♔g8?

A blunder, allowing mate in one. It was essential to play 23... ♕e7 24. ♖ac6 ♖a1+ 25. ♗b1 ♖xb1+ (25... ♖b2 26. ♗c3+–) 26. ♔d2, although White still wins.

24. ♖xe6#

A good game by Capablanca, illustrating some ideas such as ♖b3 and the b2-b3 break, which are still relevant today.

Game 4

King's Indian

Alexander Alekhine

Max Euwe

London 1922 (4)

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♗f3 g6 3. ♕f4

The London System against Black's kingside fianchetto.

3... ♕g7 4. ♗bd2 c5 5.e3 d6 6.c3 ♗c6 7.h3

Providing the f4-bishop with an escape hole in the event of ... ♗h5.

7... 0-0 8. ♕c4

This is not the usual square for this bishop. These days, against defences such as the Grünfeld or the King's Indian, it is usual to develop it to e2.

8... ♖e8 9.0-0

Nowadays we would prefer 9.dxc5 dxc5 10.0-0, with a slight advantage to

White.

9...e5 10.dxe5 ♖xe5?



A serious positional error that leaves White with a clear, even decisive, advantage. It was necessary take with the pawn: 10...dxe5 11.♕h2±.

11.♕xe5! dxe5 12.♖g5! ♕e6

It was slightly better to play 12...♖f8 13.♖de4 ♕xd1 (13...♖xe4 14.♕xf7+ 14.♖fxd1 ♖xe4 15.♖xe4 although White still has a clear advantage: the black bishop on g7 is out of play, while its white counterpart on c4 and the white knight (which can go to d6), are strong pieces. In addition, White dominates the d-file.

13.♕xe6 fxe6 14.♖de4

The doubled pawns and passive bishop add up to a clear disadvantage for Black. White will exploit these in masterly fashion in the endgame.

14...♖xe4

If 14...♖b6 then after 15.♖d6 ♖xe4 16.♖xe4 ♖xd6 (or 16...♖xb2? 17.♖ab1 ♖c2 18.♖xb7 ♖xe4 19.♖d7, and White wins) 17.♖xd6 ♖e7 18.♖ad1, White maintains a clear advantage.

15.♖xd8 ♖exd8 16.♖xe4 b6 17.♖fd1 ♖f8 18.♖f1 ♖e7 19.c4!

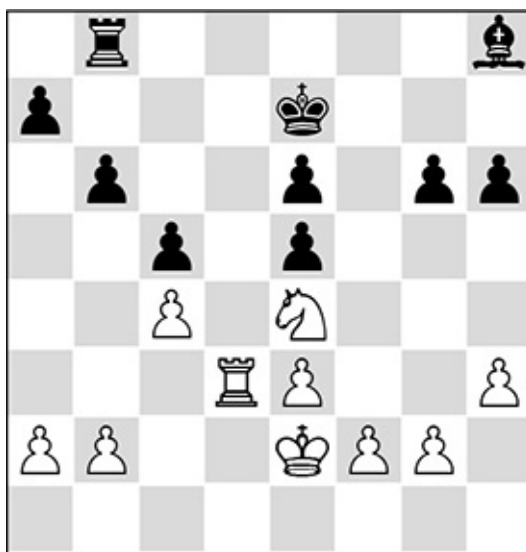


A good move: White fixes the enemy pawns on dark squares, thus restricting the bishop, and clears the third rank for the white rook. We have an endgame of good knight versus bad bishop.

19...h6 20.♖e2 ♜xd1 21.♜xd1 ♜b8

Black cannot exchange rooks because the ending is lost after 21...♜d8 22.♜xd8 ♔xd8 23.h4. White will advance with g4-g5, then bring the king to e4 and the knight to f3, with a winning endgame

22.♜d3 ♝h8



23.a4! ♜c8

If 23...a5 then 24.♜b3! and White wins a pawn with the unstoppable threat of ♘xc5.

24.♜b3 ♝d7 25.a5! ♝c6 26.axb6 axb6 27.♜a3

White finally gains a file along which his rook can invade. Black is passive and can only await events.

27... ♖g7 28. ♖a7 ♖c7

Black now offers the exchange of rooks, but White rejects this because he considers, with good judgement, that his rook is better and his advantage greater with the rooks still on the board.

29. ♖a8! ♖e7 30. ♖c8+ ♖d7 31. ♖g8 ♖c6 32. h4 ♖c7 33. g4 ♖c6 34. ♖d3 ♖d7+ 35. ♖c3 ♖f7 36. b3 ♖c7 37. ♖d3 ♖d7+ 38. ♖e2 ♖f7 39. ♖c3

The game is decided. Also winning was 39.g5 h5 40. ♖c3 ♖e7 41. ♖b5+ ♖d7 42. ♖d3 ♖c6 43. ♖e4 ♖b7 44. ♖d8 ♖e7 45. ♖b8, and Black is in zugzwang: if 45... ♖d7 then 46. ♖e8 and the pawn on e6 falls, with a decisive advantage to White.

39... ♖e7 40. g5 hxg5 41. hxg5 ♖c6 42. ♖d3 ♖d7+ 43. ♖e4

White now has his king active. Black will soon be in zugzwang.

43... ♖b7 44. ♖b5 ♖e7 45. f3 ♖d7

If 45... ♖b7 then 46. ♖d6+ ♖c6 47. ♖e8 wins.

46. ♖b8! ♖c6 47. ♖c8+ ♖d7

Again if 47... ♖b7 then after 48. ♖d6+ ♖a7 49. ♖d8, Black is once again in zugzwang: 49... ♖a6 50. ♖a8+ ♖a7 51. ♖xa7+ ♖xa7 52. ♖e8 ♖h8 53. ♖c7 and White wins.

48. ♖c7+ ♖d8 49. ♖c6 ♖b7 50. ♖xe6

And Black resigned.

A great lesson in strategy from Alekhine, who played well to exploit the opponent's doubled pawns.

Up to the 1940s the London System continued to be played by great masters, such as Capablanca and Alekhine. Around 1950 Bondarevsky included it in his repertoire, popularising it in the USSR. We then begin to see this opening in the hands of the elite of the time: Kotov, Smyslov, Ragozin, Bronstein, Keres (we shall see a game of his from 1959 in Chapter 2) and various non-Soviet players, such as Larsen and Benko. Also around the start of the 1950s, in South America, the Argentinean player Manuel Pereyra Puebla came on the scene and began to play the London System on a regular basis. Manuel Pereyra was a strong player who gained his greatest successes in correspondence chess but he also had good results over-the-board, although he never played as a professional.

Pereyra began to develop new lines and variations that differed from the known lines of the London System, so that for the Argentineans it began to be known as the Pereyra System or Attack. His line of attack gained its greatest successes when Black played the orthodox defence with ...d7-d5 and ...e7-e6: Pereyra

developed the plan with ♖e5 and h2-h4, followed by the sacrifice ♕xh7+, with a decisive attack. He had many followers in Argentina and other strong players employed it on a regular basis, such as Guimard, Bauza, Rossetto, Panno and Bolbochan. Pereyra played his opening for more than forty years until his death in 1998.

Pereyra was an International Master of the ICCF (International Correspondence Chess Federation). His highest Elo rating, according to the public archives of the ICCF, was 2321. His last game dates from 1998, but his Elo was acquired a lot earlier, when there were no electronic analysis engines, or only very weak ones, thus his rating corresponds to that of a really strong player. He played in the 11th World Championship Final for correspondence chess, in which he finished in a creditable 7th place out of 17 players. Among the contestants were two former World Correspondence Champions. In an extra chapter in the back of the book we provide further information about him.

Game 5

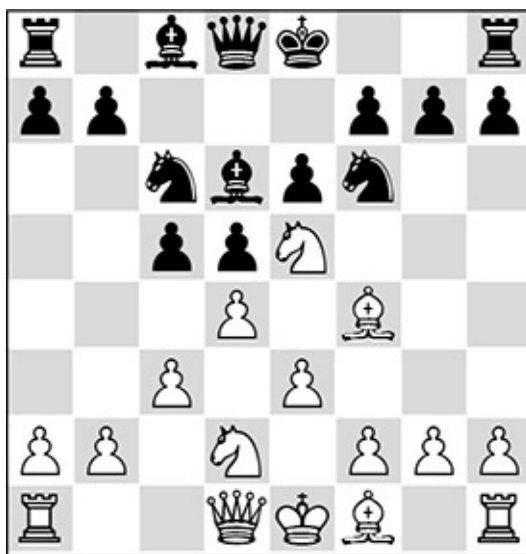
...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Manuel Pereyra Puebla

Juan Cassani

cr Argentina 1982

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 ♘f6 3.♕f4 c5 4.e3 e6 5.♘bd2 ♘c6 6.c3 ♕d6 7.♘e5



The early knight jump to e5 was Pereyra's preference, combined with h2-h4 and an attack on the black king, but he also played 7.dxc5 here, which is an interesting alternative. Another idea, which is more normal in our day, is 7.♕g3, so that if Black exchanges on g3 the h-file is opened, while if Black declines the

exchange, White reinforces the e5-square with moves such as f2-f4 or ♖df3.

7... ♗xe5

Exchanging on e5 so quickly is not Black's best course of action, especially if he has already castled on the kingside. It is more appropriate to play 7... ♔c7 8. ♖df3 0-0 9. ♗d3, with much play ahead.

8.dxe5 ♗d7 9. ♖f3

The immediate 9. ♗g4 was also good.

9...0-0

Here it was better to play 9...h6 or 9... ♗c7.

10. ♗d3 ♗c7?



But now this is a decisive error: it is very dangerous for Black when there is a white pawn on e5 and the f6-knight has had to move, because it leaves Black's castled position vulnerable and White has attacking possibilities. Black needed to play 10...h6 or 10...g6. It is White's move now: how should he begin the attack?

11. ♗xh7+!

A classic and thematic sacrifice which leaves White with a decisive advantage. The reader should familiarise himself with this idea, which we shall examine in greater depth in the theoretical section. This is the Pereyra Attack in its purest form.

11... ♗h8

Capturing the bishop fails to solve the problem: 11... ♗xh7 12. ♖g5+ and now:

A) 12... ♗g6 13. ♗c2+

A1) 13... ♗h6? 14. ♗h7+;

A2) 13... ♗h5? 14. ♗h7+ ♗g4 15.f3+ (15. ♗h3+; 15.h3+);

A3) 13...f5 (the only move) 14.exf6+ ♔xf6 15.♗h7+ ♔f7 16.♕xc7 winning.
 B) 12...♔g8 13.♖h5 ♖d8 14.♖xf7+ ♔h8 15.♖h5+ ♔g8 16.♖h7+ ♔f8
 17.♖h8+ ♔e7 18.♖xg7+ ♔e8 19.♖f7+.

12.♗g5

12.h4 g6 13.h5 also wins.

12...♗cxe5

12...g6 was the most tenacious move, but after 13.h4 ♗dxe5 14.h5 f6 15.hxg6
 fxg5 16.♕xg5 the white attack is winning.

13.♕xe5 ♗xe5

If 13...♖xe5 then 14.♖h5 ♖xg5 15.♖xg5 ♔xh7 and White is left with a
 decisive advantage.

14.♖h5 g6 15.♖h6

1-0

It is mate in four.

An attractive miniature by Manuel, demonstrating the dangerous attacking
 possibilities that White can create in this variation. The idea of the sacrifice on
 h7 should always be kept in mind. Pereyra won many games with such attractive
 attacks.

At the end of the 1970s and the start of the 1980s the system continued to be
 played by strong players, such as the young Garry Kasparov in 1977. Special
 mention should be made of the Yugoslav Vlatko Kovacevic, who was one of the
 greatest specialists in the 1980s and was the author of a book on the London
 System in 2005. Other compatriots of his, such as Nikolic or Knezevic, have also
 played it. In Spain, Bellon and Rivas began to play it.
 Let's look at an example from the young Kasparov.

Game 6

Garry Kasparov

Edvins Kengis

Riga ch-URS U20 1977

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 b6 3.♕f4 ♕b7 4.e3 c5 5.♗bd2 g6 6.c3 ♗g7 7.h3 0-0 8.♕e2 ♗c6 9.0-0 d6
 10.a4



By transposition we have reached a line of the King's Indian. Black can also develop the knight at d7 instead of c6. The thematic move a2-a4 gains space on the queenside.

10...a6 11. Nc4!?

An interesting idea. Kasparov wants to play a4-a5 at some point to weaken the enemy queenside and if Black then plays ...b6-b5, White could bring the knight to b6. The text move invites Black to advance with ...b6-b5 or ...d6-d5. Alternatives in this position include 11. Qh2 and 11. Re1.

11...b5 12. Nc3

This is better than 12. axb5 axb5 13. Qb3 (13. Nc4 b4=) 13...bxc4 14. Qxb7 Nc3 15. Qb5 cxd4 16. cxd4 Qc7, with an equal position.

12...b4 13. cxb4 Nxb4?!

A dubious move. It was better to play the natural 13...cxb4 14. Nc4 Nc3 15. Nfd2, and the position is equal.

14. dxc5 Nfd5!?



Kengis enters complications, but even against a young Kasparov this was a risky thing to do.

Quieter play follows after 14...dxc5 15.♘c4, although White is better in view of the weakness on c5.

15.cxd6 ♙xb2 16.♙h6

Here 16.♙g5 ♙xd6 17.♘c4 ♙c5 18.♘xb2 was good, when White wins a piece but Black is able to recover it after a long sequence, which would have been difficult to calculate; even so, White emerges with an advantage after 18...♘c3 19.♖c1 ♘ba2 20.♖c2 ♖fc8 21.♘d3 ♙f5 22.♙e1 ♘xe2+ 23.♙xe2 ♖xc2 24.♙xc2 ♙xf3 25.♙xe7.

16... ♙e8?

A blunder by Kengis; it was essential to play 16...♘c3 17.dxe7 ♙xe7 18.♙xf8 ♖xf8 19.♙d2 ♙xa1 20.♖xa1 ♘xe2+ 21.♙xe2 ♖c8 and Black has compensation, thanks to the strong bishop on b7.



17.d7!

The future World Champion does not pass up the opportunity.

17... ♖xd7 18. ♗c4 ♘xa1 19. ♗xa1

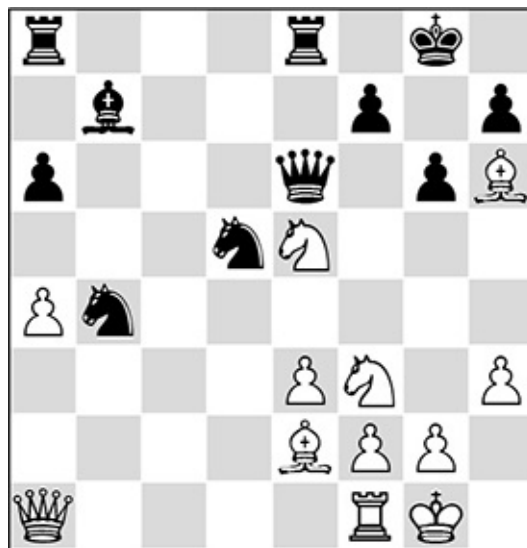
White has a clear advantage; he has sacrificed the exchange but has very direct threats against Black's castled position, weakened by the absence of Black's dark-squared bishop.

19...e5?

This loses, because White takes on e5 and then the diagonal a1-h8 decides the game, but 19...f6 would not save Black in any case after 20.e4 ♗c7 21. ♗b6.

The best defence was to return some material with 19... ♗f6 20. ♗b6 ♖f5 21. ♗xa8 ♘xa8 22. ♖c1, but White is left with an advantage, thanks to his pair of bishops, especially the one on h6, which has no opponent.

20. ♗cxe5 ♖e6



21. ♖g4! f6

The only defence against the mate on g7.

22. ♗c4!

The pin by this bishop proves decisive; Black has no satisfactory defence.

22... ♜f8 23.e4

Black resigned, because after 23... ♙xe4 24. ♖xf6+ ♜xf6 25. ♙xf6 he is unable to prevent the mate.

By the 1990s many masters were playing the London System, among whom we might single out the English grandmasters Hebden (the great specialist in the Barry Attack) and Hodgson, the Czech grandmaster Blatny, who introduced new ideas in some lines, the Serbs Vlatko and Slobodan Kovacevic, and many others, too numerous to mention. The quantity of games from the middle of the 1990s till the present day has grown exponentially, since there are more and more active players and thus more games played. Game databases have also played an important role, thanks to the arrival of computers. As we noted at the start of this book, nowadays it is a very popular opening, both among club players and strong masters, who continue to use the London System as an opening which is solid yet does not renounce the struggle to gain an opening advantage. We now close this brief historical survey with a game featuring a mixture of the London System and the Barry Attack.

Game 7

Markus Bawart

2330

Manfred Schumi

2260

Austria Bundesliga 1998/99

1. ♖f3 ♖f6 2.d4 g6 3. ♗f4 ♗g7 4. ♖bd2 d5

Black renounces the King's Indian setup, which we shall examine in greater detail in Chapter 2.

5.e3 0-0 6. ♗d3 b6 7. ♖e5 ♗b7 8.h4!?



White uses an idea from the Barry Attack, ♖e5 and h2-h4, but with the knight on d2 instead of c3, which is its natural post in the Barry.

8... ♗bd7 9.h5 ♗xe5?

This is an error. Also bad is 9... ♗xh5, which leaves White with a decisive advantage after the thematic exchange sacrifice on h5: 10. ♖xh5! gxf5 11. ♗xh5 ♗f6 12. ♗h4 c5 13. ♗g5 ♗e4 (13...c4 14. ♗f5; 13... ♖e8 14. ♗h6 ♗xh6 15. ♗xh6 c4 16. ♗xh7+ ♗xh7 17. ♗h5 ♗d6 18. ♗xf7+ ♗h8 19. ♗g6+ ♗xg6 20. ♗xg6+-) 14. ♗xe7 ♗c7 15. ♗xe4 dxe4 16. ♗g4! ♗h8 (16...exd3 17. ♗f6+ ♗xf6 18. ♗g4+ ♗g7 19. ♗f6 with unstoppable mate) 17. ♗f6 h6 18. ♗xe4.

The correct move was 9...c5! 10.hxg6 hxg6 11.c3 and White's advantage is only slight.

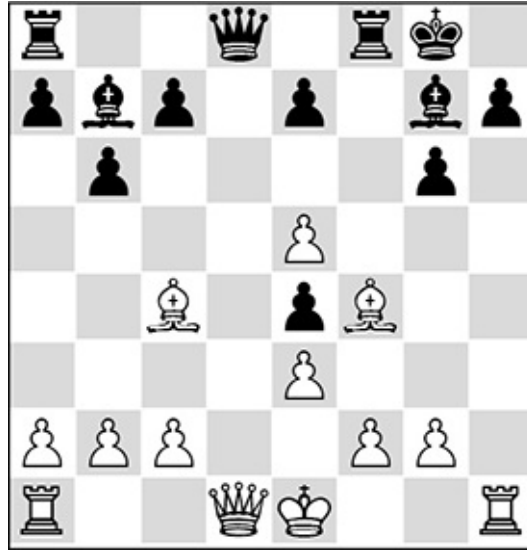
10.dxe5 ♗e4

Once again 10... ♗xh5 is bad on account of 11. ♖xh5! gxf5 12. ♗xh5 f5 13.exf6 ♖xf6 14. ♗xh7+ ♗f8 15. ♗f3 and White has a winning attack. If 10... ♗d7 then 11.hxg6 hxg6 (if 11...fxg6 12. ♖xh7! wins) 12.e6, and White again has a decisive advantage.

11.hxg6 fxg6

Or 11...hxg6 12. ♗g4 ♖e8 13. ♗xe4 dxe4 14. ♗h3 e6 (14...exd3 15. ♗h7+ ♗f8 16. ♗h6+-) 15. ♗h7+ ♗f8 16. ♗h6 ♗xh6 17. ♗xh6+ ♗e7 18. ♗b5 ♖g8 (18...c6 19. ♗h4+ ♗f8 20. ♗h8+ ♗e7 21. ♗f6+ ♗d7 22. ♖d1+-) 19. ♖d1 and White wins.

12. ♗xe4 dxe4 13. ♗c4+-

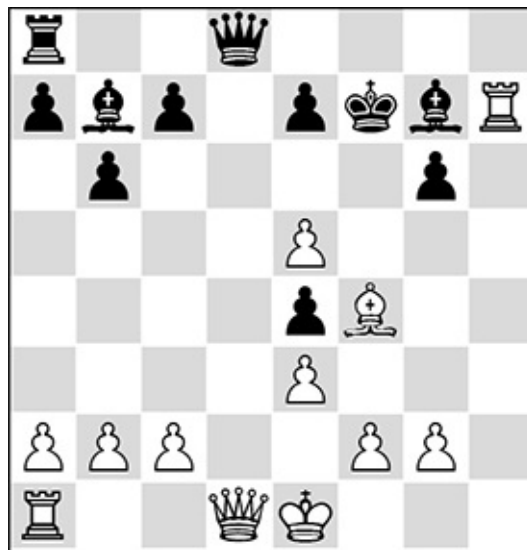


13... Rf7

A sad necessity: if 13... Kh8 14. Kg4, with the immediate threat of 15. Qxg6. The apparent defence 14... Ke8 is refuted with the sacrifice 15. Rxf7+! Kxf7 16. Bh4+ Kh6 17. Bxh6 mate.

14. Rxf7+ Kxf7 15. Rxf7

White is the exchange and a pawn up, so that the win is now only a question of technique.



15... Kg8 16. Qxd8+ Rxd8 17. Rf7 Kh1 18. Rf7 d1 19. Qxd1 c5 20. Qc1 Qd5 21. e6+!?

Many moves win, such as the quiet 21.a3.

21... Qxe6 22. Qb8 Qd7 23. Rf7 Rf7 24. Qxa7 Qxa2

If 24... Qe6 then 25. Rf7 d8, with an easy win for White.

25. Rf7 Qe5 26. b3 c4

If 26... ♖b7 then 27. ♖d7++-.

27. ♖c8+

Black resigned.

After 27... ♖b7 28. ♖xc4 ♖xa7 29. ♖a4+, White wins.

How This Book Is Organised

Following the introduction and our brief historical survey of the opening, the book is divided into chapters according to Black's responses, with the most typical defences being the Indian defences, the Grünfeld, the Benoni etc. There is also a division according to whether Black plays ...d7-d5 or not. Finally we shall cover Black's less frequent replies.

We shall present the material in the form of complete, annotated model games, not only to illustrate the different variations that can arise but also to study the middlegames and endgames. In the notes to each game we shall cover the theory of the opening and provide brief references to other relevant games.

We shall round off the book with sixty thematic exercises, both tactical and strategic, to test the knowledge acquired from reading the book.

The London System can usually be found in the Encyclopaedia of Chess Openings under the codes A45-48, D00-D02 and D10.

Finally we should like to thank all the many club players who inspired us to write this book.

GM Alfonso Romero and FM Oscar de Prado, 2016

Chapter 2

The London System versus the Grünfeld

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♖f4 g6 3.e3 ♖g7 4.♘f3 0-0



5.♗e2

5.♘bd2

5.♗d3

5...d5

5...♘h5

6.0-0

6.♘c3

6.h3

6...c5 7.c3 ♘c6

7...b6

7...cxd4

7...♔b6

8.♘bd2

8.dxc5

8...♔b6

8...b6
8...cxd4
9. ♖b3 c4 10. ♖a3

We begin the analysis of the various Indian defences against the London System with the Grünfeld, which is characterised by Black's kingside fianchetto (...g7-g6) and the move ...d7-d5. This can be reached via 1...d5 or 1...♘f6. As we shall see, the presence of the pawn on d5 makes quite an important difference in comparison with the King's Indian, in which Black plays ...d7-d6, since now the advance ...e7-e5 by Black isn't as strong and is less of a worry to White. In addition, the bishop on f4 has an open diagonal, which increases its power.

There are various plans available: White can play c2-c3 and ♖b3, or else play c2-c4. Normally the king's bishop goes to e2, which seems best against the lines with ...g7-g6, but White can also develop the bishop to d3, with the idea of advancing with e3-e4. If Black exchanges on d4 soon and we recapture with the e-pawn, we reach positions from the Exchange Variation of the Caro-Kann, normally arising from 1.e4 c6 2.d4 d5 3.exd5 cxd5 4.♙d3 ♘c6 5.c3 ♗f6 6.♙f4, where now the line with ...g7-g6 is one of Black's options. Finally White has the option of transposing to the Barry Attack by playing ♗c3, which was very popular a few years ago, especially with English players such as Hebden, and which is still played today.

Game 8

Grünfeld Indian

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2233

Antonio Pazos Porta

2363

Puentedeume 2013 (3)

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♙f4 g6 3.e3 ♗g7 4.♗f3 0-0 5.♙e2 d5



The Grünfeld Defence against the London System; instead, 5...d6 would lead to the King's Indian.

If 5... ♖h5, a thematic idea, harassing the bishop, then 6. ♕g5 (6. ♕e5 f6 7. ♕g3 ♖xg3) 6...h6 7. ♕h4 g5 and now White emerges in good shape after the alternatives:

A) 8. ♖fd2 ♖f6 (8... ♖f4 9.exf4 gxf4 10.c3; 8...gxf4 9. ♕xh5) 9. ♕g3;

B) 8.g4! ♖f6 9. ♕g3 ♖e4 (9... ♖xg4 10.h4±) 10. ♖c3 (10.h4 ♖xg3 11.fxf3, 10. ♖d3) 10... ♖xg3 11.hxf3±.

6.0-0

Here 6. ♖c3 is also possible, transposing to the Barry Attack, which we shall examine later. Another alternative is 6. ♖bd2 c5 (6... ♖h5 7. ♕g5 h6 8. ♕h4 g5 9. ♖e5 ♖f6 10. ♕g3) 7.c3 ♖c6 8.h3, while 6.h3 is also playable.

6...c5

A) Once again 6... ♖h5 is playable:



analysis diagram

A1) 7. ♖e5 f6 8. ♖g3 ♗xg3 9. hxg3 and now there are two alternatives:

A11) 9... e5 10. c4 exd4 11. ♗xd4 dxc4 (11... c5 12. ♗b3 f5 13. ♗c3 d4 14. exd4 cxd4 15. ♗b5 ♗c6 16. c5=) 12. ♖xc4+ ♔h8 13. ♗c3 f5 14. ♔e2, with a slight advantage to White;

A12) 9... ♖e6 10. c4 dxc4 (10... c6 11. ♔b3) 11. ♗a3 and White is a bit better;

A2) 7. ♖g5 h6 8. ♖h4 g5 9. ♗e5 ♗f6 10. ♖g3 ♗e4 11. c4 ♗xg3 12. hxg3 c5 13. cxd5 cxd4 14. exd4 ♗xd5 15. ♗c3 ♗d6 16. ♖f3, and now:

A21) 16... ♗d7 17. ♗c4 (17. ♗xd7 ♖xd7 is also better for White) 17... ♗xd4 18. ♗xd4 ♖xd4 19. ♗d5 e6 20. ♗e7+ ♗g7 21. ♗d6 ♗b6 22. ♖ad1 ♖e5 23. ♗exc8 ♗xc8 24. ♗xb7 ♗b6= (24... ♖xb2 25. ♖b1 with advantage to White);

A22) 16... ♖xe5 17. dxe5 ♗xe5 18. ♖e1 with advantage to White;

Other options for Black on move 6 leave White with some advantage:

B) 6... ♖g4?! 7. h3 ♖xf3 8. ♖xf3 c6 9. ♗d2 ♗bd7 10. c4±;

C) 6... b6 7. c4 ♖b7 8. ♗c3±.

7.c3 ♗c6

It is better to play 7... ♗b6 immediately, to anticipate 8. dxc5. The variation 8. ♗b3 c4 (8... ♗xb3 9. axb3 cxd4 10. exd4 ♗c6 11. b4 ♖f5 12. ♗bd2±) 9. ♗a3 ♗c6 transposes to the game.

Now 7... ♗h5 is dubious in view of 8. ♖e5 (8. ♖xb8 ♗xb8 9. dxc5 is interesting and it is not easy for Black to regain the pawn) and now 8... f6?! fails to 9. ♖xb8! ♗xb8 10. ♗e1±, winning a pawn.

Also frequently played is 7... b6, which we shall look at in another game.

7... ♗bd7 8. h3 (8. h4!?) 8... b6 transposes to the lines with ...b7-b6.



8. ♖bd2

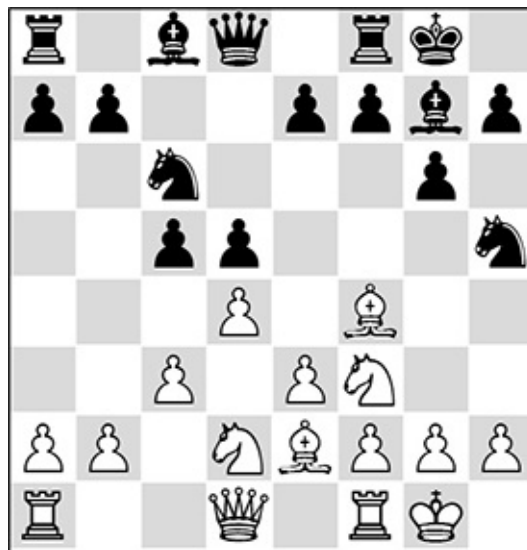
The alternative in this move order is to play 8.dxc5!, a move which we shall also see in the following game.

8... ♗b6

The most incisive. Again 8...b6 is possible. Also 8... ♘d7 9. ♗b3 c4 (9...e5!? 10.dxe5 ♘dxe5 11. ♖ad1±) 10. ♗b5 ♘f6 11.b3±.

8...cxd4 9.exd4 will be examined in another game.

Let us consider the critical move 8... ♘h5 once more:



analysis diagram

A) 9. ♘g5 h6 10. ♘h4 g5 11. ♘e1 ♘f6 12. ♘g3, and now:

A1) 12...cxd4 13.exd4 ♘f5 14. ♗b3 ♗b6 15. ♗xb6 (15.h3) 15...axb6 16.a3±;

A2) 12... ♘d7 13. ♘f3 cxd4 14.cxd4 e6 15. ♘d3;

B) 9.dxc5!? ♖xf4 10.exf4 d4 11.cxd4 ♖xd4 12.♗c4 ♖xf3+ (12...♗xe2+ 13.♗xe2±) 13.♗xf3 ♜c7 14.♗e3 ♗xb2 (14...♗xc5 15.♞c1 ♗a5 16.♗d5±, 14...♗xf4 15.♗d5±) 15.♞b1 ♗g7 16.♗c1±.

9. ♗b3 c4

There is no need to fear 9...♗xb3 10.axb3, since White has the better ending, thanks to the half-open a-file and his superior pawn structure on the queenside, e.g. 10...cxd4 11.exd4 ♗f5 12.b4 a6 13.h3±.

Black has also tried 9...♗a5!? 10.♞fc1 (10.dxc5 ♗xc5 11.h3± and 10.♗b5 ♗xb5 11.♗xb5 cxd4 12.exd4± are better) 10...♗h5!? 11.♗g5?! (11.♗xd5) 11...h6 12.♗h4 g5 13.♗g3? (13.♗xg5 hxg5 14.♗xg5 is better for Black but White has some compensation) 13...♗xg3 14.hxg3 g4⚡, Burmakin-Razmyslov, Seville 2012.

If 9...♞e8?! then 10.♗xb6 axb6 11.♗c7 ♗d7 (11...cxd4 12.exd4 ♗f5 13.♗xb6±) 12.a4±.

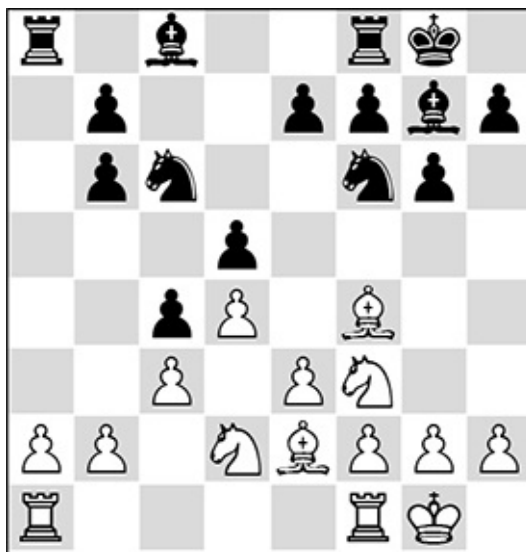
Or 9...♗f5? 10.h3? (10.dxc5±) 10...cxd4 11.♗xb6±, De Prado-Rodriguez, Ferrol 2013.

10. ♗a3!



White cannot usually play this move in the lines where Black has his king's bishop on the a3-f8 diagonal, but here it is possible, with the idea of playing a quick b2-b3 and gaining the advantage on the queenside. It is also possible to exchange on b6:

10. ♗xb6 axb6, and now:



analysis diagram

A) 11. ♖e5 ♗xe5 (11...b5) 12. ♕xe5 ♕d7 13. ♕f3 ♕c6=, Wang-Li, Tianjin 2001;

B) 11.h3 b5 12.a3 ♗f5 13.g4 ♕e6 14. ♖e5= Thejkumar-Sriram, Chennai 2008;

C) 11.b3! b5 12.a4 b4! (12... ♖e4 13. ♖xe4 dxe4 14. ♖d2±; 12...bxa4 13.bxc4 dxc4 14. ♕xc4 and although the position is equal I prefer White) 13. ♖fc1 cxb3 14. ♖xb3 bxc3 15. ♖xc3 ♗f5 (15... ♖e4 16. ♖cc1=) 16. ♖fd2, with equality in an interesting position.

10... ♗a5

This move is a recent novelty. Other options include:

10...h6. This move was played against me the previous day by another player belonging to the same team as my present opponent; it would seem that they had prepared this line together.

A) 11.b3 cxb3 (11... ♖h5 12.bxc4 ♖xf4 13.exf4±) 12.axb3 ♖h5 13. ♕e5 ♖xe5 14.dxe5 ♗c7 15.c4 ♕xe5 16. ♖xe5 ♗xe5 17.cxd5 ♗xd5 18. ♖c4±;

B) 11.h3 g5 12. ♕h2 a6 13.b3 (13.e4!±) 13...cxb3 14.axb3, with a clear advantage to White, De Prado-Ines Prado, Puente deume 2013.

The familiar 10... ♖h5 is again possible, and after 11. ♕g5:

A) 11...f6 12. ♕h4 and now:

A1) 12...g5 13. ♖e1!. Keep in mind that White almost always has the possibility of attacking the black knight in order to prevent the capture of the bishop (13. ♕g3 ♖xg3 14.hxg3, followed by b2-b3, with the better game for White) 13...gxh4 (13... ♖f4 14.exf4 gxh4) 14. ♕xh5±;

A2) 12...e5 13.b3 cxb3 (13...e4 14. ♖e1) 14.axb3 g5 15. ♕g3 ♖xg3 16.hxg3

e4 17. ♖h2 f5 18.c4 f4 19.cxd5 fxe3 20. ♖c4! Black now gets three pawns for the piece, but White retains the advantage: 20...exf2+ 21. ♔h1 ♕c7 22.dxc6 ♕xd4 23. ♖ad1 ♕e5 24. ♖xe5 ♕xe5 25. ♕c4+ ♕g7 26.cxb7 ♕xb7 27. ♖d7+ ♕g6 28. ♖xb7 ♖ad8 29. ♕xa7 1-0, S.Kovacevic-McMahon, Massy 1993.

B) 11...h6 and now:



analysis diagram

B1) Taking on e7 leads nowhere: 12. ♕xe7 ♖xe7 13. ♕xe7 ♕xb2 14.a3 (14. ♖ab1 ♕xa2 15. ♖a1 ♕b2 16. ♖fb1 ♕xc3 17. ♖c1 ♕b2 18. ♖ab1 ♕a2 with a draw) 14... ♖f6 15. ♕b4 ♕xb4 16.axb4=;

B2) 12. ♕h4 g5 13. ♖e1! (it is important to remember this idea!) 13... ♖f6 (13...gxf4 14. ♕xf4; 13... ♖f4 14.exf4 gxf4 and in both cases I prefer White's position) 14. ♕g3 ♖e8 15.b3 e5 and now:

B21) 16.dxe5 ♖xe5 17.bxc4 (17. ♕xe5 ♖xe5 18.bxc4 dxc4 19. ♖xc4 ♕c5 and Black has compensation) 17... ♖xc4 18. ♖xc4 dxc4 19. ♕xc4 ♖e4=;

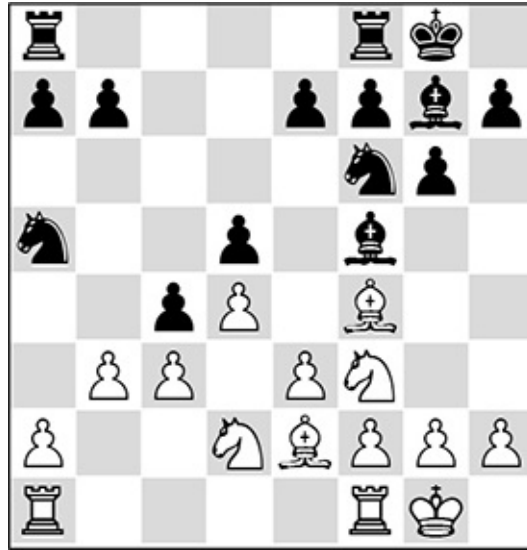
B22) 16.bxc4 ♕f8 17.c5 exd4 18.cxd4 ♖xd4 19.exd4 ♖xe2 20. ♖ef3 and the play is complicated, with chances for both sides.

The move 10... ♕d8 has also been played: 11.b3 (11. ♖e5, 11.h3) 11...b5 12. ♕c5 ♕b6 (the only move) 13. ♕xb6 axb6 14.a4 cxb3? (14...bxa4 15.bxc4 dxc4 16. ♕xc4, reaching the same ending that we saw in an earlier variation; it can be evaluated as equal but I prefer White on account of his structure) 15.axb5 ±, Olbrich-Koglin, Dresden 1998.

11. ♕xa5 ♖xa5 12.b3

Implementing White's thematic idea of breaking quickly on b3. Other good options were 12. ♖e5! ♕f5 13.g4 ♕e6 14.b3± and 12. ♖fe1! ♕f5 13. ♖e5 ♖ac8 14.g4 ♕e6 15.g5±.

12... ♖f5!



A good move, since White cannot take the pawn and Black completes his development. If 12...cxb3 then 13.axb3±.

13. ♗e5

There is no advantage in 13.bxc4 ♗xc4 14. ♗xc4 dxc4 15. ♗xc4 ♖ac8 16. ♗b3 (16. ♗e5 ♗h5=) 16... ♖xc3 and Black is at least equal. 13. ♖fe1 was also interesting.

13... ♖ac8

13... ♗e4 14. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 15.b4 ♗c6 16. ♗d7 ♖fe8 17. ♗c5±, 13... ♗h5 14. ♗xh5 gxh5 15.e4±.

14.bxc4 dxc4

14... ♗xc4 15. ♗exc4 dxc4 16. ♗f3! b6 17.e4 ♗d7 18.e5 ♗e8 (18... ♗h5±) 19. ♗b7 ♖b8 20. ♗d5±.

15. ♖fc1

White can maintain the advantage with 15. ♗f3!. The idea is to play e3-e4 and create a strong centre, while the knight on a5 remains passive, defending the pawn on c4. A possible continuation is 15... ♗d7 16. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 17. ♖ab1 b6 18.h3±. The idea seen earlier of 15.g4 ♗e6 16.e4± is also good.

15... ♗e4

The Houdini engine prefers 15... ♗d5 16. ♗g3 ♗xe5!? (a difficult move for a human player to make) 17. ♗xe5 ♗d3, with equality, although after 18. ♗f3 ♖fd8 19.e4 ♗f6 20.h3 I prefer White.

16. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 17.f3 ♗xe5

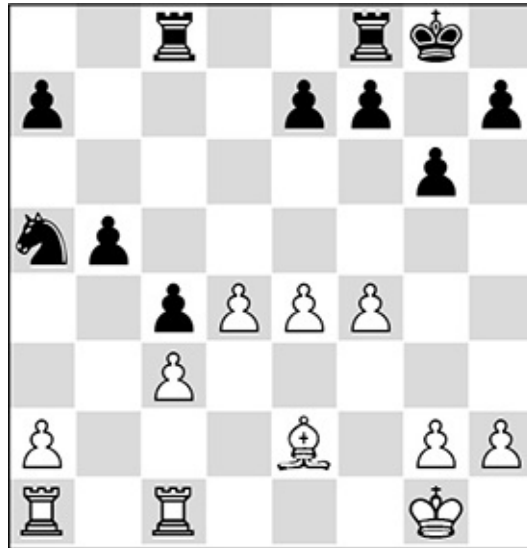
This move is now necessary. After 17... ♗f5 18.e4 ♗e6 (18...f6 19. ♗xc4 ♗xc4 20.exf5 gxf5 21. ♖ab1±) 19.d5 ♗xe5 20. ♗xe5 ♗d7 21. ♖ab1, White

has a clear advantage.

18.fxe4!

At first it seemed best to take on e5: 18. ♖xe5 ♖d3! 19. ♖xd3 (19. ♔f2=) 19... cxd3 20.d5 ♗c4 21. ♖d4 and I thought that now the pawn would soon fall, but this is not the case. Black has the advantage here: 21...e5 (21...d2 22. ♖d1 ♖fd8 23.e4 e6 24.dxe6 fxe6 ♞) 22.dxe6 fxe6 23.f4 (23. ♖xa7 b6) 23...b6 24. ♖d1 d2 ♞.

18... ♖xf4 19.exf4 b5



After the exchanges we have reached this position, where White is better, thanks to his strong centre and the fact that the bishop is superior to the knight.

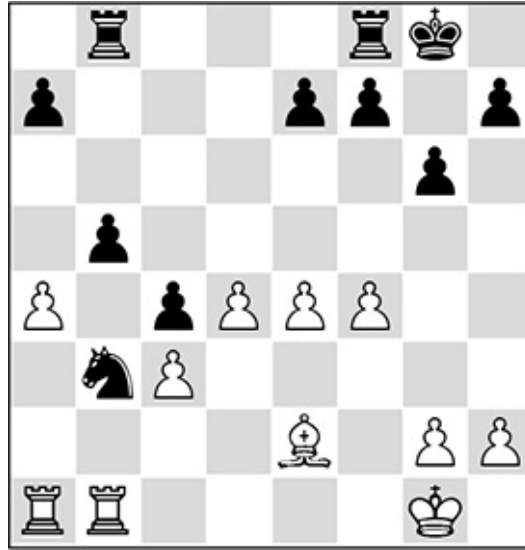
20. ♖cb1

Here there were better moves, such as 20. ♖ab1 a6 21.e5 ♖b8 22. ♖d1 e6 23. ♖f3, or 20.e5 e6 21. ♖f3, with a comfortable advantage to White in both cases.

20... ♖b8 21.a4?!

This move is dubious; I considered only a tactical idea that would lead to the win of a pawn and an exchange sacrifice. Instead, 21.e5 maintains the advantage, as does 21. ♖b2 ♞.

21... ♗b3



22. ♖a2

My first idea was to sacrifice the exchange, which looked promising, but concrete analysis does not support this. After 22. ♖xb3 cxb3 White has two ways to take the pawn:

A) 23. axb5 ♖fc8! 24. ♖c1 (24. c4 was my original idea, but this fails to 24... b2 25. ♖b1 ♖xb5!—+) 24... b2 25. ♖b1 ♖xc3 26. ♖xb2 a6±;

B) 23. ♗xb5 ♖fc8! 24. c4 ♖xb5 25. axb5 ♖xc4 26. ♖b1 ♖b4 27. ♕f2 ♖xb5 28. ♕e3 a5 29. ♕d2 a4 and this ending should be winning for Black.

22... ♖fc8?

A blunder caused by time pressure. Black could equalise with 22... b4! 23. cxb4 (23. ♗xc4 ♗a5 24. ♗b5 bxc3 25. ♖d1=) 23... ♖xb4 (23... ♖fc8) 24. ♗xc4 ♖xc4 25. ♖xb3 ♖xd4 26. ♖b7 ♖a8 27. ♖xe7 ♕f8 28. ♖e5 ♖e8 29. ♖xe8+ ♕xe8 30. ♕f2 ♖xe4=.

23. axb5 ♖xb5 24. ♖ab2?

Returning the favour. White could retain his clear advantage with 24. ♖d1. Black will be unable to defend his weaknesses on a7 and c4, whereas White maintains a good pawn structure in the event of:

A) 24... ♖c7 25. ♕f2± (25. ♖a4);

B) 24... ♖b7 25. ♖a4 ♖bc7 26. ♕f2±;

C) 24... ♖a5 25. ♖xa5 ♗xa5 26. ♖a1 ♗b3 27. ♖xa7±.

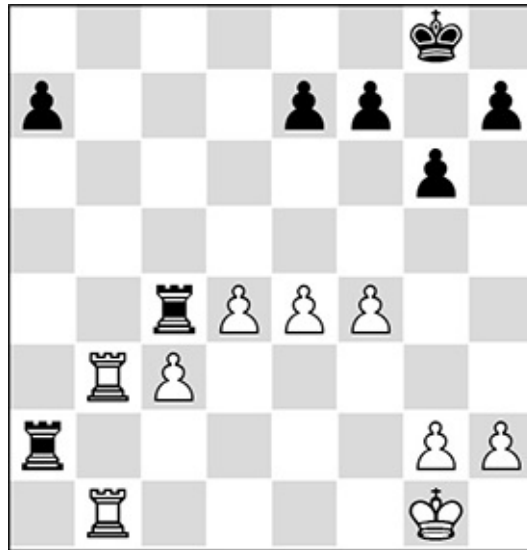
24... ♖a5

24... ♗c1? 25. ♖xb5 ♗xe2+ 26. ♕f2 ♗xc3 27. ♖b8 and White wins.

25. ♗xc4?!

Finally White wins a pawn, but this is not sufficient to gain the advantage in the rook ending. It was better to play 25. f5 gxf5 26. exf5 ♕g7± or 25. ♕f2±.

25... ♖xc4 26. ♖xb3 ♖a2



One black rook is active on the seventh rank and the other one is putting pressure on c3, meaning that White is unable to exchange a pair of rooks without losing a pawn. The game should now be a draw.

27.h3 a5 28.♖c1 ♜e2

Or 28...a4 29.♖b8+ ♔g7 30.♖b7 a3 31.♖a7=.

29.e5 ♜a4 30.c4 ♜aa2 31.♜g3 ♜f8 32.c5

Or 32.d5 ♜ec2 33.♜xc2 ♜xc2 34.♜a3 ♜xc4 35.♜xa5 ♜xf4=.

32...e6 33.c6 ♜ac2 34.♜xc2 ♜xc2 35.♜a3 ♜xc6 36.♜xa5 ♜c4 37.♜a8+ ♜e7 38.♜a7+ ♜e8

½-½

SUMMARY

In this game we saw that it is not essential for White to play h2-h3, although it is simpler to play with h2-h3 to prevent the lines with ...♘h5. The idea of ♔a3! is very interesting, taking advantage of the absence of the black bishop from the a3-f8 diagonal. Black gains some space with ...c5-c4, but with the thematic break b2-b3 White either gains some advantage or else reaches a very comfortable endgame. The idea of ...♔a5 does not appear to be unpleasant for White, who is able to maintain some advantage at no risk.

Game 9

Grünfeld Indian

Tomasz Markowski

2558

Chorzow ch-POL 2013 (7)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f3 d5 3.c3!?

An interesting move order, aimed at preventing some of Black's lines with ...c7-c5 and a quick ...♗b6.

3...g6 4.♗f4 ♘g7 5.e3 0-0 6.♗e2

The variation that we shall see in this game is even better for White with the inclusion of the move h2-h3:

6.h3 c5 7.♗bd2 ♘c6 (to avoid this line Black should play ...♗b6 first) 8.dxc5! and now:



analysis diagram

A) 8...a5 9.a4 ♗d7 (9...♗f5 10.♗b3 ♗c8 11.♗d4± Sergeev-Juhasz, Aschach 2009) 10.♗b3 e5 and now:

A1) 11.♗g3 e4 12.♗fd4 ♗e5 13.♗xe5 ♗dxe5 14.♗b5 ♗g5 15.♗f1 ♗d8 16.♗e2 ♗c4 17.♗bd4?! (17.♗c2!±) 17...♗xb2, Garcia Palermo-Adorjan, Germany Bundesliga 1989/90;

A2) 11.♗g5! (as we shall see in another game, it is better to move the bishop to g5 rather than g3) 11...♗f6 12.♗b5 ♗c7 13.0-0 (13.♗h4 ♗e6 14.0-0±, Ghane Gardeh-Mallahi, Iran Championship 2000. Also good is 13.♗fd2!±) 13...♗e6 14.♗bd2?! (the right move is 14.♗fd2!±) 14...♗d7= Pomes Marcet-Lautier, Terrassa 1991;

B) 8...♗e8 9.♗b5! ♗d7 10.♗b3! a6 (10...e5 11.♗g3±) 11.♗e2 (11.♗a4!?±) 11...e6 12.♗d6± Alcaraz Ortega-Cruz Lledo, Cullera 2012;

C) 8...♗e8!? (Morozevich's move) 9.♗e2 ♗c7, and now:

C1) The right move is 10. ♖h2! e5 (10... ♖e6 11. ♖b3± and it is not clear how Black is going to regain the pawn. If 11...a5 then 12.a4! ♖e6 12.b4±. Again it is not easy for Black to regain his pawn, since if 12...e4 13. ♖d4, with a clear advantage to White;

C2) 10. ♖b3? e5 11. ♖h2 a5!? (Black could now regain the pawn with the simple 11... ♖e7=) 12.a4 ♖e7 13. ♖b5± Jadrijevic-Morozevich, Zurich 2009;

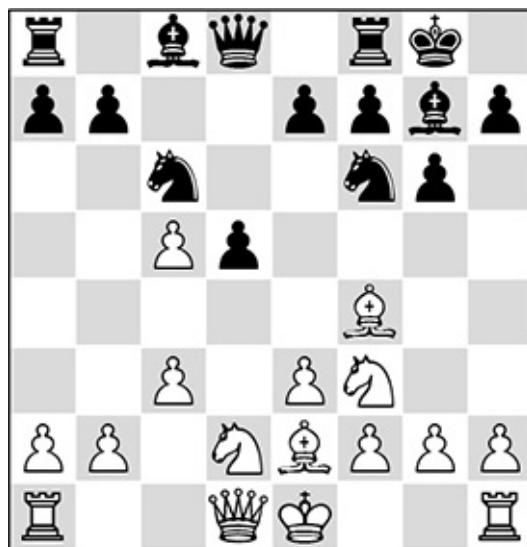
D) 8... ♖d7 9. ♖b3 e5 10. ♖g5 ♖f6 (10...f6? 11. ♖xd5+) 11. ♖b5 h6 12. ♖h4 g5 (12... ♖e8±) 13. ♖g3 ♖e4 14. ♖xc6? (14. ♖h2±) 14... ♖xg3 15. ♖xb7 ♖xb7 16.fxg3= P.S.Nielsen-H.Olsen, Copenhagen 1993;

E) 8... ♖h5?! 9. ♖h2 f5?! 10. ♖b5 f4 11.exf4?! (11.0-0!±; 11.e4±) 11... ♖xf4 12. ♖xf4 ♖xf4 13. ♖e2 (13.0-0) 13...e5 Sedlak-Brenjo, Vrnjacka Banja 2013.

6...c5 7. ♖bd2 ♖c6

To prevent the line in the game, Black should play 7... ♖b6 right away.

8.dxc5!



In this move order, this capture is not only possible but good, since even though it gives up the centre and allows Black to play ...e7-e5, the pawn is not easy to regain for Black, because White has moves such as b2-b4 or ♖b3. It also contains the idea of ♖b5, to put pressure on e5, so I recommend this capture, which furthermore could well take the opponent by surprise.

8...a5

A move to prevent b2-b4 or deter ♖b3, in view of the reply ...a5-a4. Here 8... ♖e8 9.0-0 e5 has also been played, and now:

A) 10. ♖g3 a5 (10... ♖f5 is better) 11. ♖a4 (11. ♖b5!± – again this is a thematic idea to put pressure on the c6-knight and attack e5) 11... ♖d7 12. ♖b5 ♖e7 13. ♖b3 ♖e4 14. ♖fd1 ♖xc5 15. ♖xc5 ♖xc5 16.e4 d4 Miles-Lautier,

Ohrid 2001;

B) 10. ♖g5! (we have already seen in the analysis of the line with h2-h3 above (the game Pomes Marcet-Lautier) that it is better to move the bishop to g5 rather than g3) 10...h6 11. ♖xf6 ♗xf6 12.e4! ♕e6 (12...d4 13. ♖c1±) 13.exd5 (13. ♗b3!±) 13... ♖xd5 14. ♖c4 ♗e7 (14... ♖ad8!±) 15. ♖e1± Megaranto-Chu Wei Chao, Shijiazhuang 2013.

Perhaps the best move is 8... ♗h5!?, which works best when White has not played h2-h3: 9. ♖g5 h6 10. ♖h4 g5 11. ♗d4 e5 and now:



analysis diagram

A) 12. ♗b5! gxf4 (12... ♗f6 13. ♖g3±; 12...b6!? 13. ♖xh5 gxf4 14.c4±) 13. ♖xh5 ♕e6 14. ♗d6 b6 15.c4 bxc5 16.cxd5 ♖xd5 17. ♗2c4 and White has the advantage, on account of his better pawn structure and strong knight on c4;

B) 12. ♗4b3 ♗f6 13. ♖g3 ♖f5 14.h4 (14.0-0) with a complicated position. Black has a fine pair of centre pawns, but White is a pawn up.

9.a4! ♗h5

Here 9... ♖e8 has been played, but this is inferior on account of 10. ♖b5!; again we see this move, fighting for the e5-square (or 10. ♖g5 h6 11. ♖xf6 ♗xf6 12.0-0 e5 13.e4± (13. ♗b3±), Vojinovic-Ziaziulkina, Athens 2012): 10... ♗h5 11. ♖g5 h6 12. ♖h4 ♖f5 (12...g5? 13. ♗d4±; again this thematic move, to prevent Black from being able to exchange White's dark-squared bishop without making some concession) 13.0-0±, Torre-Vidit, Subic Bay 2009.

10. ♖g5! h6 11. ♖h4 g5

11...b6!? is a thematic idea in some variations. It sacrifices a pawn to open the b-file, but in this position it does not work very well because of 12.cxb6! (better than 12. ♗b3 bxc5 13. ♗xc5 ♗b6 14. ♗xd5 ♖d8, which gives Black excellent

compensation) 12... ♖xb6 (12... g5 13. ♘d4 ♘xd4 14.cxd4 gxh4 15.b7 ♙xb7 16. ♙xh5±) 13. ♘d4 ♘xd4 14.cxd4 g5 (14... ♖xb2 15. ♙xe7±) 15. ♙xg5 hxg5 16. ♙xh5 ♖xb2 17. ♖b1 ♖a2 18. ♖b3 ♖xb3 19. ♖xb3, with advantage to White.

Also good is 12. ♙b5! ♘a7 13.c6 ♖c7 14.0-0!e5 (14... ♘xc6 15. ♙xc6 ♖xc6 16. ♙xe7±) 15. ♖c1 ♘xc6 16.c4! d4 17.c5!±.

12. ♘d4!



The thematic idea against the persecution of the bishop with ...h7-h6 and ...g7-g5. It is important to always remember this idea, which can involve the knight moving to various different squares, such as d2, e1, e5 or d4, as in this game, which shows another advantage of playing 8.dxc5!.

12...gxh4

If 12... ♘f6 then 13. ♙g3, with a healthy extra pawn and a clear advantage to White.

13. ♙xh5 e5

If 13... ♘xd4!? White can play:

A) 14.exd4 b6 (14... e5 15.dxe5 ♙xe5 16.0-0±) 15.c6 ♖c7 16.0-0 ♖xc6 17. ♖e1±;

B) 14.cxd4 e5 and now:

B1) 15. ♘b3 ♖g5 16.g3 exd4 17. ♘xd4 ♙xd4 18.gxh4 ♖xh4 19. ♖xd4 ♖xd4 (19... ♖xh5 20. ♖g1+) 20.exd4 with advantage to White;

B2) 15.dxe5 ♙xe5 16.0-0 ♙xb2 17. ♖b1 ♙g7 18. ♙f3±.

14. ♙b5

White has a clear advantage in this position.

14... ♖e7 15.0-0!

White completes his development. If Black takes the pawn on c5, White wins the one on d5. Here 15. ♖d6 ♙e6 16.e4 dxe4 (16...d4 17.0-0) 17. ♙e2± also looks interesting, while 15. ♖b3 ♙e6 16.0-0± is also good.

15... ♙e6

Inferior is 15... ♙xc5 16. ♖c7 ♜b8 17. ♖b3 ♙d6 18. ♖xd5, with a clear advantage to White.



16.e4?!

Opening up the game right now does not seem best. Instead, 16. ♖b3! was the best move, and White maintains a clear advantage, while it is not clear whether Black will be able to regain the pawn. If 16... ♜ad8 then 17. ♙g4 f5 18. ♙h3 ♜d7 19. ♜e1±.

16... ♜ad8 17.exd5?!

Another error. It was better to play 17. ♙g4! ♙xc5 (17...dxe4 18. ♙xe6 ♙xe6 19. ♙e2±) 18. ♙xe6 fxe6 19. ♙g4±.

17... ♜xd5 18. ♙f3

White has lost the thread of the game and starts to play badly; 18. ♙e2 maintains equality.

18... ♙xc5 19. ♙e2 f5



What a reversal! The black pieces are now extremely active; the rook on c5, the bishop pair and the two strong pawns on e5 and f5 mean that the black position is now to be preferred.

20. ♖e3 ♕f6!?

An interesting move, which creates complications. The natural 20... ♖d8 was good.

21. ♖fd1?!

It was possible, although risky, to take the pawn: 21. ♖xh6!? ♕g5 22. ♖g6+ ♔h8 23. ♕xc6! (23. ♖h5+ ♔g7 ♖ with the threat of 24... ♖h8) 23... bxc6 (23... ♖xc6? 24. ♕f3±) and now:

A) 24.f4!? ♕f6! (24... exf4 25. ♖ae1!±; 24... ♕xf4 25. ♖xf4 exf4 26. ♖h6+ ♔g8 27. ♖g6+ and perpetual check) 25. ♕a3 (25. ♖h6+ ♔g8 26. ♖g6+ ♕g7) 25... e4±;

B) 24. ♕f3 ♕f4 (24... ♕f6 25. ♖h6+ ♔g8 26. ♖g6+ ♔g7 27. ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 28. ♕c7 ♕c8) 25.b4 ♖c4 26. ♖fe1! (26. ♖h5+ ♔g7 27. ♕xh4 ♕xh2+--+) 26... cxb5 27. ♕xe5 ♕f7 28. ♖xf5 ♕xe5 29. ♖xe5 ♕g6 30. ♖xe7 ♕xf5 31. axb5 axb4 32. cxb4 ♖xb4 and White has sufficient compensation.

21...e4

It was slightly better to play 21... ♕g5! 22. ♖e2 e4 23. ♕h5 h3, with a clear advantage to Black.

22. ♕e2?

Another error. It was essential to play 22. ♕h5 ♕g5 23.f4 exf3 24. ♖xf3 ♖e5, although Black is still better.

22... ♕g5 23. ♖h3?

The queen is very insecure here. 23.f4 exf3 24. ♖xf3 ♕d5 25. ♖f1 h3 also gave Black a clear advantage, but this was the lesser evil.

23... ♖e5

Black now has an almost decisive advantage; the white pieces are very passive.

24. ♖d4 ♘c8 25.f4?!

Desperation, in view of the threat of 25...f4, winning the white queen; if 25.c4 e3+ (but not 25...f4? 26. ♙c3).

25... ♙xf4



The white position is in ruins and Black won without any problems in a few more moves.

26. ♖2b3 ♘c7 27. ♖b5 ♖g4 28. ♘f1 ♙xh2+ 29. ♙h1 ♖g3 30. ♖3d4 ♖f2+ 31. ♘xf2 ♙xf2 32. ♖xc7 ♙xc7 33. ♘f1 ♙g3 34. ♖c4+ ♙h8 35. ♖e6 ♙xe6 36. ♙xe6 e3

0-1

SUMMARY

It is a good idea for White to take with 8.dxc5 in the variation with ... ♖c6. For Black it is better to play 7... ♙b6 first. With the move order involving an early h2-h3 instead of ♙e2, the capture on c5 is even better for White. It is not easy for Black to regain the pawn, although White temporarily gives up the centre. Remember that the white bishop should go to g5 and not g3 when Black plays ...e7-e5. The manoeuvre ♖d4 is key when Black plays ...g7-g5. Another good idea is ♙b5, to attack the c6-knight and put pressure on e5. To defend the pawn on c5, remember the moves b2-b4 and especially ♖b3. In this game White had a clear advantage but then lost the thread and ended up losing the game.

Game 10

Grünfeld Indian
Boris Grachev

2563

Alexander Rakhmanov

2473

Moscow 2007 (6)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f3 g6 3.♙f4 ♘g7 4.e3 0-0 5.♙e2 d5 6.h3

In this game we see White playing h2-h3, completely ruling out all Black's lines with ... ♗h5, trying to hunt down the bishop. Knowing in which variations it is appropriate to play h2-h3 or not is one of the keys, because against certain defences playing an early h2-h3 can be bad, since it wastes time.

6...c5 7.c3 ♗b6

The alternative is 7... ♗c6, which will normally transpose: 8.♗bd2 (8.0-0) 8... ♗b6 9.♗c1 (9.♗b3) 9... ♗f5 10.0-0 ♖ac8 11.♗b3 (11.dxc5) 11... ♗e4 12.♗fd2? (12. ♖d1) 12...cxd4, Eljanov-Kramnik, Moscow blitz 2008.

8.♗b3 ♗c6

Also played here is 8...c4 9.♗a3 ♖e8 (9... ♗f5!? 10.b3 cxb3 11.axb3 ♖c8 12.c4±; 9... ♗d8 transposes to the game) 10.b3 ♗f8 11.♗b2 (11.♗c1!±; 11.♗e5±) 11...a5 12.♗bd2 a4 13.0-0 ♗c6± Zowada-Jasnikowski, Katowice 1995. If 8... ♗xb3 9.axb3 is slightly better for White, as we analysed in the previous game.

9.♗bd2 c4

After 9... ♗xb3 10.axb3 b6 11.0-0, White is a bit better.

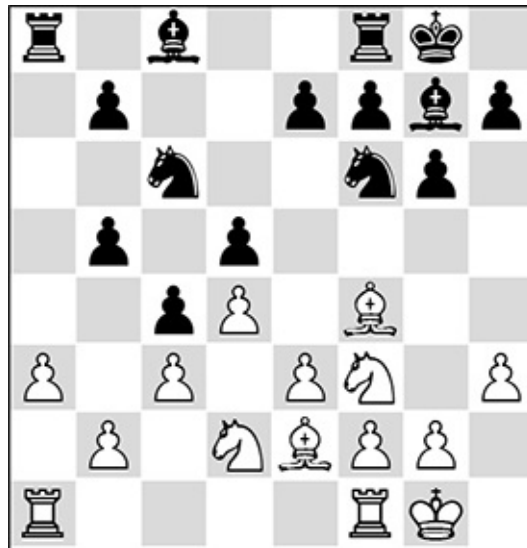
10.♗a3!



Again this is the best way to fight for the advantage. White can also exchange

queens, but this is more drawish. One of the specialists in this system, Grachev, has tried the dubious 10. ♖c2?! ♕f5 11. ♖c1 ♖a5 (11... ♖ac8; 11... ♗d7; 11... ♗e4 12. ♗xe4 ♕xe4 13. 0-0 ♗d8) 12. 0-0 b5 Grachev-Kramnik, Moscow blitz 2008.

Practice has also seen 10. ♖xb6 axb6 11. 0-0 (11. ♗e5 b5 12. a3) 11... b5 12. a3, and now:



analysis diagram

A) 12... ♖e8 13. ♗h2 (13. ♗e5, 13. ♖fe1) 13... ♖a6 14. ♖fe1 h5= Apicella-Nyzhnyk, Haguenau 2013;

B) 12... ♗f5 – let's look at a couple of interesting examples of this endgame:

B1) 13. ♖fe1 h6 (13... ♗e4 14. ♗xe4 ♕xe4 15. ♗d2 ♗f5 16. ♗f3 ♖ad8 17. e4 dxe4 18. ♗xe4 e5 19. dxe5 ♗xe5 20. ♗f6+!±) 14. g4 ♗e4 (14... ♗d7; 14... ♗e6) 15. ♗h2 ♖fe8 16. ♖ad1 ♖ad8 17. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 18. ♗d2± 18... ♗f6 (18... ♗xd2 19. ♖xd2 e6 20. ♗f3 f5 21. ♖g2) 19. ♗f1= Kotic-Pavlovic, Herceg Novi 2001;

B2) 13. g4 ♗e6 14. ♗e5 ♗d7 15. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 16. ♗f3 e6 17. ♗d6 ♖fd8 18. e4 ♗h6 19. ♖ad1 ♗e8 20. ♗g3± Thejkumar-Sriram, Chennai 2008.

10... ♗d8!

The black queen retreats, in order to allow ...b7-b5 in support of the c4-pawn, an idea which is Black's best defence, as we can see from other variations such as 10... ♗f5 11. b3 cxb3 (11... ♖a5!? 12. ♖xa5 ♗xa5 13. g4 ♗e6 14. ♗e5±) 12. axb3±. The opening of the a-file favours White, as well as enabling him to continue with c3-c4 or b3-b4, as appropriate, e.g. 12... ♗d7?! 13. g4! ♗e4 14. ♗xe4 dxe4 15. ♗d2 with a clear advantage to White, Kolev-Laylo, Las Vegas 2008.

11. b3 b5 12. 0-0

After 12.bxc4 bxc4 (12...dxc4?! 13.♞b2±) 13.♞b1 ♞f5 14.♞b7± I prefer White, in view of his control of the b-file. The difference is that the bishop on f4 denies the b8-square to the black rooks, whereas the f5-bishop can be dislodged with g2-g4 and so it is not easy for Black to contest the b-file. 12.♞b2± is also a good option, preparing a2-a4.



12...♞d7?!

A dubious move. The best defence was 12...♞f5, although White maintains the advantage:

A) 13.g4 ♞d3 (13...♞d7 14.♞e5±; 13...♞e6 14.♞b2±) 14.♞xd3 cxd3 15.c4 bxc4 (15...♞b6 16.♞ac1±) 16.bxc4 dxc4 17.♞xc4± White stands better, due to the weakness of the d3-pawn;

B) 13.♞b2 is another good option, preparing a2-a4: 13...♞d7 14.a4 a6 15.♞a2±.

13.bxc4 bxc4

It is not good for Black to recapture with the d-pawn: 13...dxc4? 14.♞ab1 (14.♞b2 e5 15.♞g3 a6 16.a4 ♞b8 17.♞fb1) 14...e5 (14...a6 15.♞xb5 axb5 16.♞xa8) 15.dxe5, in all cases with a clear advantage to White.

14.e4

Grachev decides to open the centre immediately but perhaps it made more sense to wait and improve the position of his pieces with 14.♞a4! ♞b7 15.♞ab1 ♞b6 16.♞b5±, which gives White a comfortable advantage: he has control of the b-file, his pieces are more active and he can break with e3-e4 at an opportune moment.

14...e6?!

Better is 14...♞f6! 15.exd5 (15.e5 ♞e8) 15...♞xd5 16.♞h2 ♞a5 17.♞xa5

xa5 18.fc1 h6! 19.g4 f4! 20.f1 a6 and it seems that Black is holding, but White maintains his advantage.

15.  d6

There were several moves leading to an advantage for White, such as 15. ♖ab1, 15. ♖fe1 or 15. ♗d1.

15... ♘db8?!

Another dubious move and a very passive one. It was better to play 15...  b7 16.exd5 exd5 17.  fb1 (17.  xd5?  xd4) 17...  b6 18.a4, although White retains the advantage.



16. xd8

Simplifying into a favourable endgame, but this was not forced. White could also gain a clear advantage with moves such as 16. ♖fe1, 16.exd5 exd5 17. ♖fe1 or 16. ♖ab1. The position is so healthy that it allows White a wide range of good moves.

16... ♖xd8 17. ♖fb1

It was better to move the bishop immediately with 17. ♖d1!, because the rook can go to either the e-file or the b-file. It is clear that the bishop should head for a4, so it was better to move it right away.

17... ♖a6

After 17...♘d7, 18.♙c7 ♖e8 19.♙d1!, heading for a4, maintains White's advantage.

18. ♖d1

The alternative 18.exd5 exd5 19.♘f1! ♘d7 20.♘e3 was a good idea; the knight is better on e3, putting pressure on d5 and c4, and White retains his advantage.

18... ♘d7 19.exd5 exd5 20. ♙a4 ♖ac8



How should White continue?

21. ♖b5!

A good idea, even though it appears that we are exchanging the opponent's bad bishop. The idea is to attack d5 and gain the square b7 for the rooks. It should be mentioned that 21. ♜e1 was also possible, with advantage to White. The poor contribution of the black bishops is worth noting.

21... ♜xb5 22. ♜xb5 ♞f8 23. g4?!

This move is not good because it weakens both the f4-square and the knight on f3, which will prove important later. Instead, a good continuation was 23. ♞h2 ♞e6 24. ♜b7 ♜e8 25. ♞f1 ♞h6 26. ♜b5 ♜cd8 27. ♞e3 ♞xe3 28. fxe3, with a slight advantage to White.

23... ♞e6

Black equalises with this move, because there are also some tactical ideas present.

24. ♞g3?!

It was better to play 24. ♞e3 a6 25. ♜b7 ♜b8 26. ♜ab1 ♜xb7 27. ♜xb7 ♜b8, with equality.

How should Black play now?



24... ♖d7

A pity; Black misses a good tactical opportunity with 24...♙xd4! 25.cxd4 ♗cxd4 26.♖b7 (26.♙xd4 ♗xd4 27.♖b7 transposes) 26...c3 27.♙xd4 ♗xd4 28.♙b3 ♗e2+ 29.♔g2 (29.♔f1 ♗xg3+ 30.fxg3 d4) 29...d4 and Black is at least equal. The black pawns are dangerous.

Another option is 24...♙cxd4!? 25.cxd4 ♗xd4 26.♖c1 ♗g7, which is also interesting, with good compensation for Black.

25. ♗e1

25. ♗ab1 is better, preventing the sacrifice.

25...h6

Another wasted opportunity. Here 25...♗h6!? was interesting, but the sacrifice on d4 was still good: 25...♙xd4! 26.cxd4 ♗cxd4 27.♙e5 ♗xb5 28.♙xd7 ♗bd4, with very good compensation for Black.

26. ♙f1?!

26. ♔g2, defending f3, was necessary, to prevent the sacrifices on d4.

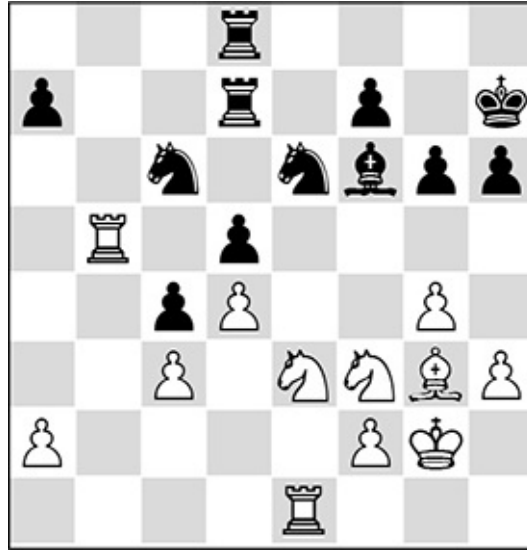
26... ♗h7?

Once again Black lets slip the tactical resource of the sacrifice on d4, which this time even gives Black the advantage after 26...♙xd4! 27.♖xe6 (27.cxd4? ♗exd4 28.♙xd4 ♗xd4 and Black wins, with the double threat of taking the b5-rook and forking the e1-rook with a check on f3) 27...fxe6! (much better than 27...♙xf2+ 28.♔xf2 fxe6 29.♙e5 ♗xe5 30.♙xe5 ♖f7+ 31.♔e2 ♖cf8 with a complex position) 28.cxd4 (28.♙xd4 ♗xd4 29.cxd4 c3) 28...c3 29.♖b3 c2 30.♙f4 ♖f7 31.♙c1 ♖xf3 32.♖xf3 ♙xd4, and Black is better.

27. ♔g2±

Finally preventing the sacrifice by defending f3. Here 27.♙e3± was also good.

27... ♙f6 28. ♙e3 ♖cd8



29. ♖c2

29.h4! was the best move for White, gaining a clear advantage: it prevents ...g6-g5 and threatens g4-g5 or h4-h5, as appropriate. The idea is to gain the e5-square later.

29... ♜e8 30.a3

White wants to play ♖b4 and force Black to capture, in order to improve the white structure after axb4 and open the a-file for the rook.

30... ♞e7 31. ♖b4

Again 31.h4± was good.

31... ♞xb4 32.axb4

White has improved his structure: he has the half-open a-file and can put pressure on the a7- and d5-pawns. However, at the moment his rook on b5 has no moves.

32... f6 33. ♜a1 ♔g7 34.h4

Finally White decides to make this advance, which is a natural one in the position, although now it is not as strong as before.

34... ♜f7?

34...g5! was absolutely necessary for Black and although White maintains the advantage, it is not easy to see how he is going to make progress.

35. ♜a6! ♜c8

In this position White has a very strong move – what is it?



36.g5!

White sacrifices a pawn in order to gain the e5- or c5-square.

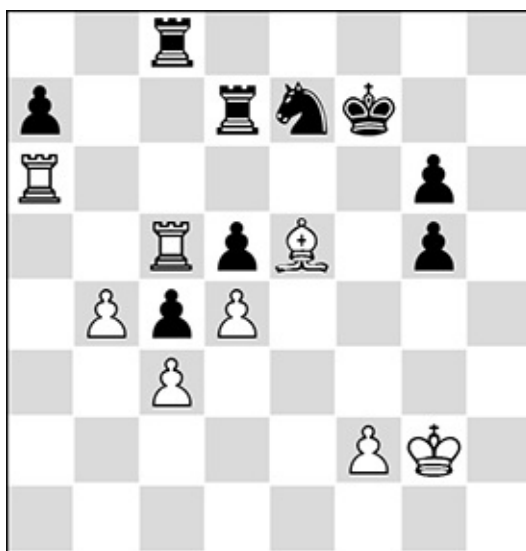
36...hxg5 37.hxg5 ♖xg5

Black cannot take with the pawn or advance with ...f6-f5 on account of the combination on c6: if 37...fxg5? then 38. ♖xc6! ♖xc6 39. ♗e5+, winning the rook on c6.

38. ♗xg5+ fxg5 39. ♖c5

This rook, which was active but could not move, is finally liberated, with decisive effect.

39... ♗e7 40. ♗e5



Despite being a pawn down White has a clear advantage; his bishop dominates the knight and Black's pawns are weak. The black king can come under attack

from the rooks and the bishop.

40... ♖f8 41. ♖ca5 ♖a8

If 41... ♗c8 then 42. ♖f6+ ♔e8 43. ♖xg6, with a decisive advantage to White.

42. ♖a1

Here 42. ♔g3 ♖b7 43. ♔g4 ♖d7 44. ♔xg5 was a simpler way to win.

42... ♖b7?

Black does not sense the danger and makes another error. It was necessary to play 42... ♖ad8 43. ♖h1 ♖f8, although White retains a clear advantage.

43. ♖h1?

There was an immediate win with 43. ♖f6+! ♔e8 (43... ♔g8 44. ♖h1+–) 44. ♖h1! ♔d7 45. ♖d6+ ♔c7 46. ♖xg6+ ♔d7 47. ♖d6+ ♔c7 48. ♖e6+ ♔d7 49. ♖xe7+ ♖xe7 50. ♖h7+ ♔e6 51. ♖xb7+–.

43... ♖b6 44. ♖ha1

White again applies pressure to the a-pawn.

44... ♗c8

44... ♖xa6 45. ♖xa6 fails to ease the defence. White can win, either by bringing his king to g5, or by playing b5-b6 to capture on a7.

45. ♖6a5 ♔e6 46. ♖e1! ♗d6 47. ♗xd6+

Here 47. ♗g3+ ♔f7 48. ♖xd5+– was also winning.

47... ♖xd6 48. ♖e5

The black pawns are about to fall like ripe fruit.

48... ♖f8 49. ♖xg5 ♔c7 50. ♖gxd5 ♖bf6 51. ♖a2

It was better to play 51. ♖xa7+!+ ♔c6 52. ♖c5+ ♔b6 53. ♖a2.

51... ♖b6 52. ♖c5

And, faced with the loss of another pawn, Black resigned.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw that the line in which White plays h2-h3 has some advantages, especially by preventing any ... ♗h5 ideas by Black. We also saw that after Black plays ...c5-c4 White's best plan is to respond quickly with b2-b3, while Black's best defence is to play ... ♔d8 and support c4 with ...b7-b5, although White maintains some advantage: his bishop on f4 is better than the one on g7 throughout the game and he can use the b- and e- files for his rooks. It is also worth noting the manoeuvre ♗d1, with idea of bringing the bishop to a4 and then exchanging it for the opponent's bishop.

Game 11

Grünfeld Indian

Paul Keres

David Bronstein

Tbilisi ch-URS 1959 (10)

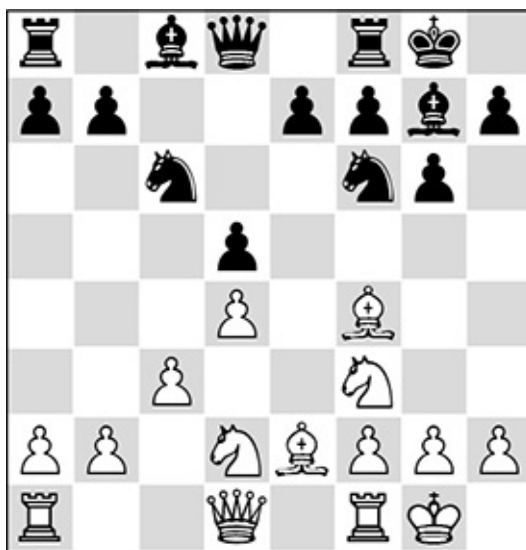
1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f3 g6 3.♙f4 ♘g7 4.♗bd2 d5 5.e3 0-0 6.♙e2 c5 7.0-0

Nowadays it is more common to play 7.c3 first.

7...cxd4

This exchange can be made now or on the following move, after 7...♗c6. It was also possible to play 7...♞b6, taking advantage of White's move order, since he cannot respond with ♞b3; then a possible continuation is 8.dxc5 (8.♞c1 and 8.c4!? are playable) 8...♞xb2 9.♙e5, with equality.

8.exd4 ♗c6 9.c3



9...♗h5

Black's idea is to gain control of the f4-square and neutralise the strong white bishop.

It is less common for Black to play for ...e7-e5, because this leaves the d-pawn weak after the exchange on e5 (one cannot have everything).

A) 9...♙f5 is an alternative tried by the strong grandmaster Nepomniachtchi recently; let's take a look at it:

A1) 10.♞e1 ♞c8 (10...♗h5 11.♙e3 ♗f6) 11.♗e5?. This move, which is an error (11.♗f1 or 11.♞b3 are better), was recommended by grandmaster Danielsen in a DVD on the London System; I suspect that he had this game in mind. My advice is to trust no-one 100% and check all the variations for oneself. Danielsen gives 11...♗d7?! (Black could already force a draw with 11...♗xd4!, but this passed unnoticed by Danielsen: 12.cxd4 ♙c2 13.♞c1 ♙f5 14.♞d1

♙c2 and the white queen can escape only by returning the piece and remaining a pawn down) 12. ♖xc6 ♜xc6± Zilberman-Kantsler, Tel Aviv ch-ISR 2002;

A2) 10.a4 a6 (10... ♙h5!? 11. ♙e3 ♙f6; 10... ♜b6!?) 11.h3 ♙e4 12. ♜e1 ♜c8 13. ♙f1 ♜b6 14. ♜b3 ♜xb3 15. ♙xb3 Shimanov-Nepomniachtchi, Warsaw Ech blitz 2011;

A3) 10.h3! looks best to me. After 10... ♙e4 11. ♜e1 h6 (11... ♜c8 12. ♙f1±) 12. ♙f1 g5 13. ♙h2 e6 14. ♙xe4 ♙xe4 15. ♙d2 White had the advantage and managed to win the game: 15... ♙g6 16. ♙b3 ♜e7 17.f4!? (17.a4!±; 17. ♙b5±) 17... ♙e4 18.fxg5 (18. ♜d2±) 18...hxg5 19. ♙c5± Vl.Kovacevic-Mikhalchishin, Pula 1980.

B) An idea which has hardly been tested but which is interesting is 9... ♜e8 10.h3 (10. ♜e1) 10... ♜b6 (10... ♙h5 11. ♙h2 ♙h6 12. ♜e1 ♙f4 13. ♙e5±) 11.b4 (11. ♜b3±) 11... ♙f5 12.a4 ♜ac8 13.a5 ♜d8 14.a6 b6 Saud-Yang Jiunn, Singapore 1995.

10. ♙e3

White takes advantage of the exchange of pawns on d4 to use the e3-square, which is usually occupied. The disadvantage is that White has to abandon the h2-b8 diagonal, which is key in the London System for White's dark-squared bishop.

10... ♜c7

Bronstein's original idea is also the first choice of Houdini, 54 years later! It would appear that the masters of the past were not at all bad players and were able to work things out in their heads without the electronic aids available to us today, for which they deserve great credit.

10... ♜d6 11. ♜e1 has also been played here:



analysis diagram

A) 11... ♖d7 12. ♗b3 ♗f6 13. ♗c5± Kachko-Deviatkin, Moscow 2007;

B) 11... ♗f6 12.h3 (12.g3) 12... ♖d7 13. ♗b3 b6 14. ♔c1±. This plan is very common in such positions, lining up the queen and the bishop, either to play ♗h6 and exchange the bishop on g7 or else to return the bishop to f4;

C) 11...f5!? is a risky move; the idea is to trap the white bishop with ...f5-f4, but it creates some weaknesses: 12. ♗b3 f4 (12...b6 13. ♖d2±) 13. ♖d2 and now:

C1) 13... ♔h8 14. ♖d3 ♖g4 15. ♖e2 ♗ae8± Turov-Burmakin, Moscow 1994;

C2) 13...b6 14.c4! (opening the position, despite leaving the d4-pawn isolated) 14...e6 (14...dxc4 15. ♖xc4+ ♔h8 16.d5±) 15.cxd5 exd5 16. ♗e5± 16... ♗xe5? 17.dxe5 ♔xe5 18. ♖f3 ♔f5 19. ♖b4 and White wins;

C3) 13... ♗f6 14.c4! – again we see that opening the position is advantageous for White and the isolation of the d4-pawn is unimportant;

C31) 14...dxc4 15. ♖xc4+ ♔h8 16. ♗c1± (16. ♗g5!?);

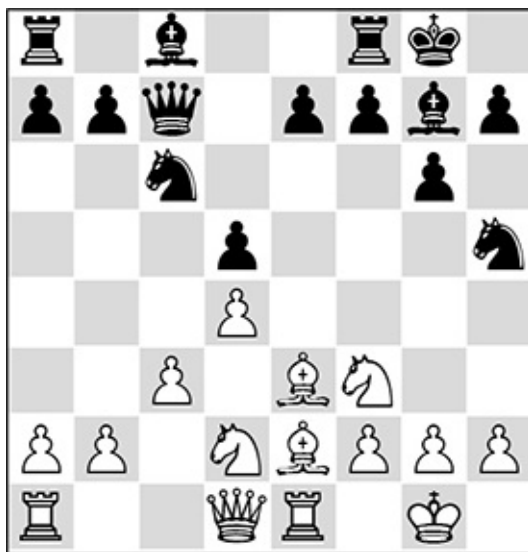
C32) 14... ♔h8 15. ♗c1 ♗b8 (15... ♖f5 16. ♗a5 ♗xa5 17. ♖xa5± 17...b6 18.c5!) 16. ♗a5 and now:

C321) 16... ♗xa5 17. ♖xa5 dxc4 (17...b6 18.c5!) 18. ♖xc4 b6 19. ♖c3±;

C322) 16... ♖g4 17.cxd5 (17.a3!±) 17... ♗xd5 18. ♗c4 (18. ♗xc6 bxc6 19. ♗e5 ♖xe2 20. ♔xe2 ♖xe5 21.dxe5 ♔e6) 18... ♔d8 Winants-Kobese, Turin ol 2006.

Retreating the knight should not be ruled out: after 10... ♗f6 11. ♗e5 ♖f5 12.h3 ♔c7 13. ♗df3 (13. ♗d3!?) 13... ♗e4 14. ♖f4 the position is unclear; both sides have strong knights.

11. ♗e1



11... ♖g4

With the passing of the years, Black has tried to improve on Bronstein's play, for example with 11... ♗f6, and now:

A) 12.h3 ♗f5 13.♗b3 b6 – this idea is thematic, to prevent the white knight from occupying c5;

B) 12.♗b3 ♗f5 (12...b6 13.♖c1 ♗e4 14.♗h6 ♗d6) 13.♗d3 ♗xd3 14.♖xd3 b6;

C) 12.g3!? is an interesting idea to enable the bishop to return to f4: 12... ♗g4 13.♗f4 ♖d8 14.♗e5 ♗xe2

C1) 15.♗xc6 ♗xd1 (15...bxc6 16.♖xe2±) 16.♗xd8 ♖axd8 17.♖axd1 e6 with equality;

C2) 15.♖xe2 e6 16.h4 ♖c8 17.♗g4 (17.♗d3 b6 18.♗g5 is interesting) 17... ♗xg4 18.♖xg4 ♖e8 19.♗f3 ♖f6 (19...h5) 20.♗h2 (20.h5!±) 20...♖f5 21.♖f3 (21.♖xf5±) 21...h5 22.♖e2? ♗xd4 23.cxd4 ♗xd4 24.♖e3 ♗xe2+ 25.♖xe2 e5—+ Renner-Gyimesi, Germany Bundesliga 2010/11.

Black has also tried 11...a6 12.♗b3 ♗f6 (12...b6 13.♖c1!±) 13.♗c5 (13.♖c1!?) 13...♗f5 (13...b6 14.♗d3) 14.h3 (14.♗d3! ♗xd3 15.♗xd3 e6 16.♗f4± with great control of the e5-square) 14...♗d7 15.♗d3 ♗xd3 16.♖xd3± Pinheiro-Frois, Lisbon 1996.

12.♗b3

Here it was good to put the question to the bishop with 12.h3, to sound out Black's intentions, because it seems that if he takes on f3 White stands better:

A) 12... ♗d7 – perhaps Bronstein was intending to play this, since h3 can be a weakness, and then fight for the f4-square; but after 13.♗f1 (13.♗b3) 13...♗f4 14.♖d2 ♗xe2+ 15.♖xe2 ♖fe8 16.♗f4 ♖b6 17.♗e3 e6 18.♗g4, White has a strong initiative on the kingside;

B) 12... ♗xf3 13.♗xf3 ♖ac8 (13...♗f4 14.♗f1) 14.♖d2, and White is better.

12... ♗f4

Black has completed the plan started with ...♗h5: placing the knight on f4, where it has both defensive and offensive functions and in particular restricts the activity of the white bishop on e3. But now White springs a surprise.

13. ♗b5!

With the unpleasant threat of winning the pawn on e7 after the exchanges on c6 and f4; it is not easy for Black to find a good move now.



13... ♖h5?!

Bronstein decides to retreat, acknowledging his error. I think that it was better to defend the pawn another way, such as 13... ♕f6 14.h3 ♕f5 (14... ♕xf3 15. ♖xf3±) 15. ♕xc6 (15. ♖c5 ♖e6 16. ♖xe6 ♕xe6 17. ♖d2±) 15... bxc6 16. ♕xf4 ♖xf4 17. ♖c5 ♖d6 and we have a very interesting situation with a knight pair vs. a bishop pair, which seems slightly better for White, with his strong knight on c5.

Sacrificing the pawn with 13... a6 14. ♕xc6 bxc6 15. ♕xf4 ♖xf4 16. ♖xe7 ♖fe8 seems to offer Black counterplay, but in fact White stands better in the endgame arising after 17. ♖xe8+ ♖xe8 18.h3 ♕xf3 19. ♖xf3 ♖xf3 20.gxf3 ♖e2 21. ♖b1 ♕f8 22. ♖f1 ♖e8 (22... ♖c2 23. ♖a1±) 23. ♖a5 ♖c8 24.b4±, with good winning chances, since the knight is better than the bishop and also White has an extra pawn.

14.h3 ♕d7

14... ♕xf3 15. ♖xf3 is also advantageous to White.

15. ♖c1

It is better to play 15. ♖c5± immediately.

15... ♖fe8 16. ♕h6

The thematic idea of exchanging the fianchettoed bishop usually favours the attacking side.

16... ♕h8

Black evades the exchange, although this was not necessary; it seems better to play 16... b6, preventing the knight from landing on c5.

17. ♕f1

A slightly odd move; instead White could play 17. ♖d2, maintaining the advantage.

17... ♖ad8 18. ♘c5 ♘f6

At this point I am in some doubt, because in some sources I have seen that Bronstein is supposed to have played 18... ♘f5? here, which loses a pawn after 19.g4 (in which case Keres declined it!). In databases such as ChessBase the game is given as we have presented it here.

Here 18...e5 would fail to 19. ♘xd7 ♙xd7 20.g4 ♘f6 (20...e4 21.gxh5 exf3 22. ♙f4±) 21. ♘xe5 ♘xe5 22. ♖xe5, with a clear advantage to White.



19.b4

Gaining space on the queenside. As we can see, it is necessary to play on both wings to try to create weaknesses over the whole board. Instead, 19. ♘f4 ♙c8 20.b4 also looks good.

19... ♘f5 20. ♘h4

Keres decides to dislodge the black bishop immediately. Again 20. ♘f4 was good.

20... ♘d7

Black has no plan and awaits events.

21. ♘f4

Now Keres finally decides to return with the bishop and dislodge Black's queen. 21. ♘f3 was not bad either.

21... ♙c8 22.g4

Keres goes over to the attack on the kingside, relying on his clear advantage in space, although it seems that the quiet continuations 22. ♘f3 and 22. ♘h2 were better.

22...h5! 23.f3 hxg4 24.hxg4 ♘h7!

Another great defensive move by Bronstein. Now the knight can go to f8 and e6.

It also controls g5 and allows a timely ...f7-f6, to deny the e5-square to the white pieces. The position is now equal.

25. ♖d3 ♗f6

Here 25...a5 was good for Black: 26.a3 (rather than 26.b5 ♖xd4! 27.cxd4 ♗xd4+ 28.♗e3 ♗xa1 29.♔xa1 ♗xb5, which seems slightly better for Black) 26...b6, or 25... ♖f8 immediately.

26. ♖g2 ♖b8?!

Again 26...b6 was better, with equality.

27.a4

Playing on both wings to create weaknesses is an important concept, because in that case the opponent's pieces can end up awkwardly placed after going to the defence of one wing or the other, or they can simply be unable to arrive in time to defend.

Here 27.g5 ♗g7 28. ♖e3± was also good.

27... ♖a6 28. ♖e3 ♖c7 29. ♗g2

29. ♗e2± seems slightly better.

29... ♗h4 30. ♖e2 b5!?



A radical move to restrain White's queenside pawns; this move is approved by the Houdini engine, which considers this to be the best move. White was threatening to advance his pawns with a4-a5 or b4-b5.

31.a5!?

It is bad to play 31.axb5 ♗xb5 or 31... ♖e6. The critical move was 31. ♗xc7 ♗xc7 32. ♖xd5 ♗d6 33. ♖e3 ♗g5 (33...bxa4 34. ♖c4±) 34. ♗e1 a6, and Black has to prove that he has sufficient compensation for the pawn.

31... ♖e6 32. ♗h2 ♗c6

The bishop was fine on d7, where it controlled the h3-c8 diagonal. It was better to play 32... ♖f6 33. ♔c2±.

33. ♔c2

Now or within the next few moves it would have been good to play the thematic advance 33.f4! ♖f6 34. ♔c2±.

33... ♖f6 34. ♖e5?! ♖b7 35. ♗f1 ♖ef8?!

It seems better to play 35... ♖hg5! and Black is holding.

36. ♗d3

Once again 36.f4! is good.

36... ♖g5 37.f4 ♖e4?!

This jump is badly timed. The only way was 37... ♖xe5 38.dxe5 ♖e4 39.f5 (not 39. ♖xd5 ♖xd5 40. ♖xe4 ♖c4 and Black wins) 39...e6 40.fxg6 ♖xg6 and although the position is complicated, Black can resist.



38. ♖xd5! ♖d6?

This loses, but after 38... ♖xd5 39. ♖xe4 White remains with a healthy extra pawn. The best try was 38... ♖xe5 39. ♗xe4 ♖xd5 40. ♗xe5 ♖xg2 41. ♔xg2 ♗xg4+ 42. ♖g3, and although White retains the advantage, this is not yet decisive.

39. ♖e3

39.f5 was much more direct and decisive: if 39...g5 (39...gxf5 40.gxf5, opening the position even more, seems even worse) then 40. ♗fe1, with a winning advantage.

39... ♖xg2 40. ♗xg2 ♖g7 41.g5

41.f5 was again better.

41... ♗b7

Black had to play 41...e6±, since it was essential to prevent f4-f5.

42.f5

White's advantage is almost decisive.

42... ♖e4 43. ♗xe4 ♘xe4

The exchange of queens fails to solve Black's problems.

44. ♖g4

It was slightly better to play 44. ♘c6 ♖d7 45. ♘g4 ♘xg5 (45...gxf5 46. ♖xf5+-) 46. ♘ge5+-.

44... ♘xc3 45.f6 ♗h8

Or 45...exf6 46.gxf6 ♗h8 (46...♗h6 47. ♘f5) 47. ♖h4, transposing to the game.

46. ♖h4!



This move decides the game, setting up threats of ♘3g4 and ♘h6+, or ♖xh8+ and ♘xf7+. We can see that the white attack remains very strong even without the queens. The passivity of the h8-bishop, the f8-knight and the e8-rook is noteworthy.

46...exf6

Or 46... ♘h7 47. ♘xf7+-.

47.gxf6 ♖xd4 48. ♘3g4!

There is no satisfactory answer to the threat of 49. ♘h6+. Instead 48. ♖xd4? was bad because of 48... ♘e2+.

48...g5 49. ♖h5

A little more precise was 49. ♖h3 ♘e2+ 50. ♗h1 ♘d7 51. ♘h6+ ♖f8 52. ♘xd7+ ♖xd7 53. ♘g4 ♖g8 54. ♖f5, and wins.

49... ♖xe5

Or 49... ♖g6 50. ♜xg5.

50. ♖h6+ ♜h7 51. ♖f5+ ♜g8

51... ♜g6 walks into mate with 52. ♜h6+.

52. ♖e7+ ♜xe7 53. ♜xh8+ ♜xh8 54.fxe7

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we have seen another defensive system for Black based on exchanging pawns on d4 and with the idea of ... ♖h5 and ... ♖f4, to fight against White's queen's bishop. It is a solid system, although White maintains good options of playing on both wings. It is notable that both players were amongst the best in the world in 1959, which adds to the importance of the game. I liked Keres's treatment, based on attacking on both wings. He was able to decide the game with an attack on the king, even without the queens. Bronstein was on the defensive, without a clear plan. At various points he made good defensive moves, such as 22...h5, 24... ♖h7 and 30...b5, although after that he went astray. In the variation with 10... ♜d6 it is worth noting White's plan of c3-c4, opening the position despite leaving the d-pawn isolated. It is always advisable to check the analysis, even of great players, since it can contain errors or omissions.

Game 12

Grünfeld Indian
Christian Bauer

2633

Romain Edouard

2600

Calvi 2011 (8)

1.d4 d5 2. ♘f4 ♖f6 3.e3 g6 4. ♘f3 ♘g7 5. ♖bd2

Another possible move order is 5. ♘e2 0-0 6.h3 c5 7.c3 b6 8.0-0 ♘b7 9.b4!? (9. ♖bd2 is normal) 9...cxb4?! (9... ♖e4 and 9...c4 are better) 10.cxb4 ♖c6 11. ♜b3, with a slight advantage to White in Burmakin-Nabaty, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2014. If 5. ♘d3!? then 5...c5 6.c3 ♜b6 is unpleasant.

5...0-0 6.h3

Another move order would be 6. ♘e2 c5 7.c3 ♖c6 (7...b6 8.0-0 ♘b7) 8.0-0 b6. We could use the move order seen in the first game, without h2-h3, but for most club players I recommend playing h2-h3 to avoid having to study the lines with ... ♖h5.

6...c5 7.c3 b6



A flexible move, retaining the option of ...♘bd7.

8. ♗e2

In this move order, 8. ♗d3 is playable. This has the advantage of controlling e4, although as a rule of thumb in the London System the bishop goes to d3 only in the lines without ...g7-g6 by Black, since it is stronger on d3 when the b1-h7 diagonal is open. Against the King's Indian it is not usually advisable to develop the bishop on d3, because after Black advances with ...e7-e5, he threatens ...e5-e4, and if White exchanges pawns on e5 Black recaptures with the pawn (the d6-pawn), renewing the threat. Here, though, 8. ♗d3 is playable, since although Black will be able to execute the ...e7-e5 advance he will not be able to recapture on e5 with a pawn.

8... ♘b7

A) It is quite normal to develop the knight to d7, although there are more games with the bishop on d3 rather than e2, which we shall see later in another game. After 8... ♘bd7 9.0-0 ♗b7 (better than 9... ♘e4 10. ♘xe4 dxe4 11. ♘d2 ♗b7 12. ♔c2, with advantage to White) we have a range of possibilities:



analysis diagram

A1) The most popular move here is 10. ♖e5, although after 10... ♗xe5 11. ♕xe5 ♗e8 (or 11... ♗d7) Black has easy equality, which is why I do not recommend this;

A2) 10. ♕b3 has not been played much, but it is interesting and thematic in many variations. Also, since Black has already played ...b7-b6, the white knight has no future on b3, so the queen can go there. 10... ♖c8 11. a4 a6 (remember that if Black closes the centre with 11...c4, White should play 12. ♕a3!, planning the thematic b2-b3, with advantage to White) 12. ♖fd1 e6 13. ♖ac1 and White is a bit better, although the black position is solid.

A3) The best move is considered to be 10. a4!, which is thematic, gaining space on the queenside and with the idea of a4-a5. 10...a6 is the best response; Black is preparing to close the queenside by answering a4-a5 with ...b6-b5. Now there is a wide range of possibilities for White. Again it is dubious to play 10... ♗e4?! or 10... ♗e8, because of 11. a5! ♗d6 12. ♗e5±. After 10...a6 we have several options:

A31) 11. ♗e5 ♗xe5 12. ♕xe5 ♗d7 13. ♕xg7 ♖xg7 leads to an equal position; there are a few interesting practical examples, but White gains no advantage:

A311) 14. a5 b5 15. dxc5 ♗xc5 16. ♗b3 ♗a4 (16... ♗xb3 17. ♕xb3 ♕c7 18. ♕b4 ♖ac8 19. ♖ad1 e6 20. h4 h5 21. ♖d2 ♕c5 Sedlak-Andrijevic, Valjevo 2012) 17. ♗c5 (17. ♕d2) 17... ♗xc5 18. ♕d4+ e5 19. ♕xc5 ♖c8 and Black drew without any problems in Meins-Perez Candelario, Kallithea 2008;

A312) 14. f4!? e6 15. ♕e1 ♕e7 16. ♕g3 ♗f6 17. h4 h5 18. ♕g5 ♖ae8 and again Black has no problems, Kekelidze-Mulyar, Wheeling 2013.

A32) The move 11.b4 was introduced by Atanas Kolev, but it is too direct and Black can equalise easily with 11...♗e4!, e.g. 12.♖c2 (12.♙c1 c4) 12...cxb4 13.cxb4 ♜c8 14.♗b2 e6. In the game Kolev's opponent played 11...cxb4 12.cxb4 ♗e4 13.♙c1 ♜c8 14.♗b3 ♗xd2 15.♗xd2 e5!, but Kolev managed to win in Kolev-Ivanova, Plovdiv 2011;

A33) 11.♗b3! is again good and is my recommendation, as in the note to move 10 above. If 11...♙c8 we have a transposition. It is also possible to play 11.♙c1 ♜c8 12.♗b3;

C4) 11.♗b1 is interesting and has the advantage over 11.♗b3 that White can play a quick b2-b4, although the downside is that the rooks are not connected: 11...♙c8 12.♙d1 (12.♙e1) 12...e6 13.♗e5 (13.b4) 13...♗e7 14.♕f3 (14.♗xd7 ♗xd7 15.♗f3) 14...♗xe5 15.♕xe5 ♙fd8 Certic-Cabrilo, Belgrade 2011.

The move 8...♕a6!? is interesting.



analysis diagram

It is a very typical idea in several openings to exchange Black's theoretically 'bad' queen's bishop for the 'good' white bishop. It is playable here as well, but White remains slightly better:

A) 9.♕xa6 ♗xa6 10.0-0 ♖c8 (10...♗c7) 11.♗e2 (11.a4±; 11.♗b3±) 11...♗b7 12.a4 ♜ac8 13.♙fe1 ♙fd8 Vafiadis-Ipatov, Rethymnon 2011;

B) 9.0-0 ♖c8 (9...♕xe2 10.♗xe2 ♗c6 11.b4!± 11...cxb4 12.cxb4 ♗xb4? 13.♗b5± 13...♗c2 14.♙ac1 ♗a3 15.♗a6 ♗c4 16.♗xc4 dxc4 17.♙xc4±) 10.♙e1 (10.♙c1±; 10.b4±) 10...♗c6 11.♗e5 (11.♙c1±) 11...♕xe2 12.♗xe2 ♗b7 Nguyen Anh-Lalic, Elista ol 1998.

9.0-0 ♗c6

We have already examined variations with the move 9...♖bd7 in the note at move 8.

9...♖fd7 has been tried by Bologan:

A) 10.b4! c4 11.a4 a6 12.♔c2 is good, with the idea of e3-e4, which is thematic when Black plays ...c5-c4 (this is better than the immediate 12.e4 dxe4 13.♖g5 ♖f6 14.♙xc4 ♖d5, with equality) 12...♖f6 13.b5 a5 14.♖e5, with advantage to White;

B) 10.♙e1 ♖c6 11.♔b3 h6 (11...e5!?!; 11...c4 12.♔c2 e5; 11...♔c8 12.♙ad1 ♙d8 13.♙g3 e6 14.♙c1 ♙a6 15.♔d1 ♙xe2 16.♔xe2 ♔b7 17.e4 ♙ac8 18.exd5 exd5 19.♖b3 ½-½ Ribli-Adorjan, Hungary tt 1995/96) 12.a4 a6? 13.♔xd5! and despite White's clear advantage here the game ended in a draw, Mouroutis-Bologan, Eretria tt 2011.

10. ♔b3



Many moves have been tried here, although this seems the best. The queen on b3 is natural for White, who threatens to take on c5 and also puts pressure on d5 to prevent ...♖d7. White also seeks to provoke ...c5-c4 or weaken Black on the queenside.

Grandmaster Danielsen recommends 10.♖e5 here, but I think that Black can equalise with 10...♖xe5! 11.♙xe5 (11.dxe5?! ♖d7) 11...♖e8 and this well-known idea levels the position... The continuation given by Danielsen is 10...♖d7 11.♖xc6 ♙xc6 12.♖f3 e6 (12...♙e8 is better; the strong GM Bartel tried 12...♔c8 13.♙g3 a5 14.a3 a4 15.♙e1 ♔b7 16.h4 ♙fe8 17.h5 e5 Pakleza-Bartel, Warsaw ch-POL 2010) 13.a4 a6?! (13...a5!; 13...♙e8) 14.b4 and Danielsen evaluates this as advantageous to White, which I do not see after 14...c4 or 14...♔e7.

Another idea is 10.a4 ♖d7 (10... ♗e4) 11. ♙b3 e6?! (11...e5!?!; 11...c4 12. ♙a3 e5) 12. ♖ad1 (12. ♙d6 c4 13. ♙a3 ♖e8 14.b3±) 12... ♖c8 Bodiroga-Balogh, Rijeka Ech 2010.

10. ♖c1 has also been played, for instance 10...a6 (10... ♗d7) 11.dxc5 bxc5 12. ♙b3 ♙c8 13. ♖fd1± Tu Hoang-Hossain, Calvia ol 2004.

10... ♙c8

Defending against White's threat to capture on c5, Black guards the b7-bishop and now also has the idea of ... ♙a6 available, exchanging his 'bad' bishop. Instead, 10... ♗d7 transposes to the games by Bologan and Adorjan (above).

11. ♖fd1 ♙a6

Here 11... ♗d7 is playable, with the idea of ...e7-e5, since now White cannot capture the d5-pawn, as the bishop on b7 is defended.

A) 12.h4!? is a typical plan for White: 12...e5 13.dxe5 ♗dxe5 14.h5! (14. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 15.a4 (15.h5 ♙f5) 15... ♖e8 16.a5 d4) 14... ♙e6 (14... ♙f5 15. ♗h4) 15. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 16. ♗f3±;

B) 12.a4! is better and now if 12...e5 then 13.dxe5 ♗dxe5 (13...c4 14. ♙a2 ♗cxe5 15. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 16.a5±) 14. ♗xe5 ♙xe5 (14... ♗xe5 15.a5±) 15. ♙xd5 ♙xf4 16.exf4 ♗d4 17. ♙c4 ♙d5 18. ♙d3 ♗xe2+ 19. ♙xe2 ♖e8 20. ♙g4 and White is better with his extra pawn.

12. ♙xa6 ♙xa6 13.a4

We can say that White has emerged slightly better from the opening, despite the exchange of bishops.



As is usually the case, the bishop on f4 is better than its counterpart on g7, which is normally condemned to play a passive role. White controls the square e5 and can make progress on the queenside, where he now threatens 14. ♙b5.

13... ♖c8

To avoid the unpleasant 14. ♗b5 by White. Black has managed to exchange the bishops but has lost a few tempi with his queen.

14. ♜ac1

In spite of everything it was still good to play 14. ♗b5! ♘d7 (if 14...c4 15.b3! – a thematic break which should be familiar to us by now – 15...cxb3 16. ♘xb3±) 15.e4! dxe4 16. ♘xe4 cxd4 17.cxd4 and White is better here, with the threat of 18. ♜c1, and after 17... ♗b7 18.d5 ♘ce5 19. ♘xe5 (19. ♘d4 is also good, with a future ♘c6 in the air) 19... ♘xe5 20. ♜ac1 and now the natural idea of 20... ♜ac8 is answered with 21. ♘c5! ♗a8 22. ♘a6, when White threatens 23. ♘b4 and 24. ♘c6.

14...c4 15. ♗a3

Now 15. ♗b5 does not work, unlike in the previous variations, since Black can play 15... ♗b7, with the threat of 16...a6. If 15. ♗c2 instead, then 15... ♘a5 and now 16.e4?! fails to 16... ♘xe4 17. ♘xe4 ♗f5!, with the better game for Black.

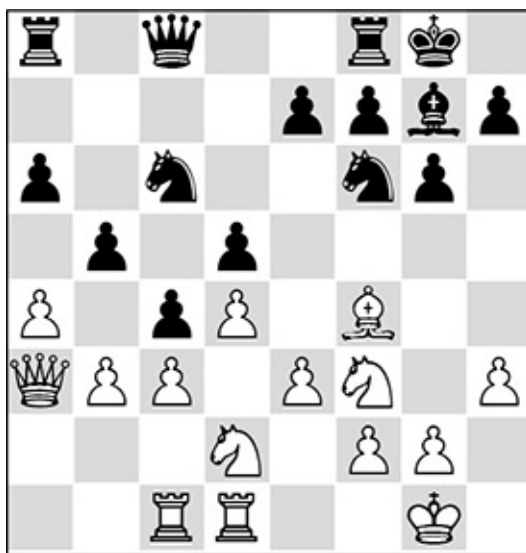
15...a6?!

Rather than weakening b6 like this, it was better to play 15... ♗b7 16.b3 cxb3 17. ♗xb3 ♜ac8, with the idea of ... ♘c6-a5-c4.

16.b3!

Correct! The thematic break that we need to remember.

16...b5



After this, ...cxb3 will be bad, since after ♗xb3 White is left with a clear advantage, in view of the weakness of the b5-pawn. How the position can be changed by a pawn move! Before advancing a pawn and changing the structure, we should always remind ourselves that pawns cannot move backwards.

17.axb5?!

A small inaccuracy by Bauer. It was simpler to play 17.bxc4 bxc4 18.♖b1!, with a clear advantage to White. The position would then be similar to the one in Game 3 between Grachev and Rakhmanov, where we saw that White was better, owing to his control of the b-file: the bishop on f4 prevents the black rooks from going to b8 and contesting the b-file. Unfortunately for Black, here he has no light-squared bishop to hinder White from playing his rook to b1. The other rook can go to e1 and then White can play e3-e4, which will leave the c4-pawn weak.

17...axb5 18.♖c5 ♖a6?!

It was better (although difficult to see) to play 18...♖d8! since after 19.♖xb5 ♖a5 20.♖b6 ♖a6 21.♖c7 (21.♖b5 ♖a5) 21...♖a8 Black is going to incarcerate the queen, although White obtains compensation after 22.♕g3 e5 23.♗xe5 ♗xe5 24.dxe5 ♖c8 25.♖e7 ♗f8 26.♖xf6 ♖xf6 27.exf6 cxb3 28.♗xb3 ♖a4, with a position that is difficult to assess. It is clear that White has compensation but there is no reason why Black should lose.

19.♖a1!

A good move: at first glance it looks as though it would be good for Black to give up his queen for two rooks, but this is not the case. It was also possible to play 19.♗e5, with advantage to White.



19...♖b7

Edouard realises that it is not good to take on a1, and he retreats. If 19...♖xa1 then 20.♖xa1 ♖xa1+ 21.♖h2 ♗a5 and now:

A) 22.♖xb5?! ♗xb3 23.♗xb3 cxb3 (23...♖b1 24.♗fd2 ♖b2 25.♗xc4 dxc4 26.♖xc4±) 24.♖xb3 ♖fa8;

B) 22.bxc4! (this is the right way) 22...♗xc4 23.♗xc4 bxc4 24.♖xe7 and

White has a clear advantage, because the d5-pawn (and subsequently the c4-pawn) is weak and will fall after ♔d6 and ♙e5.

20. bxc4 ♖xa1

If 20...bxc4 then 21. ♖ab1 ♔c8 22. ♖b6 ♖a6 23. ♔b5 ♖xb6 24. ♔xb6, with advantage to White, owing to his control of the b-file, his more active pieces and the eventual break on e4.

21. ♖xa1 bxc4 22. ♖b1 ♔d7 23. ♖b6 ♖c8 24. ♔b5

These last few moves are natural and almost forced. White has improved all his pieces and Black is defending as best he can. With his last move White threatens 25. ♖b7 and also pins the knight, leaving a possible ♙e5 in the air.

24...e6

Black defends the d5-pawn, which in some lines would be left unguarded after the piece exchanges resulting from White's ♙e5.

25. ♖b7?!

On this and the following move Bauer lets his advantage slip. Here 25.g4 was good, gaining space on the kingside and maintaining the advantage. Remember the importance of playing on both wings to create weaknesses in the opponent's camp. If 25...♔e8 then 26.g5 ♙h5 27. ♙h2±.

25...♔e8 26. ♙g5?!

It was better to play 26. ♖b6, but now Black is not worse.

26... ♙d8!



A good defensive move, since after the forced exchange of queens Black equalises.

27. ♔xe8+ ♙xe8 28. ♖a7 h6 29. ♙gf3 ♙c6 30. ♖a6 ♙f6 31. g4 ♙d7

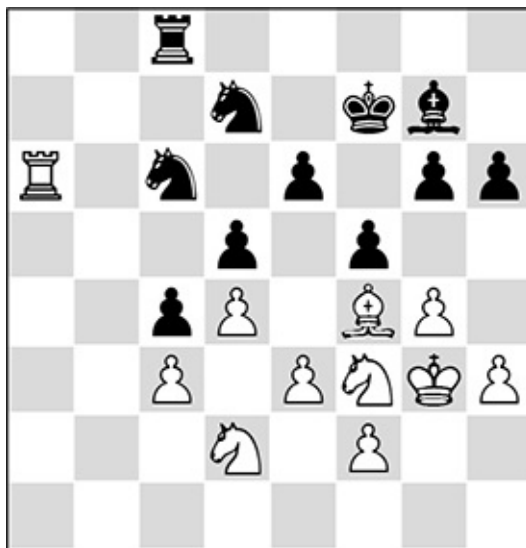
White's advantage is merely optical. Black has no weaknesses and his position is

solid.

32. ♖g2 f5

Safer was 32...g5.

33. ♔g3 ♖f7



34. ♗g1?

It is important to remember that we should not relax, simply because the position appears to be dead and risk-free. Similarly, it is dangerous to keep playing all-out for a win, just because we previously held the advantage. This move is bad and it could have turned the game on its head. Correct was 34.g5 h5, with equality.

34... ♗f6?!

Black wastes his opportunity to punish the opponent's error with 34...e5!, which would give him the advantage after 35.dxe5 (35. ♗xe5 ♗dxe5 36.dxe5 ♗xe5+ 37. ♔g2 ♗xc3+ 35...g5! when Black wins a piece for two pawns and has winning chances, e.g. 36. ♔g2 (36. e6+ ♗xe6 37.gxf5+ ♗e7+) 36...gxf4 37.exf4 fxg4 38.hxg4 ♗c5 and although the win is not easy with so little material left, and White's connected passed pawns are dangerous, still the black position is preferable.

35.f3 ♗g8 36. ♗e2 ♗ge7 37. ♗d6 ♗d8 38. ♗xe7! ♗xe7 39. ♗f4 ♗b8!?

The simple 39...e5 40. ♗e6 ♗b8 was good, with equality.

40. ♗f2?!

If White takes the pawn with 40. ♗xe6 then after 40... ♗b2 41. ♗f1 ♗f6 Black has compensation in the activity of his rook and the bad position of the knight.

40... ♗b2 41. ♗e2 e5 42. ♗e6 exd4

Here 42...f4!? would have been more unpleasant for White, e.g. 43. ♗xg7 fxe3 44. ♗xe3 exd4+ 45.cxd4 (45. ♗xd4 ♗xd2+) 45...c3 46. ♗e6 c2! 47. ♗b3

♖xb3+ 48.♔d2 ♜xf3 49.♔xc2 g5 and White still has to solve a few problems. This is better than 49... ♜xh3 50.♗f4 ♜h2+ 51.♔c3 h5 52.g5 and White is holding, thanks to the plan of ♗f4-d3-e5+.

43.exd4 ♜c2 44.♗xg7 ♜xg7 45.♜a3 ♜c1 46.f4 ♜h1 47.♜a7 ♜f8 48.♜a8+ ♜g7 49.♜a7 ♜f8

Black cannot avoid the draw. If 49... ♔f7 then 50.♗f3 ♜xh3 51.♗e5+ ♔f8 (51... ♔e8?? 52.♜a8++-; 51... ♔e6?? 52.♜a6++-) 52.♗d7+ ♔f7 53.♗e5+=.

50.♜a8+ ♜g7 51.♜a7

½-½

An interesting struggle.

SUMMARY

In the variation with ...b7-b6 Black has two options: to develop the knight to c6 or d7. The typical plan for Black of exchanging his light-squared bishop on a6 does not guarantee him equality. The best plan for White is to play ♖b3 and a2-a4, trying to create weaknesses on Black's queenside. Remember the typical break with b2-b3 after ...c5-c4 by Black. An advantageous plan is to exchange pawns on c4 and then occupy the b-file with the queen's rook; Black cannot contest the b-file, because the bishop on f4 prevents ... ♜b8; the other white rook can go to the e-file and the plan with e3-e4 is then always in the air. We advise you never to relax, even though the position appears completely safe; White could have been made to suffer for his careless 34. ♗g1. As we saw, there were resources even in a very equal position, where it seemed that neither player could lose.

The Barry Attack

Game 13

Barry Attack

Jean-Pierre Le Roux

2495

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Belfort ch-FRA 2010 (1)

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 g6 3.♗c3



This is the most popular move order for White to play the so-called Barry Attack, a system that was very popular in the 1980s, thanks to several English players, including GM Mark Hebden. Nowadays it remains quite popular. Any deep study of it would require another book, so we shall limit ourselves here to studying a few theoretical examples and one example game to provide us with an idea of the system.

It is mainly used against the King's Indian, since by playing 3. ♘c3 White 'forces' Black to play 3...d5, as otherwise White can play e2-e4, channelling the game into the Pirc. The typical plan with ♘f3, ♙f4, e2-e3 and ♘c3 is the most popular, although nowadays White also plays ♔d2 (instead of e2-e3) in a more modern version of the system.

White can also use the move orders 3. ♙f4 ♙g7 4. ♘c3 d5 5.e3 or 4.e3 0-0 5. ♙e2 d5 6. ♘c3.

3...d5 4. ♙f4 ♙g7 5.e3

5. ♔d2 is a more modern alternative, used by GM Hebden, one of the greatest experts in the Barry Attack. Although it does not seem to give White any real advantage, since it can produce quite symmetrical positions, it is a good choice to play for a draw. Black usually plays 5...0-0 or 5... ♘e4:



analysis diagram

A) 5...0-0

A1) 6.0-0-0!? ♖e4 7.♗xe4 dxe4 8.♗e5 ♔d5 9.b3 ♗c6 10.♗xc6 ♔xc6 11.e3= Hebden-Shyam, Hastings 2010/11;

A2) 6.e3 c5 7.dxc5 (7.♗e2; 7.0-0-0) 7...♗bd7 8.0-0-0 ♗xc5 9.♗e5 ♗ce4 10.♔e1 ♗xc3 11.♗xc3 ♗f5= Hebden-T.Andersson, London 2013;

A3) 6.♗h6 ♗e4 (6...♗c6!? 7.♗xg7 ♔xg7 8.♗e5 ♗f5 9.e3 ♔d6= Kogan-Anand, Venaco rapid 2005; 6...♗h6 7.♔xh6 c5 8.dxc5 d4 9.0-0-0 ♗g4 10.♔f4 e5= Hebden-D.Fernandez, Coventry 2013):

A31) 7.♗xe4 dxe4 8.♗xg7 ♔xg7, and now Black has two options:

A311) 9.♗g5 e5 10.0-0-0 (10.dxe5 ♔xd2+ 11.♔xd2 ♗d8+ 12.♔e3 ♗c6=) 10...♔xd4 11.♔xd4 exd4 12.♗xd4 e3 13.fxe3 h6 14.♗f3= Stefanova-Lagno, Rostov-on-Don 2012;

A312) 9.♗e5?! b5!= Stefanova-Dominguez Perez, San Sebastian 2011;

A32) 7.♔e3 ♔d6 (7...♗xc3 8.♗xg7 ♔xg7 9.♔xc3 ♔d6= Hebden-E.Berg, Oslo 2012) 8.♗xg7 ♔xg7, and now:

A321) 9.♗xe4 dxe4 10.♗d2 (10.♔xe4 ♔b4+=) 10...♗c6 11.♗xe4 ♔xd4=;

A322) 9.0-0-0 ♗xc3 10.♔xc3 ♗d7= Hebden-Gordon, Torquay 2013;

B) The immediate leap 5...♗e4 is also good: 6.♗xe4 dxe4 7.♗e5 ♗d7 (7...♗e6 8.e3 ♗d7 9.♗c4 (Hebden's move 9.♗xd7 is better) 9...0-0 10.♗e2 ♗xc4 11.♗xc4 e5= Jussupow-Kasparov, Belfort 1988) 8.♗xd7 ♔xd7 9.e3 0-0 (9...c5 10.c3 0-0 11.♗e2 ♗d8=) 10.♔b4 b6 11.♗d1 c6 (11...♗b7=) 12.♗e2± Hebden-Valeanu, Dublin 2012.

5...0-0

A) I do not like to give up the bishop pair so soon with 5...♗g4 6.h3 ♗xf3

7. ♖xf3 c6 8. 0-0-0 0-0 9. g4±. I think that in this line White has the advantage, with attacking possibilities on the kingside, and in Santos-Berbatov, Fermo 2009, White won a good game;

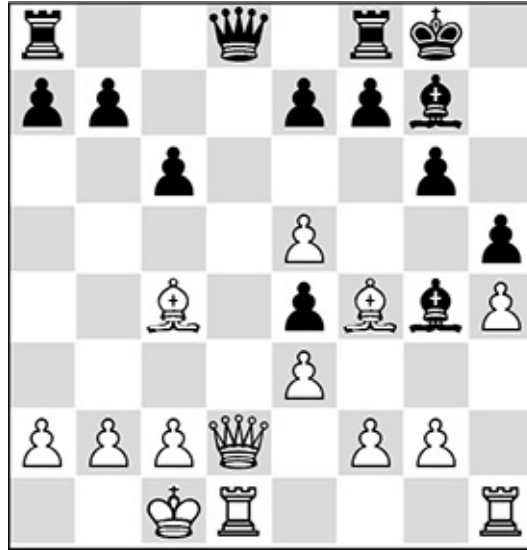
B) 5...c6 is more solid, and then:

B1) 6.h4!?



analysis diagram

White decides to sharpen the play and castle on the queenside. In this system this option is always available. 6...h5 (after 6...0-0, 7.h5 might be premature but 7. ♖e5 ♖bd7 8.h5 comes into consideration, since on 8...♖xh5 White has 9. ♖xh5, with an attack) 7. ♖e5 ♖bd7 8. ♖d2 0-0 9. 0-0-0 ♖e4 (after 9...♖xe5 10. ♖xe5 ♖e4 11. ♖xe4 dxe4 White has several options to maintain a small advantage, such as 12. ♖e2; 12. ♖xg7 ♖xg7 13. ♖c4 (or 13. ♖c3) 13...♖g4 14. ♖df1; or else the simple 12. ♖c3) 10. ♖xe4 dxe4 11. ♖c4 ♖xe5 12.dxe5! (a good capture; the bishop on g7 will take a long time to come into play) 12... ♖g4.



analysis diagram

B11) Here the exchange sacrifice 13. ♖b4!? ♙xd1 14. ♜xd1 was very interesting: 14... ♙c7 (14... ♙c8 15. ♙xe7±; 14... ♙e8 15.e6 ♙b6 16.exf7+ ♙h7 17. ♙xb6 axb6 18. ♜d7 with advantage to White;

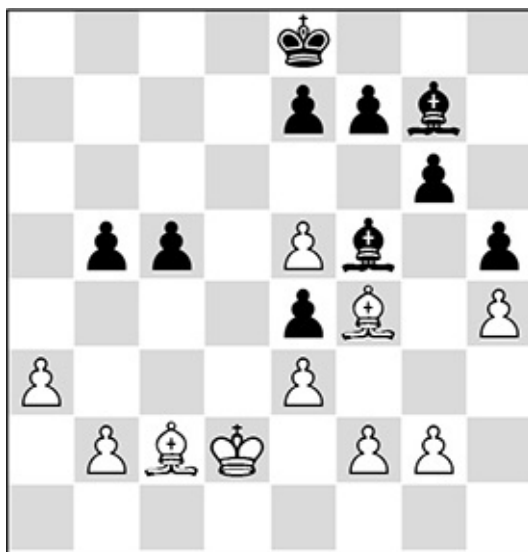
B12) 13. ♙xd8 ♜fxd8 14. ♜d4! (White's advantage is based on his strong e5-pawn, which hinders Black's communications, and on his control of the d-file, which is very important) 14...b5 15. ♙b3 c5 16. ♜xd8+ ♜xd8 17.c4 (fixing the black pawn on c5) 17...a6 18. ♙c2 (White is better here because of the weakness of the e4-pawn):

B121) 18... ♙f5 19. ♜d1 ♜xd1+ 20. ♙xd1 and White has the advantage, owing to the weakness of the pawn on c5 and the limited activity of the black bishop on g7; let us see some examples:

B1211) 20...f6 21. ♙d2 fxe5 22. ♙g5 ♙f6 23. ♙c3 ♙xg5 24.hxg5 and the white king penetrates on the queenside;

B1212) 20...bxc4 21. ♙d2 f6 22. ♙c3! with a quick invasion by the white king.

B122) 18... ♙e6 19.cxb5 axb5 20.a3 b4? (Black seeks activity, but this is ephemeral; it was more logical to play 20... ♙f5 21. ♜d1 ♜xd1+ 22. ♙xd1 and the white king will try to penetrate via the queenside; 22... ♙f8 23. ♙d2 ♙e8 and now:



analysis diagram

24.a4 (24. ♖b3!? is possible, to hold up the progress of the black king and try to force the response 24...e6, which reduces the scope of the f5-bishop) 24...bxa4 25. ♖xa4+ (or 25. ♔c3!? to attack the c5-pawn) 25... ♖d7 26.b3 with advantage) 21. ♖xe4 (finally this pawn falls and White should win this ending) 21... ♖b3 22. ♖c2! ♖e6 23. ♖d1 ♖a8 24. ♖e4 ♖a7 25. ♖d8+ ♔h7 26. ♖a8 ♖d7 27. ♖a5 ♖c7 28. ♖c2 b3+ 29. ♖c3 f6 30. ♖a6, with a decisive advantage: 30... fxe5 31. ♖xe6 exf4+ 32. ♖xb3 c4+ 33. ♖c2 and wins, Romero-Crnkovic, Pula 2012.

B2) 6. ♖e2 and now:

B21) 6...0-0 7. ♖e5 ♖fd7 (7... ♖b6 8. ♖b1 c5 9.0-0 cxd4 10.exd4 ♖f5 11. ♖f3 ♖c6= Praveen Kumar-Adhiban, Mumbai 2012) 8. ♔d2 b5 (8... ♖xe5 9. ♖xe5=) 9.a3 (9. ♖d3±) 9... ♖b6 10.0-0± Moldovan-A.Fedorov, Brasov 2011;

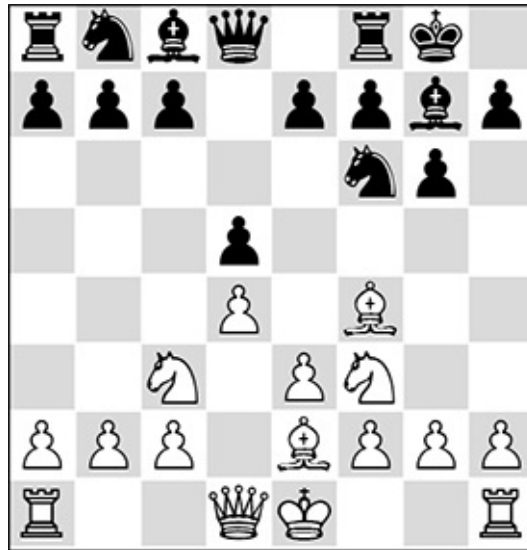
B22) 6... ♖g4 7. ♖e5 (7.h3 ♖xf3 8. ♖xf3 ♖bd7 9.0-0 0-0 10. ♔d2 (10. a4 ♖e8 11.a5 e5= Giorgadze-De la Villa, Sanxenxo 2007) 10... ♖e8= Hoang Thanh Trang-Ghaem, Jakarta 2013) 7... ♖xe2 8. ♖xe2 ♖h5 (8... ♖bd7=) 9.0-0 0 ♖xf4 10.exf4± Bellon-Romero, Mislata 2003.

B3) 6.h3 0-0 and now:

B31) 7. ♖e2 ♖bd7 (7...c5=) 8.0-0 (8.g4 ♖a5 9. ♔d2 b5 (9... ♖b6=) 10. ♖e4 ♖b6= Blatny-Krasenkow, Nimes 1991) 8...b5 9.a3 a5 10. ♖d3 ♖b6 11. ♖e5± Nigalidze-Kantans, Kazan 2013;

B32) 7. ♖d3 c5 (7... ♖bd7 8.0-0 ♖h5 9. ♖h2 f5?! 10. ♖e2± Matnadze-Strikovic, Elgoibar 2012) 8.0-0 (8.dxc5 ♖bd7) 8... ♖c6 9.dxc5 ♖a5 10. ♖b5±.

6. ♖e2



This was the original scheme of the Barry Attack. The idea is to play ♖e5 and a quick h2-h4-h5, with a strong attack. At first this gave very good results and White gained many victories, while Black could not find adequate counterplay.

6...c6

6...c5! is the most frequent response and definitely Black's best:

A) 7. ♖e5 is the move that has been played the most, e.g. 7... ♗c6 8. 0-0 cxd4 9. exd4 ♜b6 10. ♖xc6 bxc6 (10... ♜xc6 11. ♙b5 ♜b6 12. a4 ♜a5 13. ♜d2 a6 14. ♙e2= Prié-Torrecillas, Cataluña 2013) 11. ♖a4 ♜a5 12. c3 ♗d7= Hebden-Nunn, Hastings 1996/97;

B) 7. ♖b5!? cxd4! (7... ♖a6 8. h3=; 7... ♖c6 8. ♖c7 ♜b8 9. ♖b5 ♜a8 10. ♖c7 and a draw by repetition) and now:

B1) 8. exd4 ♗c6 9. 0-0= (9. ♖c7 ♗h5+–);

B2) 8. ♖c7 dxe3 9. fxe3 (9. ♖xa8 exf2+ 10. ♙f1 ♗g4 11. h3 e5 and Black has compensation) 9... ♗h5 10. ♖xa8 ♗xf4 11. exf4 ♙xb2 when Black has very good compensation;

C) 7. 0-0 cxd4 8. exd4 ♗c6 transposes to the main line;

D) 7. dxc5!? transposes to a favourable version of the Catalan, with reversed colours.



analysis diagram

The idea is to avoid the lines with the exchange on d4 and ...♞b6, which are awkward for White. It is similar to the 8.dxc5 that we saw against the Grünfeld, except that here Black can recover the pawn and equalise the game:

D1) 7... ♞a5 8. ♞d2 ♞xc5 9. ♞b3 ♞b6 10. ♞b5 ♞a6 11. ♞e5 and now:

D11) 11... ♞e6 12. ♞d4 (12.f4 ♞e8=) 12...b6 13.0-0 ♞b7 14.a4 ♞fc8= Richtrova-Baginskaite, Germany Frauenbundesliga 1993/94;

D12) 11... ♞g4 12. ♞xg4 (12.f3 ♞d7 13. ♞d4 ♞d8=) 12... ♞xb5 13. ♞e2 ♞c6 (13... ♞b6 14.0-0 ♞fd8 15.a4= Stefanova-Peptan, Belgrade 1995) 14. ♞d4 ♞b6=.

D2) 7... ♞bd7 8.0-0 ♞xc5 9. ♞e5 and now:



analysis diagram

D21) 9... ♖cd7 10. ♘d4 (10. ♘f4) 10...b6 (10... ♗c7 11. ♖xd5 ♖xd5 12. ♘xg7 ♖xe3=) 11. ♖xd5 ♖xd5 12. ♘xg7 ♖xe3 13. fxe3 (13. ♗d2 ♗xg7 14. ♗xe3=) 13... ♗xg7 14. ♗d5 ♗c7;

D211) 15. ♗xa8 ♘b7 16. ♗xa7 ♗a8 17. ♖g5 ♗xa7 18. ♗xf7+ ♗g8 19. ♗g7+ ♗h8 (19... ♗xg7 20. ♖e6++-) 20. ♗xh7+ ♗g8 21. ♗g7+ with equality;

D212) 15. ♖d4 ♘b7= Hebden-Pigott, Plymouth ch-GBR 1989;

D22) 9... ♘g4 10. h3 ♘xf3 11. ♘xf3 e6 12. ♗e2 ♗c8 13. ♗fd1 ♗b6 14. ♗ab1= Megaranto-Rodshtein, Biel 2011;

D23) 9... ♖ce4 10. ♖xe4 (10. h3= is better) 10...dxe4 and now:

D231) 11. ♖d2 b6 (11... ♗d5=) 12. c4 ♘b7= Magem-Fernandez, Barcelona 1990;

D232) 11. ♗xd8 ♗xd8 12. ♖d4 ♗d5= Megaranto-Morovic, Istanbul ol 2012; Another option is to play immediately 6... ♘g4, e.g. 7. ♖e5!? (the usual response is 7. h3 ♘xf3 8. ♘xf3 c6 9. 0-0 (9. ♗d2 ♖bd7 10. 0-0-0 a5 11. h4, with complex play in De Prado-Gomez, Spain tt 2014) 9... ♖bd7 10. ♗e1 ♗e8 11. e4 dxe4 12. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 13. ♘xe4 (13. ♗xe4!=) 13...e5 14. dxe5 ♖xe5 (14... ♘xe5!= is better) 15. c3 ♗b6 16. ♗b3± De Prado-Casares, Bembibre 2014) 7... ♘xe2 8. ♗xe2 ♖h5?! (it is more normal to play 8...c5 9. 0-0-0 (or 9. h4 h5 10. 0-0 ♗a5 11. g4± Hebden-Burgess, London 1990) 9...cxd4 10. exd4 ♖c6 11. h4 with a complicated position in Chatalbashev-Lalev, Plovdiv 2003; 8...c6 and 8... ♖bd7 have also been played) 9. ♗b5! (9. 0-0-0!?) 9... ♖xf4 10. exf4 ♖c6 11. ♖xc6 (11. 0-0-0!± is better) 11...bxc6 12. ♗xc6 ♘xd4 13. ♖xd5 ♘xb2 14. ♗d1 ♗e8 (14... ♗d6 is better, with equality) with a slight advantage to White in De Prado-Casares, Ferrol 2014.

7.h4

A thematic idea in the Barry Attack, although usually White plays ♖e5 first (7. h3 would transpose to the variations that we saw at move 6); after 7. ♖e5:



analysis diagram

A) 7... ♖fd7 8. ♗d3 (8.h4 ♗xe5 9. ♕xe5 ♗xe5 10.dxe5 ♔b6=) 8...f6 9. ♔d2 e5 10. ♗g3 ♔e7 11.0-0-0 (11.h4) 11... ♗b6= Winants-Glek, Amsterdam 2000;

B) 7... ♗bd7 8.h4 and now:

B1) 8... ♗e4 9. ♗xe4 dxe4 (9... ♗xe5=) 10. ♗c4 (10. ♗xd7 ♔xd7 11.h5 with an interesting position, although White has the advantage) 10...h6 11.c3± Stefanova-Diaz Castro, Mancha Real 2000;

B2) 8...h5 9. ♔d2 ♗xe5 10. ♕xe5 b5 11.f3 and now:

B21) 11... ♗e8 12. ♕xg7 ♔xg7 13.e4 dxe4 14. ♗xe4 ♗f6 15. ♗g5 (15.a4±) 15... ♔c7= Vera-J.Cori, Panama 2013;

B21) 11... ♗h6 12. ♗d3 (12.0-0-0) 12... ♗d7 13. ♕f4 ♗g7 14. ♗g5 b4 15. ♗e2 c5= Stripunsky-Naroditsky, St Louis ch-USA 2011.

7... ♗g4

If 7... ♗bd7 then 8. ♗e5 transposes to the variations with 7. ♗e5. Other 7th moves for Black:

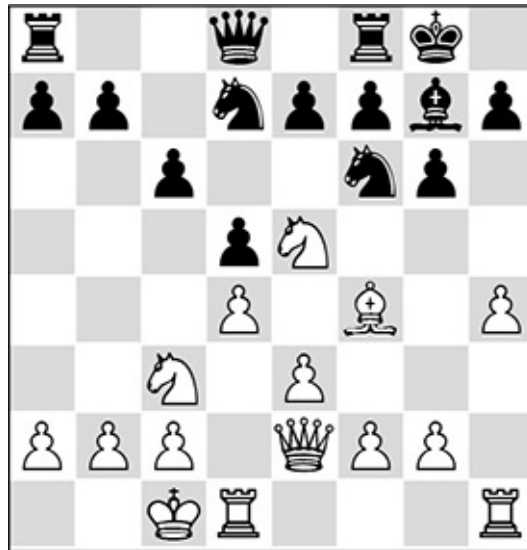
A) 7... ♗f5 8. ♗e5 ♗fd7?! (8...h5=; 8... ♗bd7=) 9.g4 ♗e6 10. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 11. ♔d2 (11.h5±) 11...f5 (11... ♗f6) 12.gxf5 ♗xf5 13.h5± Hungaski-E. Hansen, Mar del Plata 2012;

B) 7... ♔b6 8. ♖b1 (8. ♗a4 ♔a5+ 9.c3 ♗bd7= Izeta-Granero, Linares 1998) 8... ♗bd7 (8... ♗f5 9. ♗e5 c5= Arencibia-Gareev, Calvia ol 2004) 9. ♗e5 ♗e4 10. ♗xe4 dxe4 11. ♗c4 ♔d8 12.h5± Ju.Salgado-Manolache, Mondariz 2014.

8. ♗e5 ♗xe2 9. ♗xe2 ♗bd7

If 9...b5 then 10.f3 (10.a4± 10...b4 11. ♗a2 a5 12. ♗c1±) 10... ♔a5 11. ♔d2 ♖c8 12.a3 ½-½ Miles-Nijboer, Escaldes zt 1998.

10.0-0-0



Here we have one of the key positions in the Barry Attack. White is a bit better and above all his game is easier and his plans clearer. He has attacking chances on the kingside with the h4-h5 break (with g2-g4 if necessary), he can bring the queen's rook to the g-file and he already has a strong knight on e5. Black is a long way behind in his preparations to mount a counterattack against the white king on the queenside.

10... ♖c8

Various moves have been played here:

A) 10... ♗xe5 11. ♘xe5 (taking with the pawn is usually bad because after ... ♗d7 the pawn is weak: 11.dxe5 ♗d7 12.e4 e6=) 11...b5 12. ♖b1 ♗a5 (12...h5 13. ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14.g4±) 13. ♗e1 (13. ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14. ♗f3 b4 15. ♗e2±; 13. ♗f3 b4 14. ♗e2 ♗e4=) 13...b4 14. ♗e2 c5 15.f3 (15. ♗f4!±) 15... ♖ac8 16.g4± Izeta-Kazhgaleev, Cannes 1999;

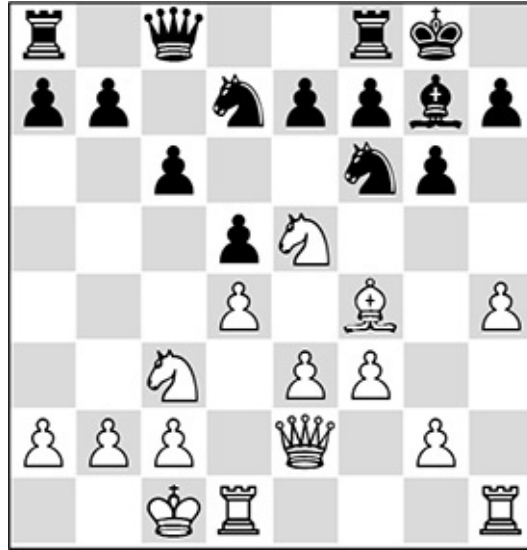
B) 10...h5 11.f3 (11. ♖b1±) 11... ♗xe5 12. ♘xe5 ♗d7 13. ♗xg7 ♖xg7 14.g4 (14.e4) 14... ♖h8 15.e4 e6= Barva-Molnar, Hungary tt-2 1999/00;

C) 10... ♗e4 11. ♗xe4 dxe4 and now:

C1) 12.h5!? ♗xe5 13.dxe5 (13. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 14.dxe5 ♗a5 15.hxg6 hxg6 16. ♗g4 ♗xe5 17. ♖d4 ♖g7 18. ♖xe4 ♗f6=) 13... ♗a5=;

C2) 12. ♗xd7 (12. ♖b1±) 12... ♗xd7 13.h5 ♗e6 14. ♖b1±.

11.f3



11...h6

As we have seen in several variations, it is better to play ...h7-h5; I dislike the advance of the pawn to h6, because it facilitates a pawn break on g5, or it can be attacked, as happens in the game. Other options for Black:

11... ♖xe5 12. ♕xe5 ♔e6 13.g4 ♕e8 14. ♕xg7 ♖xg7 15.e4 (15.h5±) 15...dxe4 (15...h5±) 16.fxex4± Ansell-Blasko, Winterthur 2009;

If 11...b5 then 12.g4 h5 (12...b4 13. ♖a4±) 13. ♔b1 and now:

A) 13...hxxg4 14. ♖xg4 (14.fxxg4 ♖xe5 15.dxe5 ♖xg4=) 14... ♖h5 15. ♔hg1± ;

B) 13... ♖b6 14. ♔dg1 with a slight advantage to White.

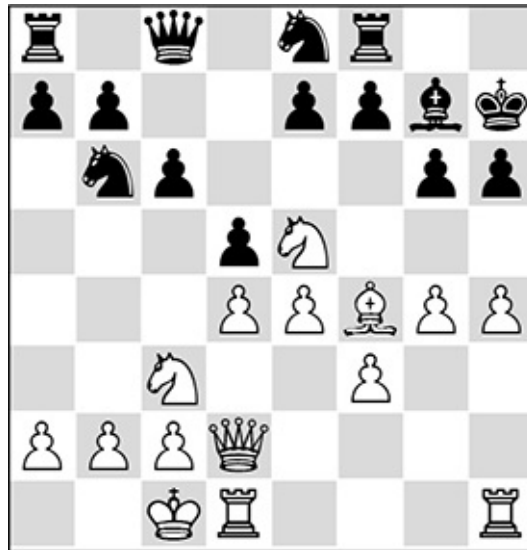
12.g4 ♖e8

Anticipating g4-g5 or h4-h5. It was again interesting to play 12...h5!?. But if 12...b5 White can play 13.h5 g5 14. ♕xg5± and if 14...hxxg5? White has 15.h6 ♕h8 16.h7+ ♖xh7 (or 16... ♔g7 17. ♔h2 with mate in three) 17. ♖xd7 ♔xd7 18. ♔h2, mating.

13.e4

As we can see, White is combining his attack on the kingside with the opening of the centre, a logical plan in view of White's greater activity, whereas the black pieces are passive. Again the quiet 13. ♔b1± was also good

13... ♖b6 14. ♔d2! ♔h7



Training question: What should White play here?

15. ♕xh6!!

An excellent winning move, and a difficult one even for an engine, which takes a while before it evaluates it as decisive. There were alternatives which retained White's advantage, such as 15.h5 or 15.♖b1, but the move played is very direct and decisive.

15... ♖xh6 16.g5 ♗f6

This move loses, but the other options are not much better, as we can see in the following variations; White's attack is very strong: if 16... ♗g7 then 17.h5! ♗xe5 18.hxg6+ ♖g8 (18... ♖xg6 19.dxe5+-) 19.gxf7+ ♗xf7 20.g6! ♗g7 21.♗h6, with a decisive advantage for White.

If 16...f6 White plays 17.♗g4! and now:

A) 17... ♗c4 18.♗e2 ♗g7 19.h5 fxg5 20.exd5 ♗cd6 (20...b5 21.hxg6+ ♖xg6 22.b3+-) 21.♗xe7 ♗f5 22.hxg6+ ♖xg6 23.♗e5+ ♗xe5 24.♗h7+ ♖f6 25.♗h6+-;

B) 17... ♗g7 18.h5 ♗c4 19.♗e2 and the position is winning for White.

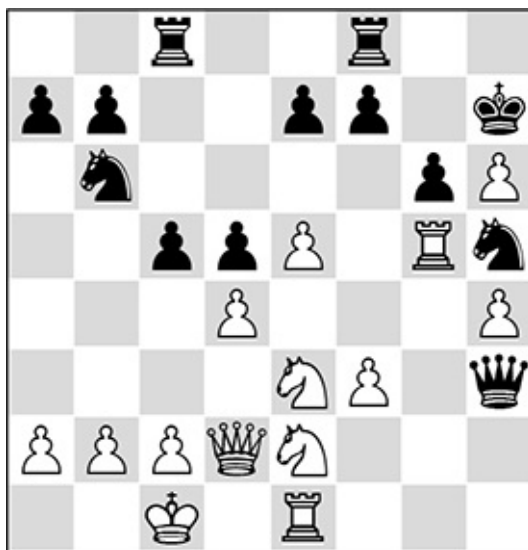
17.gxh6 ♗h5 18.♗hg1 ♗e6 19.♗de1

It was slightly better to play 19.b3! to prevent the black knight from jumping to c4.

19... ♗f6 20.♗g4 ♗d6

Or 20... ♗xh4 21.exd5 cxd5 22.♗h1 ♗g3 23.♗xe7, with a decisive advantage.

21.e5 ♗e6 22.♗e3 ♗ac8 23.♗e2 c5 24.♗g5 ♗h3



25. ♖eg1?!

Rather dubious. It was more precise to play 25.dxc5+–.

25... ♖g8?

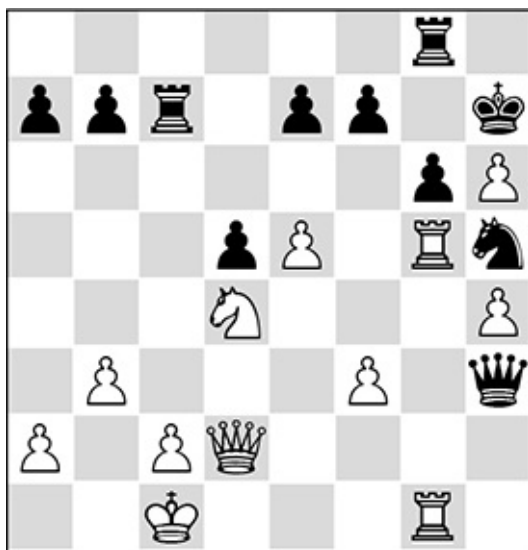
More tenacious was 25... ♖xf3 26. ♖5g4 f5 27.exf6 ♖xf6 28.dxc5 ♖c4 29. ♖xc4 ♖xg4 30. ♖xg4 ♖f1+ 31. ♖d1 ♖xd1+ 32. ♖xd1 dxc4 33. ♖xc4, although White maintains a clear advantage.

26.dxc5 ♖xc5 27. ♖d4

Here 27. ♖d3 was also winning, with the idea of 28. ♖xh5, and if 27... ♖xf3 then 28. ♖f1+–.

27... ♖c4 28. ♖xc4 ♖xc4 29.b3 ♖c7?

This loses immediately; comparatively best was 29... ♖xd4 30. ♖xd4 ♖xf3, but after 31. ♖b1 White should win.



30. ♖xh5!

The finishing stroke to White's attack; the rook is immune from capture.

30...f6

If 30...gxh5 then 31. ♖xg8 ♔xg8 32. ♕g5+ ♔f8 33.h7 and White wins.

31.exf6 exf6 32. ♖xd5

1-0

SUMMARY

We have examined the Barry Attack, with ♖c3, which can be played against both the Grünfeld and the King's Indian. The idea is to play ♖e5, ♗e2, h2-h4-h5 and castle queenside, with a strong attack on the kingside. It is a good weapon to have available and it is quite solid, although in my opinion Black can equalise more easily than against the London System. I think that the best defence for Black is with ...c7-c5. The systems with ...c7-c6, or ...♗g4, as in this game, are inferior, because they grant White more freedom to attack the black king.

CONCLUSION

To round off this Chapter on playing against the Grünfeld set-up we present a summary of the main features that we have seen. In general, as a London player, the systems with ...d7-d5 and ...g7-g6 do not worry me in the least. I think that the systems with ...d7-d6, in King's Indian style, are more dangerous, because with the black pawn on d5 the f4-bishop has more scope on the h2-b8 diagonal and gains in strength in some variations, as we could see in Game 10.

In Game 8 we saw the black scheme with ...c7-c5 and ...♗b6. The most outstanding feature for White is that after the move ...c5-c4 by Black, White is not obliged to exchange queens but instead can play ♔a3!, followed by the pawn break b2-b3, with the better prospects.

We also saw that White can play with or without h2-h3, as in Game 10; it is a matter of taste, but for club players it is simpler to play with h2-h3, to avoid the need to study all the lines with ...♖h5 by Black.

In Game 9 we saw the idea of dxc5 for White, which is good if Black allows it by adopting an incorrect move order.

In Game 11 we saw another plan for Black, based on taking on d4 and then playing ...♖h5 followed by ...♗c7. We saw that White should play

♗d2 or ♗c1, trying to control f4 or else play ♕h6, exchanging bishops. It is also worth noting the play on both wings.

In Game 12 we saw the black plan with ...b7-b6, followed by ...♘c6. We also analysed the development of the black knight to d7. I think that White has the better prospects with the plan of ♗b3 and a2-a4, not forgetting the b2-b3 break if Black plays ...c5-c4.

Finally, in Game 13 we saw an alternative which is valid against both the Grünfeld and the King's Indian, the so-called Barry Attack, which involves the move ♘c3, followed by ♕f4, e2-e3, ♘e5, ♕e2 and h2-h4-h5. This is White's standard plan if Black allows it. There is a modern alternative to the traditional London scheme, based on holding back the e-pawn and playing ♗d2, with the idea of ♕h6 and quick queenside castling. The Barry has its own body of theory and here we have provided enough theoretical lines and examples for you to include it in your repertoire, either as an occasional weapon or as a permanent component. The Barry Attack can work very well, especially if Black plays passively without a quick ...c7-c5, but with best play Black equalises more easily than in the London System.

Chapter 3

The London System versus the King's Indian

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♖f4 g6 3.e3 ♗g7



4.e3

4.♗c3

4...0-0 5.♗e2 d6

5...c5

6.0-0

6.h3

6...c5

6...♗bd7; 6...♗c6; 6...♗fd7; 6...b6

7.c3

7.h3

7...b6

7...cxd4

7...♗b6 (7...♗e6, 7...♗h5)

8.♗bd2

8.♗b3

8.h3 ♖b7 **9.♗bd2** ♗bd7
9... ♗c6
10.a4
10.♖e1
10...a6 **11.♗h2**
11.♙b3; 11.♖e1
11...♙c7
11...♗c8; 11...♗a7; 11...♙b8

The King's Indian is one of Black's most frequently used defences. In the glorious Kasparov era, it was by far the most popular defence against 1.d4. It is still quite popular today, especially among club players, and it is one of the best ways to meet the London System. By playing ...g7-g6 and ...d7-d6, with the idea of ...e7-e5 or ...c7-c5, Black blocks the b1-h7 diagonal, along which White's king's bishop is active in the lines where Black plays ...d7-d5, with a Queen's Gambit Declined setup. Furthermore, with the h2-b8 diagonal obstructed, the bishop on f4 has less scope.

There are several plans for Black: the classical systems of the King's Indian with the plans of ...e7-e5 or ...c7-c6, and options such as ...♙e8, followed by ...e7-e5; there is also ...♗bd7 or ...♗fd7, with the same idea. The main, and most popular, alternative is to play ...c7-c5, with two ideas for Black: 1) ...♙b6, or first ...♗e6 (to prevent ♙b3 by White), followed by ...♙b6, to put pressure on the b2-pawn; or 2) playing a reversed Réti Opening with ...b7-b6, which is the most common plan for Black. Personally the reversed Réti set-up is the one I encounter most often in my own games. In the final part of the book we shall cover a rarer move order with ...d7-d6, ...g7-g6, ...♗g7 and ...♗d7, with the idea of a quick ...e7-e5 but without playing ..♗f6.

We shall see various plans for White. He should play h2-h3 at an opportune moment to withdraw the bishop to h2. In response to variations where Black plays ...e7-e5, to have any chance of advantage White should play c2-c4 and ♗c3, instead of c2-c3 and ♗bd2, which is the usual set-up in the London, since it is important to keep the d2-square free for the knight on f3 in case Black plays ...e7-e5, followed by ...e5-e4; thus it is usually an error to play ♗bd2. The king's bishop goes to e2. However, against the black plan with ...c7-c5, with the idea of ...♙b6 (or first ...♗e6 and only then ...♙b6), it is necessary to play the set-up with c2-c3 and at an opportune moment change course with dxc5, or enter an endgame with ♙xb6. Against the Réti Reversed, White's plan is usually to play ♗h2, a2-a4 and ♖e1 and prepare e3-e4, or c2-c4 and d4-d5, to close the

a8-h1 diagonal and create play in the centre and on the kingside, taking advantage of the distant location of the black pieces on the queenside. It is also possible to play on the queenside with ♖b3, ♖a3 and b2-b4. Another idea is ♖b3 and ♙c4, putting pressure on f7 after ♗g5. These are solid positions which present no danger for White.

Game 14

King's Indian

Renier Vazquez Igarza

2535

José Candela Perez

2390

Madrid 2010 (6)

1. ♗f3 ♗f6 2.d4 g6 3. ♙f4 ♙g7 4.e3 d6



The King's Indian against the London.

5. ♙e2

5.h3 is another option; we shall see that is possible to play with or without h2-h3. This move has advantages and disadvantages but according to the present state of theory it seems preferable to play without an early h2-h3.

5...0-0

If 5... ♗h5 then 6. ♗g5 and now:

A) 6...h6 7. ♗h4 g5 (7...c5 8.c3 g5 9. ♗fd2 cxd4 10.cxd4 ♗f4 11.exf4 gxh4 12. ♗b3∞) 8. ♗fd2 and now:

A1) 8...gxh4 9. ♗xh5 e5 10.dxe5 (10.d5±) 10...dxe5?! (10... ♗xe5=) 11. ♗c3 ± Romanov-Drenchev, Skopje 2013;

A2) 8... ♗f6 9. ♗g3 ♗c6 10.c4± Bocharov-Nepomniachtchi, Apatity 2011;

A3) 8... ♖f4 9.exf4 gxf4 10.c3 and now:

A31) 10...c5 11.dxc5! (11. ♖b5+!? ♔f8?! (11... ♖d7=) 12.dxc5 dxc5 13. ♔h5 ± Banawa-Yermolinsky, Saint Louis 2013) 11...dxc5 12. ♖a3 ♖c6± Prié-Iwanenko, Condom 2012;

A32) 10... ♖d7 11.0-0 c5 12.d5 (12. ♖f3±) 12... ♖f6= Rivas-Romero, León 1995;

B) 6...f5?! 7.c3 0-0 8.0-0 h6 9. ♖h4± De Prado-Merayo, A Coruña 2013.

6.h3

We shall see further on that it is preferable to play 6.0-0 ♖bd7 7.h3, which transposes to the game, since this move order cuts out certain lines for Black, especially involving the move ...c7-c5.

6... ♖bd7 7.0-0 ♔e8

We shall begin our analysis with this move. In the most classical King's Indian style, Black wants to play ...e7-e5. We shall see that Black has several options here. The lines with ...c7-c5 or ...b7-b6 are analysed in other games.

A) An interesting move here is 7... ♖e4!?, with the idea of a quick ...e7-e5. This knight move is a resource that Black should always keep in mind, whether he has already played ...e7-e5 or not.



analysis diagram

A1) 8. ♖d3. Black's reply tells us immediately that this is not the best move:

A11) 8...e5!? – it seems that this move is possible – 9. ♖xe4 exf4 10.exf4 ♖f6 11. ♔e1 d5 (11... ♖h6 12.c4 ♖xf4 13. ♖c3=) 12. ♖d3 ♖h5 13.f5 gxf5 (13... ♖f4! 14.fxg6 fxg6 15. ♖f1 and Black has sufficient compensation) 14.c3±;

A12) 8... ♖df6 is inferior due to 9. ♖bd2 ♖f5 10. ♔e1±.

A2) 8. ♖bd2 ♖xd2 9. ♔xd2 e5 10. ♖g5 ♔e8 (10...f6 11. ♖h4 e4 12. ♖e1±)

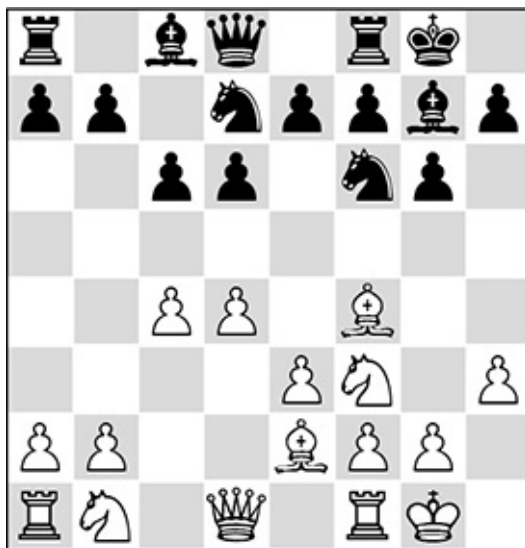
11.dxe5 ♖xe5 12.♗d4 h6 13.♙h4 a6=;

A3) 8.♚d3 is interesting and has been employed by the French player Prié:

A31) 8...f5?! 9.♗c3 (9.♜d1 e6 10.♗fd2 ♖xd2 11.♗xd2±) 9...♗df6 10.♗xe4 ♗xe4 11.♜ad1±;

A32) 8...♗df6 9.♗bd2 ♙f5 10.♗xe4 ♙xe4 (10...♗xe4 11.♚a3±) 11.♚b3 a5 12.c4 a4 13.♚a3=.

B) Another idea for Black is 7...c6 8.c4! (other possible options are 8.♙h2, 8.c3 and 8.♗bd2):



analysis diagram

B1) 8...a6 and now:

B11) 9.a4 a5 10.♗c3 ♗b8 (10...h6 11.♚c2 ♚e8 12.♙h2 e5 13.♜ad1± Khalifman-Rodshtein, Dresden 2007) 11.e4 ♗a6 12.♚d2± Dreev-Berg, Dresden 2007;

B12) 9.♚c2 ♜e8 10.♗c3 b5 (10...e5 11.dxe5 ♗xe5 12.♜ad1±) 11.a3 (11.e4 ±) 11...e5 12.dxe5 (12.♙h2!±) 12...♗xe5 13.♜ad1 ♚e7± De Prado-Meskovs, Arteixo 2013;

B2) 8...♗h5?! 9.♙h2 e5 10.♗c3± Muhammad-Simutowe, New York 2001;

B3) 8...e5!? 9.♙h2 (9.dxe5 dxe5 10.♗xe5 ♗h5 11.♙xh5 ♗xe5 12.♙e2 ♗d3=) 9...♗e4 10.♚c2 f5 11.♗c3 ♗xc3 12.♚xc3±;

C) 7...♜e8!? has also been played, with the plan of ...e7-e5:

C1) 8.♗c3! is best, with a slight advantage to White after 8...b6 9.♙c4 (9.a4; 9.e4) 9...♙b7 Sakhatova-Kim, Yerevan 1996;

C2) 8.♙h2 e5?! (8...b6) 9.dxe5! (9.c4? e4 (9...♗e4=) 10.♗e1 (10.♗fd2±) 10...♗f8 (10...♚e7) 11.♗c3± Fedorowicz-Shirov, Stockholm 1990) 9...dxe5 10.♗xe5 ♗e4 11.♗d3±;

C3) 8.c4 e5!? (8...♘e4 9.♙c2 e5 is another idea) 9.dxe5 dxe5 (9...♘e4 10.♙c2 dxe5 11.♞h2 f5 12.♚d1±) 10.♘xe5 ♘h5! 11.♞xh5 ♘xe5 12.♞e2 ♘d3! 13.♙xd3 (13.♞xd3 ♞xb2 14.♘c3 ♞xc3 15.♚b1=) 13...♙xd3 14.♞xd3 ♞xb2 15.♘a3 ♞xa3 16.♞xc7 ♞e6 and Black has compensation.

D) However, the immediate 7...e5?! does not work, due to 8.dxe5 ♘e4 9.♙d5 dxe5 10.♘xe5 ♘xe5 11.♙xe4±.



8.c4

This is one of the variations in which White should play c2-c4 instead of c2-c3, since it is important that the knight has the c3-square available, leaving the d2-square free for the f3-knight to retreat, in the event of ...e5-e4 by Black.

White's plan is to play on the queenside. It is possible to play in solid fashion with c2-c3, but in that case White cannot aspire to any advantage. The immediate 8.♞h2 can be played here, usually transposing.

8...e5 9.♞h2



9...e4?!

I dislike this advance for Black, since it gives White a free hand to play on the queenside and opens the diagonal of the bishop on h2. There are a couple of alternatives:

A) 9...♔e7 10.♚c3 and now:

A1) 10...♕e8? 11.♚b5! (this leap gives White a clear advantage) 11...e4 12.♚xc7 exf3 13.♙xf3 ♖b6 14.♚xe8 ♙xe8 15.♖c1± Kallai-Guliev, Nancy 2004;

A2) 10...b6 11.♔a4 or 11.♚d2 ♙b7 12.♙f3 ♙xf3 13.♔xf3, in both cases with advantage to White;

A3) 10...c6 11.♖c1 (there are other options, such as 11.♔c2! ♚e8 12.b4± Nikolic-Bulaji, Sarajevo 2013; 11.c5?! dxc5 12.♚xe5 ♚xe5 13.♙xe5 ♖d8= Grachev-Mamedyarov, Moscow 2010; 11.♖e1 ♚e8 12.b4 e4 13.♚d2± Prié-Macak, Birmingham 2006; 11.b4 b6 12.c5 bxc5 13.bxc5 dxc5 14.♚xe5± Bellón-Tal, Barcelona 1986) 11...♚e8 12.b4 f5 13.c5± De Prado-Fernandez, Lugo 2014.

B) 9...♚e4 – again this leap has been played quite often:

B1) 10.♔c2 (this recommendation by Houdini has rarely been played. Other options are 10.♙d3!?, or 10.♚a3!? a6 11.♖c1 f5 12.c5 dxc5 13.dxc5 c6 14.♚c4± De Prado-Leao, Famalicao 2014) 10...f5 and now:

B11) 11.♙d3 ♚xf2 (11...♚ef6 12.dxe5 dxe5 13.c5±) 12.♔xf2 e4 13.♙e2 exf3 14.♙xf3;

B12) 11.♚c3 ♚xc3 12.♔xc3 b6± Palchun-Tseitlin, St Petersburg 2013;

B2) 10.♚bd2 is the most common reply and was even played by Kasparov in the late 1970s: 10...♚xd2 (10...f5 11.dxe5 ♚xd2 12.♔xd2± Kasparov-Negulescu, Cagnes Sur Mer 1977) 11.♔xd2 and now:

B21) 11...e4 12.♘e1 ♔e7 (12...f5 13.♘c2± Pakleza-Licznerski, Chorzow ch-POL 2013) 13.♘c2 (13.♚c1) 13...♘f6 (13...♘b6 14.♔a5±) 14.♚ac1± Jussupow-Fuller, Esbjerg 1980;

B22) 11...♔e7 12.♚fd1 e4 13.♘e1 ♘f6 14.♚ac1, with advantage to White, Kasparov-Horiguti, Sao Paulo 2004.

10. ♘fd2

This is one of the key ideas that it is essential to remember – leave the d2-square free for this knight to retreat.

10... ♔e7 11. ♘c3



White has a comfortable advantage in this position. The move ♘b5 is in the air and there are ideas of playing on the queenside with ♚c1, b2-b4 and c4-c5. In contrast, Black has no clear plan; he needs to defend his pawn on e4 and furthermore the g7-bishop is likely to remain out of play.

11...c6

After 11...♚e8 there are several moves that give White an advantage:

A) 12.♔c2 ♘f8? (12...b6 13.a4 a5 14.♘b5±) 13.♚ae1± (13.♘d5!± is better) Zhang Zhong-Nolte, Beijing 2008;

B) 12.♘b5 was played by Spassky as early as 1978: 12...♔d8 (12...♘f8 13.c5!) 13.c5!? (the simple 13.♔c2 gives White a clear advantage) 13...a6 14.cxd6! (this was Spassky's idea, the sacrifice of a piece for three pawns, including one very strong one on c7) 14...axb5 15.dxc7 ♔e7 16.♙xb5. White is slightly better and eventually won in Spassky-Bukic, Bugojno 1978;

C) 12.b4 ♘f8 13.♔c2 (13.c5!±) 13...c6 14.d5 (14.c5±) 14...h5± Bagaturov-Olarasu, La Fère 2006.

12.b4 ♚e8 13.c5



The typical break: it is worth noting how the bishop on h2 comes to life again with the opening of the h2-b8 diagonal. It is typical of the London System that in many variations it seems that the h2-bishop is hardly in the game, but then suddenly it is transformed into a key piece.

13...d5

If 13...dxc5 then 14.bxc5 b6 15.♔d6 ♔d8 16.♖b1, with a clear advantage to White.

14.b5 ♘f8 15.bxc6 bxc6 16.♔a4

White has managed to create weaknesses on c6 and a7, and his pieces are better. In particular the h2-bishop compares favourably with one on g7, which is out of play, as often happens in many variations of the London System.

16...♗d7 17.♖ab1

Another recurrent theme is White's control of the b-file, which Black is unable to contest because the b8-square is denied to the black rooks.

17...♗e6 18.♖b8

It was better to employ the plan of 18.♖b4 ♘d8 19.♖fb1, with the idea of ♘b3 and ♘a5, with a clear advantage.

18...♖xb8 19.♔xb8 ♔a6

If 19...a6 then 20.♖b1±.

20.♖b1!

It is essential to defend the valuable bishop on b8.

20...♔xe2 21.♗xe2 ♖e7

The only way to defend the a7-pawn.

22.♔d6 ♖e8 23.♗a6

White has a decisive advantage: his control of the position is total, with command of the b-file and the h2-b8 diagonal, as well as having the more active

queen, added to which the pawn on a7 will soon fall.

23... ♖a8



24. ♖b8+!

But not 24. ♖b7? ♕c8 and Black is better.

24... ♖xb8 25. ♕xb8

And the a-pawn is lost. The white bishop has done a great job, enabling White to exchange all the rooks and finally helping to win the pawn.

25... ♗h5 26. ♕xa7 ♕c8

After 26... ♕xa7 27. ♕xa7 White should win the ending.

27. ♗g3 f5 28. ♗xh5 gxh5 29. ♕d6 f4 30. ♕b8 ♕xb8 31. ♕xb8 fxe3 32. fxe3 ♗xd4!?

Trying to complicate in a lost position. If 32... ♕h6 then 33. ♗f1.

33. exd4 ♕xd4+ 34. ♕f1 ♕xc5 35. ♗b3 ♕a3 36. ♗d4 c5 37. ♗c2 ♕c1 38. ♕a7 c4 39. ♕e3

White has managed to block the black pawns and has a won game.

39... ♕xe3 40. ♗xe3 c3 41. ♗c2 ♕f7 42. ♕e2 ♕e6 43. ♕e3

1-0

After 43... ♕e5 44. a4 wins.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw Black's traditional plan of playing ... ♗bd7 and ... e7-e5, normally with ... ♕e8, although we also analysed some other options for Black. It is important to keep in mind that for White to gain any advantage he should play c2-c4 (instead of c2-c3, which is normal in the London System) and ♗c3, since it is necessary to leave the d2-square free for the knight on f3, when Black plays ... e5-e4. I wish to draw your attention to the black plan of playing an immediate ... e7-e5 followed by ...

♗e4, or ...♗e4 first, which can give Black equality. In the game I dislike Black's advance ...e5-e4, since this leaves White with the advantage. White's plan is clear: play on the queenside with ideas such as ♗b5, b2-b4 and c4-c5, opening the diagonal of the bishop on h2, and also b4-b5, opening the b-file. In this game these were the keys to White's victory.

Game 15

King's Indian

Eric Prié

2510

Pierre Bailet

2426

Pau ch-FRA 2012 (8)

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♘f4 g6 3.e3 ♘g7 4.♗f3 d6 5.♗e2 0-0 6.0-0 ♗bd7 7.h3

Here the move h2-h3 is necessary, because 7.c4?! e5! 8.dxe5 ♗e4 gives Black good play.

7...b6



Playing ...b7-b6 is a good defensive method for Black, with the idea of playing ...♗b7 and a quick ...♗e4, without ...c7-c5. The lines with ...c7-c5 transpose to the Réti Reversed, which we shall investigate later and which is Black's most popular set-up. White has several plans to combat this idea.

8.a4

This seems be White's best plan to try for an advantage.

A) The main move would be 8.c4, but it seems that Black equalises after 8...♗b7 9.♗c3 ♗e4! 10.♗xe4 ♗xe4 and now:

A1) 11. ♖a4!? c5 (11...e5= is better) 12. ♖ad1 ♜c7 13.b4 a5 14.b5 cxd4 15.exd4 ½-½ Sokolov-Cheparinov, Reykjavik 2012;

A2) 11. ♕h2 has been played by some strong players:

A21) 11...c5 12. ♖c1 (12. ♗g5 ♕b7 13. ♕f3 ♜c7 14. ♖d3=);

A211) 12... ♖c8 13.a3 (13. ♗g5) 13... ♜c7 14.b4= Kamsky-T.L.Petrosian, Mainz 2007;

A212) 12...a5 13.d5?! (13. ♗g5) 13... ♕xf3 (13... ♕xb2! 14. ♗d2 ♕xc1 15. ♖xc1 ♗f6 16.g4 ♕d7) 14.gxf3 ♗d7 ♗d7 ♗d7 Vallejo-Mikhalevski, Heviz 2008;

A22) 11...e6 12. ♖a4 ♜e7 13. ♗d2 ♕b7 14. ♕f3 ♕xf3 15. ♗xf3 e5 16. ♜c6 ♖ac8 17. ♖ac1 (17.b4!?) 17...a5= Nguyen Ngoc-Edouard, Cap d'Agde 2010;

A23) 11... ♕b7 is also good, with equality;

A24) 11...e5! 12. ♖d2 ♜e7 13. ♖fd1 ♖fd8 (13... ♖fe8=) 14. ♖ac1 a5= Kamsky-Smirin, Khanty-Mansiysk 2005;

A3) 11. ♗d2 ♕b7 12. ♕f3 ♜c8= Prié-Vachier-Lagrave, Marseille 2010 (12... ♕xf3=).

B) Another plan is 8. ♗bd2 ♕b7 9.a4 ♖e8 10. ♕h2 (10.a5!) 10...e5 11.dxe5 (11.a5) 11...dxe5 12.c3 ♜e7 13.a5 a6 14.axb6 cxb6 15. ♖b3 b5 16. ♖a3± De Prado-Ferreiro, Arteixo 2013.

C) An interesting and so far untried idea is to play 8. ♗c3 ♕b7 9. ♕h2; White dispenses with moving the c-pawn and speeds up his development; this line deserves trials.

D) Also playable is 8.c3 ♕b7 (8...c5 transposes to the Réti Reversed) and now several alternatives have been played, but the majority involve the plan of a2-a4, which will usually transpose to the game.

8...a5

This seems to me to be the best move for Black, preventing White's plan of a4-a5.

If 8... ♕b7 then 9.a5 bxa5 10. ♗bd2 (10. ♖xa5! c5 11. ♖a3±) 10...c5 (10... ♗d5 11. ♕g5) 11. ♗b3 ♜b6 12. ♗xa5± Tu Hoang Thong-Bu Xiangzhi, Ottawa 2007.

Another common idea is 8...a6, which has been played by some strong grandmasters:



analysis diagram

A) 9. ♘c3!? is again an interesting idea which awaits trials;

B) 9. ♕h2 has been played quite often and after 9... ♕b7 the game can transpose to lines of the Réti Reversed if Black plays ...c7-c5, but sometimes Black avoids this and different positions arise:

B1) 10.c3 would be normal after ...c7-c5 by Black, but otherwise it is better to abstain from this move and play c2-c4 or ♘c3. Black now has several alternatives:

B11) 10... ♖e8 and now:

B111) 11.c4 e5 (11...a5 12. ♘c3 ♘e4 13. ♘b5 ♖c8 14. ♖c2 e5 15. ♖ae1 ♗e7 ½-½ Burmakin-Banikas, Vrachati 2011) 12. ♘c3 (12.a5!±) 12...exd4 (12...a5=) 13.exd4± Grachev-Nepomniachtchi, Moscow 2010;

B112) 11.a5 b5 12.c4 bxc4 13. ♕xc4 ♘e4 14. ♘c3 ♘df6 15. ♖e2±;

B113) 11. ♘a3?! e5 12. ♘c4 ♘e4= Ivanchuk-Caruana, Reggio Emilia 2012;

B12) 10...e6 was played recently by Dominguez and Nepomniachtchi;

B111) The normal move is 11. ♘bd2 ♖e7 12.a5 (better than 12. ♘c4 ♖fd8 13. ♖b3 ♖ab8 14. ♖a3 ♘e4= Gareev-Sasikiran, Visakhapatnam 2008) 12...b5 13.c4 bxc4 14. ♘xc4 (14. ♖c1! is better) 14... ♖fb8 15. ♖a4 (again 15. ♖c1!) 15... ♘d5 16. ♖fe1 ♘7f6 17. ♘fd2= Naiditsch-Dominguez, Wijk aan Zee 2014;

B112) 11. ♘fd2!? ♖e7 12. ♕f3= Grachev-Nepomniachtchi, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013;

B2) 10.c4 ♖e8 11. ♘c3 e5 12. ♖e1 (12. dxe5±) 12...a5= Grachev-Radjabov, Moscow 2010;

C) 9.c4 ♕b7 and now:

C1) 10.a5 ♘e4 11. ♘bd2 (11.axb6 cxb6 12. ♘g5±) 11...c5 12.d5 ♘ef6

13.axb6± De Prado-Martinez, Arteixo 2013;

C2) 10. ♖c3 ♗e4 (10...a5 11. ♔c2± Bricard-Jansa, Bissen 1995) 11. ♕h2 (11.a5; 11. ♗xe4 ♕xe4 12.a5 with the initiative) 11...c5 (11...a5=) 12. ♔b1 (12. ♔c2±) 12... ♗df6 13.d5 ♗xc3 14.bxc3 e6= Bauer-Le Roux, Le Port Marly 2012.



9. ♗c3

Here 9.c3 has also been played, but this seems unnecessary. The systems with c2-c3 are very solid, but I think that without ...c7-c5 by Black White achieves nothing with c2-c3: 9... ♕b7 10. ♗bd2 ♗e4 (10... ♖e8=) 11. ♗xe4 ♕xe4 12. ♔b3= Gurevich-Ftacnik, Turin ol 2006, or 9. ♗bd2 ♕b7 10.c3 e6 11. ♕h2 ♔e7 12. ♗c4 ♗e4 13. ♗fd2 ♗xd2 14. ♗xd2 f5 15. ♕f3 ♕xf3 16. ♔xf3= Cacho-Morozevich, Bilbao 2014.

The move 9. ♗a3 is interesting, for instance 9... ♕b7 10. ♕h2 e6 11.c3 ♔e7 12. ♗b5 ♖ac8 13.b4= Nguyen Thi-Nguyen Anh, Ho Chi Minh City 2011.

9... ♕b7 10. ♔d3!?

Provocative and strange. Prié wants to prevent ... ♗e4 by Black and perhaps in future play e3-e4 or ♔c4. Instead, the more normal 10. ♕b5 was good, e.g. 10... ♖c8 11. ♔e2 ♗e4 (11...c6 12. ♕c4) 12. ♗xe4 ♕xe4 13.c3± or 13. ♖ad1±.

10... ♖e8

Black is not tempted to exchange bishops, since he would end up worse after 10... ♕a6 11. ♔d2 (11. ♗b5? c6–+) 11... ♕xe2 12. ♔xe2±.

10... ♖c8 is also playable, with an unclear position after 11. ♖ad1 or 11. ♕h2, although I prefer White.

11. ♖ad1 ♔c8

Black evades the pressure of the d1-rook, in order to play ...e7-e5; instead 11...

e5? fails to 12.dxe5 dxe5 13.♖xe5.

Other ideas are 11...c5 12.d5± and 11...♗f8!?



12. ♗g3?!

Prophylaxis against the threat of ...e7-e5, but I think that it is better to play 12.♗h2!, to prevent Black from gaining a tempo later with ...♗e4 and to give the white queen more room if it goes to h4, e.g. 12...e5 13.dxe5 dxe5 14.♖c4 ♗a6 15.♖h4 ♗xe2 16.♗xe2, with a slight advantage to White.

12...e5 13.dxe5 dxe5

The alternative was 13...♗c5 14.♖d4 ♗fd7 15.e4 ♗xe5 16.♗xe5 dxe5 17.♖e3±.

14. ♖c4 ♗a6 15. ♖a2

Now the line 15.♖h4 ♗xe2 16.♗xe2 is not good, since after 16...e4 17.♗fd4 h6 the white queen does not have the square g3.

15... ♗xe2 16. ♗xe2 ♗e4

Black has equalised, largely due to the inaccurate move 12. ♗g3.

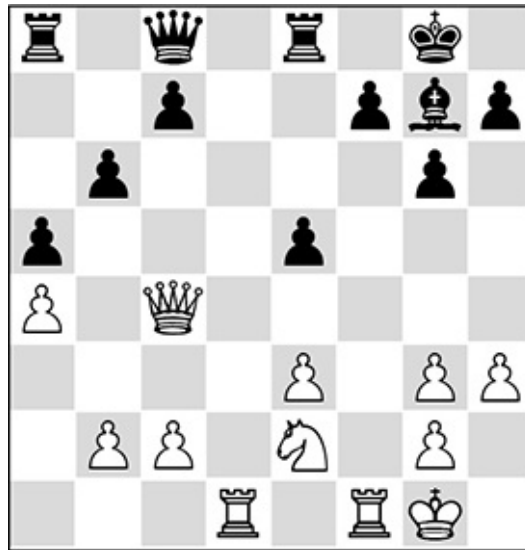
17. ♗d2

Or 17. ♗h2 ♗dc5=.

17... ♗dc5 18. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 19. ♖c4 ♗xg3?!

Eliminating White's dark-squared bishop is normally good for Black, but here that is not the case. It was preferable to play 19...♗c5, with equality.

20.fxg3!



White is better after this recapture, since he controls the light squares and can apply pressure along the half-open f-file against the weak point f7; his queen is more active, he dominates the open d-file and his knight is better than Black's bishop.

20... ♖e6 21. ♗c3 e4 22. ♗d5± 22... ♙e5 23. ♙xe4 ♜e8 24. ♙c4

It was better to play 24. ♙h4!, with a clear advantage to White.

It would be inferior to play 24. ♙xe5?! ♗xe5 25. ♗f6+ ♜f8 26. ♗xe8 ♗axe8 27. ♗d7 ♗8e7 28. ♗xe7 ♜xe7 29. ♜f2 ♗c5, which would give Black drawing chances.

24... ♗c8 25. ♗f3 ♗d8 26. ♗df1 ♗d7 27. b3 ♜g7 28. g4 ♗ed6?

It was necessary to play 28... ♜g8, although White would still maintain a clear advantage.

29. ♗xc7+- ♜e7 30. ♗xf7+

Black resigned.

SUMMARY

The move 7...b6, with the idea of a quick ...♗e4 and without ...c7-c5, is a good defensive method for Black. For White it seems that the best plan is to play a2-a4 and ♗c3, instead of c2-c4, when Black can equalise as in the game Prié-Vachier-Lagrave. In the game, White tested the move ♙d3, although the natural ♙b5 seems better. Later he should have retreated the bishop to h2 instead of g3, which allowed Black to equalise. Remember that, with rare exceptions, it is almost always better to move the bishop to h2 rather than g3. White gained the advantage after the exchange of the knight for the bishop on g3; normally this is good for Black, but this case

was an exception and Black was left with the worse position.

Game 16

King's Indian
Gata Kamsky

2741

Abdul Rahman Saleh Salem

2531

Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013 (17)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f3 g6 3.♙f4 ♙g7 4.e3 0-0 5.h3 d6 6.♙e2 ♘c6

This move is usually made after 6... ♘fd7 7.0-0. The idea is a quick ...e7-e5.

7.0-0

With the move order used in this game it is better to play 7.♘c3!, preventing ...e7-e5. More recently, Carlsen played 7.♙h2 and now:

A) 7...e5!?

A1) 8.dxe5 ♘e4 9.♙d5 ♘g5 10.♘bd2 ♘xf3+ 11.♘xf3 ♙e6 12.♙b5 ♘xe5 13.♘xe5 dxe5 14.0-0 (14.♙xe5 c6 15.♙c5 ♙g5±; 14.♙xb7 ♙d5±) 14... ♙d5=;

A2) 8.c3 ♙e7 9.0-0=;

B) 7... ♘d7 8.a4 e5 9.a5 exd4 10.exd4 a6 11.0-0 ♙e8 12.♘c3 ♘f6 13.♙e1= Carlsen-Aronian, Berlin Wch blitz 2015.

7... ♘d7



Here Black could already play 7...e5! 8.dxe5 ♘e4 9.♙h2 dxe5 10.c3, with equality.

8.c3

A) Here 8.♖c3!? looks interesting, which incidentally is Houdini's recommendation. After Black's 8...e5 in one game I mistakenly exchanged on e5 (instead the correct way to play is 9.♕g5):

A1) 9.dxe5 ♖dxe5! 10.♗d2 (10.♖xe5 ♖xe5 11.♗d2 ♕e6=) 10...♕e6 (10...♖e8=; 10...♖xf3+ 11.♕xf3 ♖e8=) 11.♖d4 (11.♖g5 ♕c4=) 11...♖xd4 (11...♖c4 12.♕xc4 ♕xc4 13.♖fe1=) 12.exd4 ♖c4= De Prado-Nicolas, Linares 2013;

A2) 9.♕g3 is inferior: 9...exd4 10.exd4 ♖e7 (10...♖e8=) 11.♖e1 ♖f6 12.♕f1 ♕d7 13.♕h4 h6= Harikrishna-Thipsay, New Delhi 2001;

A3) I think that 9.♕g5! gives White a slight advantage in all lines:



analysis diagram

A31) 9...♕f6 (if 9...♖f6 then 10.dxe5 dxe5 11.♕b5± or 9...♗e8? 10.♖d5! (10.♖b5!) 10...f6 11.♖xc7 ♗e7 12.♖xa8 fxg5 13.♖c7+—) 10.♕h6 ♕g7 (10...♖e8 11.d5±) 11.♕xg7 ♗xg7 12.dxe5 (12.♖d5; 12.♕c4) 12...dxe5 13.♕b5±;

A32) 9...f6 is best, e.g. 10.♕h4 g5 (10...♖b6 11.♖e1±) 11.♕g3 f5 (11...exd4 12.♕c4+ ♗h8 13.♖xd4 ♖b6 14.♕b3±) 12.dxe5 (12.d5! ♖cb8 13.e4 f4 14.♕h2±) 12...♖dxe5 13.♕xe5?! (13.♖xe5±) 13...♖xe5 14.♖xe5 ♕xe5= Burmakin-Jelen, Schwarzach 1998.

B) Another option is 8.c4 e5 9.♕h2 exd4 (we shall examine 9...f5 in the next game) 10.exd4 and now:

B1) 10...♖e8 11.♖c3 ♖f6 (11...♖b6) 12.♕d3 ♖h5 13.♕c2 ♖b4 14.♕a4 (14.♕b3±) 14...♕d7 15.a3 ♕xa4 16.♗xa4 ♖c6 17.♖ad1± Grachev-Aronian, Moscow 2010;

B2) 10...♗f6! 11.♖c3 ♖xd4 12.♖xd4 ♗xd4 13.♖d5 c6! (13...♗xb2

14. ♖b1 ♜xa2 15. ♗xc7± Prié-Moussard, Caen 2011) 14. ♗e7+ ♔h8 15. ♗xd6 and now:

B21) 15... ♜xb2 16. ♖b1 ♜xa2 17. ♖e1 ♗f6 18. ♗e5 (18. ♗f1± is better) 18... ♜a3 19. ♗xc8 ♖fxc8 20. ♖xb7= Prié-Bedouin, Liverpool 2009;

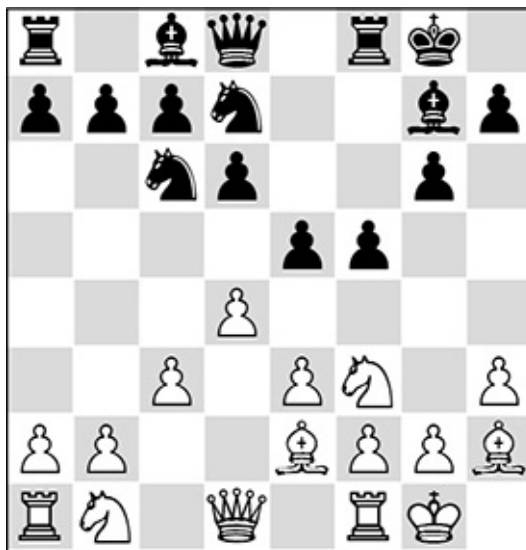
B22) 15... ♖e8 16. ♗g4 (16. ♖e1=) 16... ♗b6 17. ♜xd4 ♗xd4 18. ♖ad1 (it is better to play 18. ♗xc8 ♗xc8 19. ♗a3=, although the bishop pair might become a factor in the endgame) 18... ♗f6 19. ♗xc8 ½-½ Andrianov-Gareev, Mesa 2010.

C) 8. ♗h2 e5 has also been played, and now instead of 9.c3, which transposes, we have 9. ♗c3 ♖e8 (9...exd4 10.exd4 ♖e8=) 10. ♗c4 (10.d5±) 10... ♗b6 11. ♗b3= Nikolic-Damljanovic, Novi Sad 1995, or 9. ♗a3!? ♜e7 (9...a6=) 10. ♗b5 ♗f6 (10... ♗b6=) 11.c4 ♗e4 (11... ♖e8=) 12. ♗d3 exd4 13. ♗xe4 ♜xe4 14.exd4± Naiditsch-Jorczik, Deizisau 2013.

8...e5 9. ♗h2

If 9. ♗g5 then 9... ♜e8=; we can see that this move is playable here, whereas with the knight on c3 it would fail to ♗d5 or ♗b5; inferior is 9...f6 10. ♗h4 g5 11. ♗g3 e4 12. ♗fd2 f5, with advantage to White.

9...f5



This is the most common move in the position, but it is not the best. King's Indian players are used to advancing their kingside pawns, but against the London System this is generally not such a good idea. Even though at first sight it looks good, the pawn advances leave weaknesses and White can easily defend against the pawn storm.

Another option is 9... ♗b6 10.a4 a5 11. ♗bd2 exd4 12.exd4 ♗e6 13. ♜c2, with a balanced position, although I prefer White.

Or 9... ♖e7 10. ♗a3 (10.d5 ♗cb8 11. ♖c2=) 10...f5 (10... ♗b6=) 11. ♗b5 ♗f6 12. ♖b3+ ♖h8 13.dxe5 dxe5 14. ♖a3± Burmakin-Gochelashvili, Sochi 2012. After 9... ♗e8 10. ♖c2 (10. ♗e1) 10...e4 11. ♗fd2 ♗f6 12.a4 a6 13.b4, White has the initiative on the queenside; in the London System this is a typical plan for White against the King's Indian.

10.a4

There are many options in this position. 10. ♗a3!? is interesting; the knight usually goes to a3 or c3, in order to leave the square d2 free for the other knight in case Black plays e3-e4. Now if 10...g5?! White plays 11.dxe5 dxe5 (11... ♗cxe5 12. ♗d4±) 12. ♖d5+ (12. ♗c4!± and 12.e4!?±) 12... ♖h8 13. ♗ad1 (13. ♗c4±) 13... ♖e7 14. ♗c4 ♗f6 (14... ♗b6=) 15. ♖b5 (15. ♖d2±) 15...a6 16. ♖b3 ♗e4 17.a4± De Prado-Nataf, Orense 2007. One year later, Nataf improved his defence with 10... ♖h8 11. ♗e1 (11. c4) 11...a6 12. ♗c1 ♖e7= Naiditsch-Nataf, Evry 2008.

Black has also played 10...e4 11. ♗d2 ♗f6 12.f3!? (12. ♖b3+ ♖h8 13.c4=) 12... ♗e7 (12... ♗h6!?=; 12...exf3 13. ♖b3+ ♖h8 14. ♗xf3 ♗e8=) 13.fxe4 fxe4 14. ♖b3+± Alterman-Avrukh, Tel Aviv 1999.

Another option is 10.b4!? a6 11.a4 ♖h8 12. ♗bd2?! (12. ♖b3) 12...e4 ½-½ M.Gurevich-Svidler, Evry 2004.

Houdini's recommendation is interesting: 10.d5!? ♗e7 11.c4 ♗c5 12. ♗c3 a5∞. Even 10. ♖b3+!? ♖h8 11.d5 ♗e7 12.c4 ♗c5 13. ♖a3, with a complex position, can be considered.

10... ♖h8

Other options include 10... ♖e7 11.b4 (11.a5±) 11...e4 12. ♗fd2 ♗d8 13.a5 a6 14.c4± Golod-Sutovsky, Netanya 2009, and 10...g5?!, when the best continuation is 11.dxe5 ♗dxe5 (11...dxe5 12. ♗a3±) 12. ♗d4±; instead, 11.a5 a6 12.dxe5 (12.d5 ♗cb8 13. ♖c2±) 12...dxe5 13. ♖d5+ (13. ♗bd2±) 13... ♖h8 14. ♗d1 (14. ♖c4) 14... ♖e7= was played in Hoffman-Strikovic, Seville 1994; if 10...e4 then 11. ♗fd2 ♖e7 12.a5 a6 13.c4, with advantage to White.

11.b4



Here 11.a5 was also good, with advantage to White. In this type of position White should play on the queenside, where he can gain the advantage: the plan is to keep advancing the pawns with b2-b4 and c3-c4, bring the queen to b3 and prepare the pawn breaks c4-c5 or b4-b5. The white knight can develop to a3 or c3. White must defend against the black attack on the kingside, but this is not usually dangerous, even though it might appear so at first sight.

11...e4 12.♘fd2 d5?!

This move is dubious, because it opens the h2-b8 diagonal for the bishop on h2, which helps White. It was better to play 12...a6 13.a5 ♔e7 14.♔b3 ♕h6 15.c4 f4 16.d5±, or 12...♔e7±.

13.b5 ♘e7 14.c4! c6?!

It was better to play 14...dxc4 15.♘c3 ♘b6 16.a5 ♘bd5 17.♘xd5 ♘xd5 18.♕xc4, although White retains the advantage.

15.bxc6

Kamsky overlooks the right move, which is 15.♘c3±.

15...bxc6 16.cxd5?

But this is more serious; 16.♘c3!± was now essential.

16...cxd5?

Wasting his opportunity; with 16...♘xd5! Black equalises, because he threatens 17...c5, ridding himself of his weak pawn, and at the same time prevents the b1-knight from developing to c3.

17.♘c3±



Kamsky finally plays the right move and White has a clear advantage. Again, this type of position is familiar to us: White has pressure on d5 and commands the open b- and c-files, because the bishop on h2 denies Black the use of both b8 and c7; the black bishop on g7 is a mere spectator in such variations.

17... ♖f6

Black's best course of action was to throw his pawns forward with 17...g5 18. ♖c1 f4, even though after 19. ♗b5 ♕b6 20.h4 White has the edge, since if 20...h6? then 21.a5 ♕xa5 22.hxg5 hxg5 23. ♗c7 ♖b8 24. ♗e6 ♖f6 25. ♗xg5 and White has a clear advantage.

18. ♗b5 a6

This creates a fresh weakness on b6 and the white knight will penetrate in any case. A better defence was 18... ♗e8, although with 19. ♖c1 White maintains a clear advantage.

19. ♗d6 ♗e6 20. ♗b3

White already has a decisive advantage: the white knights range freely through Black's camp and the h2-bishop is a monster, whereas the black pieces are mere spectators.

20...g5 21. ♗c5 ♗g8 22. ♗e5

By now many moves win, such as 22. ♖b1.

22...f4

If 22... ♗e8 then 23. ♗xe8 ♕xe8 24. ♗xa6+.

23.exf4 gxf4 24. ♗xf4 ♗g6 25. ♗g3 ♕e7

Again if 25... ♗e8 then 26. ♗xe8 ♖xe8 27. ♗xa6+.

26. ♗f5 ♕f7 27. ♖b1 ♗d7

If 27... ♖a7 then 28. ♗xg7 ♕xg7 29.a5 wins.

28. ♗d6 ♕e7 29. ♖b7 ♖ad8 30. ♗g4

SUMMARY

The plan with ...♘fd7, preparing to play ...e7-e5, can be implemented immediately or after ...♘c6, as in this game. I think that 8.♘c3, to answer 8...e5 with 9.♙g5!, gives White the advantage. The positions arising in the game after 9...f5, followed by the advance of the black pawns on the kingside, present no problems to White, who can usually gain the advantage by playing on the queenside. It is essential for White to leave the d2-square free for the f3-knight and to follow the plan of a2-a4, b2-b4, c3-c4, ♖b3 and either ♘a3 or ♘c3. In the game, we saw that after ...d7-d5 White's position is preferable and he won easily, thanks to his control of the open files and his bishop on h2, which was once more a decisive influence, commanding the h2-b8 diagonal.

Game 17

King's Indian

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2251

Antonio Pazos Porta

2084

Linares 2010 (5)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♙f4 g6 3.e3 ♙g7 4.♘f3 0-0 5.♙e2 d6 6.h3

Also playable is 6.0-0 ♘fd7 7.♘c3!? (7.h3) – again an interesting and little explored idea. Now:

A) 7...♘c6 8.♖d2 (8.h3±) 8...e5 9.♙g3±;

B) 7...e5 8.♙g5 f6 9.♙h4 ♘c6 10.h3±

6...♘fd7 7.0-0

7.♙h2 e5 8.♘c3!? (an interesting idea, which occurs in several lines; 8.c4 and 8.0-0 are the normal moves) 8...♘c6 9.0-0 ♖e8 10.♖e1 a6= Carlsen-Radjabov, Berlin Wch rapid 2015.

7...e5



Here we see the immediate ...e7-e5 advance. We saw the alternative 7...♘c6 in the previous game.

8. ♙g5!?

In all the other known games White retreated the bishop to h2. However the text move also seems good to me, and Houdini backs me up.

A) The first time I reached this position I responded with 8.dxe5 dxe5 (8... ♗xe5=) 9. ♙g5 (9. ♙g3±) 9...f6 (9... ♖e8 10. ♗c3±) 10. ♙h4 ♗c6 (10... ♗e7=):

A1) 11. ♙c4+ ♖h8 12. ♗c3 ♗e7?! (12... ♗b6 13. ♙b3 ♖e7 14. ♖e2 ♙e6=) 13.a4?! (13.e4!±) 13... ♗f5= Le Phu-Nguyen Hoang, Dalat City 2004;

A2) 11. ♗c3 ♗e7?! (11... ♗b6= 12. ♖xd8 ♗xd8 13. ♖fd1 ♙e6=) 12. ♙g3 (12.e4! ♗b6 13. ♗b5±; 12. ♙c4+! ♖h8 13.e4±) 12... ♗b6 13. ♗b5 (13.e4 ♖e8=) 13...c6 14. ♗d6 ♗f5 15. ♗xf5 (15. ♗xc8=) 15... ♗xf5 16.c3 (16. ♗d2=) 16... ♖xd1 17. ♖fxd1 ½-½ De Prado-Senlle, Spain tt 2008.

B) White's usual move here is 8. ♙h2, with several possibilities:



analysis diagram

B1) 8... ♖e8 9. ♖e1 ♘c6 10.d5 ♘e7 11.e4 f5 12. ♘c3±;

B2) 8...f5!? (advancing the kingside pawns is a very typical plan in the King's Indian) 9.c4 (also good is 9.dxe5! dxe5 10. ♘c3! (10. ♘a3 ♖e7 11.c3± Cueto-Socko, Bled 2002) 10... ♘c6 11. ♙b5 (11. ♙c4+ ♖h8 12. ♙b3±) 11... ♖h8 12. ♙d5 ♙f6 13. ♙xc6 bxc6 14. ♙a5± Arencibia-Paneque, St Spiritus ch-CUB 1989) 9... ♘c6 10. ♘c3 ♖h8 (if 10...g5 then 11.dxe5 (11.d5 ♘cb8 12.a3 a5 13. ♙b1±) 11...dxe5 12. ♘d5± Prié-Nataf, Paris 2006; or 10...e4 11. ♘d2 ♘f6 12. ♙c1 ♘e7 13.b4 c6± Grachev-Karjakin, Moscow 2010) 11. ♙c1 (11. a3 e4 12. ♘d2 ♘f6 13.b4± Parligras-Vera, Istanbul 2012) 11...g5 12.d5 ♘cb8 13.b4± De Prado-Espineira, Lugo 2014.

C) 8...exd4 9.exd4 ♘c6 (9... ♖e8±) 10.a4 (10. ♙e1±) 10... ♖h8 (10... ♖e8=) 11. ♙e1± Kovacevic-Nurkic, Tuzla 1981;

D) 8... ♖e7 9.c4 ♘c6 10. ♘c3± Moldovan-Nevednichy, Targoviste ch-ROM 2001.

8...f6

The alternative 8... ♖e8 is not usually a good move, because the white knight can go from c3 to d5:

A) 9.c4 h6 10. ♙h4 g5 (10...exd4 11.exd4 g5 12. ♙g3 f5 13. ♘c3 f4 14. ♙h2±) 11. ♙g3 f5 12. ♘c3±;

B) 9. ♘c3! h6 10. ♙h4 (10. ♘d5 hxg5 11. ♘xc7 ♖e7 12. ♘xa8 e4 13. ♘d2 ♘f6 14.b4 b6 15.a4 ♙b7 16. ♘xb6 ♙xb6 17.c4±) 10...g5 11. ♙g3 ♘c6 (11... c6 12.dxe5 dxe5 13. ♙d6±) 12. ♙e1±.

9. ♙h4 g5

Or 9... ♘c6 10. ♘c3 ♘b6 (10... ♘e7 11.e4±) 11. ♙e1 ♖e8 12. ♙g3 e4 13. ♘d2

f5 14.a4±.

10. ♖g3 f5



As mentioned already, there is no need for White to fear the advance of the black pawns on the kingside, since White can defend without any problems. Furthermore he has the better game in the centre of the board and on the queenside.

If 10...e4 then 11. ♖fd2 f5 12.c4 ♖b6 13. ♖c3 ♕e6 14. ♕h2± (14. ♖c2±; 14.f3±).

11.dxe5

11. ♖c3! is the best move, with the possible variations:

A) 11... ♖c6 12.d5 ♖b4 (12... ♖e7 13. ♖xg5±) 13.a3 (13.e4 f4 14. ♕h2±) 13... ♖a6 14.b4±;

B) 11...f4?! 12. ♕h2±;

C) 11...e4 12. ♖d2 ♖c6 13. ♕c4+ (13. a4±; 13. ♕h2±) 13... ♖h8 14. ♖h5± (14. a4±).

11...dxe5

It is bad for Black to play 11... ♖xe5? 12. ♕xe5 ♕xe5 13. ♖d5+ ♖g7 14. ♖xe5±.



12. ♖d5+

It was slightly better to play 12. ♗c3 ♘c6 (12...f4 13. ♕h2±) and now:

A) 13. ♕b5!? e4:

A1) 14. ♖d5+ ♔h8 and now:

A11) 15. ♕xc6 exf3 16. ♕xd7 (16. ♕xb7 ♕xb7 17. ♖xb7 f4 18. ♕h2 fxe3 19. fxe3 ♖b8=) 16... ♕xd7 17. ♖xf3 ♕c6 18. ♖h5 f4 19. exf4 gxf4 20. ♕h4 ♕e8 and Black has compensation for the missing pawn;

A12) 15. ♗d2 ♘de5 16. ♖xd8 ♘xd8 17. ♕h2 c6 18. ♕e2 ♕e6=.

A2) 14. ♕xc6 bxc6 15. ♗d4 ♘b6 16. ♗xc6 ♖e8 17. ♗d4 f4, again with compensation.

B) 13. a3 (13. ♕c4+ ♔h8 14. a3±) 13...e4 14. ♕c4+ ♔h8 15. ♗d2 ♘c5 16. ♗b3±;

C) 12. h4 g4 13. ♕c4+ ♔h8 14. ♗g5 ♖e7 15. ♖d5 ♘b6 16. ♗f7+ ♔g8 17. ♗h6+, with perpetual check.

12... ♖h8 13. ♗c3 ♖e7 14. ♖ad1?!

It was better to play 14. ♖a5, retaining some advantage for White.

14... ♗c6 15. ♕b5

15. ♖d2= was better.

15... ♗b6 16. ♖d2 ♕d7 17. a4 ♖ad8 18. ♖e2 e4

Or 18...f4!? 19. exf4 (19. a5!?) 19...exf4 20. ♖xe7 ♘xe7 21. ♕h2 h6=.



What should White play now?

19. ♖xc7!?

Seeing that White would stand worse after the normal 19. ♖d2, I decided on this sacrifice, which appeared interesting, although it was better to take on g5 first: 19. ♖xg5! ♜xg5 (19...h6 20. ♖gxe4 fxe4 21. ♖xc7±) 20. ♖xc7 ♜e5 21. ♖xd8 ♜xd8 22.a5 ♜xa5 23. ♖xd7 ♜xd7 (23... ♜xd7 24. ♜b5+–) 24.f4 exf3 25. ♜xf3, with a complex position. White has compensation and his rooks are a danger to Black along the open files.

19...exf3 20. ♜xf3 ♜e5

If 20...g4 then 21.hxg4 fxg4 22. ♜e2 ♜de8 23. ♖d6 ♜e6 24. ♖xf8 ♜xf8, with a complex position; or 20...♜e6 21. ♖xd8 ♜xd8 22.e4, reaching a position which is rather difficult to assess; I think that the sacrifice leaves possibilities for both sides, but White of course has compensation for the sacrificed material.

21. ♜xb7

Or 21. ♜e2 ♜xb5 22. ♖xd8 ♜xe2 23. ♖xe7 ♜xd1 24. ♖xf8 ♜xc2 25. ♖xg7+ ♜xg7 26. ♜c1=.

21...♜xb5 22. ♖xb5

It was better to play 22. ♜xd8! ♜xf1 (22... ♜xd8 23. ♖xb5±) 23. ♜xf8+ ♜xf8 24. ♜xf1 ♜a8= and White has three pawns for the piece.



22... ♖xa4??

From now on the play is full of mistakes, but we were very short of time by this point. It was better to play 22... ♖xd1 23. ♖xd1 ♗xa4 24.b3 ♗c5 25. ♗xa7 ♗e4, again reaching a complex position with White having three pawns for the piece.

23. ♖xd8+- ♖xd8 24. ♗a6

There was a simpler win with 24. ♗xa7 ♗xb2 25. ♗xd8 ♗xd8 26. ♗d4+-.

24... ♗xb2 25. ♗xd8 ♗xd8 26. ♗xa7 f4 27. ♗d4 h6?

The best try was 27... ♗f6 but after 28.exf4 gxf4 29. ♗e6 ♗e8 30. ♗xf4 White has a decisive advantage.

28. ♗e6??

Missing the obvious 28. ♗xg7+ ♗xg7 29. ♗e6++-.

28... ♗g8 29. ♗xg7 ♗xg7 30. ♗b8+ ♗h7 31. ♗b1

Of course not 31. ♗xb2?? ♗f3+-+.

31... ♗ec4

Or 31... ♗bc4 32.exf4 gxf4 33. ♗b7 ♗f7 34. ♗xf4 ♗cd6 35. ♗d7, and White wins.



32. ♖a1!

The rook threatens to invade on a7 or a8 and attack the black king, taking advantage of the fact that the black knights are a long way from the kingside.

32... ♜e5 33. ♜b7+

It was simpler to play 33. ♜a7+! ♔g6 34. ♜g8+ ♔h5 (34... ♔f5 35. ♜h7+ ♔e6 36. ♜d7+ ♔f6 37. ♜f7 mate) 35. ♜f7+ ♔h4 36. ♜e7!! ♜c3 37. g3+ fxg3 38. ♜e4+ g4 39. ♜xg4+ ♔xh3 40. ♜h5 mate.

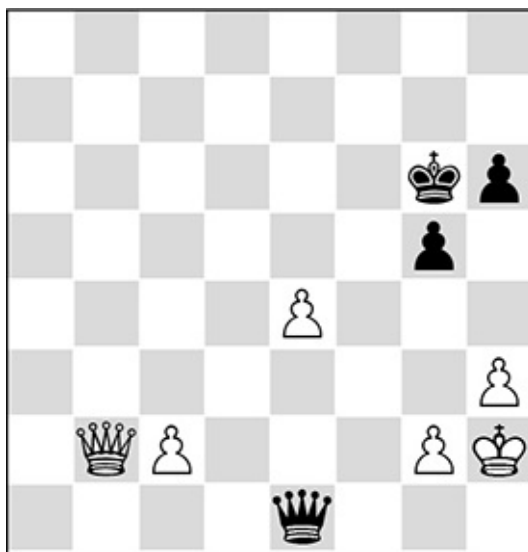
33... ♜g6 34. ♜a6+ ♜d6 35. ♜xd6??

The comedy of errors continues; White could win a knight with 35. ♜b4 ♜c4 36. ♜xc4+–.

35... ♜xd6 36. ♜xb2 fxe3 37. fxe3 ♜d1+ 38. ♜h2 ♜d6+ 39. ♜g1 ♜d1+ 40. ♜f2 ♜d2+ 41. ♜f3 ♜d5+ 42. e4

White cannot escape the perpetual check without sacrificing a pawn.

42... ♜d1+ 43. ♜g3 ♜e1+ 44. ♜h2



44...g4??

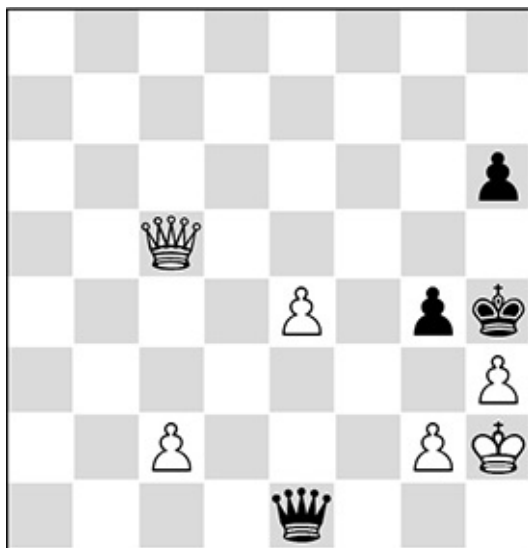
Black threatens 45...g3 mate! And if 45.hxg4 he has a draw by perpetual check. But it was better to take the pawn with 44...♞xe4 and after 45.♞b6+ ♞g7 46.♞c7+ ♞f6 47.c4, although White retains an extra pawn, it is difficult to win this ending.

45.♞b6+

Not 45.hxg4?? ♞h4+ 46.♞g1 ♞e1+, with a draw.

45...♞g5 46.♞c5+ ♞h4

If 46...♞f6 then 47.♞f8+ ♞e5 48.♞g7+ ♞e6 49.♞xh6+ ♞f7 50.♞f4+-.



47.♞e7+ ♞h5 48.♞f7+ ♞h4 49.♞f6+

After 49...♞h5, 50.♞f5+ ♞h4 51.♞xg4 is mate.

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the idea of the immediate ...♘fd7 and ...e7-e5, without ...♘c6. My recommendation is the move 8.♙g5 (instead of the usual ♙h2), which I think gives White better prospects. There is no need to fear the advance of the black pawns on the kingside; White should play in the centre and on the queenside. White's bishop, despite being temporarily hemmed in on h2 after ...f5-f4, forces Black to weaken his position with this advance, especially his e4-pawn, and in the long run White has the advantage. In the game we were able to see an interesting sacrifice and I think that despite the errors it was an interesting struggle.

Game 18

King's Indian
Arnaud Payen

2325

Eric Hansen

2557

Cappelle-la-Grande 2013 (1)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f3 g6 3.♙f4 ♙g7

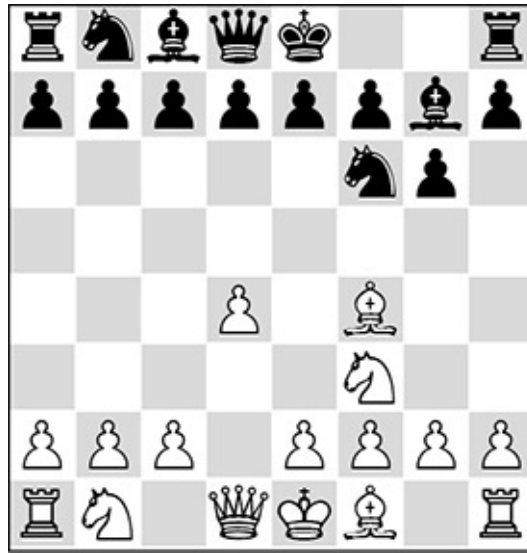
Let us examine some deviations:

3...d6 4.e3 ♘h5 5.♙g5 h6 6.♙h4 g5 7.♘fd2 ♘g7 8.♙g3 ♘f5 and now:

A) 9.♙h5 ♙g7 10.♙d3= (10.♘c3) Hoang Thi-Harika, Ningbo 2009;

B) 9.♘c3 h5 10.h3 ♘xg3 11.fxg3 c6 12.♙f3;

C) 9.♙d3 h5 (9...♘xg3 10.hxg3 ♙g7 11.♘c3± Fauland-Videki, Austria Bundesliga B 2011/12) 10.♙f3 ♙d7 11.h3 g4 (11...♘xg3 12.♙xg3±) 12.♙e2 (12.♙xf5 ♙xf5 13.♙xf5 ♙xf5 14.hxg4 ♙xg4 15.f3 ♙e6 with an interesting position; Black has the weakness on h5 but the bishop pair in return) 12...♘xg3 13.fxg3 and the position is complex.



4.e3

4.h4!? is an aggressive idea to attack Black's castled position. A possible continuation is 4...d6 5.♘c3 (5.e3; 5.♘bd2) 5...0-0 6.♙d2 (6.e4) 6...c5 7.e3 with a position similar to the Barry Attack.

Another idea is 4.c3 0-0 5.♙c1 (this is White's idea, to play a quick ♕h6) 5...d6 6.♕h6 (6.h3) 6...c5 7.h4 (7.♕xg7 ♖xg7) 7...♕xh6 8.♙xh6 ♜b6 Schlindwein-Prusikin, Altenkirchen 2001.

Finally, 4.♘c3 d6 (4...d5 transposes to the Barry Attack, as in Chapter 2) when 5.e4 transposes to a Pirc but instead 5.♙d2!? is very interesting.

4...0-0

A) Black can aim for an early ...♙b6 with 4...c5 5.c3 (5.dxc5; 5.♘c3) 5...♙b6 and now 6.♘a3!? is interesting, with the option of heading for c4 or b5 (6.♘bd2!?): 6...♙xb2? (6...cxd4 7.♘c4 ♜d8 8.exd4±; 6...d5 7.♘b5 ♘a6 8.a4±; or 6...d6 7.♕e2 0-0 8.0-0, reaching normal positions) 7.♘c4 ♙xc3+ (7...♙b5 8.♘d6+-) 8.♘fd2! cxd4 9.♙c1 d5 (9...♙b4 10.a3 ♙c5 11.♘e5+-) 10.♘e5 0-0 11.♙xc3 dxc3 12.♘b3+- De Prado-Leira, Spain tt 2010;

B) Castling can also be deferred with 4...b6 5.♕e2 ♕b7 6.0-0 0-0 7.c4 d6 8.♘c3 ♘bd7 9.♙c2 (9.h3) 9...♘h5 10.♕g5 h6 11.♕h4 c5 12.d5 g5 (12...♘df6 13.♘d2 g5 14.♙d1±) 13.♕xg5!? (13.♘d2) 13...hxg5 14.♘xg5 ♘hf6 15.f4, with compensation;

C) Or 4...d6 5.♕e2 and now:

C1) 5...♘h5 6.♕g5 h6 7.♕h4 g5 (7...c5 8.c3 ♙b6 9.♘bd2 ♙xb2? 10.♘c4 ♙xc3+ 11.♙f1±) 8.♘fd2 ♘f4 9.exf4 gxh4 10.c3±;

C2) 5...c5 6.c3 (we should not forget that other ideas are possible, such as 6.h3 (6.♘c3!?) 6...♙b6 7.♘bd2! ♙xb2 8.♙b1 ♙c3 (8...♙a3 9.♘c4 ♙c3+ 10.♘fd2±; 8...♙xa2 9.♘c4±) 9.0-0 ♘c6 10.♙b3 ♙a5 11.♘c4 ♙d8 12.dxc5

dx c5 13. ♖d3, with advantage to White) 6... ♗b6 (we shall look at the alternative 6... cxd4 in the next game) 7. ♗b3.



analysis diagram

This is one of the lines that some players with white tend to dislike, but Black can equalise only with accurate play.

C21) The exchange on b3 is better for White; after 7... ♗xb3 8. axb3 cxd4 9. exd4 0-0 10. ♖bd2 ♗c6 11. 0-0, the idea is to play b3-b4 and ♖b3, with pressure on the queenside; White generally has the better prospects in this type of position;

C22) 7... ♗e6 8. ♗xb6 axb6 9. a3 and now there are two ways for Black to play:

C221) 9... ♗c6 (the development of the knight on c6 is always a quite logical idea) 10. h3 0-0 11. ♖bd2 and now:

C2211) 11... ♗a5 (Black's most common plan; the idea is to play ... ♗b3 and exchange the knight) 12. 0-0 and now:

C22111) 12... ♗fc8 13. ♗fe1 (13. ♗fc1 ♗b3!? 14. ♗d3 (14. e4!) 14... ♗d7 15. ♗b5 ♗f8 16. a4 ♗e6= Dreev-I. Sokolov, Groningen 1991) 13... ♗b3 14. ♗xb3 ♗xb3 15. ♗d2 ♗e6 16. ♗f3 (other options are: 16. ♗g5 h6 17. ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18. ♗g4 ♗xg4 19. hxg4 d5 (19... ♗g7=) 20. f4 e6 21. g3 ♗g7 22. ♗f2 f5 23. gxf5 exf5 24. ♗f3± Megaranto-Cvitan, Biel 2013; or 16. ♗ad1 ♗c7 17. ♗f3 h6 ½-½ Pantev-Ermenkov, Sunny Beach 2012) 16... ♗d5? (this hands White the advantage, since it helps his plan of advancing his centre pawns; it was better to play 16... ♗c7 17. ♗ad1 and although the position is equal, White has the slightly preferable game, because he can play e3-e4 and advance his centre pawns) 17. e4! ♗c6 18. d5 ♗b5 19. e5! with advantage to White, E. Alvarez-

Bazan, Infiesto 2008;

C22112) Also good is 12... ♖b3 13. ♗xb3 (13. ♖ad1=) 13... ♗xb3 14. ♗d2 ♗d5 15. ♗c4 ♗d7= 16. ♖fc1 (16. ♗g5 ♖fe8 17. ♖fd1 ♗c6 Pakleza-Helis, Ustron 2006; 16.a4!=) 16...b5 17. ♗d2 ♗c6= Burmakin-Gormally, Cappellela-Grande 2000.

C2212) Black has also tried 11... ♖fe8 12.0-0 ♗f5 13. ♗h2 ♗e4 14. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 15. ♗d2 ♗f5 16. ♗c4± Alterman-Xie Jun, Wijk aan Zee 1998.

C222) 9...0-0 10.h3 ♗d7 (10... ♗d5!? 11.0-0 ♗c6 12. ♗bd2 ♗bd7 13. ♖fe1= Morozevich-Grischuk, Russia tt 2014) 11.0-0 and now:

C2221) 11... ♗c6 12. ♖d1 (12. ♗bd2) 12...b5 (12... ♗e4=) 13.dxc5 dxc5 14. ♗e5 b4 15. ♗c4 e6 16.cxb4 cxb4 17. ♗d2 bxa3= Grachev-Volokitin, Moscow 2008;

C2222) 11...b5 12.dxc5 dxc5 13. ♗e5?! (13. ♗bd2=) b4 14.cxb4 cxb4 15. ♗d2 ♗d5 16.axb4 ♖xa1 17. ♖xa1 ♗xf4 18.exf4 ♗xe5 19.fxe5 ♗c6= Grachev-Navara, Budva 2009.

C23) Instead of 7. ♗b3 it is also possible to play the very interesting 7. ♗bd2!?, e.g. 7... ♗xb2 8. ♗c4 ♗xc3+ 9. ♗fd2 (or 9. ♖f1 b5 10. ♖c1 ♗b4 11. ♖b1 bxc4 12. ♖xb4 cxb4 13. ♗a4+ (13. ♗xc4 0-0) 13... ♗d7 14. ♗xb4 ♗c6 15. ♗xc4 and I prefer White) 9... ♗d7 10.a3 cxd4 11. ♖c1 d5 12.0-0 (12. ♖xc3 dxc3 13. ♗b1 dxc4 14. ♗xc3 ♗c6 15. ♗xc4☞) 12...dxc4 13. ♖xc3 dxc3 14. ♗xc4, when Black has compensation, but I prefer White.

5. ♗e2 d6 6.0-0

The alternative is 6.h3, a move which has both advantages and disadvantages. At one time it was considered essential, but the present state of theory considers that White can manage without it. An example: 6.h3 c5 7.c3 and now if 7... ♗e6 (7... ♗b6) we should remember this idea: 8.dxc5! dxc5 9. ♗bd2±.

6...c5

Or 6... ♗h5 7. ♗g5 h6 8. ♗h4 g5 (8...f5 9.c4 g5 10. ♗fd2 ♗f6 11. ♗g3± Gunina-Bodnaruk, Moscow 2009) 9. ♗fd2 gxh4 (9... ♗f6 10. ♗g3) 10. ♗xh5 c5 11.c3 cxd4 12.cxd4 e5 13.d5± Montani-Smith, Presolana 2011.



7.c3

7.h3 is again an interesting alternative for White. The idea against ...♗b6 is the same, except that White plays h2-h3 instead of c2-c3. The ideas are similar and White usually ends up playing c2-c3 in any case, transposing: 7...♗b6 and now:

A) 8.♗c3!? sacrifices a pawn; it does not seem to grant White any advantage after:

A1) 8...cxd4 9.exd4 ♗xb2 10.♗b5 ♗c6 11.♕d3 ♕f5 (11...a6 12.♖b1 ♗xa2 13.♖a1 ♗b2 14.♖b1=) 12.a3 ♖fc8 13.♕xf5 gxf5 14.♗d3, but White has compensation;

A2) 8...♗xb2 9.♗b5 ♗d5 (9...♗a6 10.a3 cxd4 11.exd4 ♕f5 12.♕d3 ♖fc8 13.♖b1 ♗a2 14.♕xf5 gxf5 15.♗h4 ♗xc2 16.♗xc2 ♖xc2 17.♗xf5) 10.♖b1 ♗xa2 11.♖a1 ♗b2 12.♖b1=;

B) 8.♗a3 ♕f5 (8...♗xb2 9.♗c4±) 9.♗c4 ♗c7 10.c3=;

C) 8.♗bd2! is the right move, just as in the main game: 8...♕e6 (8...♕f5 9.dxc5 (9.♗c4) 9...♗xc5 10.♖c1=) 9.♗g5 (9.dxc5!? ♗xc5 10.e4) 9...♕d7 10.♗c4 ♗c7 11.a4 (11.c3) 11...b6 12.c3 ♗c6, with complex play, Macieja-McShane, Drammen 2005.

7...♗b6



One of the critical ideas against the London System is for Black to play ... ♖b6, putting pressure on the b2-pawn, which is vulnerable following the development of the c1-bishop. We shall see that this plan is used at a very early stage in some other variations, but here too it is quite a common continuation. Sometimes Black prepares the move ... ♖b6 with ... ♗e6, to prevent White from playing ♖b3.

A) Once again it is possible to play 7... ♗h5!? 8. ♗g5 h6 9. ♗h4 g5 (9... cxd4 10. cxd4 g5 11. ♗fd2) 10. ♗fd2:

A1) 10... ♗f4 (if 10... ♗f6 then 11. ♗g3 or 10... gxh4 11. ♗xh5) 11. exf4 gxh4 12. dxc5 (12. d5!±) 12... dxc5 13. ♗f3± Nguyen Thi-Franklin, Budapest 2010;

A2) 10... cxd4 11. cxd4 ♗f4 12. exf4 gxh4 and now:

A21) 13. ♗f3 h3 14. g3 I prefer White here, despite the position being close to equal;

A22) 13. ♗b3 a5 14. a4 ♗c6= Jovanic-Jovanovic, Zadar 2011.

B) The most popular alternative to playing 7... ♖b6 is 7... ♗e6.



analysis diagram

With this move Black wants to prevent White from defending the b2-pawn with ♖b3, in response to Black's ...♗b6. Now 8...dxc5! is White's best move, e.g. 8...dxc5 9. ♘bd2 ♘c6 10.h3 (10.e4±) 10... ♙f5 (or 10...a6 11.a4 ♗b6 12. ♘g5 ♙d5 13.e4 and White is better, as in Prié-Llaneza, San Sebastian 2009, or 10... ♗b6 11. ♗c2 ♙fd8 12. ♘g5± Pham Le-Van der Merwe, Mardin 2011) 11. ♙e1 a6 12.a4 h6 13. ♘c4± Prié-Apicella, Liverpool 2009.

8. ♘bd2!

This indirect defence of the pawn is possible because White has castled quickly on the sixth move, instead of playing h2-h3. This enables White to avoid the lines with ♖b3 and the subsequent exchange of queens, which many players dislike, although White's chances are not worse in that case.



8... ♖f5!

A recommendation of Houdini. Most games have continued with 8... ♖e6 instead.

A) If 8... ♜xb2? then 9. ♔c4!. This shows why it is better to castle instead of playing h2-h3, since if the white king were still on e1 Black would take on c3 with check. 9... ♜b5 (9... ♜xc3 10. ♖c1 ♜b4 11. ♖b1 ♜c3 12. ♖b3+–) 10. ♔xd6±.

B) As we mentioned, 8... ♖e6 is the usual continuation, and now:

B1) 9.e4!? ♜xb2 10.d5 ♖g4 11. ♔c4 ♜b5 12.a4 (12. ♔xd6 ♜d7) 12... ♜d7 13. ♜c2, with compensation for White. This is similar to the Vaganian Gambit in the Trompowsky, which we shall study later;

B2) 9.dxc5 ♜xc5 (9... dxc5 10. ♔g5± 10... ♖d7 11. ♔c4) 10.e4± (10.h3);

B3) 9. ♔g5 ♖d7 10. ♔c4 ♜c7. This is the difference. Without the exchange on c5 Black has the c7-square for the queen:

B31) 11.a4 h6 12. ♔f3 ♔h5 13. ♖g3?! (13.d5=) 13... ♔xg3 14.hxg3= Karpov-Gelfand, Cap d'Agde 1994;

B32) 11.h3 and now:



analysis diagram

B321) 11...b6 12. ♖e1 (12. ♖f3 ♖c6 13.dxc5 bxc5 14. ♔xd6 exd6 15. ♖xd6 ♜c8 16. ♖xf8 ♖xf8 17. ♖xc6 ♜xc6 18. ♜f3∞) 12... ♖c6 (12...h6 13. ♔f3 ♖c6=) 13. ♖f1 (13.dxc5 bxc5 14. ♔xd6 (the thematic sacrifice) 14...exd6 15. ♖xd6±) 13... ♔bd7= Prié-Favarel, Pau 2012;

B322) 11...h6 12. ♔f3 and again we have several examples from the elite:

B3221) 12... ♖f5 13. ♖h2 (13.a4; 13.dxc5 ♜xc5 14.a4) 13... ♔bd7 14.a4 ♖ad8 15.a5= Karpov-Gelfand, Cap d'Agde 1994;

B3222) 12...b6 13.dxc5 (13.♙d3 ♚b7 14.♖e1 ♘c6 15.♗cd2 ♗e4 16.♗xe4 ♗xe4 17.♚e2= Jussupow-Topalov, Las Palmas 1993) 13...♚xc5 (13...bxc5 14.♗xd6! exd6 15.♙xd6 ♚c8 16.♙xf8 ♙xf8 17.♗e5±) 14.♗xd6! (once again we see the sacrifice on d6) 14...exd6 15.♙xd6 ♚c8 16.♙xf8 ♙xf8 17.♗e5±. In general the idea of ♗xd6 is good for White;

B3223) 12...♙e6 13.♖c1 (13.♗cd2 cxd4 14.exd4) 13...♗bd7 14.♙d3 (14.♗cd2) 14...♖ac8= Khismatullin-Sutovsky, Moscow 2008.

C) 8...cxd4 has also been played, for instance 9.♗c4!? (9.exd4±) 9...♚d8 10.exd4 ♗d5 11.♙d2 (11.♙g3!?) 11...♗c6= De Prado-Hoffman, Lisbon 2014.

9. ♗c4

Also playable is 9.♚b3 ♗c6 10.h3= or 9.dxc5 ♚xc5 10.h3=.

9... ♚c7 10.h3

10.dxc5 ♚xc5 11.h3= (now it is not so good to play 11.♗xd6 exd6 12.♙xd6 ♚c8 13.♙xf8 ♙xf8 when the situation is unclear).

10... ♗bd7 11.a4

Other options for White are:

A) 11.♗cd2 e5 12.♙h2 ♖fe8 (12...e4 13.♗g5± 13...h6 14.g4! hxg5 15.gxf5 gxf5 16.♗c4! ♗e8 17.♗xd6 ♗xd6 18.dxc5±) 13.♗c4∞;

B) 11.♙d3 ♙xd3 12.♚xd3 b5 13.♗cd2 ♖ab8=;

C) 11.♙h2 ♖fc8 12.a4 ♗b6 (12...h6=) 13.♗a3 (13.♗cd2±) 13...a6 14.a5± Anton-Chirila, Richardson 2013.

11... ♖ac8 12.♙h2 ♙e6?!

It was better to play 12...♖fd8=.

13. ♗cd2 cxd4



How should White recapture on d4?

14.exd4

Here it was better to take with the knight: 14. ♖xd4! ♗c5 (14... ♕d5 15.c4 ♕c6 16. ♗xc6 ♜xc6 17.a5±) 15. ♗xe6 ♗xe6 16.a5, with advantage to White.

14... ♜b6 15. ♜b1

Now 15.c4! ♜xb2 (15... ♜fe8 16. ♜e1±) 16. ♜b1 ♜a2 17. ♜xb7± was good.

15... ♜fe8

Or 15... ♕f5 16. ♜a2 ♕e6 17.a5 ♜c6 18.c4 d5 19.b3±.

16.a5

White has achieved a slight advantage; he has more space on the queenside and Black has nothing on the kingside.

16... ♜c7 17. ♜e1

Here it was good to play 17. ♗g5! ♕d5 18.c4 h6 (18... ♕c6? 19.d5+–) 19. ♗gf3 ♕xf3 20. ♗xf3 e5 21.dxe5 ♗xe5 22. ♗xe5 dxe5 23.b4, with advantage to White, thanks to his pawn majority and space advantage on the queenside.

17... ♕h6 18. ♕d3

Also good for White were 18.c4 and 18. ♕f1, maintaining the advantage.

18... ♕d5 19. ♜e2?!

This allows Black to equalise. With 19.c4! ♕xf3 20. ♗xf3 e5 21.b4 exd4 (21... e4 22. ♕xe4 ♗xe4 23. ♜xe4 ♜xc4 24. ♕xd6) 22.a6! White would have kept the advantage.



19...e5! 20.dxe5

Now if 20.c4 Black equalises with 20... ♕xf3 21. ♗xf3 ♗h5=.

20...dxe5 21. ♜e1

Or 21.a6 b6 22. ♕b5=.

21... ♜c6

21... ♜cd8= was better.

22. ♖e4?

This move hands the advantage over to Black. It was essential to take the risk of grabbing the pawn with 22. ♖xe5 ♜xe5 23. ♙xe5 ♙xg2 24. ♙xf6 ♙xh3 25. ♖e4 ♜xe4 26. ♙xe4 ♙xf6 27. ♙g2 ♙g5 28. ♙f1 ♙e6, when Black has compensation but White should not lose.

22... ♖xe4 23. ♙xe4 ♙xe4 24. ♜xe4 f6

Black is better; the h2-bishop has been shut out of play, while the one on h6 is active; furthermore Black has threats of ... ♖d7-c5-d3 and he commands the open d-file.

25. ♖d4 ♙d5 26. ♖c2 ♖c5 27. ♜e2 ♖d3 28. ♙b1 ♜cd8



Black's advantage is clear. White's forces are passive and Black dominates the whole board. In this game, for once the bishop on h6 is better than the one on h2.

29. ♖e1?

This loses.

It was necessary to play 29. ♖e3, although Black would maintain a clear advantage.

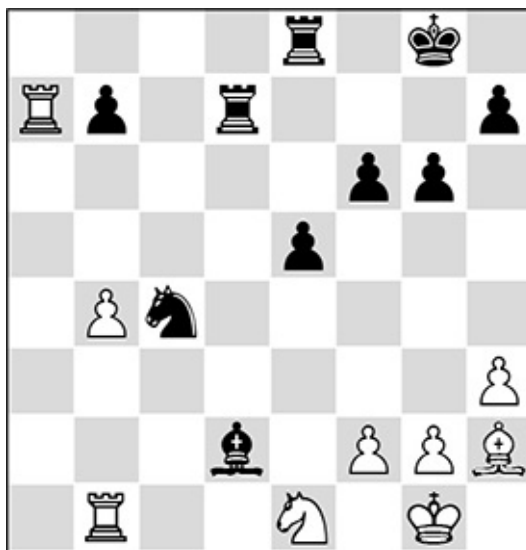
29... ♖c1 30. ♜c2 ♖b3 31. c4

If 31. ♜a3 then 31... ♙c4 (with the threat of 32... ♖d2) 32. ♖f3 ♙f8 33. ♜a2 ♙d3+., or 31. ♜a4 ♙d1+.

31... ♙e4?!

There was a simpler win with 31... ♙d4!.-+

32. ♜c3 ♙xb1 33. ♜xb1 ♖xa5 34. b4 ♖d2 35. ♜a3 ♖xc4 36. ♜xa7 ♜d7



Black has retained his extra pawn with the better position and should win the game without any great problems.

37.g4 ♖ed8 38.♜g2 b6 39.♞xd7 ♞xd7 40.♞f3 ♜f7 41.b5 ♞a5 42.♞c1 ♞c7 43.♞d1 g5 44.h4 h5!?

It was simpler to play 44...h6♠.

45.hxg5

45.gxh5! g4 46.♞g5+!? (46.♞g1 ♞a3♠) 46...fxg5 47.hxg5 would have provided White with some counterplay, although Black should still win.

45...hxg4 46.♞h4 fxg5 47.♞f5 ♜g6 48.♞g3 ♞d2 49.♞f1 ♞xf1 50.♞xe5!?

After 50.♜xf1 ♜f5–+ the game is decided in Black's favour.

50... ♞e7 51.♞d6+ ♜f5 52.♞d4 ♞d2 53.♞f6+ ♜e4 54.♞xb6 ♞xb6 55.♞xb6 ♜f5 56.♞b8 ♞e1 57.♞f8+ ♜g6 58.♞g8+ ♜f6 59.♞h8 ♞b1 60.b6 ♞f3 61.♞h1 ♞h4+ 62.♜h2 ♞xb6 63.♜g3 ♜f5

White resigned.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw a variety of alternatives available to both White and Black at an early stage of the game. The idea of ...c7-c5 followed by ...♜b6, or ...♞e6 first, is a very popular way for Black to attack b2, White's weak point after the bishop has moved to f4. White can repel the attack on b2 with the move ♞bd2 as long as he has castled early, and in this way he can avoid the line with ♜b3 followed by the exchange of queens, which is not to the taste of many players, even though it is favourable to White. The present state of theory allows White to play an early 0-0 and manage without the move h2-h3, as long as he has a good knowledge of how to

reply to ... ♖h5 by Black. It is important to remember the idea of the ♗xd6 sacrifice, after taking on c5, which leaves White with a rook and two pawns for two pieces and usually favours White. In the game, Black used a new idea with ... ♗f5, which is also recommended by Houdini. White reacted well at first and retained the advantage, but then he let it slip and after the erroneous 22. ♖e4 he was worse, eventually losing.

Game 19

King's Indian

Alfonso Romero Holmes

2455

Viktor Kortchnoi

2615

León 1994 (3)

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♖f3 g7 3. ♗f4 ♗g7 4.e3 0-0 5. ♗e2 c5

A more common move order is 5...d6 6.0-0 c5 7.c3 cxd4.

6.c3 cxd4



Here we shall look at another line for Black where he takes on d4 at an early stage and then plays ... ♗c6 and ... ♗e6. At this point White can recapture with either pawn: taking with the c-pawn is good in this position because the b1-knight has not moved yet, so it can develop on c3, where it stands better than on d2, with the possibility of playing ♖b5 at some point. Taking with the e-pawn allows White to manage without playing h2-h3, since there is no longer any danger that the bishop will be exchanged. If ... ♖h5 we have the move ♗e3 available, while if ... ♖d5 we can play ♗g3.

7.exd4

Let us examine the recapture with the other pawn: 7.cxd4 and now:

A) 7... ♖b6 8. ♗b3!? (this was the choice of GM Danielsen, a specialist in the London System; although he gained an advantage, this does not seem to be White's best continuation. It is better to play 8. ♗d2 ♘c6 9. ♘c3 d5 10.0-0 ♙f5= or 8. ♘bd2!? ♖xb2 9. ♖b1 ♗c3 10.0-0, and White has compensation) 8... ♖xb3 9.axb3 d6 10. ♘c3 ♘c6 11.0-0 ♘h5 12. ♙g3 ♘xg3 13.hxg3 ♙d7 14. ♖fc1 ♖fc8 15. ♘e1 ♗f8 16. ♘d3 f5 17.b4 ♘d8 18. ♙f3 e6 19.b5 d5?! (19...e5=) 20. ♖a2 b6?! 21. ♖ca1± Danielsen-Kjartansson, Kopavogur 2012;

B) 7...d6 8. ♘c3 and now:

B1) 8...b6 9.0-0 ♙b7 10.h3 (10. ♖c1±) 10... ♘bd7 11. ♖c1 (11. ♗b3±) 11... ♖c8 12. ♙h2 (12. ♗b3±) 12... ♘d5 13. ♘xd5 ♙xd5 14. ♗a4 ♖c7 15. ♘d2= Gelfand-Golubev, Odessa 2008;

B2) 8... ♘bd7 9.0-0 ♘b6 10.h3 (10.e4±) 10... ♘fd5= 11. ♙h2 (11. ♘xd5 ♙xd5 12. ♙h2=) 11... ♘xc3 12.bxc3 ♙e6 13.a4 ♗c7 14. ♗d2= Rogers-Ftacnik, Prague 1999.

7...d6 8.0-0

White can also include h2-h3, although this is not necessary: 8.h3 (8. ♘bd2 is also playable) 8... ♘c6 9.0-0 and now:

A) 9... ♙e6 10. ♘a3 (10. ♘bd2 ♖b6 11. ♗b1 ♖ac8 12.a4= Jovanic-Kozul, Zagreb 2011) 10... ♖c8 11.c4?! (11. ♖e1=) 11...d5 12.c5 ♘d7 (12... ♘e4) 13. ♙b5 (13. ♗d2) 13... ♘db8 14. ♗d2= Ruiz-Recuero, Linares 2013;

B) 9... ♘h5 10. ♙h2 e5 11.dxe5?! (11. ♖e1±) 11...dxe5= Kovacevic-Zufic, Rabat 2004.



8... ♙e6

In a recent game Black unsuccessfully tried 8... ♖d5 9. ♙g3 ♘c6 10. ♗bd2 ♙f5 11. ♚b3 ♘b6 12.d5 (12.a4±) 12... ♗a5? (12... ♗e5=) 13. ♚b5 ♘d7 14.b4 ♙xc3 15. ♖ac1, and White wins a piece with a decisive advantage, Dreev-Zviagintsev, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013.

8... ♗c6 is the usual move. 9. ♗bd2 (9. ♗a3 is interesting) and now:

A) 9... h6 10. ♖e1 (10.h3) 10... e5!? (10... ♙f5=) 11.dxe5 ♘h5 12. ♙e3 dxe5= Nguyen Anh-Szabo, Budapest 1999;

B) 9... ♙e6 transposes to the game, but 9... ♚c7 and 9... ♙f5 are interesting;

C) 9... ♖e8 10. ♗c4 ♘d5 11. ♙g3 e5 12.dxe5 (12. ♖e1!±) 12...dxe5 13. ♚b3?! (13. ♖e1) 13... ♗f4 14. ♙xf4 exf4 15. ♖ad1 ♚c7= Nikolic-Negi, Amsterdam 2007.

9. ♗bd2

An interesting alternative against this move order by Black is 9.c4!? d5 10.c5 ♗e4 11. ♗c3 b6=.

9... ♗c6

This is Black's plan: hold the centre, control the d5-square and try in the future to play ...e7-e5.

If 9... ♚b6 then 10. ♗g5 ♙f5 11. ♗c4 ♚c7 12. ♗e3±.



10. ♖e1

One of the other co-author's games continued 10. ♗c4 ♘d5 11. ♙d2 (11. ♙g3 is better) 11... ♖c8 12. ♗g5 (12. ♖e1 was better) 12... ♙f5 13. ♙f3 ♘b6= De Prado-Rodriguez, Spain tt 2012.

Houdini's recommendation is 10. ♙c4 ♙xc4 (10... ♙f5) 11. ♗xc4 ♖c8 12. ♚e2= with an equal game; 10. ♗g5 ♙f5 11. ♗c4 h6 12. ♗f3 ♘d5 13. ♙g3 ♖c8 gives White no advantage either.

10...a6

10... ♖c8= would be normal.

11. ♗d3

Here it would be better for White to play 11. ♗c4, with equality, trying to exchange Black's bishop, which will be very strong on d5.

11...b5?!

Advancing this pawn is dubious. Instead, the thematic idea 11... ♖b6= was better.

12.a3

Here it was good to play 12.a4! (12.h3± or 12. ♖e2±), which gives White some advantage after:

A) 12... ♖b6 13. ♗e3 (13.h3±) 13... ♖b7 14. ♖e2 ♖fb8 (14...bxa4 15. ♖xa4 ± 15... ♖xb2? 16. ♖b1 ♖xc3 17. ♗e4 ♗xe4 18. ♗xe4±) 15.axb5 axb5 16. ♖xa8 ♖xa8 17. ♗xb5±;

B) 12...b4 was the move that I feared, but after 13.c4 d5 14.c5 ♗h5 15. ♗e3 White has the advantage with his passed pawn on c5.

12... ♗d5 13. ♗e4

Again 13.a4± was good. This move was necessary, to create weaknesses on the queenside and try to dislodge the black bishop from d5.

13... ♗h5! 14. ♗g5!?

A little better was 14. ♗e3 f5 15. ♗eg5 h6 (15...f4 16. ♗d2±) 16. ♗h4! ♖e8 (16...hxcg5 17. ♗xg6 g4 18. ♗xf8 ♖xf8 19.a4±) 17. ♗h3, with complex play.

14... ♖d7

Here 14...h6! 15. ♗e3 f5 was good, e.g. 16. ♗g3 ♗xg3 17.hxcg3 e5 18.dxc5 dxe5=.

15. ♗g3 ♗f6 16.h4!?



White tries to create threats on the kingside.

Another interesting idea was 16. ♖f1, with the idea of ♗e3 to eliminate the annoying bishop on d5.

16... ♜fe8 17.h5

Consistent with the previous move, trying to open the kingside, but curiously the open h-file will eventually benefit... Black!

17... ♜g4 18.hxg6 hxg6 19. ♙e2?!

It was much better to play 19. ♙xf6! ♙xf6 (19...exf6!?) 20.a4! b4 (20... ♜ab8 21.axb5 axb5 22. ♙e4 ♙xe4 23. ♙xe4 ♙g7 24.b4±) 21. ♙e4 ♙xe4 22. ♜xe4 ♙d7 23.d5 ♙e5 24. ♜xb4, with a slight advantage.

19... ♙a5



20.b4?!

This move cannot be good, because it leaves the c3-pawn weak and grants Black the strong square c4. It was better to play 20. ♙xf6 ♙xf6 (20...exf6∞) 21. ♙d2 ♙f4 22. ♙f3, with equality.

20... ♙c4 21. ♙xf6 exf6!?

If 21... ♙xf6 then 22. ♙e5 ♙g5 23. ♙xc4 bxc4 24. ♙f3 ♙g7 is equal, although I prefer Black, since he can create threats along the h-file.

22. ♙e5

After 22. ♙d2 ♙d7 23. ♙xc4 bxc4 24. ♙d2 ♙c6, Black is still better: he has the bishop pair and can mobilise his kingside pawns; he also commands the h1-a8 diagonal.

22... ♙f4?!

22... ♙g5 was better.

23. ♙xc4 bxc4 24. ♙f1?!

White's pieces are becoming very passive.

White should play more actively with 24. ♖a4! ♔d2 25. ♖a5 ♕c6 26. ♖ed1 ♖xc3 27. ♖ac1 ♖b3 28. ♕xc4=.

24... ♖xe1 25. ♖xe1 f5

25... ♕h6 26. ♖e7 ♔g7 27. ♖e2 ♖h4 28. ♖xd6 ♕d2! was also good, and now:

A) 29. ♖xd5?? ♖h8-+;

B) 29. ♖g3 ♖xg3 30. ♖xg3 (30.fxg3 ♕e3+ 31. ♖h2 ♖h8+) 30... ♕xc3=;

C) 29. ♖h2 ♖e4 30. ♖g3 ♖h8 and Black has the advantage with his very active pieces and threats along the h-file, in return for a single pawn.

26. ♖a2?

An error; 26. ♖e7 was necessary, trying to activate the queen a little and harass the black pieces, but after 26... ♕f8 27. ♖c7 ♔d2 28. ♖a5 ♕e6 Black retains the advantage.

26... ♕f8 27. ♖e2



27... ♕f8

Kortchnoi wants to avoid the exchange of rooks, but this was not necessary, because Black would have a won endgame after 27... ♔g7! 28. ♖e8 ♖xe8 29. ♖xe8 ♔d2 30. ♖e3 (30. ♖e2 ♕e4+) 30... ♕g5 31. ♖xd2 ♕xd2 32. ♖e2 f4 33.f3 f5 34.a4 ♕c6 35.a5 g5!, with the plan of ...g5-g4 and ...f4-f3, dislodging the white knight, with a decisive advantage.

28.a4?

A little better was 28. ♖e3 ♕h4 29. ♖c1 ♔g7 30. ♖e1 ♕xg3 31.fxg3 ♖xg3 32. ♖e3 ♖h4=.

28... ♖h4

Black now has a decisive advantage. There are several plans: ... ♔g7 and ...

♖h8, or ... ♕f6-g5-f4, followed by ... ♔g7.

29.b5

There was no salvation in 29.a5 ♕g5 30.♗h1 ♕f4 31.♗g3 ♔g7 32.♖e8 ♖xe8 33.♗xe8 ♕xg3 34.fxg3 ♗xg3+.

29...axb5 30.axb5 ♖b8!



The idea is to force White to move either his queen or his rook, so that White cannot respond to ... ♔g7 with ♖e8; in that case Black's attack along the h-file will be impossible to parry.

31.♗b1 ♔g7! 32.♗b4?

White would fail to save the game with 32.♖e3 ♖h8 33.♗xf5+ gxf5 34.♖h3 ♗e4 35.♗xe4 fxe4+.

32... ♖h8 33.f4 ♗xg3 34.♗xd6 ♗xc3 35.♗xd5 ♗xd4+ 36.♗xd4 ♕xd4+

White resigned.

SUMMARY

In this game we have seen a line which is quite solid for Black but not very common, based on ...cxd4, followed by ...♗c6 and ...♕e6, trying to command the centre and deploy the black bishop on d5. It is essential for White to keep in mind the possibility of recapturing on d4 with the c-pawn, instead of the e-pawn, especially if White's queen's knight has not yet moved and can go directly to c3, where it is better placed than on d2. However, if White recaptures on d4 with the e-pawn he can manage without playing h2-h3, since his queen's bishop is in no danger of being exchanged. In the game, White should have played a2-a4 to weaken Black's queenside

and especially to be able to exchange or dislodge the strong d5-bishop. Black gained the advantage of the bishop pair and following the opening of the h-file he used it to attack and win the game.

Game 20

King's Indian

Boris Grachev

2601

Artyom Timofeev

2664

Moscow 2008 (9)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f3 g6 3.♙f4 ♙g7 4.e3 0-0 5.♙e2 d6 6.h3 c5 7.c3 b6



The line with ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6 is the most common, by far, among King's Indian players when faced with the London System. In some books this is also called the Réti Reversed. After 7... ♘bd7 8.0-0, there are other options instead of the normal 8...b6:

A) 8... ♖b8!? 9.a4 (9.c4±) 9...cxd4 10.exd4 ♘d5 11.♙d2 (11.♙h2) 11... ♘7f6 12.c4 ♘c7 13.♘c3± De Prado-Perera, Linares 2013;

B) 8... ♘e4!? 9.♙h2 (9.♘bd2±) 9...b6 10.♘bd2 (10.♘fd2!?) 10... ♘xd2 11.♙xd2 ♖e8 (11... ♙b7=) 12.e4 ♙b7 13.♙d3 (13.d5) 13...cxd4 14.cxd4 e5=, De Prado-Suarez, A Coruña 2013.

8.0-0 ♙b7 9.♘bd2 ♘c6

The move 9... ♘bd7, which we shall see in the following games, is more common. It would seem that the knight is better on d7, since it leaves the diagonal open for the bishop on b7.



10. ♕h2

Nowadays this is the most common move. Sometimes White plays 10.a4 but ends up transposing. The main alternative is 10. ♖e1 and now:

A) 10... ♗d7 11. ♕h2 e5? (11... ♖c8 12. ♖c1±) 12.dxe5? (12. ♗c4!±) 12... ♗cxe5 13. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 14. ♗f3 ♖e7= Vysochin-Kurnosov, Internet 2004;

B) 10... ♖e8 11. ♕h2 ♖c8 12.dxc5 (12. ♖c1; 12. ♗b3) 12... bxc5= Gonzalez-Jerez, Burgos 2003;

C) 10... ♗d7 11. ♕h2 ♖ac8 12.a3 (12. a4 is better) 12... ♖fd8 13.e4 (13. ♕b5) 13... cxd4 14.cxd4 d5= Prié-Lagarde, Belfort 2010.

10... ♖c8

Or 10... cxd4 11.exd4 ♕h6 12.a4 (12. ♖e1! is better and if Black follows the same plan with 12... ♗d5 13. ♕f1 ♕f4 14. ♕xf4 ♗xf4 15.g3 White is left with the advantage; the f1-bishop will be redeployed on g2 and the absence of the black bishop from g7 can make itself felt) 12... ♗d5!? (12... ♗c7=) 13. ♖e1 ♕f4 14. ♗e4 (14. ♕c4± is also good) 14... ♕xh2+ 15. ♖xh2 e6 16. ♗d2± Kamsky-Ftacnik, Manila 1990.

10... ♗d7 has also been played, e.g. 11.a4 (11. ♖e1) 11... ♖fd8 12. ♗c4 (12. ♕b5) 12... ♖ac8 13. ♗b3 (13.a5) 13... ♗e4 (13... ♗a5=) 14. ♖fd1?! (14.d5 ±) 14... d5= Grachev-Korobov, Pardubice 2007.

11.a4

The alternatives 11. ♕b5 and 11. ♖e1 are also good.



11...cxd4

Let us examine some alternatives:

A) 11...♖d7?! 12.♗e1 (12.d5! ♖ce5 13.♖xe5 ♖xe5 14.e4±) 12...d5 13.♙b3 e6= E.Alvarez-Teske, Pardubice 2011;

B) 11...♔c7 12.♗e1 ♗fd8 13.♕c4 e6 14.♕f1!? (14.♙e2±) 14...♙e7= Stripunsky-G.Shahade, Philadelphia 2012;

C) 11...♖a5?! 12.♖b3 (12.b4!±) 12...♖xb3 13.♙xb3= Pham Le-Cao, Jakarta 2012;

D) 11...♗c7? 12.a5! cxd4 (12...♖xa5 13.dxc5±) 13.axb6 axb6 14.exd4± Bellon-Calvo, Spain 1993.

12.exd4 ♖a5

Once again we have further options for Black to consider:

A) 12...♖d5 13.♕c4 (13.♗e1 ♖a5 14.♕f1 (14.♕b5) 14...a6 15.♗a3± Bellon-Sion, Spain 1993) 13...♖b8? (13...♖a5±) 14.♗e1 ♖d7 15.♙b3 ♖7f6 16.a5± Kamsky-Kasimdzhanov, Moscow 2007;

B) 12...♗e8 13.♖c4 (13.♕b5; 13.♗e1) 13...♕a6 (13...♙c7) 14.♗e1 d5 15.♖ce5± Burmakin-Cocchi, Ortisei 2013;

C) 12...♙d7 13.♖c4 (13.♕b5±; 13.♗e1±) 13...♖d8 14.♖e3 ♕h6= Hoang Thi-Gu Xiaobing, Subic Bay 2009;

D) 12...♕h6 13.♗e1 ♙d7 14.♕b5± Bern-Tisdall, Gausdal 1993.

13.♗e1 ♕h6



This is an idea that Black should keep in mind, since from h6 the bishop tries to control the f4-square and after ... ♖d5 he can play ... ♗f4 or ... ♘f4.

14.b4

14.h4 is interesting (with the idea of ♘g5), e.g. 14... ♖d5 15. ♘g5 (15. ♗f1) 15...e5 16.dxe5 dxe5 17. ♗f1±.

14... ♖c6 15. ♗b3

The white position is more pleasant, with the advantage on the queenside.

If 15.a5 then 15...bxa5 16.b5 (16.bxa5 ♘xa5=) 16... ♖b8 17. ♗b3 a6 18.c4 axb5 19. ♗xb5 ♗xf3 20. ♘xf3 ♖c6=.

15...e5

If 15... ♗c7 then 16. ♗ad1±.



Black has executed the thematic advance ...e7-e5, but it should be remembered

that this move also activates the bishop on h2.

16.dxe5

The alternative was 16. ♖c4 ♖e4! 17.dxe5 ♖xe5 and now:

A) 18. ♖fxe5?! dxe5 19. ♕xe5 ♖d5±;

B) 18. ♕xe5 dxe5 19. ♖ad1 (19. ♖fxe5 ♖h4±; 19. ♖cxe5 ♖xc3±) 19... ♖f6
20. ♖cxe5 ♖xc3=;

C) 18. ♖cxe5 dxe5 19. ♕xe5 ♖d2! 20. ♖xd2 ♕xd2 21. ♖ed1 ♖g5 22. ♕f1
♖xe5 23. ♖xd2 ♖xc3 24. ♖b2 ♖c7 25.a5=.

16... ♖xe5!

If 16...dxe5 then 17. ♖c4±.

17. ♖ad1

Or 17.c4 ♖xf3+ 18. ♖xf3 ♕g7 19. ♖ad1 ♖e4=.

17... ♖c7 18. ♖xe5

This exchange leads to equality; it seems better to wait, leaving the weak pawn on d6. For example: 18.c4 ♖fe8 19. ♕f1 with a complex position.

18...dxe5 19. ♕f3!?



A risky decision, since White is allowing his kingside pawn structure to be damaged. Instead, 19.c4 is equal.

19... ♕xd2 20. ♖xd2

20. ♕xe5 fails to 20... ♖e7 21. ♖xd2 ♕xf3 22.gxf3 ♖e4! 23. ♖d5 (23.fxe4 (or 23. ♖xe4) 23... ♖g5+±) 23... ♖g5 and Black recovers the pawn with a very good position.

20... ♕xf3 21.gxf3 ♖fe8

There was nothing wrong with taking on c3: 21... ♖xc3 22. ♖xc3 ♖xc3 23. ♖g2= (23. ♕xe5 ♖xf3 24. ♖g2 ♖f5 25. ♖d6 ♖h5 26. ♖d7 ♖a8±).

22. ♖e3



22... ♖e6?

A slip. 22... ♖e7 was good, with equality.

23.f4! exf4?

This loses. It was necessary to play 23... ♖d8 24. ♖xd8+ ♜xd8 25.fxe5 ♘d5 26. ♖e1 ♜g5+ 27. ♙g3 ♘e7 28. ♜h2 ♘f5 29. ♜d5 ♜g7 and despite being a pawn down Black has good drawing chances, since his knight is so strong, the position is blocked and the white king is weak.

24. ♖xe6 fxe6 25. ♜xe6+ ♜g7 26. ♖d6+- ♜f8 27. ♙xf4 ♜xc3

After 27... ♜f7 28. ♙e5 ♜xe6 29. ♖xe6, Black is in zugzwang and loses.

28. ♙e5 ♜f3 29. ♜g4

Black resigned, in view of 29... ♜xg4+ 30.hxg4 h6 31.f4 g5 32.f5 ♜f7 33. ♜g2. Black is in zugzwang and White wins by bringing his king to the queenside.

SUMMARY

We have looked at the line which is the most popular with King's Indian players and which is one of the most solid against the London System, where Black plays ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6. In this game Black played ... ♘c6, which is unusual. It seems better to play ... ♘d7 and leave the diagonal of the b7-bishop open. White played solidly with c2-c3, followed by a2-a4, b2-b4 and ♜b3, with the initiative on the queenside. Remember the ideas for White with ♖e1 or ♙b5. In the game, after ... ♙h6, which is an idea that Black should keep in mind, it would have been interesting for White to play h2-h4, with the idea of ♘g5. After Black's ...e7-e5, ♘c4

would have been interesting for White. Later, it would have been better for White not to exchange knights on e5, since this led to equality. Black slipped up by playing 22... ♖e6, not seeing White's response 23.f4, after which taking the pawn on f4 landed Black in a lost position.

Game 21

King's Indian
Gata Kamsky

2741

Peter Svidler

2747

Russia tt 2013 (3)

1.d4 ♟f6 2.♟f3 g6 3.♟f4

We shall see that on move 10 White could play ♟c4, but if White wants to place his bishop there it is usually better to do so in one move, rather than first playing ♟e2. Some examples: 3.h3 ♟g7 4.♟f4 0-0 5.♟bd2 d6 6.e3 ♟bd7 7.c3 c5 8.♟c4 b6 9.0-0 ♟b7 10.♟e2 (10.♟e1 a6 11.a4 ♟c6 12.♟e2± Dgebuadze-Antic, Charleroi 2005) 10...♟c7 (10...♟c8 11.a4 ♟e8 12.♟h2 h6 13.♟b5 cxd4 14.exd4± Ljubojevic-Piket, Monaco 1997) 11.♟h2 ♟ae8 12.e4 cxd4 13.cxd4 e5 14.♟ac1± and White gained a smooth victory in Capablanca-Réti, London 1922.

Translator's note: In Great Britain, the London System with ♟c4 against the King's Indian is often associated with FM Michael Franklin, who has played it throughout his long career.

3...♟g7 4.c3 0-0 5.h3 b6 6.♟bd2 ♟b7

I faced a similar plan after 6...c5 7.e3 d6 8.a4 ♟bd7 9.♟e2 cxd4 10.exd4 ♟d5 11.♟g3 (11.♟h2) 11...♟h6 12.♟c4 (12.0-0 ♟f4 13.♟e1 ♟xe2+? 14.♟xe2±) 12...♟f4 13.0-0 ♟b7 14.♟e1 e6= De Prado-Cuenca, Maspalomas 2012.

7.e3 c5 8.♟e2 d6 9.0-0 ♟bd7



In the previous game we saw ... ♖c6. The development of the knight to d7 is the more popular continuation, since it leaves the diagonal of the b7-bishop open.

10. ♖e1

There are several possible move orders, such as with 10. ♕h2 or 10. ♕c4; however, if White wants to develop the king's bishop to c4 it is preferable to do so in one move, as indicated in the note to move 3. The most popular move here is 10.a4, which we shall look at in the next few games.

10...a6

Or 10... ♗c7 11. ♕h2 (11.a4) 11... ♖fe8 12.a4 a6 13. ♕c4 ♗c6 14.e4± Prié-Apicella, Belfort 2010.

11.a4



11...cxd4

We shall view Black's options of 11...♖c7, 11...♜a7 or 11...♜c8 in the following games.

12.exd4 ♗d5

We have already come across the plan that Black carries out in this game. It is clearly to Svidler's liking, since he had already played it in an earlier game, which continued 12...♜c8 13.♙h2 (13.♙c4±) 13...♙h6 (again we see this idea for Black, taking control of the h6-c1 diagonal and the f4-square, together with ...♗d5) 14.♙d3 (14.h4, with the idea of ♗g5, is a good plan to counter Black's idea; 14.♖b3) 14...♜e8 15.♗e4 ♗xe4 16.♙xe4 ♙xe4 17.♜xe4 ♗f6= Apicella-Svidler, Paris 2004.

Black has also played 12...♜e8 13.♙f1 (13.♖b3±) 13...♖c7 14.♙h2 h6 15.♖b3± Hertneck-Swinkels, Amsterdam 2013.

13.♙h2 ♙h6



A plan which is familiar to us by now. Black's idea is to seize the f4-square and the h6-c1 diagonal. On g7 the bishop usually has little to do, faced with White's solid pawn chain b2-c3-d4.

14.♙f1

I do not think this is the best move. If 14.h4 then 14...♙f4=, but 14.♗e4! seems good, e.g. 14...♗7f6 (14...♙f4 15.♙xf4 ♗xf4 16.♙f1±; 14...♗f4 15.♙f1±) 15.♗eg5 and I prefer White. Also interesting is 14.♖b3 ♗f4 (14...♙f4 15.c4 ♙xh2+ 16.♗xh2 ♗f4 17.♙f3 ♙xf3 18.♗hxf3±; 14...♗7f6 15.c4±) 15.♙f1, with a slight advantage to White.

14...a5 15.♗c4

Now 15.h4!? was definitely good, e.g. 15...♙f4 (15...♗7f6 16.♗g5 ♙g7 17.♖b3±, 15...♗f4 16.♗g5±) 16.♙xf4 ♗xf4 17.♗e4±.

Also playable is 15.♔e2 (or 15.♔b3) 15...♙a6 16.c4 ♘7f6 17.♗e4 ♖e8 18.♚ad1=.

15...♗7f6 16.♗a3

Kamsky tries to exploit the square b5, weakened by Black's move ...a7-a5.

16...♗f4

Or 16...♚c8 17.♗b5 ♗c7 18.c4 ♗xb5 19.axb5, with a balanced position.

17.♗xf4 ♗xf4



18.g3

Or 18.♗b5 ♗e6 19.♗h2±, with the idea of ♗g4.

18...♗4d5 19.♗g2

Kamsky has recycled his bishop to g2, to oppose Black's bishop on b7. The position is equalised.

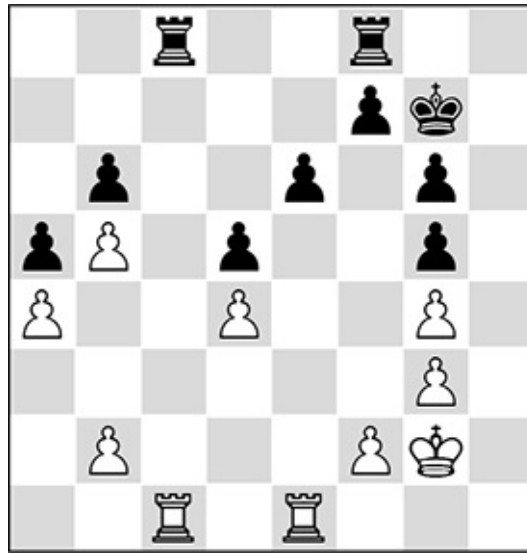
19...e6 20.♔d2 ♗g7 21.♗h2 ♖b8 22.♗g4 ♗xg4 23.hxg4 h6

White would like to use the h-file for attack, but Black prevents this.

24.♗b5 ♗c7 25.c4 ♗xg2 26.♗xg2 d5

An alternative was 26...♗xb5 27.cxb5 (27.axb5 d5=) 27...♔g5 28.♗xg5 hxg5 29.d5 exd5 (29...e5? 30.♚ac1 ♖bc8 31.♚c6±) 30.♚ad1 ♖fc8 31.♚xd5 ♖c4 32.b3 ♖c3=.

27.♔f4 ♗xb5 28.cxb5 ♔f6 29.♔e3 ♖bc8 30.♚ac1 ♔g5 31.♗xg5 hxg5



The ending is equal, although not lacking in subtleties. White probed for a while...

32. ♖f3

It would be bad to play 32. ♖c6? ♜xc6 33.bxc6 ♞f6 34. ♖c1 ♞e7 35.c7 ♞d7=

32... ♔f6 33.b3 ♕e7 34. ♕e3 ♕d7 35. ♔d2 ♖xc1 36. ♗xc1 ♜c8 37. ♜h1!

Trying to enter via the open file. The pawn ending is drawn after 37.♙xc8 ♖xc8 38.f4 gxf4 39.gxf4 ♙c7 40.b4 f6 41.bxa5 bxa5 42.♔d3 ♙d7 43.♙c2 ♙c7 44.♙c3, since neither king can force an entry.

37...♔e7 38.f4 gxf4 39.gxf4 ♕f6 40.♖h7 ♖f8 41.♔c3 ♖c8+ 42.♔b2 ♔e7

White's idea is to play ♔b2-a3-b4 and then create a passed pawn, but this proves impractical, because in that case the black rook would become active along the c-file.

43. ♖h3

Or 43.g5 ♖d8 44.♔a3 ♜a8 45.b4 axb4+ 46.♔xb4 ♜c8=, since if 47.a5? then 47...♜c4+.

43...♔d7 44.♖h2 ♕e7 45.g5 ♕d7 46.♖h7 ♔e7 47.♖h3 ♕d7 48.♔a3

Kamsky is trying all means possible to win, but Svidler defends well.

48... ♔d6 49. ♖h7 ♔e7 50. ♔b2 ♖f8 51.b4!



Finally! This is the only possible plan, although it is not good enough to win.

51...axb4 52. ♖h2! ♜c8 53. ♜c2 ♜c4! 54. ♞b3 ♜xd4 55.a5!

Kamsky finds this ingenious resource. The endgame was looking dead-drawn but has suddenly come to life.

55... ♜d3+!

Not 55...bxa5? 56.b6 ♜d3+ (56... ♜c4 57.b7) 57. ♞b2 b3 58.b7 bxc2 59. ♞xc2 and White wins.

56. ♞b2 ♞d7! 57.a6 ♜a3

Black has defended very well and the draw is very close...

58. ♜c1



58...d4?!

After defending so well, Svidler blunders. This move is unnecessary. Instead,

58... ♖a5 59. ♔b3 ♖a3+ (59... ♖xb5? 60. ♖a1+—) 60. ♔xb4 would give White some chances, but the right move was 58... ♖h3!, for instance 59. ♖c6 d4 60. ♖xb6 ♖h2+ 61. ♔b3 d3 62. ♖b7+ (62.a7?? d2—+) 62... ♔c8 63. ♖b6 ♔d7, with a draw.

59. ♖c4 ♔d6

Or 59...d3 60. ♖xb4 ♖a5 61. ♔c3, with advantage to White.

60. ♖xb4 ♖a5 61. ♖b3?!

Kamsky acquiesces to the draw, but in fact he could have continued to press for a win with 61. ♖xd4+! ♔c5 62. ♖d7 ♖xb5+ 63. ♔c2 ♖a5 64.a7 b5 65. ♖xf7 and White retains an edge.

61... ♔c7 62. ♖b4 ♔d6 63. ♖b3 ♔c7 64. ♖b4

½-½

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the main line of the system with ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6, this time with Black playing ...♗bd7. White's usual plan involves a2-a4, but in this game we saw the idea of ♖e1. Black responded with ...cxd4 and the plan of ...♗d5 and ...♕h6, which we have already seen in other games and which is thematic. To counter this plan it is interesting to play h2-h4, with the idea of ♗g5 or ♗e4. In the game, Kamsky came up with the interesting plan of bringing his knight to the b5-square, which Black had weakened by playing ...a7-a5. White's ♗h2, with the idea of ♗g4, was also interesting. Black equalised and in the rook ending, which seemed an easy draw, Kamsky managed to set some problems for Svidler after creating a passed pawn.

Game 22

King's Indian

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2208

José Larrosa Vila

2265

Arteixo 2007 (7)

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♗f3 c5 3.c3 b6 4. ♕f4 ♗b7 5.e3 g6 6.h3 ♗g7 7. ♗bd2 0-0



8. ♕e2

When Black uses this move order, with an early ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6, we know that he is not going to play ...d7-d6 and ...e7-e5, so it is possible for us to develop the bishop to c4 or d3 immediately, which are squares to which the bishop usually moves anyway in the main line with ♕e2. On d3 the bishop supports e4; on c4 it controls d5 and after a later ♖b3 it puts pressure on f7.

A) Let us examine 8. ♕c4, and now:

A1) 8...d5 9. ♕d3 (9. ♕e2 9... ♖c6 10. ♖e2 ♗d7 11. h4 (11. 0-0=) 11...e5 12. dxe5 ♗dxe5 13. h5 ♖e8 14. hxg6 hxg6 15. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 16. ♕b5 ♖e6 17. ♗f3 (17. ♕xe5 ♕xe5 18. ♗f3 ♕g7=) 17... ♗xf3+ 18. ♖xf3 a6 19. ♕d3 g5?! (19... ♖f6=) 20. ♕g3 ♖e7?! (20... ♕c6=) 21. ♖f5 d4?? (21... ♖f8 22. ♖h7±) 22. ♖h8+ 1-0 Olbrich-Voiska, Germany Frauenbundesliga 2000;

A2) 8...d6 9. 0-0 ♖d7 (9... ♖c7) 10. ♖e1 b5 11. ♕f1± Krumpacnik-Kveinys, Pula 2006.

B) The other option is 8. ♕d3, with the possible continuations:

B1) 8...d5 9. 0-0 ♗c6 10. ♖e2 ♗d7 11. ♕a6 (11. ♖ad1) 11... ♖c8 12. ♕xb7 ♖xb7 13. ♖ad1= Chubar-Dziuba, Warsaw 2013;

B2) 8...d6 9. 0-0 ♗bd7 and now:

B21) 10. ♖e2

B211) 10... ♖e8 11. e4 (11. ♕h2 e5 12. dxe5 ♗xe5 13. ♗xe5 dxe5 14. ♖fd1±) 11...cxd4 12. cxd4 e5 13. dxe5 dxe5 14. ♕e3= Kamsky-Svidler, Moscow 2008;

B212) 10...cxd4 11. exd4 e5! 12. dxe5 dxe5=;

B22) 10. ♕h2 ♖c7 11. e4 e5 12. d5 ♗h5 13. ♖e1 ♕h6 14. ♕f1 (14. a4±) 14... ♗g7 (14... ♗f4=) 15. g4± Ipatov-Vlashki, Sofia 2010.

8...d6 9. 0-0 ♗bd7 10. a4 a6 11. ♕h2

In this position there are other ideas, such as 11. ♖e1 or 11. ♖b3. For example:

A) 11. ♖b3 and now:

A1) 11... ♜b8!? A surprise.



analysis diagram

12. ♜fe1 (12. ♜fd1 ♘d5 13. ♙g3 (13. ♙h2) 13... ♘c7 (13...cxd4 14.exd4 a5=) 14. ♙c2 (14.e4±) Hort-Nikolic, Vinkovci 1968) 12... ♜c7 (12...b5!? was interesting: 13.axb5 (13. ♙c2) 13...axb5 14. ♙c2 (14. ♙xb5 ♙c6 15.c4 ♙xb5 16.cxb5 ♙b6=, 14. ♙a7 ♙b6 15. ♙ea1 c4 16. ♙c2=) 14... ♘d5 15. ♙g3 ♙b6 16.e4 ♘c7 with equality) 13. ♙h2 ♙d5 (again 13...b5 was possible, with ideas similar to those in the previous note. Black has also tried 13...e5 14. ♙c4 h6 15. ♙ad1 (15.dxe5 ♘xe5 16. ♘xe5 dxe5 17. ♙ed1±) 15...g5 16.dxe5 ♘xe5 17. ♘xe5 dxe5± Vujadinovic-Stamatovic, Belgrade 2011) 14. ♙a3 (White's best move seems to be 14. ♙c2, e.g. 14...cxd4 (14... ♙b7 15. ♙c4) 15.exd4 b5 16.axb5 axb5 17. ♙a6) 14...b5 15.axb5 (White would have fewer problems after 15.b4! c4 (15...cxb4 16.cxb4=) 16. ♙d1 ♘e4 17. ♘xe4 ♙xe4 18. ♘d2 ♙c6 19.e4=) 15...axb5 16.dxc5?! (this move is dubious. At first sight it seems to leave the b5-pawn weak, but in reality Black will play ...b5-b4 and retain the advantage. Instead, White could have kept the balance with 16. ♙a5 ♙xa5 (16... ♙b7 17. ♙a6 ♙xa6 (17... ♙c7 18. ♙a5=) 18. ♙xa6 c4=) 17. ♙xa5 c4 (17...b4 18. ♙b5±) 18. ♙ea1 ♙fc8 19.g4=) 16... ♘xc5! (if 16... ♙xc5 then 17. ♙xc5 ♘xc5 18. ♙a7, with a slight advantage to White) 17. ♙b4?! (17. ♙a7 was slightly better, e.g. 17... ♙b7 18. ♙a5 ♙b6 19. ♘d4 ♘fe4 20. ♘xe4 ♙xe4 21. ♙b4 ♙b7) and here instead of 17... ♙xf3? (De Prado-Starostits, Ferrol 2013) the right way was 17... ♙c4! 18. ♙a5 (18. ♙xc4 bxc4 19. ♙xc4 ♙xb2; 18. ♘xc4 bxc4 19. ♙xc4 ♙xb2) 18... ♙xa5 19. ♙xa5 ♙xe2 20. ♙xe2 ♘d3, with a slight advantage to Black;

A2) I have also faced 11... ♖a7 12. ♜fe1 (12. ♙c4!±) 12... ♗a8 13. ♙f1 (13. ♙c4; 13.c4 ♘e4 14.d5) 13...h6 14. ♙h2 (14. ♜ac1) 14...♘e4 15. ♘xe4 ♙xe4 16. ♘d2 ♙c6 17. ♗a3 ♜e8 18. ♘c4 ♗b8 19.b4 cxb4 (19... ♜c8) 20. ♗xb4± De Prado-Casares, Lugo 2010;

A3) Or 11... ♜c8 12. ♜fe1 ♜c7 13. ♗a3 (13. ♙c4!± is better, e.g. 13... ♗a8 14. ♘g5 ♙d5 15.e4 ♙xc4 16. ♗xc4 h6 17. ♘gf3 ♜fc8 18.d5±) 13... ♗a8 14.b4 (14.c4! ♘e4 15. ♘xe4 ♙xe4 16.d5 ♙xf3 17. ♙xf3±) 14... ♜e8 15. ♙h2 ♘e4= De Prado-P.Garcia, Padron 2013.



11... ♜c8

11... ♗c7 is the most common move here and we shall examine this in the following game. Black has also tried 11... ♜a7 or 11... ♜e8 12.b4 (12. ♙c4!±; 12. ♜c1=) 12...cxd4 13.cxd4 ♜c8 14. ♗b3 (14. ♜c1=) 14... ♙d5 (14...e5) 15. ♗b2± Kotov-Nikolaevsky, Kiev 1957.

12. ♜c1

Not the best move. Practice has also seen 12. ♗b3 ♗c7 13. ♜fd1 (13. ♜fe1) 13... ♗b8 14.c4 cxd4 15. ♘xd4?! (15.exd4=) 15... ♗a8= Burmakin-Kulkarni, Sort 2009.

The best move is 12. ♜e1 (12. ♙c4!? is interesting) and now:



analysis diagram

A) 12...d5 13. ♖e5 (13.b4±) 13... ♖xe5 14. ♗xe5 ♘d7 15. ♗xg7 ♔xg7= Kallai-Maze, Montpellier 2007;

B) 12... ♖e8 13. ♗c4 e5 14.dxe5 ♖xe5 (14...dxe5 15. ♗e2±) 15. ♖xe5 dxe5 16. ♗e2±;

C) 12... ♗c7 13. ♗d3 ♗b8 14. ♗e2 ♗a8 (Black has lost a tempo) 15.e4 cxd4 16.cxd4 and White is better, with a space advantage and the push e4-e5-e6 in the air, Raicevic-Vuckovic, Belgrade 2006;

D) 12... ♖c7 13. ♗d3 ♗a8. This plan is often used by White in the Réti Opening, hence this system is often called the Réti Reversed. White's plan is to try to play e3-e4, or c3-c4 and d4-d5, to shut down the bishop on b7, and then play on the kingside, taking advantage of the absence of so many black pieces on the queenside. 14.e4 (14.c4!±) 14...cxd4 15.cxd4, and now:

D1) 15... ♖e8?! 16. ♗b3 (16. ♗e2±) 16... ♖c8± Stewart-Kohlweyer, Germany 2011;

D2) 15...e5 16.dxe5 (16. ♗e2 ♖e8 17.dxe5 dxe5 (17... ♖xe5 18. ♖xe5 dxe5 19. ♖c4±) 18. ♖c4±) 16... ♖xe5 17. ♖xe5 dxe5 18. ♗xe5 ♖d7 and Black has compensation, but no more than that, despite which he went on to win in Mertens-Golod, Trieste 2011.

12... ♖c7

All according to plan, but it was better to exchange on d4: 12...cxd4 13.exd4 (13. cxd4 ♖xc1 14. ♗xc1 ♗a8=) 13... ♗c7 14. ♖e1 ♗h6 15. ♗f1, with equality.

13.b4

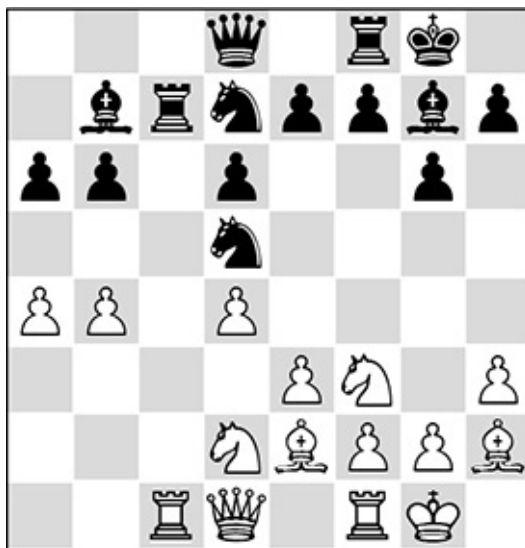
Or 13. ♖e1 ♗a8 14. ♗f3 ♖fc8= Nguyen Thanh-Nguyen Thien, Vietnam 2005.

White has also tried 13. ♖b3 ♜a8 14. ♜fd1 (14. ♜fe1 (14.c4!) 14... ♘e4= Alcaraz-Lara, Cullera 2012) 14... ♙c6 15. ♖a3 (15.c4±) 15... ♜fc8= Völzke-Pittelkow, Germany tt 1988. But once again 13. ♜e1, with the idea of a future e3-e4 or c3-c4, is White's best idea.

13...cxb4

It was better to play 13... ♜a8 14.bxc5 bxc5 15.c4 ♘e4 16.d5 ♘c3 17. ♖e1 ♘a2 18. ♜b1 ♘b4, with equality.

14.cxb4 ♘d5?!



This seemingly active move, which attacks the b4-pawn and threatens 15... ♘c3, is the cause of problems for Black. It was better to play 14... ♜xc1 15. ♖xc1 ♜a8 16. ♖b2 ♜c8 17. ♜c1, with equality. This type of position is very solid.

15. ♖b3 ♜c8?!

Black was relying on this, thinking that if he gained control of the c-file he would stand slightly better. He had no inkling of the danger hanging over him. It was not too late to play 15...a5 16.bxa5 (16. b5 ♘b4=) 16...bxa5 17. ♖b5 (17. ♙c4 ♘7b6= – this is the point of playing ...a7-a5, to free the b6-square) 17... ♘7f6=.

16. ♜xc7! ♜xc7

If 16... ♘xc7 then 17. ♜c1±.

17. ♙c4! ♘5f6?

This is bad, although at first sight it just looks normal. Black didn't want to weaken d6 by playing 17...e6 but this was the only possible move, when White would retain some advantage after 18.b5! (18. ♘e4!? looks interesting, e.g. 18... ♘xe3 19.fxe3 ♙xe4 20. ♘g5 ♘f6 21. ♙xe6 ♙h6 22. ♙xf7+ ♜xf7 23. ♙xd6 ♙d5 24. ♘xf7 ♖xf7 25. ♖c3, with a complicated position) and now:

A) 18...a5 19. ♖e4! ♗xe3 20. ♔xe3 ♕xe4 21. ♔xe4 ♖xc4 22. ♕xd6 ♖d8 (22... ♖c8 23. ♗b7!± – without b4-b5 this variation would not work for White due to ... ♗c6) 23. ♗b7!±.

B) 18...axb5 19. ♕xb5 ♖c8 20. ♖e4 e5 (20... ♕f8 21. ♕xd7 ♖xd7 22. ♗xd5! ±) 21. ♖d1 with a clear advantage to White; the threat is to take on e5.

What should White play now?



18. ♖g5!!

An unexpected leap, which gives White a decisive advantage. Black is unable to parry White's threats to break in on f7 or to sacrifice on e6.

18...e6

This loses. It was essential to accept the loss of the f7-pawn with 18... ♖c8 19. ♕xf7+ ♖h8 20. ♕c4, although White's advantage should be decisive. Instead, 18... ♖c8!? 19. ♖xf7 b5 20. axb5 axb5 21. ♖xd6+ bxc4 22. ♖6xc4 ♕d8 23. ♖b6+ ♖f8 24. ♖xc8 ♗xc8 25. b5 would also give White a winning advantage.

19. ♕xe6! ♖b8?

There was no salvation for Black with 19...fxe6 20. ♖xe6 ♖c8 (20... ♗c6 21. ♖d8+ ♗d5 22. ♖xb7+–) 21. ♖xf8+ ♕d5 22. ♖xg6 hxg6 23. ♗d3+–.

20. ♕xf7+ ♖xf7?

Or 20... ♖h8 21. ♕e6 ♖c6 22. d5+–.

21. ♕xd6! ♕d5

If 21... ♗d7 then 22. ♗xf7+ ♖xf7 23. ♖xf7 ♖xf7 24. ♖xb8+–, or 21... ♗xd6 22. ♗xf7+ ♖h8 23. ♗xb7+–.

22. ♕xc7 ♖xc7

Desperation, but 22... ♖xb3 23. ♖xf7 ♕xf7 24. ♖xb8 was also losing.

23. ♖b2 h6 24. ♗gf3 ♗bd7 25. ♖c1

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the line with ... ♖c8, where Black tries to play like in the Réti with ... ♖c7 and ... ♗a8, to put pressure along the long diagonal. White should try to block this diagonal with e3-e4, or c3-c4 and d4-d5, and then play on the kingside, taking advantage of the fact that so many of the black pieces are absent on the other wing. The best reply for White is 12. ♖e1. Although in the game Black equalised, it is worth noting how normal-looking moves such as ... ♗d5 and ... ♖c8, which might even appear to give Black the advantage, are bad, since the plan of ♗b3, followed by the counterattack with ♗c4 and ♗g5, leaves White with the advantage. One would not think that this position holds so many dangers for Black. Once again we can see that, in the London System, attacks can suddenly appear when Black is least expecting them.

Game 23

King's Indian

Robert Markus

2622

Aleksandar Indjic

2549

Serbia tt 2013 (10)

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 g6 3.♗f4 d6 4.h3 c5 5.e3 ♗g7 6.c3 ♗bd7 7.♗e2 0-0 8.0-0 b6 9.a4 a6 10.♗bd2 ♗b7 11.♗h2 ♗c7

The most common move in this position. Previously we saw ... ♖c8 and we shall examine ... ♖a7 and ... ♗b8 in the following games.



12. ♖e1

A) A very popular alternative is 12. ♖b3, with several options:

A1) 12... ♖ab8 13. ♖fc1 (13. ♖fe1 b5 14. ♖c2 cxd4 15. exd4±) 13...b5 14. axb5 axb5 15. ♖a7 (15. ♖c2±) 15... ♖b6 ½-½ Kotic-Berkes, Bizovac 2007;

A2) 12... ♖fb8?! 13. e4! b5 (13... ♖xe4 14. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 15. ♖g5+-; 13... ♖xe4 14. ♖c4!±) 14. e5?! (14. axb5 axb5 15. ♖g5 c4 16. ♖xb5! ♖xe4 17. ♖xc4±) 14...c4 (14... ♖d5=) 15. ♖c2 (15. ♖a3±) 15... ♖e8± Prié-Huerga, San Sebastian 2009;

A3) 12... ♖ac8 13. ♖fe1 and again Black has various options:

A31) 13... ♖d5 14. c4 ♖b7 15. a5 (15. d5±) 15... bxa5 16. ♖a3 (16. d5) 16... ♖b8 17. b3 (17. d5) 17... ♖fc8 18. ♖xa5= Prié-Sanchez, Cap d'Agde 2008;

A32) 13... cxd4 14. exd4 e5 15. ♖f1±;

A33) 13... ♖b8 and now:

A331) 14. ♖a3 ♖a8 15. ♖ec1 (15. ♖f1 ♖fe8 16. ♖ad1 h6 17. ♖b3 ♖c6± Guerrero-Perez, Orense 2006) 15... ♖e4 16. ♖xe4 ♖xe4= De Prado-Ramo, Barcelona 2006;

A332) The best continuation is 14. e4! cxd4 15. cxd4 ♖a8 (15... ♖xe4 16. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 17. ♖xa6±) 16. ♖d3±;

A4) 12... cxd4 13. exd4 h6 (13... ♖h6 14. ♖fe1 ♖e4 15. ♖ad1±) 14. ♖fe1± Wahono-Kasmiran, Jakarta 2012;

A5) 12... ♖c6 is the most popular move:



analysis diagram

A51) 13. ♕c4 ♖b7!= San Marco-Picard, Issy-les-Moulineaux 2006;

A52) 13. ♜fd1 ♜b7 14. ♘e1!? (played by grandmaster Megaranto, but 14.c4! ± looks better to me) 14...b5 (14... ♜fe8 15. ♘c4 ♕d5 16. ♕f3 ♕xf3 17. ♘xf3= Megaranto-Nyback, Istanbul 2012) 15. ♕f3 ♕xf3 16. ♘exf3= Megaranto-Kasyan, Tashkent 2012;

A53) 13. ♜fc1 ♕d5 (13... ♜fb8 14. ♕c4±; 13... ♜fc8=) 14. ♜a3 (14.c4! ♕b7 15.d5±) 14... ♕b7 (14...b5=) 15.a5 b5= Gelle-Horvath, Hungary tt 1995;

A54) 13.c4 e6 (13...cxd4 14.exd4 a5= 15. ♘b1!?) 14. ♜fd1 (14.a5! bxa5 15. ♜a3 ♘e4 16. ♘xe4 ♕xe4 17. ♜fd1±) 14... ♜fd8 (14...a5=) 15. ♜ac1 (15.a5 ±) 15... ♜ab8 16. ♘b1 ♘e4 17.d5 exd5 18.cxd5 ♕b7 19. ♘fd2= Bruzon-Radjabov, Tromsø 2013.

B) Another idea is 12. ♕d3!?, but I think that Black equalises easily with 12... e5. Let us see:



analysis diagram

B1) 12... ♖ad8 13.e4 (13. ♔e2±) 13...c4 14. ♕c2 (14. ♗xc4±) 14...e5 15. ♗e1 ♗fe8= Kamsky-Nyzhnyk, Moscow 2013;

B2) 12...e5! and now:

B21) 13.e4!? ♗h5 (13...b5=) 14.dxe5 dxe5 15. ♕c4 ♗f4= Grachev-Bernasek, Pardubice 2006;

B22) 13.dxe5 ♗xe5 and now either 14. ♗xe5 dxe5 15. ♕e2 ♗e4= Andersson-Moberg, Sweden tt 1999, or 14. ♕e2 ♗ad8 15. ♗c4 ♗xc4 16. ♕xc4 ♗c8= Malakhatko-Rjanova, St Petersburg 2011.

12... ♗e4

Or 12... ♗ac8 13. ♕d3 (13. ♕c4! e5 14.dxe5 ♗xe5 15. ♗xe5 dxe5 16. ♔e2±; 13. ♕f1 ♗b8 14. ♗b3 ♗a8 15. ♗ed1 ♗e4 16. ♗xe4 ♕xe4= Nill-Zhukova, Warsaw 2001) 13...cxd4 14.exd4 (14.cxd4 e5 15. ♗c1 ♗b8 16. ♗xc8 ♗xc8 17. ♕c4 b5 18.axb5 axb5 19. ♕b3=) 14... ♗fe8 15. ♔e2= Abramovic-Simic, Belgrade 2007.

One of the co-author's games continued 12... ♗fe8 13. ♗b3 (13. ♕c4± is better) 13... ♗ac8 14. ♕c4 e6 15. ♗ac1 (15. ♗d1 ♕h6 16. ♗e2± is better) 15... ♕h6 16. ♗d1 ♗c6 17. ♗e2!? (17. ♕f1=) 17...cxd4 18.cxd4 b5? (it is better to play 18...d5 19. ♕xa6 ♗xc1 20. ♗xc1 ♗xc1+ 21. ♗f1 ♕xa6 22. ♗xa6=) 19.axb5 axb5 20. ♕xb5 ♗xc1 21. ♗xc1? (White could have won with the neat zwischenzug 21. ♗c4!! ♗xe1+ (forced, since the queen is trapped) 22. ♗xe1 ♕c6 23. ♗xd6 ♕xb5 24. ♗xb5, with a decisive advantage to White; the big difference from the game is that this way the black rooks are kept out and White wins a second pawn) 21... ♗xc1+ 22. ♗f1 and, despite the position now being equal, I ended up losing in the game De Prado-Barlov, Ferrol 2012.

13. ♖xe4

White has also tried the thematic 13. ♖b3 ♖xd2 (13... ♕h6 14.d5 ♖xd2 15. ♖xd2 ♖f6 16.c4 ♜fb8 17. ♕f3 ♕g7 18.e4 ♖d7 19. ♕e2± Anastasian-Mirumian, Yerevan 1994) 14. ♖xd2 ♜ac8 (14... ♖c6 15. ♕f3 ♖c7 (½-½ Dorfman-Macieja, Elista 1998) 16.d5) 15. ♕f1 (15.d5!±) 15... ♖c6 16. ♜ad1= Bruzon-Lorenzo, Manresa 2008, as well as 13. ♜c1 ♖df6 14.c4 ♜ab8 15. ♖b1 ♖d7 16. ♕d3= Hoffman-Ubilava, Candas 1992.

13... ♕xe4 14. ♕f1

A move designed to defend g2 against a possible ... ♖b7, in preparation for moving the knight to d2.

The main alternative is 14. ♖d2 immediately (if 14. ♖g5!? then 14... ♖b7 15. ♕f3 ♕xf3 16. ♖xf3 ♜ac8=) and now:

A) 14... ♕c6 and now:

A1) 15. ♕f3 b5 (15... ♖b7 16. ♕xc6 ♖xc6 17. ♖f3 ♖xf3 18. ♖xf3= Balashov-Mikhalchishin, Klaipeda 1988) 16.axb5 axb5 17. ♖e2 ♖b7= Schorr-Lputian, Chicago 1994;

A2) 15. ♕f1 ♜fc8 16.b4 cxb4 17.cxb4 b5= Mitkov-Jancovic, Montreal 2009;

B) 14... ♖b7 15. ♜c1 (15. ♖b3) 15... ♖f6 16.b4 ♜fc8 17. ♖c4 ♕d5 18.dxc5 bxc5 19.a5 ♕xc4 20. ♕xc4 ♖b7 21. ♜b1= Ding Liren-Gupta, Subic Bay 2009.



14...e5

A good alternative was 14... ♖b7, with a balanced position.

15.dxe5

It was perhaps preferable to maintain the tension with 15. ♜c1∞.

15... ♖xe5

If 15...dxe5 then 16. ♖b3±.

16. ♖xe5

Black can equalise after 16. ♖d2 ♗c6 17. ♖c4 (17.e4 b5=) 17...d5.

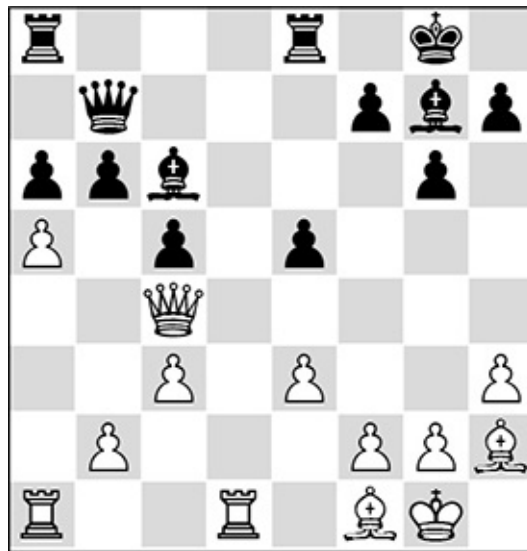
16...dxe5 17. ♗b3

Objectively the position is equal. Each side has an active bishop, but White's space advantage on the queenside and the pressure on e5 mean that White's play is simpler and it is easier for Black to go wrong.

17...♗c6 18. ♖ed1 ♖b7 19. ♗c4

19. ♖d6!? looks promising, e.g. 19...b5 (not 19...♖fd8? 20. ♗xa6!±) 20. ♗a3 bxa4 21. ♖ad1 (21. ♗xc5 ♗xb2; 21. ♖b1 ♖fd8 22. ♗xc5 ♖xd6 23. ♗xd6=) 21...♖fc8 22. ♗g3 ♖ab8=.

19...♖fe8 20.a5



The game has reached a key moment, one where Black needs to make a decision. When players with black arrive at this type of position, which is equal, they relax, thinking that they are in no danger, and this leads them into making mistakes. Or else they take too big a risk trying to win. Equality does not mean a draw. In general White usually has the initiative and the more comfortable game, while Black needs to stay alert.

20...bxa5?

And Black immediately commits an error, spoiling his pawn structure. Instead, 20...♗b5 was good, e.g. 21. ♗b3 ♗xf1 22. ♖xf1 b5 23. ♗d5 ♖c8 24.c4, but although the position is equal, White has a slight initiative; 20...b5!? 21. ♗xc5 ♗f8 22. ♗b6 ♖c8 23.e4 ♗xe4= was also playable.

21. ♖xa5

White now has the advantage, in view of the weaknesses on a6 and c5.

21...♗b5 22. ♗b3 ♖c7 23. ♗xb5 ♖xa5

Or 23...axb5 24. ♖xa8 ♜xa8 25. ♙xb5 ♜b8 26. ♙a4±.

24. ♙xe8 ♜xe8 25.g4!

White gives his king some air. His control of the open files gives him a clear advantage, even though Black has managed to maintain the material balance.

25... ♙c7 26. ♙a4

Perhaps it was better to play 26. ♙c4 ♜e6 27. ♜d5 ♙f8 28.e4 (28.b4 ♜c6 29. ♙xe5 cxb4 30. ♙d3 bxc3 31. ♙xc7 c2 32. ♙f4 c1 ♙+ 33. ♙g2) 28... ♙e7 29.b3, with a comfortable advantage.

26... ♜d8

Here 26... ♜e6 was better, although after 27. ♜d5 ♙f8 28.b3 White retains the advantage.

27. ♜xd8+ ♙xd8



28. ♙c6?

A strange move, which loses the advantage. It was good to take the pawn:

28. ♙xa6 ♙d1+ 29. ♙f1±.

28...h5! 29.gxh5 ♙g5+?

Black returns the favour; he should have played 29...gxh5! 30. ♙xa6 (30. ♙xc5 ♙g5+ 31. ♙f1 ♙f5=) 30... ♙g5+ 31. ♙f1 ♙f5 32. ♙a8+ ♙h7 33. ♙g2 ♙g6+ 34. ♙h1 (34. ♙g3 h4) 34... ♙b1+ 35. ♙g1 ♙xb2=.

30. ♙g3 ♙xh5

If 30...gxh5 then 31.h4±.

31. ♙g2 ♙f5 32.e4 ♙e6 33. ♙xc5



Now White wins a pawn and is left with a decisive advantage.

33...f5 34.♔d5 ♕xd5 35.exd5 ♖f7 36.f3 ♕e7 37.c4 ♖d6 38.♗f2 ♗h6 39.♖f1 ♗d2
40.♗e1 ♗xe1?

This loses easily. More tenacious was 40...♗c1 although after 41.♗b4+ ♔d7
42.b3 ♗e3 43.♖e2 ♗d4 44.♗a3 White should win by advancing his pawns.

41.♖xe1 a5 42.b3 ♖c5 43.♖f2 ♖d6 44.♖g2 ♖c5 45.♖g3 ♖d6 46.♖h4 f4

Or 46...♖c5 47.♖g5 ♖d6 48.h4 ♖c5 49.h5 gxf5 50.♖xf5+.

47.♖g4 ♖c5 48.h4 ♖d6 49.♖h3 ♖c5 50.♖g2

1-0

White wins by bringing his king to e4.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw 11...♖c7, which is the most popular move in the position. White has two good options: ♖e1 and ♖b3. In the game Black employed the thematic idea of ...♗e4, exchanging pieces and preventing e3-e4 by White. After ...e7-e5 the position was equal; both sides had an active bishop, but the one on h2 always had pressure against the e5-pawn. White gained the advantage after Black's error in breaking up his own pawn chain, spoiling his pawn structure. What stands out most is the necessity of taking care, because equality does not mean that the game will be drawn, and players with black often relax, thinking that there is no danger.

Game 24

King's Indian

Nguyen Thi Mai Hung

2237

Tania Sachdev

2417

Ho Chi Minh City 2012 (1)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♙f4 ♘g6 3.e3 ♙g7 4.♘f3 d6 5.h3 0-0 6.♙e2 b6 7.c3 ♙b7 8.0-0 ♘bd7 9.a4 a6
10.♘bd2 ♙a7



Another plan for Black is to play the rook immediately to a7, making room for the queen on a8. At the same time the rook can be useful on a7 if Black plays ... b6-b5, and it can also go to c7 if the bishop moves. Against this piece set-up, White should try to close the centre with d4-d5, to leave the black pieces passive on the queenside. The normal move order would be 10...c5, for example:

A) 11.♙e1 ♙a7 12.♙b3 (12.♙c4 ♙a8 13.♙e2±; 12.♙h2) 12...♙a8 13.♙ad1 (13.♙c4; 13.c4 cxd4 14.exd4 e5=; 13.♙f1) 13...♙c6 14.♙c4 h6 15.♙h2 b5 16.axb5 axb5 17.♙xb5 ♙xb5 18.♙xb5 ♙b8 19.♙d3 ♙xb2= De Prado-Garcia, Spain tt 2013;

B) 11.♙h2 would be normal. Now:



analysis diagram

B1) 11...♔b8!? (a new idea) 12.♔b3 (12.♖e1 ♔a7 13.♕c4±) 12...♔a7 13.♖fe1 (13.♕c4!± is good; also interesting is 13.c4 ♕e4 14.♕xe4 ♕xe4 15.d5 ♕xf3 16.♕xf3, and I prefer White) 13...♖ac8 14.♕d3 (to play e4, but 14.♖ad1± is better) 14...d5 15.c4!? (15.♕f1±) 15...♖fd8 16.cxd5 ♕xd5 17.♔a3!? (17.♕c4=) 17...cxd4 18.e4!? (18.exd4=) 18...♕e6 ½-½ De Prado-Pazos, Arteixo 2013;

B2) 11...♖a7. The same plan as in the game, and now:

B21) 12.b4 ♔a8 13.♔b3 cxb4 14.cxb4 ♕d5= Deepan-David, Coubertin 2009;

B22) 12.♔b3 ♔a8 and now:

B221) 13.c4 ♕e4 14.d5 ♕xd2 15.♕xd2 b5 16.axb5 (16.e4∞ is better) 16...axb5 17.♖xa7 ♔xa7 18.♔xb5 (18.cxb5 ♕b6 19.e4 f5 and Black has compensation) 18...♕a8 with equality;

B222) 13.♖fd1 ♕c6 (13...♕e4 14.♕xe4 (14.♕f1 ♕xd2 15.♕xd2 ♖c8= Pham-Lorparizangeneh, Jakarta 2013) 14...♕xe4 15.d5 ♕xf3 16.gxf3!∞ Burmakin-Gopal, Benasque 2014) 14.♔a3 (14.c4 cxd4 15.exd4 d5!= Teijeiro-Pazos, Pontevedra 2015; 14.♕e1 ♕e4 (14...b5!=) 15.♕xe4 ♕xe4 16.♕f3 (16.d5±) 16...♕xf3 17.♕xf3= Pakleza-Kukula, Katowice 2015) 14...♖c8 15.♕f1 (15.♕e1 ♖cc7 16.♕f3= Zurek-Nedela, Czechia tt 1997; 15.c4!±) 15...♕f8 16.♕e1 ♔b7 17.♕d3= Kamsky-Becerra, USA tt 2014;

B23) 12.♖e1 ♔a8 13.c4 ♕e4 14.d5 ♕xd2 15.♕xd2 b5 16.e4±;

B24) 12.♕d3 ♔a8 (a recent game continued 12...cxd4 13.exd4 e5!? (13...♔a8 14.♖e1±) 14.♖e1 ♔a8?! (14...♖e8±) 15.dxe5 dxe5 16.♕xe5!? (16.♕f1!±) 16...♕xe5 17.♖xe5 ♖d8 (17...♕d7! with compensation) 18.♔c2± Anurag-Gupta, Cappelle-la-Grande 2016) and here White has tried:

B241) 13. ♖b1 e5 14.e4 cxd4 15.cxd4 exd4? (15...d5 16. ♗xe5 dxe4 17. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 18. ♗xe4 ♗xd4=) 16. ♗xd6 ♖e8 17. ♖e1± Muranyi-Khairallah, Budapest 2007;

B242) 13.e4 cxd4 14.cxd4 ♗xe4 15. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 16. ♗xe4 ♖xe4 17. ♖e1 ♗d5 18. ♖xe7= Sandipan-Cyborowski, Trier 2013;

B243) 13. ♖e2 ♖c8?! (13... ♗e4=) 14.e4!± Nguyen-Nandhidhaa, Sharjah 2013.

11. ♖e1 ♖a8 12. ♗f1

Another option was 12. ♗h2 c5 13.b4 (it is better to play 13.c4 ♗e4 14.d5 ♗xd2 15. ♗xd2 b5 16.e4±) 13...cxd4 and now:

A) 14.cxd4 ♗e4 15. ♗f1 ♖c8= De Prado-Leira, Puente deume 2012;

B) 14.exd4 is better, e.g. 14... ♖c8 15. ♖b3 ♗e4?! (15... ♗h6 16.c4=) 16. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 17. ♗c4!±.

12...c5



Finally Black opts for the normal ...c7-c5. If 12... ♗e4 then 13. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 14. ♗d2 ♗b7 15.e4± Deepan-Gupta, Ho Chi Minh City 2012.

13. ♗h2 ♗e4

Black has other possibilities:

A) 13... ♖e8 14. ♖b3 (14. ♖e2) 14...h6 (14... ♗e4 15. ♗c4 d5 16. ♗e2 ♗xd2 17. ♗xd2 e5 18.dxe5±) 15. ♗c4± 15... ♗d5 (15... ♖f8 Toufighi-Ganguly, Guangzhou 2010, 16. ♗h4!±) 16. ♗xd5 ♗xd5 17. ♗c4 (17.e4!±) 17... ♗5f6= Manakova-Havlikova, Germany Frauenbundesliga 2013;

B) 13... ♖c8 14. ♖c1 (again it is better to play 14.c4 ♗e4 15.d5 ♗xd2 16. ♖xd2 b5 17.e4±) 14... ♗c6 15.c4 d5 16.b3± Ilic-Damljanovic, Struga 2005;

C) 13... ♗c6?! 14. ♖c2?! (14.c4!±) 14... ♗e4= E.Alvarez-Busto, Gijon 2006.

14. ♖xe4

14. ♖c4 ♘d5 15. ♖a3 (15.a5) 15... ♘c6 16. ♖c2 ♖ef6 17. ♖d2 ♖c8 18.f3 ♖ac7 19. ♖a3 ½-½ Chowdhury-Kunte, Calcutta 2003.

14. ♜b3 (14. ♜e2) 14... ♖xd2 15. ♖xd2 d5 (15... ♘c6=) 16. ♖f3 ♘c6 17. ♜a3± Thi Mai Nguyen-Havlikova, Istanbul 2012.

14... ♘xe4 15. ♖d2 ♘c6 16. ♖c4 ♖e8

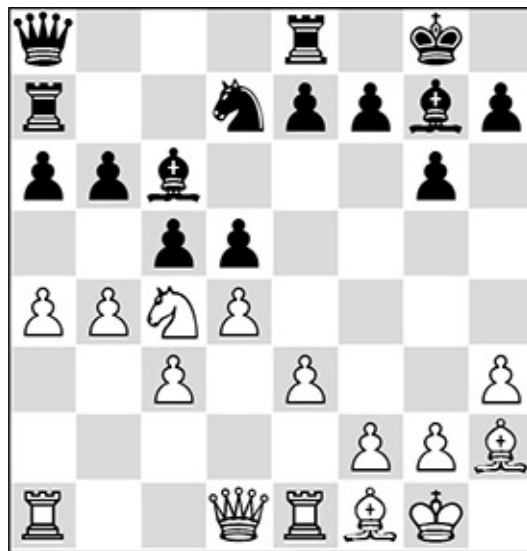
Or 16...d5 17. ♖d2 e5 18. ♖f3 (18.dxe5 ♖xe5 19.a5 b5 20. ♖b3 c4 21. ♖d4±) 18...e4 19. ♖d2 c4 (19... ♖e8=) 20.b3 b5 21. ♖a3 ♜b7 22. ♜a1± Rivas-Moreno, Lorca 2005.

17.b4

It is better to play 17.a5 b5 18.d5! ♘b7 (18... ♘xd5 19. ♖b6 ♖xb6 20.axb6 ♖d7 21. ♘xb5±) 19. ♖b6 ♜d8 20. ♖xd7 ♜xd7 21.e4, with a balanced position, but I prefer White.

17...d5

Here 17...cxb4 18.cxb4 ♖c8 19. ♖c1 was better, with equality.



18. ♖e5!?

The best move here is 18. ♖a3 (18. ♖d2 c4 19.e4 (19. ♘e2 e5 20. ♜c2 b5 21.a5 exd4 22.exd4 ♖f6 23. ♘f3 ♖ae7=) 19...b5 20. ♜c2 ♖b6 21.a5 ♖d7 22.e5 Pham Le Thao-Mohota, Ho Chi Minh City 2012) 18...c4 (18... ♖c8 19.b5 axb5 20.axb5 ♘b7 21. ♜b3±) 19.e4 e6 (19...b5? 20.axb5 axb5 21.exd5+–) 20.e5±.

18... ♖xe5 19. ♘xe5 ♘xe5 20.dxe5 ♖d7?



24... ♖a7 25. ♕a1 c4 26.e4! e6

If 26...dxe4 then 27. ♗xc4 wins.

27. ♗d1?!

It was better to play 27. ♕a3 ♖c8 28. ♖a1 ♖c6 29.exd5 exd5 30. ♖xd5, with a decisive advantage.

27... ♗d8?

Black had to try 27... ♗ee7!, even though after 28.exd5 ♗b5 29. ♕a3 ♖xa5 30. ♕xe7 ♖a7 31. ♕f6 exd5 32.e6 White has a clear advantage.

28.exd5

Again the plan of tripling on the a-file was winning: 28. ♕a3 ♖b7 29. ♖a1 d4 30.cxd4 ♖xe4 31. ♖xa6+–.

28... ♖xd5

Or 28...exd5 29. ♕a3+–.

29. ♖dxd5 exd5

possible responses when confronted with the London System.

Black has various ways of preparing the traditional plan of ...e7-e5; he can play ...♗bd7 and ...♞e8, as in Game 14; ...♗bd7 and ...b7-b6, as in Game 15; ...♗c6 and ...♗fd7 as in Game 16, or ...♗fd7 and ...e7-e5 but without ...♗c6, as in game 17.

We also looked at Black's ideas based on playing ...c7-c5 and ♞b6; in Game 18 we saw White trying to avoid playing ♞b3; in the notes to this game we also examined the option of ♞b3, offering the exchange of queens. In Game 19 we saw a different plan for Black, based on playing ...c5xd4, followed by ...♗c6 and ...♞e6, to control the centre.

In Game 20 we began our survey of what is sometimes called the Réti Reversed: the system with ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6, which is Black's most popular; in this game we looked at the development of the black knight on c6, while in the remaining games (21-24) we saw the usual development of the black knight on d7 and we examined the various plans, both for White, with moves such as ♖e1, ♞b3 or ♙h2, and for Black, with ...♙c8, ...♞c7, ...♙a7 and even ...♞b8 and ...♙b8.

For White, to summarise, there are several plans available: against ideas based on a quick ...e7-e5, remember to play c3-c4 and ♗c3 and leave the square d2 free for the f3-knight, in case Black plays ...e5-e4. It is interesting to play on the queenside, which is where White can hope to gain the advantage. There is no need to fear the variations where Black advances his kingside pawns – with accurate play in the centre and queenside, White can gain the advantage.

Against the plan with ...b7-b6 but without ...c7-c5, it is interesting to play a2-a4 instead of c3-c4. By castling quickly White can avoid the line involving the exchange of queens with ♞b3; instead he can play ♗bd2, indirectly defending the b2-pawn, then after ♗c4 he can harass the black queen.

Against the Réti Reversed it is necessary to keep in mind the plan of trying to play d4-d5, after e3-e4 or c3-c4, to leave the black pieces (the bishop and the queen or rook) out of play and remote from the centre or the kingside. White should also remember the idea of playing ♞c4 and ♞b3, to put pressure on f7 (with ♗g5) or to provoke ...d6-d5, in order to gain the use of the e5-square and close the diagonal of the bishop on b7.

Against Black's move order with an early ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6, White has the option of playing the bishop to d3 or c4, instead of e2, and this is covered in Game 27. Also remember that White has the option of playing the Barry Attack with ♗c3, which we looked at in the previous chapter,

which was devoted to playing against the Grünfeld set-up.

It can be said that the King's Indian is one of the most solid systems that White has to face when playing the London System. But this does not mean that White cannot gain the advantage against it, or reach positions which are equal but more pleasant and easier to play with white. Of course, none of the lines involve any risk for White and any losses are not the fault of the opening but are caused by errors committed later. One thing I want to particularly emphasise is that, as we saw in Games 22, 23 and 24, very often Black relaxes, thinking that the position is equal or without any danger, and then he commits errors. Sudden attacks or tactical blows crop up in the London System where they are least expected.

Chapter 4

The London System versus the Queen's Indian

1.d4 ♘f6 2. ♙f4 e6 3. ♘f3 b6

1.d4 ♘f6 2. ♙f4 e6 3. ♘f3
3...c5 4.e3 b6 5. ♘c3
3... ♙e7 4.h3 b6 5.e3 ♘e4
3...b6



4.e3 ♙b7 5. ♙d3
5. ♘bd2; 5.h3
5... ♙e7 6.h3 c5 7.c3 0-0
7...cxd4 8.cxd4
8. ♘bd2 cxd4 9.exd4 d6 10.0-0 ♘bd7
10... ♘c6
11. ♙e1

The Queen's Indian Defence is characterised by the plan of ... ♘f6, ...e7-e6, ... b7-b6, ... ♙b7, ...c7-c5 and ...d7-d6, followed by the development of the

queen's knight to d7 or c6 and exchanging pawns on d4. It is usually the choice of Nimzo-Indian players. Black's idea is to build a solid position, with the a8-g2 diagonal open for his bishop. The pawns on e6 and d6 cover important squares and Black prepares to play ...e7-e5 in the future, with the plan of ...♖e8 and ...♗f8. White has several plans at his disposal: to play a2-a4, bring the bishop to h2, the rook to e1 and the queen to e2 or b3. White's queen's knight can go via c4 to e3 and g4; the king's knight sometimes goes to g5 to provoke weaknesses on the kingside. There is also the plan of playing on the queenside with c3-c4, b2-b4, ♖c1 and c4-c5.

If Black exchanges pawns on d4, White can recapture either way, with the e-pawn or the c-pawn. As a matter of fact, GM Prié, one of the greatest specialists in the London System, recommends taking with the c-pawn, although there are some exceptions where it is better to take with the e-pawn.

We shall examine some selected games illustrating the main plans and options for both sides and we shall conclude this chapter with some little-known alternatives, such as the idea of the Czech GM Blatny, who castles queenside, and some ideas for Black involving ...♗e4.

Game 25

Queen's Indian

Gata Kamsky

2718

Sergey Tiviakov

2648

Montreal 2007 (4)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f3 e6 3.♗f4 c5 4.e3 ♗e7 5.c3

When Black plays ...♗e7 White should play h2-h3, to prevent the exchange of the f4-bishop after ...♗h5. It was therefore better to play 5.h3.

5...b6

5...♗h5 was good.



6.h3 Bb7 7.Nbd2

Or 7.Qe2!? (7.Qd3 is normal) 7...0-0 8.0-0 d6 (8...d5!=, exploiting the absence of the bishop from d3) 9.a4 a6 10.Nbd2 cxd4 11.exd4 Bbd7 12.Qe1 Qe8 13.Qd3 (reaching a theoretical position with a tempo less for White) 13... Rc7 14.Qh2 Qf8 15.Nc4 Qd5 (15...Qc6 16.Ne3 Rc7 17.Nd2 b5 18.Rb3= Burmakin-Zeller, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2014) 16.Ne3 Qc6 17.Nd2 (17.Rc2±) 17...g6 18.Rc2 ½-½ Spassky-Portisch, Geneva 1977 (by transposition).

7...cxd4 8.exd4

White can recapture with either pawn. Prié recommends 8.cxd4, as we shall see further on.

8...d6 9.Qd3 Bbd7

The alternative is to develop the knight on c6, which we shall look at later: 9...0-0 10.0-0 Nc6.

10.0-0

White has several plans and sometimes the move order is unimportant. The same can also be said for Black.

10.Rc2 0-0 11.0-0 Qe8 12.Qc2 (12.Qh2 a6 13.Nc4 Qf8 14.Nfd2 Rc7 15.Ne3 Ng6 16.Qfe1= Bauer-Graf, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2012) 12...a6 13.Qfe1 Qc6 14.a4 Qf8 15.Qd3 (15.Qh2±) 15...Rc8 16.Nc4 Qd5 17.Qg3 d7± Radlovacki-Laketic, Kragujevac 2013.

10...0-0 11.Qe1 Qe8

The alternative is 11...Rc7; then 12.a3, 12.Qh2 and 12.Rc2 are all interesting. Practice has seen:

A) 12.Qg3!? Qfe8 13.Nf1 (the knight is heading for e3, although normally it travels via c4; 13.Rc2±; 13.Qc1±) 13...Qf8 14.Ne3 Qc6 15.c4 Rb7 16.Qc1 (16.Nd2±) 16...Qac8 17.Qe2 d5 18.cxd5 Nxd5 19.Nc4= Pakleza-Piorun,

Chorzow ch-POL 2013;

B) 12. ♖c4 ♜fe8 13. ♖g5 ♘f8 (13...h6=) 14. ♙c2 h6??



analysis diagram

A horrible blunder; 14...g6= was correct. 15. ♘h7+ 1-0 Perez-Mejuto, Ferrol 2014; after 15... ♙h8 16. ♖xf7 is mate;

C) 12.c4 ♜fe8 with the alternatives:

C1) 13. ♜c1 ♜ac8 and now:

C11) 14.b4 ♘f8 15.a3 ♙b8 (15...e5=) 16. ♘f1 (16. ♙b3) 16... ♙a8 (16...e5=) 17. ♙b3± Nogueiras-Quesada, Havana 2010;

C12) 14. ♖b1?! ♘f8?! (14...e5! 15.dxe5 dxe5 16. ♖xe5 ♘c5) 15. ♘h2 ♙b8 (15...e5=) 16. ♖c3 a6± Karjakin-Leko, Beijing 2013.

C2) 13. ♙c2 ♘f8 14. ♙c3 (14. ♘h2) 14... ♜ac8 15. ♜ac1 ♙b8 16. ♘g3 (16. ♘h2) 16... ♙a8 17.b4 g6= De Prado-Quesada, Ferrol 2010.

11...h6 has also been played: 12.a4 a6 13. ♙e2 ♜e8 14. ♘h2 ♘f8 15. ♖e4 ♖xe4 16. ♘xe4 ♘xe4 17. ♙xe4= Soos-Csom, Koszeg 2000.

12.a4

Again the alternatives were 12.a3, 12. ♙e2 or 12. ♘h2.

12...a6 13. ♘h2

Here one of the co-authors has employed another idea: 13. ♖g5!? ♙c7 14. ♙e2 (14. ♘h2 transposes to the note at move 14) 14... ♘f8 15. ♖ge4 ♖xe4 16. ♘xe4 ♖xe4 17. ♖xe4 ♙c6= De Prado-Sanchez, Cambre 2013.

White has also tried 13. ♖c4 ♙c7 14. ♘g3 (14. ♘f1 ♘f8 15. ♘g3 ♖c6= Popchev-Kersten, Marianske Lazne 2006; 14. ♘h2 ♘d5 15. ♖e3 ♘b7 16. ♖c4 ♘d5 ½-½ Knezevic-Rajkovic, Vrnjacka Banja 1987) 14... ♘c6 15. ♙e2± Berezjuk-Petrik, Slovakia tt 2016.

13... ♖c7

Black has also played 13... ♗f8 14. ♗c4 (14. ♖b3±) 14... ♗g6 15. a5 b5 16. ♗b6 ♗b8= Kotic-Gonda, Dunaharaszti 2013, and 13... ♗f8 14. ♗c4 ♖c7 15. ♖e2 g6 16. ♗cd2 (16. ♗g5±) 16... ♗g7 17. ♗e4 (17. a5±) 17... ♗xe4 18. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 19. ♖xe4 ♗f6= Lenic-Dervishi, Bratto 2009.

14.c4



One of the plans for White is to play c3-c4, b2-b4, ♖c1 and c4-c5, to exploit the pin on the d6-pawn. Another idea is to play ♖e2 and ♗g5-e4.

The following year Kamsky himself tried to improve with 14. ♖b3 ♗f8 15. ♗e2!? ♗c6 (15...h6 16. ♗ae1 ♗c6 17. ♖a3 (17.c4!?) 17...b5 18.a5 ♗d5= Cacho-Moreno, Linares 2015) 16.c4 ♖b7 17. ♗ae1?! (17. ♖c2±) 17...d5= Kamsky-Carlsen, Moscow 2008.

GM Kotic likes to play 14. ♗g5!? (14. ♗c1) 14...h6 and now:

A) 15. ♗gf3 ♗f8 16. ♖e2 ♖c6 17. ♗c4 (17. ♗c2) 17... ♗ac8 (17... ♗d5=) 18. ♗e3± Kotic-Mihok, Budapest 2008;

B) 15. ♗ge4 ♖c6 (15... ♗xe4=) 16. ♖f3 ♗xe4?! (16... ♖c7=) 17. ♗xe4 d5 18. ♗c2± Kotic-Drasko, Belgrade 1994.

14...a5!?

A move directed against b2-b4 by White. It seems better to play 14...e5. Possibly this explains why Kamsky varied with 14. ♖b3 against Carlsen, since it seems that Black equalises: 15.dxe5 (15.a5=) 15...dxe5 16. ♗xe5 ♗d6 17. ♗ef3 ♗xh2+ 18. ♗xh2 ♗xe1+ 19. ♖xe1 ♗e8 20. ♖b1 h6 21. ♖c2 ♗c5= and Black has very good compensation.

15. ♗b1!



Kamsky recycles his knight towards the square b5, via a3 or c3. This is an idea to keep in mind, exploiting the squares that our opponent weakens.

15... ♖d8 16. ♗c3

White is a bit better, with a space advantage, pressure on d6 and the square b5.

16. ♗a3 d5 17.b3± was also good.

16...d5 17.b3

Kamsky does not want to leave his queen's pawn isolated.

If 17.cxd5 then 17... ♗xd5=, or if 17. ♗b5 then 17...dxc4 18. ♗xc4 ♖c8 19. ♖c1 ♗b4=.

17. ♖c1 dxc4 18. ♗xc4 ♖c8 19. ♗d3± was also playable.

17... ♗b4 18. ♖c1 ♖c8 19. ♗e3!

From here the rook can go to the queenside on c3 or the kingside on g3 and it also restrains Black's ...e6-e5 break.

19... ♗f8 20. ♗b5 ♗e4 21. ♖c2 ♖e7

21... ♗g6± was a little better.

22. ♖c1 ♗d7?!

It was better to play 22...f6±.

23. ♗a7! ♖a8 24.cxd5! exd5 25. ♗c6 ♗xc6 26. ♖xc6



White has a clear advantage: he commands the c-file, the h2-b8 diagonal and in particular the c7-square. He will soon invade with his rooks and bishops. The pawns on b6 and d5 are weak and will eventually fall. Once more it is worth noting that Black's bishop plays the role of a mere spectator, as in many other lines when it is placed on g7, in comparison with its opponent on h2.

26... ♖f8 27. ♜e2 ♜ae8 28. ♜ec2

It was better to play 28. ♞b5±, and if 28...f6 then 29. ♜c7.

28...h6 29. ♞f4

Once again 29. ♞b5 was better, with a clear advantage to White.

29...g5 30. ♞c7 ♜ef6

Or 30...f6 31. ♞xb6±.

31. ♞f5



White's advantage is decisive: the invasion of the eighth rank and the capture of the weak pawns will grant him victory in a few moves.

31... ♖g7 32. ♕d6 ♕xd6 33. ♖xd6 ♗f8 34. ♖c8 ♖xc8 35. ♗xc8 ♗e8 36. ♖xb6 h5 37. ♗d8 ♖e2 38. ♕d3

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the classic Queen's Indian set-up against the London with ...b7-b6, ...♗b7, ...c7-c5, ...e7-e6 and ...d7-d6 and the development of the black queen's knight to d7. In another game we shall see the plan with ...♗c6. White recaptured on d4 with the e-pawn (we shall cover the recapture with the c-pawn in another game) and employed one of the traditional plans in such positions of playing a2-a4, ♗h2, ♖e1 and then the idea of c3-c4, to play on the queenside with ♖c1, b2-b4 and c4-c5. Black prevented b2-b4 by playing ...a6-a5, but this left the square b5 weak, which Kamsky exploited in masterly fashion with the plan of ♗d2-b1-c3-b5. Then he invaded along the c-file, which, combined with the power of the bishop on h2, gave him a decisive advantage. Once again White wins by occupying a file on the queenside (the b- or the c-file) with the help of the bishop on h2.

Game 26

Queen's Indian

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2282

Pablo Fernandez Borrego

2411

Gallego 2012 (5)

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♗f3 e6 3. ♕f4 c5

The immediate 3...b6 is playable, e.g. 4.e3 ♗b7 5. ♕d3 ♕e7 6.h3 c5 7. ♗bd2 ♗c6 8.c3 d6 9. ♕h2 0-0 10.0-0 ♖c8 11.a4 ♖e8 12. ♗c4 ♕f8? (12...d5±) 13.dxc5 bxc5 14. ♗xd6 ♕xd6 15. ♕xd6± Sandipan-Diaz, Sabadell 2014.

4.e3 ♗c6 5. ♗bd2

Here 5. ♗c3 is interesting. It has not been played often, but was tested in 2014 by Rapport and Vitiugov: 5...cxd4 (5...♗a5 6. ♗d2± Van Dijk-Fedorchuk, Maastricht 2011) 6.exd4 ♗b4 (6...♕e7 7.a3 0-0 8. ♕d3 b6 9.0-0 ♕b7 10. ♖e1 ♖c8 11. ♗e2 Hort-Am. Rodriguez, Amsterdam 1987) 7. ♕d3 0-0 (7...♗d5 8. ♕d2 ♗xc3 9.bxc3 ♕e7 10.h4!? (10. c4!; 10.0-0) 10...h6 11.0-0 d5 12.h5 0-0

Rapport-Naiditsch, Nagykanizsa 2014) 8.0-0 ♖e7 9.♗e4 (9.♗b5!? is interesting, e.g. 9...d5 (9...d6 10.c4±) 10.♖c7 ♜d7 11.♗e5 ♗xe5 12.♗xe5 a6 13.♗c3) 9...♜b6?! (9...♗d5) 10.♗xf6+ ♗xf6 11.c3!? (11.♗d6!±) 11... ♜xb2∞ Vitiugov-Lysyj, Kazan 2014.

5...b6 6.c3 cxd4 7.exd4 ♗e7 8.h3 ♗b7 9.♗d3 0-0 10.0-0 d6



By a roundabout route we have reached the main position. In the previous game we saw ...♗bd7.

11.♜e2

The alternative is 11.♞e1 (11.♗h2) 11...♞e8 12.♗c4. This is another typical plan for White: from c4 the knight puts pressure on d6, supports a4-a5 and can go to the kingside via e3 and g4 (12.♞c1±; 12.♗h2±). Let us see what Black can do:

A) 12...♗f8 (if 12...h6 then 13.a4± or 12...b5 13.♗e3 a6 14.a4±) 13.♜e2 (13.a4±) 13...h6 (13...e5? 14.dxe5 b5 15.♗xd6 ♗xd6 16.♞ad1!±) 14.a4±;

B) 12...♗d5!? 13.♗g3 (13.♗h2) 13...g6?! (13...♜d7±) 14.a4 a6 15.h4 (a typical plan against ...g7-g6; 15.♜e2±) 15...♗a5!? 16.♗cd2 (16.♗xa5 bxa5 and although White is better Black has counterplay on the b-file) 16...♗f6 17.b4! ♗c6 18.♗g5 ♗h5 19.♗h2 e5 (19...♗xg5 20.hxg5 ♜xg5 21.♗e4) 20.d5 (20.b5 axb5 21.♗xb5±) 20...♗b8 21.♜f3 ♞f8 22.♗xh7 ♜xh7 23.♜xh5+ ♜g7± Christiansen-Peter, Bad Mergentheim 1988.

11...♞e8

The most natural move, although others have also been tried:

A) 11...♜c7 12.♞fe1 ♞fe8 13.♗h2 (13. a3±; 13.♞ad1±) 13...♗f8 14.a4 (14.♗e4!?±; 14.♗g5!?±; 14.♗c4!?±) 14...♗e7 15.a5± Gholami-Sanal, Doha 2015;

B) 11... ♖d7 12. ♖fe1 (12. ♗e4±) 12... ♖fe8 13. ♖ad1± Kotic-Draskovic, Podgorica 2014.

12. ♖fe1 ♗f8 13. ♗e4

13. ♗g5!? has been tried here:

A) 13... ♗e7 14. ♗f4 (14. ♗h4±) 14... ♗f8 15. ♗g5 ♗e7 16. ♗f4 ½-½ Danielsen-Thorhallson, Kopagovur 2012;

B) 13...h6 14. ♗h4 ♗e7 15. ♖ad1 (15. ♗g3±) 15...a6 16. ♗b1 ♗h5?! 17.d5! (17. ♗xe7 ♗xe7 Hu-Li Ruofan, Canberra 2008) 17...exd5 18. ♗d3 g6 (18... ♗xh4 19. ♗h7+ ♖f8 20. ♗h8 mate) 19. ♗xd5 ♗a5 (19... ♗xh4 20. ♖xe8+ ♗xe8 21. ♗xh4±) 20. ♗d4±.

13... ♗xe4



14. ♗xe4

It was better to recapture with the bishop, maintaining a comfortable white advantage, but it seems that the capture with the queen weakens Black's castled position more quickly.

14. ♗xe4 h6 (14...g6 invites White to carry out the attractive plan of h3-h4-h5: 15.h4±) 15. ♖ad1±.

14...g6 15. ♗g5?!

15. ♗h2 is better, e.g. 15... ♗g7 (15... ♗a5 16. ♗e2±; 15... ♗b4 16. ♗xb7 ♗xd3 17. ♖e2±) 16. ♖ad1 ♖c8 17. ♗g4, with a slight advantage to White. Instead, 15.h4 can now be answered with 15... ♗e5, which is why it was better to recapture on e4 with the bishop.

15... ♗c7 16. ♗h4 ♗e7!

The knight is heading for f5, where it will strengthen Black's defences on the kingside and also harass the white queen. Black has now equalised.

17. ♖d2 ♗f5 18. ♜f4

It was better to play 18. ♜g4 ♗g7 19. ♜ad1 (19. ♖e4 ♗xd4 20. cxd4 f5 21. ♜h4 fxe4 22. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 23. ♜xe4) 19...h6 20. ♗f4 ♜ad8.

18... ♗g7 19.g4?!

A dubious move, to say the least. White wants to dislodge the knight from its good square on f5, but in doing so he gives up his dark-squared bishop and exposes his king by opening the h1-a8 diagonal. It was better to play 19. ♖e4 e5 20. dxe5 dxe5 21. ♜g4 h6 22. ♗f6 ♗xe4 23. ♗xe4 ♗xf6 24. ♗xf5 h5 25. ♜g3 ♜ad8.



19...h6! 20.gxf5 hxg5 21. ♜xg5 exf5 22. ♜h2?

This further error gives Black a clear advantage. It was necessary to play 22. ♗b5 ♜xe1+ (22... ♗c6) 23. ♜xe1 ♗f8 24.h4 ♜d8, with a balanced position. Black has the bishop pair and a weakness on d6, whereas White has a weakness on h4.

22... ♗e4?!

Here 22... ♜h7! was good, e.g. 23. ♜g3 ♗h6 24. ♖f3 ♜c6 25. ♖h4.

23. ♗b5

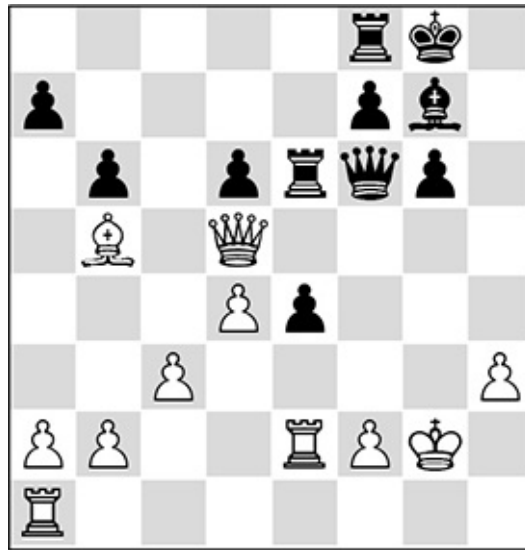
If 23. ♗xe4 then 23...d5+ 24. ♜g3 ♜xg3+ 25. ♜xg3 fxe4 26. ♖f1 f5 27. ♖e3 ♜ad8 28.a4 ♗f8.

It was better to play 23. ♖xe4 fxe4 (23...d5+? 24. ♖g3) 24. ♗b5 (24. ♗xe4 d5+) 24...d5+ 25. ♜g2 ♜ed8 26.h4 ♜d6 27. ♜h1, with a balanced position.

23... ♜e6?!

If 23... ♗c6 then 24. ♗xc6 ♜xc6 25.h4 ♜xe1 26. ♜xe1 ♜e8 27. ♜xe8+ ♜xe8, with equality; it was better to play 23...d5+ 24. ♜g1 ♜ed8, when Black maintains a slight advantage.

24. ♖xe4 fxe4 25. ♗d5 ♖f8 26. ♔g2 ♗e7 27. ♖e2 ♗f6



28. ♖e3

Here 28. ♖ae1! ♗f3+ 29. ♔g1 ♗xh3 (29... ♖f6 30. ♗xe4) 30. ♖xe4 was better, with equality.

28... ♗f4?

28... ♗h6 29. ♖g3 was better.

29. ♖ae1?

Overlooking 29. ♗c6! ♖f6 30. ♖f1 ♗h6 31. ♗xe4 ♗g5+ 32. ♖g3 ♗d2 33. ♗b1 and White has the advantage, since he has an extra pawn and can repel Black's attack.

29... ♖f6 30. ♖1e2 ♖f5 31. ♗c6?

The white queen will be cut off from the kingside. It was necessary to play 31. ♗b3 d5 32. ♗d1.

31...d5



Now the white king is left unprotected and Black has a winning attack.

32. ♖g3 ♗f6 33. ♖g4 ♜f3+ 34. ♔h2 ♗g5 35. ♖g2 ♗f4+ 36. ♖g1 ♜xh3 37. ♜d7 e3

It would have been more direct to choose the plan of ... ♔g7 and ... ♖h8, either now or on the following move.

38. f3 ♗g3 39. ♖xe3 a6

Black will be able to win White's queen if the bishop ceases to protect it. But it was stronger to play 39... ♜h6 40. ♖e1 ♜h4 41. ♖e3 ♗f2+ 42. ♖xf2 ♜g5+, and wins.



40. ♗d3

Or 40. ♗c6 ♜h6—+, with the same plan as in the previous note.

40... ♗h2+ 41. ♖f2 ♖xf3+ 42. ♖xf3 ♜xd7 43. ♖xh2 ♜g7 44. ♖fh3 ♜g4 45. ♖h7+ ♜f6 46. ♖2h3 ♜e7 47. ♖e3+ ♜d6 48. ♖f3 ♜g5 49. ♖h2

Or 49. ♖hxf7 ♗xf7 50. ♖xf7 ♘d2+ 51. ♙e2 ♘xb2 52. ♖f6+ ♔e7 53. ♖xg6 ♘xc3 54. ♖g4 b5–+.

49... ♖e8 50. ♖g2 ♘d2+ 51. ♙g1

If 51. ♙g3 then 51... ♘e1+ 52. ♖gf2 f5–+.

51... ♘d1+

0-1

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the same set-up for Black as in the previous game, but with the knight developed to c6. I think that it is not as well placed there as on d7, because the b7-bishop is blocked. White chose the plan with ♘e2 and ♙e4. Other ideas include ♙c4 and a2-a4 or ♙g5, as we saw in the analysis. In the game White should have recaptured on e4 with the bishop rather than the queen, thus maintaining a slight advantage. Black equalised with the plan of ...♙e7-f5 and after White's erroneous g2-g4 and ♙h2 Black gained the advantage, but he continued inaccurately, after which anything could have happened.

Game 27

Queen's Indian

Eric Prié

2526

Sergio Garza Marco

2398

Castell de Sant Ferran 2008 (6)

1.d4 e6 2. ♘f3 ♘f6 3. ♙f4 b6 4.e3 ♙b7 5. ♙d3 c5 6.c3 ♙e7 7.h3 0-0 8. ♙bd2 cxd4 9.cxd4



White is one of the top specialists in this system, and he prefers to recapture with the c-pawn rather than the e-pawn, since now White can play on the c-file. White can also play in the centre by advancing with e3-e4 and even attack the black king after e4-e5. Black usually exchanges on d4, but even if Black delays this, White eventually plays e3-e4, after which Black then exchanges on d4, reaching similar positions. A further advantage for White is that if Black exchanges on d4 very early in the game, White can take advantage of this to develop the queen's knight to c3 instead of d2.

9... ♖c6

This is the most popular move, but let us examine some alternatives:

A) 9... ♖a6!? is interesting. The idea of exchanging the bishop on a6 is very typical of the Queen's Indian, but it is perhaps better to do so directly, without losing a tempo. There are two options now:

A1) 10. ♖xa6 ♖xa6 11.0-0 (11.a3 ♖c8 12.0-0 ♖b7 or 11.♖e2 ♖c8 12.0-0 ♖b7 13.♖ac1) 11... ♖c8 (11... ♖b4 12.♖e2 ♖c6 13.♖ac1 ♖c8 14.♖b5±) 12.♖e2 ♖b7 13.a3 ♖ac8;

A2) 10.♖e2 ♖xd3 11.♖xd3 ♖c8 12.a3 ♖a6 (12... ♖b7 13.0-0 ♖c6 14.♖ac1 ♖ac8 15.♖g5±) 13.♖xa6 ♖xa6 14.♖c1 ♖ac8 15.♖e2±.

B) 9...d6 10.0-0 ♖bd7 is also possible and now 11.♖c4!± is good, although other ideas have also been seen, such as:

B1) 11.♖e2 ♖d5 12.♖h2 ♖b4 13.♖c4 (13.♖b5 a6 14.♖a4 b5 15.♖b3 Vafiadis-Charkhalashvili, Kavala 2011) 13...a6 (13...d5 14.♖b5 a6 15.♖a4 b5 16.♖d1±) 14.a3 d5 15.♖b3 ♖c6 16.♖fc1± Bagheri-Lputian, Warsaw 2005;

B2) 11.♖h2 ♖e8 12.♖e2 (12.♖c4±) 12... ♖f8 13.♖fd1 e5 14.dxe5 dxe5 15.e4± ½-½ Rudolf-Nagy, Szombathely 2010;

B3) 11.a3 ♖e8 12.♖e2 (12.♖h2±) 12...a6 13.e4 (13.♖h2±) 13... ♖f8

14. ♖h2 ♗g6 15. ♖ac1 ♗h5 16. ♔e3 e5 17. dxe5 (17. ♖b1!±) 17...dxe5 18. b4 (18. ♖c4±) 18...♗hf4 19. ♖c4 b5 20. ♖a2 ♗g5 De Prado-Paramos, Spain tt 2009.

10.0-0

It is more precise to play 10.a3! (to prevent 10...♗b4) 10...a6 11.0-0, with the following examples:



analysis diagram

A) 11...b5 12.e4 (12. ♔e2±) 12...d6 13. ♔e2± Alcaraz-Kovacevic, Mislata 2011;

B) 11...d6 12. ♔e2 b5 13. ♖fc1 (13. ♖ac1±) 13...♖e8 14. ♖c2± Bharat-Karlsson, Reykjavik 2012;

C) Against 11...d5 Kamsky gained a good victory after 12. ♖c1 h6 13. ♗e5 ♗xe5 14. dxe5 ♗e4 15. ♗f3 (15. ♗g4!±) 15...b5 16. ♗d4 ♗b6 17. ♗g4 ♗h8 18. f3 ♗c5 19. ♖b1 (19. ♖xc5! ♗xc5 20. ♗xe6 fxe6 21. ♗g6 ♖f5 22. g4) 19...♗d7 20. ♗h5 ♗g8 21. ♖xh6! gxh6 22. ♗xh6 f5 23. ♗xe6 ♗f7 24. ♖xf5 1-0 Kamsky-Gundavaa, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013.

10... ♖c8

It was better to play 10...♗b4 11. ♖e2 a6 12.a3 ♗bd5 13. ♖g3 b5.

11.a3 d6

It is unusual for Black to play the Queen's Indian and then follow up with ...d7-d5, but it needs to be considered and later we shall also see it with the white knight on c3.

11...d5 and now:

A) 12.b4 ♖d6 13. ♗e5 (13. ♖xd6 ♗xd6) 13...♗e7 14. ♗a4 a6 15. ♖ac1 Kamsky-Leko, Beijing 2012;

B) 12. ♖e2 ♕d6 13. ♕xd6 ♖xd6 14. ♖fc1 ♖c7 15. ♖c3 ♖fc8 16. ♖ac1 h6
 ½-½ Spiridonov-Georgiev, Pernik 1983;

C) 12. ♖c1! ♕d6 13. ♘e5 ♘e7 (13... ♖e7 14. ♖f3±) 14. ♖xc8 (14. ♖a4±)
 14... ♕xc8 15. ♖c2± Hoang Thanh Trang-Bokros, Hungary tt 2011/12.

12. ♖e2



White has a slight advantage after the opening; he can play on the queenside with b2-b4 and ♕a6, and on the kingside with e3-e4 and e4-e5.

12. ♖c1 has also been played, for instance: 12...a6 13.b4 e5 14. ♕h2 ♘xb4 15.axb4 e4 16. ♕e2 (16. ♘xe4 ♘xe4 17. ♖b3±) 16...exf3 17. ♕xf3 ♕xf3 18. ♖xf3 d5 Theofilopoulos-Maier, Rio Achaia 2013.

12... ♖c7

I do not think that this is the best square for the queen. Various other moves have been tried here:

12... ♘d7 13. ♘c4 (13. ♖ac1±) 13... ♘f6 14. ♖fc1 d5 (14... ♖d7±) 15. ♘ce5 ♘xe5 16. ♘xe5± Meins-Babula, Bremen 2013.

The continuation 12... ♖d7 seems to be the best, but White maintains a slight advantage: 13.e4 (better is 13. ♖fe1± or 13. ♖ad1±) 13... ♖fd8 14. ♕e3 (14. ♕b5) 14... ♖e8 15. ♖fe1 ♘a5 16.b4 ♘c6 17. ♕a6 (17. ♖ac1±) 17... ♕xa6 18. ♖xa6 ♖d7 Ponomariov-Carlsen, Moscow 2010.

Or 12... ♖c7!? 13. ♖ac1 (13. ♖ad1±; 13. ♖fe1±) 13... ♖d7 14. ♕h2 ♖fc8 15. ♖c2 (15. ♖cd1±) 15... ♘b8 16. ♖fc1 ♖xc2 17. ♖xc2 ♖xc2 18. ♕xc2 ♖c6 Assmann-Larsen, Lugano 1989.

13. ♖ac1 ♖b8

The queen is not well placed on b8. It was better to unpin with 13... ♖d7 14.e4±

.

14. ♖h2 ♜a8

We saw the same plan in the Réti Reversed, in the chapter on the King's Indian, but here it does not seem very appropriate, especially once Black has played ... d6-d5.

15. e4 d5?



This is a clear strategic error, closing the long diagonal and giving White a free hand to attack the black king. It was better to play 15... ♜fd8±.

16. e5! ♞d7 17. h4

White takes advantage of the absence of black pieces from the kingside to launch an attack on the black king. The idea is support ♞g5 and create weaknesses. Here 17. ♙f4 was also good.

17... ♜ce8?

It was better to play 17... ♞a5!? 18. b4! (18. ♙b1 ♜xc1 19. ♜xc1 ♜c8) 18... ♞c4 (18... ♞c6 19. ♙b1±) 19. ♞xc4 dxc4 20. ♙xc4, still with advantage to White though.

18. ♙b1 a5 19. ♞d3

The threat is simply to mate on h7! The idea is to provoke ...g7-g6 and then follow up with h4-h5 and open up Black's castled position.

19... g6

19... f5 is worse, e.g. 20. exf6 ♞xf6 21. ♜fe1 ♙a6 22. ♙c3 ♜c8 23. ♙e3 (23. ♞g5 ♞d8 24. ♙h3) 23... ♞d8 24. ♙c7.

20. ♙e3 f5

Black tries to close the b1-h7 diagonal but weakens his position; however, after 20... ♙a6 21. ♜fe1 ♜c8 22. ♙h6 White would retain a clear advantage, with a dangerous attack.



21. ♕f4?!

It was better to capture on f6 and open the position: 21.exf6 ♕xf6 22.h5 gxh5 23. ♖g5 ♕xd4 24. ♕xh7+ ♔h8 25. ♔h3, with a decisive advantage.

21...a4 22.g3

Prié wants to play ♔g2, ♖h1 and h4-h5. There were several good alternatives for White, such as the immediate 22.h5 (which was good either now or in the next few moves), 22. ♕h6 or 22. ♖g5.

22...b5 23. ♕h6

It seems stronger to play the immediate 23.h5, e.g. 23... ♖a5 24.hxg6 hxg6 25. ♕h6 ♖c4 26. ♔f4 ♖f7 27. ♖g5 ♕xg5 28. ♔xg5 ♖f8 (28... ♔h7 29. ♔g2) 29. ♖f3, and wins.

23... ♖f7 24. ♖g5

Again 24.h5± was better.

24... ♕xg5 25. ♕xg5 ♖b6

It was better to play 25... ♖a5 26. ♖f3 ♕a6 27. ♕h6 b4 (27... ♖c4 28. ♔g5±) 28. ♖fe1 bxa3 29.bxa3 ♖b3±.

26. ♖f3 ♖c4 27. ♔f4 ♖xb2



28.h5!

Finally White decides to make this move, which opens up the position of Black's king and decides the game. The loss of the b2-pawn is not important, since White has a winning attack.

28... ♖c4

If 28... gxf5 then 29. ♔g2 (29. ♕f6) 29... ♗e7 30. ♕f6 ♗g6 31. ♖g5.

29.hxg6 hxg6 30. ♖g2 ♗b8

If 30... ♖h7 then 31. ♖h1 ♖xh1 (31... ♖ee7 32. ♕xe7 ♖xe7 33. ♖h4 ♖f7 34. ♖f6+ ♖e8 35. ♖h8+) 32. ♖xh1 ♖f8 33. ♕f6 ♖f7 34. ♖h7+ ♖e8 35. ♖h6, with mate in a few moves.

31. ♖h1

In the end the absence of the bishop from g7 and the open h-file prove decisive.



Black has no defence against the coming invasion by White's queen and rooks along the h-file.

31... ♖c7 32. ♕f6 ♖g7

32... ♖xf6 loses to 33. ♕h4 ♖ef8 (33... ♕g7 34.exf6) 34.exf6 and 32... ♖h7 33. ♖xh7 ♕xh7 34. ♖h1 is equally futile.

33. ♕h6 ♕f8

And Black resigned, rather than allow the mate after 34. ♕h8+ ♖g8 35. ♕xg8+ ♕xg8 36. ♖h8+ ♕f7 37. ♖g5 mate.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw White recapturing on d4 with 9.cxd4 (instead of 9.exd4, as in the previous game), which is recommended by GM Prié. The cxd4 recapture is even better for White if he is able to play ♖c3, as we shall see in the next game. White's idea is to play e3-e4 and e4-e5 and then attack the black king. He can also play on the queenside, on the c-file or with ♖a6. Black played ... ♖c6, which is the main line, although we also analysed some alternatives such as ... ♖a6, or ...d7-d6 and ... ♖bd7, or ...d7-d5. In the game, Black ended up in a bad position with the plan of ... ♕a8, as in the Réti Reversed. However, White should have opened the game with 21.exf6. It is worth noting the plan of g2-g3, ♖g2 and ♖h1 to open the h-file, which, since Black lacked a bishop on g7, proved decisive.

Game 28

Queen's Indian
Eric Prié

2532

Anatoly Karpov

2670

Ajaccio 2007 (25)
1.d4 ♖f6 2. ♖f3

With the 2. ♖f4 move order recommended here, Black has some interesting alternatives after 2...b6 3.e3 ♖b7 4. ♖f3 (4. ♖d2; 4.h3):



analysis diagram

A) 4...g6 5.♘bd2 (5.c4!? ♘g7 6.♘c3 d6 7.d5 Grischuk-Vachier-Lagrave, Berlin Wch blitz 2015) 5...♘g7 6.♘c4 0-0 7.0-0 c5 8.c3 Sergeev-Kovalenko, Lutsck 2015;

B) 4...♘h5 5.♘g5 (5.♘c3!?!; 5.♘g3!?) 5...h6 6.♘h4 g5 7.♘fd2 ♘g7 (7... ♘f4 8.exf4 gxh4 9.♘f3 e6∞) 8.♘g3± 8...d6 (8...♘f5 9.♘e5±) 9.h4 (9.e4±) 9...♘f5 10.hxg5 ♘xg3 11.fxg3∞ Prié-Weill, Montpellier 2015;

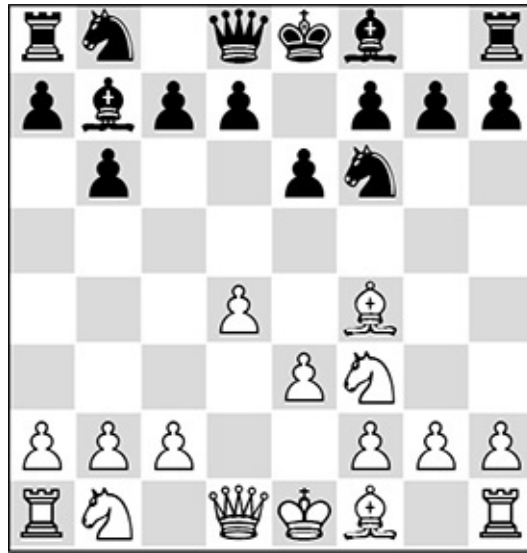
C) 4...h6!? 5.h3 (5.♘d3!?) 5...e6 6.♘d3 ♘d6 7.♘xd6 (7.♘c3!? ♘xf4 8.exf4 c5 9.♔e2∞ De Prado-Fernandez, Arteixo 2016) 7...cxd6 8.c4 0-0 9.♘c3 d5 Grischuk-Anton, Berlin Wch rapid 2015.

2...e6 3.♘f4 b6 4.e3

If 4.h3?! then 4...♘a6 or 4...♘d6.

4...♘b7

In a game by one of the co-authors, White was able to take advantage of the premature exchange on d4. After 4...c5 5.♘bd2 cxd4 6.exd4 ♕b7 7.♘d3 ♘e7 8.h3 0-0 9.a3 d6 10.0-0 ♘bd7 11.c4 (better were 11.♘h2, 11.♖e1 or 11.♔e2) 11...♖e8 12.♖e1± White had reached a theoretical position with an extra tempo, having played c2-c4 in one move, in De Prado-Sanchez, Spain tt 2011.



5.h3?!

This is an inaccuracy. Playing h2-h3 prematurely is one of the greatest mistakes made by players on the white side of the London System.

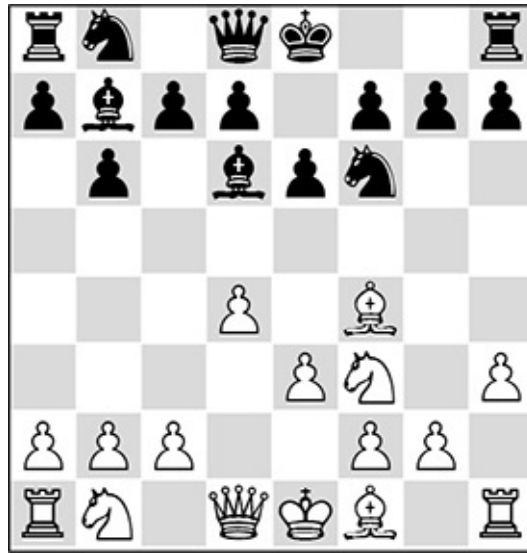
In this line the right moment to play h2-h3 is when Black has played ...♙e7 and threatens to play ...♘h5. The right move order is therefore 5.♙d3 ♙e7 (5... ♙d6!? is playable, e.g. 6.♙g3 (I think that it is better to respond with 6.♙xd6 cxd6 7.♘bd2 (7.c4) 7...d5 8.0-0 0-0 Maisuradze-Bollengier, Caen 2011) 6... ♙xg3 7.hxg3 c5 8.♘bd2 ♘c6 9.c3 ♚c7 10.dxc5 bxc5 11.♙a4 Appel-L'Ami, Germany Bundesliga 2013/14) and now after 6.h3, playing 6...♙d6 at the cost of a tempo is not so effective for Black, for instance: 6...♙d6 7.♙xd6 (7.♙e5 ♙xe5 8.dxe5 ♙e4 9.♙xe4 ♙xe4 10.♘c3 ♙b7 11.♙e2 0-0 12.0-0-0, with a complex position) 7...cxd6 8.♘bd2 (8.0-0 0-0 9.c4 d5 10.♘c3 dxc4 11.♙xc4 ♘c6 12.♙e2±) 8...d5 9.0-0 0-0 and now:

A) 10.c4 ♘c6 11.♙e1 ♙b4 12.♙f1 dxc4, Balogh-Kaunas, Budapest 1993;

B) 10.♙c1 ♘c6 11.c4 ♙b4 12.♙b1 dxc4 13.♙xc4 ♙e7 (13...♙c8) 14.a3 ♘c6± Hoang Thanh Trang-Vazquez, Jakarta 2013.

5...c5

A) Here 5...♙d6! is better.



analysis diagram

This is Black's idea, since now, having already moved his h-pawn, White does not have the option of retreating with ♕g3. Doubling Black's d-pawns is not problematic for Black, who is able to equalise. Let us look at a few examples after 6. ♕xd6 cxd6, and now:

A1) 7.a4 ♖c6 8. ♗bd2 d5 9. ♗b3 a5 Ortega-Naumkin, Gallipoli 2013;

A2) 7. ♗bd2 d5 (7...0-0 8. ♕e2 ♗c6 9.c3 d5 Rotunno-Petkov, Palmi 2012)
8. ♕d3 d6 9.c3 ♗bd7 10. ♖c2 ♖c7 11.a4 e5 Stripunsky-Ivanov, Saint Louis 2011;

A3) 7.c4 d5 8. ♗c3 0-0 9. ♖c1 and now:

A31) 9...d6 10. ♕e2 (10.cxd5 ♗xd5 11. ♗xd5 ♕xd5 12. ♕d3) 10...dxc4 11. ♕xc4 a6 Sanchez-Vazquez, Madrid 2007;

A32) 9...♖e7 10.a3 dxc4 11. ♕xc4 d6 12.0-0 ♗bd7 13. ♖e1 ♖fc8 14. ♗d2 a6 15. ♕e2 ½-½ Prié-Eingorn, Montpellier 2007.

B) Black has also tried 5...d6 6. ♗bd2 ♗bd7 7. ♕d3 g6!? (a mixture of the Queen's Indian and the King's Indian) 8. ♖e2 ♕g7 9.0-0 0-0 10. ♖fd1 (10.c3 ♖e7 11.e4 e5, Vager-Medvedkov, St Petersburg 1997; 10. ♕a6±; 10. ♖ad1±) 10...a6 11.a4 ♖e7± Prié-Delchev, Noyon 2008.

6.c3 cxd4

Other options are:

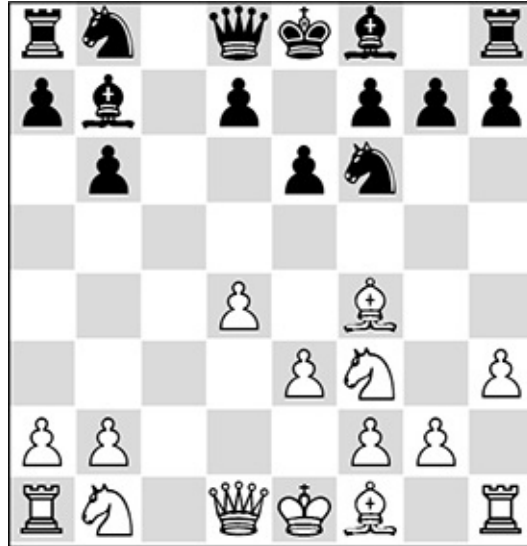
A) 6... ♕e7 7. ♕d3 0-0 8. ♗bd2 ♕a6 9. ♕xa6 ♗xa6 10. ♖e2 ♗b8 11.0-0 ♗c6 12. ♖fd1±;

B) 6...d5 7. ♕xb8 ♖xb8 8. ♕b5+±;

C) 6... ♗c6 7. ♗bd2 d5 8. ♗e5 ♗xe5 9.dxe5 (9. ♕xe5±) 9... ♗d7 10.h4 h5 11. ♖f3 ♖c7 12. ♖g3 0-0-0± (12...g6) Kamsky-Karjakin, Beijing 2013.

7.cxd4

Recapturing with the c-pawn is even better here, because White's queen's knight now has the option of going to c3 immediately or to d2, depending on what Black does.



7... ♖c6

Now 7... ♖a6 is inferior: 8. ♕xa6 ♗xa6 9. 0-0 ♕e7 10. a3 0-0 11. ♗d3±.

8.a3

To prevent the unpleasant idea of ... ♗b4 if we play the bishop to d3. Also playable is 8. ♗bd2 ♕e7 9. a3 0-0 10. ♕d3±.

8... ♕e7 9. ♗c3 d5?!

This move seems dubious to me: I think that it is bad to block in the b7-bishop. It seems to me to be better to leave the pawn on d7 and then play ...d7-d6 or ...d7-d5 later, as and when appropriate. The position now resembles a line of the Exchange Variation of the Slav Defence where Black has not equalised, due to placing his bishop on b7. It was better to play 9...0-0 10. ♕d3 ♖c8 11. ♗e2±.

10. ♕d3 0-0 11. 0-0 ♖c8 12. ♗e2 ♗a5

Black seeks counterplay against c4 and b3. If 12... ♕d6 then 13. ♕xd6 ♗xd6 14. ♖fc1 (14. ♖ac1±) 14... ♗e7 15. ♖c2 ♗e8± Camara-Dos Santos, Sao Paulo 1997.



13. ♖e5?!

A dubious move that allows Black to equalise. Ulf Andersson played better with 13. ♖d2 (13. ♖ac1±) 13... ♗d6 14. ♗xd6 ♜xd6 15. ♖ac1 ♜e7 16. ♖c2 ♗e8 17. b4 ♗c6 18. ♖fc1, with a comfortable advantage, which White steered to a win in Andersson-Ansell, Birmingham 2006.

13... ♗d7?!

It was better to play 13... ♗e4!, which would equalise for Black.

14. ♖fe1

White should acknowledge his error and retreat with 14. ♗f3±.

14... ♗xe5 15. ♗xe5 ♗c4 16. ♗g3 ♗d6

Black would equalise more easily by bolstering the knight on c4 with ...a7-a6 and ...b7-b5: 16...a6 17. ♖ec1 b5.

17. ♖ac1 ♜d7 18. ♖c2 ♗c4 19. ♖ec1 a6

It would be bad to play 19... ♗xb2 20. ♖xb2 ♗xa3 21. ♜d2 ♗xb2 22. ♜xb2 h6 23. ♖a1±.

Instead, it was more logical to support the knight with 19...b5, with equality.



20. ♖b1

White wants to play b2-b3 and evict the annoying knight from c4. Instead, 20.a4 b5 21.axb5 axb5 22.♖b1 was playable, with the same idea.

20...b5 21.b3 ♗d6

21...♗xa3 fails to 22.♕c7! ♔d8 23.♕a2 b4 24.♗xa3 bxa3 25.♕b1 ♕xc7 (25...h6 26.♕xb7) 26.♙xh7+ ♔h8 27.♕xc7 ♙a8 28.♙d3, with a clear advantage to White.

22. ♕c5!? ♕c6?

A bad move that allows White to make a combination. It was better to play 22...♗e4 23.♙xe4 ♙xc5 24.♙xh7+ ♔xh7 25.dxc5 and, although White has compensation, Black is not worse.

23. ♕xc6 ♙xc6

How should White continue now?



24. ♖xh7+!

Correct. White wins a pawn. A most surprising error on Karpov's part, although it should be said that this was a rapidplay game with only 25 minutes per player.

24... ♜xh7 25. ♖c2+

It was more precise to eliminate the knight first with 25. ♖xd6 ♜xd6 26. ♖c2+ ♜g8 27. ♖xc6, and White's advantage is clear.

25... ♗e4 26. ♖xc6 ♜xc6 27. ♖xc6 ♗xg3 28. fxg3 a5 29. ♖f2 ♜g6 30. ♖f3

White misses the opportunity to activate his knight with 30. ♗c3! ♖xa3 31. ♗xd5, again maintaining a clear advantage.

30... ♜b8 31. ♖c7 ♖d6 32. ♖c6 ♗e7 33. ♖c7

½-½

Prié decided to repeat moves; perhaps he was very short of time. White could retain the advantage with 33.g4, e.g. 33... ♜b7 34. ♖e2 ♜b8 35.g3 ♜b7 36.h4 ♜b8 37. ♖a6 b4 (37...a4 38.b4) 38.a4±.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the premature exchange 6...cxd4, which allows White to recapture with his c-pawn and have the option of developing his queen's knight to c3. Also remember the correct moment to play h2-h3, which is after Black has played ...♗e7. In the game Black could have equalised with ...♖d6. For White the move a2-a3 is quite thematic, to prevent the black knight leaping to b4 to harass the bishop on d3. I think that the black scheme with ...♖b7 followed by ...d7-d5 is dubious, because the black bishop on b7 remains passive. White can gain the advantage by doubling his rooks on the c-file, as in the Andersson game that we saw. Prié allowed Karpov to equalise after ♗e5, which in that position was not correct. Then Karpov allowed the shot ♖xh7+ and was almost lost.

Game 29

Queen's Indian

Pavel Blatny

2495

Josef Jurek

2320

Czechoslovakia tt 1990/91 (10)

1.d4 e6 2. ♗f3 ♗f6 3. ♖f4 b6 4.e3 ♖b7 5. ♗bd2 ♗e7 6. ♖d3!?



The Czech GM Pavel Blatny likes to play attacking positions and is one of the few players who do not play h2-h3. He has his own ideas, based on rapid queenside castling and an attack on the enemy king.

6...h5

This is the only way to try to punish White for not playing h2-h3. Black has also played 6...c5 7.c3 and now:

A) 7...h5 8.g3 d6 (8...h6 9.hxg3 h6 10.e2 c6 11.g4 d6 12.0-0-0 c7 13.g5± Blatny-De Francesco, Graz 2013) 9.e2 and now:

A1) 9...d7 10.0-0-0 h6 11.b1 c7 12.c2 (12.e4 a6 13.d5 e5 14.c4 g6 15.e1 g5 16.c2= Chernyshov-Krejci, Olomouc 2010) 12...h5 13.hxg3 0-0-0 14.g4 b8 15.e4= Blatny-Chachere, Gausdal 1992;

A2) 9...a6 10.0-0-0 (10.e4 cxd4 11.cxd4 c6 12.a3 d5 13.e5 0-0 14.0-0= Kamsky-Almasi, Beijing 2011) 10...d7 11.e4 (11.b1∞) 11...h5 12.hxg3 c4 13.c2 b5 14.g4 b4 (14...d5) 15.cxb4= Blatny-Forintos, Germany Bundesliga B 1991;

B) 7...d6 8.e2 0-0 9.h4!? c6 10.0-0-0 c8 11.b1 cxd4 12.exd4 e8 13.e4± Blatny-Pioch, Triberg 1991;

C) 7...cxd4 8.exd4 0-0 9.h4 a6 10.e2 xd3 11.xd3 c8 12.g5 c6 13.0-0-0 d6 with unclear play, Blatny-D.Gurevich, Biel 1991.

7.e2

This is Blatny's idea: he spends no time on retreating the bishop and quickly castles queenside. The main move here is 7.g3 but Black has no problems in this line and equalises easily, for example after 7...d6 (7...h6, 7...h5 8.hxg3 h6) 8.c3 d7 9.e2 (9.c2 g6 10.a4 a6 11.0-0 0-0= J.Polgar-Topalov, Linares 1994) 9...c5 10.a3 h6 11.e4 cxd4 12.xd4 h5 13.hxg3 a6 14.f4 c5 15.c2 c7 16.0-0-0= Kamsky-Rozentalis, Manila 1992.



7...d6

7... ♖xf4 8.exf4 c5 9.dxc5 (9.c3) 9...bxc5 10.0-0 0-0= Cinar-Maric, Varna 1994.

8.h4!?

White has no intention of castling on the kingside. 8. ♖g3 would take us back into known theory. Instead, 8.0-0-0 ♖d7 9. ♖e4 0-0 10.h4 ♖xf4 11.exf4 ♖e8 was unclear in Orlov-Renet, Pancevo 1985.

8... ♖xf4

Black eliminates the bishop before White can retreat it to h2. However, 8... ♖d7 9. ♖h2 ♖hf6 10.0-0-0 c5 11.c3 ♖c7 12. ♖b1 a6 13.e4 was about equal in Ortega-Dizdarevic, Formia 1995.

9.exf4 ♖d7 10.f5?!

It was better to play 10.0-0-0 0-0 11. ♖de1 and now if Black makes a natural move, such as 11... ♖e8 (11... ♖b8), intending to play to play ... ♖f8 or ... ♖f8, he lands in a mess after the sacrifice 12. ♖xh7+ ♖xh7 13. ♖g5+ ♖g8 (13... ♖xg5 14.hxg5+ ♖g8 15. ♖h5±) 14. ♖h5±.

10...exf5 11. ♖xf5 g6

It was better to play 11...0-0 12.0-0-0 ♖e8 13. ♖e4 (13. ♖xh7+ ♖xh7 14. ♖g5+ ♖g8 15. ♖h5 ♖f8 16. ♖xf7+ ♖h8 17. ♖h5+ ♖g8) 13... ♖xe4 14. ♖xe4 c5, with equality.

12. ♖e4

Here it is better to play 12. ♖d3 0-0 13.h5 (13. ♖a6 ♖xa6 14. ♖xa6 c5 15.0-0-0) 13... ♖e8 14.hxg6 hxg6 (14... ♖f6 15.gxf7+ ♖xf7 16. ♖e4 ♖f8 17.0-0-0±) 15.0-0-0 ♖f6 16. ♖f1 c5, with complex play.

12...c6?!

It was better to play 12...d5! 13. ♖d3 c5 14.c3 0-0 15.0-0-0 ♖e8±.



13.h5!

A thematic move to gain space and open the h-file, despite the fact that Black has not yet castled. White seizes the initiative and poses Black problems, because he threatens to take on g6. What should Black do?

13... ♖g8?

This is an error. It was essential to take the risk of castling, e.g. 13...0-0 14.0-0-0 ♕f6 15.hxg6 hxg6 16.♗d3 ♕g7 17.♕xg6 fxg6 18.♗xg6 ♖f4 (18... ♖f6 19.♗h7+ ♕f8 20.♗e4±) 19.♗xd6 ♖f6 20.♗g3 ♗f8, when White has three pawns for the piece and the attack.

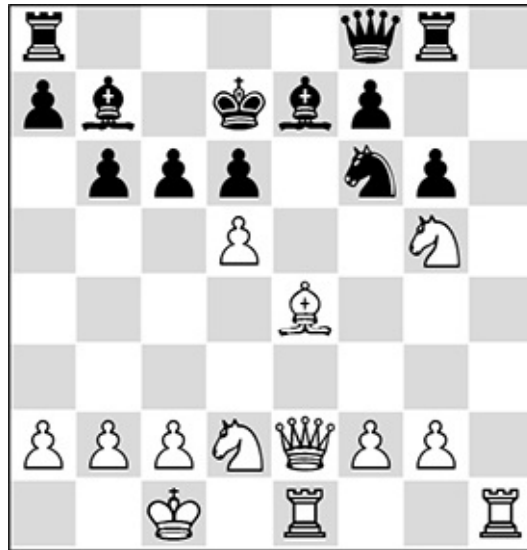
14.0-0-0 ♗f6 15.hxg6 hxg6 16. ♖de1

White has a clear advantage: the black king is still in the centre and the bishop on b7 is passive.

16... ♖d7!

The best move: the king flees but will find no safe haven. Black would be lost after 16... ♗xe4 17.♗xe4 ♕f8 (17... ♗d7 18.♗g5) 18. ♖h7 ♕g5 19.♗xg5 ♗xg5 20.♗f3 ♖g7 21. ♖h8+ ♖g8 22.♗h3.

17. ♗g5 ♗f8 18.d5!



Trying to expose the black king, which is still in the centre of the board.

18...cxd5

18... ♖xd5 fails to 19. ♕xd5 cxd5 (19... ♕xg5 20. ♖g4+ ♔c7 21. ♖xg5 cxd5 22. ♗e7+) 20. ♖h7 ♕d8 21. ♖f3 f5 22. ♖e3±.

19. ♕d3 ♗c8?

It was necessary to prevent the check on b5 with 19...a6 20. ♖df3 ♕d8 21. ♔b1 ♗c8 22. ♖d2 ♗b8 23. ♖b4 ♔a7 24. ♖a4. White retains the advantage, but Black is still in the game.

20. ♕b5+ ♗d8?

It was slightly more tenacious to play 20... ♕c6 but after, for instance, 21. ♖df3 ♕xb5 22. ♖xb5+ ♔c7 23. ♖d4 ♕e8 24. ♖a6 ♗b8 25. ♖b5 ♕d7 26. ♖xa7 ♖xa7 27. ♖xa7+ ♔xa7 28. ♗xe7+, White would have a decisive advantage. How should White continue now?



21. ♖e6!?

Very pretty, but less effective than the spectacular 21. ♜h7!!, with the unstoppable threat of 22. ♜xf7, while after 21... ♗xh7 22. ♗xh7 wins; the black queen cannot move away because of the mate on e7.

21... ♜xc2+

The only defence. If 21... ♜g7 then 22. ♜h8!, while 21... fxe6 allows 22. ♗xe6 mate!

22. ♜xc2 fxe6 23. ♗xe6+ ♖c8 24. ♗xf8 ♗xf8

White is the exchange up, the b7-bishop is passive and Black's pawns are doubled, but the game still carried on for a good while.

25. ♗b3 a6 26. ♗d3 ♖d7 27. ♗d4 ♗e4 28. f3 ♗g7 29. fxe4

It was better to play 29. ♜h7! ♗f6 30. ♗xg6 ♗xh7 31. ♗xh7 ♖c8+ 32. ♖d3 ♜e8 33. ♗f5+ ♖d8 34. ♗e6+, with a decisive advantage.

29... ♗xd4 30. ♜h7+ ♖g7 31. ♜xg7+ ♗xg7 32. exd5 ♗xd5 33. ♗xg6



33... ♗e5

Now 33... ♗xg2 fails to 34. ♗f5+ ♖c6 35. ♜g1, winning a piece, while if 33... ♗xa2 then 34. b3 ♗e5 35. g4 a5 36. ♗d3 ♖c6 37. ♜e4 wins.

34. g4 ♖e6 35. ♜f1 ♖e7 36. ♗d3 b5 37. g5 ♗e6 38. b3 ♗d7 39. b4 ♗e6 40. a3 ♗d5 41. g6 ♗g7 42. ♜e1+ ♗e5 43. ♗e4!

White either exchanges bishops or invades b7.

43... ♗e6

Or 43... ♗xe4+ 44. ♜xe4 ♖f6 45. ♜g4.

44. ♜f1 ♗c4 45. ♜f3 ♗f6 46. ♗b7 d5 47. ♜f5 ♖e6 48. ♗c8+ ♖e7 49. ♗xa6 ♖e6 50. ♗c8+ ♖e7 51. ♜f3 d4 52. ♗f5 ♗d5 53. ♜f1

SUMMARY

In this game we saw GM Blatny's idea of playing without h2-h3, thus allowing the London bishop to be exchanged. His plan is to play ♔e2, 0-0-0 and h2-h4, to attack on the kingside. It is an interesting option and worth considering if we want a complicated game, or we need to take risks in pursuit of a win. If Black is not well prepared he can come unstuck. In the game Black did not dare to castle on the kingside, but his king remained in the centre and came under a strong attack just the same.

Game 30

Queen's Indian

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2195

Marcial Garcia Carbo

2320

Spain tt 2009 (2)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f3 e6 3.♙f4 ♙e7

A) An interesting idea is the move order 3...c5 4.e3 and now:

A1) 4...cxd4 5.exd4 b6 6.♘bd2 (it is better to use the move order 6.♙d3 ♙e7 7.0-0 ♙a6 8.c4 ♘c6 9.♘c3± 9...d5 10.♔a4±) 6...♙e7 7.h3 0-0 8.♙d3 ♙a6 (this idea works better without losing a tempo with ...♙b7) 9.♙xa6 (9.c4 ♘c6 10.a3 d5) 9...♘xa6 10.0-0 b5 11.c3 ♘c7 12.a4= Kamsky-Topalov, Sofia 2007.

A2) 4...b6 5.♘c3!.



analysis diagram

This move gives White the advantage. Let us view a few examples:

A21) 5...cxd4 6.♘b5! (with the threat of 7.♘c7; this is better than 6.♘xd4 ♙b4 7.♙f3 (7.♘b5±) 7...d5 8.♘b5 (8.♙d3±) 8...♘a6 9.a3 ♙xc3+ 10.♘xc3 0-0 11.♙g5± Sammour Hasbun-Akobian, Saint Louis 2013, or 6.exd4 ♙b7 7.♙d3 ♙e7 8.0-0 0-0 9.h3 a6 10.♙e1= Nguyen Thi May-Batchimeg, Tagaytay City 2013) and now:

A211) 6...d6 7.♙xd4± 7...♘d5? (7...♘c6 8.♘xd6+ ♙xd6 9.♙xd6±; 7...e5? 8.♘xe5 dxe5 9.♙xe5+ ♙e7 10.♘c7+) 8.♘xd6+ ♙xd6 9.♙xg7 ♙d7 (9...♙f8 10.♙b5+) 10.♙xd6 ♙xd6 11.e4+- Ortega-Farago, Montecatini Terme 2000;

A212) 6...♘d5 7.♙xd4! (better than 7.♘d6+? ♙xd6 8.♙xd6 dxe3= Bozic-Cabrilo, Vrnjacka Banja 2007, but 7.♙d6 is playable, e.g. 7...a6 (7...dxe3? 8.♙c4) 8.♙xf8 ♙xf8 9.♘bxd4±) and now:



analysis diagram

A2121) 7...♘c6 8.♙a4 (8.♘d6+?! ♙xd6 9.♙xg7 ♙b4+ 10.c3 ♙xc3+ 11.bxc3 ♙f6= Echeverria-Gongora, Mislata 2008) 8...a6 9.♘d6+ ♙xd6 10.♙xd6 ♙b7 11.0-0-0± Peter Horvath-Pal Petran, Hungary tt 2001;

A2122) 7...♘xf4 (7...a6 8.♘d6+ ♙xd6 9.♙xd6±) 8.♙xf4 ♘a6 9.0-0-0± Ortega-Marinelli, Catania 1993.

A22) 5...d5 6.♘b5!± 6...♘a6 7.♘e5 (7.h3±; 7.♙e2±) 7...♙b7 8.c3 ♙e7 9.a4?! (9.♘g4±) 9...0-0 10.♙d3 ♘b8= Kotic-Belezky, Munich 2013;

A23) 5...a6 6.d5!± 6...d6 7.dxe6 (7.a4± Nilsen-Djurhuus, Oslo 2015) 7...♙xe6 8.♘g5 d5 9.♘xe6 fxe6 10.g4± Karjakin-Ni, Doha 2015.

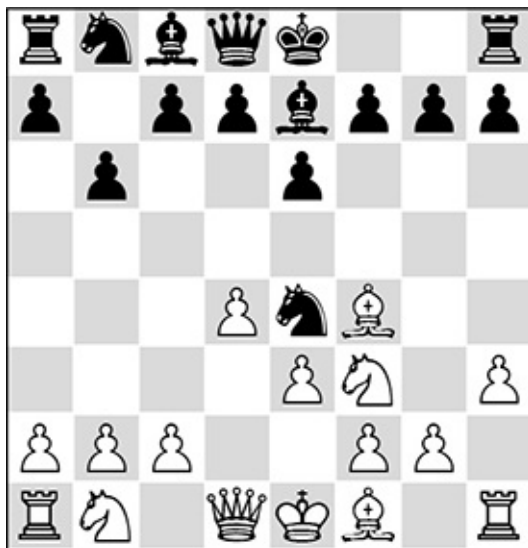
B) Another alternative for Black is 3...♘h5!? 4.♙g5 (4.♙d2!?) 4...♙e7 5.♙xe7 ♙xe7 6.e3 (6.e4!?) 6...0-0 (6...♙b4+ 7.♘c3 ♙xb2? 8.♘b5±) 7.c4

♖f6 (7... ♜b4+ 8. ♜d2±) 8. ♖c3±.

4.h3!

We need to remember that if 4.e3 then 4... ♖h5!.

4...b6 5.e3 ♖e4!?



This was a surprise, since Black does not usually play this move so early. Black wants to seize control of the e4-square with ... ♖b7 and then ...f7-f5. The normal moves are 5... ♖b7 and 5...0-0.

6. ♖d3

6. ♖bd2 and 6. ♖fd2 were also playable.

6... ♖b7 7. ♖bd2

The natural move would be to castle, but I preferred this move, since if Black plays ...f7-f5 then White has other options.

A) After 7.0-0 0-0 there are several examples:

A1) 8. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 9.c4 d6 10. ♖c3 ♖b7 11.e4 ♖d7= Appel-Gordon, Trier 2013;

A2) 8. ♖fd2!? d5 and now:

A21) 9. ♖xe4 dxe4 10. ♖e2 ♖d7 11.c4 ♖f6 (11...f5) 12. ♖c3± Vila-Fernandez, Valencia 2006;

A22) 9.a4 a5 (9...f5) 10. ♖xe4 (10. ♖xe4 dxe4 11. ♖c3 f5 12. ♖b5±) 10... dxe4 11. ♖c4 ♖d6= Bauer-Miezis, Grächen 2013;

A3) 8.a4 f5 9.a5 ♜h8 10.a6 ♖c6 11.c4± Renner-Traunwieser, Grieskirchen 2013;

A4) 8. ♖bd2 f5 9.c3 d6 (9... ♜e8) 10. ♜c2 ♖xd2 11. ♖xd2 ♖f6 12. ♖h2± Colijn-G.Kuzmin, Pardubice 2013;

B) Another option is 7.c4 0-0 8.0-0 f5 9. ♜c2 d6 10. ♖fd2 ♖xd2 11. ♖xd2

♖c6 (11...♗d7= Noirox-M.Erwich, Belgium tt 2010/11) 12.a3 ♗f6 13.d5±
De Prado-Baltar, Spain tt 2014.



7...d5

A) The consistent move would be 7...f5. Since White has not yet castled, he has the option of going queenside and then playing ♖g1, g2-g4 and ♗e2. Let us see a few examples with 7...f5:

A1) 8.g4!? ♗xd2 (8...♗d6) 9.♖xd2±;

A2) 8.♖g1! 0-0 9.♗e2 (9.g4!±) 9...♗xd2 (9...c5 10.0-0-0 d5 11.c3 c4 12.♗xe4 fxe4 13.♗e5 b5= Csiszar-Bali, Hungary 2000) 10.♗xd2 c5 11.c3 (11.g4!±) 11...♗c8 12.g4± Zimmer-Kerkmeester, Mondorf 1991;

A3) 8.♗e2 0-0 9.0-0-0 (9.♖g1) 9...a5 10.g4 (10.♖hg1±) 10...a4 (10...♗xd2 11.♖xd2±) 11.gxf5 exf5 12.a3± Teske-Meister, Tegernsee 2008;

A4) 8.c3 d6 (8...0-0) 9.♗b3 (9.♗c4±) 9...♗xd2 10.♖xd2 ♗d5 11.c4 (11.♗c4) 11...♗b7= Akhmedov-Rombaldoni, Batumi 2006.

B) Another option is 7...♗xd2 8.♗xd2 (8.♗xd2) 8...0-0 9.e4± (9.0-0-0!? or 9.c3).

8.0-0

Or 8.c3 (8.c4! and 8.a4 are also playable) 8...♗d7 and now:

A) 9.♗e2 a6 10.0-0 (it is better to play 10.0-0-0 or 10.♗c2) 10...g5! (10...0-0) 11.♗h2 h5 12.♗e5 ♗xe5 13.♗xe5 f6 14.♗h2 ♗xd2 15.♗xd2 f5= Macek-Pokorna, Pula 2002;

B) 9.0-0 0-0 10.a4 c5 11.♗e2 (11. a5±) 11...♗xd2 (11...a5) 12.♗xd2 ♗f6 (12...c4) 13.b4 ♗e7 (13...c4±) 14.bxc5 bxc5 15.♖fb1± Bogosavljevic-Miljkovic, Kragujevac 2013;

C) 9.♗c2 and Black has the following options:

C1) 9... ♖df6 10. ♗e5 (10.a4) 10...0-0 11. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 12.f3 (12.0-0) 12... ♗h4+ (12... ♗f6) 13. ♖e2 g5 14. ♗h2 ♗g3+ 15. ♗xg3 ♗xg3 16. ♗xh7+ ♖g7 17. ♗d3 c5 and Black has compensation, Toufighi-Khalesi, Tabriz 2012;

C2) 9...f5 10.g4 g6 11.gxf5 exf5 12.h4± Lomineishvili-Makropoulou, Belgrade 2013.

8... ♗d7

A) Here it was better to play 8...0-0 9.c4 c5 and now:



analysis diagram

A1) 10. ♖c2

A11) 10... ♗xd2 11. ♗xh7+ (11. ♗xd2 cxd4, 11. ♖xd2 dxc4 12. ♗xc4 ♗xf3 13.gxf3) 11... ♖h8 12. ♗xd2 cxd4 (12...g6) 13.cxd5 dxe3 14. ♗xe3 g6 15. ♗xg6 fxg6 16. ♖xg6 ♗xd5 17. ♖h6+=;

A12) 10...f5 11. ♖fd1 (11.cxd5±) 11... ♗d7 12. ♖ac1 cxd4 (12... ♖c8) 13.exd4 (13. ♗xd4±) 13... ♖c8= Malloni-De Barberis, Oklahoma City 2001;

A2) 10.cxd5! exd5 11. ♖c1±.

B) Another option was 8...g5 9. ♗e5 (9. ♗h2 h5 10. ♗e5±) 9... ♖g8 10. ♗h2?! (10.c4±) 10... ♗xd2 11. ♖xd2 f6 12. ♗g3 h5± Dobos-Lakat, Budapest 2005.

9.c4



This seems to be the best plan for White: attack d5 and e4, and open the c-file to put pressure on c7, with the aid of the rook on c1 and the bishop on f4. White could also employ the move order 9. ♖c1 0-0 10.c4.

9... ♗xd2

Now 9...0-0? is not possible due to 10.cxd5 exd5 11. ♕c2±, and White wins a pawn with the double attack on c7 and e4, or h7 if Black exchanges on d2. Now 9...g5? is not a good idea: 10. ♕h2 f5 (or 10...h5 11.cxd5 exd5 12. ♕c2 ♗xd2 13. ♗xd2 c5 14. ♕f5±) 11.cxd5 ♗xd5 (11...exd5 12. ♖c1±) 12. ♖c1±.

White retains some advantage after 9...c5 10.cxd5 (10. ♖c1 0-0 11.cxd5 exd5 12. ♕b5±) 10...exd5 11. ♕c2 f5 (11... ♗xd2 12. ♗xd2±, 11... ♗df6 12. ♕b5+±) 12.dxc5 bxc5 13. ♕b5±.

10. ♗xd2

If 10. ♕xd2 then 10...dxc4 11. ♕xc4 0-0 (11... ♕xf3!? 12.gxf3 0-0∞) 12. ♕e2 ♕d6.

10...dxc4

This appears to be the best move. If 10...♗f6 then 11. ♕a4+ c6 (11... ♕d7 12. ♕xd7+ ♖xd7 13. ♖ac1±) 12. ♖fd1±.

Once again 10...0-0? is bad due to 11.cxd5 ♗xd5 (11...exd5 12. ♕c2±) 12. ♕c2±, while if 10...c5 then 11.cxd5 ♗xd5 (11...exd5 12. ♕c2 h6 13.dxc5 bxc5 14. ♖ad1±) 12. ♕g4±.

11. ♗xc4 0-0 12. ♕c2

Trying to put pressure on h7 and c7. Other options were 12. ♖c1± or 12. ♕e2±.

12...h6

There were several options for Black here, but White maintains a slight advantage in all cases, e.g. 12...f5 13. ♖ac1 ♕g5 14. ♕h2±; 12...g6 13. ♖ac1± or 12...♗f6 13. ♖fd1±.

13. ♖fd1

White had the interesting alternatives 13. ♖ac1± and 13. ♕h7+ ♔h8 14. ♕e4 ♕xe4 15. ♖xe4 ♗f6 (15...c5 16. ♖ad1±) 16. ♖c6 ♗d5 17. ♕g3 ♖c8 18. ♖fc1±.

13... ♗f6 14.a3

This move was directed against 14... ♗d5, which would threaten 15... ♗b4 as well as 15... ♗xf4, although it was also possible to ignore this with 14. ♖ac1 ♗d5 (14... ♖d5 15.f3 c5 16. ♗e5±) 15.a3 (15. ♗e5 ♗xf4 16.exf4±) 15... ♗xf4 16.exf4 ♗d5 (16... ♖d5 17. ♗e3±; 16...f5 17. ♖e2±) 17. ♗e3±.

14... ♖d5

Or 14... ♗d5 15. ♕g3 ♖c8 16. ♖ac1 c5 17.dxc5 ♗xc5 18. ♖d2±.



15.f3

It was better to play 15. ♕f1 c5 16. ♖ac1 ♖fd8 17. ♗e5±.

15...c5 16.dxc5 ♖xc5 17.b4 ♖h5!?

The black queen will remain exposed in the future. It was better to play 17... ♖c6 18. ♖ac1 ♖fd8 19. ♖b2 (19. ♖b1 ♖e8 20. ♕c7 ♖dc8 21. ♕e5±) 19... ♖a4 20. ♕c2 ♖c6 21. ♕b3±.

18.e4!

This move was designed to avoid possible sacrifices on f3 and to leave the b7-bishop out of play. White could also have opted for 18. ♗d6 or 18. ♕d6, retaining a slight advantage.

18... ♖h4!?

If 18... ♖fd8 then 19. ♕f1±; it seems best to play 18... ♖ac8 19. ♖f2 ♖fd8 20. ♕e2±.

19.g3!



White wants to hunt down the black queen and so sacrifices a pawn. A quieter continuation was 19. ♖d6! ♜fe8 (19... ♘h5 20. ♙f2±) 20. ♙f2 ♙xf2+ 21. ♔xf2 ♘a6 22. ♙xe7 ♜xe7 23. ♜ac1±, but during the game I considered that the move 19.g3 presented Black with more difficulties.

19... ♙xh3

Black must accept the challenge or lose time; if 19... ♙h5 then 20. ♔g2 (20. ♙f2) 20... ♜ac8 21. ♙e2±.

20. ♜d2!

Threatening 21. ♜h2, winning the queen.

20... e5?

Black had to play 20... ♙h5 and although after 21. ♘e5 he has to sacrifice his queen, in return he gains some counterplay:

A) 21... ♖d6 22.g4 ♖xe5 (22... ♙h4 23. ♜h2 ♖xe5 24. ♜xh4 ♖xa1 25. ♖xh6±) 23.gxh5 ♖xf4 (23... ♖xa1 24. ♙c7 ♜ab8 25. ♖b5) 24. ♜dd1 and White is clearly better;

B) 21... ♜fc8 22. ♖c4 (22. ♙a2 ♖d6 23.g4 ♖xe5 24.gxh5 ♖xf4±) 22... ♖a6 23. ♜h2 ♖xc4 24. ♜xh5 ♘xh5 25. ♖xh6 ♖f6 26. ♖f4±.

21. ♘xe5



21...g5?

Black was relying on this resource, but he is lost.

A) If 21... ♖ac8 then 22. ♗b3, and now:

A2) 22...g5? 23. ♗g6 ♜fe8 (23...gxf4 24. ♗xe7+) 24. ♙b5 ♜h5 (24...gxf4 25. ♗xf4 ♜xg3+ 26. ♜g2; 24... ♙c6 25. ♗e5) 25. ♗e5 gxf4 26.gxf4 and White has a decisive advantage with multiple threats, such as 27. ♜h2 or 27. ♙xe8;

A2) 22... ♗h5 is slightly better, but fails to save Black after 23. ♙f1 ♜e6 24. ♜xe6 fxe6 25. ♜d7 ♙f6 26. ♜xb7 g5 27. ♜d1 gxf4 28. ♗d7 ♜f7 29.g4 ♗g3 30. ♗xf6+ ♜xf6 31. ♜dd7.

B) Other defensive possibilities were 21... ♜c8 22. ♙c4 (threatening 23. ♗g6 and 23. ♗b3) and 21... ♗h5 22. ♜h2.

22. ♜c7! ♜ae8

Other tries were 22... ♜fe8 23. ♜xb7 gxf4 24. ♙c4 or 22...gxf4 23. ♜xe7 ♜e6 24. ♜xe6 fxe6 25.gxf4.

23. ♜xb7 gxf4 24. ♜h2 ♜c8

If 24... ♜e6 then 25.gxf4.

25. ♜xc8 ♜xc8 26.gxf4



White has a decisive advantage: he is a pawn up, the black pawns on h6 and f7 are weak and there are attacking chances against the black king.

26...h5

Or 26...♖h7 27.♞d1 ♞c3 28.♞c4 ♞xa3 29.♞xf7.

27.♞g2+ ♖h7 28.♞c4 ♞g8 29.♞a2

Here 29.♞xg8 ♞xg8+ 30.♖h1 h4 31.♞xf7 was strong.

29...♞xg2+ 30.♞xg2 ♞g8

If 30...♞d7 White wins with 31.♞xf7 ♞xe5 32.fxe5 ♞c3 33.f4 ♞xa3 34.f5.

31.♞xg8 ♞xg8 32.♞xf7

White wins a second pawn and the game.

32...♖g7 33.e5 ♞d7 34.f5 ♞h4 35.♖g2 a5 36.bxa5 bxa5 37.♖h3 ♞f2 38.f4 ♞c5 39.a4 ♞b6 40.♞b3 ♞e3 41.♞g5 ♞d7 42.f6+ ♖f8 43.♞e6+ ♖e8 44.♞g7+ ♖f8 45.♞xh5

1-0

SUMMARY

We saw in this game some alternatives to the main lines. Remember that an early ...c7-c5 and ...b7-b6 is well answered with 5.♞c3!, which gives White the advantage. In the game we saw Black's plan of ...♞e4 to gain a grip on the centre. Black can follow this up with ...f7-f5 or ...d7-d5. I think that it is better for White to delay castling, in case Black plays ...f7-f5, since in that case the plan of queenside castling, ♞g1 and g2-g4 is good. If Black plays ...d7-d5, the best plan for White is to advance with c2-c4, put pressure on d5 and e4, open the c-file and with the help of the f4-bishop put pressure on c7. In the game Black had to make some concessions to enable him to castle and White emerged from the opening with advantage. Black's

plan of ...♔h5 was dubious, since he had problems with his queen on the kingside. White sacrificed a pawn and gained a clear advantage, while Black, in order not to lose his queen, had to sacrifice material and was unable to save the game.

CONCLUSION

We have been studying the Queen's Indian set-up against the London System. In Game 25 we saw Black's traditional line, based on exchanging pawns on d4: White recaptured with the e-pawn and Black continued with the plan of ...d7-d6 and ...♞bd7. In Game 26 we saw Black's other option of developing his queen's knight to c6. White used one of the standard plans with a2-a4 and ♖e1, followed by the advance of the queenside pawns with c2-c4. Another option is to play ♔e2 and operate on the kingside with ♞g5, or ♞c4 followed by ♞e3-g4.

In Game 27 we saw the recommendation of GM Prié, which is to recapture on d4 with the c-pawn. White's idea is to play on the open c-file, advance with e4-e5 and attack on the kingside. In Game 28 we saw that if Black exchanges pawns on d4 at an early stage, recapturing with the c-pawn allows White to develop the queen's knight directly to c3.

In Game 29 we saw GM Blatny's idea to dispense with h2-h3 and allow the exchange of the f4-bishop for Black's knight. White's plan then is to play ♔e2, 0-0-0 and h2-h4 to attack the black king and this is an interesting and complex line, suitable for players who like to attack, or for when you need to go all out for a win. It is good to have this plan in your arsenal, because if the opponent is not familiar with its nuances he can easily get into difficulties.

Finally in Game 30 we saw various ideas: if Black plays an early ...b7-b6 and ...c7-c5, White has the option of 5.♞c3, which gives him the advantage. We also analysed Black's idea of ...♞e4, which can transpose to positions from the Dutch Defence if Black follows up with ...f7-f5. White's idea is to undermine the strong centralised knight with c2-c4 and open the c-file.

Remember that if Black plays an early ...c7-c5 and exchanges on d4 we have some extra options. Also keep in mind that the move h2-h3 is only necessary when Black plays ...♞e7 and threatens ...♞h5. If White plays h2-h3 before Black plays ...♞e7 Black can equalise by playing ...♞d6 directly.

Chapter 5

The London System versus the Benoni

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f4 c5

1.d4 ♘f6
1...c5 2.c3 cxd4 3.cxd4 d5
2.♗f4
2...e6
2...c5



3.e3
3.d5; 3.dxc5; 3.c3
3...e6
3...♗b6; 3...cxd4; 3...♗d5
4.♗f3 ♗b6
4...d5
5.♗c3
5.♗a3
5...d5
5...♗xb2; 5...a6

6. ♖b5

6. a3

6... ♗a6 7. a4

The Benoni Defence is characterised by the move ...c7-c5 by Black. Against the London System Black cannot achieve a normal Benoni position because White usually abstains from advancing with d4-d5, instead playing c2-c3 or e2-e3. Black then has the option of playing ...♗b6, putting pressure on b2. The majority of the lines follow this route. White has several options to defend against this threat: one option is to play c2-c3 and ♗b3; another interesting idea is to respond to ...♗b6 by developing the queen's knight to c3, d2 or a3, since normally Black cannot then take the b2-pawn. If White plays d4-d5, we usually transpose to the Vaganian Gambit, which normally arises from the Trompowsky Opening. Another option for Black is to exchange pawns on d4 and after ...d7-d5 transpose to the Exchange Variation of the Slav Defence, which we shall cover in Chapter 7. In answer to ...c7-c5, if your opponent is normally a Benoni player, then responding with c2-c3 is a good idea. If he does not normally play the Benoni, then advancing with d4-d5 is an option worth considering.

Game 31

Benoni

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

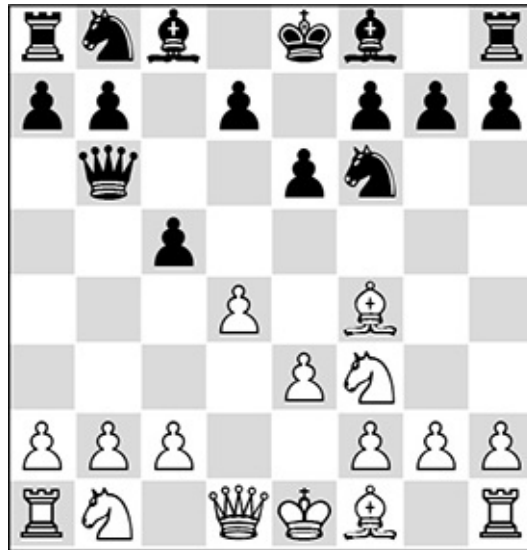
2326

Robert Patiño

2220

Spain tt 2011 (3)

1. d4 ♗f6 2. ♖f3 e6 3. ♗f4 c5 4. e3 ♗b6



One of Black's typical ideas is to move the queen to b6 to attack the weak point b2, but here this gives White the advantage, since he can just ignore the attack. In addition, capturing on b2 often allows White to repeat the position with a perpetual attack on the black queen, which will not suit Black if he is the stronger player.

5. ♖c3

A) This is the most common response but it is not the best. Instead, 5. ♖a3!± is the best move, because it allows White to play ♖c4 as well as ♖b5. Let us consider some examples:

A1) 5...d5 6. ♖b5! ♖a6 7.a4± (7.c3±) 7...c4 (7...cxd4 8.exd4 ♕e7 9.c3 0-0 10. ♕d3± Kotic-Rindlisbacher, Gabcice Mare 2014) 8.c3 and now:

A11) 8...♕d7 9.b3! ♕xb5 10.axb5 ♖xb5 11.bxc4 dxc4 12. ♖e5?! (12. ♖b1! ♖a5 13. ♕xc4 ♖xc3+ 14. ♖d2) 12...♖c8 13. ♕xc4 ♖xc4 14. ♖e2± Torre-Sinurat, Jakarta 2013;

A12) Or 8...♕e7 9.b3 cxb3 10. ♖xb3 0-0 and now 11. ♕e2 ♖h5? (11... ♖e4 12.h3 ♕d7 13.0-0 ♖fc8 14. ♖fc1±) 12. ♕c7! ♖xc7 13.a5 ♖c6 14. ♖e5 ♖xb5 15. ♖xc6 bxc6 16. ♕xh5+- De Prado-Melgar, Spain tt 2014, or 11. ♕d3± Mary-Yeppez, cr 2002, or 11.h3 ♖e4 12. ♕d3 ♕d7 13. ♕xe4 dxe4 14. ♖e5± Kotic-Kovacevic, Herceg Novi 2001.

A2) 5...cxd4 6. ♖b5± 6... ♖a6 7.exd4 d6 8.a4 (8.c4±) 8...♕e7 9. ♕e2 (9. ♖d2!± is better, with the idea of playing ♖c4, e.g. 9...d5 (9...0-0 10. ♖c4 and the d6-pawn falls) 10. ♕d3 ♕d7 11.c3 0-0 12.0-0±) 9...0-0 10.0-0± Mitkov-Tiviakov, Morella 2007;

A3) Taking the pawn is bad: 5...♖xb2? 6. ♖b5 ♖d5 7. ♖b1 ♖xa2 8. ♖a1 ♖b2 9. ♕c4 ♖b4+ 10. ♖d2 ♖a6 11. ♖b1 ♖a4 12. ♕xd5 (12.0-0 ♕e7 13. ♕d6) 12...exd5 13. ♖h5; but if Black really cannot take the pawn, then the move ...

♔b6 is not a good one, because the queen becomes exposed to attack.

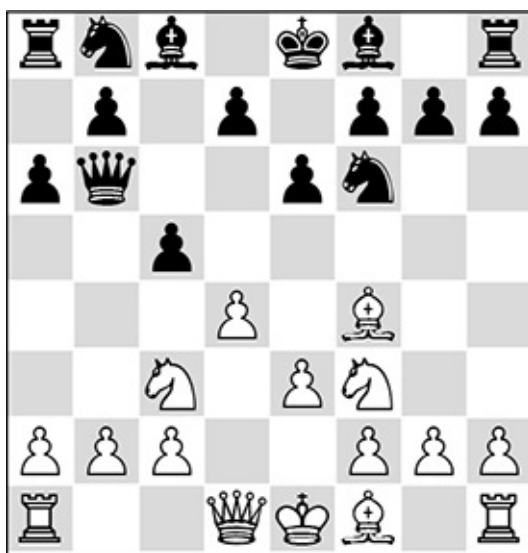
B) A few strong GMs have played 5. ♔c1, but this is passive, as is 5.b3, and in both cases Black equalises. On c1 the queen is badly placed... 5... ♕c6 (5... ♕h5=) 6.c3 (6.dxc5 ♕xc5 7.h3 d5) 6... ♕h5 7. ♕g3 h6 (7... ♕xg3 8.hxg3 d5= Grachev-Moiseenko, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013) 8. ♖bd2 d5 9. ♕d3 ♕e7 10.0-0 ♕xg3= Kamsky-Giri, Beijing 2013.

5...d5?!

This move is dubious.

A) However, the b2-pawn cannot be captured; after 5... ♕xb2? 6. ♖b5 ♕d5 (6... ♖a6? 7.a3 and the black queen cannot escape: 7... ♕d5 8. ♖b1 ♔a2 9. ♕d6 ♕xd6 10. ♕c4 ♖c3 11. ♖xd6+ ♔e7 12. ♕xa2 ♖xd1 13. ♖xc8+ ♖hxc8 14. ♔xd1) 7. ♖b1 ♕xa2 8. ♖a1 ♕b2 9. ♕c4!, with the decisive threat of 10. ♖b1 (the immediate 9. ♖b1 draws by repetition) 9... ♖c3 10. ♖c7+ ♔d8 11. ♔c1 ♕b4 12. ♕f1!± and the rook on a8 falls.

B) The best move is 5...a6!.



analysis diagram

This should give Black equality:

B1) 6.dxc5 ♕xc5 (6... ♔xc5 7. ♕e2 (7.e4!?!; 7. ♕d3) 7...d5 8.0-0= Pereyra-Engel, cr Argentina 1991) 7. ♕e2 ♕xb2 8. ♖a4 and now:

B11) 8... ♔b4+? 9.c3 ♔a5 10. ♖xc5 ♔xc5 (10... ♔xc3+ 11. ♖d2 ♔xc5 12. ♖c1) 11. ♕d6 ♔xc3+ 12. ♖d2 ♖c6 13. ♖c1 ♔a5 14. ♕f3 and White has the advantage; he has compensation for the two pawns, since Black is behind in development and his king is stuck in the centre;

B12) 8... ♔a3! 9.c4 d6 (9... ♕b4+ 10. ♔f1±) 10. ♖xc5 ♔a5+ 11. ♔d2 ♔xd2+ 12. ♖xd2 dxc5 13. ♕d6 and White has compensation;

B2) 6.a3 (if 6.♘a4 ♚a5+ 7.c3 c4= (7...cxd4 8.b4 ♚d8 9.exd4±)) with a few examples:

B21) 6...♗h5? 7.♕g5?! (7.dxc5! ♕xc5 8.♘a4 ♚a5+ 9.c3 ♗xf4 10.b4 ♚c7 11.bxc5±) 7...h6 8.♕h4 g5 9.♘e5 gxh4 10.♚xh5 (10.dxc5! ♕xc5 11.♚xh5 ♚xb2 12.♖d2) 10...♚xb2 11.♚xf7+ ♖d8 12.♚f6+ ♖c7 13.♖d2?! (13.♘d1 ♚xa1 14.♚xh8±) 13...cxd4= Zsu. Polgar-Browne, Dortmund 1990;

B22) 6...cxd4 7.exd4 ♕e7 8.h3 0-0 9.♕d3 d5 (9...d6=) 10.0-0 ♕d7 Kovacevic-Narciso, La Pobla de Lillet 1997;

B23) 6...d5 7.dxc5 (7.♕e2 cxd4=) 7...♕xc5 8.♕d3 (8.♕e2 0-0 9.0-0=) 8...♕d7 9.♖b1 ♕d6= Kovacevic-Saric, Sibenik 2011.

6.a3

The idea of a2-a3 is thematic in many variations of the London System, because it indirectly defends the b2-pawn, since after ♘a4 the black queen is trapped. But here it was better to play the immediate 6.♘b5!±, transposing to the note to the move 5.♘a3! above.



6...♕e7?!

This natural move is a mistake, because White can exploit it to gain several development tempi. The b2-pawn is taboo: if 6...♚xb2?? then 7.♘a4 wins; however, 6...♕d7 and 6...a6 were both good moves.

7.♘b5! ♘a6 8.dxc5! ♕xc5

8...♕xc5 9.b4 ♚b6 10.c4 is similar to the game.

9.b4! ♕e7 10.c4!± ♚d8?!

It was better to play 10...dxc4, although White retains the advantage after 11.♘d6+ ♕xd6 12.♕xd6 ♘e4 (12...♘d5 13.♕g3 0-0 14.♕xc4±) 13.♕e5 (13.♕f4 ♘xb4 14.axb4 ♚xb4+ 15.♘d2 b5±) 13...f6 (13...♘xb4 14.axb4

♙xb4+ 15. ♖d2) 14. ♙c2 ♖xf2 15. ♙xf2 fxe5 16. ♖xe5±.

Also after 11. ♖xc4 0-0 (11... ♖d7 12. ♖d6+ ♖xd6 13. ♙xd6 ♙xd6 14. ♖xd6±) 12. ♖e5 ♖d7 13. ♖d4 ♙d8 14. 0-0± White would stand better.

11.c5



White has a clear advantage from the opening; his pieces are more active, the d6-square is weak, the c5-pawn is strong, Black's knight is passive on a6, and his c8-bishop and a8-rook have poor prospects. In contrast, White's king's bishop can go to d3 and attack Black's kingside. Black's only possible counterplay is with ...f7-f6 and ...e6-e5.

11...0-0 12. ♖d3 ♖e8

Black reinforces the d6-square and prepares to play ...f7-f6 and ...e6-e5, but the knight is passive on e8 and its absence from f6 weakens the defence of the black king. It was slightly better to play 12... ♖e4 13. ♖fd4±.

13. ♙c2!

Putting pressure on h7 and with the other eye on the c-file, where the advance of the c5-pawn is in the air.

13...h6 14.0-0 ♖d7



15. ♖ac1?!

It was better to try to avoid piece exchanges and play 15. ♗bd4, with an advantage which is already almost decisive, despite White not having won any material yet. Black cannot prevent b4-b5 or c5-c6 and White also threatens to capture on a6.

15... ♗b8

15... ♗xb5 16. ♗xb5 ♗b8 would provide Black with some relief but White would retain some advantage.

16. ♗bd4 a6 17. a4!

White's idea is to play b4-b5 and c5-c6, creating a strong passed pawn, and there is little that Black can do to prevent this. White can also attack on the kingside.

17... f6

Black tries to create some counterplay with ...e5-e4, but he is not in time. The great thing about this position for White is that he can play on either or both wings, as he wishes, thanks to the passivity of the black pieces.

How would you continue now for White?



The winning move once more. The idea is to clear the h-file for the white queen.

21...exf4

If 21...exd4 22.♘h4!! (but not 22.♙h5? ♘g4!) 22...♙g4 23.♙xf7 ♔xh7 24.♙g6+ ♔g8 25.♙xg4.

22. ♔h5?!

This wins, but the pretty 22.♖h4!! was more direct, e.g. 22...f5 (22...♗g4 23.♖df5) 23.♗h5 ♘xh4 24.♗g6+ ♔g8 25.exf4!! ♖f6 26.♗xf7+ ♔f8 27.♗h8+ ♔xf7 (27...♔e7 28.♖fe1+, with a decisive advantage; the idea of 25.exf4 is now clear) 28.♗xd8, and wins.

22... ♖g4 23. ♙xf7 ♔xh7 24. ♘h4



White still has a decisive advantage; he has an attack on the weak black king, the black pieces are passive or out of play, whereas the white knights rampage

freely.

24... ♖c6

There was no salvation in either 24... ♕c8 25. ♗g6 or 24... ♖d7 25.h3! ♕xc5 26. ♗g6+ ♖g8 27.bxc5.

25. ♗g6+ ♖g8 26. ♗xg4 f5 27. ♗hxf5 ♗xb4 28. ♗e6 ♖c8?

In extreme time pressure Black loses his queen, but there is no defence; if 28... ♖d7 29. ♗fxg7 wins.

29. ♗xe7+

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the idea of ... ♗b6, after ...e7-e6 and ...c7-c5. In this move order, ... ♗b6 is dubious, because Black cannot really take the b2-pawn. If he does so, he will be worse or even lost. But if the queen cannot take on b2, then ... ♗b6 is just a loss of time, since the queen is exposed on that square. Furthermore, after Black captures on b2 White always has the option of forcing a draw, if that suits him. White's best response is ♗a3!, rather than ♗c3, because from a3 the knight can go to either b5 or c4. However, after ♗c3 the idea of playing a2-a3 is thematic in some variations of the London System, because it defends the b2-pawn indirectly. Against a2-a3, Black needs to have played ... ♕d7 or ...a7-a6, preventing the plan that starts with ♗b5. In the game the sequence was forced and gave White a clear advantage. The black pieces remained passive and hemmed in on the queenside, while White had a clear advantage in space, the possibility of attacking on both wings, a strong c5-pawn and the square d6 under his control. When Black tried to create counterplay, he was hit with the sacrifice 18. ♕xh6, with a decisive attack on the black king. The idea of 21. ♕f4 to clear the h-file for the white queen was very attractive. White's attack was decisive.

Game 32

Benoni
Eric Prié

2490

Inigo Argandona Rivero

2388

San Sebastian 2011 (7)
1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♕f4 c5

If Black is going to play this move, it is best to do it now, without ...d7-d5 or ...e7-e6.

3.e3

We shall examine the options with 3.d5 in the next game.

A) Here 3.c3?! is bad in view of 3... ♖b6! and now:

A1) 4. ♖b3 cxd4 (4... ♖xb3 5. axb3 cxd4 6. cxd4=) 5. ♕xb8 (5. ♖xb6 axb6 6. cxd4 ♕c6 7. e3 ♖b4) 5... ♖xb8 (5... ♖xb3) 6. ♖xb6 axb6 7. cxd4 d6 8. ♕c3 ♕d7 9. e3 e6 10. ♕f3 ♕e7= Jakubiec-Mista, Czechia tt 2005/06;

A2) 4. ♖c2 cxd4 5. cxd4 ♕c6 6. e3 (6. ♕f3?! ♕xd4 7. ♕xd4 ♖xd4 8. e3 ♖e4 9. ♖d2 ♖d5) Boguszlavszkij-Rajlich, Budapest 2001) 6...d6 (6...d5 7. ♕c3 ♕f5 8. ♖d2= Salac-Cech, Germany tt 1995) 7. ♕f3 g6= (7... ♕b4) 8. ♕c3 ♕g7= Steinle-Begna, Dortmund 2013.

B) An interesting alternative is 3.dxc5!?, preventing the complications of ... ♖b6. This was the recent choice of grandmaster Rapport against Giri in the 2014 Tata Steel tournament.



analysis diagram

B1) The game continued 3... ♕a6 4. ♖d4 ♖a5+ 5. ♕c3 (5. c3 ♖xc5 6. e3) 5... ♕xc5 (5... ♖xc5 6. e3= (6. ♖d2!?) 6... ♖xd4 7. exd4 ♕b4 8. 0-0-0= Boguszlavszkij-Galyas, Budapest 2002) 6. ♕d2 (6. b4 ♕e6) 6... ♕e6 7. ♖h4!? (7. ♖d3=) 7...g5!? 8. ♖g3 d5 9. e4 d4 10. ♕b5+ ♕d7 11. ♕xd7+ ♕xd7 12. ♕d5 ♖c5, with a complex position in Rapport-Giri, Wijk aan Zee 2014;

B2) The alternative is 3... ♖a5+ 4. ♖d2 (if 4. ♕c3 ♕e4! (4... ♖xc5 5. ♕f3) 5. ♖d3 ♕xc5 6. ♖b5 (6. ♖d2=) 6... ♖xb5 7. ♕xb5 ♕ba6=) 4... ♖xc5 (4... ♖xd2+ 5. ♕xd2 ♕a6 6. ♕b3 ♕e4= is better) 5. ♕c3 d6 6. e4± Nabaty-Loncar, Zagreb 2014.

C) 3. ♖f3?! is dubious: 3...cxd4 4. ♗xd4 (4. ♕xd4? e5 5. ♕xe5 ♖a5+, winning a piece. Curiously there are some forty games where White fell for this trap; if 4. ♕xb8 ♖a5+ 5. ♗d2 ♖xd2+ 6. ♕bxd2 ♗xb8 7. ♕xd4 d5) 4...d6, and Black is slightly better. The queen is badly placed on d4.

3... ♖b6



Now this attack on b2 works, but it is only sufficient for a draw, if that is what White wants. So this is a line where Black must accept the risk of a draw if he takes on b2.

A) An alternative is to exchange on d4 first: 3...cxd4 4. exd4 ♖b6 and now:

A1) 5. ♕c3 with the following possibilities:

A11) 5...e6 6. ♕f3 (6.a3; 6. ♗b1) and now:

A111) 6... ♕e7 7.a3 (7. ♕e2) 7...0-0 8. ♕d3 ♗c6 9.0-0 d6 (9...a6) 10. ♗e1 (10. ♕b5±) 10... ♕d5?! (10...a6) 11. ♕xd5 exd5± Rakic-Perunovic, Novi Sad 2000;

A112) 6...a6 (6... ♖xb2 7. ♕b5±) 7.a3 (7. ♗b1) 7...d5 8. ♕d3 ♗c6 9.0-0 ♕d7 10. ♗e1± Kovacevic-Tiviakov, Calvia 2004;

A12) 5...d6, again with several examples:

A121) 6. ♕b5+ ♕d7 7.a4 (7. ♕xd7+ ♗bxd7 8. ♗b1 e6= Vujic-Hansen, Germany Bundesliga 2004/05) 7...a6 8. ♕c4?! (8.a5 ♖c7 9. ♕a4±) 8...g6 (8... ♕c6=) 9. ♕g5 ♕g7 10. ♕xf6 ♕xf6 11. ♕d5 ♖c6 12. ♕b3 0-0 13. ♕e2 ♗e8? (13... ♕h4 14.g3 e6=) 14.0-0 b6? (14...a5±) 15. ♕ec3 ♕g7? (15... ♗a7 16. ♗e1±) 16. ♕xe7+ 1-0 Bauer-Bressac, Calvi 2011;

A122) 6. ♕f3, with two options:

A1221) 6...e6 7.a3 (7. ♕e2 ♕e7 8.0-0 0-0 9.a3 ♕d7= Aguinaga-Cortés, Pamplona 2007) 7... ♕d7 8. ♗b1 a6 9. ♕d3= (9.d5±) Kovacevic-Arribas,

Valencia 1998;

A1222) 6...g6 7.♙e2 (7.♙c4±; 7.♙b5+±) 7...♙g7 8.0-0 0-0 9.♖e1 (9.a3±) 9...♖e8 (9...♗xb2=) 10.♖b1= Ruiz-Shen, Linares 2013.

A123) 6.a3 and again we have several examples:



analysis diagram

A1231) 6...♙d7 7.♖b1 e5!? 8.♙g5? (8.♙e3!; 8.dxe5 dxe5 9.♙xe5 ♙c5 10.♙g3 0-0 11.♙e2 ♖d8 and Black has compensation) 8...exd4 Ponomariov-Aronian, Moscow 2010;

A1232) 6...g6 7.♙f3 (7.♙c4 ♙g7 8.♙ge2 0-0 9.0-0= Ponomariov-Grischuk, Moscow 2010) 7...♙g7 8.♙e2 0-0 9.0-0= Muse-Zaragatski, Berlin 2009.

A2) 5.♙a3 ♙d5= (5...♗xb2? 6.♙b5±, 5...d5 6.♙b5±).

A few other ideas have also been played on move three:

B) 3...♙d5!? 4.♙g3 (4.♙xb8 ♖xb8 5.c4 (5.e4 ♙c7 6.dxc5 ♙e6=) 5...♗a5+ 6.♙d2 ♙f6=) 4...♗b6 5.♙c3! ♙xc3 6.bxc3 ♙c6 (6...♗b2 7.♙e2±; 6...e6 7.d5=) 7.♙d3 (7.d5±) 7...d6 (7...d5=) 8.♙e2 (8.♙f3±) 8...e6 (8...g6=) 9.0-0± De Prado-Zlotnik, Cambre rapid 2013;

C) 3...d6!? 4.♙c3 (4.♙f3, 4.dxc5!?, 4.c3 ♗b6 5.♙a3?! ♗xb2 with advantage to Black, Fontecha-Popov, Bilbao 2014) 4...♙bd7 5.♙f3 g6 6.♗d2!?, with complex play in De Prado-Santos, Famalicao 2014. It is safer to play 6.h3 ♙g7 7.♙e2=.

4.♙c3

A) 4.b3?! d6 5.♙f3 g6 6.♙c3 ♙g7= Prié-Libiszewski, San Sebastian 2011.

B) 4.♙f3!? is an interesting gambit which has hardly been tested yet: 4...♗xb2 (4...cxd4 5.♗xd4± Boguszlavszkij-Berczes, Budapest 2001) 5.♙bd2 ♗c3 6.♖b1 cxd4 7.♖b3 ♗a5 8.exd4, with compensation for the pawn in view

of the advantage in development, the half-open b-file and the possibility of transferring the rook to the kingside via g3-h3, although Black definitely has a solid position here. The position requires further practical tests;

C) White can also play 4. ♖a3 and then if 4... ♜xb2 we reach the same position as in the game.



4... ♜xb2

This is the right moment when Black can capture the pawn without disadvantage.

A) If 4... d6!? then 5. ♗b5+ ♕d7 6. a4 a6 7. a5 ♜c7 and now:

A1) 8. ♗a4 g6 9. ♗g5 (9. ♗f3) 9... ♗g7 10. ♜d2 (10. ♗f3) 10... ♗xa4= Prié-Georgiev, Aix-les-Bains 2011;

A2) 8. ♗xd7+ is stronger: 8... ♗bxd7 9. ♗f3 (9. d5±) 9... g6 10. 0-0 ♗g7 11. h3 0-0 12. ♜d2 b5 13. axb6 ♗xb6± De Prado-Sanchez, Spain tt 2014.

B) If 4... ♗a6!? (4... cxd4 5. ♜xd4 ♜xd4 6. exd4±) 5. a3 e6 6. ♗e2 (6. ♗f3±) 6... ♗e7 7. dxc5 ♗xc5= To-Szeberenyi, Budapest 2014.

5. ♗b5 ♗d5

This is the only sound defence. If 5... ♗a6 then 6. a3±, or if 5... cxd4 then 6. exd4±.

6. a3!

This is the only move that allows White to play for a win. However, if he wants, he can draw immediately with 6. ♜b1 ♜xa2 7. ♜a1 ♜b2 8. ♜b1 ♜a2 9. ♜a1 ♜b2 10. ♜b1 ½-½ Kamsky-Ivanchuk, Gibraltar 2014.

White can still force a draw later on, so he might as well try this idea first to put Black's approach to the test.



6...a6!

Again the only move for Black. The continuation 6... ♖c3 7. ♗c7+ ♔d8 8. ♕c1 is good for White.

7. ♖b1 ♗a2 8. ♕c1!

With this move White is playing to win. Black is going to lose the queen but for quite a lot of material, with a complex position. White can still repeat with 8. ♖a1 ♗b2 9. ♖b1=.

8...axb5 9. ♖a1 ♗xa1 10. ♕xa1 ♗c6



The key position, very difficult to assess; Black has rook, piece and pawn for the queen.

11. ♗xb5

Prié faced this variation twice in the same tournament. In the first game he

played the weaker 11.dxc5 b4 12.a4 ♖c3 13.♗f3?! (13.♗e2 ♜xa4 14.♜c1 ♗xe2 15.♗xe2 e5=) 13... ♜xa4 (13...f6) 14.♜c1, when he was worse and ended up losing in Prié-Gonzalez, San Sebastian 2011.

11...cxd4 12.♗xc6

The alternative is 12.♗e2 e5 13.♗xc6 ♜xa3 14.♜b2 (14.♜xa3 ♗xa3 15.♗xd5 exf4 16.exd4=) 14... ♗b4+ 15.♜d1 dxc6 16.♗xe5 dxe3 17.♗f4 with a complicated position.

12...bxc6

12...dxc6 13.♜xd4 ♜xa3 was also playable, with complex play.

13.♜xd4 f6

It seems better to play 13... ♜xa3 14.♗f3 e6 15.0-0, with a balanced position and chances for both sides.

14.c4 ♗xf4!

Prié's idea was to sacrifice material to gain the advantage after 14...e5 15.♗xe5 fxe5 16.♜xe5+ ♗e7 17.♗f3 ♜xa3 18.0-0±, when White, who is better here in view of Black's poor development, has various plans: ♗f3-g5-e4-d6 or ♜f1-b1-b8.

15.exf4 e5?

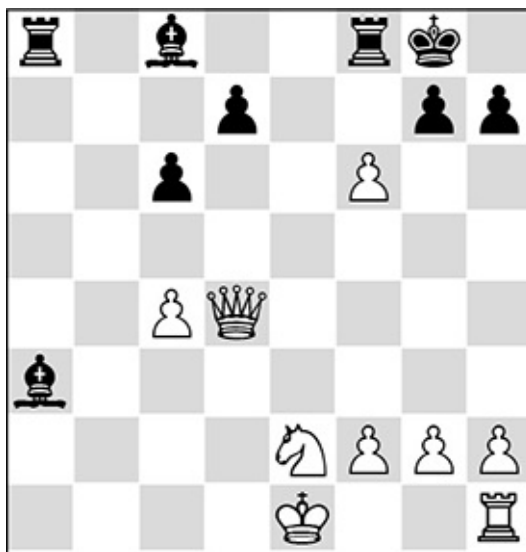
This move gives White the advantage. It was better first to play 15... ♜xa3 16.♗e2 and only then 16...e5!, since after 17.♜b2 (17.fxe5 ♗b4+ 18.♜d1 0-0=) 17...exf4 18.♗xf4 ♜f7 19.0-0 the position is unclear. Black always has good compensation in this variation.

16.fxe5 ♗xa3 17.exf6 0-0 18.♗e2?

This allows Black to equalise. White needed to play the bold 18.fxg7!, and now:

A) 18... ♗b4+ 19.♜d1 ♜f7 (19... ♜xf2 20.♜xf2 ♜a1+ 21.♜e2 ♜a2+ 22.♜f3±) 20.c5;

B) 18... ♜f7 19.♗e2 ♗b4+ 20.♜d1 d6 21.f3±.



18... ♖b4+ 19. ♔d1 ♜xf6 20. c5 ♜b8 21. ♗g3

It was better to play 21. ♗f4 d6 22. ♗h5 ♜f7 23. cxd6 ♜b5 24. ♗f4 ♕c5=.

21...d5

It was possible to play 21...d6 22. ♗e4 ♜f5 23. ♔c2 ♜d5 24. ♔c4 dxc5, with equality, but the black pieces are dangerously active and White needs to play well to avoid being worse.

22. ♖e5 ♜f8 23. f3

23. ♔xb8? fails to 23... ♕g4+, with a decisive advantage.

23... ♜b7 24. ♗d6 ♜f6 25. ♗d8+ ♜f8 26. ♗d6 ♜f6 27. ♗d8+ ♜f8 28. ♗d6 ♕d7

Black avoids the repetition with the right move. What follows now is strange and it might be that the moves have been input wrongly in the database, or perhaps both players were in extreme time trouble.

29. ♗h5?

A blunder, after which White should be lost. It was better to play 29. ♔c2, with a slight advantage to Black.

29... ♕c8?

Black could gain a decisive advantage with 29... ♜e8.

30. ♗g3?

½-½

Now White repeats the position and allows a draw, when he could have won with 30. ♔xc6. A strange end in a critical line, one of the most complex in the whole system.

SUMMARY

We have examined the critical line with 3... ♖b6, without ...d7-d5 or ...e7-

e6, which is the only variation in which Black can capture on b2 without being worse. Black must be willing to accept the draw by repetition with ♖b1-a1. If White wants to play for a win, as in the game, the only way is to play the line with a2-a3 and ♔c1, which reaches a position which is difficult to evaluate. Black gives up his queen for rook, knight and pawn, with good compensation. The game then offers possibilities for both sides. It could be that many players dislike playing without their queen, and this might explain why this variation is rarely seen in practice. If White wants to avoid the messy lines following 3...♞b6 he has the option of 3.dxc5, as played by Rapport against Giri in the 2014 Tata Steel tournament, which is no more than equal but quite playable for both sides.

Game 33

Trompowsky/Vaganian Gambit

Eric Prié

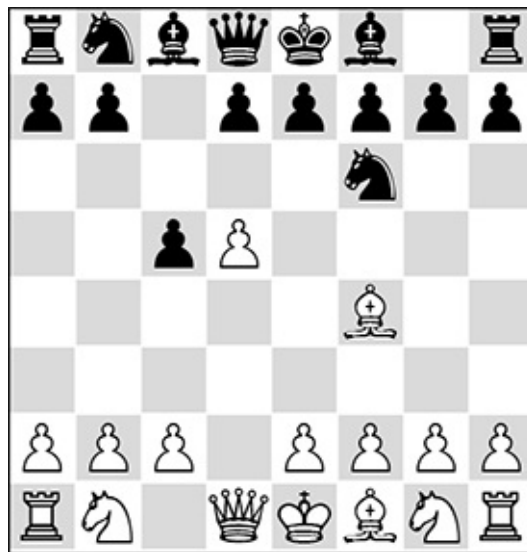
2490

Nicolas Tripoteau

2392

Pau ch-FRA 2012 (7)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f4 c5 3.d5



This move is a departure from the spirit of the London System, but can lead to interesting positions, especially if Black accepts the Vaganian Gambit.

3...♞b6

Once again the thematic move, attacking b2. There are other options:

A) For example, the interesting 3...b5!? and now:

A1) 4.f3!? ♖h5 5.♙c1 e5 6.♗h3 d6 7.♗f2 ♗d7= Prié-Crut, Pau 2012;

A2) 4.a4 ♗b7 (4...♙a5+ 5.♗d2±; 4...b4!=) 5.axb5 (5.e4±) 5...♗xd5 6.♗g3 g6 (6...d6 7.e4±) 7.e4 ♗b6 8.♗d2 ♗g7 9.c3= Kamsky-Kramnik, Baku 2010;

A3) 4.♗f3 and now:

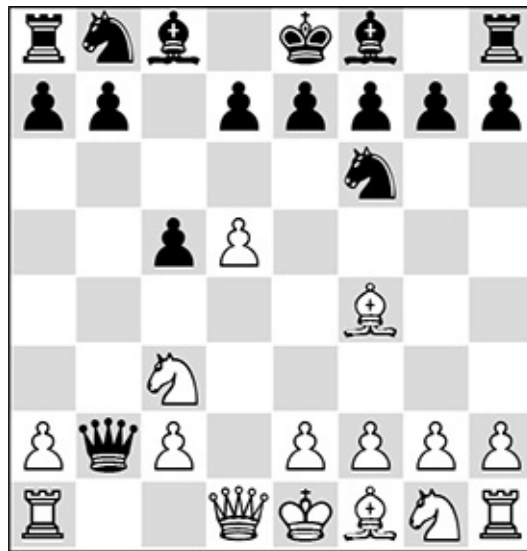
A31) 4...e6 5.dxe6 fxe6 6.♗bd2 d5 7.e4± 7...c4 (7...♗xe4 8.♗xe4 dxe4 9.♙xd8+ ♙xd8 10.0-0-0+-; 7...dxe4 8.♗xb5+±) 8.e5 ♗fd7 9.♗d4±;

A32) 4...♗b7 5.c4 d6 6.♗bd2 (6.h3) 6...g6 (6...♗h5=) 7.e4 ♗g7 8.cxb5± Smirin-Tzermiadanos, Katerini 1992.

A4) 4.c4 bxc4 5.♗c3 d6 6.e4 ♗bd7 7.♗xc4 ♖b8=.

B) 3...d6 is also playable, e.g. 4.♗c3 e5 (4...g6 5.e4 ♗g7 6.♗f3 ♗g4 7.♗e2 0-0 8.0-0= Renner-Pötz, Austria Bundesliga B 2012/13) 5.dxe6 ♗xe6 6.e4 ♗c6 7.♙d3 (or 7.♙d2 ♗e7 8.0-0-0 0-0 with complex play) 7...d5 (7...♗e7) 8.exd5 ♗xd5 9.♗xd5 ♙xd5 10.♙xd5 ♗xd5 11.0-0-0 0-0-0= Milosavljevic-Kocic, Belgrade 2011.

4.♗c3 ♙xb2



The so-called Vaganian Gambit, named after the Armenian GM Rafael Vaganian, who was one of the first to play it and develop it. The most common move order to reach it is via the Trompowsky: 1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗g5 c5 3.d5 ♙b6 4.♗c3 ♙xb2 5.♗d2. Theory considers it to be a sound gambit, for which White obtains very good compensation, even against Black's best defences. It is playable for both sides. White needs to like playing a pawn down but with the initiative, while Black must be happy to defend a rather passive position but with an advantage in material. From the Trompowsky this position can also be reached via 2...♗e4 3.♗f4 c5 4.f3 ♗f6?! (4...♙a5+!) 5.d5 ♙b6 6.♗c3 ♙xb2 7.♗d2.

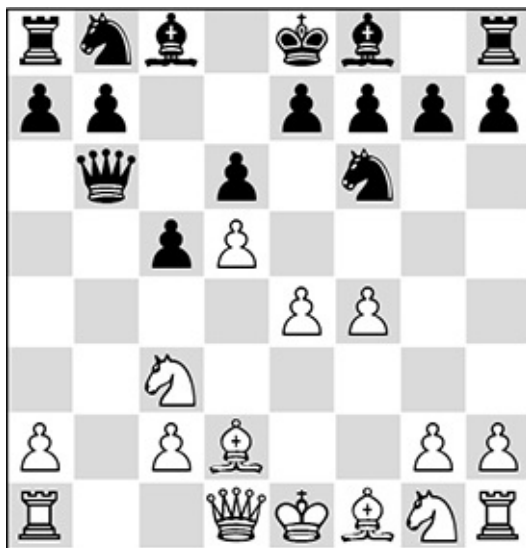
5. ♖d2

White sacrifices a pawn: his compensation is based on the half-open b-file and better development. White's plan is to advance his centre pawns with f2-f4 and e2-e4, followed by e4-e5 or f4-f5, to build up a strong attack against the black king.

5... ♟b6 6.e4 e5

One of the possible defences is immediately to obstruct White's intended e4-e5 advance by playing ...e7-e5 himself, and nowadays this is regarded as Black's strongest defence.

The alternative is 6...d6 7.f4 and now there are three options for Black:



analysis diagram

A) 7...g6?! 8.e5! ♞fd7 (8...dxe5 9.fxe5 ♞fd7 10.♞f3 ♞g7 11.♞b1 ♞d8 12.e6!± Vaganian-Kupreichik, Leningrad 1974) 9.♞f3 a6! (9...♞g7?! 10.♞b1 ♞d8 11.e6! fxe6 12.♞g5 ♞f8 13.♞b5+ ♞d7 14.dxe6± 14...♞xb5 15.♞xb5! ♞c8 16.0-0 a6 (16...♞c6? 17.f5+– Zubarev-Zinchenko, Rethymnon 2011) 17.♞c3? (17.♞xd6+! exd6 18.♞f7+–) 17...axb5 18.♞xg7 ♞g8 19.♞xf8 ♞xf8 20.♞xh7± Vaganian-Jansa, Kragujevac 1974) 10.♞b1 (10.♞c4±) 10... ♞c7 11.e6 (11.♞g5∞) 11...fxe6 12.♞g5 ♞f6 13.dxe6 ♞g7 with a slight advantage to Black in Vachev-Stanojoski, Albena 2011;

B) Black's best response is 7...e6 and now: 8.♞b1 (8.♞f3 exd5 9.e5 (9.♞b1=) 9...dxe5 10.fxe5 ♞e4 11.♞xd5 ♞d8 12.c4∞ McShane-Ni Hua, Bled 2002; 8.♞b5+!?) 8...♞c7 (8...♞d8 9.♞b5+ ♞d7 10.dxe6 fxe6∞ Hodgson-Glavina, Spain tt 1993) 9.♞f3 a6 10.dxe6 fxe6∞ Moskalenko-Erdogdu, Ankara 2010;

C) 7...♞bd7?! is dubious, because this square might be needed by the f6-

knight: 8. ♖f3 g6? (an error which hands White a clear advantage; the best defence was 8... ♗c7 9. ♕e2 ♖g4 (9... a6 10. e5±) 10. h3 ♖h6±, although White maintains the advantage; instead, 8... e5? loses to 9. dxe6 fxe6 10. ♖g5 ♖b8 11. ♗c4+—) 9. e5! dxe5 (any move of the knight is answered with 10. e6) 10. fxe5 ♖g4 11. ♖b1 ♗d8 (if 11... ♗c7 then 12. e6 and now Black's best is to sacrifice the piece with 12... ♗g7 13. exd7+ ♗xd7 14. ♗b5 0-0, but White should win, since Black has only two pawns for the piece) 12. e6!+— and Black's development is a disaster, Caselas-Khamrakulov, Ortigueira 2004.

7.f4 d6 8.f5

The idea of this move is to shut in the bishop on c8 and prepare a kingside pawn storm with g4-g5.

White has many options in this position, as we shall see:

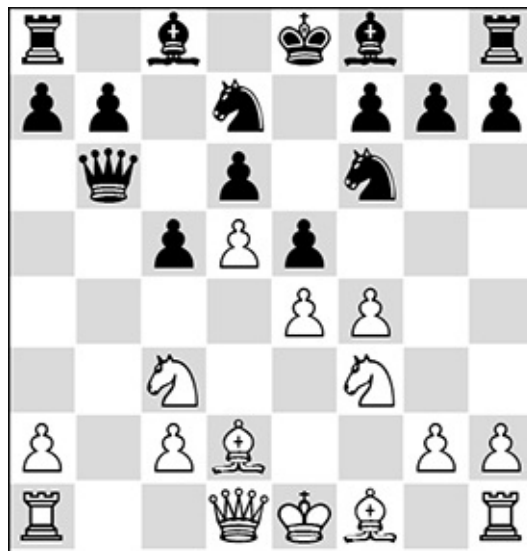
A) 8. ♖f3 (I think that it is better to exchange first on e5, to prevent ...exf4) and now:

A1) 8... exf4! looks best to me; now we have:

A11 9. e5 dxe5 10. ♖xe5 ♗e7 11. ♖b1 ♗d8 12. ♗b5+, with compensation;

A12) 9. ♖b1 ♗d8 10. ♗xf4 ♗e7 11. ♗d3 (11. ♗b5!?) 11... 0-0 12. 0-0 ♖bd7 13. h3 Nguyen Ngoc-Karatorossian, Budapest 2004.

A2) 8... ♖bd7 is the most common reply, but White stands very well.



analysis diagram

Two famous games continued 9. fxe5 dxe5 10. ♗c4 ♗e7 (10... ♗d8 11. ♖b1 ♗d6 12. 0-0 0-0 13. ♗g5 h6 14. ♗h4 a6 15. a4 ♗a5 16. ♗e1 Nakamura-Nijboer, Wijk aan Zee 2004) 11. ♖b1 ♗d8 12. ♗g5 h6 13. d6 hxg5 14. ♖xg5 0-0 15. 0-0± Bruzon-Nijboer, Wijk aan Zee 2004.

B) It is better for White to exchange on e5 right away: 8. fxe5 dxe5 9. ♖f3 ♗d6

(9... ♖bd7 transposes to the previous note) 10. ♕c4 a6 11.0-0 ♕g4?! (11...0-0 12.a4♞) 12.h3 ♕h5 13.a4± Liascovich-Julia, Villa Martelli 2008;

C) Another option is to insert 8. ♜b1 ♞d8 and now:

C1) 9.fxe5 dxe5 10. ♖f3 and now:

C11) 10... ♖bd7 11. ♕e2 g6?! (11... ♕d6=) 12.0-0 ♕g7 13. ♕g5± Kanep-Landa, Deizisau 2003;

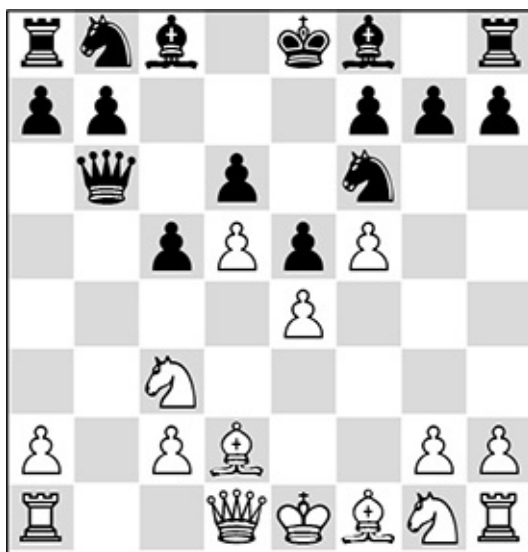
C12) 10... ♕d6 11. ♕c4 a6 12.a4 0-0 13.0-0♞ Romcovici-Belosvetov, Illichevsk 2008.

C2) 9. ♖f3 ♖bd7 10.fxe5! ♖xe5 11. ♖xe5 dxe5 12. ♕b5+ ♖d7? (12... ♕d7=) 13.0-0± Christiansen-De Firmian, cr 2001.

D) Finally, 8. ♕b5+ has also been played, and now:

D1) 8... ♕d7 9. ♕xd7+ (9.fxe5 dxe5 10. ♕c4♞) 9... ♖bxd7 10.f5 h5 11. ♖f3 a6 12.a4 ♕e7 13.0-0 c4+ 14. ♞h1 ♞c7 15. ♞e2♞ Kekelidze-Griggs, Wheeling 2013;

D2) 8... ♖bd7 9. ♖f3 (9.fxe5 dxe5 10. ♞e2♞) 9...a6 10. ♕xd7+ ♖xd7 11.f5 (11.0-0♞) 11... ♕e7♞ 12.g4? h6 13. ♞e2♞ Moskalenko-Movsziszian, Sitges 2007.



8... ♕e7

Black has also tried the immediate 8...h5!? 9. ♖f3 ♖bd7 (9... ♕e7 10.a4 ♞d8 11. ♕e2 ♖a6 12.0-0 ♖b4 13.h4♞ Panjwani-Bercys, Philadelphia 2008) 10. ♕d3 (10. ♕c4♞) 10...a6 11. ♞e2 ♕e7= Bricard-Nevednichy, Montpellier 2003.

There is also 8...g6 9. ♞f3 (9.g4 gxf5 10.gxf5 ♜g8 11. ♞f3 ♖bd7 12. ♖h3 a6 13.a4 ♞c7♞ Karttunen-Anjuhin, Finland tt 2007) 9...gxf5 10. ♕b5+?! (10. exf5=) 10... ♖bd7 (10... ♞d8♞) 11.exf5?! (11. ♞xf5=) 11...a6 12. ♕e2 (12. ♕xd7+) 12... ♜g8♞ Cheng-Moiseenko, Edmonton 2008.

9.g4



An aggressive move, continuing the plan instigated with f4-f5. White has also played 9. ♔f3 ♘a6 10.g4 ♘b4 11. ♔d1 ♙d7 (11... ♘d7=) 12.a3± Mertanen-Vepkhvishvili, Tallinn 2014.

9...h6

Another option is 9... ♘a6 10. ♖b1 (10. g5) 10... ♔d8 11.g5 ♘d7 12.h4 ♘c7, with complex play, Wojtaszek-Czaron, Sroda Wielkopolska 2004.

10.h4 h5

Trying to restrain the advance of the white pawns and conquer the g4-square. Black has also tried 10... ♘a6 11. ♖b1 ♔d8 12. ♔f3 ♘d7 ♘f6 Prié-Cossin, Caen 2011, and 10... ♔d8 11. ♔f3 (11. ♖h3!) 11... ♘h7 (11... ♘fd7) 12. ♔g3 ♖g8 13. ♘f3 f6 (13...g6=) 14. ♙h3 (14. ♙c4±) 14... ♘d7 15. ♔f2 ♖b8 16.a4± Lahiri-Tukhaev, Alushta 2005.

11. ♖b1 ♔c7 12.g5 ♘g4 13. ♙e2

It seems better to develop the knight before the bishop, for example 13. ♘ge2 ♘d7 14. ♘g3 g6 15. ♙e2±.

13...a6

It was better to play 13...g6 14. ♙xg4 (14.f6 ♙d8) 14...hxg4 15.f6 (15. ♙xg4 ♙d7) 15... ♙d8 16. ♘ge2∞.

14.a4

It was also possible to capture: 14. ♙xg4 hxg4 15. ♙xg4=.

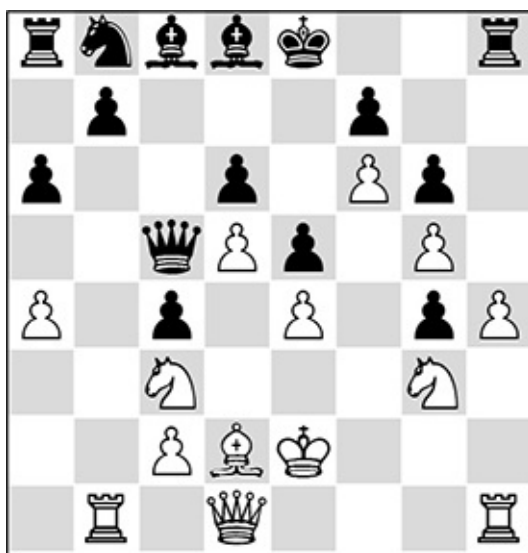
14...g6 15. ♙xg4 hxg4



16.f6!

White gains space and drives Black's bishop into passivity on d8. It is difficult for Black to develop his pieces and his king has no safe haven. This position is very comfortable for White to play. Less clear is 16. ♖xg4 ♜d7 17. ♘ge2 gxf5 18. exf5 ♜xf5 19. ♜e4.

16... ♞d8 17. ♘ge2 c4 18. ♘g3 ♜c5 19. ♜e2!!



A bold and excellent move by Prié: the king advances into the centre but, since the position is fairly closed, there is no risk involved. White wants to connect his rook and his queen and he is planning to play h4-h5. I think that in this position White already has a decisive advantage; the engines do not think so at first, but the longer they are left to analyse the clearer the advantage becomes. It is a very interesting position and Prié handles it in masterly fashion.

19... ♖a5

Or 19... ♔d7 20.h5 gxh5 21. ♖xh5 ♖xh5 (21... ♖f8 22. ♖h7±) 22. ♗xh5 ♔c7 23. ♙e3 ♚a3 24.g6+–.

20.h5! gxh5 21. ♗xh5 ♖g8

After 21... ♖f8 22. ♗g7+ ♔d8 23. ♙e3 ♚c7 24. ♖h7+– White wins with the threat of 25. ♗e6!; 21... ♔d8 also loses: 22. ♗g7 ♖h3 23. ♖xh3 gxh3 24. ♗e6+! ♙xe6 (24... fxe6 25.g6+–) 25.dxe6, again with a decisive advantage for White.

22. ♗g7+ ♚f8

How to continue White's attack?

23. ♚f1

This move wins, but the best and most attractive finish was with 23. ♗e6+!!, after which Black has no satisfactory defence:

A) 23... fxe6 24.g6! ♖xg6 25. ♖h8+ ♖g8 (25... ♔f7 26. ♚h1 forces mate: 26... ♔xf6 27. ♚h4+ ♔f7 28. ♖f1+ ♔g7 29. ♚h7 mate) 26. ♚h1 with mate soon;

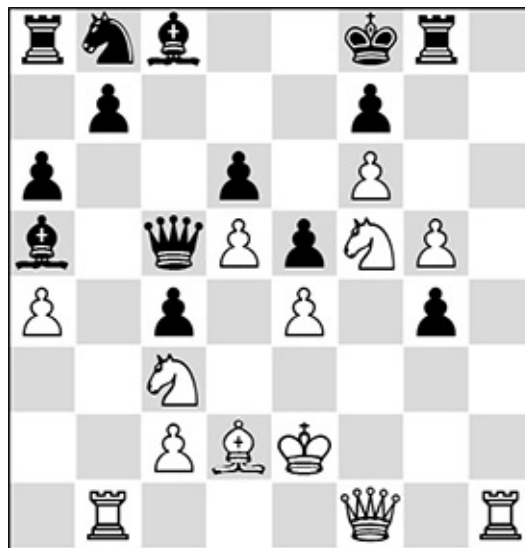
B) 23... ♙xe6 24.dxe6 ♗c6 (24... fxe6 25.g6+– is similar to the previous variation) 25.exf7 ♚xf7 26. ♖xb7+ ♚f8 27.g6, and wins.

23... ♗d4

There was no salvation in 23... ♗xc3 24. ♗xc3 g3 25. ♚f3 ♗d7 26. ♖h7 ♚f2+ 27. ♚xf2 gxf2 28. ♗f5 ♖xg5 29. ♗h6 ♗xf6 30. ♖xf7+ ♚e8 31. ♖xf6+–.

24. ♗f5! ♚c5

24... ♗xf5 is no use, since after 25. ♚xf5, threatening mate on c8, 25... ♔e8 26. ♚c8+ ♗d8 27.g6, the engines announce that it is mate in eight moves; White's attack is unstoppable.



25. ♖h7

There was a quicker win here with 25.g6 ♖xg6 (25...fxg6 26. ♖h7+–) 26. ♖h8+ ♖g8 27. ♗h6++–.

25...g3 26. ♗e3

Again 26.g6! was better.

26... ♖a3 27. ♗h3

1-0

Once again 27.g6 was quicker, but Black resigned because mate is near. The threat is 28. ♖xf7. A possible continuation after 27. ♗h3 would be 27... ♖e8 28. ♖h8 ♖xh8 29. ♗xh8+ ♖d7 30. ♗e7 ♗c6 31. ♗xc6 bxc6 32.dxc6+ ♖c7 33. ♗d5+ ♖xc6 34. ♗e8+ ♗d7 35. ♗xa8 mate.

SUMMARY

In this game we have looked at the variations following the move 3.d5, taking the game into a Benoni set-up. Black played 3... ♗b6 once more and we reached the so-called Vaganian Gambit, a very interesting line, usually arising from the Trompowsky Opening 2. ♗g5, where White gains very good compensation for a pawn in the shape of the half-open b-file and a strong pawn centre. In the game we saw Black's option of playing ...e7-e5, which is considered best; White has several plans available but in this game we saw the one of closing the centre with f4-f5, followed by advancing the kingside pawns with g4-g5. Black ended up very cramped after White played f5-f6. It is hard to spot exactly where Black went wrong, but after the surprising 19. ♖e2!! White had a decisive advantage. White won with his kingside attack and Black's queenside pieces played no part in the game whatsoever.

CONCLUSION

In this chapter we saw the Benoni Defence against the London System. Most of the time White abstains from d4-d5 and avoids the Benoni Defence as such. Black can employ the plan of ...c7-c5 and ... ♗b6 to attack b2, as we saw in Game 31, but if he cannot take on b2 then ... ♗b6 is not a good move, because the queen is left exposed. In the game White gained a very good space advantage after the opening and was able to play at will on either wing. Finally White sacrificed a piece and gained a winning attack against the black king.

If Black wants to play ... ♗b6 it is better to do so right away, without ...

e7-e6, as in Game 32, where the b2-pawn can be captured, but then Black must be prepared to accept the draw by repetition that White can force. If White wants to play for a win instead, then we reach a complicated position, one which is difficult to assess, where Black sacrifices the queen for a rook, a piece and a pawn. An alternative for White, if he dislikes such a complicated game, is 3.dxc5.

In Game 33 we saw White advancing with d4-d5 and we analysed Black's various options. We focused on the so-called Vaganian Gambit, where White sacrifices the b2-pawn for very good compensation. This variation is usually reached from the Trompowsky. Black has two ways to defend: one is with ...e7-e5, trying to close the centre as in Game 33. The other method is to play ...d7-d6, allowing White to build a strong pawn centre and then break with e4-e5 and e5-e6.

Chapter 6

The London System versus the Dutch

1.d4 f5 2. ♘ f3 ♘ f6 3. ♙ f4

1.d4 f5 2. ♘ f3
2. ♘ c3 d5 3. ♙ f4
2... ♘ f6 3. ♙ f4



3...d6
3...e6; 3...g6
4.h3
4.e3
4...g6 5.e3
5.c3
5... ♙ g7 6. ♙ c4
6. ♙ e2; 6. ♘ bd2

In this chapter we are going to see the Dutch Defence against the London System. There are several options for White, but the traditional London scheme

works quite well here, because it prevents ...e7-e5, which is Black's main idea. Depending on which variation Black chooses, Leningrad, Classical or Stonewall, White can choose between several plans. Against the Leningrad it is interesting to play ♖c4, making it difficult for Black to castle. There are some interesting variations for White involving queenside castling and g2-g4, but he can also simply play the normal London plan.

Playing the London System against the Dutch tends to produce positions which are quite complex and normally open, in contrast to the other variations of the London which tend to be quieter or more closed. It is essential for White to be willing to play actively and take risks.

Game 34

Dutch Defence
Levon Aronian

2812

Loek Van Wely

2672

Wijk aan Zee 2014 (11)
1.d4 f5 2.♘f3 ♘f6 3.♙f4



Recently Aronian has been playing the London System against the Dutch. Further on we shall see the idea of playing ♘c3, which usually leads, after ...d7-d5, to variations of the Stonewall.

3...d6 4.e3 h6!?

This move has been played only rarely. The idea is to play ...g7-g5. The normal move in the Leningrad is 4...g6, which we shall see in the next game.

5.h3 g5 6.♙h2 ♙g7 7.♘bd2

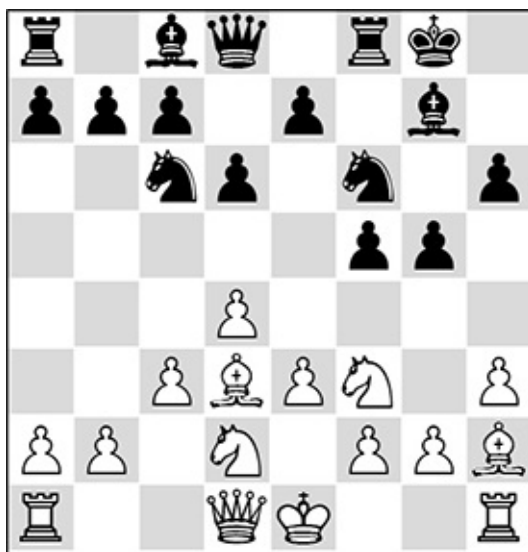
It seems better to play Kovacevic's idea of 7. ♖e2 (7. ♖d3!?) 7...e6 8.c4 ♗e7 9. ♘c3 0-0 10.0-0 b6 11. ♖c1± Kovacevic-Avshalumov, Paris 1992.

7...0-0

An earlier game had continued 7... ♘c6 8. ♖c4 (8.a3±, to prevent ... ♘b4 in answer to ♖d3) 8...e6 9. ♗e2 a6 10.c3= Scekic-Kontic, Mataruska Banja 1997.

8.c3 ♘c6 9. ♖d3

White, for the present, is preventing Black's main plan, which is to advance with ...e7-e5. White is preparing to advance in the centre himself with e2-e4 at an opportune moment. If Black plays ...g5-g4, this would weaken his kingside.



9... ♖b8!?

A strange move; I think that the idea is not so much to play ...b7-b5, but rather to defend the b7-pawn, so as to be able to develop the c8-bishop without any problems, preventing the queen check on b3 followed by the capture of the b7-pawn.

10.0-0 ♗e8 11. ♖e1

It was better to play 11. ♗c2 immediately, attacking f5, e.g. 11...g4 (11...e6 12.e4±) 12.hxg4 ♘xg4 13. ♖g3 e5 14.dxe5 dxe5 15.e4 f4 16. ♖h4±. The rook normally goes to d1, since on e1 it is not so well placed. This position is very similar to some arising from the King's Indian.

11... ♗h5

This square is the usual one for the black queen in the main line of the Leningrad. Normally White will have played g2-g3 and ♖g2 and Black typically wants to play ...e7-e5, ...f5-f4 and ... ♖h3, exchanging the bishops; but the situation here is different and the advance of the black pawns is not so dangerous. White defends well and plays in the centre and on the queenside,

with advantage. Black should have played 11...e5 12.dxe5 dxe5 13.♖c2 e4 14.♙c4+ ♕e6 (14...♖h8 15.♘d4±) 15.♗b3 ♙xc4 16.♘xc4 ♖h7 17.♘d4±.

12.♗c2

12.♗b3+ was a very annoying check. Black would have had to play 12...♗f7 (12...♖h8 13.d5 ♘d8 14.♘d4±) 13.e4 (13.♗c2±) 13...fxe4 14.♘xe4 ♗xb3 (14...♙e6?? 15.♘xf6+) 15.axb3 and, despite the exchange of queens, White is better.

12...g4 13.hxg4 ♘xg4

Now 13...fxg4? fails to 14.♙g6 ♗a5 15.b4 ♗b6 16.♘h4±.



14.♙b5?!

I have played this type of position several times, usually reaching it from the King's Indian. White should move his bishop to g3, not allowing it to be exchanged for the knight, because it is a good defender of the castled position. So White should play 14.♙g3, and after 14...e5:

A) 15.♘h4 e4 16.♙c4+ ♖h8 17.♘xe4 (17.f3) 17...fxe4 (17...d5 18.♙xd5 ♘e7 19.♙b3 fxe4 20.♗xe4 ♘f5 21.♘xf5 ♙xf5 22.♗d5±) 18.♗xe4 ♙f5 19.♘xf5 ♗xf5 20.♗xf5 ♖xf5 21.♙e6 ♖g5 22.♙f4 ♘f6 23.♙xg5 hxg5 24.f3 with a slight advantage;

B) 15.dxe5 dxe5 (15...♘cxe5 16.♙e2±) 16.♙e2 (16.e4 f4 17.♙h4 ♖h8∞) 16...♙e6 (16...♗f7±; 16...f4 17.exf4 exf4 18.♗b3+ ♖h7 19.♙h4±) 17.♘h2±

.

14...♖h8

It was better to eliminate the bishop with 14...♘xh2 15.♘xh2, when White's advantage is minimal.

15.♗b3

But not 15. ♖g3? now, since 15...f4 would win a piece, owing to the attack on b5.

15... ♖d8?!

Again it was better to play 15... ♖xh2.

16. ♖g3!



Aronian finally safeguards his bishop from exchange, with a clear advantage.

16...e5 17.dxe5 dxe5 18. ♖b4?!

One of White's plans in such positions is to double the rooks quickly on the d-file, so it was better to play 18. ♖ad1±.

18... ♖e6?!

Here 18...a6! 19. ♖e2 ♖c6= was good.

19. ♖ad1?

Now it was better to retreat the bishop with 19. ♖e2±.

19...c5?

19...e4! was possible, e.g. 20. ♖h2 (20. ♖d4? c5) and now 20...f4!? is interesting, e.g. 21.exf4 e3 22. ♖xg4 (22. fxe3 ♖xe3 23. ♖xe3 ♖xd1+ 24. ♖hf1 ♖) 22...exd2 23. ♖xd2 ♖xg4. But safer is 20... ♖e5! 21. ♖xe5+ ♖xe5 and if anything I prefer Black in this position.

20. ♖b3 ♖c7

Now 20...e4 fails to 21. ♖xb8.

21. ♖e2 ♖e6 22. ♖c4 ♖d7 23. ♖e2

Here 23. ♖a3 was good, winning a pawn with the double attack on a7 and c5, with a clear advantage.

23...f4 24.exf4 exf4 25. ♖h4 ♖c6



Black threatens to create counterplay with 26... ♖g8. What should White play now?

26. ♗e7?!

Here 26. ♗h2! was good: 26... ♙xh4 27. ♗xg4 ♜be8 (27... ♖g8 28. ♗df3 ♙f6 29. ♗e5) 28. ♜xe8 ♜xe8 29. ♗f3 and White has a substantial advantage.

26... ♜f7?

It was much better to play 26... ♖g8, to answer 27. ♗c4 with 27... ♗e5!, with the following possibilities:



analysis diagram

A) 28. ♗h4 ♗xg2 29. ♗xg8 ♙g4 30. ♗xg2 (30. ♗c4 f3) 30...f3 31. ♗xf3 ♗xf3+ 32. ♙f1 ♜xg8, with good compensation; if Black wants, he can draw with 32... ♗h2+;

B) 28. ♖xg8 ♜xg8 29. ♗xe5 (29. ♜xe5 ♖xe5 30. ♜e1 ♜g6 31. ♗g5 ♗d5 32. ♜xe5 ♗xe7 33. ♜e6=) 29... ♖xe5 30.f3 ♗d5 31. ♖xc5 ♗e3 and once again Black is better.

27. ♖c4 ♗d5 28. ♖h4?!

It was better to play 28. ♖d6 ♜c8 (28... ♜d8 29. ♗e4) 29. ♗f1 ♜f5 30. ♜d2±.

28... ♜f5?

Black could have equalised with 28... ♜g8.

29. ♖d3 ♜ff8 30. ♖b1 ♜be8 31. ♜xe8

31. ♜c4± was stronger.

31... ♜xe8 32. ♗e4?

32. ♜c2 ♗df6 33. ♜g6± was better.

32... ♗de3?!

Both players were short of time, which partly explains the inaccurate play. Black therefore played this move to complicate the game, although it was better to play 32... ♗e5! 33. ♗ed2 ♗xf3+ 34. ♗xf3 ♗f6 35. ♖xf6 ♖xf6 and Black has a clear advantage in this position, with the bishop pair and the half-open g-file.

33.fxe3 ♖xe4 34. ♖xe4 ♜xe4 35. ♜xb7

It would have been better to play 35.exf4 ♜xf4 36. ♜d8+ ♜f8 37. ♜xf8+ ♖xf8 38. ♜xb7, with a clear advantage to White.

35... ♜g6

If 35... ♜xe3 then 36. ♜b8+ ♜e8 37. ♜xf4±.

36. ♜d8+?!

Safer was 36.exf4±.

36... ♜h7 37. ♜d5?

An error. White should have played 37. ♜d6 ♜e6 38. ♜xe6 ♜xe6 39.exf4 ♜e3+ 40. ♜h1 ♜xf4 41. ♜xa7±.

37... ♜e6= 38.exf4??



A blunder by Aronian which loses the game.

Such serious tactical errors are quite rare among the chess elite but, as we can see, even the great players are human and can make mistakes.

It was necessary to play 38. ♖e1, with a balanced position. This position will no doubt feature in basic tactics books of the future: it is Black to play and win.

38... ♜d4+!

Aronian resigned because the back-rank mate is unstoppable, except by giving up the queen, since after 39. ♔h1 ♚b1+ 40. ♙e1 ♜xe1+ 41. ♙xe1 ♚xe1 is mate.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw a fairly unusual plan for Black with ...h7-h6 and ...g7-g5, instead of the normal Leningrad move ...g7-g6. These pawn advances left Black's kingside slightly weak and White emerged from the opening with an advantage. The position is similar to some variations that can arise from the King's Indian. In the middlegame Aronian did not play well. Remember that White should not allow the dark-squared bishop to be exchanged for a black knight. White should have played 14. ♙g3. White's best plan is to double rooks on the d-file and play on the queenside. In some variations it is possible to advance with e3-e4. The black position looks menacing on the kingside but White can easily repel the black attack. Time pressure caused both players to make quite a few errors. Aronian had a clear advantage at several points in the game but spoiled things in the last few moves, including the serious tactical error 38.exf4, which allowed Black a simple finish.

Game 35

Dutch Defence

Carlos Garcia Palermo

2459

Marco Corvi

2325

Frascati 2005 (9)

1.d4 f5 2.♘f3

An interesting alternative is 2.♙f4 ♘f6 3.e3 g6 (3...d6 is better) 4.h4!?:

A) 4...♙g7 5.h5 ♘xh5? (5...d6 6.h6 ♙f8 7.♘c3±) 6.♙xh5 gxh5 7.♙xh5+ ♙f8 8.♙xf5+ ♙g8 (8...♙f6 9.♙h6+) 9.♘c3 e6 10.♙h5 d6 11.0-0-0±;

B) 4...h6 and now:

B1) 5.♘c3 ♙g7 6.♙c4 (6.♙f3±) 6...d6 7.♘ge2 (7.♙f3±) 7...e6 8.♙d2 ♙e7 9.0-0-0 a6∞ Sjöberg-Berg, Stockholm 1998;

B2) 5.c4 d6 6.♘c3 ♙g7 7.♘f3 ♙bd7 8.♙c2 (8.c5±) 8...c5 9.d5 a6= Morozevich-Ivanchuk, Moscow 2009.

2...♘f6 3.♙f4 d6 4.h3 g6

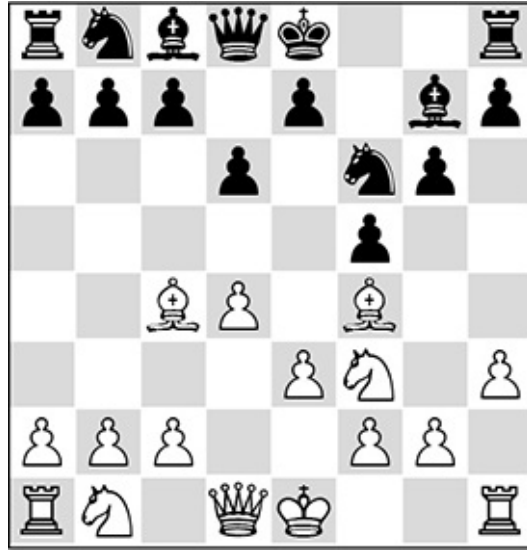


The normal line of the Leningrad.

5.e3

Another similar idea to hinder Black from castling is 5.c3 ♙g7 6.♙b3!? e6 7.♘bd2 ♘c6 8.e3 ♙e7 9.0-0-0 0-0 10.g4 fxg4 11.hxg4 ♘xg4 12.♙g3, which gave White very good compensation and an eventual win in Garcia Palermo-Rodi, Pinamar 2004.

5...♙g7 6.♙c4!



This is an unpleasant move against the Leningrad, because it makes it difficult for Black to castle; to accomplish this Black will have to play ...e7-e6 or ...d7-d5, neither of which usually forms part of his plan.

Aronian and Grachev chose 6. ♖e2, which is also playable, although this seems a rather inferior square for the bishop: 6...0-0 7.0-0 (7. ♖h2 ♔h8 8.0-0 ♕e6 9.c4 ♖g8 10. ♘c3 ♘bd7 11. ♚c1± Grachev-Cherniaev, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013) 7...e6 8. ♖h2 (8.c4±) 8... ♘c6 9. ♘bd2 ♙e7 10.c3± Aronian-Caruana, Zurich rapid 2014.

White has also tried 6. ♘bd2 ♘c6 7.c3 0-0 8. ♙b3+ (8. ♖c4+ e6 9.0-0±) 8... ♔h8 9.0-0-0!? (9. ♖h2±) 9... ♙e8= Hodgson-M.Gurevich, Haifa 1989.

6...e6

6...d5 7. ♖b3± would be dubious.

7.g4!?

An interesting and very aggressive idea. Other quieter, and better, options are: 7.0-0 0-0 8. ♖h2 (8. ♘c3±) 8... ♙e7 9.b4?! (9. ♘bd2) 9...a5= Khrushchiov-Fazulyanov, Cheliabinsk 2008, and 7. ♘c3 ♙e7 8. ♙e2 (8.0-0±) 8... ♘bd7 9.a4 (9.0-0±) 9...c6 10.a5 ♘e4 11. ♖h2 e5= Miladinovic-Grivas, Ano Liosia 1995.



7... ♖e7

Black declines the pawn, because he would stand worse after 7...fxg4 8.hxg4 ♘xg4? (8...0-0 9.♗c3±) 9.♗g5 ♗f6 10.♙xe6±; 7...a6 has also been played, e.g. 8.gxf5 exf5 9.♗bd2 (9.♙g1±) 9...♗c6 10.a3 ♖e7 11.♙e2 ♙d7= Moor-Gabrielsen, Oslo 2011.

8. ♗c3

Or 8.gxf5 exf5 (8...gxf5 9.♙g1±) 9.♗c3 ♗bd7 10.♙e2 ♗b6 11.♙b3 ♙d7 12.0-0-0 0-0-0=.

8... ♗bd7

If 8...fxg4 then 9.hxg4 ♘xg4 10.♙e2, and White, after castling queenside, will have very good compensation, thanks to the half-open g- and h- files.

9.gxf5 gxf5

The alternative was 9...exf5, with the idea of castling queenside.

10. ♙g1 ♗b6 11. ♙b3 ♙d7 12.a4

White is now planning to dispense with castling. Instead, 12.♙e2 0-0-0 13.0-0-0 ♙hg8 would lead to equality.

12...a5?!

It was better to play 12...♗bd5 (12...0-0-0=) 13.♗xd5 ♗xd5 14.♙xd5 exd5 15.♙d2 0-0-0=.

13. ♗b5 ♙xb5 14.axb5 ♗bd5 15. ♙g5 b6?

This is a decisive error. It was better to play 15...♙f7 16.♗d2 ♙g8 17.c4 ♗b4 18.♙f3±.



16. d4!

This simple move wins material with the twin threats of Qxd5 and Bxf5.

16... f7

If 16...0-0-0 then 17. Qxd5 exd5 18. Bxf5; or 16... d7 17. Bxf5 exf5 18. f3.

17. Bxf5 exf5

If 17... e4 then 18. Qh4 and again White wins after 18...exf5 (18... xf5 19. Qxd5 exd5 20. Bxg7) 19. Qxd5 xf5 20. Bxg7.

18. Qxf6 Bxf6

After 18... Qxf6 White recovers the piece with 19. f3, with a decisive advantage.

19. f3+ e7 20. Qxd5 Bae8



White has a winning advantage: he is a pawn up, the black king is stranded in

the centre and there are bishops of opposite colour, which usually help the attacking side.

21. ♖d2! f4 22. ♗g5

White proceeds carefully, but it was more forceful to play 22. ♖c6 ♜eg8 23. ♗g4! fxe3+ 24. fxe3 ♜e6 25. ♗xe6+ ♜xe6 26. c4, winning more material.

22... ♗h6 23. ♗xf6+ ♜xf6 24. e4 ♜e7 25. ♜a4 ♗g5 26. ♜e2 ♜he8 27. ♜f3

The game is decided and Black can do nothing to save himself.

27... ♜g7 28. ♜c4 ♜ge7 29. ♜c6

White could have won a piece here with 29. e5+!, since if 29... dxe5 White wins with 30. ♜c6+ ♜g7 (30... ♜f5 31. ♗e4+) 31. ♜xg5+-, while if 29... ♜f5 then 30. ♗e4+ ♜e6 31. ♜xg5 wins.

29... h6 30. h4 ♗xh4 31. e5+ ♜f5 32. ♗e4+ ♜e6 33. ♜g6+ ♜d7

After 33... ♜f7 34. ♜xh6 ♗g5 35. ♜h5 Black would lose the bishop.

34. ♗f5+

Black resigned, since he will be mated after 34... ♜d8 35. ♜gxd6+ cxd6 36. ♜c8+.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the London System in action against the Leningrad (Dutch Defence with ...g7-g6). White used the unpleasant idea of 6. ♗c4, which prevents Black from castling in the normal way. After Black played 6...e6 White used the aggressive advance 7. g4, although he can also play more conservatively with kingside castling or 7. ♗c3, with a slight but stable advantage. White abstained from castling and gained the advantage after a couple of bad moves by Black, who had equalised after the opening. It is worth noting the simple idea of 16. ♗h4, which gave White a decisive advantage, since he not only won a pawn but also had the better position and an attack. The presence of bishops of opposite colour favours the attacking side and White decided the game on the light squares.

Game 36

Dutch

Vladimir Georgiev

2540

Francisco Vallejo Pons

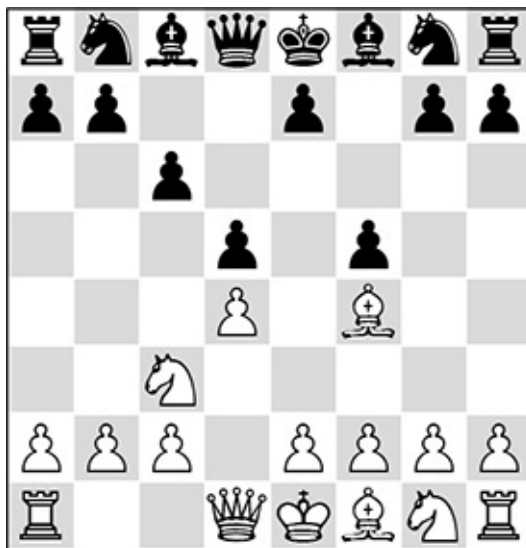
2450

Elgoibar 1998 (7)

1. d4 f5 2. ♗c3

The line with 2. ♖c3 and 3. ♕f4 is a very popular variation against the Dutch, normally resulting in the adoption of a type of Stonewall set-up by Black. The natural move order of the London System would be 2. ♕f4 ♖f6 3. e3 e6 4. ♖c3 d5 5. ♕d3 c6. Instead, a more classical approach would be 4. ♖f3 d5 5. c4 ♕d6 (5... ♕e7) 6. ♖c3 (6. ♕xd6 ♖xd6 7. ♖c3±; or 6... cxd6 7. cxd5 ♖xd5 8. ♕c4 ♖b6 9. ♕b3±) 6... c6 7. ♕d3 0-0 8. 0-0 ♖e7 9. c5 ♕xf4 10. exf4 ♖bd7 11. ♖a4± Van Wely-Rakhmanov, Baku 2008.

2...d5 3. ♕f4 c6



This move order is designed to avoid lines with ♖b5. The move ...a7-a6 is also played for the same reason.

If Black plays 3... ♖f6 instead, White has two main options:

A) 4. e3 a6 (4... e6; 4... c6) 5. ♖f3 (5. ♕d3) 5... e6 6. ♕d3 c5 7. dxc5 (7. 0-0 c4 8. ♕e2 ♖c6 9. ♖e5± Dzagnidze-A. Muzychuk, Beijing 2013) 7... ♕xc5 8. 0-0 ♖c6 9. ♖e2 0-0 (9... ♖e7 10. ♖ed4 ♕d6 11. ♕xd6 ♖xd6 12. c4± A. l'Ami-Moynihan, Bunratty 2014) 10. c4 and now:

A1) 10... ♖b6 11. ♖c1 (11. ♖c3±) 11... ♖d8 12. ♖b3?! (12. a3) 12... ♖xb3 13. axb3= Grigoryan-Panbukchian, Golden Sands 2013;

A2) 10... ♖b4, again with several examples:

A21) 11. a3 ♖xd3 12. ♖xd3 ♕d7 13. ♖ed4 (13. ♖e5 ♕d6 14. ♖fd1 ♖c8 15. ♖xd7 ♖xd7 16. ♖ac1 ♖fd8= Svetushkin-Sivuk, St Petersburg 2010) 13... ♖c8 14. cxd5 ♖xd5 15. ♖e5± Svetushkin-Zygouris, Nikea 2011;

A22) 11. ♖c3 ♖xd3 12. ♖xd3 dxc4 13. ♖xc4 ♖e7 14. ♖ac1 ♕d7 15. ♖e5 b5 16. ♖b3 ♖fc8 17. ♖xd7 ♖xd7 18. ♖fd1±, Gelfand-Nakamura, Zurich 2014.

B) 4. ♖b5! ♖a6, and now:

B1) 5. e3 e6 (5... c6 6. ♖c3 ♖c7 7. ♕d3 g6 8. ♖ce2 ♕g7 9. ♖f3 ♖e6 10. ♕e5

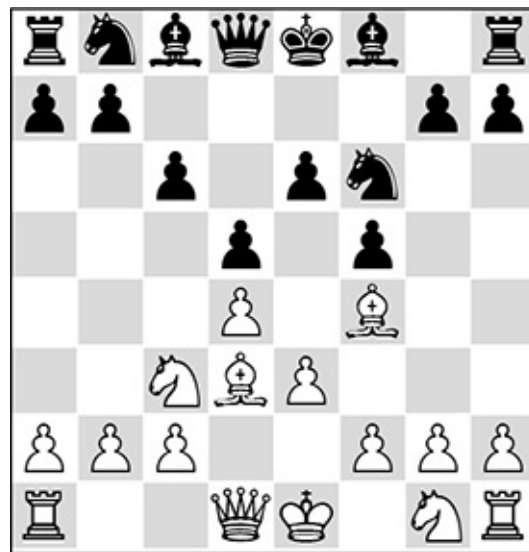
0-0 11.0-0± Hillarp Persson-Mohammadi, Tylosand 2012) 6.♘f3 c6 7.♘c3 ♘c7 8.♙d3 ♙e7 9.0-0 0-0 10.♘e2 ♘ce8 11.c4 ♘d6 12.c5 ♘f7± Zubov-Firman, Alushta 2009;

B2) 5.c4 (5.♘f3±, 5.a3±) 5...e6 6.♘f3 dxc4 7.g3?! (7.e3±) 7...♙d7 8.♘c3 ♙c6= Grischuk-Nakamura, Monaco (blind) 2011.

4.e3 ♘f6 5.♙d3

Another option is 5.♘f3 g6!? (5...e6) 6.♙d3 ♙g7 7.0-0 ♘bd7 8.♘e2± Gelfand-Nakamura, Moscow 2013.

5...e6



So now we have the Stonewall against the London System.

6.♘f3 ♙e7

In the Stonewall Black normally plays ...♙d6, but since White has his bishop on f4 he decides to avoid this. In such positions, White generally seeks the exchange of Black's 'good' dark-squared bishop, leaving Black with the 'bad' one on c8. However, there have also been games with ...♙d6:

6...♙d6 7.0-0 0-0 (7...♙xf4 8.exf4±) 8.♘e2 ♙e7 9.c4 ♘e4 (9...♘bd7 10.♙c1 e5 11.dxe5 ♘xe5 12.♘xe5 ♙xe5 13.♙b3± Polak-Bozanic, Split 2005):

A) 10.♙c2 ♘d7, and now:

A1) 11.c5 ♙b8 12.b4 (12.♙xb8 ♙xb8 13.b4±) 12...g5 (12...e5=) 13.♙xb8 ♙xb8± Paunovic-Markovic, Budva 1996;

A2) 11.♙ab1 g5 12.♙xd6 ♘xd6 13.♙fc1± Maletin-Mesropov, Moscow 2012;

B) 10.♙b1 ♘d7 11.♙xd6 ♘xd6 12.♙c2 ♘e4 13.b4± Svetushkin-Fernandez, Roquetas de Mar 2014;

C) 10.c5 ♖xf4 11.exf4 b6 12.b4 a5 13.a3± Manolache-Samolins, Arteixo 2007.

7.0-0

White has also tried 7.h3 0-0 8.0-0 (8.♘e2 b6 9.0-0 ♘e4 10.c4 ♘d7 11.♖c1 ♖b7± Sargissian-A.Muzychuk, Antwerp 2009) 8...♘bd7 (8...♖d7 9.♘e2 ♖e8 10.♖h2 ♖h5 11.♘f4 ♖xf3 12.♔xf3 ♔d7 13.c4± Gelfand-Beinoras, Kallithea 2008) 9.♘e2 h6 10.♖h2 g5 11.c4± Kotic-Schmidt, Munich 2013.

7...0-0 8.♘e2



White repositions the knight, with an eye on the f4-square and also making way for the natural plan of c2-c4, followed by doubling rooks on the c-file. This plan is the most common one in this position. The main difference between this position and the normal Stonewall is the deployment of White's bishops at f4 and d3.

8...♘e4

Another option is 8...♘bd7 9.c4 dxc4 10.♖xc4 ♘b6 11.♖b3 a5 12.a3 ♘bd5 13.h3±.

9.c4

9.h3 is again possible, e.g. 9...♖d7 10.c4 ♖e8 11.♔b3 ♔b6 12.c5 (12.♔c2±) 12...♔xb3 13.axb3 ♘d7 14.♘e5 ♘xe5 15.♖xe5± Dizdar-Nordahl, Gothenburg 2005.

9...♖d7

A) Or 9...♘d7 10.h3 ♔e8 (10...a5 11.♖h2 g5 12.♘e5 ♘xe5 13.♖xe5± Dizdar-Kobalia, Dresden 2007; 10...♖f6 11.♖h2 ♔e7 12.♔c2 g5 13.♖ac1± Malakhatko-Kuzubov, St Petersburg 2011) 11.♖h2 g5 12.♘e5± I.Sokolov-Haraldsson, Reykjavik 2013.

B) An interesting and thematic line is 9...g5!? and now:



analysis diagram

B1) 10. ♕e5!? (10. ♕g3 ♖xg3 11.hxg3±) 10... ♗d7 11.h3 ♗df6 (11... ♗xe5 12. ♗xe5±) 12. ♗d2 ♗d7 13.f3 ♗xd2 14. ♖xd2± Guramishvili-Batsiashvili, Tbilisi 2008;

B2) 10. ♕xb8 ♖xb8 11. ♗e5 (11. ♖c1) 11... ♗d7 (11... ♗d6 12.f4± Ernst-Bosch, Dieren 1998) 12.f3 ♗f6 13. ♖c2 (13. ♖c1±) 13... dxc4 14. ♗xc4 ♗d5 15. ♖d2± Meszaros-Farkas, Hungary 2011.

10. ♖b3! b6

Black could also defend the pawn with 10... ♖b6, and now:

A) 11. ♖xb6 (11.c5 ♖xb3 12.axb3±) 11... axb6 12. ♗c7 ♗d8 13. ♗xd8 ♖xd8 14.a3± (14. ♗xe4?! dxe4 15. ♗e5 ♗e8 Ishbulatov-Boe, Budapest 1998);

B) I think that the best reply is 11. ♖c2 ♗e8 12. ♖ac1±.

11. ♖fc1

White's plan is to double rooks on the c-file, and after exchanging pawns on d5, invade with the rooks if Black recaptures with the c-pawn, or put pressure on c6 if Black takes with the e-pawn. There is another thematic option for White, which is to play h2-h3, to prevent the exchange of the London bishop, although here this is not essential.

11...g5



A typical plan for Black is to advance his kingside pawns, trying to create counterplay on this wing, because on the queenside he is behind in development. The attack can be dangerous if White plays with insufficient care, although in this precise position it does not look as if it should cause White many difficulties.

12. ♖g3

I think that it is better to play 12. ♕e5 ♖e8 (12...g4 13. ♗e1±) 13.a3 g4 14. ♗e1 ♗d2 (14... ♗h5 15. ♗f4±) 15. ♖c2 ♗xc4 16. ♕xc4 dxc4 17. ♗xc4±.

12... ♗xc4 13.hxg3 ♗e8

This manoeuvre is typical in the Stonewall; the c8-bishop has two possible development routes: via d7-e8-g6 (or -h5) and to b7. Here Black activates it via e8, but since he has already played ...b7-b6, the queenside is left weak.

14. ♖c2 ♗d7 15.cxd5!

A precise move; Black must recapture with the c-pawn and White seizes control of the c-file.

15...cxd5 16. ♖ac1

White has a clear advantage in this position: control of the c-file, possible entry squares at c7 or c6 and tactical ideas against the pawn chain d5-e6-f5.

16...a6?!

This move is designed to control b5 but it is dubious, not only for tactical reasons, but also because it weakens b6. It was better to play 16... ♖b8 17. ♗e5 ±.

17.a4

There were other options for White here. The best seems to be 17. ♖c6! but it is also possible to play 17. ♕xa6 ♖xa6 18. ♖c8 ♗c5 19. ♖1xc5 ♗d6 20. ♖c1, with a healthy extra pawn.

17... ♖f7 18. ♜c6 ♜b8 19. ♜c2 h6?



Black overlooks White's reply. It was better to play 19... ♜e8 20. ♜e5 ♜xe5 21. dxe5 ♜c5 22. ♜d4, although White retains a clear advantage. What should White play now?

20. ♜xf5!

Correct! This sacrifice is crushing and grants White a decisive advantage. The weakness of Black's castled position and the light squares is key, along with the passivity of the black pieces.

20... exf5 21. ♜xf5 ♜e8

If 21... ♜f6 then 22. ♜xf6 ♜xf6 23. ♜xf6 wins.

22. ♜xd5+?!

There was a quicker way with 22. ♜e6+! ♜f7 23. ♜c8 ♜xc8 (23... ♜b7 24. ♜xc8 ♜xc8 25. ♜e5 ♜b4 26. ♜xf7 ♜xf7 27. ♜xd7, with a decisive advantage.

22... ♜g7 23. ♜e6 ♜f6 24. e4



White has a decisive advantage, with three pawns for the piece, the attack, a weak black king and a strong pawn centre. Black therefore tries to return some material.

24... ♖c5 25.dxc5 ♗xc6 26. ♗xc6

It was stronger to interpolate 26.cxb6! ♗e8 (26... ♗e8 27. ♖c7+ ♗h8 28.e5; 26... ♗xb6 27. ♖xc6 ♗xb2 28.e5) 27. ♗xc6 ♗xb2 28. ♖c2 ♗xc6 29. ♖xc6.

26...bxc5 27. ♖xc5 ♗xb2?!

27... ♗e8 was better: 28. ♖ed4 ♗xc6 29. ♖xc6±.

28.e5 ♗e7 29. ♖c2 ♗a1+ 30. ♖c1 ♗a3 31. ♖ed4!

The entrance of the white knight at e6 or f5 will prove decisive.

31... ♖ac8

If 31... ♗h7 then 32. ♗e4+ ♗h8 33. ♖c6.

32. ♖f5+! ♗f7

This results in mate, but White wins anyway after 32... ♖xf5 33. ♗xc8.

33. ♗d5+ ♗g6 34. ♗e6+ ♖f6

If 34... ♗f6 then 35. ♖xc8, or 34... ♗h5 35. ♖g7 mate.

35. ♖xe7+

1-0

35.exf6 mates more quickly, but the game continuation also wins after 35... ♗xe7 36. ♗xe7 ♖xc1+ 37. ♗h2 ♖f7 38. ♗e8 ♗g7 39.e6 ♖a7 40.e7.

SUMMARY

In this game we have seen the Stonewall Variation, a system that has a very solid reputation. With the London System the idea of playing ♗f4 and ♖c3 is very popular, instead of the more classical plan with c2-c4, although this

is also possible. White's advantage against this system is based on his bishop on f4 and so Black often avoids playing the natural move ...♗d6, and instead plays ...♗e7, since in the Stonewall the exchange of the dark-squared bishops usually favours White. In the game, the typical white plan after recycling the knight to e2 is to play c2-c4, doubling rooks on the c-file and exploiting his advantage on the queenside. White's control of the c-file, combined with some tactical possibilities, allowed him to sacrifice a piece and obtain a decisive advantage, exploiting Black's weak kingside. Black was left helpless.

Game 37

Dutch

Vlatko Kovacevic

2478

Boris Dugandzic

2234

Croatia tt 2011 (1)

1.d4 e6 2.♗f4 f5 3.e3 ♘f6 4.♗f3

White has also tried 4.♗e2!? d6 5.c4 ♗e7 6.♗h5+?! (6.♗c3) 6...♗xh5 7.♗xh5+ g6 8.♗e2 ♗f6 (8...h5 9.h3 ♗d7=) 9.♗c3 0-0 10.h4∞ Morozevich-Amin, Almaty 2008.

4...♗e7



The main alternative in the Classical Dutch is to play 4...b6.

This is a good scheme for Black in many variations of this defence. Once more the idea is to control e4. There are several options now:

A) 5. ♖e2 ♖b7 6. 0-0 ♖e7 (6...g6!? 7.c4 ♖g7 8. ♗c3 0-0 9. ♔c2 ♗e4 10. ♗xe4 ♖xe4 11. ♗b3±) and now:

A1) 7.c4 0-0 8. ♗c3 ♗h5 (8...d6 9. ♗g5 ♗d7 10. ♖f3 c6 11.h4 h6 12. ♗h3 d5 ± Irizanin-Isak, Paracin 2013) 9. ♗e5 (9. ♗e1±) 9... ♗xf4 10.exf4 d6 11. ♖f3 ♗c8?! (11...c6=) 12. ♖xb7 ♗xb7 13. ♗f3± Stoczek-Bigg, Zurich 2005;

A2) 7.h3 0-0 8.c4 h6 9. ♗c3 d6 10. ♖h2± Izeta-Vaisser, Las Palmas 1995;

B) 5. ♗bd2 ♖b7 6. ♖d3 and now:

B1) 6... ♖d6!? with a further division:

B11) 7. ♗e5 0-0 8. 0-0 ♗c6 9.a4 (9.a3) 9... ♗b4 10. ♖e2 ♖e7 11.c3 ♗bd5 12. ♖f3 d6 13. ♗d3= Teske-Teran, Seville 2012;

B12) 7.c3 0-0 8. ♔c2 ♖xf4 9.exf4 c5 10. 0-0 ♗c7 11.g3 cxd4 12. ♗xd4= Wesseln-Dgebuadze, Oldenburg 2000;

B13) 7. ♖xd6 cxd6 8. ♗e2 0-0 9.h3 ♗e4 10. ♗g1 ♗xd2 11. ♗xd2 ♗c6 12.c3 a6 13.g4± Hoang Thanh Trang-Prakash, Chennai 2012;

B2) 6... ♖e7 7.h3 0-0 and now:



B21) 8.c3 ♗e4 9. ♗g1 c5 10.g4 cxd4 11.gxf5 (11.cxd4±) 11... ♗c5 12. ♖b1 dxc3 13.bxc3= Khenkin-Meister, Bad Liebenzell 2010;

B22) 8.g4!? ♗e4?! (8...c5) 9.gxf5 exf5 10. ♗g1± 10... ♖f6 (10...d5 11. ♗e5 ♗d7 12. ♗xe4 dxe4 13. ♖c4+± Kasic-Stamenkovic, Niksic 1996) 11.c3 (11. ♗e2±) 11...d6 12. ♗e2 ♗d7 13. 0-0-0± Stefanova-Moser, Plovdiv 2008;

B23) 8. ♗e2 and now:

B231) 8... ♗e4 9. 0-0-0 (9. ♗g1±) 9...a5 10.g4 (10. ♗hg1±) 10...a4 11.gxf5 exf5 12.a3± Teske-Meister, Tegernsee 2008;

B232) 8...c5 9.c3 ♗e4 10. 0-0-0 (10. 0-0±) 10...b5?! (10...a5 11. ♖b1 a4 12.a3 ♗a6∞) 11. ♖xb5 ♗a5 12. ♗b3? (12. ♖b1 ♖d5 13. ♗b3±) 12... ♗xa2 13. ♖c2

c4? (13... ♖xc3! 14. ♔xc3 cxd4+ 15.exd4 ♕c8+ ♖) 14. ♕xc4 ♕a3 15. ♖b1 ♕c8? (15...d5±) 16. ♖c5 De Prado-Abella, Spain tt 2006.

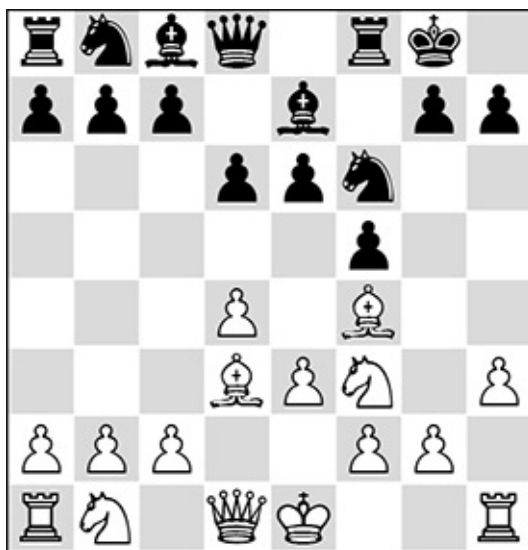
5.h3 0-0 6. ♕d3

An alternative is to play 6.c4 d6 7. ♖c3 and now:

A) 7... ♖e8?! 8. ♖c2 ♖g6 (8...b6±) 9.0-0-0 c6? (9... ♖h5±) 10.g4! fxg4 (10... ♖e4±) 11. ♕d3 Goldaracena-Farias, Spain tt 2014;

B) 7... ♖e4 8. ♖xe4 (8. ♖c2 ♖xc3 9.bxc3 b6 10. ♕d3 ♕b7= Sharevich-Lagvilava, Minsk 2004) 8...fxe4 9. ♖d2 d5 10. ♕e2 ♖c6= Piket-Nikolic, Wijk aan Zee 1992.

6...d6



Here we have the Classical set-up of the Dutch versus the London System: Black's plan is based on trying to advance with ...e6-e5. White's advantage is that with this set-up he can choose which side to castle: he can play quietly with kingside castling or head for a more complicated game by castling queenside, with the plan of ♖g1 and g2-g4.

7.c4

Or 7. ♖bd2 (7.0-0) 7... ♖c6 8.0-0 ♕h8 9. ♕h2 a6 10.a3 ♖b8 11.e4 fxe4 12. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 13. ♕xe4± Pezerovic-Komljenovic, Munich 2013.

7... ♖e8

I think that the idea of 7... ♖e4 is better, which is typical of the Classical Dutch. Black's plan would be to follow up with ...b7-b6 and ...♕b7 to gain firm control of e4. Play might continue 8.0-0 b6 9. ♕xe4 fxe4 10. ♖fd2 d5 11. ♖c3±.

8. ♖c3 ♖c6

Now it is too late for 8...b6 9.0-0 ♕b7 10. ♕h2 ♖e4?! 11. ♕xe4 fxe4 12. ♖d2 d5 13. ♕xc7±.

9.0-0

It is inferior to play 9.d5 e5! 10.dxc6 exf4 11.cxb7?! (11.exf4 ♖d8+ 12.♗e2 bxc6=) 11...♖xb7 12.♖xf5 (12.0-0=) 12...fxe3 13.fxe3 ♗h5= (13...♖d8=) Zaitseva-Savitskaya, Elista 1998.

9...♖d8



This is a normal move in the Classical Dutch: the bishop retreats to d8 to enable the queen to support the ...e6-e5 advance, and at the same time defends the c7-pawn against a possible ♗b5 by White.

If 9...♗h5?! then 10.♖h2 f4 11.♙b1 g6 12.b4± Sharevich-Yakovlev, St Petersburg 2003.

10.d5!?

Here 10.♖h2 was good, and after 10...e5 White maintains the advantage:

A) 11.c5 e4 (11...♙h8 12.cxd6 cxd6 13.♖b5±) 12.cxd6 exf3 13.dxc7 fxg2 14.♙e1! ♖xc7 (14...♖e7 15.d5±) 15.♖xc7±;

B) 11.♖c2 e4 12.♗d2 a6 13.a3 ♙b8 14.b4 b5 15.♖b3±.

10...exd5?

An error. Black should play 10...♗b4 11.♖b1 e5 12.♖h2 a5 13.a3 ♗a6 14.b4 ♙g6±.

11.cxd5 ♗e5

If 11...♗b4 then 12.♖c4±.

12.♖c2?!

It seems better to play 12.♗xe5 dxe5 13.♖h2 a6 14.♙b3 with a comfortable advantage.

12...♖d7?

Black misses his opportunity. It was better to play 12...♗xf3+ 13.♙xf3 ♙h5! 14.♙g3 a6, with equality.

13. ♖d4

White now has a clear advantage: he attacks f5 and can force an entry at e6.

13... ♗h5 14. ♖e6

14. ♕h2± was also good.

14... ♗xe6 15. dxe6 ♖xf4 16. exf4 ♖c6?!

It was a little better to play 16... ♖g6 17. ♕a4 c6 18. ♖xd6±.

17. ♖e1

Here 17. ♕a4 was even better, preventing the black knight from blockading on e7, with a decisive advantage to White.

17... ♖e7 18. ♕a4 ♖g6

If 18... c6 then 19. ♖xd6±.

19. ♕d7



White's advantage is very clear: he has a strong passed pawn on e6, Black is weak on the light squares and his pieces are passive, especially the bishop on d8, the knight on e7 and the rook on a8.

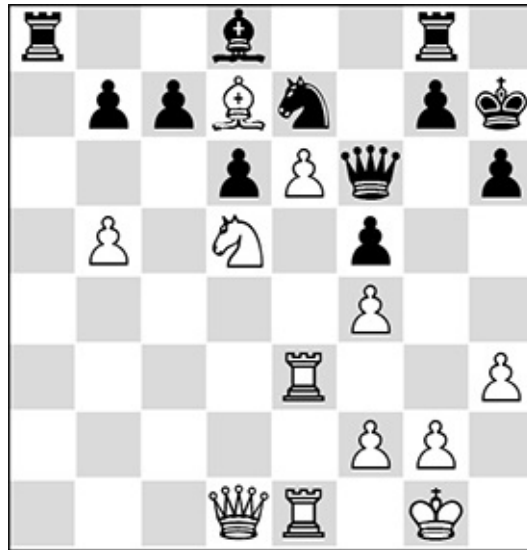
19... ♖f6 20. ♖c1 ♖h8 21. ♖c2

Here White could already win with 21. ♖b5 ♖xb2 22. ♖xc7 ♖xc7 23. ♖xc7 ♖b4 24. ♕a4 d5 25. a3 ♖xa3 26. ♖a1 ♖xa1 27. ♖xa1 ♖g6 28. e7 ♖fe8 29. ♕xe8 ♖xe8 30. g3.

21... a6 22. ♖ce2

Another good move was 22. ♖d5 ♖xd5 23. ♖xd5 ♖b8 24. ♖d1, with a clear advantage.

22... ♖b8 23. a4 h6 24. ♖e3 ♖h7 25. b4 ♖g8 26. b5 axb5 27. axb5 ♖a8 28. ♖d5!



Finally this knight move, which was also possible a few moves ago. White has a decisive advantage.

28... ♖b2 29. ♗xe7 ♕xe7 30. ♗d5

Winning material with the double attack on f5 and b7.

30... ♖a2 31. ♖3e2! ♗xe2 32. ♖xe2 ♖xe2 33. ♗xb7 ♖c2 34. ♕c6! g5

Also losing was 34... ♕d8 35. g3 ♖f8 36. ♗c8 (36.e7 ♕xe7 37. ♗xc7 ♕f6 38. ♗xd6) 36... ♖c1+ 37. ♗g2 ♖e1 38. ♗d7 ♖h8 39. f3 ♖h7 40. ♖f2.

35. ♗xc7 ♖g7 36. fxg5 ♕xg5 37. ♗xd6 ♕e7 38. ♗d3 ♖c1+ 39. ♖h2 ♖h8 40. ♗xf5 ♕d6+ 41. g3 ♕c5 42. ♖g2 ♖g8 43. ♕d5

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw Black's final option in the Dutch: the Classical set-up, the main idea of which is to advance with ...e6-e5. Black has two main development plans: he can opt for ...b7-b6 and ...♕b7 or ...♕e7 and ...d7-d6. The London System works well against this variation and White has the choice of where to play. Kingside castling is the quieter option, with a solid position and a slight advantage, whereas queenside castling, with the plan of ♖g1 and g2-g4, leads to more complex play, with chances of a strong attack. In the game, White gained a clear advantage by placing his knight on e6, ending up with a strong passed pawn and play on the light squares. Black was left passive and unable to defend.

CONCLUSION

In this chapter we have been looking at the Dutch Defence against the London System. In Game 34 we saw a type of Leningrad, with ...h7-h6 and ...g7-g5, a rather rare line which resembles some variations of the King's Indian. In Game 39 we saw the true Leningrad with ...g7-g6 and White's annoying deployment with ♔c4, hindering Black's castling.

In Game 36 we saw the Stonewall, a line with a very solid reputation. White can play an early c2-c4 against it, but White also has the very interesting plan of ♙c3 (threatening ♙b5), followed by ♙e2 and c2-c4, which is the most popular. White won, thanks to his control of the c-file.

In Game 37 we saw the Classical Dutch with ...♙e7, ...d7-d6 and ...♙e8. There is another option for Black, based on ...b7-b6 and ...♙b7. White can choose where to castle and he maintains a slight advantage.

In general, the bishop on f4 considerably disrupts Black's usual plans in the Dutch, since in most variations Black's idea is to play ...e6-e5. In the Stonewall Black usually plays ...♙d6, but since White's bishop is on f4 and the exchange of dark-squared bishops tends to favour White, Black often plays the bishop to e7, where it is not so well placed.

Chapter 7

The London System versus the Slav

1.d4 d5 2.♘f4 ♘f6 3.e3 ♙f5 4.c4

1.d4 d5

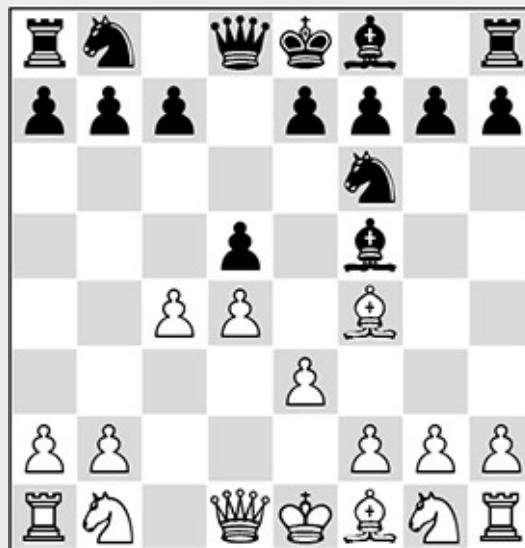
1...c5 2.c3 cxd4 3.cxd4 d5 4.♘f4 (4.♘c3)

1...♘f6 2.♘f3 c5 3.c3 cxd4 4.cxd4 d5

2.♘f4 ♘f6

2...♙f5; 2...c6

3.e3 ♙f5 4.c4



4...c6

4...♘c6; 4...e6

5.♘c3 e6 6.♙b3 b6

6...♙b6; 6...♙c8

In this chapter we shall see the London System in action against the Slav Defence set-up. We shall begin by looking at the Slav Exchange Variation, which can arise by transposition if Black plays an early ...c7-c5 and then

exchanges quickly on d4. We therefore need to know how to play the white side of the Slav Exchange Variation, even though strictly speaking it does not form part of the London System.

Then we shall look at the symmetrical lines where Black plays ...d7-d5 and ... ♖f5 and also lines with ...c7-c6. In general, against the Slav White should aim for the plan of c2-c4, ♖c3 and ♗b3, putting pressure on the b7-pawn, in similar manner to the variations where Black plays ... ♗b6, putting pressure on the b2-pawn.

In the main line, Black has problems defending the b7-pawn. The variations with ... ♗b6 lead to endgames which are favourable to White after White plays c4-c5 and the queens are exchanged. Playing ...b7-b6 weakens the queenside but ... ♗c8 is not the best square for the black queen, just as ♗c1 is not ideal for White.

We have included some other types of Slav with ...c7-c6 and ... ♗b6 or ... ♗g4, which are also interesting.

Game 38

Slav Exchange
Li Chao

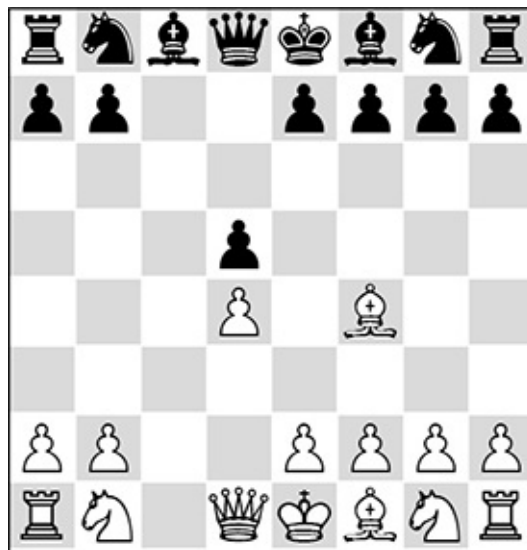
2680

Mariya Muzychuk

2503

Gibraltar 2014 (3)

1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.cxd5 cxd5 4. ♖f4



Here we have the Exchange Variation of the Slav Defence. It is a line that we need to learn as White, since we can end up in it via several different move

orders, such as 1.d4 c5 2.c3 cxd4 3.cxd4 d5 4.♙f4, or 1.d4 ♘f6 2.♙f3 c5 3.c3 cxd4 4.cxd4 d5. It has a drawish reputation, but it has to be handled with care. It is a very comfortable option for White, who is usually able to gain some slight advantages with no risk of losing. The main plan is to play on the c-file and the queenside. White also can play here 4.♙f3 or the most precise move order, which is 4.♙c3 ♘f6 5.♙f3 ♙c6 6.♙f4.

4... ♙c6

Against this move order Black has the option of playing 4...♙b6 5.♙c3 ♙f6 (5...♙xb2? 6.♙xd5) 6.e3 (6.♙c1 ♙c6 7.e3 ♙xb2 8.♙d3) 6...♙xb2 (6...♙c6 7.♙d3 ♙g4 8.♙ge2± Grischuk-Kamsky, Moscow 2013) 7.♙b5+ ♙d7 (7...♙c6 8.♙ge2) 8.♙xd7+ ♙bxd7 9.♙ge2 with compensation, Morozovich-Mamedyarov, Tashkent 2012.

5.e3

If 5.♙c3 (5.♙f3) then 5...e5!? is interesting: 6.dxe5 (6.♙xe5 ♙xe5 7.dxe5 d4 8.♙e4 ♙a5+ 9.♙d2 ♙e7 10.♙f3 ♙c6= Varga-Grigoriants, Hungary 2011) 6...d4 7.♙e4 ♙a5+ (7...♙f5 8.♙d6+ ♙xd6 9.exd6 ♙f6 10.♙f3 ♙h5= Maisuradze-Lampert, Gibraltar 2014) 8.♙d2 ♙ge7 9.♙f3 ♙d5 10.g3 (10.♙g3 ♙e3 11.fxe3 dxe3± Mikhailov-Volkov, Taganrog 2013) 10...h6 11.h4= Stefanova-Ali, Skopje 2013.

5... ♙f6 6.♙c3



6... ♙g4

The most popular continuation is 6...a6 7.♙d3! ♙g4 (7...g6 8.h3 ♙f5 9.♙f3 ♙xd3 10.♙xd3± Kramnik-Aronian, Istanbul 2012) 8.♙ge2 e6 9.0-0 (9.♙c1 ♙d6 10.f3 ♙h5 11.0-0 ♙g6 12.♙a4 ♙xd3 13.♙xd3 ♙xf4 14.♙xf4± Bruzon-Yakovenko, Poikovsky 2012) 9...♙e7 10.♙c1 ♙h5 (10...0-0 11.♙a4 ♙c8

12.f3± Aronian-Nakamura, Sandnes 2013) 11.♖b3 (11.♗a4±) 11...♗a5 12.♖a4+ ♗c6 13.♙g3= Wang Hao-Caruana, Tashkent 2012.

Another common sequence is 6...♙f5 7.♖b3 ♗a5 8.♖a4+ ♙d7, which transposes to the game.

7.♖b3 ♗a5 8.♖a4+

If 8.♙b5+ then 8...♙d7 9.♖c2 (9.♙xd7+ ♖xd7 10.♖b5= Hertneck-Kramnik, Germany Bundesliga 1993/94) 9...e6=.

8...♙d7 9.♖c2

The alternative is 9.♙b5 e6 and now:

B) 10.♙xd7+ ♗xd7 11.♗f3 a6 12.0-0 ♙e7 13.♖fc1 (13.♖ac1= Garcia-Dominguez, Las Tunas 2001; 13.♗d2 ♖c8= Fridman-Balogh, Munich 2013) 13...♗c6 14.♖b3 (14.♖d1 0-0 15.♗a4 ♖c8 16.a3= Grachev-Yilmaz, Kocaeli 2014; 14.h3 0-0 15.♖d1 ♗b6= Mirzoev-Solak, Denizli 2013) 14...♖b6 15.♖d1 0-0 16.♗a4 ♖a5 17.a3± Kotic-Mihok, Budapest 2011;

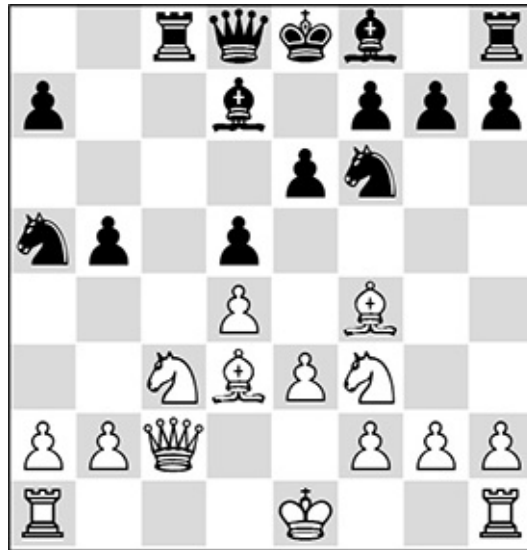
B) 10.♖c1 ♖c8 11.♗f3 ♖c4!? (11...a6 12.♙xd7+ ♗xd7 13.0-0=) 12.♖d1?! (12.♙xd7+ ♗xd7 13.♖c2=) 12...♙xb5 13.♗xb5 ♙b4+ 14.♙e2 ♖xc1 (14...0-0 15.♖a4 ♙c3 16.♖a3 ♙b4 17.♖a4 ½-½ Wen Yang-Ni Hua, Danzhou 2013) 15.♖xc1 0-0= Romanov-Eljanov, Legnica 2013.

9... ♖c8

Here 9...e6 is slightly better, as played in several games in the 2014 Gibraltar tournament: 10.♙d3 ♙e7 (10...♗h5 11.♙e5 ♗c6 12.♖e2 ♗xe5 13.dxe5 g6 14.♗f3 ♙b4 15.0-0= Vitiugov-Dreev, Gibraltar 2014) 11.h3 ♖c8 12.♗f3 ♗c4 (12...b5 13.a3 0-0 14.0-0= Li Chao-Rodshtein, Gibraltar 2014) 13.0-0 0-0 14.♗e5 ♙c6 15.♖ac1 b5± Smirnov-Belous, Taganrog 2014, or 15...♗d6 16.♖b3± Svidler-Le Quang Liem, Tromsø 2013.

10.♙d3 e6 11.♗f3 b5

Making use of the pin on the white queen, Black threatens ...b5-b4 and consolidates his grip on c4. Another option is 11...♙b4 12.0-0 0-0 13.♗e5± Nisipeanu-Zhao Zong, Canberra 2014.



12. ♔e2

The best move for White is considered to be 12.a3, and now:

B) 12...♙e7 13.0-0 0-0 14.♘e5 (14.♖fc1) 14...♙e8= Ju Wenjun-A. Muzychuk, Beijing 2013;

B) 12...♘c4 13.0-0 ♙e7 and now:

B1) 14.♘e5 ♘h5 (14...0-0 15.♔e2± Yakovenko-Sjugirov, Yerevan 2014) 15.♘xd7 ♙xd7 16.♙g3 (16.♙e5±) 16...♘xg3 17.hxg3 g6= Palac-Svetushkin, Porto Carras 2011;

B2) 14.h3 a5 15.♔e2 ♘xa3 (15...0-0) 16.♘xb5 ♘xb5 17.♙xb5± I.Sokolov-Giri, Boxtel 2011.

12...a6

White is better after 12...♘c4 13.0-0 ♙e7 14.♖ac1 (14.b3±) 14...a6 15.b3 ♘a5 16.♘e5± Naiditsch-Dubov, Wijk aan Zee 2013.

Best is 12...b4 13.♘d1 ♙b6 (13...♘c4 14.b3 ♘a3=) 14.♘e5± Kotic-Pajkovic, Cetinje 2009.

13.0-0 ♙e7 14.♘e5 0-0

Or 14...♙b6 15.♙g5 (15.♖ac1±) 15...h6 16.♙xf6 ♙xf6± Soors-Cabrera, Fermo 2009.

15.♖fc1 ♙e8 16.♖c2



White has emerged from the opening with a slight advantage: he is ready to double rooks on the c-file, has a strong knight on e5, and the bishop on d3 it is better than its counterpart on e8. Black is trying to gain a grip on the c4-square, but his pieces are rather passive.

16... ♖d7

Another option was 16... ♖c4 17. ♖ac1 ♖d7 18. ♗f3±.

17. ♗f3

White avoids piece exchanges. If 17. ♗xd7 then 17... ♗xd7 18. ♖ac1 ♗c4 19. ♗b1 ♗a5 20. b3 ♗d6 21. ♖c5 h6= (21... ♗b7 22. ♗c7±; 21... ♗e4 22. ♗c7±).

17... ♗b6 18. ♖ac1 ♗ac4?!

It is better to play 18... ♗c6 19. a3.

19. e4

White decides to open the centre. However, it was better to play 19. ♗b1!±, with the idea of b2-b3, driving back the black knight, with a slight advantage to White.

19... dxe4 20. ♗xe4

It seems better to recapture with the knight: 20. ♗xe4! ♗d5 21. ♗d2±.

20... g6 21. ♗h6

It is better to play 21. ♗e2 ♗c6 22. ♗e4 ♗d5 23. ♗h6±.

21... ♗c6 22. ♗e2 ♗xf3

Or 22... ♗e8 23. ♗e4 ♗d6 24. ♗xc6 ♗xc6 25. ♗e5 ♗c8 26. ♗e4 ♗xc2 27. ♗xc2 ♗d5=.

23. ♗xf3 ♗e8 24. ♗e4



24...xd4 25. b7 cd8?

This allows White a clear advantage. It was necessary to exert some control over the b5-square with 25...c5, e.g. 26. xa6 b4 27. e4 (if White plays 27. b5?, as in the note to move 27, then Black has the edge after 27...d7) 27...e5 28. e3 (28. f6+ h8=) 28...xe3 29. xe3 xc2 30. xc2 a8=.

26. xa6 b4 27. e4

Even better was 27. b5 d7 28. h4 f8 29. g5 e7 30. b3±.

27...e5 28. e2 d3 29. f1

Here it was better to play 29. a1±, indirectly defending the bishop on a6 as well as the pawn on a2.

29...f5?



A clear mistake, weakening Black's king and leaving Black in a lost position. The best try was 29...b3!? 30.axb3 ♖b4 31. ♖d2 ♕e5 32. ♗b5, although White maintains a slight advantage.

30. ♗g3 f4

If 30...♗c5 then 31. ♗b5 ♖bd7 32. ♖d1 ♕f6 33.h3 g5 34. ♗xg5 ♕xg5 35. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 36. ♕xe6++-.

31. ♕xe6+ ♖h8 32. ♗e2 ♕f6 33. ♕xf6+ ♗xf6 34. ♖c6 ♗h4 35. ♗xd3 ♖xd3 36. ♗xf4

And, faced with the loss of a piece, Black resigned.

SUMMARY

We have seen that from the Benoni or after 1...♗f6 Black can transpose to the Exchange Variation of the Slav Defence. It is a line which a London System player needs to know and which can be reached by transposition. The Exchange Variation is a very solid line, and although it has a drawish reputation, it is played quite often. Black often relaxes in this type of variation, thinking that any move will do to make a draw, but this is not the case – Black needs to play carefully. White's plan is based on doubling rooks on the c-file and playing on the queenside or in the centre. In this game Black chose a fashionable line with ...♗g4. White emerged slightly better from the opening and was first to double rooks on the c-file. Black had the c4-square under control, which is important, but after breaking in the centre with e3-e4 White gained the better game and his advantage became decisive after Black blundered with 29...f5.

Game 39

Slav Exchange

Arkady Naiditsch

2712

Sergey Movsesian

2705

Croatia tt 2012 (6)

1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3. ♗c3 ♗f6 4.cxd5 cxd5 5. ♗f4 ♗c6 6.e3 a6 7. ♗d3 e6

In this game we shall look at the line with ...e7-e6. In the London System generally, I much prefer White in the variations where Black leaves his queen's bishop shut in with ...d7-d5 and ...e7-e6, and this position is no exception. The bishop on d3 is always aimed towards h7. White has options of mounting an attack with ♗e5, f2-f4 and g2-g4-g5, followed by bringing the queen to the kingside. In the next game we shall look at lines with ...♗f5.



8. ♖c1

The alternative is 8. ♘f3, and now:

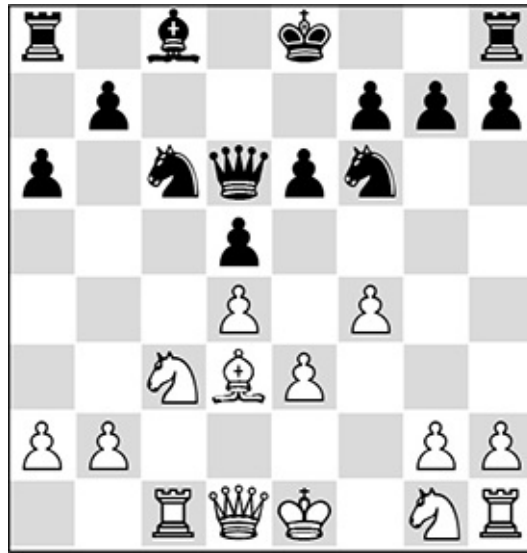
A) 8... ♙d6 9. ♖c1!? (9. ♙xd6 ♜xd6=; 9.0-0 ♙xf4 10.exf4 ♜d6 11. ♜d2 0-0 12. ♜fe1 ♙d7 13. ♜ad1 ♜ac8 14. ♘e5= Graf-Burmakin, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2010) 9... ♙xf4 10.exf4 ♜d6 11. ♜d2 ♙d7 12.0-0 0-0 13. ♙b1± Melkumyan-Grabarczyk, Grodzisk 2007;

B) 8... ♙e7 9. ♘e5 (9.h3±) 9... ♙d7 10.0-0 ♜c8 11. ♖c1± (11.a3±) De Prado-Zurano, Spain tt 2005.

8... ♙d6

Another possibility is 8... ♙e7 9.h3 0-0 10. ♘f3 ♙d7 11.0-0 b5 12. ♘e5± 12... ♜b6 (12... ♜c8 13.a4 b4 14. ♘xd7 ♜xd7 15. ♘b1 ♘a5± Bosiocic-Jankovic, Philadelphia 2012) 13. ♙g5 ♙e8 14.f4± Rakhmanov-Shvedchikov, Moscow 2012.

9. ♙xd6 ♜xd6 10.f4



White prevents ...e6-e5 and fortifies this square for his knight. This scheme is like the Stonewall, but with the advantage of having exchanged the 'bad' bishop. The typical plan is ♖f3-e5, followed by the pawn advance g2-g4-g5 and then ♙h5, or ♙f3-h3, with a strong attack.

10...b5 11. ♖f3 ♙b7 12. ♖e5 0-0 13.0-0 ♜ac8

The alternative is to play 13...♖e7, bringing the knight to the kingside to strengthen the defences against White's impending attack, e.g. 14. ♙f3 (14.a4 b4 15. ♖b1 a5 16. ♖d2± Rojicek-Ponizil, Czechia tt 2013/14) 14...♜ac8 15.g4 b4?! (15...♖d7∞) 16. ♖a4± Shimanov-Ipatov, Moscow 2013.

14.a3

White has also tried 14. ♙f3 ♖a5 15.g4 ♖c4 16.g5 ♖e4 (16...♖d7=) 17. ♖xc4 bxc4 18. ♖xe4 dxe4 19. ♙xe4± Stefanova-Gvetadze, Batumi 2012.

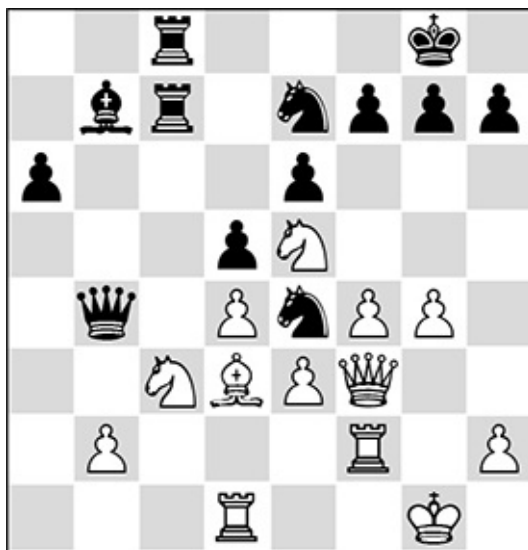
14...♖e7 15. ♙f3 ♜c7 16.g4!

White launches the typical kingside assault. White prefaced this with ♙f3 in order to prevent ...♖e4 – a standard plan, as we shall see in other variations where Black plays ...d7-d5 and adopts a Queen's Gambit Declined set-up. In this type of position the bishop on b7 tends to remain passive and Black has to seek counterplay on the queenside. It was also possible to play 16.f5 exf5 17. ♙xf5 ♖xf5 18. ♙xf5=.

16... ♜fc8 17. ♜cd1 b4 18.axb4 ♙xb4 19. ♜f2

The rook defends b2 and can go to g2 or double rooks on the f-file.

19... ♖e4!?



Black cracks under the pressure and sacrifices a pawn to gain some activity, but this should not be sufficient. It was better to play 19... ♖g6 20. ♜df1±, or 19... a5 20.g5±.

20. ♜xe4 dxe4 21. ♙xe4 ♙xe4 22. ♗xe4 ♜c1?!

Here it was better to play 22... ♙b3 23. ♜fd2 ♜d5 24. ♜d3±.

23. ♜df1?!

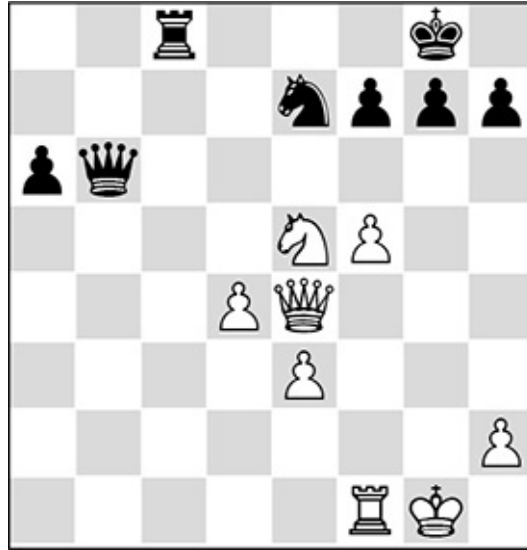
Now 23. ♜xc1! ♜xc1+ 24. ♙g2± was better.

23... ♜xf1+ 24. ♜xf1?!

White could have maintained his advantage with 24. ♙xf1±.

24... ♙xb2= 25.f5 exf5 26.gxf5 ♙b6?

The best move was 26... ♙e2, with the threat of 27... ♜c2, and this would have guaranteed Black the draw: 27.f6 gxf6 (27... ♜c2?? 28. ♙xc2! ♙xc2 29.fxe7) 28. ♜d7 ♜c2 29. ♜xf6+ ♙f8 30. ♜xh7+ ♙g8 31. ♜f6+ ♙f8 32. ♜h7+ ♙e8 33. ♜f6+ with a draw by perpetual check, since 33... ♙d8? would lose to 34. ♙a8+ ♙c7 35. ♙a7+ ♙c6 36. ♙d7+ ♙b6 37. ♙d6+.



27. ♖g4?

The right move was 27.f6! ♜g6 (27...gxf6?? 28.♙g4+) 28.♜xf7! gxf6 (28...♙xf7 29.♙d5+ ♔f8 30.fxg7+ ♙xg7 31.♙d7+) 29.♜h6+ ♙h8 30.h4, with a clear advantage to White.

27...h5 28.f6 ♜g6?

This loses; he needed to play 28...hxg4!, with equality after:

B) 29.♙xg4 g6 30.fxe7 ♜e8 31.♙d7 ♙b5 32.♙xb5 (32.♙d8?? ♙g5+) 32...axb5=;

B) 29.fxe7 ♜e8 30.♜f5 (30.♜b1 ♙c7 31.♜b7 ♙c1+ 32.♙g2 ♙d2+ 33.♙g3 ♙e1+ 34.♙xg4 ♙g1+ 35.♙f5 ♙xh2=) 30...a5 31.♜g5 g6 32.d5 ♙d6 33.♜e5 ♙a3=.

29.♙f5

Attacking the rook and the pawn. White now has a decisive advantage.

29...♙b7 30.♙xh5 ♜c2 31.d5 gxf6?

A blunder that hastens the defeat; I imagine this was caused by time pressure. Black was lost anyway, but he could have put up greater resistance with 31...♙c8 32.fxg7 ♜c1 33.♙g5.

32.♙h6

1-0

Black must give up his queen to prevent mate with 33.♜xf6.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the line with ...e7-e6 by Black, without developing the queen's bishop. In general, the variations where Black leaves this bishop shut in with ...d7-d5 and ...e7-e6 are very comfortable for White. White

exchanged the dark-squared bishops and then played f2-f4, switching to a Stonewall set-up but without the usual ‘bad’ bishop. White’s plan in such positions is to play ♖e5 and g2-g4-g5 and then move the queen to the kingside, either via f3-h3 or moving to h5 directly, to attack the black king. In the game, Black tried to create counterplay on the queenside and in a worse position he hurriedly played ...♗e4, sacrificing a pawn. However, White then played badly and let Black equalise, but a further mistake by Black allowed White to win material and mount a strong attack against the black king, forcing resignation. Not all the lines of the Exchange Variation are boring or dead drawn.

Game 40

Slav Exchange
Vassily Ivanchuk

2776

Hikaru Nakamura

2774

Medias 2011 (10)

1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.cxd5 cxd5 4.♗c3 ♗f6

In this move order Black can also play the interesting Winawer Counter-Gambit 4...e5!? (which can also arise via 1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.♗c3 e5).



analysis diagram

Let us review White’s options here:

A) 5.♗f3 e4 6.♗e5 f6 7.♔a4+ ♗d7 8.♗g4 (8.♗xd7 ♗xd7 9.♔b3 ♗c6

10. ♖f4 ♘d6= Wiedenkiller-Engqvist, Borlange 1992) 8... ♔f7∞ Perelshteyn-Holt, Wheeling 2010;

B) 5.e4!? (a counter-counter-gambit!) 5... dxe4 6. ♘b5+ ♘d7 7.dxe5 ♘b4 and now:

B1) 8.e6!? fxe6 9. ♗h3 (9. ♗h5+ g6 10. ♗e5 ♗f6 11. ♖f4 a6= Beliaevsky-Lautier, Belgrade 1991) 9... ♗f6 10. ♘c4 (10. ♗b3 ♘b5 11. ♗xb4 ♘a6=) 10... ♗c7 11. ♗b3 ♗c6= Chabanon-Khenkin, Genova 1996;

B2) 8. ♘xd7+ ♗xd7 9.e6!? (9. ♗e2 ♗xe5 10.0-0 ♗xd1 11. ♗xd1 ♗f6 12. ♗g5=) 9... fxe6 10. ♗e2 ♗c5 11.0-0 ♗f6 12. ♗e3 with compensation, Vavrak-Saric, Pula 2008.

C) 5.dxe5 d4 6. ♗e4 ♗a5+ 7. ♗d2 (7. ♗d2 ♗xe5 8. ♗g3 ♗c6 9. ♗f3 ♗d6 10.a3 (10.e3 dxe3 11. ♗xe3= Bunyatov-Shkuran, Lviv 2015) 10... ♗f6 11.e4 dxe3 12. ♗xe3= A.Muzychuk-Stefanova, Monaco 2015) 7... ♗c6 8. ♗f3 ♗g4 (8... ♗h6 9.g3 ♗g4 10. ♗g2 ♗e3 11.fxe3 dxe3 12.0-0 exd2 13. ♗xd2± Guliev-Morozevich, Moscow 1998) 9.g3 ♗xf3 10.exf3 ♗xe5+ 11. ♗e2 ♗xe2+ 12. ♗xe2 0-0-0 13. ♗c4 (13. ♗d3 g6 14.0-0 ♗g7 15.f4± Sarwer-Ebeling, Finland tt 2015/16) 13... ♗b4 (13... ♗e5 14. ♗b3±) 14.a3 (14. ♗xf7 ♗h6 15. ♗e6+ ♗b8 16.0-0±) 14... ♗xd2+ 15. ♗xd2 ♗e5 16. ♗e2± Fridman-Hector, Germany 2010.

5. ♗f3 ♗c6 6. ♗f4 ♗f5

This is the position that is reached most often. The Symmetrical Variation is considered Black's simplest way to equalise, but that is not always the case. The move 6... ♗e4!? is regarded as slightly dubious, but it is played nevertheless and even some strong players, such as Kramnik and Shirov, have employed it. I think this is because some aggressive players dislike symmetrical positions and prefer a more open and complex position, even though it might be a bit worse. 7.e3 ♗xc3 8.bxc3 and now:



analysis diagram

A) 8...e6 9. ♖d3 ♘d6 10. ♖xd6 (10.0-0 0-0 11. ♜e1±) 10... ♙xd6 11.0-0 0-0 12.e4 dxe4 13. ♗xe4 g6?! (13...b6 14. ♜e1=) 14. ♙d2± Rezan-Kreisl, Zadar 2012;

B) 8...g6 and now there are several good moves for White:

B1) 9.h4 h6 10. ♘e5± Ubilava-Cifuentes, Benasque 2005;

B2) 9. ♖d3 ♘g7 10.0-0 0-0 11. ♜e1± (11. ♜b1 b6 12.c4 dxc4 13. ♖xc4 ♗b7 14. ♙e2± Banikas-G.Kasparov, Patras blitz 2001);

B3) 9. ♜b1 ♗g7 and now:

B31) 10.h4!? ♙a5 (10...0-0 11.h5±) 11. ♙d2 a6 12. ♖d3± Daly-Ferguson, Rotherham 1997;

B32) 10.c4 0-0 11. ♜b5 dxc4 (11... ♗e6=) 12. ♖xc4 a6 13. ♜d5 (13. ♜c5) 13... ♙b6= Lakdawala-S.Jones, Los Angeles 2000.



7. ♖b3

The normal move is 7.e3 e6, with more than 7,000 games. Let us consider a few examples:

B) A very common line leading to a draw is 8. ♕d3 ♕xd3 9. ♖xd3 ♕d6 10. ♕xd6 ♖xd6=;

B) The most popular line is 8. ♕b5 ♖d7 and now:

B1) 9. ♖b3 ♕e7 10.0-0 (10. ♖c1) 10...g5 11. ♕g3 h5 12.h3 g4 13.hxg4 hxg4= Rakhmanov-Yakovenko, Plovdiv 2012;

B2) 9.0-0 ♕e7 10. ♖c1 ♖c8 11. ♖b3 0-0 12. ♕xc6 bxc6 13. ♖a4 ♖a5= Fressinet-Balogh, Bastia 2010;

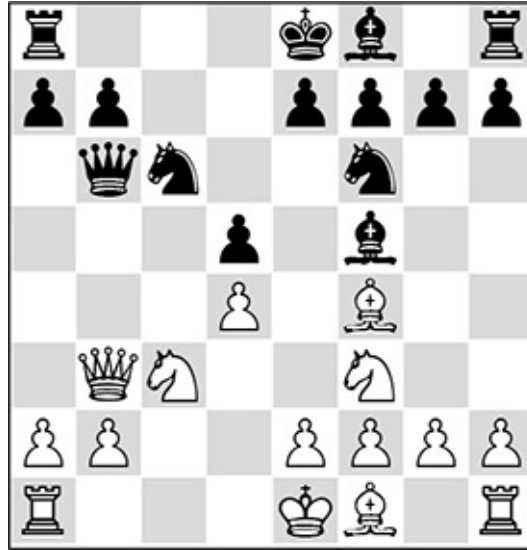
B3) 9. ♖a4 ♖c8 10.0-0 a6 11. ♕xc6 ♖xc6 12. ♖fc1 ♕e7 13. ♖e2 ♖b6= Ivanchuk-Dominguez, Moscow 2009.

C) 8. ♖b3 ♕b4 9. ♕b5 0-0 10. ♕xc6 ♕xc3+ 11. ♖xc3 ♖c8 12. ♖e5 ♖g4 13. ♖xg4 ♕xg4 14. ♖b4 ♖xc6 15. ♖xb7 ♖c8= Kramnik-Anand, Bonn 2008.

7... ♖b6

This is a typical move to parry the attack on b7 but I do not think it is a good one here. It is preferable to play 7... ♖a5 8. ♖a4+ ♕d7 9. ♖c2 e6 10.e3 ♖c8 11. ♕d3± I.Sokolov-Yu Yangyi, Jakarta 2012.

7... ♖d7 is inferior: 8. ♖e5 (8.e3±) 8... ♖xe5 9. ♕xe5 (9.dxe5 ♖e4 10. ♖xe4 dxe4 11.e3±) 9...a6 Sumets-Latreche, Tipaza 2011; and 7... ♖c8 is bad in view of 8. ♖b5±.



8. ♖xb6 axb6 9.e3 e6 10.a3

Practice has also seen 10. ♗h4 ♘e4 11.f3 ♘b4 12.fxe4 (12. ♖d1=) 12... ♗xe4 13. ♘d3 ♗xc3 14.bxc3 ♘xc3+ 15. ♖e2 ♘xa1 16. ♗xa1∞ Moradiabadi-Rublevsky, Khanty-Mansiysk 2010.

10... ♘e7 11. ♘e2

The bishop goes to e2 rather than b5 because White is reserving that square for the knight, while from e2 the bishop controls the h5-square. But 11. ♘b5 is also played and White was slightly better after 11... ♗d7 12.0-0 0-0 13. ♗ac1 in Prié-Van Wely, Bastia 2007.

11. ♗c1 is also good, e.g. 11...0-0 12. ♘e2 (12. ♗h4±) 12... ♗fc8 13. ♗d2± Bauer-Arnold, Biel 2011.

11...0-0 12.0-0 ♗fc8 13. ♗fc1

The main problem with the doubled pawns is their lack of flexibility. White has absolute control of the square b5 and the pawns are weak for the ending. Here 13. ♗d2± was also good.

13... ♗h5

Here 13... ♗e4 was better.

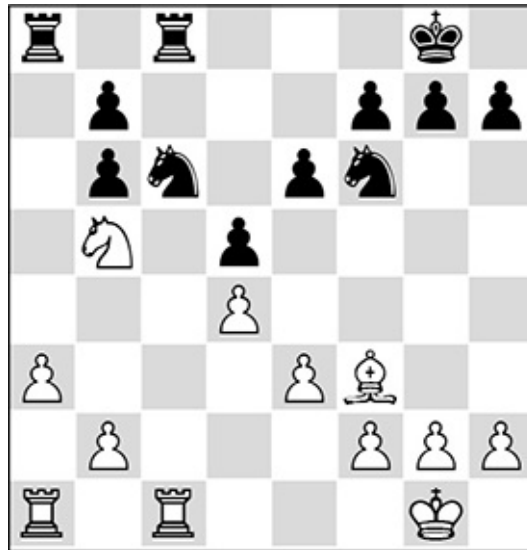
14. ♗g5 ♗xg5

After 14...f6 15. ♗h4 ♘e4! (15...fxg5 16. ♗xf5±) 16. ♗xh5 fxg5 17. ♗g4 ♖f7 18. ♗xe4 gxh4 19. ♗c3 White has a slight advantage.

15. ♗xg5 ♗f6 16. ♗f3

The immediate 16. ♗b5 was good, e.g. 16...h6 17. ♗f3 ♗d8 18. ♗d2±.

16... ♗g4 17. ♗b5 ♗xf3 18. ♗xf3



Black is close to equality in this position. The piece exchanges are in his favour but he must exercise great care. What should he play now?

18... ♖d8?!

18... ♗a5! was the right move: 19. ♖c3 (19. ♕d1 ♖f8 20. ♗d6 ♖c6=) 19... ♖xc3 20. bxc3 ♖f8 21. ♖b1 ♖e7=.

19. ♖f1 ♖f8 20. ♖c3 ♖e7 21. ♖ac1 ♖dc8 22. ♖e1 ♖d7 23. h3 h5 24. h4

Ivanchuk fixes the black pawns on light squares, so that in the future they can be attacked by the bishop. White has a space advantage, and he controls the c-file and the b5-square, while Black's doubled pawns are weak. Still, the win is a long way off.

24... g6 25. g3 ♖a5 26. ♕e2 ♗e8 27. ♖b3 ♖d8

27... ♗xd4? does not work, owing to 28. ♖xc8 ♗xb3 29. ♖c3 ♗a1 (29... ♗c5 30. b4±, and the a1-knight's future is looking bleak.

28. f3 ♗f6 29. ♗c3! ♖c7 30. ♗a2! ♗g8?!

30... ♖c8 31. ♗b4 ♗d7 was better, controlling e5 and defending b6. Still, White can try to open the kingside to gain the advantage.

31. ♗b4



White now has a clear advantage. The knight is heading for e5, to create weaknesses.

31... ♖e7 32. ♗d3 ♜aa8

If 32...f6, weakening his position, White can play 33. ♗f4 with a clear advantage.

33. ♗e5 ♜f8

After 33...f6 34. ♗d3, followed by ♗f4 and then ♗f1-h3, Black has problems on e6.

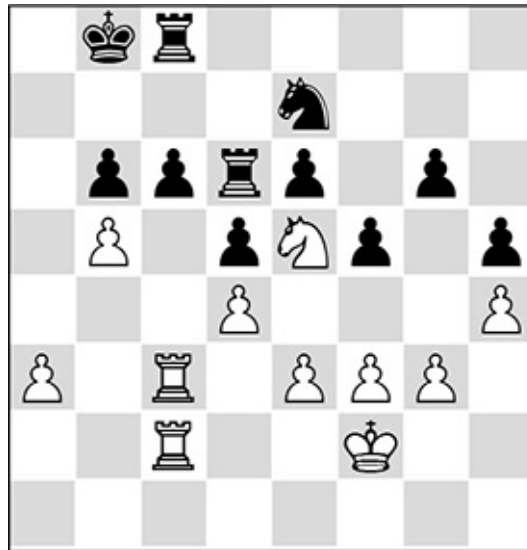
34. ♗d3 f5

After this move White's game is strategically winning. Black has a lot of weaknesses: b6, b7, e6, g6. 34... ♜ad8 was better, but after 35. ♖f2 White retains a clear advantage.

35. ♗b5 ♜ac8 36. ♖f2 ♜g8 37. ♗a4 ♜gf8 38. ♜c2 ♜fd8

If 38... ♜g8 then 39. ♜bc3 ♖d6 40. ♗f7+ ♖d7 41. ♜b3 ♖c7 42. ♗g5 and the e6-pawn falls.

39. ♜bc3 ♜d6 40. b4 ♖b8 41. ♗xc6 bxc6 42. b5



White now wins a pawn and the game is decided. In the end Black was unable to defend all his weaknesses.

42... ♖b7 43.bxc6+ ♜c7

If 43... ♗xc6 then 44. ♗xg6 wins.

44.a4 ♜dd8 45. ♜b2 ♜a8 46. ♜cb3

The target is the b6-pawn, to create an entry for the rooks on b7.

46... ♗c8

If 46... ♜a6 then 47.a5!.

47. ♜a2 ♜g8 48.a5 b5

48... ♜a6 fails to 49.axb6+ ♜xb6 50. ♜xb6 ♜xb6 51. ♜b2+, with a winning advantage.

49. ♜xb5 ♗d6 50. ♜b4 ♜a6 51. ♜g2 g5?! 52.hxg5 ♜xg5 53. ♜h3! ♜g8 54. ♜h4

White is going after the weak pawn on h5.

54... ♜h8 55. ♜ab2 ♜a7

If 55... ♜xa5 then 56. ♜b7+! ♗xb7 57. ♜xb7+ ♜c8 (57... ♜d6?? 58. ♜d7 mate) 58. ♗d7 and wins.

56. ♜b6 ♜ha8 57. ♜xh5 ♜g8 58.a6 ♜ga8 59. ♜b7+ ♗xb7 60.axb7

Black resigned. There is no defence against 61. ♗d7.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the main line of the Slav Exchange with ... ♗f5. White has various options after the usual 7.e3 e6, including 8. ♗d3, which is very drawish, and 8. ♗b5, the most popular move. Ivanchuk chose the interesting 7. ♗b3, delaying e2-e3. Black has several ways to defend the b7-pawn and chose 7... ♗b6, allowing his pawns to be doubled, although the best reply is

7... ♖a5. In the game, White gained a slightly better position, mainly on account of the doubled pawns and his control of the b5-square and the c-file. Ivanchuk kept improving his position and he exploited his opponent's weaknesses very well, finally winning a pawn and the game.

Game 41

Slav

Ferenc Berkes

2682

Miloje Ratkovic

2186

Skopje 2012 (1)

1.d4 d5 2. ♘f4 ♗f6

A) If Black plays symmetrically with 2... ♗f5, White should play 3.c4! right away (the normal 3.e3 e6 4.c4?! is dubious because of 4... ♗xb1! 5. ♖xb1 (or 5. ♗xb1) 4... ♗b4+ and White loses castling rights) and now:



analysis diagram

A1) If 3...c6 4. ♗c3 e6 5. ♗b3 ♗b6 6.c5 ♗xb3 7.axb3 ♗d7 8.b4 ♗gf6 9.e3 (9.b5±) 9... ♗h5 10. ♗g3 (10. ♗e5±) 10... ♗e7= Gazik-Chernyshov, Ustron 2013;

A2) On the third move Black can also opt for 3...dxc4 4. ♗c3 ♗f6 5.e3 (5.f3 e6 6.e4 ♗g6 7. ♗xc4± Kaunzinger-Stross, Bavaria 2011, or 5...c6 6.e4 ♗e6= Olea-Fernandez, Asturias 2009) 5...c6 6. ♗xc4± 6... ♗bd7? (6...e6±) 7. ♗b3 (with a double attack on b7 and f7) 7... ♗b6 (7...e6 8. ♗xb7 ♖c8 9. ♗a6)

8. ♖xf7+ ♔d8 1-0 Romero-Aranda, Caete 1994;

A3) 3...e6 and now 4. ♖c3 transposes to the game; if 4. ♗b3 ♖c6 with advantage, or 4.cxd5 exd5 5. ♖c3=.

B) Another option is 2...c6 3.e3:



analysis diagram

B1) 3... ♖f5 4.c4 (4. ♖f3 e6 5.c4 ♖d6= Vachier-Lagrave-Caruana, Biel 2010, or 4. ♖d3 ♖xd3 5. ♗xd3 ♖f6 6. ♖f3 e6 7.0-0 ♖d6 8. ♖xd6 ♗xd6 9.c4 0-0 10. ♖c3 ♖bd7= Stefanova-Harikrishna, Cap d'Agde 2006) 4...e6 (4... ♖xb1?! 5. ♗xb1 e5 6. ♖xe5 ♗a5+ 7. ♗d1± 7... ♖d7 8. ♖g3 c5 9. ♖f3 ♖gf6 10.a3 cxd4 11.exd4 ♖e7 12.c5 ♖e4 13. ♖d3 f5 14.b4 ♗d8 15. ♗b3 f4 16. ♖xf4 ♖xf2+ 17. ♗c2 ♖xh1 18. ♗xd5 Berkes-Lupulescu, Dresden 2008) 5. ♖c3 ♖d7 6. ♗b3 ♗b6 7.c5 ♗xb3 8.axb3 a6 9.b4 ♗c8 10. ♖f3 h6 11. ♖d2 g5 12. ♖g3 ♖g7 13. ♖b3 e5 14. ♖a5± Grachev-Kobalia, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013;

B2) 3...e6 4. ♖f3 ♖d6 5. ♖d3 ♖xf4 6.exf4 ♖e7 7. ♖bd2 b6 8.0-0 ♖a6 9.c4± Jobava-Ivanov, Sochi 2014;

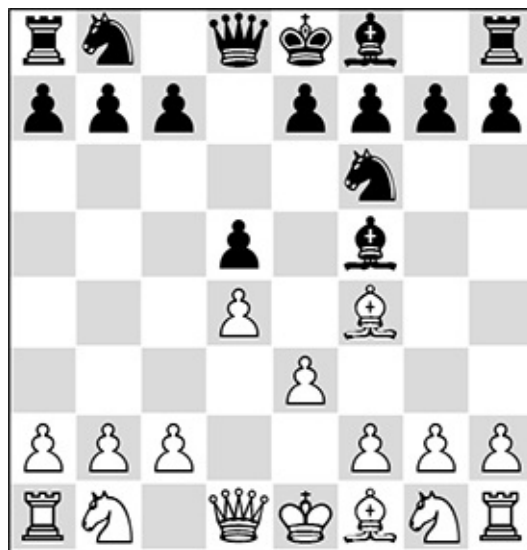
B3) 3... ♗b6 and now:

B31) 4.b3! (this must be one of the few times when this move is necessary and good) 4... ♖f5 (4... ♖f6 5. ♖d3 c5 6. ♖c3 (6. ♖f3± is better) 6... ♖g4!? 7.f3?! (7. ♖xd5±) 7... ♖d7 8. ♖ge2 e6= Prié-Tregubov, Le Port Marly 2009) 5. ♖d3 (5. ♖f3 e6 6. ♖d3 ♖g6 7.0-0 ♖f6 8.c4 ♖bd7 9.c5 ♗d8 10.b4± Eljanov-Golod, Netanya 2009) 5... ♖xd3 6. ♗xd3 ♖f6 7. ♖e2 e6 8.0-0 ♖bd7 9.c4± Predojevic-Houska, Oslo 2013;

B32) White has also tried 4. ♗c1!? ♖f5 (4... ♖f6 5. ♖d3 (5. ♖f3! and 5.h3! are better) 5... ♖h5 6. ♖g5 h6 7. ♖h4 ♖d7= Sandipan-Komljenovic, Benasque 2014) 5. ♖f3 ♖d7 6. ♖e2 e6 7.0-0 h6 8.h3 ♖gf6 9.c4± Stefanova-Zatonskih,

Beijing 2012.

3.e3 ♘f5



The Slav set-up against the London System is a defence that has a solid reputation and it is difficult for White to gain any advantage against it. Black plays symmetrically in many lines. We have already seen in the chapter on the Benoni how Black can transpose to the Exchange Variation of the Slav. This defence and its associated patterns of play are very common in many variations of the London System, so it is essential to have a good knowledge of them with white.

4.c4 c6

Alternatives include:

A) 4... ♘c6!?

A1) 5. ♖b3!? (5. ♘f3) 5...e6 (5... ♘a5 6. ♖a4+ c6 7.c5 b5=) 6. ♖xb7?! (6. ♘c3=) 6... ♘b4 7. ♘a3 dxc4 8. ♘xc7 (8. ♘b5!? ♖b8 9. ♘xc7+ ♔d7 10. ♖xa7 ♘c6 11. ♖a4 ♖b4 12. ♖a6 ♖xb2) 8... ♖d5! 9. ♖xd5 ♘fxd5 10. ♘g3 (10. ♘a5 ♘d3+ 11. ♘xd3 ♘xd3) 10... ♘d3+ 11. ♘xd3 cxd3!? (11... ♘b4+ 12. ♖d1 ♘xd3) 12. ♘f3 (12. ♖c1=) 12... ♘b4+ 13. ♖d1 0-0?! (13... ♖c8) 14. ♘c4= De Prado-Patio, Spain tt 2014;

A2) 5. ♘c3 e6 6. ♘f3 (6.a3 is better) 6... ♘b4 7. ♘e2 (7. ♖c1) 7... ♘e4 8. ♖b3 0-0 9.0-0 ♘xc3 10.bxc3 ♘a5= Nguyen Ngoc-Le Quang Liem, Cap d'Agde 2010.

B) 4...e6 5. ♘c3 (5. ♖b3 ♘c6=) 5... ♘d6 (5... ♘b4 6. ♖b3 (6. ♘d3=) 6... ♘c6 7.a3 ♘xc3+ 8.bxc3= Stefanova-Koneru, Beijing 2013) 6. ♘xd6 ♖xd6 7. ♘f3 c6 8. ♘e2 0-0 9.0-0= Shimanov-Mikhailov, St Petersburg 2013.

5. ♘c3 e6 6. ♖b3



This is the thematic idea when Black moves his bishop from c8; White attacks the weak point b7, just as Black does in other lines with ...♞b6, attacking b2. The difference is that White is helped by having his bishop on f4, controlling a key diagonal.

Now Black has to choose how to defend his b7-pawn; he has various options, such as 6...♞c8, 6...b6 or 6...♞b6. Each of these has its drawbacks and the choice is not easy for Black, since White's threats are more unpleasant than they might appear at first sight.

6...b6

This is not the most popular move but according to the engines it is the best. Let us consider the alternatives:

A) 6...♞b6. The resulting endgame is considered better for White after 7.c5 ♞xb3 8.axb3 ♞bd7 9.b4 (other options at this point are 9.h3 a6 10.b4 ♞c8 11.♞f3 ♞e7 12.♞d2 ♞d8 13.♞b3 ♞c7 14.♞xc7 ♞xc7 15.b5± Grachev-Mohammad, Chennai 2016, and 9.♞f3 a6 10.h3 ♞e7 11.b4 0-0 12.♞d2 ♞ac8 13.♞b3 ♞d8 14.♞d6 ♞e8 15.♞a5 ♞xa5 16.bxa5± Bortnyk-Nguyen, Böblingen 2015) 9...♞h5 (or 9...♞e7 10.f3!± 10...0-0 11.g4 ♞g6 12.b5 Löffler-Cardili, Porto Mannu 2013; or 9...a6 10.f3 (10.b5 cxb5 11.♞xb5 ♞c8 12.♞a4±) 10... ♞c8 11.g4 ♞g6 12.h4±) and now:



analysis diagram

A1) 10. e5 f6?! (10... xe5 11.dxe5 g5 12.h3± and the pawn break on b5 gives White the advantage) 11. c7 g5 12.b5± Yermolinsky-Lu, Dallas 2008;

A2) In the above line, instead of 10.♖e5, the move 10.♖c7!? is fashionable, and the piece sacrifice after 10...♜c8 11.♜xa7!? (11.♖e5±) 11...♜xc7 12.♜a8+ (12.b5☞) 12...♔e7 13.b5 appears to give White compensation (and in fact he has scored well) but although this idea is quite interesting I do not think that White gains any advantage with it: 13...b6 (13...cxb5 14.♕xb5 ♜c6 15.♕a7 ♜c7 16.f3 (16.♕b5=) 16...♕xc5 17.dxc5 ♜xc5 18.g4 ♜c1+ 19.♔f2 ♜c2+ = Miladinovic-Grbovic, Cetinje 2012; or 13...e5 (13...g5?! 14.b6 ♕xb6 15.cxb6 ♜d7± Riordan-Katz, Parsippany 2013) 14.b6 ♕xb6 15.cxb6 ♜c8 16.♜a7= Noirox-Hommerson, Belgium tt 2013/14) 14.bxc6 ♜xc6 15.♜a7? (15.♖b5! ♜c7 16.c6 ♕df6 17.f3☞) 15...♕f6 (15...♔d8⚡) 16.♖b5 Rusev-Mitkov, Sunny Beach 2010.

B) The move 6... ♖c8 is played more often, although this does not seem like a good square for the queen (similar to when White plays ♕c1); I think that eventually the queen will be exposed to an attack by an enemy rook along the c-file.



analysis diagram

B1) Here White has tried 7.h3 ♖e7 8.♗f3 h6 9.♕e2 0-0 10.0-0 ♗bd7± Kamsky-Leko, Beijing 2013, as well as 7.cxd5 ♗xd5 8.♕g3 ♕e7 9.♗f3 0-0 10.♕e2± Bocharov-Simonian, Bhubaneswar 2010;

B2) Another good option seems to be 7.♖c1 and now:

B21) 7...♗bd7 8.cxd5 (8.♗f3 ♕e7 9.♗h4±; 9.cxd5 exd5?! 10.♗b5± D.Gurevich-Zhou, Moscow 2005, but 9...♗xd5 is an improvement) 8...♗xd5 9.♕g3 (or 9.♗xd5 exd5 10.♗e2±) 9...♗7f6 10.♗f3 ♕e7 11.♕e2 0-0= Roiz-Bryzgalin, Dagomys 2010;

B22) 7...♕e7 8.cxd5 ♗xd5 9.♕g3 (9.♕xb8?! ♖xb8 10.e4 ♗xc3 11.exf5 ♗d5 12.♕c4 0-0 with a slight advantage to Black, De Prado-B.Vega, Linares 2013; instead 9.♗xd5! exd5 10.♕d3± is better) 9...0-0 10.♗f3 ♗xc3 11.♖xc3 a5 12.a3± Ponomariov-Karjakin, Moscow 2010.

7.♗f3 ♕d6

Or 7...♕e7 8.♕e2 (8.♖c1±) 8...0-0± Vezzosi-Modena, Arbo 2009.

8.♗e5

This seems best. White has also tried 8.♕g3 0-0 9.♕e2 ♖e7 10.♗e5 ♗fd7 11.0-0= Nguyen Ngoc-Tologontegin, Guangzhou 2010, and 8.♕xd6 ♖xd6 9.cxd5 exd5 10.♕e2 ♗bd7 11.0-0 h6= Dorfman-Cuijpers, Germany Bundesliga B 1999/2000.

8...dxc4

I think that it is better to play 8...0-0 9.h3 (9.♕e2±) 9...♗e4 10.cxd5 ♗xc3 11.♖xc3= Abdel-Sarwat, Windhoek 2007.

9.♕xc4

I think that White has emerged from the opening with a slight advantage, since

Black has a weak square at c6 and his queenside development is lagging.

9...0-0 10. ♖e2!



A good move: the bishop retreats from c4 to control g4 and go to f3; at the same time it clears the c-file.

10... ♗d5 11.g4!?

Here the simple 11. ♗xd5! would give White a pleasant advantage, e.g. 11... cxd5 (11...exd5 12.0-0±) 12.g4 ♖e4 13.f3 ♖g6 14. ♖c1±.

11... ♖g6 12.h4 ♗xc3 13.bxc3

It was better to recapture with the queen: 13. ♙xc3!±.

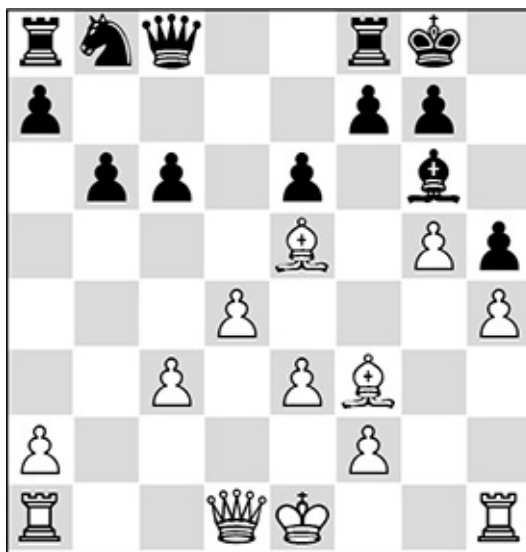
13... ♖xe5 14. ♖xe5 h6 15. ♖f3

White has a clear advantage: he has the bishop pair and the initiative on the kingside, while Black is nursing a weakness on c6 and has an inactive knight on b8.

15... ♙c8 16.g5 h5!?

If 16...hxg5 then after 17.hxg5 ♗d7 18. ♖g3 White would maintain a clear advantage, owing to the open h-file.

17. ♙d1!



White is going to win the pawn on h5.

17... ♖a6 18. ♗xh5 ♗xh5 19. ♖xh5 ♖a3 20.0-0!!

A very good move by White: he brings his king into safety and indirectly defends his pawn.

20... ♗d7

Why did Black not take the pawn with 20... ♖xc3?



analysis diagram

Because this loses after 21. ♗g7! ♖xg7 22. ♖h6+ ♖g8 23.g6 fxg6 24. ♖xg6+ ♖h8 25. ♖h1 and the arrival of the rook on g1 will be decisive.

21. ♗g3

Now the sacrifice 21. ♗g7 ♖xg7 22. ♖h6+ ♖g8 23.g6 fxg6 24. ♖xg6+ ♖h8 is only good enough for a draw, since if 25. ♖h1? then 25... ♖e7 and Black wins.

21... ♖xc3 22. ♖ac1 ♖a5 23. ♖xc6 ♖xa2

Black has recovered the material, but stands worse. White commands the open file, Black's knight cannot move and White has the attack, with g5-g6 in the air.

24. ♖fc1

Here 24. ♖c7! ♖d5 25. ♖g4 was stronger, with the idea of e3-e4. White would have a clear advantage.

24... ♖d5 25. ♖d6 ♖b5?

It was better to play 25... ♖b7, although White would still have a clear advantage after 26. ♖dc6 ♖fc8 27. ♖c7 ♖xc7 28. ♖xc7 ♖d5 29. ♖g4.

26. ♖d1 ♖fd8 27. ♖c7



Now White gains material and has a won game.

27... ♖f8 28. ♖xd8

Even stronger was 28. ♖f3! ♖e8 29. h5 ♖ac8 30. ♖xa7.

28... ♖xd8 29. ♖xa7 ♖d5 30. ♖c2 b5 31. ♖c5 ♖f3

If 31... ♖xc5 then 32. dxc5, or 31... ♖d7 32. ♖xd5 ♖xd5 33. ♖b7.

32. ♖xb5

White is two pawns up and to win he just needs to parry a few threats by Black.

32... ♖c8 33. ♖f1 ♖g6 34. ♖g2 ♖c1+?

34... ♖g4 was more tenacious, but after 35. f3 ♖f5 36. e4 ♖b5 37. ♖a2 White is winning.

35. ♖h2 ♖h5 36. ♖a8+ ♖h7 37. ♖e4 ♖g8 38. ♖a8+ ♖h7 39. ♖f8

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw a Slav Defence set-up by Black against the London

System and we reviewed various options for Black on move 2. We saw that after 2...c6 and 3...♞b6 we have one of the few occasions when White should respond with 4.b3!. We learned that if Black plays 2...♙f5 White should play an immediate 3.c4. After 1.d4 d5 2.♙f4 ♞f6 3.e3 ♙f5 4.c4 we saw that 4...♞c6 and 4...e6 are interesting. In the game, after White played the main line with 6.♞b3, Black had several ways to defend the b7-pawn. In the game we saw 6...b6 but we also analysed 6...♞b6 and 6...♞c8, which are the main alternatives. White emerged from the opening with some advantage, on account of his better development and the weakness on c6 in particular. White opted to put pressure on both wings and won a pawn. Then, following the brilliant 20.0-0!! White had a clear advantage and shortly afterwards he was able to win without any problems.

Game 42

Slav

Sergey Karjakin

2766

Vladimir Kramnik

2787

Khanty-Mansiysk Candidates 2014 (9)

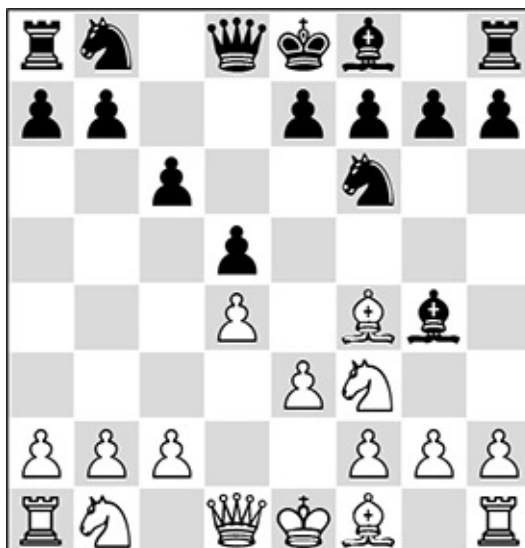
1.d4 ♞f6 2.♞f3 d5 3.♙f4

We already know that White does better to employ the 2.♙f4 move order.

3...c6?!

3...c5 would be the best move for Black against this move order. Kramnik opts for a type of Slav Defence.

4.e3 ♙g4



The most popular move with this move order. The alternatives are:

A) 4... ♖b6 – a classical line for Black which Kramnik had already played before: 5. ♗bd2!? (5. ♖c1 ♕f5 6. c4 e6 7. ♗c3 (7. c5) 7... ♗bd7 8. c5± Kamsky-Kramnik, Turin ol 2006) 5... ♖xb2 (5... ♗bd7 6. ♕d3) 6. ♖b1!? (6. ♕d3 ♖a3 (6... ♖b6 7. 0-0 e6 8. c4 ♕e7 9. ♖b1 ♖d8± Annaberdiev-Barsov, Doha 2006) 7. ♖e2 (7. 0-0; 7. ♗e5 e6 8. 0-0☞ Karaboikis-Kjartansson, Rodas 2013) 7... ♕g4?! 8. 0-0 ♗bd7 9. h3 ♕xf3 10. ♗xf3± Van Harreveld-De Vreugt, Enschede 2006) 6... ♖xa2 7. ♕d3☞;

B) 4... ♕f5 – heading for the Slav, as we saw in the previous game: 5. c4 e6 6. ♗c3 (here it is better to play 6. ♖b3 ♖b6 7. c5 ♖xb3 8. axb3± Kadziolka-Kulon, Wroclaw 2013) 6... ♗bd7 (6... ♕e7 (6... ♕d6=) 7. ♖b3 ♖c8 8. h3 0-0 9. ♕e2 ♗e4 10. 0-0± E. Alvarez-B. Vega, Linares 2013) 7. ♖b3 ♖b6 8. c5 ♖xb3 9. axb3±.

5. c4 ♗bd7

Other options for Black are:

A) 5... e6 6. ♖b3 ♖b6 (6... ♖a5+ 7. ♗c3 ♖b4 8. c5± Ilic-Stojanovic, Obrenovac 2011) 7. c5! (7. ♗e5 ♕f5 8. c5 ♖xb3 9. axb3 ♕xb1 10. ♖xb1 ♗bd7 (10... ♗h5=) 11. b4 a6± Pakleza-Dreev, Varosvia 2013) 7... ♖xb3 8. axb3 ♗bd7 9. h3 (9. ♗c3 ♗h5 10. ♕g3 ♗xg3 11. hxg3 ♕e7= Röder-Iagar, Balaguer 2011; 9. ♗bd2!±) 9... ♕f5 10. ♗c3 h6 11. b4 ♕e7 12. b5 0-0 13. bxc6 bxc6 14. ♕a6;

B) 5... ♕xf3!? 6. gxf3 (6. ♖xf3 e6 7. cxd5 cxd5 8. ♗c3 ♗c6 9. ♕d3 ♕d6± Ravi-Murali, Tirupati 2012) 6... dxc4 (6... ♗bd7 7. ♗c3 e6 8. e4 (8. ♖b3±) 8... ♕b4 9. ♖b3 ♕xc3+ 10. bxc3 dxe4 11. ♖xb7 0-0 ½-½ Bacrot-Khenkin, Eppingen 2008) 7. ♕xc4 e6 8. ♗c3 ♗bd7 9. ♖c2 (9. ♕d3±) 9... ♗b6 10. ♕e2 ♕d6= Grachev-Bryzgalin, Ulan Ude 2009.

6. ♗c3

I think that it is even better to play 6. ♖b3 right away, and now: 6... ♕xf3 (6... ♖b6 7. ♗c3 (7. ♗bd2) 7... dxc4 8. ♕xc4 e6± Georgiev-Mchedlishvili, Warsaw 2005) 7. gxf3 ♖b6 (7... ♗h5 8. ♕g3 ♖b6 9. ♗c3 (9. cxd5 ♖xb3 10. axb3 cxd5 11. ♗c3 e6 12. ♗b5±) 9... e6 10. ♖c2 ♖a5 (10... ♕e7 11. ♕e2 g6 12. f4 ♗g7 13. 0-0-0 ♗f5= Mirzoev-Sengupta, Calvi 2010) 11. a3 dxc4 12. ♕xc4± Bagheri-Pähtz, Belgium tt 2003/04) 8. ♗d2 (8. ♗c3±) 8... ♗h5 9. ♕g3 e6 10. c5 ♖xb3 11. ♗xb3= Tu Hoang-Varga, Elista 1998.

White has also played 6. ♗bd2 ♗h5 7. ♕g5 (7. h3 ♕xf3 8. ♖xf3 ♗xf4 9. ♖xf4=; 7. ♕e5!?) 7... h6 8. ♕h4 g5 9. ♕g3 e6= Gomez-Magem, Linares 1995.

6... e6 7. ♖b3

Or 7. cxd5 ♗xd5 8. ♗xd5 exd5 9. ♕d3 ♕b4+ 10. ♖f1 ♖e7= Ye-Liang, Beijing 2005.

7... dxc4?

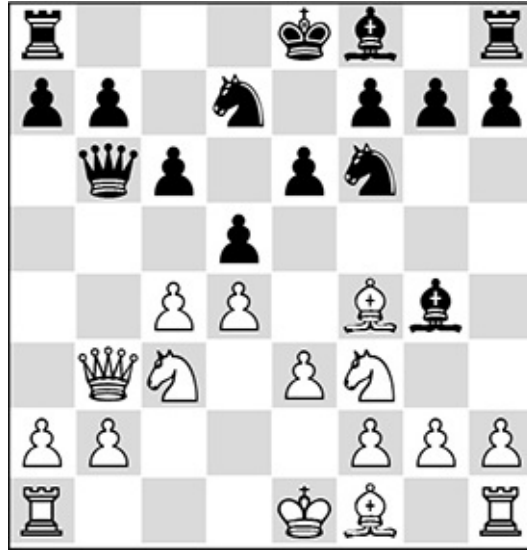


This capture is a clear mistake: allowing White to capture on b7 is usually bad for Black in the London System and this is no exception. We do not know if Kramnik had prepared this or decided to improvise, but it did not turn out well for him in such an important game.

A) In this position Black has also played 7... ♖xf3 8.gxf3 ♜b6 (8... ♜c8 9.cxd5 ♜xd5 10. ♜xd5 exd5 11. ♜h3± Crouch-Baburin, Birmingham 2001; or 8... ♜h5 9. ♜g3 ♜xg3 10.hxg3 ♜b8± Wirthensohn-Cherniaev, Scuol 2001) 9.c5 ♜xb3 10.axb3 a6 (10... ♜h5 11. ♜g3 a6 12.b4 ♜c8 13. ♜d3 (13.f4 ♜xg3 14.hxg3 g6 15. ♜d3 ♜g7 16.g4± Torre-Supriyono, Jakarta 2012) 13...g6 14. ♜e2 f6± Hulak-Wessman, Novi Sad 1990) 11.b4 ♜c8 12. ♜g3 g6= Elianov-Naer, Netanya 2009;

B) If 7...b6? 8.cxd5 ♜xd5 9. ♜xd5 cxd5 10. ♜a6 Hirscher-Welsch, Koblenz 2003;

C) 7... ♜b6 reaches the lines in the note to move 5...e6. Now:



analysis diagram

C1) 8.h3 ♕xf3 9.gxf3 ♖xb3 10.axb3 ♕b4=;

C2) 8.♗d2 ♕f5 9.h3 (9.c5±) 9...♖xb3 10.axb3= Pham-D.Nguyen, Ho Chi Minh City 2013;

C3) 8.c5 ♖xb3 9.axb3±.

8.♖xb7± ♕xf3 9.gxf3 ♗d5 10.♕g3 ♗b6

It appears that Black's idea was to continue with 10...♕b4, but White responds with 11.♕xc4±, when 11...♗xc3 (11...♕xc3+ 12.bxc3 ♗xc3 13.♕c7 ♖c8 14.♕a6) loses to 12.♖xb4 +–.

11.♖xc6 ♕b4 12.♖b5

12.♗c1± was also possible.

12...♖e7 13.a3 ♕xc3+ 14.bxc3 0-0

White has an extra pawn and can capture a second; his advantage is clear.

15.♕xc4

Karjakin takes the second pawn. It was also possible to play 15.a4 a5 16.♕e2 f5 (16...♗d5 17.♖d2±) 17.♗g1±.

15...♗xc4 16.♖xc4 ♗ac8 17.♖d3 ♗b6 18.0-0 ♗c4



Black is trying to blockade the pawns on the light squares and put pressure on c3 with his knight and his rooks, while the bishop on g3 is taking little part in the game. But two pawns is a lot of material and I do not think that Black's compensation is sufficient.

19. ♖fb1 ♜fc8 20. ♖b3 h5 21. e4

Another option was 21. h4±.

21... ♗g5 22. h4 ♗a5 23. ♖c1

It was possible to defend the pawn indirectly with 23. ♔g2! ♗a4 (23... ♜xc3? 24. ♔d2) 24. ♜ab1 ♗c6 25. ♙f4 f6 (25... ♜xc3 26. ♜xc3 ♗xc3 27. ♗a6) 26. ♙d2±.

23... ♗a4 24. ♗b1 ♙d7 25. ♗g2 ♙f8?

This plan is bad. The knight was very well placed on b6, blocking the b-file and controlling c4 and a4. It was better to move it back there, although after 25... ♙b6 White would still maintain a clear advantage.

26. ♗b2

Here 26. d5 exd5 27. exd5 ♗a6 28. d6 was also strong.

26... ♗e8

If 26... ♜xd4 then 27. cxd4 ♜xc1 28. ♗xc1 ♗xb3 29. ♗c8 ♗b6 30. d5.

27. ♜b7 a6 28. ♗b6 ♙g6 29. ♗xa6

A third pawn falls. White's advantage is decisive.

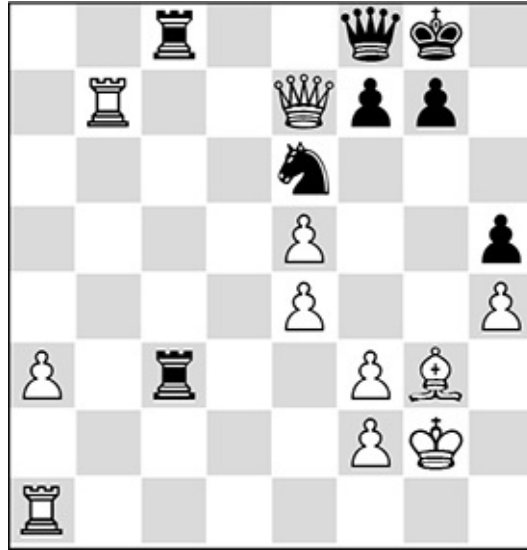
29... ♗d8

Now 29... ♜xc3 loses to 30. ♜xc3 ♜xc3 31. ♜b8.

30. ♗b5 e5 31. ♜h1

White could also play 31. dxe5 ♙xh4+ 32. ♙xh4 ♗xh4 33. e6.

31... ♜xc3 32. dxe5 ♙f8 33. ♗d5 ♗e8 34. ♜a1 ♙e6 35. ♗d7 ♗f8 36. ♗e7



White exchanges the queens and simplifies the position to reach a winning endgame.

36... ♖xe7 37. ♙xe7 ♗d4 38.a4 ♗xf3 39.e6

Here 39.a5 was also winning.

39... fxe6 40. ♙xe6 ♗d4 41. ♙e5 ♗e2 42. ♙xh5 ♗xg3 43.fxg3 ♙e3 44.a5

The simplest: White returns one pawn and the rook ending is a very easy win.

44... ♙xe4 45.a6 ♙e7 46. ♙b5 ♖h7 47. ♖h3

Or 47.a7 ♙a8 48. ♙ba5.

47... ♙a8 48. ♙b6 ♙aa7 49. ♙a5 ♙e3 50.h5 ♙d3 51. ♖h4 ♙d4+ 52.g4 ♙e4 53. ♖g5 ♙f7 54. ♙g6!

Now 54.a7 would complicate the task a little, since it would lose another pawn, but after 54... ♙ff4 55. ♙e5 ♙xg4+ 56. ♖f5 ♙gf4+ 57. ♖e6 ♙a4 58. ♙b7 White should still win.

54... ♙a7 55. ♖h4 ♙b4 56. ♙c6 ♙e4 57. ♙b6 ♙e1 58. ♙a4 ♙e3 59.g5 ♙ee7 60. ♙b8 g6 61. ♙b6 gxh5 62. ♙ab4 ♙e1

If 62... ♖g7 then 63. ♙b7 ♖g6 64. ♙xe7 ♙xe7 65. ♙b6+ ♖f5 66.g6 wins.

63. ♙b7+ ♖g6

Equivalent to resignation. But if 63... ♙xb7 then 64.axb7 wins.

64. ♙4b6+ ♖f5 65. ♙xa7

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw Black's plan of ...c7-c6, typical of the Slav, but with ...♙g4 instead of ...♙f5. Kramnik had played 4... ♖b6 previously against Kamsky, but this time he preferred to play something different. White played in a similar way to the typical plan against the Slav with c2-c4, ♗c3

and ♖b3; the main difference is that Black is able to exchange on f3 and leave White with a less mobile pawn structure. In the game Black went wrong with the move 7...dxc4, which left him with a clear disadvantage after 8.♖xb7. It is not usually good for Black to allow White to capture on b7 and this game was no exception. White emerged with two extra pawns and although Black had some compensation, this was not sufficient.

CONCLUSION

We have seen that from the Benoni we can reach the Exchange Variation of the Slav Defence, via several different move orders, such as 1.d4 c5 2.c3 cxd4 3.cxd4 d5 4.♙f4, or 1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 c5 3.c3 cxd4 4.cxd4 d5. (There is also the possibility of 1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 c5 3.c3 d5 and then 4.dxc5 is playable, as we shall see in the chapter devoted to ...d7-d5.) A London System player needs to have this variation in his repertoire. It has a drawish reputation, but is no more drawish than other variations. It is played a lot and normally White ends up in a risk-free position, maybe even with a slight advantage, and it is quite easy to play. The main plan is to double rooks on the c-file, play on the queenside and place a strong knight on e5.

In Game 38 we saw a topical line where White delays playing ♗f3 and Black plays ...♙g4; White was slightly better and then took good advantage of his opponent's errors. In Game 39 we saw the lines where Black plays ...e7-e6, leaving the queen's bishop at home. In these lines White is usually better, since the bishop on d3 is stronger than the one on b7, which usually remains passive. There are good chances of mounting the typical Stonewall attack with f2-f4, ♗e5, g2-g4-g5 and ♖f3-h3, but with the added benefit of having exchanged the 'bad' dark-squared bishop. In this game White gained a good victory. In Game 40 we saw the more common line with ...♙f5. Instead of the usual e2-e3, White played ♖b3 immediately, attacking b7. Black chose the defence with ...♖b6, which after the exchange of queens leaves him with a worse endgame. In my opinion the best defence is ...♗a5. In this game White manoeuvred very well, keeping a comfortable advantage throughout, until Black finally lost a pawn and with it the game.

In Game 41 we analysed all the other ideas for Black which involve the move ...♙f5: the normal Slav set-up against the London System, the symmetrical 2...♙f5 (against which White should play 3.c4! before playing e2-e3) and also the immediate 2...c6; now, after 3.e3 ♖b6, we have

one of the few occasions where White can and should play 4.b3!, which is good here, although 4.♔c1!? is also playable.

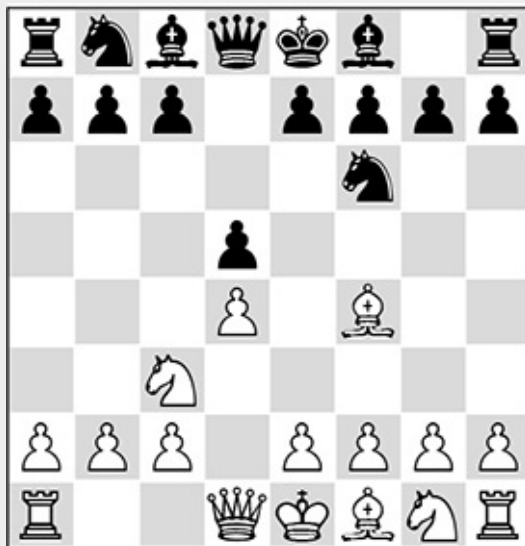
The key line occurs when White carries out the standard plan of playing 6.♗b3, attacking the b7-pawn. Black has three ways to defend it: in this game we saw 6...b6 but we also analysed 6...♗c8, which is the most popular in practice. Black can also play 6...♗b6, although the endgame arising after White plays 7.c5 is advantageous for White. In Game 42 we saw the black plan of ...c7-c6 and ...♖g4, used by Kramnik. White's plan then is similar to the one employed against the normal Slav with c4, ♗b3 and ♕c3. In the game Black went wrong with 7...dxc4, which gave White a clear advantage after 8.♗xb7, when White had an extra pawn and the better pawn structure.

Chapter 8

The London System versus ...d7-d5 without an early ...e7-e6

1.d4 d5 2.♘f4

1.d4 d5
1...♘f6
2.♘f4
2.♘c3 ♘f6 3.♘f4



3...a6 and ...e7-e6; 3...♘f5; 3...c5
2.♘f3 ♘f6 or 2...c5 3.c3
2...♘f6
2...c5
3.e4; 3.e3
3.e3 c5
3...♘c6
4.c3 ♘c6
4...♙b6

5. ♘d2 ♜b6
 5... ♙f5; 5... cxd4
 6. ♜b3



6... c4
 6... ♙f5
 7. ♜c2
 7. ♙xb6
 7... ♙g4

In this chapter we shall look at:

- the various systems for Black with 1...d5, but without an early ...e7-e6;
- the lines with ...c7-c5, in the style of the Tarrasch Defence, and once again the idea of ...♜b6, putting pressure on b2, which is one of Black's most popular systems;
- the Chigorin set-up with ...♘c6.

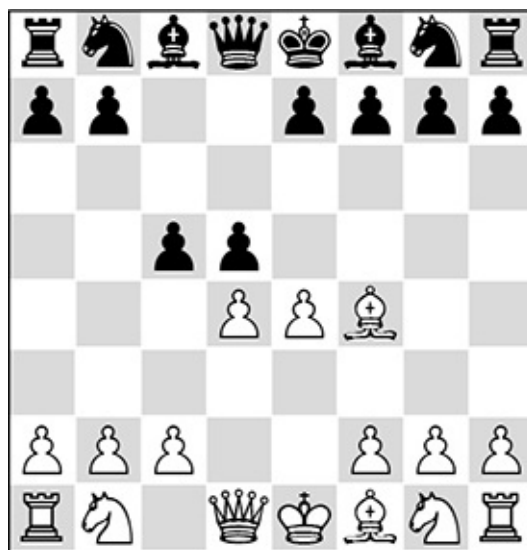
As well as looking at ways to combat all these lines, we shall cover some other interesting ideas for White: the Morris Gambit 1.d4 d5 2. ♙f4 c5 3.e4!? and a new idea, the Jobava Attack, 1.d4 d5 2. ♙f4 ♘f6 3. ♘c3!?, brought into fashion by the strong grandmaster of that name; this line is a cross between the London System and the Richter-Veresov Attack. It also involves an interesting idea to avoid Black's plan of ...♜b6.

Game 43

Morris Gambit

Warsaw 2005 (3)

1.d4 d5 2.♘f4 c5 3.e4



The Morris Gambit is a sort of Albin Counter-gambit with reversed colours and an extra tempo, since White has already developed the bishop on f4. The Belgian grandmaster Luc Winants is its main exponent. The normal line is 3.e3, which we shall see in the next game.

A) If 3.♘xb8?! ♜xb8 4.dxc5 e6 5.♙d4 ♞e7 6.e3 ♞d7 (6...♞c6) 7.c4 ♞c6 ♞Stefanova-Skripchenko, Shenyang 2000;

B) The alternative is 3.♞c3, with several replies that we shall now examine. We shall leave 3...♞f6 until later, when we consider the Jobava Attack.

B1) 3...♞c6 4.e3 (4.e4 transposes to the Morris Gambit with the line 3...♞c6) 4...cxd4 5.exd4 ♞f5 6.♞d3 ♞xd3 7.♙xd3 e6 8.♞f3 ♞d6 9.♞e2 (9.♞xd6 ♙xd6 10.0-0 ♞ge7 11.♜fe1 0-0 Knezevic-Sveshnikov, Anapa 1991) 9...♞ge7 10.c3 ♞g6 11.♞g3 ♞xg3 12.hxg3 ♙d6= Miladinovic-Ratkovic, Vrnjacka Banja 2013;

B2) 3...e6 4.e4± Prié-Doluhanova, Montpellier 2013;

B3) 3...cxd4 4.♙xd4 e6 5.e4 ♞c6=.

3...dxe4

It is often said that the best way to refute a gambit is to accept it, although we know that often that is not the case. In this position there are several alternatives, and although capturing was always the main move, nowadays there are other lines that are more unpleasant for White. Let us see:

A) 3... ♖f6!? 4.e5 ♗fd7 5.♕d3?! (5.c3 ♗c6=; 5.c4 e6 6.♗f3 ♗c6=) 5...e6 (5...♔b6!?) 6.c3 ♗c6 7.♗f3 ♕e7 8.0-0= Dickson-Wagner, England 4NCL 2011.

B) 3... ♗c6! is very interesting. This idea involves an exchange sacrifice, but Black obtains very good compensation and scores very well. Let us examine White's options here:



analysis diagram

B1) 4. ♗c3 cxd4 5.exd5 dxc3 6.dxc6 ♔xd1+ (6... ♔a5? 7.b4±) 7. ♖xd1 bxc6 and now:

B11) 8. ♕c7 ♗g4 (8...e6!=) 9.f3 ♖c8?! (9...♕d7=) 10. ♕a5± Hoffmeyer-Hoffmann, Germany tt 2011;

B12) 8.bxc3 f6 9.♕c7 ♗f5 (9...♔f7=) 10. ♕a6 ♔f7 11. ♕b7 ♖e8= Reddmann-Svane, Hamburg 2012;

B2) 4.dxc5 ♗f6 5.exd5 (5.e5 ♗e4=) 5... ♗xd5 6. ♗g3 e5 7. ♕c4 ♕e6 8. ♗f3 f6= Reddmann-Boidman, Hamburg 2004;

B3) 4.exd5. Here 4... ♔xd5 5. ♗c3 is considered best, and now:



analysis diagram

B31) 5...♔f5?! 6.♕e3 (6.♕g3±) 6...cxd4 7.♖b5 ♕d7 8.♖xd4 ♖xd4 9.♖xd4= Winants-Van der Werf, Netherlands tt 2006.

B32) 5...♔e6+?! 6.♖ge2 ♖xd4 7.♕e3 (7.♔d2±) 7...a6 (7...♖xe2 8.♕xe2 ♕d7 9.♕xc5±) 8.♖xd4 cxd4 9.♖xd4± Romero-Fernandez, Barcelona 2015;

B33) 5...♖xd4! 6.♖d5 and now:

B331) 6...♕d7 7.♖c7+ ♔d8 8.♖xd4 ♖xd4 9.c3 (9.♖xa8 ♖xc2+ 10.♔d2 ♖xa1 11.♕d3 g6=) 9...♖c2+ 10.♔d2 ♖xa1 11.♖xa8 g6=;

B332) 6...e5 7.♖c7+ ♔d8 8.♖xa8 exf4 9.♖f3 (9.♖e2?! ♔d6 with a slight advantage to Black, Winants-Adly, Turin ol 2006) 9...♖xd1+ 10.♖xd1+ ♕d7 11.♕b5 (11.♕c4 ♖h6 12.0-0 ♖c8 13.♖fe1= Klaric-Sermek, Makarska Tucepi 1995) 11...♖c8 12.0-0 f6 (12...♖ge7?! 13.♖g5 ♕e6? (13...♕e8±) 14.♖fe1± Bestard-Argandoa, Gijon 2011) 13.a4 (13.♖fe1=) 13...♕e7 14.♖fe1 ♕g4= Winants-Michalczak, Dresden 2007.

4.d5 ♖f6

Another possible scheme is 4...g6 5.♖c3 ♕g7 6.♔d2 (6.♖xe4 ♕xb2 7.♖b1 ♕g7 8.♖f3±) 6...♖f6 7.0-0-0 0-0± Winants-Okkes, Netherlands tt 2006/07, 4...♖b6 5.♖c3 ♖xb2? (5...♖f6 6.♔d2 ♕d7 7.0-0-0± Steiner-Hatzl, Köflach 2006) 6.♕b5+ ♕d7 7.♕d2± 7...♖b4 8.♖b1 ♖a5 9.♕xd7+? (9.♖xe4±) 9...♖xd7 10.♖xb7 ♖a6= Lobron-Nadanian, St Vincent 2000.

5.♖c3 a6

5...g6 6.♔d2 ♕g7 7.0-0-0 0-0, or 5...e6 6.♕b5+ ♕d7 7.dxe6 fxe6, with compensation.

6.♔e2



A typical position in this gambit. White is attacking e4 and plans queenside castling.

Also interesting are 6.f3!? exf3 7.♘xf3 e6 8.dxe6 ♔xd1+ 9.♚xd1 ♕xe6, with a slight advantage to Black, or 6.♘ge2 ♖bd7 7.♘g3 ♖b6 8.♘gxe4=.

6...♕f5

Black defends the pawn. There are various other options.

A) For example returning the pawn with 6...g6 (it is bad to play 6...♘xd5? 7.0-0-0 e6 8.♚xe4±) 7.♘xe4 (7.0-0-0) 7...♘xe4 8.♚xe4 ♕g7 9.0-0-0 0-0 (9...♕f5 10.♚e3 ♘d7 11.d6= Trent-Solodovnichenko, Milan 2008) 10.♘e2 (10.♕c4?! ♕f5 11.♚f3 b5 12.♕f1 ♚a5≡ McShane-Illescas, Gothenburg 2005; or 10.♚e3 (10.♘f3 ♕f5 11.♚e3≡) 10...♚a5 11.♚b1 ♕f5 12.♕h6∞ Berkes-Prohaszka, Zalakaros 2015) 10...♘d7 11.♚e3 ♘f6 12.♘c3 (12.♚xc5 ♕f5≡ Bauner-Lederman, Plovdiv 2013) 12...b5 13.♚xc5 ♕f5 14.♚b4= Elianov-Ponomariov, Kharkiv 2008;

Black has also played:

B) 6...e6 7.0-0-0≡ Winants-Tregubov, Warsaw 2005;

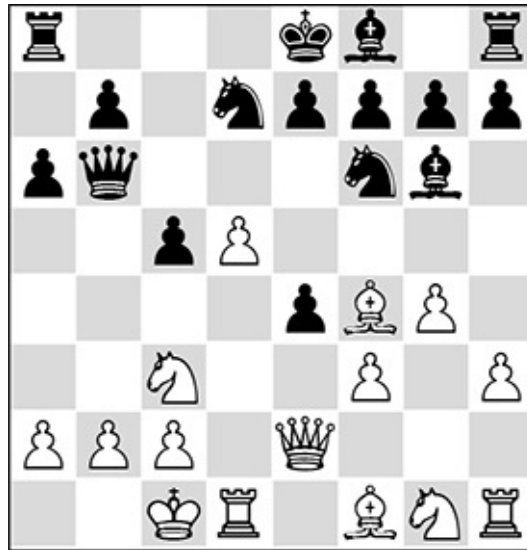
C) 6...♘bd7 7.0-0-0 g6 8.♘xe4 ♘xe4 9.♚xe4 ♕g7 10.d6±;

D) 6...♕g4 7.f3 exf3 8.♘xf3 (8.gxf3 ♕f5 9.0-0-0 g6 10.♚e3 ♘bd7 11.♘ge2= Danielian-Krivec, Athens 2006) 8...g6 9.0-0-0 ♕g7 10.h3 ♕xf3 11.♚xf3 0-0 (11...♘bd7 12.d6≡ Prié-Dumitrache, Condom 2012) 12.g4≡ Grachev-E.Sveshnikov, Jurmala 2012.

7.0-0-0 ♘bd7 8.h3 ♚b6?!

This move is inferior. I do not like 8...♚a5 9.g4 ♕g6 10.♚b1± either. It seems best for Black to play 8...b5 9.g4 b4 10.♘a4 ♕g6 11.♚b1, with a balanced position.

9.g4 ♕g6 10.f3!



White gives up trying to regain the pawn and instead opens lines, since he has a lead in development, which not only compensates for the pawn but even grants him some advantage.

10...e5

Black declines the material. The problem for Black after 10...exf3 11.♘xf3 is his lack of kingside development, while if 11...0-0-0 then with 12.♘h4 ♘e8 13.♔b1 ♘d6 14.♙f3 White maintains excellent compensation. Black has development problems.

11.dxe6 fxe6

Here 11...♙xe6 12.h4 exf3 (12...h6 13.♙h3+–) 13.♙xf3 ♙xg4 14.♙e1+ ♔d8 (14...♙e7 15.♙xg4 ♘xg4 16.♘d5+–) 15.♙f2 is better for White. Black's king is stuck in the centre and will not be able to survive.

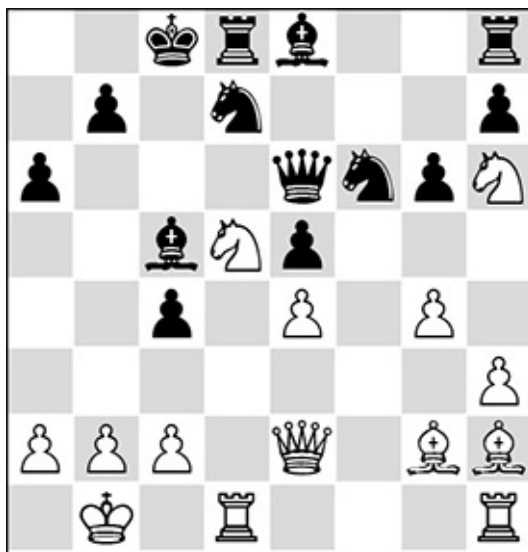
12.fxe4 e5

This move weakens the d5-square and delays his development. It was better to complete development with 12...♙e7 13.♘f3 0-0 14.♙g2, although White maintains an appreciable advantage.

13.♙h2 0-0-0 14.♘f3 ♙e6 15.♘h4 ♙f7 16.♙g2 c4

Black wants to liberate his f8-bishop and free the c5-square, but this move also closes the a2-g8 diagonal. White has a clear advantage in space.

17.♔b1 ♙c5 18.♘f5 g6 19.♘h6 ♙e8 20.♘d5



White's advantage is decisive; he is threatening the pawn on c4 and the black pieces remain passive.

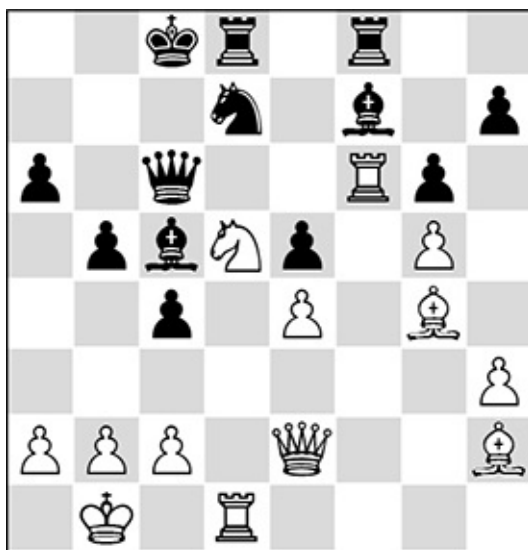
20...b5 21. ♖hf1 ♗g8 22. ♕xg8 ♜xg8 23.g5!

White's plan is ♗g2-f3-g4 and Black has no defence against this.

23... ♜f8 24. ♗f3 ♗f7?

A blunder which hastens his defeat, but even after the best move 24... ♔d6 White still retains a decisive advantage with 25. ♗g4 ♜xf1 26. ♜xf1 ♔b7 27. ♗e1.

25. ♗g4 ♔c6 26. ♜f6



The game is decided: White has a strong attack and is winning material.

26... ♔b7 27. ♗xe5 ♗xd5 28. ♜xd5 ♜fe8?

A blunder in a position that was desperate in any case, since if 28... ♗e7 then

29. ♖f2! ♙xf6? 30. ♖c5+, mating, or 28... ♖xf6 29. ♙xf6 and Black loses a lot of material.

29. ♖xc5+

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the so-called Morris Gambit with 3.e4, which is an interesting alternative to 3.e3. GM Winants has frequently played it. The idea of the gambit is a sort of Albin with an extra tempo. White wants to castle queenside quickly and benefit from his lead in development. For Black I think that it is best not to take the pawn. The line 3... ♗c6 seems best at the moment.

Once Black has accepted the pawn it is best to return it with ...g7-g6 rather than defend it with ...♙f5. In the game we saw how White gained a clear advantage thanks to his better development and he won without any problems. White scores very well in the games where Black hangs on to the pawn.

Game 44

...d7-d5 without an early ...e7-e6

Nikola Sedlak

2589

Oliver Mihok

2445

Hungary tt 2011/12 (10)

1.d4 d5 2. ♗f4 c5 3.e3 ♗c6

If 3... ♗b6?! then 4. ♗c3! e6 (4... ♗xb2 5. ♗xd5+–) 5. ♗b5!±; if 3... ♙f5 then 4. ♙b5+ ♗c6 5. ♗f3±, while if 3...cxd4 then 4.exd4 takes us into the Exchange Variation of the Caro-Kann.

4.c3

An alternative is 4. ♗f3 ♙g4!? (4... ♗f6 is the normal line) 5.c3 e6 6. ♗b3 (6.h3) 6... ♗c8 (6... ♗d7=) 7. ♗bd2 ♗f6= Kramnik-Gelfand, Moscow 2007; 4. ♗c3 is possible and similar to the line which we shall see with ... ♗f6.

4... ♗b6

Again a common idea, trying to punish White's set-up by putting pressure on b2.

A) Instead, 4... ♗f6 would lead to the normal lines of the London System. An alternative is 4... ♙f5!? 5. ♗d2 (5. ♗b3 ♗d7 6. ♗d2 c4=) 5...e6 (5... ♗b6 6. ♗b3 c4? 7. ♗xb6 axb6 8.e4±) 6. ♗gf3 ♗f6 (6... ♙d6 7.dxc5! ♙xc5 8. ♗d4±)

and now:

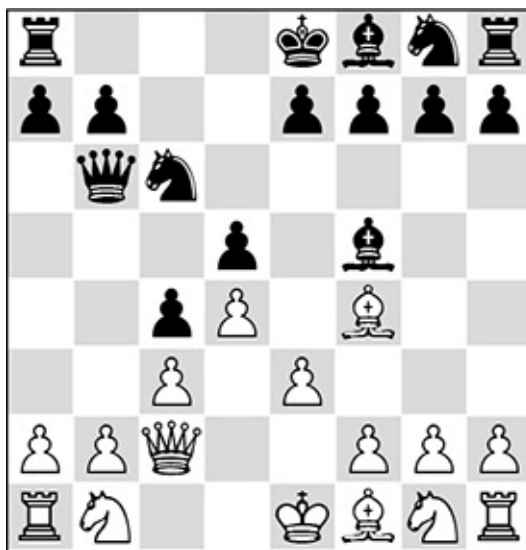
A1) 7. ♖a4 ♗d7 8. ♘b5 ♙c8 9. ♕e5?! (9. ♕h4) 9... ♗cxe5 10. ♘xe5 a6 11. ♘xd7+ ♙xd7 12. ♙xd7+ ♙xd7= Sedlak-Korneev, Istanbul 2012;

A2) 7. ♘e2 ♘e7 8. h3 h6 9. 0-0 0-0 10. ♕e5 ♗xe5 11. ♘xe5 ♗d7 12. ♘g3= Klimenko-Solodovnichenko, Russia Internet 2004;

A3) 7. ♙b3 ♙c8 8. ♘b5 a6 9. ♘xc6+ bxc6 10. h3 ♘e7 11. 0-0 0-0= Prié-Gomez, San Sebastian 2008.

B) In the event of 4...cxd4 White can choose between transposing to the Exchange Variation of the Caro-Kann with 5.exd4, e.g. 5... ♘f5 6. ♕f3 (6. ♙b3 ♙d7 7. ♕f3 a6 8. ♕bd2 e6 9. h3 h6 10. ♘e2 ♕f6= Morozevich-Anand, Monaco (blindfold) 2003) 6...e6 7. ♙b3 ♙d7 8. ♕bd2 ♕ge7 9. h3 h6= Prié-Vaisser, Caen 2011, or to the Exchange Variation of the Slav with 5.cxd4 ♘f5, which we covered in the chapter on the Benoni.

5. ♙b3 c4 6. ♙c2 ♘f5?!



This idea works in some other variations, when the black knight is already on f6, but here it is dubious because White can sacrifice the exchange for a pawn and incarcerate the black queen.

6... ♕f6 would be the normal line, and we shall see this in the next game; another option is 6...e5!? 7.dxe5 ♘f5 8. ♙c1 ♕ge7 9. ♕f3 ♕g6 10. ♘g3 ♘c5 11. ♘e2 (11. ♕d4) 11...0-0± Basha-Gibbons, Antalya 2007; finally, we shall consider 6...g6 7. ♕d2 ♕f6 8.e4 in the variation with ... ♕f6.

7. ♙xf5! ♙xb2 8. ♙xd5



8...♙xa1

A) 8...♙c1+ is no better: 9.♔e2 ♙b2+ 10.♔f3 (10.♙d2! ♙xa1 11.♙b5 0-0-0 12.g3±) 10...♙f6 11.♙xc4 ♙xa1 12.♙b3 0-0-0 13.♙b5 ♙a5 14.♙c2 a6 15.♙d3 ♙d5 (15...e5? 16.♙xe5 ♙d7 17.♙f4 ♙e7 18.♙h3 g5 19.♙xg5 1-0 Miles-Minasian, Ohrid 2001) 16.♙e2 ♙xf4 17.exf4 ♙d6 18.♙a4 ♙c6 19.♙b3+– Curien-Georgiadis, Switzerland tt 2013.

B) Black is also worse after 8...♙f6 9.♙xc4 ♙e4 (9...0-0-0 10.♙b3 ♙xa1 11.♙b5 ♙a5 12.♙c2 ♙e8 13.♙f3 ♙d6 14.♙xd6 ♙xd6 15.0-0 a6 16.♙a3 1-0 Bauer-Reuss, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2012) 10.♙b5! ♙xf2+ (10...♙c1+ 11.♙e2 ♙c2+ 12.♙f3+– Bogosavljevic-Miladinovic, Vrsac 2007, or 10...♙xa1 11.♙xb7+–) 11.♙d1 a6 12.♙e2 e5 13.♙g3+– Sedlak-Czebe, Subotica 2005;

C) If 8...e6 then 9.♙xc4 ♙xa1 (9...♙c1+ 10.♙e2 ♙b2+ 11.♙d2±) 10.♙b3 is much better for White.

9.♙b5 0-0-0

The alternative is 9...a6 10.♙xb7 ♙d8 and now 11.♙e4! is the right move, with advantage to White, but not 11.♙b4?? ♙c8? (11...e5–+) 12.♙f3? ♙xa2– + Bistic-Sveshnikov, Bled 1991, or 11.♙xa8 ♙xb1+ 12.♙e2 e5 13.♙xe5 ♙d3+ 14.♙f3 ♙xf1 15.♙c7 ♙e7 16.♙xd8 ♙xd8 17.♙c6+ with perpetual check, ½-½ Kristjansson-E. Sveshnikov, Marianske Lazne 2008.

10.♙f5+!?



White's idea is to trap the black queen. The best and most popular move is 10. ♖xc4!, which gives White the advantage. Here are a few examples:

A) 10...e6 11. ♖e2 ♘a3 12.0-0+ ♙b2 13. ♖xa3 ♙xa3 14. ♗b1 ♙e7 15. ♙a4 (15.e4 ♗f6 16.d5 exd5 17.exd5 ♗xd5 18. ♖xd5 König-Vaysberg, Leinzell 2011) 15... ♙d7 16. ♖a6! e5 17. ♗xb7 ♙xb7 18. ♙xc6+ 1-0 Hamblok-Maddens, Ghent 2013;

B) 10...e5 is Black's only chance; now:

B1) 11. ♖g5?? f6? (11... ♖b4!-+) 12. ♖e2 ♘a3 13.0-0± Grachev-Ponomariov, Moscow 2008;

B2) 11. ♖e2 and now:

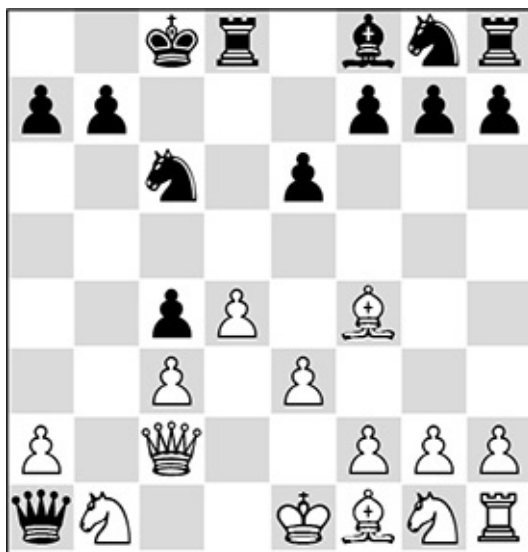
B21) 11... ♖d6 12.0-0 a6 13. ♙b3 ♗a5 (13...exf4 14. ♖d2 ♗a5 15. ♙c2 ♙xf1+ 16. ♙xf1±) 14. ♖e6+?! (14. ♙a4+-) 14...fxe6 15. ♙xe6+± Van der Werf-Krudde, Netherlands tt 2006/07;

B22) 11... ♖a3 12.0-0 (12. ♖g3±) 12... ♙b2 13. ♖xa3 (13. ♙a4+-) 13... ♙xb5 14. ♖xb5 exf4 15. ♖xf4± Unuk-Sirnisk, Sentjur 2013;

B23) 11...exf4 12.0-0 a6 (12...fxe3? 13.fxe3 ♗f6 (13... ♖ge7? 14. ♖d2+- Hamark-Bellon, Stockholm 2007) 14. ♖d2+- Grachev-Gelfand, Moscow 2008) 13. ♙b6 ♖d6 14. ♖d2 ♖c7 15. ♙b3 ♗a5 16. ♙c2 (16. ♙b4 ♖c6 17. ♙a3±) 16... ♙xf1+ 17. ♙xf1± Cramling-Zatonskih, Beijing 2012.

B3) 11. ♖xe5! ♖b4 (11... ♖b4! 12. ♖d3 ♖xd3+ 13. ♙xd3 ♙xa2 14. ♖f3 ♙a6 15. ♙f5+ ♗d7 16. ♖g3±) 12. ♖d3 ♖xc3+ 13. ♙f1 ♖ge7 14. ♖xg7 ♗he8 15. ♙b3 ♖d5 16. ♖e2+- Hoang Thanh Trang-Das Sayantan, Mumbai 2012.

10...e6 11. ♙c2



11...g5

An earlier game had continued 11...♘a5 12.♙f3 ♜d5 13.♙e2 ♜b5 14.0-0± Ortega-Mazzilli, Palermo 2007.

Black's best line seems to be 11...b5 12.♙f3 ♘f6 13.♙e2 ♘d5 14.0-0±.

12.♙g3 ♘a5

If 12...h5 then after 13.♙f3 h4 14.♙e5 f6 15.♙xc4! fxe5 16.0-0 exd4 17.exd4 Black has to sacrifice material to rescue the queen, or be worse in the ending of queen against two rooks.

13.♙f3 ♜d5 14.♙e2 ♜b5 15.0-0



White has completed development and is only the exchange down; in return he has an attack and threats against the black queen.

15...♙f6

If 15... ♖b2 then 16. ♖a4 ♙e7 17. ♘bd2 a6 18. ♙xc4+–.

16. ♖a4! ♙xb1

Or 16...a6 17. ♙e5 ♙e7 18. ♙xc4+–.

17. ♖xa5

White now has a decisive attack on the black king.

17... ♘d5 18. ♖xa7 f6

18... ♙g7 changes nothing: White wins with 19. ♖b8+ ♔d7 20. ♖d6+ ♔e8 21. ♘g5.

19. ♘d2 ♙xf1+ 20. ♘xf1 ♖xc3 21. ♖b8+ ♔d7 22. ♖xb7+ ♔d8 23. ♖b8+ ♔d7



White's attack is decisive, but how should he continue now?

24. ♙h5!

Correct! The bishop threatens a check on e8, followed by mate.

24...e5

This allows mate, but 24... ♙e7 25. ♖xh8 was equally hopeless.

25. ♙g4+

Even stronger was 25. ♖b7+ ♘c7 26. ♙g4+ ♔e8 27. ♖xc7.

25... ♖c6 26. ♖a8+ ♖d6 27. ♖d8+

27. ♖c8 was mate in four.

27... ♖c6 28. ♙d7+ ♖d6?

This allows mate in two, but he would also have lost after 28... ♖b7 29. ♙c8+ ♖b8 30. ♙e6+ ♖a7 31. ♙xd5.

29. ♙e8+

If 29... ♖e6 then 30. ♖d7 is mate.

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the normal line with e2-e3 and a very common variation with ...♖b6, where Black used the move ...♕f5, which works in other variations, but not without Black's knight being on f6. Here White is able to sacrifice the exchange and keep the advantage. Black has problems with his queen, which often remains trapped, or else he has to return some material to save it. I think that this line is dubious for Black. In the game White gained a decisive attack against the black king.

Game 45

...d7-d5 without an early ...e7-e6

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2233

Jorge Rodriguez Guillen

2110

A Coruña 2013 (3)

1.d4 d5 2.♕f4 ♖f6 3.e3 c5 4.c3 ♗c6

The alternative is 4...♖b6 and now:

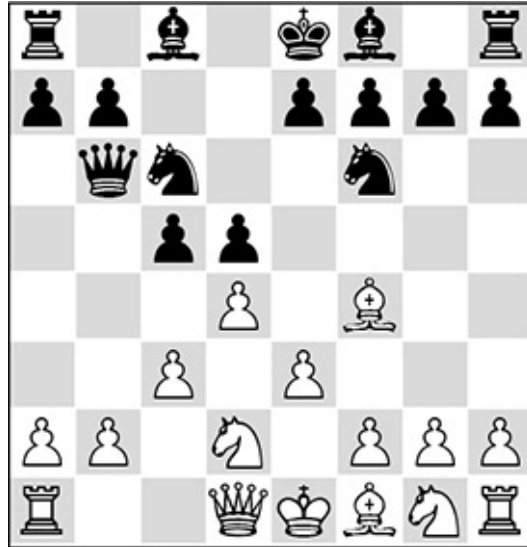
A) 5.♗c2 g6 (5...♗c6 6.♗d2 g6 7.♗gf3 ♕g7 (7...♕f5 8.dxc5 ♗xc5 9.♗b3 ±) 8.h3 0-0 E.Alvarez-Johannessen, Oporto 2012) 6.♗d2 ♕f5 7.dxc5 ♗xc5 8.♗b3± Nguyen-Roque Ho Chi Minh City 2011;

B) 5.♗b3 c4 6.♗c2 (6.♗xb6 axb6 7.♗d2 (7.♗a3 ♕d7 8.♗f3 e5 9.♕xe5 ♕xa3 10.bxa3 ♗c6 11.♕xf6 gxf6 12.0-0-0 ♖xa3 13.♗b2 ♖a4=; 7.♗f3) 7...b5 8.a3 ♕f5= Welling-Volkov, Oslo 2011) 6...g6 7.♗d2 (7.b3 ♕f5 8.♗d1=) 7...♕f5 8.♗c1 ♗c6 9.h3= Jovanic-Unuk, Opatija 2014.

5.♗d2

Or 5.♗b3!? c4 6.♗c2 g6 7.b3 ♕f5 8.♗b2 ♗b6= Prié-Perez Candelario, Elgoibar 2006.

5...♗b6



Again this thematic idea.

A) Black can also play 5... Qf5 and now:

A1) 6. Qb3 with a further division:

A11) 6... Qc8

A111) 7.dxc5 e5 8. Qg5 (8. Qg3 Qxc5 9. Qgf3 Qd6= Stefanova-Munguntuul, Doha 2011) 8... Qd7 (8... Qe6 9. Qxf6 gxf6 Ponomariov-Gelfand, Moscow 2010) 9. Qxd5 Qxc5 Sedlak-Todorovic, Belgrade 2009;

A112) 7.c4 e6 (7... dxc4 8. Qxc4 e6 9. Qc1 (9. Qgf3=) 9... cxd4 10. exd4 Qd7 11. Qb5 Qe7 12. Qgf3 0-0= De Prado-Rey, Ferrol 2013) 8.dxc5 (8. Qgf3=) 8... Qxc5 9. Qc1? (9. Qgf3=) 9... d4 Nguyen Thi-Lu, Ho Chi Minh City 2011;

A12) 6... Qd7 and now:



analysis diagram

A121) 7.dxc5 e5 8.♙g3 ♘xc5 9.♚gf3 ♙e7 10.♙b5 d4 (10...♙d6 11.c4 a6 12.cxd5 axb5 13.dxc6 bxc6= Perunovic-Hristodoulou, Bansko 2010) 11.0-0 (11.♙xc6+ bxc6 12.♙a4=) 11...dxe3 12.fxe3 ♙xe3+ 13.♙h1☞ Bogosavljevic-Atalik, Paracin 2012;

A122) 7.♚gf3 c4 8.♙d1 (8.♙b5!? e6 9.b3 a6 (9...cxb3 10.axb3= Nguyen Thi-Bagi, Budapest 2010) 10.♙b6 cxb3 11.axb3 ♙e7 12.b4 ♖c8 13.b5= De Prado-Andres, Bembibre 2014) 8...e6 9.♙e2 (9.♚h4=) 9...h6 (9...b5 10.0-0 ♙d6 11.♙xd6 ♙xd6 12.♚h4 ♙g6 13.b3 ♚e4= Berkes-Robson, Paks 2010; or 9...♙e7 10.♚e5 ♚xe5 11.♙xe5 0-0 12.g4 ♙g6 13.h4 with an initiative to White, Berkes-Shulman, Dresden 2008) 10.0-0 ♙e7 11.♚e5 ♚xe5 12.♙xe5 0-0= Kamsky-Potkin, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch rapid 2013;

A2) 6.♚gf3 ♙b6 and now:

A21) 7.♚h4 (the favourite move of GM Sedlak) 7...♙d7 8.♙b3 c4 9.♙c2 (9.♙xb6=) 9...♚h5 10.♙g3 and now:

A211) 10...g6 11.e4 e6 12.♙e2 ♚xg3 13.hxg3 ♙c7 14.♚f1 ♚e7 and now:

A2111) 15.♚e3 b5 16.♚f3 ♙g7 17.a3 (17.e5 a5 18.a3 ♖b8 19.♚g4 ♙d8 20.♙d2= Sedlak-Svetushkin, Vrsac 2012) 17...h5 18.e5 ♚c6 19.g4 hxg4 20.♖xh8+ ♙xh8 21.♚xg4± Sedlak-Schneider, Lienz 2013;

A2112) 15.e5 ♚c6 16.♚e3 ♙e7 17.f4 b5 18.♚f3 b4 19.g4 ♙a5 20.♙f2 ♖b8 21.g5= Sedlak-Borisek, Istanbul 2012;

A212) 10...e6 11.♙e2 ♚xg3 12.hxg3 ♙c7 13.e4 0-0-0 14.♚hf3= Elianov-Ponomariov, Moscow 2010;

A22) 7.♙b3 c4 8.♙xb6 axb6 9.a3 (9.♚h4=) 9...b5 10.♖c1 h6 11.h3 ♙d7 12.♙e2 g5 13.♙h2 ♙g7= E.Alvarez-Moskalenko, Palma de Mallorca 2010;

A23) 7.♙c1 e6 8.♙e2 ♙e7 9.a3 0-0 10.0-0 ♖ac8 11.dxc5 = Kamsky-Gulko, New York 2006;

A24) 7.dxc5 ♙xb2 (7...♙xc5?! 8.♚b3± Curien-Sedina, Switzerland tt 2013) 8.♚d4 e5 9.♙xe5 ♙g4 10.♖b1 ♙a3 11.f3 ♚xe5 12.fxg4 ♙xc5☞ Prié-Flear, San Sebastian 2011.

B) Another variation is 5...cxd4 6.exd4 (we have now transposed to the Caro-Kann Exchange Variation) 6...♙f5 (6...g6 7.♙e2 ♙g7 8.h3= Popovic-Ivanisevic, Serbia tt 2007) 7.♙b3 and now Black can defend b7 in two ways:



B1) 7... ♔d7 8. ♘gf3 (8. ♕e2) 8...a6 9. ♕e2 (9. ♘h4!?) 9...e6 10.h3 (10. ♘h4, 10. ♘e5, 10.0-0 ♕e7 11. ♘e5= Berkes-Mihok, Mako 2013) 10... ♕e7 11.0-0 0-0 12. ♘h4= De Prado-Medarde, A Coruña 2013;

B2) 7... ♔c8 8. ♘gf3 e6 9. ♘h4 (the alternative is 9. ♕e2 ♕e7 10.0-0 0-0 11. ♘h4 (11. ♖fe1 a6 12.a4?! ♘e4= Ringoir-Palac, Tromsø 2014) 11... ♕g4 12.f3 ♕h5 13.g4 ♕g6 14. ♕g3 ♔d7 15. ♖ae1= Rapport-Korpa, Zalakaros 2014) 9... ♕e4 (9... ♕g6 10. ♘xg6 (10. ♕b5!?) 10...hxc6= Kamsky-Macieja, Achaea 2012) 10. ♘xe4 dxe4!? (10... ♘xe4 11. ♘f3 ♕d6 12. ♕xd6 ♘xd6= Sandipan-Kasimdzhanov, Dubai 2014) 11.g3 (11.f3!?) 11... ♕e7 12. ♘g2 ♘d5 (12...0-0 13. ♕e2 ♘d5 14. ♕d2= Sedlak-Ragger, Achaea 2012) 13. ♕d2 0-0 14. ♘f4 ♘f6= Sandipan-Prasad, Benasque 2014.

6. ♔b3 c4



A) If 6... ♖xb3 7.axb3 cxd4 8.exd4±;

B) The main alternative is 6... ♕f5 7.dxc5 ♖xb3 8.axb3 e5 9. ♕g3 ♕xc5 and now:

B1) 10. ♕b5!? ♖d7 11. ♖gf3 f6= Danielsen-Anwesh, Visakhapatnam 2011;

B2) 10.b4 ♕d6 11.b5 ♖e7 12. ♖gf3 ♖d7 (12... ♖g6 13.h3 0-0 14. ♕e2± Sean-Nguyen, Kuala Lumpur 2012) 13. ♖d4 ♕g6 14. ♕e2 0-0= Sergeev-Cernousek, Rakovnik 2008;

B3) 10. ♖gf3! and now:

B31) 10...e4 (10... ♕d6 11. ♕b5±, 10...d4?! 11.b4 dxe3 12.fxe3 ♕b6 (12... ♕xe3 13. ♖c4+-) 13. ♖c4 (13. b5 ♖e7 14. ♕xe5±) 13...0-0 14.b5 ♖e7 15. ♕xe5± Kovacevic-Garcia, Mislata 1993) 11. ♖d4 (11. ♖e5±) 11... ♖xd4 12.exd4 ♕b6 13. ♕e2± Stefanova-Sebag, Doha 2011;

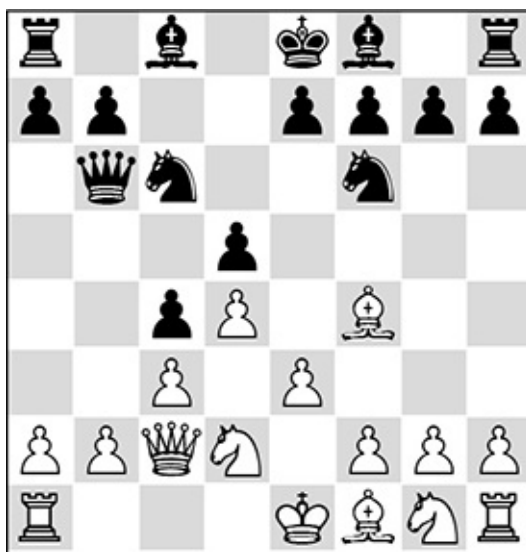
B32) 10... ♖d7 11.b4 ♕d6 and again there are several options for White:

B321) 12. ♖d4 ♖xd4 13.exd4 ♖e7 (13...f6 14. ♖f3 ♖e7 15.dxe5 fxe5 16. ♕b5± Condie-Crouch, London 1984, or 13...0-0 14. ♖f3±) 14.dxe5 ♕xe5± Gogolis-Miskulin, Neos Marmaras 2012;

B322) 12. ♕e2 f6 (12...0-0 13. ♖b3 ♖fe8 14.0-0= Kovacevic-Garcia, La Pobra de Lillet 1998) 13.0-0± Ipatov-Silva, Barcelona 2011;

B323) 12. ♕b5 f6 13. ♖d4 ♖xd4 14.exd4 ♖e7 15.dxe5 ♕xe5 16.0-0± Delchev-Behling, Forni di Sopra 2014.

7. ♖c2!



The endgame following the exchange of queens is fine for Black: 7. ♖xb6 axb6 8.a3 b5 9. ♖c1 ♕f5 10.h3 (10. ♖gf3=) 10...e6 11. ♖gf3 (11.g4) 11...h6= De Prado-Obregon, Ferrol 2012.

7... ♕g4

An interesting move. Several alternatives have been tried here, e.g.

A) 7...g6 8.e4! and now:

A1) 8...♗xe4?! 9.♗xe4 dxe4 (9...♕f5 10.f3 dxe4 11.fxe4± Prié-Labarthe, Gap 2008) 10.♕xc4± 10...♕g7 (10...♕f5 11.♖b3 ♖xb3 12.axb3 ♕g7 13.♕e3± Ruiz-Astasio, Linares 2013) 11.♕e3 ♖c7± Bosque-Martin, Benidorm 2011;

A2) 8...♔d8 9.♕g5 (9.♗gf3 ♕g7 10.♕e2 0-0 11.0-0=) 9...b5 10.a4±;

A3) 8...e5!? 9.dxe5 ♗g4 10.♗h3 ♕c5 11.0-0-0±;

A4) 8...dxe4 9.♗xc4 ♔d8± Soysal-Shetty, Al-Ain 2013.

B) Also interesting is 7...♗h5!?, for example:

B1) 8.♕g3 ♗xg3 9.hxg3 and now:

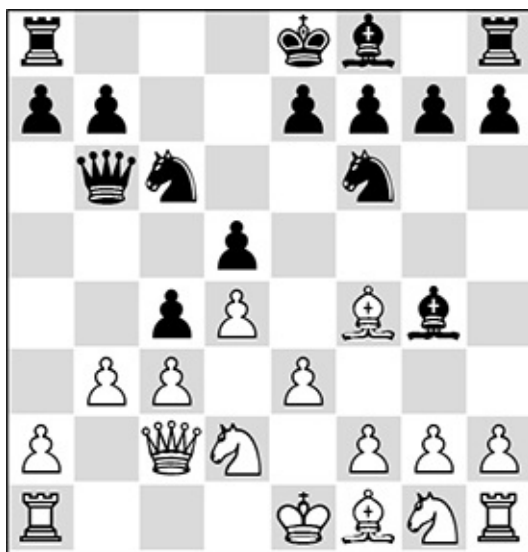
B11) 9...e6 10.e4 (10.b3±) 10...♕d7 11.♕e2 g6 12.♕f3 ♗e7 13.♗e2 ♕g7 14.♗f4 ♔d6= Grachev-Potkin, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013;

B12) 9...e5 10.e4! exd4 11.exd5 dxc3 12.bxc3 ♗e7 13.♕xc4± Sedlak-Vasilev; Blagoevgrad 2013;

B2) 8.♕g5 h6 9.♕h4 g5 (9...e5 10.♕e2 g5 11.♕xh5 gxh4 12.♗gf3±) 10.♕e2 ♗g7 11.♕g3 ♕f5 12.e4 ♕g6 13.h4 gxh4 14.♗xh4 0-0-0 15.♗gf3± Sedlak-Todorovic, Subotica 2008.

8.b3!

The thematic break on b3, in response to ...c5-c4 by Black, is usually the best plan for White and in this position it is again the best move.



Other moves have been tried, e.g.:

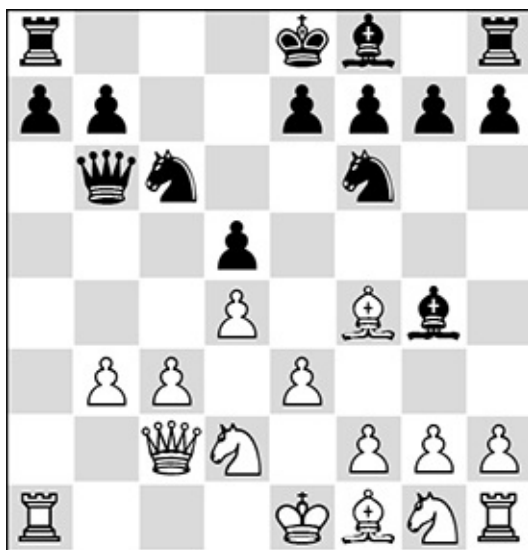
A) 8.♕e2 ♕xe2 (8...♕h5 9.♕xh5 (9.b3!) 9...♗xh5 10.♕e5 e6 11.♗e2 (11.h3) 11...♕e7 12.♗f3 0-0= Prié-Huerga, Elgoibar 2007) 9.♗xe2 e6 10.♕g5 (10.e4±) 10...♕e7= Kukov-Kozhuharov, Sunny Beach 2013;

B) 8.h3 ♖h5 9.♗gf3 e6 10.♗h4 ♔d8 11.g4 ♖g6 12.♗xg6 hxg6± Sergeev-Thesing, Predeal 2006;

C) The normal 8.♗gf3 e6 9.h3 (9.♖e2 ♖e7 10.h3 ♖f5= Rodriguez-Arizmendi, El Sauzal 2010; or 9.b3 ♖f5 10.♔c1 ♔a5 ½-½ Meduna-Stangl, Brno 1993) 9...♖f5 10.♔c1 ♖c8 (10...h6 11.♖e2 ♖c8 12.0-0 ♖e7= Marzolo-Drazic, Bastia 2000) 11.g4!? ♖g6 12.♗h4 ♖e7 13.♗xg6 hxg6= Sergeev-Potkin, Warsaw 2011;

D) And even 8.e4 e6 9.f3 ♖h5 10.h4 ♖g6 11.g4 h5= Sean-Sutorikhin, Kecskemet 2013.

8...cxb3 9.axb3



9...e6

9...♖c8 is the main alternative, discomforting the white queen, but it is able to move aside without any problems: 10.♔b1 (10.♔b2 ♖f5=) 10...e6 11.♖d3 (11.h3 ♖f5 12.♖d3 ♖b4 13.♗e2 ♖xd3 14.♔xd3 0-0=) 11...♖e7 12.♗gf3 ♖h5 13.b4± Bruno-Suc, Trieste 2013.

10.♖d3

An alternative is 10.h3 ♖f5 11.♖d3 ♖xd3 12.♔xd3 ♖e7 13.♗gf3 0-0 14.0-0 and the white position is more comfortable, as he has the better structure and pawn breaks available on c4 or e4.

10...♖e7 11.♗gf3

It was better to gain a tempo with 11.h3! ♖h5 12.♗gf3±.

11...♖c8 12.♔b2 0-0 13.h3 ♖h5

The alternative was 13...♖f5 14.♖xf5 exf5 15.0-0, which is better than the game continuation.

14.0-0



White has emerged from the opening with some advantage: more space, the better pawn structure, half-open a-file, pawn breaks available on e4 or c4 and the possible plan of b2-b4 and ♖b3.

14... ♗g6 15. ♗xg6 hxg6 16. ♖fb1

This defends the queen and prepares to play c3-c4. There were several other possibilities for White, such as 16. ♗h2, 16. ♖fc1 or 16. ♖fe1.

16... ♗d8?!

Black has also played 16...a6 (16...a5±) 17. ♖c1 ♗d8 18. ♖e1 ♖h5 19. ♗e5 ♗d6 20. ♖d3 ♖f6 21. ♗xd6 ♗xd6 22. c4± Maksimovic-Ioannidis, Plovdiv 2014.

17. c4?!

It was better to employ the plan of 17.b4! ♖e8 (17...b6 18. ♖a6±; 17...a6 18. b5±) 18. ♖b3±.

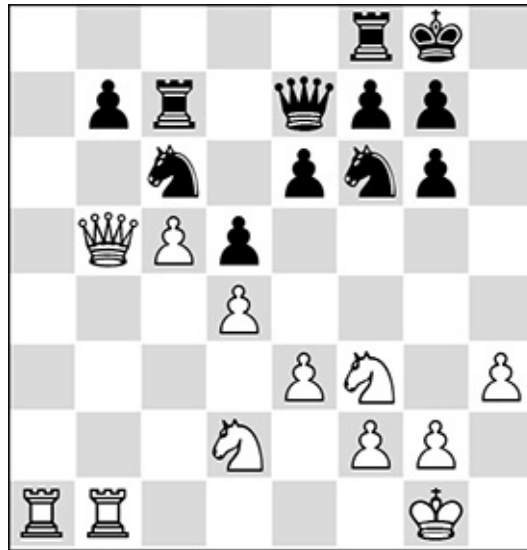
17... ♗d6?!

17...a5 was better, e.g. 18. ♖e1 (18.c5 b6=; 18. ♖c1 b6 19. ♗b1=) 18...b6 19. e4 ♗b4=.

18. ♗xd6 ♗xd6 19. c5

Here 19. ♖e5 was favourable, e.g. 19...a6 20. c5 ♗e7 21. ♖xc6 ♗xc6 22. b4±; also good was 19. b4 dxc4 20. ♖xc4 (20. b5 ♖e7 21. ♖c1 ♗d5 22. ♖e5 c3 23. ♖xc3 ♗xc3 24. ♗xc3 ♗xb5 25. ♖xa7±) 20... ♗d5 21. ♖c1±.

19... ♗e7 20. b4 a6 21. b5 axb5 22. ♗xb5 ♖c7



White has a clear advantage in space, with pressure along the open files and against the weak b7-pawn, but it is not easy to turn these advantages into something concrete.

23. ♖a3 ♗e4?

This is a bad move; it was better to play 23...e5, although White is still better after 24. ♗b2 ♗e4 25. ♖b3 ♖b8 26. ♖b6.

24. ♗xe4 dxe4 25. ♗d2 f5 26. ♗b2?

An error. White could have gained a decisive, long-term advantage with 26. ♗c4!, achieving total domination of the position after 26... ♖b8 27. ♗b2 (27. ♗d6+–) 27... ♗d8 28. ♖b3 ♗d7 29. ♗d6 ♖h7 30. ♖b6 ♗e7 31. ♗a2 ♗c6 32. g3 ♗d7 33. h4 ♗e7 34. ♖g2 ♗d7 35. ♗b5 ♖cc8 36. ♗a7 ♗xa7 (36... ♖c7 37. ♗xc6 ♖xc6 38. ♖xc6 ♗xc6 39. ♖b6+– and e6 falls) 37. ♗xa7+– and the b7-pawn falls.

26... ♖d8 27. ♖b3?

This allows Black to free his game. White would still have a clear advantage after 27. ♗c4 e5 28. ♖d1 (28. ♗d6 exd4 29. exd4 ♖xd6 30. cxd6 ♗xd6 31. ♖a8+ ♖h7 32. ♖d1±) 28... exd4 29. exd4 ♖h7 30. ♖a4.

27... e5! 28. ♗c4!?

With Black in time pressure, White complicates the game and avoids the drawish line 28. ♖xb7 ♖xb7 29. ♗xb7 ♗xb7 30. ♖xb7 exd4 31. exd4 ♗xd4=.

28... exd4 29. ♗d6 dxe3?!

It was better to play 29...d3, allowing 30. ♗xb7=+.

30. fxe3 ♖cd7 31. ♗a2 ♖h7 32. ♖xb7 ♖xb7 33. ♖xb7 ♖d7 34. ♖b6 ♗e5 35. ♖b4?

35. ♖b8 led to equality after 35... ♖d8 36. ♖xd8 ♗xd8 37. ♗e6 ♗c6.

35... ♗d3?

35... ♗g5 was better, e.g. 36. ♗e2 ♖a7±.

36. ♖b8 ♗xc5?

A further mistake that gives White a clear advantage; instead, 36... ♖d8 37. ♖xd8 ♜xd8= was fine.

37. ♜g8+ ♜h6 38. ♜h8+ ♜g5 39. g3 ♜f6 40. ♖f8+ ♜e6 41. ♖e8!?



This wins the queen, but Black can obtain good compensation. Another winning attempt was 41. ♗xf5 gxf5 42. ♖e8±. However, the best move was 41. ♗c4! ♜d5 (41... ♜g5? 42. ♜g8+ ♜e7 43. ♜f7+; 41... ♖d6 42. ♜g8+ ♜d7 43. ♖f7; 41... ♖d1+ 42. ♜g2 ♜d5 43. ♖d8+ ♜xc4 44. ♖xd1+–) 42. ♗b6+ ♜c6 43. ♗xd7 ♜xd7 (43... ♜xd7 44. ♖a8+–; 43... ♗xd7 44. ♖a8+–) 44. ♖d8+–.

41... ♜xd6 42. ♖xe7 ♖xe7 43. ♜h7 ♖e6! 44. ♜xg7 ♗d3 45. h4

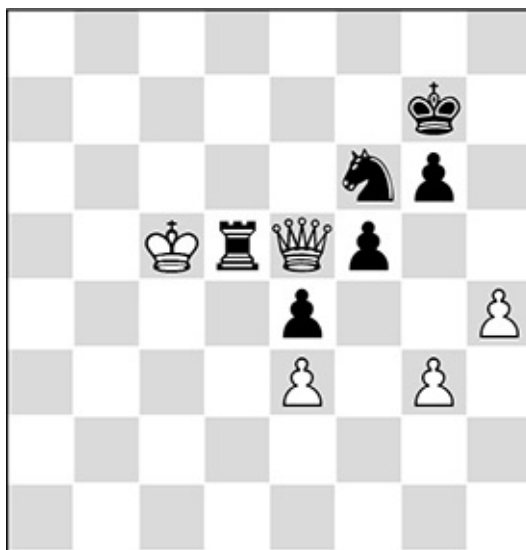
Black can construct a fortress in this ending, so it was better to play 45. g4 fxg4 46. hxg4 ♗e5 47. ♜f8+ ♖e7 48. ♜f6+ ♜d7 49. g5 ♖e6 50. ♜f4 ♗f3+ 51. ♜f2 ♜c6±.

45... ♗e5 46. ♜f2 ♗g4+ 47. ♜e2 ♜c5 48. ♜c7+ ♜d5 49. ♜g7 ♜d6 50. ♜d2 ♖e7 51. ♜g8 ♗e5 52. ♜d8+ ♜e6 53. ♜c3

Trying to bring his king into the struggle, but White cannot penetrate the black fortress.

53... ♜f7 54. ♜d6 ♗g4 55. ♜f4 ♗f6 56. ♜g5 ♜g7 57. ♜c4 ♖d7 58. ♜c5 ♖d5+ 59. ♜c4 ♖d7 60. ♜f4 ♖d3 61. ♜c5 ♖d8 62. ♜c7+ ♖d7 63. ♜e5!? ♖d5+?!

Black loses patience and enters the pawn ending that White was seeking. Although the pawn ending should be drawn, it is risky to enter it when short of time. It was safer from the practical point of view to maintain the fortress with 63... ♜f7, when White cannot make progress.



64. ♕xd5 ♖xd5 65. ♕xd5 g5?!

This is not losing, but it comes close. There was an easy draw with 65... ♖f6! and now:

A) 66. g4 fxg4 67. ♕xe4 g5 68. h5 (68. hxg5+? ♕xg5–+) 68... ♖g7 69. ♕d3 ♕h6 70. e4 ♕xh5 71. ♕e3 ♕h4 72. ♕f2 ♕h3 73. ♕g1 ♕h4=;

B) 66. ♕d6 ♖g7 67. ♕e6 ♕h6 68. ♕e5 (68. ♕f6? ♕h5–+) 68... ♖g7=;

C) 66. ♕d4 ♕e6 67. g4 fxg4 68. ♕xe4 g5 69. hxg5 g3 70. ♕f3 ♕f5 71. ♕xg3 ♕xg5=.

66. ♕e5 f4?

And now this is definitely losing. Black could have drawn with the neat idea 66... ♕g6 67. h5+ ♕h6!!= (67... ♕xh5 68. ♕xf5+–) 68. ♕xf5 ♕xh5 69. ♕xe4 ♕g4 70. ♕d5 ♕xg3 71. e4 ♕f4 72. e5 g4 73. e6 g3 74. e7 g2 75. e8 ♖ g1 ♖=.

67. gxf4 g4

If 67... gxf4 then 68. ♕xe4 h3 69. ♕f3 wins, or if 67... gxf4 then 68. ♕xf4+–.

68. ♕xe4 ♕h6 69. f5 ♕h5 70. f6 ♕g6 71. ♕f4 ♕xf6 72. ♕xg4

Black resigned.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the normal line with ... ♖f6 and ♖d2. Then after 6... c4 by Black, the right move for White is 7. ♖c2, since the endgame after 7. ♖xb6 is good for Black. We saw the idea of 7... ♖g4 in the game and analysed various alternatives, such as 7... g6 and 7... ♖h5. Once again the best move for White was 8.b3!, the thematic break that should always be kept in mind when Black plays ...c5-c4. In the game, White emerged from the opening with some advantage: the better pawn structure, the half-open

a-file, possible pawn breaks on e4 or c4 and an alternative plan of b3-b4, which would have been even better than the game continuation. Both sides made mistakes and in the endgame, after White won the queen for rook and knight, Black should not have lost, since he had a fortress position, but in time pressure he entered the pawn ending, and although this should have been a draw, further errors led to Black's defeat.

Game 46

...d7-d5 without an early ...e7-e6 Caro-Kann Exchange Variation (by transposition)

Magnus Carlsen

2850

Radoslaw Wojtaszek

2748

Reykjavik Ech-tt 2015 (9)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♙f4

In the last few years some of the world's best players, such as Carlsen, Kramnik, Grischuk and Karjakin, have begun to play the London System. Many of them started playing it in rapidplay games but then graduated to using it in important standard play games, such as this one from the European Team Championship.

2...d5 3.e3 c5 4.c3 ♘c6 5.♙d2 cxd4



In the previous game we saw the variations which arise after 5...♙b6.

After the exchange on d4 we usually transpose to the structure of the Exchange Variation of the Caro-Kann Defence, which we can also reach via the move order 1.d4 d5 2.♙f4 c5 3.e3 cxd4 4.exd4 ♘c6 5.c3, e.g. 5...♙f5 (5...♙f6) 6.♙f3 (in this move order 6.♙b3 is better: 6...♙d7 7.♙f3 e6 8.♙bd2 ♙ge7!?)

(8... ♖f6 transposes to the game; 8...f6!?∞) 9. ♕e3 ♗g6 10. ♕g3 ♕d6= De Prado-Suarez, Arteixo 2016) 6... ♗f6 7. ♗bd2 e6 8. ♖b3, as in our main game.

6.exd4 ♗f5 7. ♖b3

White can also play 7. ♗gf3 first, and after 7...e6 then 8. ♖b3.



7... ♖c8

The most common defence. Black can also play 7... ♖d7, which reaches a practically equal game, but Black often prefers to place his queen out of reach of White's possible threats based on ♗e5 and ♗b5; a sample continuation would be 8. ♗gf3 a6 (8...e6 9. ♗e5 ♖c8∞) 9. ♕e2 (9. ♗h4!?) 9...e6 10.0-0 (10.h3 ♕e7 11.0-0 0-0 12. ♗h4= De Prado-Medarde, A Coruña 2013; 10. ♗h4!?) 10... ♕e7 11. ♗e5 ♗xe5 12. ♕xe5 0-0 13.a4 (13.c4 dxc4 14. ♗xc4 ♗d5 15. ♕f3 b5= Berkes-Mihok, Hungary tt 2013/14) 13... ♗e4 14. ♗xe4 ♕xe4= Jacobsen-Annenkov, Jyväskylä 2015.

Here the offer to exchange queens with 7... ♖b6 gives White a comfortable advantage after 8. ♖xb6 (8. ♗gf3 e6 (8... ♖xb3 9.axb3!±) 9. ♖xb6 (9. ♗h4±) 9...axb6 10. ♕b5 ♗d7 11.0-0± Bocharov-Yapparov, Kazan 2014) 8...axb6 9. ♗gf3 (9. ♕b5±) 9... ♗d7 10. ♕b5 f6 11. ♕g3± Berkes-Czebe, Hungary tt 2009.

8. ♗gf3 e6

Previously, in the World Rapidplay Championship in Berlin, Carlsen had faced 8...h6 9. ♗e5 g5 10. ♕g3 ♕g7 11. ♕e2 0-0 12.0-0 e6 13. ♖ae1 (13.h3±) 13... ♗e4 (13... ♗xe5 14. ♕xe5 ♗d7=) 14. ♗xe4 ♕xe4 15. ♗d3± Carlsen-Wagner, Berlin Wch rapid 2015



9. ♖h4

The critical line; White is trying to exchange the black bishop and gain the bishop pair. Practice has also seen:

A) 9. ♖e2 ♖e7 (9...h6 10. ♗e5 (10.0-0 ♖e7 11.c4!? 0-0 12.c5 ♗d7= E.Sveshnikov-J.Alvarez, Dresden 2008) 10...♖e7 11.0-0 0-0 12.a4 ♗d7 Kamsky-Fressinet, Beijing 2012; 9...♗e4 10. ♗xe4 ♖xe4 11.h4!? (11.0-0=) 11...h6 12. ♗d2 ♖h7 13.g4∞ Nguyen-Bogner, Khanty-Mansiysk 2010) 10.0-0 0-0 11. ♗h4 and now:

A1) 11. ♖fe1 a6 12. ♗d1 (12.a4 ♗e4 13. ♗xe4 ♖xe4 14. ♗d1 ♗d8= Ringoir-Palac, Tromsø 2014) 12...h6 13. ♗f1 b5 14.a3 ♖e8= Reich-Ribli, Germany Bundesliga 2014/15;

A2) 11. ♖ac1 ♗e4 12. ♗xe4 (12. ♖fe1 h6 13. ♗xe4 ♖xe4 14. ♗e5= Kovalevskaya-Kadimova, Moscow 1994) 12...♖xe4 13. ♗d1 ♖xf3 14. ♖xf3 ♗d7± Berkes-Mchedlishvili, Novi Sad 2009;

A3) 11. ♗h4 ♖g4 (11...♖e4 12.f3 ♖g6 13. ♗xg6 hxg6 14. ♖ae1=) 12.f3 ♖h5 13.g4 ♖g6 (13...♗e8 14. ♖g3 ♗d8 15. ♗g2∞) 14. ♖g3 ♗d7 15. ♖ae1± Rapport-Korpa, Zalakaros 2014.

B) 9.h3 (9. ♗e5 ♖e7 10. ♖e2 0-0 11.0-0 ♗xe5 12. ♖xe5 ♗d7= Elianov-Motylev, Berlin Wch blitz 2015) 9...h6 10. ♖e2 ♖e7 11.0-0 0-0 12. ♖fe1 (12. ♗e5 a6 13. ♖fc1 ♗e4 14. ♗xc6 ♗xc6= Trent-Hagen, Aarhus 2015) 12...a6 (12...♖d8 13. ♖f1 ♖d6 14. ♖xd6 ♖xd6= Karakehajov-Nikolov, Sofia 2004) 13.a4 ♗d7 (13...♗e4 14. ♗xe4 ♖xe4 15. ♗d2 ♖f5= Pavlovic-Bogosavljevic, Belgrade 2014) 14. ♖f1 ♖e8 15. ♖ac1= Grachev-Motylev, Sochi tt rapid 2015.

9... ♖e4

The most common response; the main alternative is 9... ♖g6 10. ♗xg6 hxg6 11. ♖d3 (11.h3 ♖e7 12. ♖d3 (12. ♗f3±) 12...♖d8 (12...a6 13.a4 ♗h5

14. ♕h2= Gonda-Erdős, Budapest 2005) 13. ♖f3 ♗c7 14. ♕e3± Grischuk-Motylev, Berlin Wch rapid 2015) 11... ♖h5 12. ♕e3 ♗d6 13. 0-0-0!? (a new and more aggressive idea of Kramnik's, instead of 13.g3 ♖f6 14. ♗d1!? (14.0-0±; 14. ♖f3±) 14...0-0 15.f4± Kamsky-Macieja, Achaia 2012, or 13. ♖f3 ♖f4 14. ♕xf4 ♕xf4 15.g3 ♗d6 16.h4± Elianov-Tkachiev, Moscow 2008) 13...a6 14. ♖b1 b5 15. ♗c2 ♖a5 16. ♖f3 ♖c4 17. ♕c1∞ Kramnik-Sjugirov, Doha 2015. Black has also played 9... ♗g4 10.h3± (10. ♗d3 ♗e7 11. ♖hf3 (11.h3 ♗h5 12.0-0±) 11... ♗h5 12.0-0 ♗g6 13. ♗xg6 hxg6± Anikonov-Rublevsky, Khanty-Mansiysk 2015) 10... ♗h5 11. ♗d3 ♗e7 12.0-0 (12. ♖df3 h6 13.g4 g5 14. ♗e5 gxh4 15.gxh5± Sulskis-Galkin, New York 2000) 12... ♖d7 13. ♖hf3± Nisipeanu-Banusz, Austria Bundesliga 2015/16.

10. ♖xe4

If 10.f3 then 10... ♗g6 11.g4 (11.g3 ♗d7 12. ♖xg6 hxg6 13. ♗g2= E.Sveshnikov-Agrest, Tallinn 2015) 11... ♗e7 12. ♖xg6 hxg6 13. ♗d3 ♖d7 14.0-0= E.Sveshnikov-Arngrimsson, Albena 2013.



10... ♖xe4

The engines prefer the move 10...dxe4, which is no doubt less logical. On the one hand Black doubles his pawns and weakens his pawn structure, but it is true that he also deprives the g1-knight of its natural position on f3 and at the same time clears the d5-square. The game might continue 11.g3 ♗e7 12. ♖g2 0-0 (12... ♖d5 13. ♗d2 (13. ♗e2; 13.0-0-0!?) 13...0-0= Sandipan-Arun, Benasque 2014) 13. ♗e2 ♖d5 (13...a6 14.0-0 ♖d5 15. ♖ae1 (15.f3±) 15... ♖xf4 16. ♖xf4± Renner-Levushkina, Germany tt 2013) 14. ♗d2 ♗d7 (14... ♖d8 15.0-0 ♗d7 Sedlak-Ragger, Achaia 2012; 14...f5 15.0-0 ♖h8 16.f3± Sedlak-Ivanov, Aschach 2015) 15.f3!? (15.0-0=) 15...exf3 16. ♗xf3 ♖a5 17. ♗c2

♖ac8 (17... ♗c4 18.0-0= Sedlak-Perunovic, Hungary tt 2013/14) 18.0-0 ♗c4= Cruz-Ghosh, Barbera del Valles 2014.

11. ♗f3

Here 11. ♗d3 has also been played, e.g. 11... ♗d6 12. ♗xd6 (12. ♗e3 ♗f6 13.g3 (13.h3 0-0 14. ♖c2= G.Pap-P.V.Kiss, Hungary tt 2008/09) 13...0-0 14.0-0 ♖c7= Jovanic-Doric, Croatia tt 2015) 12... ♗xd6 13.0-0 0-0 14. ♗f3 (14. ♖c2 h6 15.f4 ±) 14... ♖c7 15. ♖c2 h6 (15...g6 16. ♖fe1 b5 17. ♖d2± Sandipan-Kasimdzhanov, Dubai 2014) 16. ♖e2 ♖ab8 17.a4 ♖be8= Sedlak-Prohaszka, Hungary tt 2012/13.

11... ♗d6

It is normally a good idea for Black to exchange this bishop. In a recent game Black played 11... ♗e7 12. ♗d3 0-0 13.0-0 (13. ♖c2±) 13...f5 14. ♖ae1 g5 15. ♗c1 g4 16. ♗d2± Sandipan-Gunina, Gibraltar 2016.

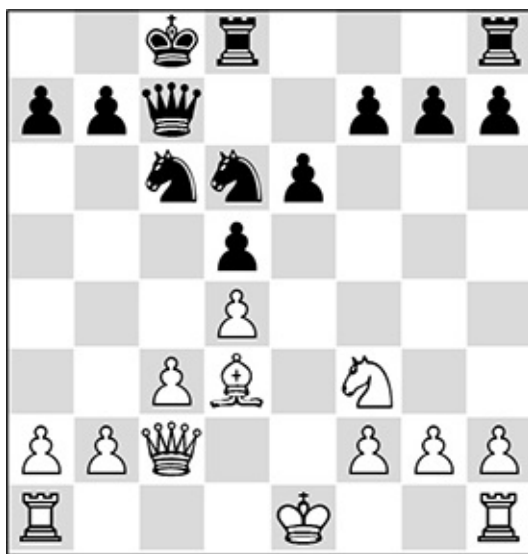
12. ♗xd6!

Carlsen improves on a previous game between Kamsky and Wojtaszek himself, where White played 12. ♗g3 ♗xg3 13.hxg3 ♖c7 14. ♗d3 h6 15.g4 0-0-0∞ Kamsky-Wojtaszek, Russia tt 2015.

12... ♗xd6 13. ♗d3 ♖c7 14. ♖c2

This is a new idea of Carlsen's; 14.0-0 0-0 would lead to the games mentioned in the notes to White's 11th move (Sandipan-Kasimdzhanov and Sedlak-Prohaszka).

14...0-0-0!?



A risky decision against Magnus. It was perhaps better to wait to see what White was going to do by playing 14...h6, e.g. 15.0-0 (15.0-0-0 b5±; 15. ♖e2!?) 15...0-0 16. ♖e2∞.

15.0-0! h6

Preparing to advance his pawns against White's castled position. The immediate 15...g5? would be too hasty: White would be better after 16. ♖xg5 ♜dg8 17. ♗f3.

16.a4

And Carlsen does the same, so that we have a typical position with castling on opposite wings. There were other good moves available for White, such as 16. ♜fe1± or 16. ♜ac1±.

16... ♖b8

Another option was 16...g5 17. ♜fe1 g4 18. ♗e5 h5 19. ♙c1 (19.a5∞) 19... ♚b8 20. ♙f4±.

17. ♜fe1 ♜c8



18. ♙d1!?

A typical Carlsen move; he wants to improve his queen and keep an eye on the kingside. The most natural move would be 18. ♙e2±.

18... ♜he8

Black changes plan, on seeing that the idea of playing ...g7-g5 is not very convincing: 18...g5 19. ♗e5 h5 (19... ♗xe5 20. ♜xe5±) 20. ♙d2±.

19. ♗f1!?

Carlsen continues to make quiet moves. It would be more normal to play 19. ♗e5 ♗xe5 20. ♜xe5±, or 19.g3±.

19... ♜e7

Here 19...f6! was good, to control the e5-square and in the future prepare ...e6-e5, with equality.

20. ♜c1 ♜d8 21. ♜e2!?

Carlsen decides to improve another piece before playing b2-b4, which was also

possible here (21.b4!±).

21... ♖e4?!

It seems better to revert to his initial plan with 21...g5 22.b4 g4 23. ♗e5 h5, with a complex position.

22.b4! ♗g5



23. ♗e1!?

Yet one more move that would probably not occur to other mortals, but is quite normal for Carlsen, who wants to avoid piece exchanges and then prepare his breakthrough on the queenside; he also has the d3-square for the knight. Here 23. ♗d2± was also good, as was 23. ♗xg5 hxg5 24.a5±.

23...e5 24.b5!

This move is very important for establishing White's advantage. After 24. ♗d3 e4 25. ♗c5 f5 White is better, but Black has managed to complicate the game and can gain some initiative on the kingside.

24... ♗a5 25. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 26.dxe5 ♗xe5

It was better to play 26... ♗c4! 27.f4 (27. ♗d3 ♗e4 28. ♗g4 ♗xe5 29. ♗xg7 ♗xd3 30. ♗xd3 ♗xf2! 31. ♗d4 (31. ♗xf2? ♗f4+ 32. ♗e2 ♗xc1-+) 31... ♗xd3 32. ♗xd3=) 27... ♗e4 28. ♗d4 ♗cd2 29. ♗c2 ♗b3 30. ♗e3 ♗bc5 and Black has compensation, although these lines would have been complicated to see.

27.c4 ♗e6

If 27...d4 then 28.c5±.

28. ♗f3



28... ♖f4?

A mistake; it was better to play 28... ♖e4 29.c5 ♜c8 30. ♙d3 ♜g4 31.h3 ♜f4 32.g3 ♜f6 33.c6 bxc6 34.bxc6 ♜xc6 (34... ♙xc6?? 35. ♙a6 ♜c7 36. ♜b3+ ♙a8 37. ♜xc6+-) 35. ♜xc6 ♙xc6 36. ♜b3+ ♙c7 37. ♜xd5, and White is better, in view of the weakness of the black king.

29.cxd5! ♜xd5

If 29... ♙c7 then 30.g3 ♜d6 31. ♜c2 ♙xd5 32. ♙h3, with a decisive advantage to White. The control of the light squares and the c-file are key.

30. ♜xd5 ♜xc1 31.g3 ♜c5?!

This is not good, but the black position was already difficult, even with the best defence: 31... ♜c8 32. ♙h3 ♙c4 and now White can choose between several moves which give him the advantage: 33. ♙d4 (33. ♙xe6 ♜xe6 (33... fxe6 34. ♜e4+-) 34. ♜d8+ ♜c8 35. ♜e7±, or 33.a5 ♙f4 34.gxf4 ♜xh3 35.f5 ♜g4+ 36. ♙h1±) 33... ♙f4 34.gxf4 ♜xh3 35. ♙f5 (35. ♜xc4 ♜g4+ 36. ♙f1 ♜d1+ 37. ♙g2 ♜g4+ with a draw) 35... ♜g4+ 36. ♙h1±.

32. ♜d7

The position is winning for White; the key to the position is the black knight on a5, which is out of play. The white queen is very active, the black king is unsafe and the kingside pawns are weak; in contrast, the bishop on f1 defends the white king.

32... ♜f8

If 32... ♜c7 then 33. ♜e8+ ♙d8 (33... ♜c8 34. ♜xf7±) 34. ♙e5 f5 (34... f6 35. ♙f7!+-) 35. ♙d3+-.



33. ♖e5! ♗c5 34. ♕d5 ♔c7

Here 34...f6? fails to the tactical shot 35. ♕xc5! ♕xc5 36. ♗d7+ ♔c7 37. ♗xc5, winning a piece.

35. ♗xf7

White has won an important pawn and the black king remains in danger. In addition, the knight on a5 is still out of play.

35... ♗xa4 36. ♕e5+ ♔b6 37. ♗d6 ♗c5 38. ♗e8!

Black resigned. White threatens mate on c7 and Black has no good defence, e.g. 38...a6 (38... ♕f7 39. ♕d6++-) 39. ♕c7+ ♔a7 40.b6+ ♔a8 41. ♕c8 mate.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw Black's option of an early exchange on d4, transposing to the Exchange Variation of the Caro-Kann. White put pressure on b7 with 7. ♕b3 and Black defended with 7... ♕c8, instead of the alternative 7... ♕d7, which is also playable. Carlsen shortly improved on a previous game between Kamsky and Wojtaszek himself by exchanging with 12. ♗xd6, instead of playing 12. ♗g3. Black played in a risky manner with 14...0-0-0. It was surely better to wait to see where White was going to castle. Carlsen manoeuvred to improve his pieces, perhaps with unnecessary caution, but when Black tried to free his position with 23...e5 he was worse, once Carlsen played 24.b5. White gradually increased his advantage with the help of some inaccuracies on Black's part and he gained a decisive advantage, thanks to his greater piece activity. The situation of the black knight on a5 and the weakness of the black king contributed to the outcome of the game.

Game 47

Queen's Pawn Opening

Gata Kamsky

2725

Sergey Karjakin

2706

Wijk aan Zee 2009 (11)

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3

In this game we shall see the main problem for White of playing ♘f3 before ♙f4. But there is an alternative for White if he still wants to play 2.♘f3, yet avoid the unpleasant line that Black has available against routine play.

Black can also begin with 1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f3 d5.

2... ♘f6

If 2...c5 3.c3 ♘c6 4.dxc5! (Black often discounts this capture, although it is usually good for White) 4...e6 5.b4 a5 6.b5 ♘a7 7.e3 (7.a4 ♙xc5 8.♙b2 ♘f6 9.e3 0-0 10.♘bd2= Cacco-Astengo, Italy-ch sf 1998) 7... ♙xc5 8.♘bd2±.

3.c3!?



This is the correct move order for White if he wants to prevent the unpleasant line explained in the note to White's fourth move.

Another option is 3.♙f4 c5 4.dxc5!? e6 (4... ♘c6 5.♘bd2 e6 6.♘b3 ♘e4 7.e3 ♙xc5= Bitoon-Paragua, Tagaytay City 2013) 5.e3 ♙xc5 6.♙e2 0-0 7.0-0 ♘c6 8.c4= Biolek-Lintchevski, Pardubice 2013.

3...c5

An alternative is 3... ♙f5 4.♙b3 and now:

A) 4...b6 5.♙g5 e6 6.♘bd2 ♙e7 7.e3 0-0= Gritsak-Bacrot, Ciudad Real 2007;

B) 4...♚c8 5.♙f4 e6 6.c4 (6.♘bd2=; 6.e3 ♙e7 7.c4 0-0 8.♘c3 c6 9.h3 ♘bd7 10.♙e2= Sergeev-Dziuba, Karvina 2013) 6...c6 7.♘c3 (7.e3) 7...♘bd7 8.♘h4 ♙g6 9.♘xg6 hxg6 10.♚c1± Taleb-Tan, Kuala Lumpur 2005.

4.dxc5!

The normal London System continuation would be 4.♙f4 ♘c6 5.e3 ♚b6 6.♚b3 c4, but the difference, now that both sides' knights are developed (on f3 and f6), is that White runs into a problem if he plays the normal 7.♚c2, owing to the reply 7...♙f5!.

A) The endgame after 7.♚xb6 axb6 is considered fine for Black:

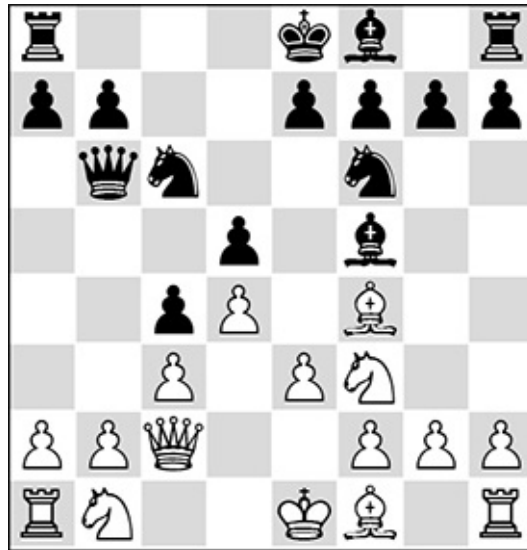
A1) Now if 8.♘bd2 Black is in time to get rid of his doubled pawn with 8...b5 9.a3 b4 10.cxb4 ♘xb4 11.♚c1 ♘c6 and I think Black has the better prospects, with the plan of ...b5-b4, for instance 12.♙e2 e6 (12...♙f5 13.♘h4 ♙d7 14.0-0 h6 15.♘hf3± Ragones-Korneev, Porto San Giorgio 2011) 13.0-0 ♙e7 14.♘e5 0-0= Milovic-Blagojevic, Cetinje 2012;

A2) 8.♘a3! ♚a5 (8...♘a7 9.♘c2=; 8...e5 9.♘b5±; 8...♚xa3!? 9.bxa3 ♙f5 ☞ Kubikova-Stojanovic, Kusadasi 2006) 9.♙c7 ♙f5 (9...e6 10.♘c2=) 10.♙xb6 ♚a6 and now:

A21) 11.♙c7 ♚d7 12.♘b5 e6 13.♙f4 (13.♙e2 ♙e7 14.♙d1 ♚ha8 15.a4 ♘a7= Legky-Cvetkovic, Vrnjacka Banja 1989) 13...♚a5 (13...♙e7 14.♘e5+ ♘xe5 15.dxe5 ♘h5 16.♘d4=) 14.a4 ♙c2 15.♘e5+ ♘xe5 16.dxe5 ♘e4= Kovacevic-Rausis, Las Palmas 1995;

A22) 11.♙c5 ♘e4 12.♘b5 ♚d7 13.♙e2 (13.♘h4 ♙g6 14.♘xg6 hxg6 15.♘a3 b6 16.♙b4 ♘xb4 17.cxb4 e5 Vlahov-Loncar, Croatia tt 2010) 13...♚a5 14.a4 ♘xc5 15.dxc5 e6 16.♘fd4= Schumacher-Percze, cr 2002.

B) 7.♚c2 ♙f5!



Here this move works. White cannot capture on f5 this time and has to play 8. ♖c1 (8. ♖xf5? ♜xb2+), which is a move that we should avoid with white, if possible. It is curious that there are quite a lot of games with this position, yet it does not offer any advantage to White. Even Kamsky and some other strong players have played this position, but I think that it is best avoided, because Black stands very well after 8... ♘h5!. This move, which has not been played much, is the recommendation of the Houdini engine, which awards Black the advantage. An important game continued 9. ♕g3 e6 (9... ♘xg3 10.hxg3 h6) 10. ♘bd2 ♘xg3 11.hxg3 h6 12. ♕e2 (12.e4 ♕h7 13. ♕e2 ♕e7 14.exd5 exd5= Rozhko-Volkov, Taganrog 2013) 12... ♕e7 (12... ♕d6) 13. ♕d1 ♜c7 14. ♕c2= Kamsky-Carlsen, Moscow 2007.

The more common move, also good for Black, is 8...e6 9.h3 (9. ♘bd2 ♕e7 10. ♕e2 0-0 11.b3 Georgiev-Artemiev, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013) 9... ♕e7 10. ♘bd2 ♜d8 11. ♘e5 (11. ♕e2=) 11...0-0 12. ♕e2 ♘xe5 13. ♕xe5 Telljohann-Adams, Gibraltar 2013.



4...g6!?

Playing in gambit style. The normal continuation would be to regain the pawn with 4...e6 5.b4 a5 6.e3 (6.♘bd2 axb4 7.cxb4 b6 8.cxb6 ♖xb6 9.a3 ♕xb4 10.♖b1 ♕xd2+ 11.♕xd2 ♗a7, with a complex position) 6...axb4 7.cxb4 b6 and in this position White can head for a type of Abrahams-Noteboom variation of the Slav with reversed colours, which gives rise to complex positions. In spite of Houdini's preference for Black in this line, I think it is perfectly playable for White.

A) 8.a4 bxc5 9.b5 (9.bxc5 ♕xc5 10.♕b2=) 9... ♕d6 10.♕b2 ♘bd7 11.♘bd2 0-0 12.♕e2 ♕c7 13.♗c2∞ Kulicov-Derjabin, Alushta 2004;

B) 8.♕b5+ ♕d7 9.♕xd7+ ♘bxd7 10.a4 bxc5 11.b5 ♕d6 12.0-0 0-0 13.♕b2∞ Cifuentes-Bauer, San Sebastian 2009.

5.g3

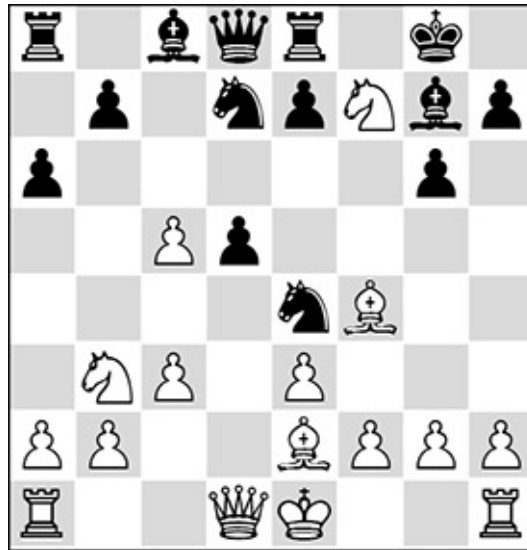
Kamsky often plays the Schlechter Variation of the Slav with black and here he chooses a similar system with white. There were other interesting options, such as:

A) 5.b4 ♕g7 6.♕b2 0-0 7.♘bd2 a5 8.a3 ♘c6 9.e3 (9.b5±) Rogers-Morris, Adelaide 2007;

B) 5.e4 is also interesting: 5...♘xe4 (5...dxe4 6.♗xd8+ ♖xd8 7.♘g5±) 6.♕b5+ ♕d7 (6...♘c6 7.♘e5±) 7.♗xd5 ♕xb5 8.♗xe4 ♘d7 9.♕e3 ♕g7 10.♘bd2∞;

C) Another good move is 5.♕f4 ♕g7 6.♘bd2 0-0 7.e3 and now:

C1) 7...♘bd7 8.♘b3 a6 9.♕e2 ♖e8 10.♘e5 ♘e4? (10...a5±) 11.♘xf7+–;



analysis diagram

11... Nxc3 (11... Kxf7 12. Qxd5+ e6 13. Qxe4+-) 12. Nxd8 Nxd1 13. Nxe6 1-0
Epishin-Bankmann, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2013;

C2) 7... a5 8. a4 (8. Qa4 Qd7 9. Qb5 Qe8= Varga-Almasi, Budapest 2000)
8... Nxa6 9. Qxa6 Bxa6 10. Qe5± Torre-Srivachirawat, Ho Chi Minh City 2009.

5... Qg7 6. Qg2 0-0

Or 6... a5 7. 0-0 Nxa6 8. c4± Udani-Mok, Kuala Lumpur 2010.

7.0-0

In this position it is not clear how Black is going to be able to regain his pawn. It is inferior to play 7. Nbd2 Qc7 8. Nb3 e5 9. Qg5 (9.0-0=) 9... Qe6 10.0-0= Dokutchaev-Kanep, Joensuu 2013.



7... Nc6

There are several interesting alternatives in this position:

A) 7... ♖e4 8. ♗g5! (8. ♙e3 ♗a6 9. ♗bd2 ♗axc5 10. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 11. ♔b3 e6 12. ♖fd1± Orel-Licina, Bled 1994) 8... ♗xg5 9. ♙xg5 h6 10. ♙e3± Fominykh-Shlakich, Moscow 2006;

B) 7... ♗a6 8.b4 ♗e4 and now:

B1) 9.a3!? b6 (9... ♗xc3 10. ♗xc3 ♙xc3 11. ♖a2 ♙g7 12. ♖d2± Fiorito-Pierrot, Trelew 1995) 10. ♗d4 e6 11.c6± Sahl-Riemersma, Lyon 1990;

B2) 9. ♗d4 ♗c7 (9...e5 10. ♗b5 ♙e6 11. ♗d2 ♗xd2 12. ♔xd2± Brestian-Mitter, Austria Bundesliga 1999/2000) 10. ♙b2 a5 11.a3 (11. ♗d2±) 11... ♗e6 12.e3 ♗6g5 13.f3± Boguszlavszkij-Bagonyai, Zalakaros 2003.

C) 7...a5!? 8.c4 (8. ♗a3 ♗a6 9. ♗b5 ♗xc5 10.a4 ♙d7 11. ♙e3 ♙xb5 12.axb5 ♙d6= Efimov-Vezzosi, Sestola 1992) 8... ♗a6 9. ♗c3 dxc4 10.c6! ♗b4 (10... ♔c7 11. ♗d4±) 11. ♔xd8 ♖xd8 12.c7 ♖d7 13. ♙f4 ♗h5 14. ♗e5±;

D) 7... ♔c7 8.b4 e5 9. ♙b2 (9.c4±) 9... ♖d8 10. ♗bd2 ♙f5= E.l'Ami-Bok, Haarlem 2013.

8. ♔b3

White puts pressure on d5 and b7 and prepares ♖d1, but I dislike this move, because it gets in the way of playing b2-b4. I think that 8. ♗a3! is better, e.g. 8... e5 (8... ♔a5 9.b4±) 9. ♗b5±; likewise 8. ♗bd2!? or 8. ♗d4.



8... ♔a5

If 8... ♗e4 then 9. ♔a3 b6 10.cxb6 ♙xb6 11. ♗g5!±, but it was better to play 8...e5! 9. ♙g5 ♙e7 10. ♔a3 ♙f5 11. ♗bd2=.

9. ♔a3 ♙c7 10. ♙g5!?

Here 10. ♗d4± looks more natural.

10... ♗e4

10...h6! is better, e.g. 11.♙xf6 ♖xf6 12.♘bd2 ♙f5 and Black has compensation.

11.♙e3 e5 12.♘bd2 f5 13.♚ad1 ♘f6

It was bad to play 13...f4?! 14.gxf4 exf4 15.♙d4±, or 13...♙e6? 14.♘xe4 dxe4 15.♘g5±.

14.b4 ♚e8 15.♘b3

White has completed his development and maintains a slight advantage with his extra pawn. Black has a strong centre at present, but his queenside development is lagging.

15...♘e4 16.b5 ♘e7 17.♙c1 b6?!



This is an error which gives White a clear advantage, but it was not easy suggest anything good for Black here. If 17...♙d7 18.a4 a6 19.c6! bxc6 20.b6±, or 17...a6 18.b6±.

18.♘g5!

An excellent move to bring the g2-bishop into the game and exploit some tactical ideas.

18...bxc5

If 18...♘xg5 then 19.♙xg5 e4 20.c4+–.

19.c4

Even better was 19.♘xe4! fxe4 (19...dxe4 20.c4+–) 20.♘xc5±.

19...d4 20.♘xe4 fxe4

If 20...dxe3 then 21.♘d6+–.

21.♙g5

Another option was 21.♙xe4 ♙b7 22.♙xb7 ♚xb7 23.♙g5, with a clear advantage.

21...♙b7 22.♙xe7

Here it was better to play 22. ♖a3± and it would not be easy for Black to defend the pawn on c5.

22... ♜xe7 23. ♘c2 ♜f8

If 23... e3 then 24. ♙xb7 ♜xb7 25. ♘xc5±.

24. ♙xe4

White wins a pawn and is left with a good knight against a bad black bishop.

24... ♙c8 25. ♚g2?!

It was better to recycle the knight with 25. ♘d2±.

25... ♙h6 26. ♜d3 ♜g7 27. ♜f3 ♜d8 28. h3 ♙e6 29. a4 a5?



A bad move, creating a new weakness and making the b-pawn passed. It was better to wait with 29... ♜c8±.

30. ♙c6 ♜b6 31. e4?!

It was more sensible to wait a while before making this advance and instead play 31. ♘c1±, with the idea of going to d3.

31... dxe3?

This is a serious strategic error, rare in a player as strong as Karjakin: he loses his passed pawn and opens the f-file for White's rooks. The game is now decided. Instead 31... ♜c8± was better.

32. fxe3 ♜g8 33. e4 ♜d6 34. ♙d5 ♙xd5 35. cxd5 ♜c7 36. ♜c3 ♜f6 37. ♜xf6 ♜xf6 38. ♘xc5 ♜f7 39. ♜e2 ♙d2 40. ♜f3 ♜g5 41. ♙e6

1-0

SUMMARY

In this game we learned about the drawback of using the move order with 2. ♘f3 instead of 2. ♙f4. In the critical line with 5... ♜b6 and 6... c4 the

white queen should not retreat to c2, because now 7...♔f5 works. But the ending after 7.♚xb6 is fine for Black. Thus if White wants to use the 2.♗f3 move order, Kamsky's idea of 3.c3 is interesting, so that when Black plays ...c7-c5, White can capture with dxc5. Karjakin decided to play 4...g6!? and gambit the pawn, instead of the normal 4...e6, which could lead to complex positions similar to the Abrahams-Noteboom line in the Slav, but with colours reversed. Kamsky opted for the solid 5.g3, although he had other interesting options, such as 5.b4, 5.e4 or 5.♔f4. In the game it was not easy for Black to regain the pawn and in the middlegame White gained a clear advantage. Then after errors on both sides White emerged the winner.

Game 48

Chigorin Defence

Luc Winants

2543

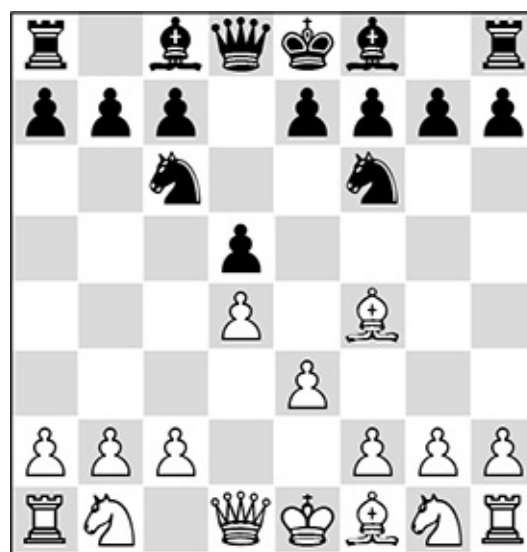
Abdalsalam Albzour

Istanbul 2012 (1)

1.d4 d5 2.♔f4 ♗f6

Black can also choose the move order 2...♗c6 3.e3! f6?! (3...♗f6 transposes to the game) 4.♔d3!± (4.c4 e5!? 5.cxd5! ♚xd5 (5...exf4 6.dxc6 fxe3 7.fxe3 bxc6 8.♗f3±) 6.♗c3 ♔b4 7.dxe5± Jugelt-Shteinberg, Dresden 2009) 4...♔e6 (4...e5? 5.♚h5+±) 5.♗f3 ♔f7 Macedo-Santiago, Recife 2012, 6.0-0±.

3.e3 ♗c6



The Chigorin Defence against the London System.

If 3... ♖g4 then:

A) 4. ♖e2 ♖xe2 5. ♗xe2 e6=;

B) or 4. ♗f3 e6 5. c4 c6 6. ♖b3 (6. ♗c3 ♗h5 7. ♖g3 ♗d7 8. ♖d3= Georgiev-Liiva, Puhajarve 2013) 6... ♖b6 7. c5 (7. ♗c3 ♗bd7 8. ♗d2 ♖f5± Pham Le-Nguyen, Ho Chi Minh 2013) 7... ♖xb3 8. axb3 ♗bd7 9. ♗bd2±;

C) 4. f3!? ♖f5 5. c4 (5. ♗c3!?) 5... c6 (5... e6 6. ♗c3 ♖b4 7. ♖b3 ♗c6 8. a3 ♖xc3+ 9. ♖xc3= Carlsen-Polgar, Rishon-Le-Zion 2006) 6. ♗c3 e6 7. ♖b3 b6 (if 7... ♖b6 then 8. c5 ♖xb3 9. axb3 ♖e7 10. b4±) 8. g4 ♖g6 9. h4 h6 (9... h5 10. g5 ♗g8 11. cxd5 exd5± McShane-Jansa, Tegernsee 2003) 10. ♗h3 ♖e7 11. 0-0-0!? (11. ♖g3 ♗bd7 12. ♗f4 ♖h7 13. 0-0-0 0-0 14. g5±) 11... a5 12. cxd5 exd5 13. ♖d3 ♖xd3 14. ♖xd3± Winants-Wiedenkeller, Neum 2000.

4. ♗f3

4. ♗c3!? is a line that deserves practical tests: 4... ♖g4 5. ♖d2 e6 6. f3∞.

4... ♖g4

This is the move most in the spirit of the Chigorin. Other options are:

A) 4... ♖f5 5. ♖b5 ♖d7 6. 0-0 e6± Landa-Balducci, Ajaccio 2007;

B) 4... e6 5. ♗bd2 ♖d6 6. c3 ♗d7 7. ♖xd6 (7. ♖b3±) 7... cxd6 8. e4 dxe4 9. ♗xe4 ♗f6 10. ♖d3± Bogdanovski-Sipila, Warsaw 2013;

C) 4... ♗h5!? is an interesting idea, for instance:

C1) 5. ♖g5 (5. ♖g3 ♗xg3 6. hxg3 ♖g4 7. ♖b5±) 5... h6 6. ♖h4 g5 7. ♗fd2 ♗f6 (7... ♖f5 8. ♖xh5 ♖g6 9. ♖g4 gxh4 10. c3±; 7... ♗g7 8. ♖g3 ♗f5 9. c4 ♗xg3 10. hxg3 ♖g7 11. cxd5 ♖xd5 12. ♗c3± Yedidia-Curdo, New England 1997) 8. ♖g3± Akkozov-Khouseinov, Tashkent 2011;

C2) 5. c3?! g6?! (5... ♗xf4=) 6. ♖g5 f6 7. ♖h4± Paunovic-Arribas, Elgoibar 2013.

5. ♖b5!?

This move is interesting. The idea is to threaten to damage Black's pawn structure with ♖xc6 and after h2-h3 gain the bishop pair or else occupy e5 with the knight. Black cannot now advance ...e7-e5 in the future.

White has also tried 5. c4 (5. h3 ♖xf3 6. ♖xf3 e6 7. a3=) 5... e6 6. ♗c3 ♖b4 7. ♖c1 ♗e4 (7... 0-0=) 8. ♖d3 f5 9. ♖b3± Ibrahimov-Eidivadi, Mashhad 2010.

5... h6?!

This is not the best move. If 5... ♖xf3?! then 6. ♖xf3 e6 7. ♗d2 ♖d6 8. ♖g5 a6 9. ♖xc6+ bxc6 10. e4± Bauer-Marie, Vandoeuvre 2008.

It seems best to play 5... e6 6. h3 ♖xf3 7. ♖xf3 a6 8. ♖a4 (8. ♖xc6+±) 8... ♖e7 9. c3 b5 10. ♖c2± Oblitas-Morante, Sullana 2012.

6. h3

Here it was good to play 6. c4! dxc4 (6... e6 7. ♖a4±) 7. ♗bd2±.

6... ♖xf3 7. ♖xf3 e6 8. c4 a6?!

It was better to complete development with 8...♖b4+ 9.♗c3 0-0 10.0-0, although I prefer White.



9.♗xc6 bxc6 10.0-0

It was even better to play 10.c5!, restricting the f8-bishop and closing the queenside, with a substantial advantage to White: he is going to be able to play ♗c3, b2-b4 and a2-a4, followed by bringing a rook to b1 to prepare the break on b5.

10...♗d6 11.♖c1 ♖b8 12.b3 0-0 13.cxd5 cxd5 14.♗c3 ♖c8 15.♗a4

The pawn on a6 is weak and the one on c7 is backward. White commands the half-open c-file, whereas Black is unable to make use of the b-file.

15...♗e4 16.♖c6 ♗f6?

This loses material without compensation.

It was better to play 16...a5 17.♖ac1 ♗d7 18.♖1c2±.

17.♗xd6! ♗xf3 18.gxf3 ♗xd6 19.♖xa6



The game is very straightforward for White, with an extra pawn and the better position.

19... ♖fd8 20. ♖c1 ♗f5 21. ♖ac6!

Winning a second pawn and the game.

21... ♗h4

21... ♖d7? loses to 22. ♗b6.

22.f4 ♗f3+ 23.♖g2 ♗h4+ 24.♖f1 ♗f3 25.♖e2 ♗h4 26.♖xc7 ♖xc7 27.♖xc7 f6 28.♗c5 ♖e8 29.a4 e5 30.dxe5 fxe5 31.fxe5 ♖xe5 32.a5 d4 33.a6 ♗f5 34.♖c8+ ♖h7 35.a7 dxe3 36.fxe3 ♖xe3+ 37.♖d2 ♖xh3 38.a8 ♖h2+ 39.♖c1

Black resigned.

SUMMARY

We have seen the Chigorin Defence, with ...♗c6, against the London System. This set-up for Black is less effective here, because, having developed the bishop on f4 and played e2-e3, Black's thematic move ...♗g4 presents fewer dangers to White. In the game White emerged from the opening with the better game, especially after the dubious moves 5...h6 and 8...a6. Black was left with weak pawns on the queenside and once more White exploited the c-file to win the game.

The Jobava Attack

Now we shall analyse a line which has become quite fashionable and which is a cross between the Richter-Veresov Attack with ♗c3 and the London System with ♗f4. The strong grandmaster Baadur Jobava has been playing it regularly.

Other strong grandmasters, such as Naiditsch, Rapport and Prié, have also included it in their repertoires. Grandmaster Henrik Danielsen also recommends using this line in the normal London System against the idea of ...c7-c5. Even the Houdini engine often gives 2. ♖c3 as the best move. Theory has moved on from the days when playing c2-c4 was the only approved idea for White in the Queen's Pawn Openings and nowadays in many lines it is fine to develop the knight first.

Game 49

Jobava Attack
Baadur Jobava

2706

Boris Savchenko

2556

Minsk 2014 (5)

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♖c3

White can also use the move order 2. ♖f4 d5 3.e3 c5 4. ♖c3. In the traditional line, this move, recommended by grandmaster Danielsen, is also fashionable:

A) 4... ♖c6? 5. ♖b5±;

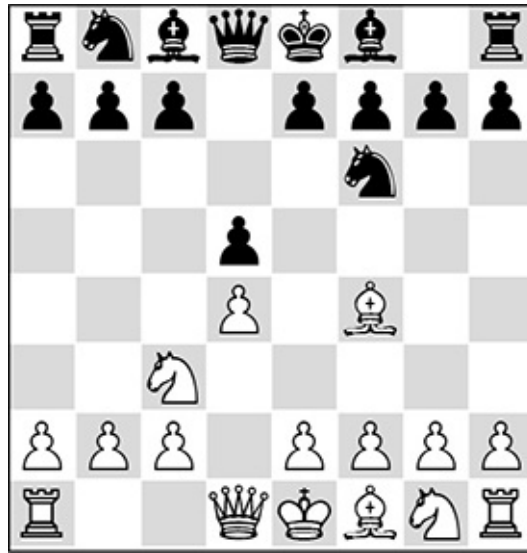
B) 4...a6 5.dxc5 e6 6. ♖a4 ♖xc5 7. ♖xc5 ♔a5+ 8.c3 ♔xc5 9. ♖f3 ♖c6 10. ♖d3±; 4... ♔b6 5. ♖b5 ♖a6 6.dxc5±;

C) 4...cxd4 5.exd4 (5. ♔xd4 ♖c6 6. ♖b5 ♖d7 7. ♖xc6 ♖xc6 8. ♖f3 e6 9.0-0 ♖e7=) 5...a6 (5... ♖c6?! 6. ♖b5±; 5... ♖g4 6.f3 ♖f5 7. ♖b5 ♖a6±; 5... ♔b6 6. ♖b5±) 6. ♖f3 ♖c6 7. ♖e5, with a slight advantage to White according to Danielsen; I think that this position is playable for White but I do not think that he has any real advantage:

C1) 7...e6 8. ♖xc6 (8. ♔d2∞) 8...bxc6 9. ♖a4 ♖d6= Heinzl-Leutwyler, Austria Bundesliga B 2013; or

C2) 7... ♖f5 8.g4 ♖xe5 9.gxf5 ♖c6 10. ♔d3 g6 11.0-0-0± Hector-Andersen, Växjö 2013.

2...d5 3. ♖f4



This is the fashionable line employed by grandmaster Jobava, a cross between the Richter-Veresov and the London System.

3...a6

Of course there are other options:

A) 3...e6 (a very solid and popular alternative) 4.e3 and now:

A1) 4...♙e7 5.♙d3 (5.♘f3 a6 6.♙d3 ♘bd7 7.♘e5 (7.e4!?) 7...c5 8.a3 ♘xe5 9.♙xe5 c4 10.♙e2 b5= Ganguly-Arizmendi, Linares 2014) 5...c5 (5...0-0 6.♘f3 c5 7.dxc5 ♘c6 (7...♙xc5 8.0-0 ♘c6 9.e4 dxe4 10.♘xe4 ♙e7= Stefanova-Lagno, Khanty-Mansiysk 2014) 8.0-0 ♘d7 9.e4 d4= Wei Yi-Zhao Jun, Jiaying 2014) 6.dxc5 0-0 (6...♙xc5 7.♘b5±) 7.♘f3 ♘bd7 8.b4± Jobava-Andreev, Al-Ain 2013;

A2) 4...♙d6 5.♘f3 (5.♙d3 b6 6.♙g5!? ♙b7 7.♙f3 h6 8.♙h3 ♘bd7 9.♘b5= Harikrishna-Rakhmanov, Linares 2014) 6...0-0 6.♙d3 c5 7.dxc5 ♙xc5 8.0-0 (8.a3 ♘c6 9.0-0 ♙d6 10.♙xd6 ♙xd6 11.e4 ♙d8± Prié-Lillo, Spain tt 2013) 8...♘c6 9.e4 dxe4 10.♘xe4 ♘xe4 11.♙xe4± Jobava-Malakhov, Warsaw 2013;

A3) 4...♙b4 and now:

A31) 5.♘e2 0-0 6.a3 ♙d6 7.♙d2 (7.g3 b6 8.♙g2 ♙b7 9.0-0 c5= Jobava-Caruana, Wijk aan Zee 2015; 7.♘g3 c5 8.dxc5 ♙xc5 9.♙d3 ♘c6 10.0-0 ♙d6= Navara-Wojtaszek, Berlin Wch rapid 2015) 7...c5 8.0-0-0 ♘c6= Jobava-Kravtsiv, Al-Ain 2013;

A32) 5.♙d3 c5 6.dxc5 ♘bd7 7.♘e2:

A321) 7...0-0 and now:

A3211) 8.0-0 ♘xc5 9.♙c1 ♙d7 10.a3 ♘xd3 11.cxd3 ♙e7= Demidov-Panarin, Sochi RUS-tt rapid 2015;

A3212) 8.♙d6 ♙e8 9.♙b5 a6 10.♙xd7 ♘xd7 11.♙d4 ♙a5= Jobava-

Korneev, Sochi 2014.

A322) 7... ♖xc5 8.a3 ♗xd3+ 9.♔xd3 ♕a5 10.0-0-0 0-0 11.♕g5 h6 12.h4 ♕d7 13.g4 ♕c6 14.♖h3 e5? (14... ♖e8∞) 15.♗f5± Jobava-Shalamberidze, Ureki 2014.

C) Black has also tried 3...c6 4.e3 g6 (4... ♗b6 5.♖b1 ♕f5 6.♗f3 e6 7.♕d3 ± Ibarra-Perez Candelario, Navalmoral 2012) 5.♗f3 (5.♕e2 ♕g7 6.h4 ♗b6 7.a3 ♗bd7 8.♗f3 0-0∞ Prié-Dominguez, Spain tt 2013; 5.h3 ♕g7 6.♗f3 0-0 7.♕d3± Jürgens-Lomineishvili, Germany Frauenbundesliga 1998/99) 5... ♕g7 6.h4 h5 7.♗e5 ♗bd7 8.♗d2 0-0 9.0-0-0∞ Romero-Crnkovic, Pula 2012;

D) Practice has also seen 3...g6 4.♗d2 (4.e3 ♕g7 5.♕e2 0-0 6.♗f3 c5 transposes to the Barry Attack, which we examined in Chapter 2) 4...c6!? (4... ♕g7 5.♕h6 0-0 6.♕xg7 ♗xg7= Cabrera-Dvirnyy, Spain tt 2014) 5.f3 b5 6.a3 ♕g7 (6... ♗bd7 7.e4 ♗b6 8.e5 ♗g8 9.♕d3 e6 10.♗h3= Boguszlavszkij-Szegi, Kisber 2011) 7.♕h6 ♕xh6 8.♗xh6 ♗d6 9.e3 e5 10.♕d3 ♗bd7 11.♗ge2± Jobava-Winants, Tromsø 2014.

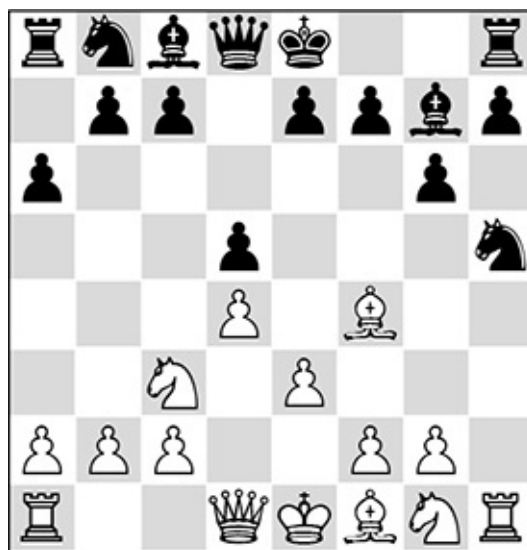
4.e3 g6

One month before this game, Jobava had faced 4...e6 5.♗f3 c5 6.a3 (6.♗d2) 6... ♗c6 7.h3 b5 8.dxc5 ♕xc5 9.♕d3 ♕b7 10.0-0 ♕d6 11.♖e1= Jobava-Zhao Xue, Wijk aan Zee 2014.

5.h4 ♕g7 6.h5!?

This position resembles a Barry Attack, but one in which White has not yet developed his kingside knight or bishop. Jobava goes straight for the attack. Normal moves in the Barry would be 6.♕e2 or 6.♗f3.

6... ♗xh5



7. ♖xh5! gxh5 8. ♗xh5

White has sacrificed the exchange and has good compensation. Now kingside castling for Black would be dangerous, since White is going to castle queenside and has the better development. This sacrifice is similar to one played against the Leningrad Dutch.

8...c6 9.♘f3 h6 10.0-0-0 ♘d7 11.♙h2! ♘f8 12.♙c7 ♙d7 13.♙e2

Here 13.♘a4 ♘e6 14.♙e5 was interesting; White has good compensation.

13...♘e6 14.♙e5 b5 15.♙h1 f6 16.♙g3 ♘g5 17.♘e1

White avoids exchanges, because Black's king is still in the centre and Black is behind in development.

White can keep quietly improving his pieces, since his compensation is long-lasting.

17...0-0 18.♘d3 ♙f5 19.♙f4 a5 20.♘c5 ♙h7 21.g4!



White is now better: the bishop on g7 is passive, as is the black queen; White's knight on c5 is very strong and he threatens 22.♙d3.

21...♙g6 22.♙c7 b4

If 22...♙f7 then 23.f4 ♘e6 24.♙b6±.

23.♘3a4 e5 24.♘b6 ♙a7 25.♙d6 ♙e8 26.f4 ♘f7 27.g5!

Opening lines; this is better than 27.♙b8 ♙ae7 28.f5 ♙g5=.

27...♘xd6?

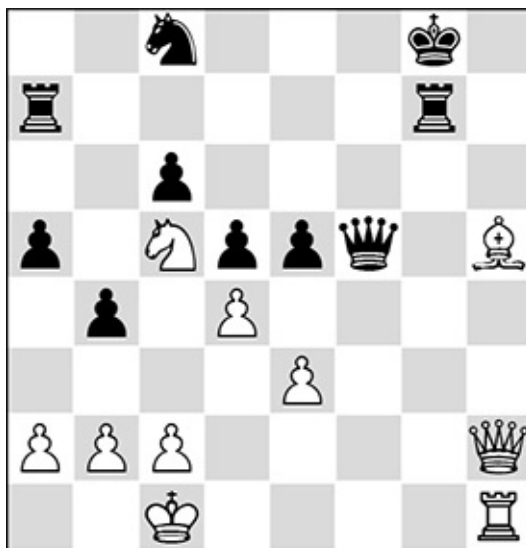
Black makes a mistake; he needed to play 27...fxg5 28.♘xc8 ♙xc8 29.♙xe5 ♘xe5 30.dxe5±.

28.♙h5± ♙f5 29.gxh6! ♙ee7?

This loses; it was essential to play 29...exf4 30.♙xe8 ♘xe8 31.hxg7 ♙xg7 32.♘xc8 ♙xc8 33.♙xf4±.

30.hxg7+- ♙xg7 31.fxe5 fxe5 32.♘xc8 ♘xc8

If 32... ♖xc8 then 33.dxe5 ♘f7 34. ♙xf7+ ♔xf7 35. ♖h5+ ♔f8 36. ♖h6 and White's attack is decisive. But how should White continue now?



33. ♖g6!!

An excellent move that accomplishes the task in brilliant fashion: White clears the h-file.

33... ♖xg6

33... ♖xg6 loses to 34. ♖h8+ ♔f7 35. ♖h7+ ♖g7 36. ♖xg7+ ♔f6 37. ♖f8+ ♖f7 38. ♖xf7 mate.

34. ♖h8+ ♔f7 35. ♖f1+

1-0

Black must give up his queen with 35... ♖f6, since if 35... ♔e7 then 36. ♖f8 mates.

SUMMARY

We have seen an alternative line, one that is interesting and fashionable, the so-called Jobava Attack. The Georgian grandmaster has employed it regularly, as have some other strong grandmasters. The line is a cross between the Richter-Veresov with 2. ♘c3 and the London System with 2. ♙f4. There are quite a lot of games available, but ones by strong grandmasters have only appeared in the last few years. Ideas involving ♘c3 (without c2-c4) are now quite common in the London System and often this move is the top recommendation of the Houdini engine. In this game Black responded with 3...a6, to prevent the idea of ♘b5, and we also analysed other options for Black. Jobava played very aggressively against Black's

fianchetto and sacrificed an exchange at a very early stage. The positions with ...g7-g6 resemble the Barry Attack. Jobava obtained very good compensation and his position got better and better. Then, when he already had the advantage, following an error by his opponent, he finished off the game brilliantly with 33. ♕g6!.

Game 50

Jobava Attack
Baadur Jobava

2688

Shakhriyar Mamedyarov

2799

Dubai 2014 (3)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗c3 d5 3.♕f4 ♕f5

In the previous game we saw 3...a6, and we shall see 3...c5 in the next game.

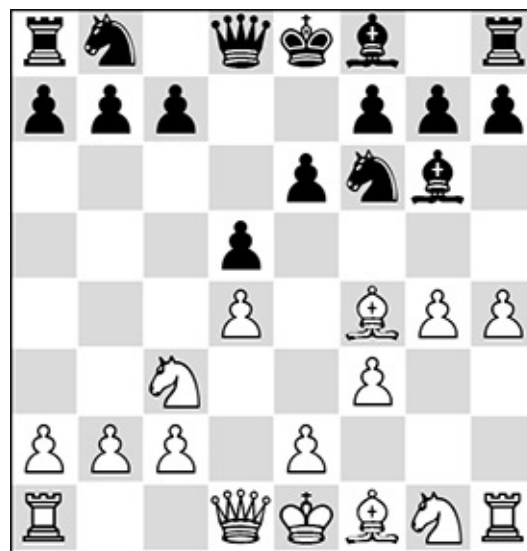
4.f3

The most popular response; the alternative is 4.e3 e6 5.♗f3 ♕e7 6.♗e5 h6 7.g4 ♕h7 8.♕d3 c6 (8...♕xd3=) 9.♕xh7 ♖xh7 10.♖f3± Rapport-Pajeken, Reykjavik 2014.

4...e6 5.g4

The alternative 5.♖d2 ♕e7 6.0-0-0 ♗c6 7.♖e1?! ♕g6 8.♗h3 0-0 9.♗f2?! ♗h5 10.♕e3 ♗b4 was played in Naiditsch-Harikrishna, Wijk aan Zee 2014.

5...♕g6 6.h4



6...h6

The advance 6...h5 has also been played: 7.g5 ♗fd7 8.e3 and now:

A) 8...c5 9. ♖d3 (9. ♗b5 ♗a6 10.c3) 9... ♕xd3 10. ♖xd3 ♗c6 11.g6 (11.0-0-0) 11...f6∞ Boguszlavskij-Lukacs, Budapest 2010;

B) 8...a6 9. ♖d3 ♕xd3 and now:

B1) 10.cxd3 ♗c6 (10...c5 11.dxc5 ♕xc5 12.d4 ♕e7 13. ♗ge2 ♗c6= Juhasz-Nikolova, Budapest 2015) 11.g6?! (11. ♗ge2=) 11...fxg6 (11...f6♞) 12. ♕g5 ♕e7 13.f4 ♗f6♞ Jobava-Nakamura, Khanty-Mansiysk 2015;

B2) 10. ♖xd3 c5 (10...g6?! 11.e4 c6 12. ♗ge2 ♕g7 13.0-0-0± Vidovic-Grachev, Croatia tt 2014) 11.g6!? (11.0-0-0 is playable, with a balanced game) 11...f6 12. ♗ge2 (12.0-0-0) 12... ♗c6 13.a3 ♖b6 14. ♕h2 0-0-0 15.0-0-0= Ipatov-Kantans, Tromsø 2014.

7.e3



White's idea is reminiscent of play in the Caro-Kann: he gains space on the kingside with g2-g4 and h2-h4-h5, and then exchanges the bishops on d3.

7...c5

The thematic idea to break the white centre. There are several alternatives for Black here:

A) 7...c6 and now:

A1) 8. ♖d3 ♕xd3 9. ♖xd3 (9.cxd3!? ♕d6 10. ♗ge2 ♕xf4 11. ♗xf4 ♗bd7 12. ♖f2= Rapport-Sachdev, Gibraltar 2014) 9... ♕d6 10.0-0-0 (10. ♗ge2 ♗a6 11.0-0-0 ♕xf4 12. ♗xf4 ♖a5 13.g5± Colovic-Nikolic, Serbia tt 2013) 10... ♖e7 11. ♗ge2 ♗bd7 12. ♕xd6 ♖xd6 13.e4! dxe4 14.fxe4 ♗xg4?! (14...e5 15.g5 hxg5? (15... ♗g4! 16. ♖f3 h5) 16.hxg5 ♖xh1 17. ♖xh1 ♗g8 18.d5± Nabaty-Samblic, Malinska 2014) 15.e5? (15. ♖f3! h5 16.e5 ♖e7 17. ♗e4±) 15... ♖e7? (15... ♗dxe5! 16.dxe5 ♖xd3 17.cxd3 ♗f2=) 16. ♗e4?! (16. ♖f3!±) 16...0-0-0± Thorfinnsson-Nordenbaek, Ballerup 2014;

A2) 8.h5 ♖h7 9.♗d3 ♗xd3 10.♞xd3 ♗d6 11.♕ge2 ♗xf4 12.exf4!? (12.♕xf4 0-0 13.0-0-0=) 12...♗bd7 13.♞e3 (13.0-0-0!?) 13...♞e7 14.♕c1= Jobava-Salgado, Yerevan 2014, a game in which Jobava won an interesting endgame.

B) 7...♗d6 8.h5 (8.♕h3 ♕c6 9.♞d2 (9.♗d3 ♗xd3 10.♞xd3 e5=) 9...e5 10.dxe5 ♕xe5 11.♗xe5 ♗xe5 12.0-0-0 c6 13.♕f4= Nabaty-Gomez Esteban, Benasque 2012; 8.♗d3 ♗xf4 9.exf4 ♗xd3 10.♞xd3 ♞d6= Isik-Sengul, Kocaeli 2014) 8...♗h7 9.♗d3 ♗xd3 10.♞xd3 a6 (10...♕c6 11.♕ge2 ♞d7 12.0-0-0 0-0-0 13.♗xd6 cxd6 14.♕f4= Vorontsov-Vignesh, Moscow 2014) 11.♕ge2 c5 12.dxc5 ♗xc5 13.0-0-0 ♕c6= Stefanova-Dzagnidze, Khanty-Mansiysk 2014;

C) 7...a6 and now:

C1) 8.♗d3 ♗xd3 9.♞xd3 (9.cxd3 ♗d6 10.♕ge2 ♗xf4 11.♕xf4 ♞d6= Zavgorodniy-Kanarek, Katowice 2014) 9...c5 10.♕ge2 (10.♕ce2 ♕c6 11.c3 ♗d6 12.0-0-0∞ Nakamura-Nepomniachtchi, Dubai 2014; 10.dxc5 ♗xc5 11.0-0-0 ♕c6 12.♕ge2 ♞a5 13.♞b1∞ Bortnyk-Munguntuul, Moscow 2015; 10.0-0-0!?) is also playable here) 10...♕c6 11.0-0-0 c4 12.♞d2∞ Putka-Neiksans, Jurmala 2016;

C2) 8.h5 ♖h7 9.♗d3:

C21) 9...♗xd3 10.♞xd3 (10.cxd3 ♗d6 11.♕ge2 ♕c6 12.♞d2 ♞e7 13.0-0-0∞ Jobava-Nepomniachtchi, Dubai 2014) 10...c5 11.dxc5 ♗xc5 12.♕ge2 ♕c6 13.♕d4 Nazaretyan-Zakharov, Russia tt 2015;

C22) 9...c5 10.♕ge2 ♗xd3 11.cxd3 cxd4 12.♕xd4 ♕bd7= Jobava-Hovhannisyan, Yerevan 2014.

8.h5

8.♗d3 has also been played, e.g. 8...♗xd3 9.♞xd3 ♕c6 10.♕ge2 cxd4 11.exd4= Boguszlavskij-Turzo, Budapest 2009.

8...♗h7



Having played ...c7-c5, Black is on the verge of having a good position. What should White play now?

9. ♖b5

This knight move is thematic in several lines, as in the Dutch. White's idea, in addition to gaining a tempo, is to bolster his centre with c2-c3 and redeploy his knight. It also forces Black to develop his knight to a bad square, from which it does not move for the rest of the game.

9... ♗a6 10.c3 ♘e7 11. ♙d3

Another possibility is 11.dxc5 ♗xc5 12.b4 ♘e7 13. ♙d3 ♗xd3 14. ♖xd3 0-0 15. ♖e2=.

11... ♗xd3 12. ♖xd3 ♙d7

Black delays castling; if 12...0-0 13.g5 and White has the attack.

13. ♖e2 0-0

But now Black castles, because he has the g5-square under control.

14.a4

An idea for White here is to play 14. ♔f2, connecting the rooks. We have seen several examples of how White can place his king here without any problems.

14... ♗f6 15. ♙d6 ♖e8

It was better to play 15... ♘e7=.

16.f4

Again 16. ♔f2! seems good.

16... ♖b6?



It was to better to deprive White of the right to castle with 16...Qh4+, forcing 17.Ke1 or 17.Kd1, with a complex position and chances for both sides.

17.g5! hxg5 18.h6! g6

The best defence. If 18...gxh6 then 19.Qxh6 wins, or 18...gxf4 19.hxg7 Qh4+ 20.Ke1 Qf6 (20...Qxg7 21.Qg1+ Qh8 22.Qe5+ Qf6 (22...f6 23.Qg6) 23.exf4 mating) 21.Qe5 Qh6 22.Qxf4.

19.fxg5 Qxg5 20.h7+ Qg7

If 20...Qh8 21.Qe5+ Qf6 (21...f6 22.Qd6 Qf8 23.Qf4±) 22.Qd6, with a clear advantage to White.

21.Qe5+ f6?

It was better to defend with 21...Qf6 22.Qd6 Qxe5 23.dxe5, although White maintains the advantage.



How should White continue now?

22. ♖d6?

22. ♖f4! ♙xf4 23. ♖g1!! (a difficult but important move) would have been decisive; the attack on the black king is unstoppable, e.g. 23...g5 (23...fxe5 24. ♙xg6+ ♔h8 25. ♙g7 mate) 24. exf4! fxe5 (24...♙h8 25. ♖xg5+-) 25. ♖xg5+ ♔h8 (25...♙xg5 26. fxg5+-) 26. ♙g6 ♙e7 27. ♖d6! (the knight always lands on d6 to put the icing on the cake) 27...♖f8 28. 0-0-0 with unstoppable mate in five: 28...exd4 29. ♙g8+ ♖xg8 30. hxg8 ♙+ ♖xg8 31. ♖h1+ ♙h7 32. ♖f7 mate – that would have been a wonderful finish, wouldn't it?

22... ♖h8?

It was better to play 22...fxe5! 23. ♖xe8+ ♙xe8 24. h8 ♙+ ♙xh8 25. ♖xh8 ♖xh8 26. 0-0-0±.

23. ♖f4!

Now it seems that Jobava has finally seen the winning idea...

23... ♙xf4 24. ♙xf4?

Alas, no; he fails to see 24. ♖g1!! g5 25. exf4 fxe5 26. ♖xg5+, winning in even simpler fashion than in the variation given above.

24...g5 25. 0-0-0

25. ♙e2 also gives White a decisive advantage after 25...♖c4 26. ♖h6! ♙xh6 27. ♖f7++-.

25... ♖c4



It is time to realise White's advantage. How should he continue?

26. ♖h6!?

Very spectacular, although not the best; there was a simpler win with 26. ♖xc4!

dx c4 27. ♖c2 cxd4 28. ♗xd4! ♕e7 29. ♖h2 e5 30. ♖h6+ ♔f7 31. ♖h5+ ♕f8 (or 31... ♖g7 32. ♗xg5 fxg5 33. ♖h6+ ♕f7 34. ♗f1+ ♕e8 35. ♖h5+ mating) 32. ♗xg5 ♗xh7 (or 32... fxg5 33. ♗f1+ mating) 33. ♖xh7 (33. ♗h6+) 33... ♖xh7 34. ♗xh7 fxg5 (34... exd4 35. ♗h8+) 35 ♗dd7+–.

26... ♖xh6

Black's best defence is to give up his queen. If 26... ♗xd6 then 27. ♖g6+ ♔f8 28. ♗xd6+ ♖xd6 29. ♖xf6+, with a decisive advantage; or 26... ♖e7 27. ♖g6+ ♔f8 28. ♗e5!! ♗xe5 (if 28... fxe5 then 29. ♗f1+ wins, while if 28... ♖g7 then 29. ♖xf6+ ♖xf6 30. ♗xf6+ ♔g7 (or 30... ♖e7 31. ♗f7+ ♔d8 32. ♗f6 mate) 31. ♗f7+ ♔g6 32. ♗g7+ ♔h5 33. ♗f7, with unstoppable mate; or finally if 28... ♗xd6 then 29. ♗xd6 ♖xd6 30. ♖xf6++–) 29. dxe5 ♖g7 30. ♖h5 fxe5 31. ♗xe6, with a decisive advantage.

27. ♗f7+ ♖g7 28. ♗xd8 ♗axd8

White is winning: he has an edge in material, the black king is still very weak, the black knights are out of play and the pawn on h7 is a nuisance.

29.b3

There was a simpler win starting with 29.e4!, e.g. 29... ♗xh7 (if 29... gxf4 30. ♗g1+ ♔f7 31. exd5 exd5 32. ♖g6+ ♕e6 33. ♖g4+! ♔d6 34. ♖xf4+ ♕e6 (34... ♖c6 35. ♖xf6+ ♗d6 36. ♖xd8 ♗xd8 37. ♗g8+–) 35. ♖g4+ ♔d6 36. ♖g7) 30. exd5 exd5 31. ♗xg5 fxg5 32. ♖f5 with a decisive attack, for example: 32... ♗f8 33. ♖xg5+ ♕h8 34. ♖xd5 ♗b6 35. ♖e5+ ♗g7 36. ♗g1 ♗f7 37. ♖e8+ ♕h7 38. ♗h1+ ♕g6 39. ♖e4+ with mate in a few moves.

29... ♗b6 30. ♗g1! ♗xh7 31.e4

31. ♗xg5! was also winning, e.g. 31... fxg5 32. ♗xg5+ ♕h8 33. dxc5 ♗d7 (33... ♗xc5?? 34. ♖d4+) 34. c6.

31... ♖h8

If 31... cxd4 32. e5+–.

32.e5! gxf4

This hastens Black's defeat, but there was no defence; if 32... ♗d7 33. exf6+–, or 32... cxd4 33. exf6+–.

33. ♖g6 ♗f8 34. exf6

And Black resigned, in view of the unstoppable mate after 34... ♗d7 35. f7! ♗c7 (35... ♗hxf7 36. ♗h1+ ♗h7 37. ♗xh7 mate, 35... ♗xf7 36. ♖g8 mate) 36. ♖g8+ ♗xg8 37. ♗xg8 mate!

SUMMARY

In this game we continued to study the Jobava Attack. We analysed the reply 3... ♗f5, which is one of the most popular. White's plan consists of

gaining space on the kingside by advancing his pawns against the black bishop, similar to what happens in the Caro-Kann, and then exchange bishops on d3. Black played 7...c5, but in that position he has other interesting options as well, such as 7...a6, 7...♗d6 or 7...c6. White employed the plan of ♖b5 and then gained a strong attack against the black king. He won material with the pretty 26. ♗h6, although he missed good chances to finish the struggle sooner with the idea of ♖f4 and ♗g1!!. Jobava exposed the black king by sacrificing material and finished the game with a mating attack. Both players made mistakes, but these are excusable, since this game was played in the World Rapidplay Championship in Dubai. Nevertheless, the game has some very good points and is well worth analysing. It is a good illustration of the dangers facing Black.

Game 51

Jobava Attack
Richard Rapport

2704

Emil Sutovsky

2624

Tromsø 2014 (9)
1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♗c3 d5 3. ♗f4 c5



We shall conclude our survey of the Jobava Attack by examining this very thematic black option.

4.e3

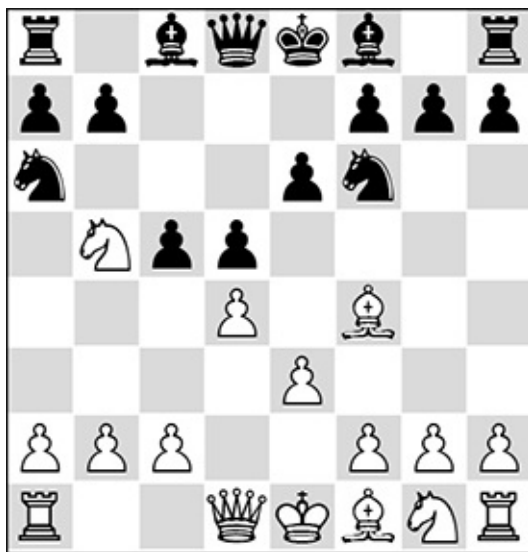
The normal move. Here 4.e4!? is interesting, e.g. 4...♖xe4 (4...dxe4 5.d5 transposes to the Morris Gambit, which we looked at earlier; 5.♖xe4 dxe4 6.d5!? (6.dxc5=) 6...♖d7 7.♖e2 g6 8.♖c3 ♗g7 9.♔d2 f5?! (9...♖f6 10.0-0-0∞ Boguszlavszk ij-Flumbort, Hungary tt 2010/11) 10.♖b5 ♖e5 11.d6! 0-0? (11...exd6±) 12.♖xe5 ♖xe5 13.♔d5+ 1-0 Boguszlavszkij-Wang, Budapest 2012.

4...cxd4

The best move for Black. Other options are:

A) 4...a6 5.dxc5 ♖c6 6.a3 (6.♖f3 ♗g4 7.♖e2 e6 8.♖a4 ♖e4= Stripunsky-Perelshteyn, Ledyard 2014) 6...e5 7.♗g5 d4 8.exd4 (8.♖xf6 gxf6 (8...♔xf6 9.♖d5±) 9.♖a4±) 8...exd4 (8...♖xd4=) 9.♖e4± Nakamura-Fressinet, Dubai 2014;

B) 4...e6 5.♖b5 ♖a6, and here there are several options for White:



analysis diagram

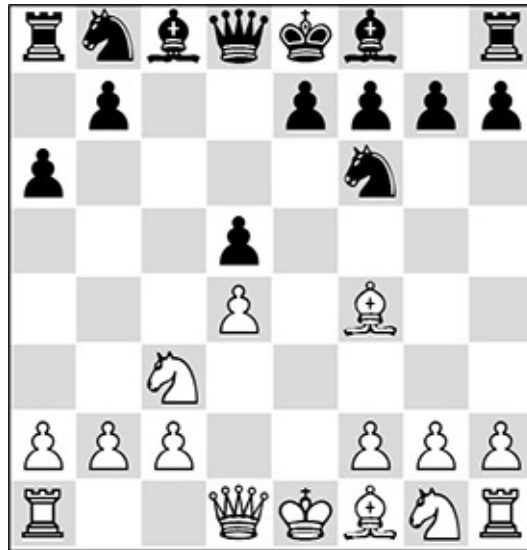
B1) 6.c3! ♔b6?! (6...♖e7 7.dxc5 (7.a4±) 7...♖xc5 8.♖f3 0-0 9.♖d3 ♖e7= Hoang Thanh Trang-Kravtsiv, Chennai 2012) 7.a4 ♖d7 8.♖f3±, transposing to the variation with ...c7-c5 and ...♔b6 which we analysed in the chapter on the Benoni and which gives White a clear advantage, as in Iotov-Inkiov, Sunny Beach 2014;

B2) 6.h3 ♖e7 7.♖f3 ♖e4 8.c3 c4 9.a4± Stefanova-Kosteniuk, Khanty-Mansiysk 2014;

B3) 6.♖f3 ♖e7 7.dxc5 ♖xc5 8.a3± Agdestein-Johannessen, Oslo 2010;

B4) 6.a4 ♖e7 7.c3 0-0 8.h3 ♖d7 9.♖f3± Short-Amonatov, Bangkok 2012.

5.exd4 a6



6. ♘f3

At this point various moves have been tried:

A) 6. ♘e2 ♘c6 7. ♘f3 ♘g4 8. 0-0 e6 9. ♘e5 (9. h3 ♘h5 10. ♖e1 ♘d6 11. ♘xd6 ♜xd6= Colovic-Ivanov, Novi Sad 2016) 9... ♘xe2 10. ♘xe2 ♘xe5 (10... ♘e7= Vaisser-Postny, St Quentin 2014) 11. ♘xe5 ♘d7= Kovacevic-Kuljasevic, Croatia tt 2010;

B) 6. ♘d3 ♘c6 7. ♘e3 ♘g4 8. f3 ♘h5 9. ♘ge2 e6 Danov-Arnaudov, Albena 2014;

C) 6. ♜d2 ♘c6 7. a3 (7. 0-0-0 e6 8. ♜e3 b5 9. ♘f3?! b4 10. ♘a4 ♜a5= Colovic-Vrbljanac, Valjevo 2011) 7... e6 8. ♘f3 ♘d6 9. ♘d3 h6 10. 0-0= Hoang-Akshat, New Delhi 2012;

D) 6. ♘ce2 ♘c6 7. c3 g6 8. ♘f3 ♘g7 9. ♘c1 0-0 10. ♘e2 ♘e4= Shimanov-Geller, Moscow 2014.

6... ♘g4

Another option is 6... ♘c6 and now:

A) 7. h3:

A1) 7... e6 8. ♘d3 ♘d6= Kovalev-Blübaum, Berlin Wch rapid 2015;

A2) 7... g6 8. ♘e5 (8. ♘e2 ♘g7 9. 0-0 0-0 10. ♘e5= Williams-Hawkins, Coventry 2015) 8... ♘g7 9. ♜d2= Danielsen-Gagare, New Delhi 2012;

A3) 7... ♘f5 8. ♘d3 (8. ♘e2 e6 9. 0-0 ♘d6 10. ♘xd6 ♜xd6= Milanovic-Wagner, Berlin Wch rapid 2015) 8... ♘xd3 9. ♜xd3 e6 10. 0-0 (10. g4?! ♘d6 11. ♘e3?! ♜c8 12. g5?! ♘b4= Khotenashvili-Stefanova, Beijing 2014) 10... ♘d6 11. ♘g5 0-0 (11... h6 12. ♘h4 0-0 13. a3 ♜c8= Miladinovic-Dizdarevic, Belgrade 2010) 12. ♜ae1 ♘e7 13. ♘xf6 ♘xf6 14. ♘d1 b5 15. ♘e3= Kovalev-Mirzoev, Minsk 2015.

B) 7. a3 (7. ♜d2!? ♘f5 8. ♘d3 ♘xd3 9. ♜xd3 e6=) 7... ♘g4 8. ♘e2 ♘xf3

9. ♖xf3 e6 10. ♖e3 ♖e7 11.0-0 ♖c7 12. ♖e2= Bortnyk-Santos, Manacor 2016;
C) 7. ♖e5 and now:

C1) 7...e6 8. ♖xc6 (8. ♖e2 ♖d6 9.0-0 ♖c7 10. ♖e1 0-0= Bortnyk-Gavrilov, Schwäbisch Gmünd 2016) 8...bxc6 9. ♖a4 ♖d6 10. ♖xd6 ♖xd6 11. ♖d3 (11. ♖e2 0-0 12.0-0 ♖d7 13.c4= Romanov-Wagner, Berlin Wch rapid 2015) 11...0-0 12.0-0 e5 13.dxe5 ♖xe5 14. ♖f3 Rapport-Bu Xiangzhi, Tsaghkadzor 2015;

C2) 7...♖d7 8. ♖d3 ♖c8 9.a3 g6 10. ♖e2 ♖g7 11.0-0= Bauer-Abel, Berlin Wch blitz 2015;

C3) 7...g6 8. ♖d2 ♖g7 9. ♖e2 ♖e6 10.h4 ♖c8 11.h5∞ Bromann-Stenner, Germany tt 2016;

C4) 7...♖f5 8.g4 ♖xe5 (8...♖e6 9.h3 (9. ♖xc6 bxc6 10.g5±, 9. ♖g2 h6 10.0-0 g5 11. ♖g3= Petrusic-Pucovski, Novi Sad 2016) 9...g6 10. ♖d2 (10. ♖g2±) 10...♖g7 11. ♖g2 ♖c8 12.0-0-0± Bauer-Kirszenberg, Le Port Marly 2012) 9.gxf5 ♖c6 10. ♖d3= Hector-Andersen, Växjö 2013.



7.h3

Best; 7. ♖e2 ♖c6 8. ♖e5 ♖xe2 9. ♖xe2 e6 (9...g6 10.c3 ♖g7 11. ♖g3 ♖c8 12.0-0 0-0= Stefanova-Khotenashvili, Lopota 2014) 10.c3 ♖d6 (10... ♖c8 11.0-0 ♖d6 12. ♖d3 0-0= Boguszlavszkij-Kislik, Heviz ch-HUN 2011) 11. ♖d3 0-0= Miladinovic-Jankovic, Rogaska Slatina 2009.

7...♖xf3!

Better than 7...♖h5?! 8.g4 ♖g6 9. ♖e5! ♖c6 (9...♖e4?! 10. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 11.f3 ♖g6 12.h4± Heinzl-Platzgummer, Austria Bundesliga B 2013/14) 10.h4! ♖b6 11. ♖xc6 bxc6 12. ♖a4 ♖a5+ 13.c3±.

8. ♖xf3 ♖c6

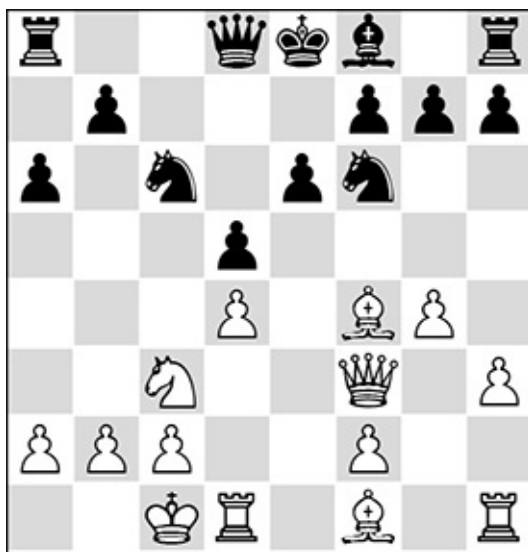
Here Black has also tried 8...e6 9.0-0-0 ♖d6 10.♙xd6 ♜xd6 11.g4 ♘c6 12.g5 ♘d7 13.h4 ♘e7 (13...b5 14.h5 0-0 15.♚b1± Vojinovic-Burrows, Caleta 2015) 14.h5 0-0-0± Ferreira-Illingworth, Tromsø 2014.

9.0-0-0

A normal move, and better than 9.♘e2 e6 10.c3 ♜b6 11.♚b1 ♜c8= Fries-Agrest, Sweden 2014.

9...e6 10.g4

The typical plan for White, after castling queenside, is to start a pawn storm on the kingside. However, since Black has not castled yet he has more options.



10...♙b4!?

Sutovsky's move was a novelty at the time. Black has also played:

A) 10...♜b6?! (10...♜a5?! 11.g5 ♘d7 12.♚b1± Semiev-Seliverstov, Moscow 2015; 10...b5 11.g5 ♘d7 12.h4 ♘e7± Korley-Flaquer, Arlington 2015) 11.g5/♘d7 12.♚e3 0-0-0?! 13.h4± Bauer-Bindrich, Biel 2008;

B) 10...♙d6! seems best. Nikolic employed it against Rapport himself, one month after the Sutovsky game: 11.♙e3 (there are alternatives, such as 11.♙xd6 ♜xd6 12.h4=, or 11.g5 ♙xf4+ 12.♜xf4 ♘h5 13.♜e3 ♜d6 14.h4 (14.♙e2 ½-½ Georgescu-Berescu, Rumania tt 2014) 14...♘a5, with equality) 11...♜a5 (11...b5!? 12.g5 ♘d7 13.♚b1 ♘b6∞) 12.♚b1 ♜c8 13.g5 ♘d7 with equality in Rapport-Nikolic, Palic 2014, although Rapport managed to win;

C) 10...♜c8 11.♚b1 ♙b4 12.♘e2 ♘e4 13.♘g3 ♜b6 14.♘xe4 dxe4 15.♜e3± Berczes-Peczely, Zalakaros 2014.

11.♘e2!?

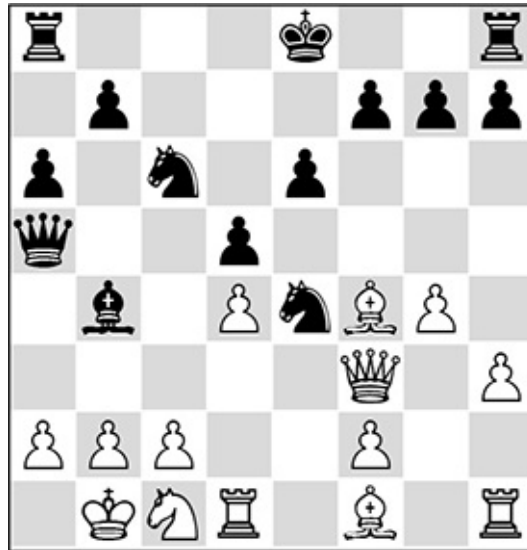
White avoids exchanges and also decides to redeploy his knight. It was possible to play 11.g5 ♙xc3 (11...♘g8) 12.♜xc3 ♘e4 13.♜e3 0-0 14.♚b1, with a

balanced position.

11... ♖a5

It seems normal to bring the queen closer to the white king; 11...0-0 or 11... ♙d6 were also good moves.

12. ♖b1 ♗e4 13. ♗c1!?



Rapport continues with his plan of redeploying his knight. The young Hungarian's play is very original and it is obvious that he likes to play positions that are unusual and sharp. Here 13. ♙e3 was also good.

13... ♙d6

13... ♙b6! 14. ♗b3 ♗a5 15. a4 0-0 16. h4= seems a better defence.

14. ♗b3 ♙c7 15. ♙e3 0-0

Better was to delay castling with 15...a5=.

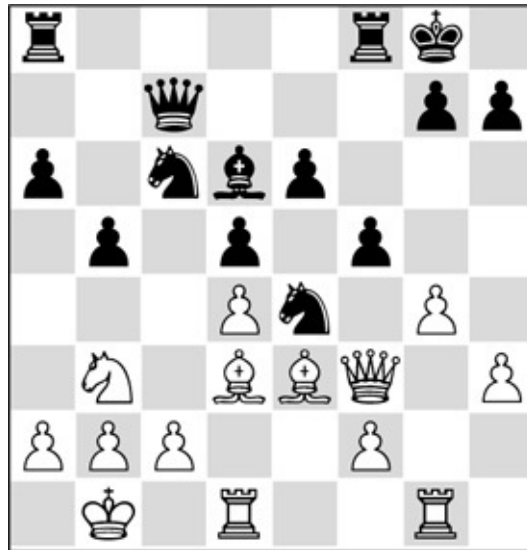
16. ♖g1

It looks better to complete development with 16. ♙d3 f5 17. ♖hg1, when White has the initiative; he is going to open the g-file, although Black has counterplay and possibilities of defence.

16...b5?!

Again 16...a5! 17. a4 ♗a7= was better.

17. ♙d3 f5?



This is an error. It was better to sacrifice a pawn, either with 17...a5! 18. ♖xe4 dxe4 19. ♗xe4 a4 or 17...♗e7 18. ♖xe4 dxe4 19. ♗xe4 ♗d5, with good compensation in either case.

18.gxf5 exf5?!

Here 18... ♗xf5 was slightly better, although after 19. ♗g2 ♗b4 (19... ♗h2 20. ♗ge1±) 20. ♖xe4 (20. ♗c5 ♗xc5 21. ♖xe4 dxe4 22. dxc5±) 20...dxe4 21. ♗xe4 ♗e8 White would have a clear advantage.

19. ♗h6!

White's attack is very dangerous.

19... ♗f7



20. ♖xg7!

A piece sacrifice to open Black's castled position: White will either recover his

material or obtain a strong mating attack.

20... ♖xg7 21. ♗xf5 ♜h8

The best defence; other moves lose in simpler fashion, such as 21... ♗e7 22. ♗e6+ ♜h8 23. ♖xg7 ♜xg7 24. ♖g1+ ♗g6 (24... ♜h8 25. ♙xe4 dxe4 26. ♗f6+) 25. ♗xd5, or 21... ♗f7 22. ♙xe4 dxe4 23. ♗xe4 ♖c8 24. ♖xg7+ ♜xg7 (24... ♗xg7 25. ♗e6+) 25. ♗g4+, with a winning advantage.

22. ♖xg7 ♗xg7

If 22... ♜xg7 then 23. ♙xe4 dxe4 24. ♖g1+.

23. ♗xd5 ♗xf2 24. ♗xc6 ♖f8

After the tactical skirmishing, White has emerged with two extra pawns and a decisive advantage.



25. ♖c1

It was even better to sacrifice the exchange and eliminate Black's queenside pawns with 25. ♗xa6! ♗xd1 26. ♗xd6 ♗f2 27. ♙xb5.

25... ♗xd3 26. cxd3 ♗g3 27. a3!? ♙f4

If 27... ♗xd3+ then 28. ♗a2 ♙f4 29. ♗c5.

28. ♖d1 ♗xh3 29. ♗c5 ♙e3 30. ♗e4 ♗f3 31. ♗e5+!

Rapport shows good judgement in avoiding the exchange of queens: he wants to attack, because the white pieces are more active and the black king is more exposed, whereas the white king is in no danger.

31... ♜g8 32. ♖e1! ♙f2 33. ♖e4!

The rook joins in the attack!

33... ♗f5 34. ♗c7 ♜h8 35. ♗e6 ♖g8 36. d5

It was slightly better to play 36. ♗c3 ♗d5 37. ♗f4 ♗d7 38. d5+ ♗g7 39. ♗b3.

36... ♙h4 37. ♗c5 ♙f6 38. ♖a2 h5?

This hastens the defeat, although Black would also be lost after 38...♔e5 39.♚e2.

39.♚f4! ♜g6

If 39...♜e5? then 40.d4.

40.d6! ♜g7 41.♜f5 ♜h7

If 41...♜xf5 then 42.♚xf5.

42.d7 ♜xf5 43.♚xf5 ♜g6 44.♚f8!

1-0

A neat finish; the d-pawn cannot be prevented from queening.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw Black play 3...c5, followed by exchanging pawns on d4 and then the plan of ...♔g4 and ...♔xf3, which is considered solid for Black. Sutovsky then played the novelty 11...♔b4, although 11...♔d6 seems better, as Nikolic played soon after. White castled on the queenside and advanced his kingside pawns – a typical plan. Rapport showed originality in playing ♜c3-e2-c1 and ♔e3, preventing piece exchanges. However, Black had everything under control until he made a serious error with 17...f5?. White then opened the g-file and, after a piece sacrifice on g7, obtained a strong attack and a decisive advantage. White could have concluded the game more quickly, but in the endgame the advance of White's d-pawn proved decisive.

CONCLUSION

In this chapter we looked at Black's various schemes against the London based on playing...d7-d5 and ...♜f6, without an early ...e7-e6. In Game 43 we analysed the Morris Gambit, 1.d4 d5 2.♔f4 c5 3.e4!?, which is a weapon to consider for inclusion in our repertoire. In Game 44 we saw Black's typical plan of ...c7-c5 and ...♜b6. If White employs the right move order in the opening, after ...c5-c4, White is not forced to exchange queens on b6 but can play ♜c2 instead. In this game we analysed the move ...♔f5 in reply to ♜c2. In Game 45 we analysed the other moves for Black, such as ...♔g4 instead of ...♔f5. Once again the right plan for White is to play a quick b2-b3, which gives him the advantage on the queenside.

In Game 46, Carlsen allows a transposition to the Exchange Variation of

the Caro-Kann and wins a sharp struggle involving castling on opposite sides; a very instructive game. In Game 47 we analysed 2. ♖f3. Our recommendation is to play 2. ♕f4 instead. In the variation with ♖f3, Black's advance with ...c5-c4 is stronger. Retreating the queen to c2 is inferior, but the queen exchange on b6 gives White nothing either. However, for anyone still wanting to play 2. ♖f3, our recommendation is to follow Kamsky's suggestion of playing 3.c3 before bringing out the c1-bishop. The idea is that after ...c7-c5 White takes dxc5, with an interesting game. Karjakin decided to play a gambit with ...g7-g6, but he remained worse and ended up losing. It is better to regain the pawn but the resulting positions are complex. In Game 48 we analysed the Chigorin Defence with 2... ♖c6, although against the London System this is not so effective, since White, by playing 3.e3 instead of 3. ♖f3, can avoid the quick ... ♕g4 pin.

Finally, in Games 49, 50 and 51 we analysed the Jobava Attack, which is a cross between the Richter-Veresov with ♖c3 and the London System with ♕f4. This is a fashionable line, played by some strong grandmasters, such as Jobava himself, Rapport and Harikrishna. Lines with ♖c3, and without c2-c4, are very common in the London System, more so than we imagined. We looked at Black's various replies to the Jobava Attack, such as 3...a6 and 3...e6 (Game 49), 3... ♕f5 (Game 50) and 3...c5 (Game 51). We analysed most of the important games played so far with this system; its theory is developing daily, and there still remain many improvements to be found and games to be played with it.

Chapter 9

The London System versus ...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

1.d4 d5 2. ♖f4 ♘f6 3.e3 e6 4. ♘f3



4... ♗d6

4... ♗e7; 4... c5

5. ♗g3 c5

5... ♘e4; 5... ♗xg3

6.c3 ♗c6

6...b6

7. ♗bd2 0-0 8. ♗d3 ♖e7

8... ♖e8; 8...a6

9. ♗e5

In this chapter we shall analyse the variations with ...d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6, which are usually typical of the Queen's Gambit, or the Nimzo-Indian with ...♗f6 and ...e7-e6 when Black ends up playing ...d7-d5. In these lines, the c8-

bishop usually emerges on b7. White prepares the typical plan of ♖d3 and ♗e5, trying to mount an attack on the kingside. We shall analyse the so-called Pereyra Attack with h2-h4 and various other lines involving attacks which are dangerous to Black. Black has two main options: to play ...♗e7 or ...♗d6, and I think that the latter move is slightly better. I consider that the London System works very well for White against this set-up with ...d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6 and for me personally it is the one that causes me the least concern.

Game 52

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Pereyra Attack

Eric Prié

2513

Dmitry Svetushkin

2590

Chalons-en-Champagne 2009

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f4 e6 3.e3 c5 4.c3 ♗c6 5.♗f3 d5 6.♗bd2 ♗d6

The alternative is 6...♗e7, which we shall look at further on.



7.♗g3

The normal response, with the idea of opening the h-file, if Black captures on g3, or playing f2-f4 in the future.

Practice has also seen:

A) 7.dxc5 ♗xc5 8.♗d3 ♗e7 9.e4 dxe4 10.♗xe4 ♗xe4 11.♗xe4 e5= Harikrishna-Zaragatski, Vlissingen 2013;

B) 7.♗xd6 ♗xd6 8.♗b5 (8.♗d3 0-0 9.0-0 e5 10.dxc5 ♗xc5 11.e4 ♗g4 12.♗c2= Abasov-Idani, Al-Ain 2013) 8...♗d7 9.0-0 0-0 10.a4 (10.♗b3 a6

11. ♖xc6 ♖xc6 12. ♗a3 ♘d7= Nguyen-Caruana, Biel 2010) 10...a6 (10... ♖ac8 11. ♗b3 ♖fd8 12. ♗a3± Moreno-Georgiev, Jaen 2011) 11. ♖xc6 ♖xc6 12. ♘e5 ♘d7= Kveinys-Kryvoruchko, Cappelle-la-Grande 2008.

7...0-0

A) Black has also played 7... ♗e7 8. ♘e5 and now:



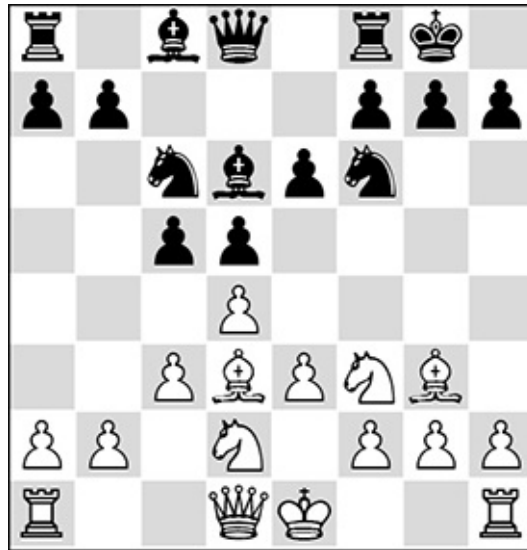
analysis diagram

A1) 8... ♖xe5 9. dxe5 ♘d7 10. f4 f5 (10...f6 11. ♖h4± Albano-Grottke, Dresden 2013) 11. ♘f3± Prié-Dgebuadze, Condom 2012;

A2) The alternative is 8... ♘d7 9. ♖b5 (9. f4 0-0 10. ♖d3 f6 transposes to the lines with f2-f4 mentioned in the note to move 10 below; 9. ♘xc6 bxc6 10. ♗a4 ♖b7= Tu Hoang-Battulga, Olongapo City 2010) 9... ♖xe5 10. dxe5 0-0 11. f4 c4 12. ♖a4 f5= Prié-Gozzoli, Pau 2012.

B) Exchanging on g3 is also playable: 7... ♖xg3 8. hxg3 ♗d6 9. ♖b5 (9. ♗c2 h6 10. ♖b5 ♖d7= Kovacevic-Dizdarevic, Sarajevo 1982) 9... ♖d7 10. ♖xc6 (10. ♗e2; 10.0-0) 10... ♖xc6 11. ♘e5 ♘d7 (11... ♖b5 12. ♗b3±; 11...0-0 12. g4 ♘d7 13. ♗c2± Kamsky-Dlugy, New York 1989; 11...h6 12. g4±) 12. ♘xd7 (12. f4 ♖xe5 13. fxe5 ♗e7 14. ♗g4 f5 15. ♗h5+ ♗d7∞ Kamsky-Potkin, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013) 12... ♖xd7 13. ♘f3 h6 14. ♘e5 cxd4 15. exd4 ♗e7 16. ♗g4± Abdulla-Ghosh, Calcutta 2014.

8. ♖d3



This is one of the key positions in this variation. Black has several options at this point, while White must prevent Black from playing ...e6-e5.

8... ♖e7

We shall see the move 8...b6 in another game.

A) Here 8... ♖c7?! is dubious, owing to 9.dxc5 ♘xg3 10.hxg3 e5 11.e4± Markus-Papp, Sarajevo 2013.

B) An alternative is 8... ♖e8, when White can play 9. ♘e5! and now:

B1) 9...cxd4 10.exd4 ♙xe5 11.dxe5 ♘d7 12. ♘f3 (12.f4 ♖b6 13. ♘b3 ♖e3+ 14. ♖e2 ♖xe2+ 15. ♙xe2±) 12...f6 13.exf6 gxf6± Vaisser-Buhmann, France tt 2013;

B2) 9... ♖c7 10.f4 (10. ♘xc6 ♖xc6 11. ♘f3 ♘d7=) 10... ♘d7? (10... ♘e7 11. ♖f3 ♘f5 12. ♙f2∞ Li-Krauseneck, Lenk 2011) 11. ♙xh7+± Blatny-Seifried, Triberg 1991;

B3) 9... ♙xe5 10.dxe5 ♘d7 and now:

B31) 11.f4!?



analysis diagram

This move involves a pawn sacrifice: 11...c4 12.♙c2 ♚b6 13.0-0 ♜xb2 (13...♜xe3+ 14.♚h1) 14.♜c1 ♞c5 (better than 14...f5?! 15.exf6 ♞xf6 16.♙h4) Mitkov-Shulman, Bolingbrook 2005, or 14...♜xa2 15.♙h4 (15.e4) 15...♜a3 16.♜f3 g6 17.♜h3 Moradiabadi-Nasri, Jakarta 2011) 15.♜f2 (15.e4!) 15...♜a3 16.♙h4 ♞d3 (16...b6) 17.♙xd3 cxd3 Cvetnic-Tinture, cr Belgium 2002.

B32) Instead of 11.f4!? the normal move would be 11.♞f3 and now:

B321) 11...♜c7 12.0-0 g6 (12...h6 13.e4± M.Rodriguez-Walton, Calvia 2011; 12...♞dxe5?? 13.♞xe5 ♞xe5 14.♚h5+—) 13.♙b5 (13.♜e1 ♞dxe5 14.e4) 13...a6 14.♙xc6 bxc6 15.e4 ♜b8 16.b3 a5 17.♜d2 ♙a6 18.♜fe1±;

B322) 11...f6 (11...♞f8 12.h4 (12.0-0±) 12...f5 13.h5± Danielsen-Skytte, Borup 2010) 12.exf6 ♞xf6 13.♞e5± Torre-Bitoon, Manila 2011;

B323) 11...a6 12.0-0 b5 13.a4 (13.e4 ♙b7 14.exd5 exd5 15.♜e1±) 13...♜b8 14.axb5 axb5 15.♜e2± Prié-Flear, Narbonne 2007.

C) Finally let us examine the continuation 8...a6, when White can again play 9.♞e5! (White has also tried 9.♜e2 ♜e8 10.♞e5 ♞e7 11.♞df3 ♜f8 12.dxc5 ♙xc5 13.0-0± Elianov-Malakhatko, St Petersburg 2012, and 9.0-0 ♙xg3 10.hxg3 c4 (10...cxd4 11.exd4 b6 12.♜c2 ♙b7 13.♞e5 g6= T.Nguyen-N.Nguyen, Vung Tau 2000) 11.♙c2 b5 12.e4= Zilberman-Kataev, Ramat Aviv 2004) and now:

C1) 9...♞e7 10.f4 b5 11.♙h4 ♞f5= Zakaria-Tan, Kuala Lumpur 2007;

C2) 9...♙xe5 10.dxe5 ♞d7 11.♜b1 f5 (11...h6=) 12.f4 (12.exf6±) 12...c4= Heinzl-Martin, Nuremberg 2011;

C3) 9...♜c7 10.f4 ♞d7 11.0-0 f6 (11...cxd4 (11...g6 12.♜g4 f5 13.♜h3

♔g7 14. ♖h4± Tuerlinckx-Bennett, Prague 2012) 12.exd4 ♖b6 13. ♗df3! ♗f6 (13... ♖xb2? 14. ♖xh7+! ♔xh7 15. ♗g5+ ♔g8 16. ♗xd7±) 14. ♖e2± Banoci-Skrabakova, Tatranske Zruby 2011) 12. ♖xh7+!? (White can also try 12. ♖h5 f5 13. ♖h4 ♗f6 14. ♖f3 ♖d7 15. ♖xf6 ♗xf6=, or 12. ♗xc6 bxc6 13.e4=).



analysis diagram

The sacrifice looks interesting; it is thematic in some lines and although it gives no advantage here, it certainly complicates the game and makes it difficult for Black to defend: 12... ♔xh7 13. ♖h5+ ♔g8 14. ♗g6 and now:

C31) 14... ♗e8 (14...cxd4 15.exd4 ♗d8 16. ♗f3±) 15.e4 (15. ♗e5 ♗e7 16. ♗g6 ♗e8= or 15. ♖h8+ ♔f7 16. ♖h7 ♗f8 (16... ♗e7 17. ♗e5+±) 17. ♗f3 with compensation) 15... ♗e7 (if 15...f5 16.e5 ♖e7 17. ♗f3± or 15...cxd4 16.exd5 ♗d8 17. ♗e4± or 16...exd5 17. ♖xd5+ ♔h7 18. ♗c4±) 16.e5 ♗xg6 17.exd6 ♖c6 18. ♖xg6 ♗f8 19. ♖d3 with a small advantage;

C32) 14... ♗d8 and now:

C321) 15. ♗f3 ♗f8 16. ♖h8+ ♔f7 and now instead of 17. ♗g5+? (De Prado-D. Perez, Ferrol 2012) it was better to play either 17. ♗gh4! ♖e8 18. ♗g5! ♗e7 19. ♖xg7 fxg5 20.fxg5 ♖xg3 21. ♗xf8+ ♔d7 22.hxg3 ♗xf8 23. ♖xf8 ♖xg3 24. ♗f3, or 17. ♗ge5+! ♖e8 (17... ♖xe5 18.fxe5 f5 19. ♖h4 ♖e8∞ 20. ♗g5; 17...fxe5 18.fxe5+–) 18. ♖h4 fxe5 19.fxe5 ♖e7 20. ♖xg7, when White has good compensation;

C322) Here 15.e4! was good, e.g. 15...f5 (15...cxd4 16.exd5 ♗f8 (16... ♗e7 17. ♗xe7+ ♖xe7 18.dxe6±, 16...exd5 17. ♖xd5+ ♔h7 18. ♖h5+ ♔g8 19. ♗e4±) 17.dxc6 ♗xg6 18. ♖xg6 dxc3 19. ♗e4 ♖e7∞) 16.e5 ♖e7 17. ♗f3 and White is a bit better in this position.

9. ♗e5



9...d7

Another option is 9...xe5 10.dxe5 d7 and now:

A) 11. f3 f6 (11...f5 12. f4 (12. exf6±) 12...c4 13. c2 c5= Bauer-A. Sokolov, Flims 2012) 12.exf6 xf6± Kovacevic-Izeta, Albacete 1992;

B) 11.f4 f6 (11...c4 12. c2 b5 13. f3± E.Alvarez-Trepat, San Sebastian 2010) 12. f3 b6 (12...fxe5 13.fxe5±) 13.h4 (13.0-0±) 13...f5 (13...fxe5=) 14.c4 (14.h5) 14...dxc4 (14...d4=) 15. xc4± Gochelashvili-Sanzhaev, Izhevsk 2010.

10. xd7!

The start of a sequence that took Black by surprise. Other moves have also been tried, such as 10.h4 cxd4 11.exd4 xe5 12.dxe5 dxe5 13. xe5 xe5 14. xh7+ xh7 15. h5+ g8 16. xe5= Prié-Luther, Arvier 2007, or 10.f4 f6 (10...f5 11.0-0 f6 12. h4 c7 13.h3 e4 14. xe4 (14. g4?! xe5 (14... b6) 15.fxe5 cxd4 16.exd4= Yemelin-Orlov, St Petersburg 2013) 14... fxe4 15. e2 e7= Grachev-Zakharov, Pardubice 2007) and now White has several options, including:

A) 11. xh7+?!.



analysis diagram

This sacrifice is dubious here: 11...♔xh7 12.♚h5+ ♔g8 13.♘g6 ♚e8 and now:

A1) 14.♘f3 (14.♚h8+ ♔f7 15.♘xf8 ♚xf8) 14...♘e7 15.f5? (15.♘fh4 ♘xg6 16.♘xg6 ♔f7? (16...f5) 17.0-0 (17.f5) 17...f5 Herzog-Kozio, Ortisei 2013) 15...exf5 16.♘fh4 (16.♘xd6 ♘xg6 17.♘xf8 ♚xe3+-) 16...♘xg6 17.♘xg6 ♚xe3+- Blatny-Iotov, Kusadasi 2006;

A2) 14.f5!? ♘xg3+ 15.hxg3 exf5 16.0-0-0 ♘e7 17.♘xe7+ ♚xe7 18.♚xf5 g6 19.♚xg6+ ♚g7 20.♚h5 f5.

B) White can also play 11.♘xd7 ♘xd7 12.0-0 (12.♚h5 g6 13.♚h6 b5 14.0-0 b4 Kotic-Caruana, Budapest 2007) 12...e5? 13.fxe5 fxe5 14.♚h5+- g6 15.♘xg6 hxg6 16.♚xg6+ ♔h8 17.♚h6+ ♔g8 18.♘h4 ♚e6 19.♘f6 1-0 Gongora-Del Valle, Alcudia 2010.

C) And finally there is 11.♘xc6 bxc6 12.0-0 e5 (12...f5 13.♚a4 ♘b6 14.♚a5= Summerscale-Berry, London 2011) 13.fxe5 fxe5 14.♚xf8+ ♘xf8 15.dxe5 ♘xe5= Rozhko-Kovalchuk, Taganrog 2013.

10...♘xd7?!

This natural move is dubious. If Black had foreseen what was going to happen he would have played 10...♚xd7, with the following variations:



analysis diagram

A) 11. ♖xd6 ♜xd6 12.dxc5 ♜xc5 13. ♖xh7+ (here this sacrifice is only sufficient for a draw) 13... ♜xh7 14. ♜h5+ ♜g8 15. ♗e4 g6 16. ♜g5 ♜e7! 17. ♗f6+ ♜g7 18. ♗h5+ ♜h7 19. ♗f6+ ♜g7 20. ♗h5+ ♜g8 ½-½ Heberla-Fier, Plovdiv 2013;

B) 11. ♜h5 g6 12. ♜h6 cxd4 13. ♖xd6 (13.exd4=) 13... ♜xd6 14. ♗f3 ♜e7 15.exd4 e5 16.dxe5 ♗g4= Sedlak-Tadic, Jahorina 2012;

C) 11. ♗f3 (11.dxc5 ♗xc5 12. ♗f3±) 11...h6 12. ♗e5 (12.dxc5 ♗xc5 13.0-0±) 12... ♗xe5 13.dxe5= Sean-Gupta, Kecskemet 2013;

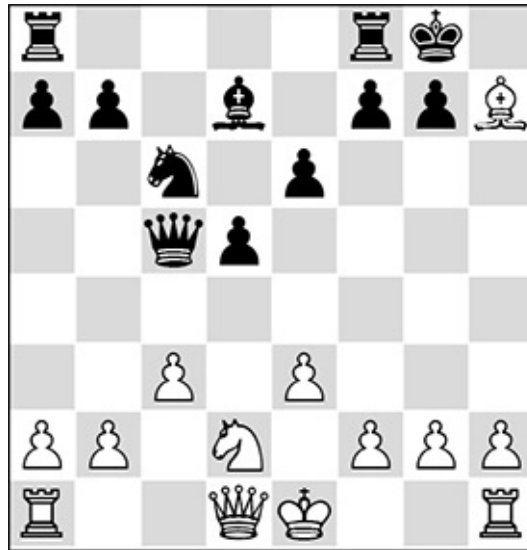
D) 11.0-0 b6 12. ♖xd6 ♜xd6 13.f4= Grischuk-Hammer, Stavanger 2015;

E) 11.dxc5! ♗xc5 12. ♗f3 ♜e7 (12... ♗d6 13.e4 ♗xg3 14.hxg3 dxe4 15. ♗xe4± Pakleza-Theodorou, Rethymno 2014) 13.e4?! (13.0-0!±) 13...f5∞ Heberla-Zajic, Plovdiv 2015.

11. ♖xd6! ♜xd6 12.dxc5! ♜xc5

This whole series of exchanges, which would appear to favour Black, is justified by the discovery on the next move. Black is now almost lost. In this position he should acquiesce to the loss of a pawn and play 12... ♜e7 13.b4 (13. ♗b3±; 13.0-0 a5 14.a4 e5± Karlik-Jasny, Czechia tt 2013/14) 13...b6? (13... ♜f6±) 14.cxb6? (14. ♗b3±) 14...axb6∞ Grachev-Ponkratov, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013.

13. ♖xh7+!!



This sacrifice was discovered by an unknown reader of ChessPublishing who called himself AlanG, and further analysed by GM Prié; the analysis engines have difficulty in finding it, but once it is pointed out to them they award White a clear advantage.

13... ♖xh7 14. ♗h5+ ♕g8 15. ♗e4 ♖c4

In one of my own games Black played 15... ♗b5, which is similar after 16. ♗g5 ♗fd8 (16... ♗fe8!? 17. ♗xf7+ ♕h8 18. ♗h5+ (18. ♗xd7 ♗e7 19. ♗d6 ♗xb2 20.0-0±, 18. ♗d1!? ♗xb2 19.0-0 ♗xc3 20. ♗xd7± Pham Le-Zatonskih, Istanbul 2012) 18... ♕g8 19.0-0-0±) 17. ♗xf7+ ♕h8 18. ♗h5+ ♕g8 19. ♗h7+ (19.0-0-0!+–) 19... ♕f8 20. ♗h8+ ♕e7 21. ♗xg7+ ♕d6 22. ♗f7+ ♕c7 23. ♗xd8 ♗xd8 24.0-0-0± De Prado-Rey, Spain tt 2013.

16. ♗g5 ♗fd8

If 16... ♗d3 17.e4 (1-0 E.Alvarez-Pellicer, Padron 2011). Black could have played on, but he is losing after 17... ♗fd8 18. ♗d1 ♖c4 19. ♗xf7+ ♕h8 20. ♗g6 ♕g8 21.f4. There is no salvation after 16... ♗fe8 17. ♗xf7+ ♕h8 18. ♗xd7± either.

17. ♗xf7+ ♕h8 18. ♗h5+ ♕g8



19. ♖f7+

Here 19. ♖d1! also works, as played by Kamsky in 2014 against the strong grandmaster Shankland. Strong players are still falling into this trap! The game continued 19... e5. No better are:

A) 19... d4 20. ♖f7+ (20. exd4) 20... ♔h8 21. h4 ♖d5 22. 0-0 ♖f5 23. ♖xf5 exf5 24. ♗f7+ ♔g8 25. ♗xd8 ♖xd8 26. exd4+– Nguyen Ngoc Truong Son-Kanep, Khanty-Mansiysk 2010;

B) 19... ♖xa2 20. 0-0 ♖xb2 21. f4 ♖c2 22. f5! exf5 23. ♖xd5, with a decisive attack;

C) 19... ♗e8 20. ♖h7+ ♔f8 21. ♖h8+ ♔e7 22. ♖xg7+ ♔d6 23. b3 ♖h4 24. g3 ♖h5 25. ♗e4 mate!

Kamsky's game continued 20. ♖f7+ ♔h8 21. e4! ♗e7 (if 21... ♗g4 22. f3 ♗c8 23. ♖xd5+–) 22. ♖xe7 ♗b5 23. ♖d2 ♖xa2 24. ♖f7 ♖a1+ 25. ♖d1 ♖xb2 26. ♖h5+ ♔g8 27. ♖h7+ ♔f8 28. ♖h8+ ♔e7 29. ♖xg7+ ♔d6 30. ♖xd5+ ♔c6 31. ♖f6+ 1-0 Kamsky-Shankland, Sturbridge 2014.

19... ♖h8 20. h4!

A very good move: White defends the knight and makes way for the rook via h3-f3.

20... ♗e5

If 20... ♗e8?? then 21. ♖f8++ 1-0 Tasic-Ratkovic, Paracin 2012; or if 20... ♖e8 21. ♖xd7 wins.

21. ♖h5+ ♔g8 22. 0-0-0!



The king is tucked away, the rooks are connected and the rook on the d-file is particularly active.

22... ♖xa2 23. ♗h7+ ♜f8 24. ♗h8+ ♜e7 25. ♗xg7+ ♜d6 26. ♗e4+ ♜c6 27. ♗xe5 ♜a1+
 Here 27...dxe4 fails to 28. ♜d6+ ♜c7 29. ♜a6+, with a decisive advantage.

28. ♜d2! ♗xb2+ 29. ♜e1 b6

Now 29...dxe4 loses to 30. ♜d6+ ♜c7 31. ♜d2++-.

The first game Prié played with this line, against Bonn in Rochefort 2008, ended with 29... ♜ac8 30. ♗d6 ♜c7 31. ♗c4 ♜c2 32. ♗d6+ 1-0.

30. ♗d6!

With the threat of 31. ♗f7 and 31. ♗d6+. White has an extra pawn, and a rather dangerous one at that, since the h-pawn is flying towards h8.

30... ♜a3 31.c4!



Another very accurate move. In this game Prié's play is at a high level, even if this line was part of his home preparation.

31... ♖b4+

Black loses his queen after 31... ♖xd6 32.cxd5+ exd5 33. ♖c1+ ♖c5 34. ♖xc5+, and wins.

32. ♖d2! ♖c5

Black is mated after 32... ♖b1+ 33. ♖e2 ♖xh1 34.cxd5+ ♖c7 35. ♗e8+ ♖b7 36. ♖c7+ ♖a6 37. ♖a2+ ♖b5 38. ♗d6+ ♖b4 39. ♖c4++.

33.h5

According to Prié, his preparation extended to here!

33... ♗e8 34.cxd5+ exd5 35. ♗f5

The pawn is flying and the black king is not safe. White should win this, of course, but Prié now made some inaccuracies and eventually the players agreed a draw:

35... ♖b7 36.h6 ♗a4 37. ♖g7+ ♖d7 38. ♖a1 ♗b5 39.h7 ♖c4 40.h8 ♖xh8 41. ♖xh8 d4 42. ♖h5 ♖d5 43.e4 ♖d7 44.e5 ♖a6 45. ♖d1 ♖e6 46. ♖c2 ♖xe5+ 47. ♖e2 ♖b8 48. ♖a2+ ♖b7 49. ♖e6 ♖f8 50. ♗d6+ ♖xd6 51. ♖e7+ ♖xe7 52. ♖xe7+ ♖c6 53. ♖xa7 ♖e6+ 54. ♖d1 ♗c4 55. ♖e1 ♖f6 56.f3 ♖g6 57. ♖g1 ♖e6 58. ♖a1

‘Now it is getting complicated and I did not want to lose control in time trouble’ (Prié).

58... ♖c5 59. ♖e1 ♖g6 60. ♖g1 ♖e6 61. ♖e1 ♖g6 62. ♖g1 ♖e6

½-½

SUMMARY

In this game we have seen one of the key positions of Black's defensive scheme with ... ♗d6. On the eighth move there are several options for Black. In this game, which is very famous, Black chose the line with 8... ♖e7, with the plan of ... ♗d7, to dislodge the white pieces from the strong square e5. White started a series of exchanges that appeared to favour Black, until White made the spectacular sacrifice 13. ♗xh7+!!, which refutes the variation... The sacrifice had been deeply investigated by Prié in his home analysis and he played well for much of the game, with some excellent moves, before making some inaccuracies and eventually agreeing a draw in time trouble. Even today strong players continue to fall into this trap.

Game 53

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Skopje 2015 (7)

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 ♘f6 3.♙f4 e6 4.e3 ♙d6 5.♙g3

Via another move order, White has tested the idea of a quick ♘e5 after 5.c3 c5 6.♘bd2 ♘c6 7.♘e5. This immediate knight leap promises White no advantage, as Hou Yifan demonstrated against Giri (the main line is 7.♙g3). Black continued with 7...♙c7 8.♘df3 0-0 9.♙d3 b6 10.♘xc6 ♙xc6= Giri-Hou Yifan, Wijk aan Zee 2016.

5...c5 6.♘bd2

The usual move order is 6.c3.

6...♘c6 7.c3 0-0

The alternative is 7...♙c7 8.dxc5 ♘xg3 9.hxg3 and now:

A) 9...e5 10.b4 (10.♙b5) 10...♙f5 11.♙b3 (11.♙b5 0-0 12.0-0 a6 13.♙xc6 bxc6 14.♘b3±) 11...0-0 12.♙b5 a6 13.♙xc6 bxc6 14.0-0 ♙d3 15.♙fe1 e4= Georgievski-Markovski, Skopje 2012;

B) 9...0-0 10.♙c2 h6 (10...e5 11.e4 d4 12.cxd4±) 11.b4 a5 12.♙b2±;

C) 9...a5 10.c4 ♘e5 11.cxd5 ♘xf3+ 12.♘xf3 ♙xc5 13.dxe6 ♙xe6 14.♙a4+ ♙d7 15.♙d4± Grischuk-Sethuraman, Berlin Wch blitz 2015.

8.♙d3



The usual move in this position: the bishop is usually placed on the b1-h7 diagonal, aiming towards Black's castled position and with possible sacrifices on h7 in mind. Recently, however, we have begun to see the move 8.♙b5, as played by Carlsen and Grischuk. The idea is to put pressure on the knight on c6 and

control the e5-square. Black has various options in reply:

A) 8...a6 9. ♖xc6 (9. ♖d3!? b6 10.e4 ♖e7 11.dxc5 bxc5 12.0-0= Grischuk-Karjakin, Berlin Wch blitz 2015) 9...bxc6 10. ♗e5 (10. ♖xd6 ♗xd6 11.0-0=; 10. ♗a4 ♖xg3 (10...cxd4 11. ♖xd6 ♗xd6 12.cxd4 a5 13.0-0 ♖a6 14. ♖fc1 ♖b5 15. ♗c2=) 11.hxg3± Vuilleumier-Tari, Reykjavik 2016) 10...♗c7 11. ♗d3 c4 12. ♖xd6 ♗xd6 13. ♗c5 e5 14.b3= Carlsen-Karjakin, Berlin Wch blitz 2015;

B) 8...♗c7 9.dxc5 ♖xg3 10.hxg3 e5 11. ♗c2 (11. ♗a4 e4 with compensation, Ortega-Ceresoli, Bratto 1996) 11...e4 12. ♗d4± Ni-Tari, Gibraltar 2016;

C) 8...♖xg3 9.hxg3 ♗b6 (9...♗d6 10. ♖xc6 bxc6= Nogueiras-Todorovic, Internet 2005) 10. ♖xc6 bxc6 11. ♗c2 ♖b8 12. ♖b1 cxd4 (12...g6 13. ♗e5 ♗d7 14.0-0 ♗xe5 15.dxe5 ♖a6 16. ♖fe1= Kamsky-Balakrishnan, Philadelphia 2015) 13.cxd4 ♖a6 14. ♗e5 ♖fc8 15.b4± Kamsky-Sevian, Chicago 2015;

D) 8...♗e7 9. ♖xc6 (9.0-0 ♖xg3 10.hxg3 ♖d7= Kayumov-Eljanov, Dubai 2014) 9...bxc6 10. ♗a4 ♖xg3 (10...cxd4 11.cxd4 ♖d7?! (11...♖xg3 12.hxg3 ♖b8=) 12. ♖xd6 ♗xd6 13.0-0± Nogueiras-Kunte, Mallorca 2004) 11.hxg3 cxd4 12.cxd4 ♖b8= Raznikov-Li, Dallas 2016;

E) 8...♗e7 and now:



analysis diagram

E1) 9.dxc5 ♖xc5 10. ♖d3 b6 11.0-0 ♖b7= Kramnik-Nakamura, Zurich 2016;

E2) 9. ♖d3 cxd4 (9...♗g6 10. ♗e5 b6 11.h4 ♖b7 12.h5 ♗e7 13. ♗f3∞ Kamsky-Li, Rockville 2015; or 9...a6 10.e4 dxe4 11. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 12. ♖xe4± Winants-Decoster, Belgium tt 2015/16) 10.exd4 b6 11.0-0 (11. ♖xd6 ♗xd6 12.0-0±) 11...♖b7 12. ♖e1 (12. ♖xd6±) 12...♖xg3 13.hxg3 ♗c8= Kamsky-Azarov, Las Vegas 2015.

8...b6

At present this is reckoned to be Black's best line, and it is the reason why some players with white have been switching to 8. ♖b5.

In previous games we looked at Black's other options, such as 8... ♗e7 or 8... ♗e8. Recently we saw a good win by Carlsen against 8... a6, as played by Yu Yangyi in the tiebreak of the Qatar Open.



White won in brilliant style with a kingside attack after 9. ♗e5 (9.e4±) 9... ♗e7 10.0-0 b6 11. ♗h4!? (11. ♗f4) 11... ♗f5 12. ♗g5 (12. ♗c6!? ♗c7 13. ♗xf6 gxf6 14. ♗h5! ♗b7 (14... ♗xc6 15.g4±) 15. ♗h1 ♗xc6 16.g4 ♗h8 17.gxf5 ♗g8=) 12...h6 13. ♗f4 ♗b7 14.h3 ♗e7 15.a4 ♗d6 16.f3 ♗d7 17. ♗e2 ♗f6 18. ♗h2 ♗c8 19. ♗ac1 a5 20.g4 ♗d8 21. ♗g2 ♗d7 22.f4 ♗c8 23. ♗ce1 cxd4 24.exd4 ♗a8 25.g5 hxg5 26.fxg5 ♗xe5 27. ♗xe5 ♗c4 28. ♗f3 ♗xe5 29. ♗xe5 ♗d6 30. ♗e2 g6 31. ♗g4 ♗g7 32.h4 ♗h8 33. ♗xe6! (a decisive sacrifice which destroys Black's kingside) 33...fxe6 34. ♗xe6 ♗e8 35. ♗xd6 ♗c6 36. ♗e5+ ♗xe5 37. ♗xe5 ♗xh4 38. ♗f7+ ♗g8 39. ♗a7 ♗c8 40. ♗xg6 ♗c6 41. ♗f7+ ♗f8 42. ♗g6+ 1-0 Carlsen-Yu Yangyi, Doha blitz 2015.

9.e4

A new attempt to improve White's play. The main line is 9. ♗e5 ♗b7, and now there are two main ideas:



analysis diagram

A) 10.0-0, perhaps the best move, according to the current state of theory. Black now has three options:

A1) 10... ♖c8, when White has tried:

A11) 11. ♗e2 ♜c7 12.f4 (12. ♘xc6 ♜xc6 13. ♙xd6 ♜xd6=) 12... ♘e7 13. ♗f3 ♘f5 14. ♙f2 ♙e7= Kotic-Korobov, Reykjavik 2015;

A12) 11.a4 ♘e7 (11... ♜e7 12.f4= Michna-Zawadzka, Porto Rio 2015) 12. ♙h4 (12.a5!?) 12... ♘g6 13. ♘xg6 hxg6= Michna-Zatonskih, Germany Frauenbundesliga 2015/16;

A13) 11. ♘xc6 ♙xc6 12. ♗e2 (12. ♙xd6 ♜xd6=) 12...c4 13. ♙c2 b5= Reich-Zelcic, Schwarzach 2014.

A14) 11.f4 (considered best) 11... ♘e7! (initiating the manoeuvre ... ♘e7-f5, ... ♙e7 and ... ♘d6, to control the e4-square, which enables Black to render the position harmless. This variation has become very popular for Black) 12. ♗b1 (other options: 12. ♗f3 ♘f5 13. ♙f2 ♙e7 14. ♗h3 (14. ♘g4 ♘xg4 15. ♗xg4 ♘d6= Dlugy-Zhigalko, Berlin Wch rapid 2015; 14.dxc5 bxc5 15. ♗h3=) 14... ♘e4 15. ♜ad1 ♜c7 16.g4 ♘fd6= Pham-Perena, Khanty-Mansiysk 2010; or 12. ♙h4?! ♘e4 13. ♙xe7 ♜xe7= Milanovic-Nabaty, Belgrade 2015) 12... ♜c7 13. ♙h4 ♘g6 14. ♙g5 ♜a8= Kamsky-Korobov, Antalya 2013.

A2) 10... ♜c7



analysis diagram

A21) 11.f4 and now:

A211) 11...♞e7 12.♞b1 (12.♞f3 ♞f5 13.♞f2 ♞e7 14.♞ad1 ♞ac8= Astasio-Barrenechea, Elgoibar 2015; 12.♞h4?! ♞e4 13.♞xe7 ♞xe7 14.♞xe4 dxe4 15.♞e2= Kayumov-Salgado, Dubai 2014; 12.♞c2 ♞g6 13.♞ae1 a6 14.♞df3 b5= Hoang-Kochetkova, Rijeka 2010) 12...♞g6 (12...g6 13.♞h4 ♞e8 14.♞e1 f6 15.♞ef3 ♞g7= Gholami-Krush, Doha 2015) 13.♞xg6 hxg6 14.♞h4= Kotic-Urkedal, Reykjavik 2015;

A212) 11...♞d7 12.♞h5!? (12.♞e2=, 12.♞h4=) 12...f5 13.♞e2 ♞f6 14.♞h4 ♞e4= Georgiev-Rauk, Puhajarve 2013.

A22) 11.♞xc6 ♞xc6 (11...♞xc6=) 12.♞xd6 ♞xd6 13.♞f3 c4 14.♞c2 b5 15.♞e5 Pezerovic-Werle, Bad Wörishofen 2016.

A3) 10...♞e7 and now White has various options:



analysis diagram

A31) 11.f4 ♖e4 12. ♕h4 f6= Ivanisevic-Pavlovic, Belgrade 2014;

A32) 11.a4 ♖e4 12. ♕xe4 dxe4 13.dxc5 bxc5 14. ♖dc4= Sandipan-Vaibhav, Bhubaneswar 2014;

A33) 11. ♖e2 a6 12. ♖ad1 ♖c7 13.f4 ♖e4= Lubbe-Ducarmon, Netherlands tt 2015/16;

A34) 11. ♖b1 g6 (11...a5 12. ♖e1 ♖c7 13.a4 g6= Saleh-Ehlvest, Dubai 2015) and now:

A341) 12. ♕h4 ♖g7 (12... ♖h5=) 13.e4?! (13.f4∞) 13...cxd4 14. ♕xf6+ (14.cxd4 ♕b4 15. ♕xf6+ ♖xf6 16. ♖df3 ♖g7=) 14... ♖xf6 15. ♖g4+ ♖g7 16.e5 h5= Zharebtsova-Iljiushenok, Moscow 2015;

A342) 12.f4 ♖f5 13. ♕f2 ♕e7 14.g4 ♖d6 15. ♕h4= Reyes-Torre, Quezon City 2014;

A343) 12. ♖ef3 ♖f5 13. ♕e5 ♕e7 14.h3= Kamsky-Arun, Rockville 2015.

A35) 11. ♖f3 ♖g6 (11... ♖c7 12. ♕f4 ♖g6 13. ♖xg6 hxg6= Gelle-Samu, Hungary 2012) 12.h4!? (12. ♖ad1=, 12. ♖xg6=) 12... ♕xe5?! (12... ♖e7=) 13.dxe5 ♖d7± Meier-Donchenko, Internet 2012.

B) 10.f4



analysis diagram

Once again, White's old standard plan. Karjakin played this line not long ago: 10... ♖e7! Once again Black employs the fashionable plan of ... ♖c6-e7-f5, ... ♗e7 and ... ♗d6, which promises a good position.

B1) 11. ♗f3 ♗f5 12. ♗f2 ♗e7! 13.g4 (it is more prudent to play 13.0-0 ♗d6 14.dxc5 (14. ♗h3 c4 15. ♗c2 ♗fe4= Burghoff-Galanov, cr Email 2011; 14. ♗h4 ♗fe4 15. ♗xe7 ♗xe7= Pezerovic-Postny, Bad Wiessee 2013) 14...bxc5 15. ♗h3 ♗c7= Böhme-Zidu, cr Email 2013) 13... ♗d6 14.g5 ♗fe4 15.0-0-0!? (White generally does not castle queenside in such lines, since Black's attack tends to strike first; White has also played 15.h4 ♗xd2 16. ♗xd2 ♗e4+ ♗ Mitkov-Borges, Toluca 2009, and 15. ♗h3 ♗f5 (15...cxd4 16.exd4 g6=) 16. ♗df3 ♗c8= Blatny-Zilka, Ostrava 2014) 15...c4?! (15...cxd4! 16.exd4 b5= seems better, Sodomski-Fedorov, cr Email 2011) 16. ♗c2 (it is also possible to play 16. ♗xe4 dxe4 17. ♗e2 b5 18.h4=; the main difference being that here the c-file is closed and so White is fine) 16...b5 17. ♗h3 (17. ♗xe4 dxe4 18. ♗g2= seems better) 17...b4! (now the black attack strikes first) 18. ♗xe4 dxe4 19. ♗e1 ♗d5?! (19...bxc3 20. ♗xc3 ♗b5= Petrusic-Derakhshani, Novi Sad 2016; 19...a5! ♗ 20. ♗g1? (20.cxb4!∞) 20...b3= Karjakin-Adams, Wijk aan Zee 2016.

B2) White has also tried 11. ♗b1 (better than 11. ♗c2?! c4 12. ♗e2 ♗f5 13. ♗f2= Andreikin-Karjakin, Baku 2015) and now:

B21) 11... ♗g6 12.0-0 (12. ♗xg6 hxg6 13. ♗h4 cxd4 14.cxd4 ♗b4 15. ♗d1 Sandipan-Kryvoruchko, Dubai 2014) 12... ♗h5 13. ♗e1 cxd4 14.cxd4 ♗f6 15.a3 ♗c8 Kamsky-Dreev, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013;

B22) 11...g6 12. ♗f2 (12. ♗h4 ♗f5=) 12...cxd4 (12...a5 13.0-0 ♗a6= Izoria-Brattain, Internet 2015) 13.exd4 ♗h5 14.g3 f6 15. ♗ef3= Grischuk-Wang,

Beijing 2014.

Back to the game!



9...Qe7!

Taking on e4 gives White the advantage after 9...dxe4?! 10.♘xe4 ♘xe4 11.♙xe4 ♙b7 12.dxc5! (12.♙a4 ♙c7 13.dxc5 bxc5± Burmakin-Iturrizaga, Barcelona 2013) 12...♙xc5 13.♙a4 ♙c8 14.♙d1 ♙e8?? (14...♙f6 15.0-0± Sedlak-Prusikin, Bavaria 2014).

We have reached a typical attacking position for the player of the London System.



analysis diagram

How should White continue here?

15. ♖xh7+!. Once again there is a thematic sacrifice on h7 and it wins: if 15... ♔xh7 then 16. ♕h4+ 1-0 Grachev-Gorodetzky, Minsk 2015. There is no defence against mate after 17. ♖g5.

10.e5!?

Trying to gain space. This is, without doubt, White's most ambitious move here. In general, the engines evaluate the black position as advantageous, but several strong grandmasters continue to play this move, even in longplay games, which leads me to think that in practical play the position is complex and playable for both sides.

White has also played:

A) 10.dxc5 bxc5 11.0-0 ♕b6= Burmakin-Urkedal, Manacor 2016;

B) 10. ♕c2 h6 (10...c4 11. ♖e2=) 11.0-0 cxd4 12.e5 ♖h5 13. ♖xd4 ♖xd4 14.cxd4= Van Foreest-Admiraal, Wijk aan Zee 2016;

C) 10.0-0 with equality;

D) The latest treatment of this position by London System specialist Gata Kamsky gave him a good position from the opening: 10. ♖e5 ♖xe5 (10... ♖b7 11. ♖xc6 ♖xc6 12.e5 ♖e4 13. ♖f4=) 11.dxe5! ♖xe4 12. ♖xe4 dxe4 13. ♖xe4 ♕xd1+ (13... ♖b8=) 14. ♖xd1 ♖b8 with a slight advantage to White, Kamsky-Nakamura, Saint Louis 2016.

10... ♖h5

The most common response in this position, hitting the white bishop on g3. If Black plays 10... ♖d7 the position resembles the French Defence and White would have excellent attacking possibilities on the kingside.

11.a3!?

A recent idea. White plays in a similar way to the Advance Variation of the French and prepares counterplay with b2-b4.

One of the greatest specialists of the London System in the world, Gata Kamsky, has tried other moves here, but without good results:

A) 11. ♕e2 ♖d7 12.a3 a5 13.0-0 c4 14. ♖c2 b5 ♠ Kamsky-Goryachkina, Gibraltar 2016;

B) 11.0-0 ♖d7 12. ♖e1 ♖xg3 (varying from the original game, in which Nakamura stood well after 12... ♖c8 13.a3 ♖xg3 14.hxg3 f5 ♠ Kamsky-Nakamura, Saint Louis 2015; what improvement did Kamsky have in mind? Perhaps 13. ♖f1) 13.hxg3 a5 14.a3 a4 15. ♖f1 b5 16. ♖e3 b4 ♠ Kamsky-M. Muzychuk, Gibraltar 2016.

11...a5 12. ♕e2 ♖a7!?



At the time, this move of Nakamura's was a novelty. Previously Black had played 12...c4 (12...♘b8 13.♘g5 ♙xg5 14.♙xh5 g6 15.♙e2= Kamsky-Taborsky, New York 2015; 12...g6 13.0-0 f5 14.exf6 ♙xf6 15.♙e3∞ Berkes-Demuth, Cappelle-la-Grande 2016) 13.♙c2 b5 14.♘g5! ♙xg5 15.♙xh5 g6 16.♙e2± Kramnik-Zhigalko, Berlin Wch rapid 2015, with good attacking chances; closing the queenside is dangerous.

'The rook move is a normal idea in the Orthodox set-up; the rook is activated along the second rank' – Jorge Luis Fernandez.

13.0-0

An alternative would be 13.♘f1, to develop the knight to e3, e.g.:



analysis diagram

A) 13...g6 14.h3 ♘xg3 15.♘xg3 c4 16.♙c2 b5 17.h4 b4 with complex play;

B) 13...c4 14. ♖c2 b5 and now:

B1) 15.h4 ♗xg3 16. ♗xg3 f6 17. ♕xh7+ (17. ♗g5 fxg5 18. ♖h5 g6 19. ♗xg6 ♕c5 20.hxg5 (20. ♕c2; 20. ♕b1 ♗xd4 21.hxg5 ♖c7 22.cxd4 ♕xd4 and Black wins) 20...hxg6 21. ♖h8+ ♖f7 22. ♖h7+ ♖e8 23. ♖xg6+ ♗af7 and Black wins) 17...♖xh7 18. ♗g5+ fxg5 19.hxg5+ ♖g8 20. ♗h8+ ♖f7 21. ♖h5+ g6 22. ♗h7+ ♖e8 23. ♖xg6+ ♖d7 and Black wins;

B2) 15. ♗g5 ♗xg5 16. ♖xh5 g6 17. ♖e2 ♕e7 (17...f5!? is interesting, e.g. 18.exf6 ♕xf6 19. ♗e3 (19.f4 b4 20.axb4 axb4 21. ♗xa7 ♗xa7 22. ♗e3 ♖a5 23. ♗g4 bxc3 24. ♗xf6+ ♗xf6 25.bxc3 ♖xc3+ 26. ♖d2) 19...e5 20.dxe5 ♗xe5 21. ♗d1 ♗d7 22.0-0 with equal chances) 18.h4 h5 19. ♕f4±.

But if 13. ♗g1 then 13...g6! and Black is better.

13...c4

Once White has castled, Black closes the queenside.

14. ♕c2 b5 15.h4!

White needs to seek counterplay on the kingside, since Black is winning the battle on the queenside.

15...g6?!



Inexplicably, Black does not exchange the bishop. It looks natural to play 15... ♗xg3! 16.fxg3 b4 17.axb4 axb4 18. ♗xc4!? (18. ♕a4±) 18... ♕a6 (18...dxc4 19. ♖e4±) 19. ♗xa6 ♗xa6 20. ♗e3, when White has a pawn for the exchange and attacking chances (20... ♖a8± Jorge Luis Fernandez).

16...f5 17.g4 g6 (17...fxg4 18. ♗g5 ♗xg5 19.hxg5 ♗xf1+ 20. ♗xf1 ♖xg5 21. ♖f2 ♖e7 22. ♖f4 with compensation) 18.g3 b4 with initiative (Jorge Luis Fernandez).

16. ♕h2!

An interesting pawn sacrifice; White preserves his bishop and prepares to dislodge the black knight. Now White's kingside attack can begin.

16... ♖xh4 17.g4

Tempting, but surely premature. Another way to play for White, and perhaps sounder, was 17. ♖xh4 ♗xh4 18. ♖f3 ♗d8 (18... ♗g4 19. ♗e3 f5 20.exf6 ♗xf6 21. ♖e5±; 18... ♗e7 19. ♗e3 f5 20.exf6 ♖xf6 21. ♗g5∞) 19.g4 ♖g7 20. ♗e3 (20. ♗g2± Jorge Luis Fernandez), with good compensation. The h-file is dangerous.

17... ♖g7 18. ♖xh4!?

It seems natural to eliminate the dark-squared bishop, but it was better to play 18. ♗e3!, which threatens moves like 19.g5, trapping the bishop, or 19. ♗h6. After 18... ♖e7 19. ♗g2 f5 20.exf6 ♖xf6 21. ♖g3 (21. ♗h1 e5! 22.dxe5 ♖e7 23. ♖g3 ♖e6 24. ♗h6 ♖c5∞ Jorge Luis Fernandez), with the plan of ♗h1, White has very good compensation, as well as an attack along the h-file.

18... ♗xh4 19. ♗g2 f5

The other option was 19...h5 20. ♗h1!? (20.f3 ♗g5 21. ♖g3∞) 20... ♗xg4+ 21. ♗xg4 hxg4 22. ♖d1 b4 23. ♖xg4 bxa3 24.bxa3 ♗b7 25. ♖f4 f6 (25...f5 26. ♖f3 with compensation) 26.exf6 ♗xf6 27. ♖g5 ♗f8 28. ♖f3 ♗b3 29. ♗h6 ♗xc3 30. ♗xg6 ♖f7 31. ♗h6, and White has compensation.

20.exf6 ♗xf6 21. ♖d6?!

A dubious move; the simple 21. ♖f3! was good, e.g. 21...e5 (21... ♗af7 22. ♖e5 ±) 22. ♖xe5 ♖xe5 23. ♖xe5 ♗g5 24.f3, with equality.

21... ♗ff7 22.f4?!



White wants to prevent ...e6-e5, but for this it was better to play 22. ♗e3, e.g.

A) 22...e5 23.dxe5 (23. ♖xe5? ♖xe5 24. ♗xe5 (24.dxe5 ♗h4 25.f3 ♖h5)

24... ♖xe5 25.dxe5 ♗xg4) 23... ♖d8 24.f3 ♗e6;

B) 22... ♖d8 23.♗e5 (23.♗c5 e5) 23... ♗xe5 24.dxe5 d4 25.cxd4 ♖ad7 26.f3 ♗b7.

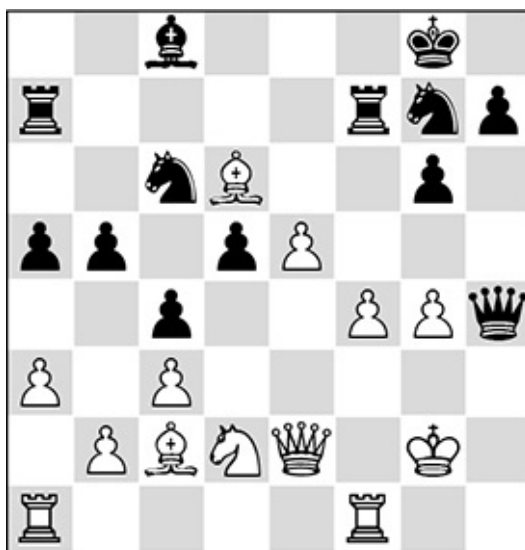
22...e5!

A good freeing move by Black: his bishop enters play and joins in the counterattack on the kingside.

23.dxe5

If 23.fxe5? then 23... ♖g5, or if 23.♗xe5? then 23... ♗xe5 24.dxe5 ♖h4 25.♖h1 ♖xg4+ 26.♖xg4 ♗xg4 27.♖g3 ♗f5.

23... ♖h4



24.f5!

White cannot defend g4 and so he hurries to complicate the play. If 24.♖h1 then 24... ♖xg4+ 25.♖xg4 ♗xg4 26.♖g3 ♗f5.

24...gxf5?

And it works, because Black immediately goes astray. The right move was 24... ♗xf5! 25.♗xf5 (not 25.gxf5? gxf5 26.♖g1 ♖g7+ 27.♖f3 f4, with a decisive attack for Black, or 25.e6 ♖g7 26.♗xf5 gxf5 27.♖f4 ♖g6!) 25...gxf5 26.♗f3 ♖xg4+ 27.♖f2 ♖g7 28.♖g1 ♖f4 29.♖e3! ♖xe3+ 30.♖xe3, when Black has the advantage, but White has drawing chances, thanks to his control of the dark squares.

25.♖h1 ♖d8

Here 25... ♖g5!? was interesting, e.g. 26.♗f3 ♖f4 (not 26... ♖xg4+? 27.♖f2±, with the idea of ♖g1, and White would have a dangerous attack) 27.♖h4 ♗e6 28.gxf5 ♖xh4 29.♗xh4 ♗f4+ 30.♖f2 ♗xe2 31.♖xe2∞; here White has very good compensation.

26.♖e3



26...d4!

A good move by Black, clearing the long diagonal h1-a8 in order to revive his bishop.

27.cxd4 ♖e8?

But Nakamura follows it up erroneously. Instead, 27...♙b7! was good, e.g.

A) 28.d5 ♖d4! 29.♙xd4 ♖e6! 30.♙e3 ♙xd5+ 31.♙h3!? (after 31.♙f2! f4 32.♙h3 ♙b6+ 33.♙f1 ♙d4 Black has very good compensation and the result should be a draw after 34.♙d1 ♙xb2 35.♙e4 ♖g5 36.♙h4 ♖xe4 37.♖xe4 ♙xe4 38.♙d8+ ♙g7 39.♙g5+ ♙h8 40.♙d8+ ♙g7 41.♙g5+) 31...f4 32.♙f2 ♙g7 33.♙hg1 f3! and again it seems that the most likely result will be a draw by perpetual check: 34.♙h2 ♙g5 35.♖xf3 ♙f4+ 36.♙g3 ♙h6+ 37.♙h3 ♙f4+ 38.♙g3=;

C) 28.♙f2!? is interesting, for instance 28...♖e7 29.d5 ♙xd5! 30.♙xa7 fxg4+ 31.♙g1 ♙xh1 32.♙xh1 ♖d5 33.♙xh7+! ♙xh7 34.♙xf7 ♙h4+ 35.♙g1 ♙g3+ 36.♙h1 ♙h3+ 37.♙g1 ♙g3+ with a draw; a fantastic variation, very difficult to see during the game.

28.♙h6?!

In time pressure both players slip up and the advantage keeps changing hands. Now it is Grischuk's turn to miss the best move: 28.♙c5! ♙ac7 29.♖f3 ♙g7 (29...fxg4? 30.♖g5+-) 30.♙ag1± 30...♙xg4+ (30...fxg4 31.♙h6 gxf3+ 32.♙f2+-) 31.♙f2 ♙cg7 (31...♙xg1 32.♙xg1+ ♙g7 (32...♙h8 33.♙h6 ♙g7 34.♙xg7 ♖xg7 35.♖g5+-) 33.♙h6 ♙c7 (33...♙xg1 34.♙f8+#) 34.♙xg7+ ♙xg7 35.♙xc6+- or 34...♖xg7 35.♖g5+-) 32.♙xg4 ♙xg4 (or 32...fxg4) 33.♙h6+-.

The move 28.d5!? was also good, e.g. 28...♖xd6 (28...f4 29.♙c5 ♖xd6 30.♙xc6±) 29.dxc6 ♖e8 30.♖f3±.

28... ♖g7 29. ♖g1 ♖ad7?!

It was better to play 29... ♖xg4+! 30. ♔f1 ♖xg1+ 31. ♕xg1+ ♖g7 32. ♕e3 ♕e7 and once again Black is better.



30.d5?

Here 30. ♔f1! was good, e.g. 30... ♕xd6 31. exd6 ♕f8 (31... ♖xd6 32. ♖xd6 ♕xd6 33. ♕e8+ ♕f8 34. ♕xc6+–) 32.d5 ♕d8 33. gxf5±.

30... ♕e7 31. ♕xe7 ♖dxe7 32. ♕d4 ♕b7?

Here it was better to play 32... ♖xg4+ 33. ♔f1 ♖eg7 34. ♖xg4 ♖xg4 35. ♕f2 ♕xd5 36. ♕xf5 ♕xf5 37. ♕xf5 ♕g2+ 38. ♔e1 ♕g1+ 39. ♕f1 ♕d4±.

33. ♕f2 ♕xd5 34. ♕xd5+ ♕xd5 35. ♕xf5 ♖xe5 36. ♖e1!

After these exchanges the position levels out.

36... ♖xe1 37. ♕xe1 b4 38. axb4 axb4 39. ♕e6+

White should draw without difficulty after 39. ♕f1! c3 40. bxc3 bxc3 41. ♕e3 ♖e7 42. ♕f2 ♕b3 43. ♖b6=.

39... ♕xe6 40. ♖xe6 ♕c7?!

And the draw was agreed, in view of 41. ♖c6 ♕d5 42. ♖xc4 with an easy draw. Black had a better option in 40... ♕f7! 41. ♖c6 ♖xg4 42. ♕xc4 ♖h4; even though this should also end in a draw, Black should have chosen this continuation.

A great fighting game, very complicated, and one in which both sides had winning chances. And some people say that the London System is boring!

SUMMARY

We have seen a game in which White tried the idea of 9.e4, instead of the

more usual 9. ♖e5, which recently Black has been countering successfully with the manoeuvre ... ♖c6-e7-f5, ... ♗e7 and ... ♖d6, in order to control e4, as in the game between Karjakin and Adams from Wijk aan Zee 2016. To combat this particular line White has also been testing 8. ♗b5, instead of 8. ♗d3, as can be seen in the annotations. The idea of e4-e5 is reminiscent of some positions from the Advance Variation of the French Defence. In the game White sacrificed a pawn on the kingside and complicated the play, since Black had the upper hand on the queenside. White obtained very good compensation and attacking chances along the half-open h-file, but then in time pressure and in a very complex position, the advantage changed hands several times. Finally it all ended in a very hard-fought and entertaining draw.

Game 54

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Gata Kamsky

2673

Aleksey Goganov

2575

Moscow 2016 (8)

1.d4 d5 2. ♗f4 ♖f6 3.e3 c5 4. ♖f3

An interesting alternative for White is to delay the development of the king's knight and play an early f2-f4 after 4. ♖d2 ♖c6 5.c3 e6 6. ♗d3 ♗d6 7. ♗xd6 (7.dxc5 ♗xc5=) 7... ♙xd6 8.f4.



analysis diagram

White is trying to set up the attacking formation known as the Stonewall Attack, but having first exchanged his 'bad' bishop. Now:

A) 8...♙d7 9.a3 0-0 10.♗gf3 cxd4 11.cxd4 ♘e7 12.0-0 (12.♗e5 ♙b6 13.♙b3± Romero Holmes-Zambrana, Bogota 2010) 12...♙c6 13.♗e5 ♗d7 14.♙h5 f5± Kamsky-Wang Yue, Beijing blitz 2013;

B) 8...cxd4 9.cxd4 0-0 (Black has also played 9...♙b4 10.♖b1 ♗e4 11.♙xe4 dxe4 12.a3 ♙a5 13.♗e2± Moran-Harper, Bridgetown 2009, and 9...♗b4 10.♙e2 (10.♙b1=) 10...♙b6 (10...0-0=) 11.♙b3 ♙d7 12.a3 ♗c6 13.♙xb6 axb6± Kovacevic-Beliavsky, Plovdiv 1983) 10.a3 ♗e7 11.♗gf3 ♙b6 12.♙b3 ♙xb3 13.♗xb3 b6= Kramnik-Grandelius, Stavanger 2016.

4...♗c6 5.♗bd2



An interesting move order, directed against the thematic ...♙b6.

5...e6

White's idea against the annoying 5...♙b6 is to play 6.dxc5! ♙xc5 (6...♙xb2 7.♖b1 ♙c3 (7...♙xa2 8.♙b5 with compensation) 8.♙b5 e6 (8...♙xc5 9.0-0 with compensation, Genga-Palm, cr Email 2013) 9.0-0 ♙e7 10.♗e5 ♙xc5 11.c4 with compensation, Böhme-Büttner, Email 2013) 7.a3 (7.♙e2 ♙f5 8.c3 ♙b6 9.♙b3± Torre-Abelgas, Olongapo City 2015) 7...♙f5 (7...♙g4±) 8.c4 e6 9.b4 ♙b6 10.c5± Kramnik-Cheparinov, Berlin Wch blitz 2015.

6.c3 ♙d6 7.♙g3 0-0 8.♙d3

We looked at the alternative 8.♙b5 in the previous game.

8...b6 9.♙e2

Gata Kamsky applies an interesting idea, which is not new, however. In the previous game we saw the move 9.e4 and we are also familiar with the traditional move 9.♗e5.



9...Qb7 10.Qd1?

A quiet move, awaiting events and delaying castling. Practice has also seen here 10.dxc5?! bxc5 11.e4 Qe7 12.e5? Qh5 Sandipan-Karjakin, Dubai 2014.

Castling is also possible: 10.0-0 Qc7 11.dxc5 bxc5 12.e4 (12.Qxd6 Qxd6 13.e4=) 12...Qxg3 13.hxg3 Radjabov-Leko, Beijing 2014, as well as the normal 10.Qe5 Qc7 11.f4 Qe7 12.Qf3 Qf5 13.Qf2 Qe7 14.Qh3 Qe4 15.g4 Agrest-Cuenca, Sweden tt 2015/16.

10...Qe8

Black has also played 10...Qe7 11.e4 dxe4 12.Qxe4 Qxe4 13.Qxe4 Sergeev-Van den Doel, Delft 2014, and 10...cxd4 11.exd4 Qe7 12.0-0 Qf5 13.Qe5 Maksimenko-Schwabeneder, Austria Bundesliga 2015/16.

11.e4

But this is a new idea at this point. Kamsky decides to play e3-e4 under more favourable conditions. In another game White had played 11.dxc5 Qxc5 (11...bxc5) 12.e4 a5 (12...Qh5=) 13.Qh4 Qe7 14.e5 Qd7 15.Qxe7 Qxe7 16.0-0= Sandipan-Travesset, Benasque 2014.

11...Qe7

The thematic retreat, as in several other lines. If 11...e5!? then 12.dxc5 Qxc5 13.0-0.

12.e5!?

This is a move which, in general, the engines dislike, but it is a natural one, since it gains space. 12.0-0= is also playable.

12...Qh5 13.a3

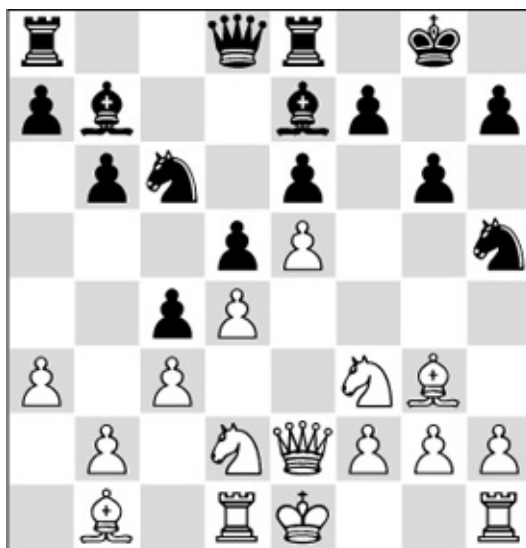


To control the b4-square, as in the previous game between Grischuk-Nakamura. The main differences are that the rook on e8 does not seem to be very well situated and White has not castled yet. These differences are important, as we shall soon see.

13...c4!?

Closing the queenside does not look the best option. Perhaps Black should have played 13...a5, with the idea of ...♔c8 and ...♕a6, or 13...♖c8, with a complex position and possibilities for both sides.

14. ♖b1 g6



15. ♗f1!

Kamsky takes the opportunity to improve his pieces and he still delays castling. 15.h4 was also interesting.

15...b5 16.♘e3 a5 17.♘g4

As a result of White's precise knight manoeuvre, he now has the advantage. The knight reaches a more active square and menaces the enemy's castled position.

17...b4 18.♙e3!

Another good and thematic move, to bring the queen to the kingside. Black is focusing on the queenside, while White is directing his forces towards the black king.

18...bxc3 19.bxc3 ♖b8

The black bishop has to wait patiently on e7, because otherwise the dark squares on Black's kingside would be vulnerable to a future ♕h4 by White, followed by an eventual g2-g4.

Thus, capturing the pawn would lose: after 19...♕xa3? 20.♘h6+ ♔g7 (or 20...♔f8 21.♕h4 ♕e7 22.g4! ♕xh4 23.gxh5, with a decisive advantage; White threatens 24.♙f4, among other things) 21.♕h4 ♕e7 22.♕xe7 ♘xe7 (22...♙xe7 23.g4+–) 23.g4, White wins a piece. Or if 19...♔h8 then 20.♕f4 ♕xa3 21.♕h6±, with a strong attack and advantage to White.

20.♕f4!



Kamsky handles the attack with great precision; he now improves the bishop, to include it in the attack.

20...♗c8

The exchange 20...♘xf4 21.♙xf4 would leave White with a strong attack and a practically decisive advantage. It is curious how the black knight is the king's main defender. White would quickly play h2-h4 and ♙h6.

21.♕g5

It is normal to want to exchange the dark-squared bishops, but it also was good

to play 21. ♖h6+ ♔g7 22.h4, with a strong attack for White.

21... ♜b3

Black continues with his own play on the queenside, but the danger is in the other wing. It was better to defend with 21... ♔h8 but White is better after 22.h4.

22.h4

Again 22. ♖h6+ was playable, with great advantage to White.



22... ♜b6?

Another mistake, removing this powerful piece from the king's 'security zone'.

I do not think that it would have saved Black, but 22... ♜f8 was better, e.g. 23. ♖h6+ ♔h8 (23... ♔g7 24.g4 f6 25.gxh5 fxg5 26.hxg6 hxg6 27. ♖xg5 ♖xd4 28. ♗xd4 ♗xh6 29. ♗g4±) 24.g4 ♖g7 25. ♕xe7 ♗xe7 (25... ♖xe7 26. ♖g5 ♗e8 27.h5) 26. ♖g5 ♖d8 and now:

A) 27. ♖xh7!? ♜xb1 (27... ♔xh7 28.h5+–) 28. ♖xf8 ♜xd1+ 29. ♔xd1 ♗xf8 30.h5±.

B) 27.h5±; or

C) 27. ♕c2 ♜b2 (27... ♜xa3 28.h5+– or 27...a4 28. ♖xh7+–) 28. ♗c1 ♜a2 (28... ♜xc2 29. ♗xc2+–) 29. ♖xh7 ♜xc2 30. ♗xc2 ♔xh7 31.h5 with a decisive attack.

23. ♕c2!?

Here White could play 23. ♖d2! (or 23. ♖h6+ first) 23... ♜xa3 24. ♕xe7 ♖xe7 25. ♖h6+ ♔g7 (25... ♔f8 26.g4 ♖g7 27. ♗f4+– (27.h5+–; 27. ♖f3+–)) 26.g4, with a decisive advantage.

23... ♜xa3

Here 23... ♕f8 was a better defence, but after 24.0-0 (24. ♕xb3 cxb3±) 24...

♖xa3 25. ♕f6 White would again have a decisive attack.

24. ♕xe7 ♖xe7

If 24... ♖xe7 then 25. ♔h6 wins, with the threat of 26. ♖g5.

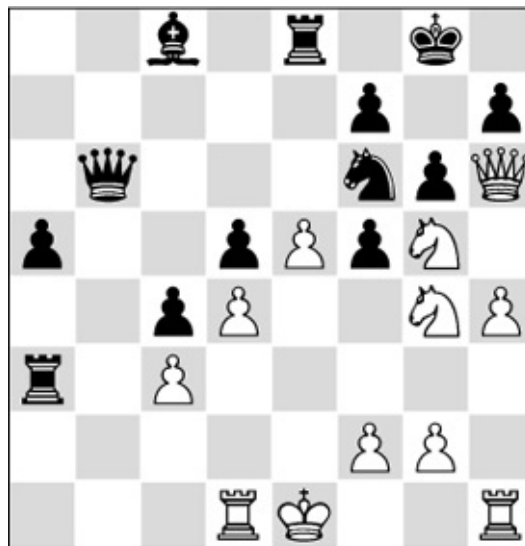
25. ♔h6



Finally White's attack is decisive. There is no good defence against the threat of 26. ♖g5.

25... ♖f5 26. ♕xf5 exf5 27. ♖g5 ♖f6!?

If 27... ♕e6 28. ♔xh7+ ♖f8 29. ♖h6.



28. ♖e3!

With the unstoppable threat of 29. exf6 and 29. ♖xd5; this is stronger than 28. ♖xf6+ ♔xf6 29. ♔xh7+ ♖f8 30. f4 ♔g7±.

28... f4 29. ♖xd5! ♔d8 30. 0-0!

It is very satisfying and creates a sensation of aesthetic beauty to win by castling so late, and indeed on the very last move of the game. With this move White forces resignation. If 30... ♖xd5 (30... ♗xd5 31. ♖xh7+ ♔f8 32. ♖xf7 mate) then 31.exf6, mating.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw a new idea of Kamsky's, 9. ♖e2 and 10. ♖d1, in one of the critical and currently most popular lines of the London System.

Kamsky's idea is to delay castling and then to play in a similar fashion to the course of the game between Grischuk and Nakamura. The dubious 13... c4 is worth highlighting; Black should not close the queenside.

Kamsky's manoeuvre ♗d2-f1-e3-g4, followed by ♖e3/♗f4, gave him a great advantage and very good attacking chances against the black king. Finally Black's counterplay on the queenside proved futile and White won with a mating attack. A good game and a model for how to conduct White's attack in this type of position.

Game 55

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Magnus Carlsen

2844

Evgeny Tomashevsky

2728

Wijk aan Zee 2016 (6)

1.d4 ♗f6 2. ♗f3 e6 3. ♗f4 b6

Here we have a London System which is heading towards... a Queen's Indian?

4.e3 ♗b7 5.h3

As I am sure many players of the London System are aware, this is a 'slight inaccuracy' in the move order; the move h2-h3 should be played only after Black has played ... ♗e7.

5... ♗e7

The move 5... ♗d6! (=) is the way to 'punish' White for the premature 5.h3; now White must exchange on d6, since the move ♗g3 is not available with the pawn on h3: 6. ♗xd6 cxd6 7.c4 d5 8. ♗c3 0-0 9. ♖c1= Prié-Eingorn, France tt 2007.

6. ♗d3 0-0 7.0-0 c5 8.c3 ♗c6

The usual choice would be 8...cxd4 9.cxd4 (9.exd4) 9... ♗c6 (9...d6, followed by ... ♗bd7, is the most popular, in the style of the Queen's Indian) 10.a3.

9. ♖bd2



9...d5!?

But Tomashevsky switches to the main line of the Queen's Gambit set-up, with ...♕e7, instead of continuing in Queen's Indian fashion. In particular I think that it is better for Black to play ...d7-d6, since this is a more flexible set-up. The systems with ...d7-d5 are particularly hard on the b7-bishop and although they can be more solid, I think that they considerably reduce Black's possibilities of active play. The normal alternative was 9...d6, or 9...cxd4 10.exd4 d6.

10. ♖e2

An interesting move; White controls the f1-a6 diagonal and supports a possible e3-e4. Practice has also seen:

A) 10.a4 ♕d6 11.♕g5 (11.♕xd6 ♖xd6=) 11...h6 12.♕h4 ♕e7 13.♖e5 ♖xe5 14.dxe5 ♖d7= Kamsky-Almasi, Beijing 2011;

B) 10.♕h2 ♕d6 11.♖e5 ♖c7 12.f4 ♖d7 13.g4 f6 14.♖xd7 ♖xd7 15.♖f3∞ Sanikidze-Petriashvili, Ureki 2015;

C) 10.♖e1 ♖h5 11.♕h2 ♕d6 12.dxc5 bxc5 13.♕xd6 ♖xd6= Lelenko-Yloenen, cr Email 2013;

D) The knight move 10.♖e5 is normal; e5 is one of the key squares in these set-ups:



analysis diagram

D1) 10... ♖xe5 11. ♕xe5 (11.dxe5 ♘d7 (11... ♗e4!?) 12. ♔g4 ♜e8 13. ♗f3 f5?! (13... ♔c7=) 14.exf6 ♕xf6± Lazic-Postny, Lodi 2006) 11...c4 12. ♕c2 b5 13. ♜e1 ♗e4= Zuluaga-Leitao, Mar del Plata 2012;

D2) 10... ♗d7 11. ♗xc6 ♕xc6 12.a4 a5 13. ♔e2 ♗f6 14. ♗f3 ♕b7 15. ♕b5 ♔c8= Vachier-Lagrave-Caruana, Biel 2010.

10... ♕d6

If Black is intending to play this way it is better to do so directly with ...d7-d5 and ...♕d6, without losing a tempo, although admittedly in these closed positions the lost tempo is not very noticeable.

Practice has also seen:

A) 10... ♜c8 11. ♜ad1 ♗h5 12. ♕h2 c4 13. ♕c2= Grachev-Frolyanov, Sochi 2015;

B) 10...h6 11. ♜ad1 ♕d6 12. ♕xd6 ♔xd6 13.e4 ♔c7 (13...dxe4? 14. ♗xe4 ♗xe4 15. ♔xe4± Sergeev-Leniart, Katowice 2014) 14.e5 ♗d7 15. ♔e3 a5 16. ♕b1 ♕a6 17. ♜fe1 ♜fc8∞ Kamsky-Castellanos, Cappelle-la-Grande 2016. Gata Kamsky managed to win a good game with a kingside attack.



11. ♖fe1!?

This move is a new one in over-the-board games; two Email games are the only others played with this line. White has also tried:

A) 11. ♖e5 ♜c7 12. ♖df3 ♜e7= Yurtseven-Sanal, Antalya 2013;

B) 11. ♙xd6 ♜xd6 and now:

B1) 12.e4 dxe4 13. ♖xe4 ♜xe4 14. ♜xe4 f5 15. ♜e3 cxd4 16.cxd4 ♜f6∞;

B2) 12. ♙a6 ♜xa6 13. ♜xa6 e5 14.dxe5 ♜xe5 15. ♖xe5 ♜xe5 16.a4= Ravi-Babujian, Hyderabad 2013;

B3) 12.dxc5 ♜xc5 (12...bxc5!? looks interesting, e.g. 13.e4 ♜d7 14.exd5 exd5 15. ♖fe1 ♜f6= Potkin-Kurnosov, Moscow 2010) 13. ♙a6 ♜xa6 14. ♜xa6 e5 15. ♖fd1 Pirard-Hautot, Belgium tt 2014/15.

C) 11. ♙g5 h6 12. ♙h4 ♜e7 13. ♙g3 ♜d7 (13...a5 14. ♖fe1 ♜c8 15. ♖ad1 ♜a6= Umetsubo-Leitao, Joao Pessoa 2013) 14. ♖ad1 ♜e8 15.a3 a5 16.e4 ♜c8 17. ♖fe1± V.Georgiev-Quesada, Merida 2006;

D) 11. ♖fd1 ♜e8 12. ♙xd6 ♜xd6 13.e4 ♜f4 14.e5 ♜d7 15. ♖f1 f6 16.exf6 ♜xf6 17. ♙b5= Sergeev-Zelbel, Austria Bundesliga B 2013/14.

11... ♜e7



This is the first new move, although we have seen this manoeuvre to bring the knight to the kingside before.

In the Email games mentioned Black had played 11... ♔xf4 12.exf4 cxd4 13. ♖xd4 ♖xd4 14.cxd4 ♗d6 15.g3 (15. ♗e3 ♖ac8 16.a3 ♖fe8 17. ♖ac1= Carvalho-Damigo, cr Email 2008) 15... ♖ac8 16. ♖ac1 ♗d7 17. ♔g2= Leimgruber-Dmitriev, cr Email 2013. We can infer that Carlsen was relying on this type of structure to put pressure on the black position, thanks to his better bishop. How, though? Perhaps it is better to play 17. ♖f3 immediately and answer 17... ♖e4 with 18. ♖g5!?

12. ♖ad1

White maintains the tension. If 12. ♔xd6 ♗xd6 13.e4 then 13... dxe4 14. ♖xe4 ♖xe4 15. ♔xe4 ♔xe4 16. ♗xe4 cxd4 17. ♖ad1, with a balanced game.

12... ♖g6

The knight finally reaches g6, but it seems simpler for Black to play 12... ♔xf4 13.exf4 ♖c8 14. ♖f1 ♗c7 15.g3=.

White is more comfortable, with his greater control of the dark squares.



13. ♖xg6!

A decision with the Carlsen stamp on it. It is unusual for White to exchange this bishop, which is usually his most dangerous piece, aiming towards h7. Carlsen rules out any attack (seemingly) and plans to leave himself with a good knight vs. a bad bishop, with a view to the endgame. This knight will be strong on e5 because after the exchange on g6 it can hardly be evicted by ...f7-f6.

13...hxg6 14. ♖xd6 ♜xd6 15. ♗e5 g5!?



A questionable move, since it is not usually good to move the pawns in front of the castled position. Obviously Black was afraid of f2-f4 or h3-h4, bolstering the knight on e5, and is trying to prevent that. An alternative was 15...♞e7, with a balanced game.

16. f4!

But Carlsen plays the move f2-f4 anyway. 16. ♖f3± was also possible.

After Black's dubious advance with 15...g5 Carlsen is once again thinking about an attack!

16...gxf4 17. ♖f1!

The key to the previous idea: White brings the rook to the f-file, where it will be much more dangerous, although logically Carlsen had to calculate thoroughly the consequences of the capture on e3.

If 17.exf4 cxd4 18.cxd4 ♖ac8=.

17... ♗d7

A prudent move. In the event of 17...fxe3 White would play...



analysis diagram

18. ♖xf6! was Carlsen's plan when he played 16.f4. This sacrifice promises a strong initiative, and although it does not win by force it presents difficulties to the defender:

A) 18...gxf6? loses after 19. ♖g4+, e.g.:

A1) 19... ♖h7 20. ♖f1! fxe5 (20...f5 21. ♖h4+ ♖g7 22. ♖g5+ ♖h7 23. ♖f4 and mate, or 20...e2 21. ♖xe2 fxe5 22. ♖h5+ ♖g8 23. ♖g5+ ♖h7 24. ♖f6, mating) 21. ♖f6! exd2 22. ♖h5+ ♖g7 23. ♖g5+ ♖h7 24. ♖h6 mate;

A2) 19... ♖h8 20. ♖f1! exd2 21. ♖f4, again with a mating attack after 21... d1 ♖+ 22. ♖xd1 ♖xe5 (22... ♖g8 23. ♖h5+ ♖g7 24. ♖g4+ ♖f8 25. ♖xf7 mate, or 22...fxe5 23. ♖h5+ ♖g7 24. ♖g4+ ♖f6 25. ♖g5 mate) 23.dxe5 ♖g8 24. ♖h5+ ♖g7 25. ♖xf6 with unstoppable mate once again.

B) 18...cxd4 19.cxd4 exd2 20. ♖f4! f6 21. ♗g6 ♖fc8 22. ♖xd2 – White is better and has attacking chances;

C) 18...exd2 19. ♖xd2 ♖e7 (19...gxf6 20. ♖g4+ ♖h7 21. ♖f2!) 20. ♖f4 ♖g5

21. ♖g4 ♜h6 22.dxc5 bxc5 23.♜f2 d4 24.cxd4 ♖ad8 25. ♖h4 ♜g5



analysis diagram

And here White has an elegant combination: 26. ♜xf7+! ♖xf7 27. ♖h8+ ♜xh8 28. ♜xf7+ ♜g8 29. ♜xg5 ♖xd4 30. ♖xd4 cxd4 31. ♜xe6, with a very advantageous endgame.

18. ♜h5!?

Another option was 18. ♜xd7 ♜xd7 19. ♖xf4 f6 20. ♖h4±.

18... ♜f6

If 18...fxe3? then 19. ♜xf7+-. But 18...cxd4! was fine, e.g. 19. ♜xd7 (19.exd4 ♜xe5 20.dxe5 ♜c5+ 21. ♖f2 ♜a6=) 19...♜xd7 20.exd4, with no more than a very slight advantage to White. He has pressure along the f-file and threats along the h-file; Black's defence is difficult, but possible: he should play 20...f6! (after 20...♜d6 the knight manoeuvre 21. ♜f3!? f6 22. ♜h4 is interesting) 21. ♖xf4 ♜a6!?.

19. ♜h4 ♜d8

If 19...fxe3 then once more 20. ♖xf6! wins, for example:

- A) 20...exd2 21. ♖xd2 gxf6 22. ♖d3+-;
- B) 20...gxf6 21. ♜g4+ ♜h8 22. ♖f1!+-;
- C) 20...♜d8 21. ♜g4+-;
- D) 20...♜e7 21. ♜g4! exd2 22. ♖xd2+- (or 22. ♜h6+! gxf6 23. ♖xd2+- (23. ♖g6+ fxf6 24. ♜xe7+-) 23... ♖fe8 24. ♖d3, and wins).

20. ♖xf4 ♜e4?

It is understandable that Black wanted to exchange queens and simplify, but now he is going to be clearly worse in the endgame, since a white rook will invade the seventh rank.

It was necessary to exchange on d4 first, thanks to a strategic detail: 20...cxd4! 21.exd4 ♖e4 and now if White continues as in the game with 22.♗xe4 ♜xh4 23.♞xh4 dxe4 the d-file remains closed to White's rook. Instead, White can keep an edge with 22.♞g4 f5 23.♞g6 ♜f6 24.♞h5, since the e5-knight is better than the b7-bishop; nevertheless, Black would still be in the game.

21.♗xe4 ♜xh4

If 21...dxe4? then 22.♞h5! f6 23.♗g6+–.

22.♞xh4 dxe4



23.dxc5! bxc5 24.♞d7±

This is the difference; because Black failed to exchange on d4 first, White will now be able to occupy the seventh rank; furthermore Black's pawns are weak.

24...♞ab8 25.b3 a5 26.♞c7 a4!?

Desperation; but passive defence with e.g. 26...♞a8 27.♞f4 ♞b7 (or 27...f5 28.♞h4+–, with the idea of ♗g6 and ♞h8 mate) 28.♞xc5 would leave White with a comfortable advantage.

27.bxa4 ♞a8 28.a5 ♞b7 29.♞xc5 ♞a7 30.♗c4

And here Tomashevsky decided to resign, in view of the futility of any defence. Of course, he could have carried on for a while, for example with 30...♞d8 31.♞f4 (or 31.♗b6 f5 32.♞f4 ♞f7 33.♞f2 ♞d3 34.♞e2+–) 31...f5 32.♞f2, but the result would be the same.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw a variation where Black plays ...♞e7 instead of ...♞d6, arising from a different move order. The game began as a Queen's

Indian (subsequently Black decided to play 9...d5). Black ended up playing ...♕d6 just the same, losing a tempo; this is hardly noticeable in a closed position, but still, if Black wants to play ...♕d6 it is preferable to do so directly. Carlsen employed a very interesting idea, exchanging his 'good' bishop on d3 for the knight on g6. There are few players who would have made such a move. Then he found a way to open the position on the kingside by sacrificing with f2-f4 and ♖f1. White had in mind a decisive exchange sacrifice on f6. Tomashevsky defended himself as best he could, until he made an error, failing to exchange pawns on d4 before offering the exchange of queens. Carlsen exploited this mistake by going into a very superior endgame. He was able to invade the seventh rank and soon won two pawns, after which his opponent resigned.

Game 56

...d7-d5 with an early ...e7-e6

Pereyra Attack

Kiril Georgiev

2648

Tonu Rauk

2207

Puhajarve 2013 (32)

1.d4 ♟f6 2.♟f3 e6 3.♟f4 c5 4.e3 d5 5.c3 ♟d6

Here the thematic 5...♟b6 is playable, e.g. 6.♟b3 ♟c6 7.♟bd2 ♟e7 8.h3 0-0 9.♟e2 ♟d7 10.0-0 (10.♟xb6 axb6 11.♟c7 ♟d8= Grachev-Kamsky, Moscow 2008) 10...♟fd8? (10...♟fc8 11.♟fe1 ♟e8 (11...h6 12.♟h2±) 12.♟ad1 (12.♟d3 c4 13.♟xb6 axb6 14.♟c2= E.Alvarez-Lobo, Gijon 2005) 12...♟a5?! 13.♟xb7 (13.dxc5±) 13...c4= Vysochin-Rublevsky, Internet 2004) 11.♟xb6 axb6 12.♟c7!± De Prado-Lorenzo, Ferrol 2013.

Another option is 5...♟c6 6.♟bd2 cxd4 7.exd4 ♟h5!? 8.♟g5 (8.♟e3±) 8...♟e7 9.h4!? (9.♟xe7 ♟xe7 10.♟b5±) 9...h6 10.♟xe7 ♟xe7 11.♟e5± De Prado-Espieira, Spain tt 2014.

6.♟g3 0-0

Another option here is 6...♟c6 7.♟d3 (7.♟bd2) 7...♟xg3 8.hxg3 ♟d6 9.♟bd2 b6 10.♟e2 ♟b7 11.0-0-0 0-0-0 12.e4± De Prado-Wegerle, Portugal tt 2010.

7.♟bd2 b6

The normal move order would be 7...♟c6 8.♟d3 b6.



A) Here the main move is 9. ♖e5 (9.0-0 ♜xg3 10.hxg3 ♜b7 11.a3 ♞d6 Eljanov-Gelfand, Moscow 2008) 9... ♜xe5?! (9... ♞c7 10.f4 ♜e7 (10... ♜b7 11. ♜h4 ♜e8 12.0-0 f5 13. ♞f3± Sedlak-Drozdovskyij, Ajaccio 2006) 11. ♜h4 ♜e8 12. ♜xe7 ♜xe7 13. ♞h5 f5 14.g4∞ Sedlak-Sargissian, Valjevo 2012) 10.dxe5 ♜d7 11.0-0?! (11.f4!± is better, e.g. 11...f5 12.exf6 ♜xf6 13.0-0 Bodirolga-Katzir, Rijeka 2010; 11. ♖f3 ♜b7 12.0-0 h6 13.e4=) 11... ♖dxe5 12. ♜xe5 ♜xe5 13. ♜xh7+ ♞xh7 14. ♞h5+ ♞g8 15. ♞xe5 f6 16. ♞g3= De Prado-Portela, Spain tt 2014;

B) But on the ninth move 9.e4!? is interesting, for example:

B1) 9...dxe4?! 10. ♖xe4 ♜xe4 (10... ♜e7 11.dxc5 bxc5 12. ♖xf6+ ♜xf6 13. ♞c2 g6 14.0-0±) 11. ♜xe4 ♜b7 12. ♞a4 (12.dxc5! ♜xc5 13. ♞a4 ♞c8 14. ♞d1 ♞e7 15.0-0±) 12... ♞c7 13.dxc5 bxc5 (13... ♜xg3 14.hxg3 f5 15. ♜xc6 ♜xc6 16.cxb6 axb6 17. ♞c4±) 14. ♜xd6 (14. ♞c4±) 14... ♞xd6= Burmakin-Iturrizaga, Barcelona 2013;

B2) 9... ♜e7!? 10.dxc5 (10.e5 ♜h5 11. ♞e2 ♜b7 12. ♞e3 ♞c8 13.a3=) 10... bxc5 11.0-0 ♜b7= Sarapu-Rogers, Auckland 1992;

B3) Another idea is 9... ♜xg3 10.hxg3 h6 11.e5 ♜g4 12. ♞e2=.

8. ♜d3 ♜b7 9. ♖e5 ♜c6



The line with ...b7-b6 and ...♙b7 is considered the best for Black, forgetting about playing ...e6-e5 and focusing on controlling the e4-square.

10.0-0

The alternative is 10.f4 ♘e7 and now:

A) 11.♙f3 ♘f5 12.♙f2 ♙e7 13.0-0 (13. g4!? ♘d6 14.g5 ♘fe4= Mitkov-Borges, Toluca 2009; 13.♘g4?! ♘xg4 14.♙xg4 ♘d6= Pakleza-Jaracz, Chorzow ch-POL 2013) 13...♘d6= 14.♙h4 (14.♙h3=) 14...♘fe4 15.♙xe7 ♙xe7= Pezerovic-Postny, Bad Wiessee 2013;

B) 11.♙b1 ♘g6 12.0-0= Kamsky-Dreev, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013.

10...♙c7

A) An alternative is 10...♙c8 11.f4 (11.♘xc6 ♙xc6 12.♙e2 c4 13.♙c2 b5= Reich-Zelcic, Schwarzach 2014) 11...♘e7 12.♙b1! (this is a thematic idea, not only in the London System but also in some other openings, such as the Torre Attack or the Colle: the queen puts pressure on h7 to provoke a weakness in Black's kingside position, after which the queen goes back; in addition, the queen controls e4. Practice has also seen 12.♙f3 ♘f5 13.♙f2 ♙e7 14.♙h3 ♘e4 15.♙ad1 ♙c7 16.g4∞ Pham Le-Perena, Khanty-Mansiysk 2010) 12...♙c7 13.♙h4 ♘g6 14.♙g5 ♙a8 15.f5? (Kamsky sacrifices a pawn without justification; he should have played 15.♙e1, with a complex position; I am not convinced of the value of placing the queen on a8 behind the bishop and I think that White has chances on the kingside; White could also consider 15.♙xf6 gxf6 16.♘g4 f5 17.♘f6+ ♙h8 18.♙e1∞) 15...♘xe5 16.dxe5 ♙xe5= Kamsky-Korobov, Antalya 2013.

B) Another typical option is 10...♘e7 and now:

B1) 11.♙c2 ♙c8 12.♙ae1 c4 13.♙e2 b5+ Torre-Berkes, Istanbul 2012;

B2) 11.♙f3 (11.♙e2) 11...♘g6 12.h4 ♙xe5 13.dxe5 ♘d7 14.♙xg6

(14. ♖h5±) 14...hxg6 15. ♖g4+ Meier-Donchenko, Internet 2012;

B3) 11. ♖c1 (11.f4?! ♗e4+ Alcaraz-Defrance, Le Touquet 2011) 11... ♗e4
12. ♗xe4 dxe4± Colas-Adamson, Las Vegas 2013.

11.f4 ♗d7



It seems better to employ the plan with 11... ♗e7 12. ♖c2 (12. ♖f3 (12. ♖b1!?) 12... ♗e8 (12... ♗f5 13. ♗f2 ♗e7 14.a4=) 13. ♗h4 f5 14. ♖h3 ♗f6∞ Pezerovic-Scheckenbach, Bad Wiessee 2011) 12... ♗g6 13. ♖ae1 a6 14. ♗df3 b5 15. ♗g5∞ ½-½ Hoang Thanh Trang-Kochetkova, Rijeka 2010.

12. ♖h5 f5

Black sets up a Counter-Stonewall, which is very solid. White now needs to redeploy his queen and king's bishop. One of the plans is to pry open the kingside with g2-g4, ♖h1 and ♖g1 and exploit the passive bishop on b7.

13. ♖e2 ♗f6 14. ♗h4 ♗e4 15. ♗xe4!?

I do not think that this is White's best plan. I should prefer to play 15. ♖ad1 and then the plan with ♖h1, ♖g1 and g2-g4.

15...fxe4 16. ♗b5 ♗xe5 17.fxe5 ♗e7 18. ♗g3

White avoids exchanges, although after 18. ♖g4 ♗xh4 19. ♖xh4 I prefer White.

18... ♗c6 19.a4 c4 20. ♖g4 ♗d7 21.h4



White is trying to create some threats on the kingside. The position is balanced, although White has more space.

21... Rxf1+ 22. Rxf1 a6

Another option was 22... Qxb5 23. axb5 Rf8 (23... Rxb5? 24. Rxe6++-) 24. Rxf8+ (24. Qf4 Rf5=) 24... Rxf8=. The exchange of the light-squared bishops helps Black equalise.

23. Qxc6 Rxc6 24. h5 Rf8 25. Qf4 Rd7 26. Rd1!?

If 26. h6 then 26... g6 27. Qg5 Rxf1+ 28. Rxf1 Qxg5 29. Rxc5 Rf8 30. Re2 Qe7=.

26... Qe8 27. g4 Rc6 28. Qg2 Rf8?! a8?!?

I think that it is dubious to remove the rook from the kingside. It was better to wait with 28... Rd7=.

29. g5 g6 30. Rg4



30...b5?

This is already a serious error: the action is building up on the kingside and Black is ignoring it. He should play 30...gxh5 31.♖xh5 ♕e8 32.♖g4 ♖g6 33.♗h1 ♘f8=.

31.hxg6 hxg6 32.♗h1?

White could win with 32.axb5 axb5 33.♖h4 ♕f7 34.♖h7+ ♕e8 35.♖xg6+ ♕d7 36.♖h7+–.

32...♕f7?

Black misses another opportunity to save himself by playing 32...bxa4 33.♖h4 ♕f7 34.♖h7+ ♕e8 35.♖xg6+ ♕d7=; he would not be a pawn down and could create counterplay on the b-file.

33.axb5 axb5 34.♖h3

It was more precise to play 34.♖h4 ♗g8 35.♙g3 ♙f8 36.♗f1+ ♕e8 37.♖f4 ♕d7 38.♖f6 and once again Black is powerless to prevent the rook from invading via the a-file.

34...♗g8 35.♗f1 ♗g7?

This hastens the defeat but Black's position was already very delicate. Let us review his other defensive tries:

A) 35...♗f8 36.♖h7+ ♕e8 37.♖xg6+ ♕d7 38.♖h5+–;

B) 35...♕e8 36.♖h7+–;

C) 35...♙f8 36.♖h7+ ♗g7 37.♖h8 ♕e7 38.♙g3 ♖e8 39.♗f6+–.

36.♖h8

and Black resigned, since there is no good defence against the discovered check with 37.♙g3.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw some alternatives for Black, such as ...♖b6 and taking on d4. Black chose the line with ...b7-b6 and ...♙b7, which is the most solid, since it forgets about advancing with ...e6-e5 and fights for control of the e4-square, blocking White's attack. The best plan for Black involves ...♗c6-e7-f5-d6. In the game, when Black closes the position with 12...f5, White should try to attack with the plan of ♖h1, ♗g1 and g2-g4, with good prospects. The exchange on e4 and then the exchange of light-squared bishops favoured Black, who equalised the game. White tried to attack on the kingside, but only an error on Black's part allowed White to mount an attack and win.

Game 57

... d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6

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2444

Rafael Rodriguez Lopez

2326

Mondariz 1999 (5)

1.d4 e6 2.♘f3 c5 3.c3 d5 4.♙f4 ♘c6

Another possible move order is 4...♘f6 5.e3 ♙e7 6.♘bd2 b6 7.♙d3 ♙b7 8.♘e5 0-0 9.♙f3 (9.h3 ♘e4 10.♙h5 f6 11.♘g4 g6 12.♙h6∞ De Prado-Piay, Spain tt 2010) 9...♘bd7 10.♙d1 (10.♙h3 ♙e8 11.♘df3 ♘xe5 12.♘xe5 c4 13.♙c2± Stefanova-A.Rodriguez, Madrid 1997) 10...♘xe5 11.dxe5 ♘e8 12.♙h3± Ortega-Drei, Senegallia 1996.

5.e3 ♘f6 6.♘bd2 ♙e7



I think the variation with ...♙e7 is inferior to the one with ...♙d6.

7.♙d3

There are some better options for White in this position, such as:

A) 7.h3 0-0 8.♙d3 ♙b6 (8...b6 9.0-0 ♙b7 10.♙e2 ♙d6 11.♙xd6 ♙xd6= Potkin-Kurnosov, Moscow 2010) 9.♙b1 (when this move is possible there is no need to play ♙b3) 9...♙d7 10.0-0 cxd4 (10...♙ac8 11.♘e5 ♘xe5 12.dxe5 ♘e8 13.c4± Miladinovic-Seitaj, Ohrid 2009) 11.exd4 ♙fd8± Hebden-Britton, London 2013;

B) 7.♘e5! is the best line to prevent the variations where Black plays ...♘h5; 7...0-0 8.♙d3 ♙b6 (8...♙d7 9.♙f3 ♙c8 10.♙h3± Annaberdiev-Seitaj, Bled 2002) 9.♙b1 ♙d7 10.0-0 ♙ad8± Cuno-Chuikov, cr ICCF 1996;

C) 7.h4!? is a suggestion of Prié's; (7.dxc5!?) 7...0-0 8.♙d3 ♘g4? (8...h6

9. ♖e5∞) 9. ♙xh7+! ♔xh7 10. ♗g5+ ♙xg5? (10... ♔g8 11. ♚xg4 e5 12. ♚h5±) 11.hxg5+ ♔g6 12. ♚xg4 ♖h8 13. ♜h6+! 1-0 Bruno-Opacic, Verona 2005.

7...0-0

A) Here the thematic move 7... ♗h5 was interesting, harassing the bishop;

A1) 8. ♙e5 ♗xe5 (8...f6 9. ♙g3 g6 (9... ♗xg3 10.hxg3 f5 11.g4±) 10.0-0 0-0 11.a3 a6 12.b4 c4 13. ♙c2 ♗xg3 14.hxg3 f5= Danielsen-Sai, New Delhi 2011) 9. ♗xe5 (9.dxe5 g6= Winants-Michiels, Belgium tt 2004/05) 9... ♗f6 10.0-0 0-0 11.f4± Safin-Sareen, Sangli ch-Commonwealth 2000;

A2) 8. ♙g3 ♗xg3 9.hxg3 h6 10. ♗e5 (10. ♚e2 b6 11. ♙b5 ♙d7 12. ♙xc6 ♙xc6 13. ♗e5 ♜c8= Kotic-Dehlinger, Munich 2013; 10.g4 ♙d7 11.dxc5 ♙xc5 12.g5 ♚b6 13. ♗b3= Kotic-Savic, Herceg Novi 2001) 10... ♗xe5 11.dxe5 ♙d7 12. ♚g4 ♙f8∞ Kamsky-Yakovenko, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013.

B) Another thematic option is 7... ♚b6, although it is not so good here, for instance: 8. ♜b1 (8. ♚b1 ♙d7 9.h3 ♜c8 10.0-0 cxd4 11.exd4± Larsen-Garcia Padron, Las Palmas 1976) 8...h6 9.h3 0-0 10.0-0 ♙d7± Bosch-Shreyansh, Dieren 2009.

C) 7...c4 is playable, e.g. 8. ♙c2 b5 9. ♗e5 (9.0-0; 9.e4) 9... ♙b7± Lukov-Colin, Paris 2003.

8.0-0



This is the classical line of the London System. In another game we shall look at the so-called Pereyra Attack with 8. ♗e5!; as an alternative to capturing on e5 there is 8... ♙d6?!, although moving the bishop again looks dubious: 9. ♙g3 ♚c7 10.f4 ♜b8 (10... ♗d7 11.0-0 f5 12. ♙h4± Yemelin-Orlov, St Petersburg 2013) 11.0-0 b5 12. ♙h4 ♙e7 13. ♚f3 b4 14. ♚h3 g6 15. ♗df3 ♗d8 16. ♙xf6 ♙xf6 17. ♗g5± De Prado-Stanoey, Arteixo 2007.

It is also possible to play 8.h4!? and 8.h3, which is more precise, preventing ... ♖h5.

8...b6

I think that Black does better to play 8... ♖h5!, for instance:

A) 9. ♖e2?! cxd4 10.cxd4 ♖xf4 11.exf4 ♖b6 12. ♖b3 a5 ♜ Tu-Ardiansyah Vung, Tau 2001;

B) 9. ♘g3 c4 10. ♘c2 ♖xg3 11.hxg3 b5 12.e4=;

C) 9.dxc5 ♖xf4 10.exf4 ♘xc5 11. ♖b3 ♘d6 12.g3= Takemoto-Pham, Jakarta 1993.

9. ♖b1!?



An interesting idea that we mentioned earlier and which is played in other openings, such as the Torre Attack or the Colle: White tries to put pressure on h7 and control e4.

An alternative is 9. ♖e5 ♘b7 (9... ♖xe5 10.dxe5±) 10. ♖df3 (10. ♘g3!? with the idea of f2-f4) 10... ♜c8± Bartha-Juhasz, Budapest 2013.

9... ♘b7 10. ♖e5 ♜c8

A rather strange move. The idea is to play ... ♘a6 in the future, but it was better to play 10... ♜c8 11. ♘g3 h6 12.f4; or 10...h6 11.h3, or 10... ♘d6, with a balanced position.

11. ♘g3

White wants to employ the typical plan of the Stonewall with f2-f4. There were other good options, such as 11. ♜e1, 11.a4 or 11.h3.

11...g6

I think that it was better to play 11...h6, but after 12.f4 White has the initiative.

12.f4 ♖h5 13. ♘e1

13. ♕f2 was a little better.

13...cxd4

If 13...f6? then 14. ♖xg6 hxg6 15. ♕xg6 ♖g7 16. ♕h7+ ♔h8 17. ♖f3 ♕d6 18. ♖h3 ♗e7 19. ♖h6 and White's attack is decisive. Instead, 13...♗g7 was a better defence and after 14. ♙d1 the position is unclear.

14.exd4 ♗xe5 15.fxe5



The white position is superior: she has the half-open f-file and the possibility of attacking on the kingside, while the bishop on b7 and the queen on c8 are both passive.

15...♗a6 16.g4! ♗g7

If 16...♕xd3 then 17. ♙xd3 ♗g7 18. ♕g3±.

17. ♗f3 ♗e8

Again 17...♕xd3 18. ♙xd3 h5 19.h3 and 17...h5 18.h3 ♕c4 19. ♕d2 are better for White.

18. ♕d2! f5

After 18...♕xd3 19. ♙xd3 ♗c4 20. ♙xc4 dxc4 21. ♕h6 ♗g7 22. ♗d2 b5 23. ♗e4 White remains with a decisive advantage: she threatens to play 24. ♗f6+ and double rooks on the f-file.

19.exf6 ♗xf6 20. ♕h6 ♖e8

There was no salvation. If 20...♗xg4 then 21. ♕xf8 ♕xf8 22. ♕xg6! ♕xf1 (22...hxg6 23. ♙xg6+ ♕g7 24. ♗g5+–) 23. ♕xh7+ ♔h8 24. ♙g6 ♕h6 25. ♖xf1+–.

21. ♕xg6



A thematic sacrifice that decides the game; finally the queen enters Black's castled position from b1.

21... ♕xf1?

If 21...hxg6?? then 22. ♖xg6+ ♔h8 23. ♖g7 mate. More tenacious was 21... ♗e4 22. ♕xe4 dxe4 23. ♖xe4 ♕xf1 24. ♖xf1 ♕d6 (24... ♕f6 25. ♗g5! ♕xg5 26. ♖f7!! with unstoppable mate) 25. ♗g5 ♖e7 26. ♖f8+ ♗xf8 27. ♕xf8 ♖xf8 28. ♗xe6 ♖fe8 29.d5+–.

22. ♗xh7+ ♔h8

Again it is mate after 22... ♗xh7 23. ♖g6+ ♔h8 24. ♖g7+.

23. ♗e5

Black resigned, in view of the unstoppable mate.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the line for Black with ... ♕e7 instead of ... ♕d6. White used the traditional plan with ♕d3, 0-0 and then the interesting idea of ♖b1, followed by the Stonewall Attack with ♗e5, ♕g3, f2-f4. In the opening White should prevent the lines with ... ♗h5 by Black with moves such as 8.h3 and 8. ♗e5, which is the best move. In the game Black weakened his kingside and the plan with ... ♖c8 and ... ♕a6 was dubious. Finally White gained a decisive attack on the kingside, concluding with the sacrifice 21. ♕xg6!.

Game 58

...d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6

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Michael Hammes

2393

Belgium tt 2011/12 (8)

1.d4 e6 2.♘f3

We recommend the move order with 2.♙f4.

2...♘f6

The idea of ...♙d6 can be employed even earlier; after 2...d5 3.♙f4 the move 3...♙d6, offering the exchange of bishops, is an interesting option, e.g.



analysis diagram

A) 4.♙xd6 ♙xd6 (4...cxd6=) 5.♘bd2 ♘f6 6.e3 ♘bd7 7.c4 0-0= Torre-Antonio, Tagaytay City 2013;

B) 4.e3 c5 (4...♙xf4 5.exf4 ♘e7 6.♙d3 b6 7.c3 a5 8.♘e5 ♙a6 9.♙h5 g6 10.♙e2 ♙xd3 11.♙xd3= Gareev-Luther, Turin ol 2006) 5.c3 (5.♙xd6 ♙xd6 6.dxc5 ♙xc5 7.c4±) 5...♘c6 6.♙g3 ♘ge7 7.♙d3 b6 8.♘bd2 ♙b7 9.♙e2 h6= Grachev-Naer, Moscow 2014;

C) 4.♙g3 ♘e7 5.e3 (5.♘c3!?) 5...♘f5 6.♙d3 (6.c4 ♘xg3 7.hxg3 ♘d7 8.♙c2 h6 9.♘c3 c6± Heberla-Luther, Dresden 2011; 6.♙xd6=) 6...♘xg3 7.hxg3 ♘d7 8.♘bd2 (8.c3 ♙e7 9.♘bd2 ♘f6 10.♘e5 ♙xe5 11.dxe5 ♘d7± Lang-Hammes, Germany tt 2012; 8.c4 c6 9.♘c3 h6 10.e4 dxe4 11.♘xe4 ♙b4+ 12.♙f1 ♙e7 13.♙e2± Margvelashvili-Priyadharshan, Lubbock 2013) 8...♘f6 9.♙e2 ♙d7 10.♘e5 ♙e7 11.0-0-0± De Prado-Graa, Spain tt 2005.

3.♙f4 d5 4.e3 ♙d6



Black offers the early exchange of bishops, which in theory favours him.

5. ♖g3

There are other options, although this is the main one.

A) If 5. ♖xd6 cxd6 6.c4 (6. ♗bd2 0-0 7.c4 dxc4 8. ♖xc4 d5 9. ♖d3 ♗c6 10.0-0 ♖d7 11.a3 ½-½ Strikovic-Illincic, Vrnjacka Banja 1998; 6.c3 0-0 7. ♗bd2 ♗c6 8. ♖e2 e5 9.0-0 a6 10.h3 h6 ½-½ Mikadze-Khukhashvili, Anaklia 2011) 6...0-0 (6...dxc4 7. ♖xc4=) 7. ♗c3 dxc4 8. ♖xc4 b6 9.0-0 ♖b7 10. ♗e2 ♗bd7 11.h3 ♗c8 12. ♖a6± Prié-Mohota, Creon 2007;

B) 5. ♖d3 is also playable, for instance: 5... ♖xf4 6.exf4 0-0 7.0-0 c5 8.dxc5 ♗c7 9. ♗d2 ♗xc5=;

C) And finally 5. ♗e5 0-0 6. ♖d3 (6. ♗d2 c5 7.c3 ♗c6 8. ♖g3 ♖xe5 9.dxe5 ♗d7 10.f4 f6 11.exf6 ♗xf6= Mirzoev-Velten, Bugibba 2012) 6...c5 7.c3 ♗c6 8. ♗d2 ♗c7 9. ♗df3= Derbenev-Kharchenko, St Petersburg 2011.

5... ♗e4

Black wants to exchange the g3-bishop for his knight and keep his d6-bishop.

A) Another option is 5... ♖xg3 6.hxg3 ♗bd7 7. ♗bd2 (7.c4 b6 8.cxd5 exd5 9. ♗c3 ♖b7 10. ♖d3± Alonso-Mindegua, Bergara 2012) 7... ♗e7 8.c3 (8.c4 c6 9. ♗c2 h6 10. ♖e2= H.Nguyen-Medina, Tagaytay City 2013) 8...e5 9.dxe5 ♗xe5 10. ♗xe5 ♗xe5 11. ♗a4+ c6 12. ♖d3= Sedlak-Ascic, Bosnjaci 2006;

B) Black can also play 5...0-0 e.g. 6.c4 (with this move order it is a good idea to transpose to the Queen's Gambit; 6. ♗bd2 b6 7.c3 c5 8. ♖d3 ♖a6 9. ♖xa6 ♗xa6= Danielian-Koneru, Moscow 2011) 6...c5!? (6...h6=) 7.cxd5 (7. ♗c3 ♗c6 8.cxd5 exd5 9. ♖e2 ♖g4 10.dxc5 ♖xc5 11.0-0± Kir. Georgiev-Rakhmanov, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013; it seems best to play 7.dxc5! ♖xc5 8. ♗c3±) 7... ♗xd5 8. ♖c4 (8.dxc5±) 8... ♗c6 9. ♖xd5 exd5= Kamsky-Ivanchuk, Beijing 2013.

6. ♖bd2

An alternative is 6.c4 c6 7.♖c3 ♖xg3 8.hxg3 ♖d7± Piankov-Schröter, Leipzig 2011.

6... ♖xg3 7.hxg3 ♖d7

Practice has also seen 7...h6 8.e4 (8.c4) 8...dxe4 9.♖xe4 ♖e7 10.c3 ♖d7 11.♖d3 c5 12.♗e2 cxd4 13.♖xd4 ♖c5 14.♖b5+ ♖d7? (14... ♖d7±) 15.♖xc5 ♖xc5 16.♖xe6+– Yemelin-Aleksandrov, St Petersburg 2013, and 7...c5 8.c3 (8.dxc5!? ♖xc5 9.c4) 8...♖c6 9.♖d3 ♗e7 10.dxc5 ♖xc5 11.e4 ♖d7 12.♗e2 h6= Labeckas-Kalvaitis, Vilnius 2013.

8.c3 e5 9.dxe5 ♖xe5 10.♖xe5 ♖xe5 11.♖f3

An earlier game had continued 11.♖e2 g6 12.♖g4 f5 13.♖f3 c6 14.a4 0-0 15.♖b3 ♗f6 16.a5 ♖e6= Kovacevic-Diaz, Vrnjacka Banja 1988.

11... ♖f6 12.♗c2 g6 13.0-0-0



It is typical for White, after the exchange on g3, to castle queenside and exploit the half-open h-file or else open the centre, and although the engines do not see any advantage, I think that White is slightly better.

13...c6 14.e4 ♗a5!?

The quieter 14...0-0 is playable, and if 15.♖c4 then 15...♗b6! 16.exd5 cxd5 17.♖xd5 ♖f5 18.♖e4 ♖xe4 (18...♖e6 19.♗b1 ♖ad8) 19.♗xe4 ♗xf2, with equality.

15.exd5 cxd5?!

Black could also play 15...♗xa2 16.♗e4+ ♗f8 17.♖d3∞ or 15...0-0∞.

16.♗b3



Black has a weakness on d5 and his king is still in the centre.

16... ♖e6

It was better to sacrifice a pawn with 16...0-0 17. ♖xd5 ♗c7 ♖.

17. ♗b5+ ♖f8 18. ♗d4 ♖d8 19. ♗e2

19. ♗xe6+ fxe6 20. ♗d3± was better.

19... ♗c8 20. ♖b1 ♗g7 21.g4 ♖d6 22. ♗c2 h6 23. ♗d2

White keeps improving his pieces; he has a strong knight on d4, while Black has a permanent weakness on d5. White's position is preferable.

23... ♖dd8 24. ♖h3 ♗c7 25.f4 ♗c5 26. ♖d3

There were better options, such as 26.f5± or 26. ♖dh1.

26...b6 27. ♖a1 a5 28. ♗f3



White lines up all his pieces against the d5-pawn.

28...a4

Here 28...♙a6 was good, e.g. 29.♖e3 ♜he8= 30.♜xe8 ♜xe8 31.♙xd5 ♙xd4 32.♙xd4+ ♙xd4 33.cxd4 ♙e2 34.♜e1 ♜d8 35.♜xe2 ♜xd5 36.♜d2 f5!= and Black should draw this ending.

29.♙c2 ♙e6 30.a3 ♙c4?

After defending well, Black now goes wrong. It was better to sacrifice the pawn with 30...d4! 31.♙xd4 (31.cxd4 ♙b5 32.♜c3 ♙b3 33.♙c6 ♙a5) 31...♙c4 32.♜e3 ♜d6 33.♙e2 ♙d5 and Black has compensation. After the text move Black loses the pawn without any compensation.

31.♙e3



31...♙c8 32.♙xd5 ♙xd5 33.♜xd5 ♙c7?

More tenacious was 33...♜xd5 34.♙xd5 ♜d8 35.♙b5 ♜xd1+ 36.♙xd1±.

34.g5+- ♙e7 35.♙d4+

Black resigned, in view of 35...f6 (35...♙h7 36.♜h1 h5 37.f5+-) 36.gxh6+ ♙xh6 37.f5 g5 38.♜xd8 ♜xd8 (38...♙xd8 39.♙xa4+-) 39.♜h1+ ♙g7 40.♙g4.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw Black playing an early ...♙d6 to exchange the bishops. We also saw the plan of ...♙e4, to take on g3 with the knight and retain the d6-bishop. We also analysed capturing on g3 immediately. In this type of variation, White usually castles queenside, exploits the half-open h-file, and opens the centre. In the game, White gained the advantage, owing to the weakness of the d5-pawn, although he did not choose the best plan.

Black defended very well until the error with 30...♖c4; he could have equalised by sacrificing the pawn with 30...d4!, but after 31.♗e3 the d5-pawn fell anyway and White won without any problems.

The Pereyra Attack

To conclude this chapter on the lines with ...d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6, we are going to look at a complete game with the so-called Pereyra Attack. This system is named after the Argentinean Manuel Pereyra Puebla, whom we mentioned in the introduction to this book; this attack is characterised by delayed castling, an early ♗e5 and the advance h2-h4, with the idea of sacrificing with ♙xh7+ or breaking with g2-g4.

Game 59

Pereyra Attack

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1471

David Ramon Losada

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Spain tt 2014 (6)

1.d4 d5 2.♘f4 ♗f6 3.e3 e6 4.♗f3 ♘e7 5.♘d3 0-0 6.♗e5



The Pereyra Attack differs from the London System in that White does not castle and instead plays an early ♗e5 and h2-h4, preparing to sacrifice on h7; alternatively he tries to attack the black king by bringing the queen to the kingside, or even by advancing with g2-g4.

6...♗bd7

The knight can go to c6, but after taking on e5 it just transposes, e.g. 6...c5 7.c3 ♖c6 8. ♖d2 ♖xe5.

7. ♖d2 c5 8.c3 a6?!

A) If 8...b6?! then 9. ♖c6± Kveinys-Nemcova, Cappelle-la-Grande 2014;

B) Another option is 8...c4!? 9. ♕c2 ♖xe5 10.dxe5 ♖d7 11.h4!? (11.0-0±) 11...f6 12. ♖f3 f5 13. ♖g5 (13. ♖d4±) 13... ♕xg5?! 14.hxg5± Matovic-Takac, Topusko 2012;

C) The main line is 8... ♖xe5 9.dxe5 ♖d7 10.h4!.



analysis diagram

This is preparation for bringing the other knight to g5, opening the h-file and sacrificing on h7. Now:

C1) 10...f6 11. ♖h5! (11. ♖f3 c4 12. ♕xh7+!? ♖xh7 13. ♖g5+ ♖g8 14. ♖h5 fxg5 15.hxg5 ♕xg5 16. ♕xg5 ♖e8 17. ♖h7+ ♖f7 18. ♖h4 1-0 Gonzalez-Sanchez, Spain tt 1993) 11...f5 (11...g6 12. ♕xg6 hxg6 13. ♖xg6+ ♖h8 14. ♖h6+ ♖g8 15. ♖h3+–) 12.g4! g6 (12...c4 13. ♕c2 g6 14. ♖h6±) 13. ♖h6 and White had a strong attack in Bogoevski-Tuzi, Struga 2013;

C2) 10...f5, closing the b1-h7 diagonal to prevent the sacrifice on h7, is the best defence:

C21) If 11.exf6 ♖xf6=;

C22) Or 11.g4!? ♖c7 (11...g6?! 12.gxf5 exf5 13. ♖f3± Hribar-Kukovec, Ljubljana 1995; also 11...c4 12. ♕c2 ♖c5 13.gxf5 exf5± Tkacheva-Dagaeva, St Petersburg 1999; or 11...fxg4 12. ♖xg4±) 12. ♖f3 fxg4 13. ♖g5 ♖xe5?? (13... ♕xg5 14.hxg5 g6 15. ♖xg4 ♖xe5 16. ♕xe5 ♖xe5 17. ♖h4 ♖f7 18.0-0-0±) 14. ♕xh7+ ♖h8 15. ♕xe5 ♖xe5 16. ♖xg4+– Valero-Garcia, Valencia 2005;

C23) 11. ♖f3 ♖b6 (11...h6 12.h5 ♖b6 13.g4 fxg4 14. ♖h2±) 12. ♖b1 c4

13. ♖c2 ♗c5 14.g4!? (14.h5; 14. ♖g5) 14...fxg4 15. ♗d4 h5 16.f3 ♗d3+ (16... gxf3 17. ♖xf3 ♗d3+ 18. ♖xd3 cxd3 19. ♖xh5±) 17. ♖xd3 cxd3 18.fxg4±
T.A.Petrosian-Skatchkov, Yerevan 2004.

C3) 10...c4 11. ♖xh7+!!



analysis diagram

The thematic sacrifice in the Pereyra: White gains a clear advantage (there are some long lines, but Black's defence is difficult).

11... ♖xh7 12. ♖h5+ ♖g8 13. ♗f3 f6 (13... ♗e8 14. ♗g5+–) 14. ♗g5! White sacrifices a second piece to open the h-file. 14...fxg5 15.hxg5 and now:

C31) 15... ♗f5? 16. ♖h7+ ♖f7 17.g6+ ♖e8 18. ♖xg7 ♖b6 (18... ♖f8 19. ♗h8 ♖e7 20. ♖h6 ♖d8 21.g4 ♖c7 22.gxf5 ♖xh6 23.f6 ♖c5 24. ♖xh6+–) 19. ♗h8+ ♖f8 20.g4 ♗xf4 21.exf4 ♖xb2 22. ♖f7+ ♖d8 23.g7 ♖xa1+ 24. ♖e2 ♖xa2+ 25. ♖f3 ♖a3 26.gxf8 ♖+ ♗xf8 27. ♗xf8+ ♖xf8 28. ♖xf8+, with a decisive advantage;

C32) 15... ♖xg5! 16. ♖xg5 ♖b6 (16... ♖c7 17. ♖h7+ ♖f7 18. ♗h4 ♗xe5 19. ♖f4 ♗d3+ 20. ♖xd3 cxd3 21. ♖xc7±; 16... ♖e8 17. ♖h7+ ♖f7 18. ♗h4+–) 17.0-0-0 (17. ♖h7+ ♖f7 18. ♗h4 ♗xe5 19. ♗f4+ ♖e8 20. ♖xg7 ♗d3+=) 17... ♗xe5 (17... ♗xf2 18. ♗d2 ♗xd2 19. ♖h7+ ♖f8 20. ♗f1+ ♗f6 21.b4!+–, 17... ♗f5 18. ♗d4 ♗f8 19.f4+–) 18. ♗h4 ♖c5 (18... ♖d6 19. ♖h7+ ♖f7 20. ♖f4 ♖e8 21. ♖xg7+– ♗d3+ 22. ♗xd3 ♗xf4 23. ♗xf4 cxd3 24. ♗f7, mating) 19. ♖h7+ ♖f7 20. ♖h6 ♖e8 21. ♖xg7 ♗xf2 (21... ♗f7 22. ♗g4 ♖d7 23. ♖xf8 ♖xf8 24. ♗g8 ♖e7 25. ♗g7 ♖e8 26. ♗d4+–) 22. ♖h8+ ♖d7 23. ♖xe5 ♖f8 (23... ♖xe3+ 24. ♖b1+–) 24. ♖xf8 ♗xf8 25. ♗xc4+–.

9.h4!

The key move of the Pereyra Attack. White's idea is to support the other knight

coming to g5 and to open the h-file; the normal move here would be 9.0-0±.

9...♘xe5?

This move is bad here and gives White a clear advantage; instead, 9...cxd4 10.exd4 ♖e8 11.♘df3± ♘f8? (11...h6) 12.♘g5+– was Vassallo-Garcia, Lisbon 2000.

10.dxe5 ♘d7

10...♘e8 does not prevent the sacrifice: 11.♙xh7+! ♔xh7 12.♚h5+ ♔g8 13.♘f3 f6 14.♘g5 fxg5 15.hxg5 ♖f5 16.♚h8+ ♔f7 17.g6+ ♔xg6 18.g4+–.

In the light of what is coming, the lesser evil would be 10...♘e4 11.♘xe4 dxe4 12.♙xe4±.

11.♙xh7+!!



Once again the thematic sacrifice on h7; yet some say that the London System is boring or drawish.

11...♔xh7 12.♚h5+ ♔g8 13.♘f3 ♖e8

The lines are similar to those given in the note at move 8, except that here Black has played ...a7-a6, which is even worse than ...c5-c4. The other defensive try was 13...f6, although this would not save the game after 14.♘g5 fxg5 15.hxg5 ♙xg5 (15...♖f5 16.♚h7+ ♔f7 (16...♔f8 17.♚g6+–) 17.g6+ ♔e8 18.♚xg7 ♘f8 19.♚h8+–) 16.♙xg5 ♖b6 (16...♚c7 17.f4 c4 18.0-0-0 ♚c5 19.♚h7+ ♔f7 20.f5+–) 17.♚h7+ ♔f7 18.♖h4 ♘xe5 (18...♚xb2 19.♖f4+ ♘f6 20.♖xf6++–) 19.♖f4+ ♔e8 20.♚xg7 ♘d3+ (20...♘f7 21.♙h6 ♚d6 22.♚g6 ♙d7 23.0-0-0 ♚e7 24.♙xf8 ♚xf8 25.♖h1 ♔e7 26.♚f6+ ♔e8 27.♖h7+–; 20...♚d6 21.♖xf8+ ♚xf8 22.♚xe5+–) 21.♔f1 ♚d6 22.♚g6+ ♔d7 23.♚xd3±.

14.♘g5! ♙xg5

If 14... ♖f8 then 15. ♔xf7+ ♔h8 16.h5 ♕xg5 17.h6! gxf6 (17... ♕xh6 18. ♕xh6 is mate) 18. ♕xg5 ♖xg5 19. ♔xe8 ♖g7 20. ♖h3+.

15.hxg5 ♖f8

The black king tries to escape, but will not find any safe hiding place.

16.g6! ♖e7

If 16... fxf6 then 17. ♔xg6+–, while if 16... ♖a5 then 17. ♔g5 f6 18.exf6 ♕xf6 19. ♕d6+ ♖g8 20. ♔h4+–.

17.gxf7! ♖f8 18. ♕g5+! ♕f6



How should White continue the attack here?

19. ♔g6!!

An excellent move, not rushing to regain material and making way for the rook.

19... ♖xf7 20. ♖h7!

The complement to the previous move; Black is lost. Another winning line was 20.exf6+ gxf6 21. ♖h7 ♕d6 (21... ♖f8 22. ♔xf6+; 21... ♖xh7 22. ♕xf6+ ♕d6 23. ♕xd8 ♖h1+ 24. ♕d2 ♖xa1 25. ♔f7+–) 22. ♕f4+ e5 23. ♖xf7 exf4 24.0-0-0+–.



20... ♖f8

If 20... ♖g8 then 21.exf6+ ♔d6 22. ♕f4+ ♔c6 23.fxg7 ♕d7 24. ♕e5 and there is no defence against 25. ♖h8.

21.exf6+ ♔d6

If 21... gxf6 then 22. ♖xf6+ or 21... ♔d7 22.fxg7 ♖g8 23. ♖xf7+ ♖xf7 24.g8 ♖.

22.fxg7 ♖g8 23. ♕h6

1-0

There is no defence against 24. ♖h8. An excellent game by White, and all the more meritorious in that the player was only twelve years old. I had taught him the sacrifice, but after Black's 13... ♖e8 he found all the moves on his own.

SUMMARY

To conclude the chapter on the QGD Orthodox Defence set-up with ...d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6, we looked at the so-called Pereyra Attack against Black's system with ... ♕e7. White's plan consists of playing ♕e5 and h2-h4 and preparing the ♕xh7 sacrifice, or else attacking Black's castled position with g2-g4 or ♖h5. In the game, Black, after playing 8...a6, then exchanged on e5 and allowed the thematic sacrifice 11. ♕xh7!!, which gave White a decisive advantage. Black has two defences once White has played ♕f3: one is to play ...f7-f6, but this fails to prevent the attack with ♕g5, sacrificing a second piece; the other defence is to play ... ♖e8, as in the game, but this also gives White a winning attack. The game is very instructive for the way White concluded the struggle with quiet moves, such as 19. ♖g6! and 20. ♖h7!.

CONCLUSION

In this chapter we have looked at the classical systems for Black with ...d7-d5 and an early ...e7-e6, known as the Orthodox Defence. When Black plays like this against the London System, he has two main plans: to play either ...♗d6 or ...♗e7. In Game 52 we saw the classical line with ...♗d6, which is very famous for White's sacrifice with ♖xh7, prepared by GM Prié in his home analysis. There are several examples with this line and many players with black fall into the same trap.

In Games 53 and 54 we saw Black's best option in the ...♗d6 line, which is to play ...b7-b6 and ...♗b7, forgetting about playing ...e6-e5 and instead focusing on controlling the e4-square. White has several options then: one interesting one is to play e3-e4, as in Game 53; another is Kamsky's latest plan of preparing e3-e4 with useful moves such as ♖e2 and ♙d1 (Game 54); finally there is also the traditional plan based on ♗e5 (Game 56).

In Game 55 we saw Black's plan with ...♗e7. But later Black lost a tempo by moving the bishop to d6 anyway. Carlsen handled the position in a very interesting manner, giving up his light-squared bishop for a knight.

In Game 57, White employed the traditional London System with ♗d3 and 0-0 but followed it up with the plan of ♖b1 and finally gained a good victory, with a strong attack on the black king, including a sacrifice on g6.

In Game 58 we saw Black's plan of an early ...♗d6, to exchange the bishops. White normally responds to this with ♗g3, although there are other options. We saw that Black can exchange the bishops on g3 or play ...♗e4 and then take with ...♗xg3. White's plan in these variations is usually to castle queenside, open the centre and exploit the half-open h-file with g3-g4-g5.

Finally, in Game 59 we saw the so-called Pereyra Attack, which is very effective against the ...♗e7 plan. The idea is to delay castling and instead play an early ♗e5 and h2-h4. The threat is to sacrifice with ♖xh7 or attack the king with g2-g4. It is a very dangerous line and in the game we saw the ♖xh7 sacrifice, which gave White a decisive advantage in an instructive game.

Chapter 10

The London System versus other defences

1.d4

1.d4



1...g6

1...d6

1... ♘f6 2. ♙f4 d6 3. ♘f3 c6 or 3... ♘bd7

1...b5

1...e5; 1...a6; 1...b6 1... ♘c6; 1...c6

To conclude our study of Black's various defences, we are going to finish with a chapter devoted to all the other lines, played even as early as move one. We shall focus especially on a move order for Black involving ...d7-d6 and which can lead to similar positions to the King's Indian. We shall also examine some other lines, such as ...b7-b6, ...b7-b5 or ...e7-e5, for example.

Game 60

Irregular Defence

Gata Kamsky

2667

Murtas Kazhgaleev

2580

Cappelle-la-Grande 2016 (7)

1.d4 ♖f6 2.♗f4 ♗h5!?



Attacking the bishop on f4 is always a possible idea for Black. In this case it seems to me to be too early.

3.♗g5

It is possible to play 3.♗d2, but the bishop is not well placed on this square, and after 2...g6 (it is not necessary to retreat the knight) Black's previous move would be justified.

3...h6 4.♗h4 g5 5.e3

This move is very important to safeguard the bishop; it is possible here because White has not yet played ♗f3.

5...♗f6

The knight returns home 'empty-handed', and having weakened his kingside. If Black insists on pursuing the bishop with 5...♗g7 6.♗g3 ♗f5 then 7.♗e5 gives White the advantage, since 7...f6?? allows 8.♖h5 mate.

6.♗g3 d6

Practice has also seen 6...♗g7 7.♗c3 c5 8.dxc5!? (8.♗ge2±) 8...♖a5 9.♖d4 (9.♖d2 ♖xc5 10.0-0-0±) 9...♗h5 10.♖c4 ♗xg3 11.hxg3± To-Balint, Budapest 2014.

7.♗d2 ♗g7 8.c3

Or 8.♗d3 ♗c6 9.♗gf3 ♗h5 10.c3 ♗xg3 11.hxg3± Solovjev-Gajsin,

Ekaterinburg 2008.

8... ♖c6 9. ♗d3 e5 10. ♘e2



The knight's development on e2 is more flexible, since on f3 it would always be exposed to the advance with ...e5-e4. White has also played 10. ♙c2 ♙e7 11.0-0 ♗e6 12.h4 g4= Ponomarev-Andreikin, Moscow 2010, and 10. ♗gf3 ♙e7 11. ♙c2 ♗d7 12.0-0 0-0-0∞ Baumann-Riemer, Internet 2003.

The control of the f5-square should give White the advantage.

10... ♙e7

Another option was 10... ♗h5 11. ♙c2 (11. h3 ♗xg3 12. ♗xg3±; 11.0-0±) 11... ♗e6 12.0-0-0 ♙d7 13.f3 0-0-0 14. ♗f2∞ Böhm-Hommeles, Netherlands tt 1997 (by transposition).

11.h3 e4?!



I usually dislike this advance for Black, since on e4 the pawn can become weak and also the diagonal of White's dark-squared bishop is lengthened. It was better to play a waiting game, first developing the queen's bishop (11...♗e6 or 11...♗d7), and waiting to see which side White is going to castle.

12. ♖c2 ♗f5 13. b4! ♗g6 14. ♖b1!

Putting pressure on the e4-pawn and also supporting the advance on the queenside.

14...0-0 15. ♗h2! ♜ae8 16. b5

Gaining space on the queenside; 16.a4± and 16.0-0± were also good.

16...♗a5 17. a4 b6 18. ♖a2 ♜c8



19. ♗c4!

A good move, to eliminate the a5-knight and allow the future opening of the a-file.

19...♗xc4 20. ♖xc4 d5 21. ♖a2

Here 21. ♖c6! was good, e.g. 21...♗e6 22. ♗b3 ♖xc6 23. bxc6 ♗f5 24. a5 ♜fd8 25. axb6 axb6 (25...cxb6 26. c7+–) 26. ♜d2, with advantage to White.

21...c5 22. bxc6 ♜xc6 23. ♗b3 ♜d8 24. 0-0 ♗f5 25. c4!±



A typical move to shed the weakness on c3. In addition White gains a passed pawn in the centre and the bishop on h2 will be able to cooperate better with the rest of the white pieces. White is going to fight for control of the c-file.

25... ♖e6

If 25... dxc4 then 26. ♙xc4 ♙e6 27. ♖ac1±.

26. ♖ac1

26.cxd5 ♙xd5 27. ♖fc1± was also good.

26... ♜b4 27.cxd5 ♖xc1 28. ♖xc1 ♙xd5



29. ♙g3

This bishop exerts its power all along its diagonal and White has gained a comfortable advantage. However, at this point the move 29.g4! was stronger, to prevent Black from defending his e4-pawn with ...f7-f5.

29... ♖d7 30. ♖c8+ ♜h7?

It was better to play 30... ♕f8, although after 31. ♕c4 ♔g7 32. ♜c2 White has a clear advantage.

31. ♜h2?!

Here White could gain a decisive advantage with 31. ♖c3! ♖c7 (if 31... ♖xc3 32. ♕xe6! fxe6 33. ♜xe6 winning; or 32... ♖xa2 33. ♕f5 mate) 32. ♕xe6 ♖xe6 33. ♜c2 f5 34. ♕b8!, with the idea of g2-g4, and White should win.

31... f5?!

31... ♜e7 was a better defence, but White keeps the advantage with 32. ♜c2 f5 33. ♜c6.

32. ♖c3! ♜a5

Again if 32... ♖xc3 then 33. ♕xe6! is winning, since if 33... ♖xa2 then 34. ♕xf5 mates.

33. ♜c2

There were other options here, such as 33. ♖xd5 ♖xd5 34. ♕b8 ♔g6 35. g4±. The best move was 33. ♖b5! ♜b4 34. ♖c6 ♜e7 (34... ♕g8 35. ♕d6+-) 35. ♕d6 ♜f7 36. ♕a3 ♕f6 37. ♖xe6! ♜xe6 38. ♖c3 ♖xc3 39. ♕xe6 ♖xa2 40. ♕xf5+! ♔g7 41. ♕xd7, and wins.

33... ♕f7

If 33... ♖b4 then 34. ♜b1 ♖xb3 35. ♜xb3 ♖d5 36. ♕e5+-.



34. ♖xe4!

34. ♖b5! was another winning idea.

34... ♕g6

This move loses, but there is no defence anyway.

Capturing with 34... fxe4 fails to 35. ♜xe4+ ♕g6 36. ♜e6 ♖f6 37. ♕e5 h5

(37... ♖a6 38. ♜b8 ♜b7 39. ♙c8+–) 38. ♙xf6 ♙f5 39. ♙xg5 ♙xg5 40. ♙xd7, with a decisive advantage.

Or if 34... ♘b4 then 35. ♙b1 ♙xb3 36. ♙xb3 ♙d5 (36... fxe4 37. ♙g8+ ♙g6 38. ♙e6+ ♙f6 (38... ♙h7 39. ♙xe4++–) 39. ♙e5 ♙d5 40. ♜g8+ ♙h7 41. ♙e8 and mate in a few moves) 37. ♙xg5+ hxg5 38. ♙xb4+–.

35. ♙c6 f4

Everything loses: 35... fxe4 36. ♙xd7+–; 35... ♜f7 36. ♙xd5+–; 35... ♜e7 36. ♙xd5 fxe4 37. ♙g8++–.

36. ♙xd7 ♙xe4



37. ♜h8+

This wins, although White could mate more quickly with 37. ♙f7 fxg3+ 38. fxg3 ♙e7 (38... ♙d2 39. ♙g8+ ♙g6 40. ♙e8+ ♙f5 (40... ♙h7 41. ♙xe4#, 40... ♙f6 41. ♜c6+ ♙f5 42. g4#) 41. g4+ ♙f6 42. ♜c6#) 39. ♜g8! ♙xg8 40. ♙xg8+ ♙g6 41. ♙e8+ ♙h7 (41... ♙f6 42. ♙e6# or 41... ♙f5 42. ♙e6#) 42. ♙g8+ ♙h8 43. ♙f7+ ♙f8 44. ♙xf8+ ♙h7 45. ♙g8 mate.

37... ♙g6

If 37... ♙xh8 38. ♙e8+ ♙h7 39. ♙xe4+ ♙g8 40. ♙e8+ ♙f8 (40... ♙h7 41. ♙c2#) 41. exf4 gxf4 42. ♙xf4 with mate in a few moves.

In all these variations we can observe the bad position of the black queen, totally out of play and unable to defend the black king.

38. ♙e8+ ♙f5



39. ♖xe4+!

The most attractive finish, although not the quickest, which was 39. ♖f8+! ♕xf8 (39... ♗f6 40. ♕e6#, or 39... ♕f6 40. ♖xe4+ ♖xe4 41. ♕c2#) 40. ♖f7+ ♗f6 41. ♕e6#.

Black resigned, in view of 39... ♖f6 (39... ♖xe4 40. ♕c2#) 40. ♖e8, with mate in four moves.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw the outlandish idea 2... ♗h5, harassing the bishop on f4. Although this is a common idea for Black, here it is too early. Black's move ...e5-e4 is not the best and White played very well on the queenside with some precise moves, such as b2-b4 and ♖b1, and he gained the advantage after the pawn break 25.c4!. White's control of the centre and the c-file led to a strong attack against the black king. The game contained some good tactical details, with sacrifices and variations involving a mating attack, and the final queen sacrifice was the icing on the cake.

Game 61

Modern Defence

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

Pablo Garcia Castro

Spain 2012

1.d4 g6 2. ♗f3

With this move order, Black must always be prepared for 2.e4. Another option is

2. ♖f4.

2... ♜g7 3. ♖f4

Again 3.e4 is an option. I want to show an example from a real game between two masters, which ended in explosive fashion after 3...d6 4. ♖c4 ♜d7?? (4... ♜f6 5. ♙e2± is a comfortable variation for White) 5. ♖xf7+!.



analysis diagram

In Ibragimov-Zhelmin, Moscow 1998, Black resigned here, in view of 5... ♔xf7 6. ♜g5+ ♔e8 (6... ♔f8 7. ♜e6++-; 6... ♔f6 7. ♙f3 mate) 7. ♜e6. This is possibly the shortest win in a standard-play game between 2500+ masters.

3...d6 4.e3 ♜d7 5.h3 e5



This is Black's idea, to play a quick ...e7-e5 and transpose to variations of the

King's Indian, but having avoided the main line, in which it is difficult to play ... e7-e5 under good conditions.

6.dxe5

The first few times I came up against this line I always exchanged on e5, because it freed the d4-square for the f3-knight, in case Black advanced with ... e5-e4. Later I discovered that it is also good to play 6.♙h2, as we shall see in the next game.

6...dxe5 7.♙h2



7...♘e7

Another option is 7...♙e7 8.♘c3 ♘gf6?! (8...c6 is better, e.g. 9.♙d2 ♘gf6 10.♙e2 0-0 11.0-0±) 9.♙c4?! (the right move is 9.♘b5! 0-0 (sacrificing the pawn is best; if 9...♙c5? then 10.♘xe5 ♘xe5 11.♙d4 ♙xd4 12.exd4±) 10.♘xc7 ♙b8 11.♙e2 and although Black has some compensation I prefer White) 9...0-0 10.0-0 e4! (10...c6 11.a4 a5 12.♙d2 h6 13.♙fd1± De Prado-Redondo, Spain tt 2013) 11.♘d4?! (11.♘d2 c6 12.♘b3 ♘e5=) 11...♘e5 12.♙b3?! (12.♙e2 and 12.♙e2 were both better) 12...a6 (12...c5) 13.a3 c5 14.♘de2 ♙d8 De Prado-P.Fernandez, Ferrol 2013.

8.♘c3 0-0 9.♙c4

9.♙d2±, followed by 0-0-0, was a good plan for White here.

9...a6 10.a4

It is essential to prevent Black from expanding on the queenside and to provide a retreat for the c4-bishop on a2.

10...b6

Or 10...♘c6 11.0-0 ♙e8 12.a5± Shvedchikov-Tseshkovsky, Arbo 2010.

11.0-0 ♙b7 12.e4!



This move is typical, blocking the diagonal of the b7-bishop, controlling d5 and hindering a future advance of the black pawns with ...f7-f5. The position now looks like a king's pawn opening.

12...c6?

This is already a clear mistake: it leaves the b7-bishop passive and weakens the d6-square. The idea of ...b6-b5 is not unpleasant to White. It was better to play 12...♖c6 13.♗d5, with advantage to White, but still with everything to play for.

13.♗g5

The idea is to play ♗e6 and also f2-f4, putting pressure on f7. Houdini considers that it was even better to play 13.♔d2! b5 14.♖fd1! ♗f6 (14...bxc4 15.♔xd7) 15.♔e3 ♔c8 16.♕a2 b4 17.♗b1 c5 18.♗bd2, which the engine considers to give White a decisive advantage, e.g. 18...♗d7 (18...♗c6 19.♔xc5+-) 19.♗c4 ♔c7 20.♗d6 h6 21.♗xb7 ♔xb7 22.♖d6+-.

13...♗c8

An ugly move, but if 13...b5 then 14.♗e6! fxe6 15.♕xe6+ ♔h8 16.♔xd7 ♔xd7 17.♕xd7±.

14.♔d2



White's idea is to line up his queen and a rook on the d-file.

14.f4! was also good, e.g. 14... ♖e7 15.fxe5! and now:

A) 15... ♗c5+? 16. ♔h1+- ♗xc4 (16... ♕xe5 17. ♕xe5 ♗xe5 18. ♖xf7+-; or 17... ♗xc4 18. ♕xg7 ♗xg7 19. ♗d7 ♖b8 20. ♕d5 cxd5 21. ♖xf7+-; or 17... ♕xe5 18. ♖xf7+-) 17. ♗xd7 ♖a7 18.e6 ♕a8 19. ♖xf7 ♖xd7 20. ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 21.exd7+-;

B) 15... ♕xe5 16. ♕xe5 ♗xg5 (16... ♕xe5 17. ♖xf7 ♖xf7 18. ♕xf7 ♕xc3 19.bxc3 ♗c5+ 20. ♗d4 ♗xd4+ 21.cxd4 ♖g7 22. ♖f1+-; 16... ♗xe5 17. ♖xf7 ♗c5+ 18. ♔h1 ♗xc4 19. ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 20. ♗d7 ♕e7 21. ♗xb7+-) 17. ♕xg7 ♗xg7 18. ♗d4+ f6 19. ♗d7+ ♗h8 20. ♖ad1±.

14... ♗e7

If 14...b5 then 15. ♖fd1 (or 15. ♕e6 fxe6 16. ♕xe6+ ♗h8 17. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 18. ♕xd7 b4 19. ♕d1±) 15...bxc4 16. ♗xd7 ♗xd7 17. ♖xd7 ♖a7 18.a5±.

15. ♖ad1 ♕f6

If 15... ♕c5 then 16.b4 ♕h6 (16... ♕e6 17. ♕xe6 fxe6 18. ♗d7+-) 17.f4 ♕xg5 18.fxg5+-.

16. ♕b3 b5

If 16...c5 then 17. ♕xf7 ♖xf7 18. ♕xf7+ (18. ♗d8+ ♕f8 19. ♗xe7 ♕xe7 20.f4 ±) 18... ♗xf7 (18... ♖xf7 19.f4) 19.f4! ♗e8 (19...exf4 20. ♗xf4 and White wins) 20. ♗d8 ♕e7 21. ♗c7 ♕c6 22.fxe5 ♕xe4 23. ♕xe4 ♕xe4 24. ♖d7 ♕f8 25. ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 26.e6+- or 25... ♗xf8 26. ♖xe7+-.

17. ♕xf7

Once again it was better to play 17.f4! b4 (17...exf4 18. ♗xf4 b4 19. ♕e2 h6 20. ♕xf7 ♖xf7 21. ♕xf7+ ♗xf7 (21... ♖xf7 22.e5) 22. ♖d8+ ♗h7 23.e5 ♗e7 24.exf6 ♗xd8 25.fxg7+-) 18. ♕e2 exf4 19. ♗xf4 h6 20. ♕xf7 ♖xf7 21. ♕xf7+ ♗xf7 22.e5+-.



17... ♖xf7

If 17...c5 then 18.♗d8+ (or 18.♗xe5+ c4 19.♗xc4 bxc4 20.♕xc4+ ♔h8 21.♗fe1+—) 18...c4 19.♗xb7 ♜xb7 20.♕a2+—.

18. ♜d8+

Once again 18.f4! was stronger:

A) 18...♗d5 19.exd5 ♜c5+ 20.♔h1 cxd5 21.♗xd5 ♔h8 22.♗c7 ♜xc7 (22...♗xc7 23.♜d8+ ♕f8 24.fxe5+—) 23.♕xf7 ♜xf7 24.♜d8+ ♜g8 25.♜xg8+ ♔xg8 26.♗d8+ ♔f7 27.♗d7+ with a decisive advantage;

B) 18...♗b6 19.♕xf7+ ♜xf7 20.fxe5 ♗c4 21.♜e1+—;

C) 18...exf4 19.♜xf4 ♗d5 20.exd5 ♗xf4 21.d6+ ♔h8 22.dxe7 ♗xf1+ 23.♔xf1 ♗xe7 24.♗d7+—.

18... ♕f8

If 18...♜xd8 then 19.♗xd8+ ♕f8 20.♕xe5+—; or 18...♗e8 19.♜xe7 ♗xe7 20.♗d7 ♗d5 21.exd5 ♗xd7 22.dxc6+ ♗f7 23.cxb7+—.

19.f4!

Finally White plays this move, opening the f-file.



19...bxa4?

This hastens the defeat, but Black was in a very difficult position anyway.

A) If 19...♙xd8 then 20.♖xd8 exf4 21.♖xf4 ♘d6 22.♖xf6 ♖xd8 23.♙xd6 ♖d7 24.e5+–;

B) The best defence was possibly 19...♘d5 20.♙xe7 ♘cxe7 (20...♘dxe7 21.fxe5+–) 21.axb5 axb5 22.fxe5 ♖xf1+ 23.♙xf1 ♖d8 24.exd5 ♘xd5 25.♙e2 ♙g7 26.♘e4+–;

C) If 19...exf4 then 20.♖xf4 ♘d6 21.♙xe7 ♙xe7 22.♖xf6 ♙xf6 23.♙xd6 ♙g7 24.e5 ♙d8 25.e6+–;

D) Finally, if Black plays 19...♙c5+ then 20.♙h1 ♘e7 (20...♘d6 21.♙xf6 (21.♙xf7+ ♙xf7 22.♙c7+ ♙g8 23.♖xd6 ♙xd6 24.♙xb7±) 21...♘c4 22.♙xe5 ♙xe5 (22...♘xe5 23.fxe5+–) 23.fxe5 ♖xf1+ 24.♖xf1±) 21.♙xf7+ ♙xf7 22.♙c7+–.

20.♙xe7 ♙xe7 21.♙xf7+ ♙xf7 22.fxe5 ♙e6 23.exf6 ♙xf6 24.♖xf6+

And Black resigned, in view of 24...♙xf6 25.♖d7 ♖a7 26.♙b8 ♖a8 27.♖xb7+–.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw a line for Black with ...g7-g6, ...♙g7, ...d7-d6 and ...♘d7, in order to play a quick e7-e5. White can always play e2-e4 and transpose to a Pirc or Modern Defence. In this game we saw the exchange 6.dxe5, although it is also possible to play 6.♙h2. In the game Black chose a passive plan with 9...a6 and 10...b6 and White stood better after he played 12.e4!. Then, after the bad reply 12...c6, White gained a clear advantage and had several ways to finish the game. Black's main problem

was his lack of development and White won thanks to his control of the d-file, the opening of the f-file and the pressure on f7, which proved decisive.

Game 62

Modern Defence

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2250

Aleksa Strikovic

2510

Spain tt 2014 (2)

1.d4 d6 2.♘f4

Another possible move order is 2.♘f3 ♘d7 3.e4! (3.♘f4) and now:

A) 3...g6 4.♘c3 ♘g7 5.♘c4±;

B) 3...e5 4.♘c4 transposes to the Philidor, when the best lines for Black are 4...exd4 5.♙xd4± or 4...c6 5.0-0±. Black should avoid 4...♘gf6? 5.dxe5 ♘xe5 (5...dxe5 6.♘g5+-) 6.♘xe5 dxe5 7.♘xf7+ ♔xf7 8.♙xd8 ♘b4+ 9.♙d2 ♘xd2+ 10.♘xd2± and 4...♘e7? 5.dxe5 dxe5 (5...♘xe5 6.♘xe5 dxe5 7.♙h5) 6.♙d5+-.

C) 3...♘gf6? 4.e5±.

2...♘d7 3.♘f3 g6

If 3...c6 then 4.e4 ♙c7 5.e5! dxe5 6.dxe5±

4.e3



Again the analysis engines prefer 4.e4 or 4.♘c3, transposing to the Pirc or the Modern Defence:

A) 4.♘c3

A1) 4...♗gf6 5.e4 ♗h5 (5...♘g7 6.♘e2±) 6.♘e3± Colovic-Todorovic, Vrnjacka Banja 2012;

A2) 4...♘g7

A21) 5.♙d2!? and now:

A211) 5...c6 6.e4 (6.0-0-0!? ♙c7 7.♖b1 b5 8.e4 e5 9.dxe5 dxe5 10.♘g3± Prié-Beeckmans, Belgium tt 2012) 6...e5 (6...b5 7.e5 d5 8.♘d3± Domenech-Mouhamad, Chateaux 2013) 7.dxe5 dxe5 8.♘e3 (8.♘g5±) 8...♗gf6 9.0-0-0± De Prado-A.Rodriguez, Spain tt 2008;

A212) 5...c5 6.e4! (6.dxc5 ♗xc5 7.e4 ♘g4 8.♘b5+ ♘d7 9.♘xd7+ ♗xd7= Prié-Vandenbussche, Belgium tt 2012/13; or 6.0-0-0 cxd4 7.♗xd4 a6= Asensio-Arribas, Lluçmajor 2013) 6...cxd4 7.♗xd4 ♗gf6 8.♘h6 0-0 9.♘xg7 ♙xg7 10.0-0-0∞.

A22) 5.e4 ♗gf6 6.♘e2 0-0 7.0-0 e5! 8.dxe5 dxe5 9.♘e3=.

B) Perhaps 4.e4 is better, and now:

B1) 4...♗gf6 5.♗c3 (5.e5!? ♗d5 6.♘d2) 5...♘g7 (5...c5? 6.dxc5 ♗xc5 7.e5±) 6.♙d2!? (6.h3 c5 7.e5 ♗h5 8.♘h2 cxd4 9.♙xd4 dxe5 10.♙e3 0-0 11.♙d1☞) and now:

B11) 6...c5 7.dxc5 ♗xc5 8.e5 ♗fe4 (8...♗ce4 9.♙d3 dxe5 10.♙xd8+ ♖xd8 11.♘xe5±) 9.♗xe4 ♗xe4 10.♙b4! dxe5 (10...d5 11.♘b5+ ♘d7 12.♙d1±) 11.♗xe5 ♗d6 12.♘b5+ ♙f8 13.0-0-0±;

B12) 6...0-0 7.0-0-0 (7.♘h6 ♘xh6 8.♙xh6 c5 9.0-0-0 cxd4 10.♗xd4 a6∞) 7...c5 8.dxc5 ♗xc5 9.e5 ♗fe4 10.♗xe4 ♗xe4 11.♙e3 d5 12.♙b1!±.

B2) 4...♘g7 5.e5!? (5.♗c3) and now:

B21) 5...dxe5?! 6.dxe5/e6 7.♗c3 ♗e7 8.♙d2 0-0 9.0-0-0 c6 (9...♗c6±) 10.♘g5!+– Prié-Steinhart, Pierrevert 2007;

B22) If 5...♗b6 then 6.♗c3±;

B23) Or 5...c5 6.c3±;

B24) The best idea is 5...♗h6! 6.♗c3 (6.♙d2 ♗g4 7.exd6 cxd6 8.h3 ♗gf6 9.♘e2=) 6...♗f5 (6...♗g4 7.♙e2±) 7.♘c4 (7.exd6 cxd6 8.♙d2∞) 7...c5 (7...0-0=) 8.♗g5 e6 (8...0-0? 9.♗xf7 ♙xf7 10.e6±) 9.♘xe6 fxe6 10.♗xe6 ♙a5 (10...♙e7 11.♗d5+–) 11.0-0 cxd4 (11...dxe5 12.dxe5±) 12.b4 ♙xb4 13.♗d5 ♙c4 14.♗ec7+ ♙f7 (14...♙f8 15.exd6±) 15.e6+ ♙g8 16.♙d3 ♙xd3 17.cxd3 ±.

4...♘g7 5.h3 e5 6.♘h2

In the previous game we saw 6.dxe5, although the text move is more popular.



6...d6

Black has also tried 6...e7 7.e2 gf6 (7...d6 8.c4 f5 9.c3 c6± Bodiřoga-Krasenkow, Rijeka 2010) 8.c4 (8.0-0 0-0 9.e1; 8.a4) 8...e4 9.0-0 0-0= Pantev-Chatalbashev, Plovdiv 2014, or 6...e7 7.dxe5! dxe5 8.c3±, as in the previous game.

7.e2

A) 7.c3 0-0 8.e2 f5 9.0-0 f7 10.a3 a6 11.c4 e7= Akbaev-Bologan, Khanty-Mansiysk 2013;

B) 7.c4 0-0 (7...exd4 8.xd4 (8.exd4=) 8...0-0 9.c3 c5= Rombaldoni-Rotstein, Livigno 2011) 8.c3 f5 9.e2 e8 10.0-0 exd4 11.exd4 f8 12.d5 d7 E.Alvarez-Strikovic, Oporto 2012;

C) White's best continuation here is 7.dxe5 xe5 (7...dxe5 8.c3±) 8.xe5 xe5 (8...dxe5 9.xd8+ xd8 10.c3±) 9.c3 xh2 (9...0-0 10.d2) 10.xh2 0-0 11.d2±.

7...0-0 8.0-0 f5 9.c4

It is better to play 9.e4+ f7 10.a4± or 9...h8 10.dxe5 dxe5 11.c3±.

9...g5



This is a typical idea in the King's Indian. Black employs a similar plan in the main line of the Mar del Plata variation. Here the engines dislike this move and award a clear advantage to White, although in practice it is not so easy for him.

Another option is 9...f4!? 10.exf4 exd4 (10...exf4 11.♘c3±) 11.♘xd4 (11.♘bd2) 11...♙f6 12.♘b5 (12.♘b3 ♜xb2 13.♘1d2 ♘c5=) 12...♜xb2 13.♘xc7 ♜b8 14.♙d5+? (14.♘d2 ♜xa1 15.♙xa1 ♙xa1 16.♜xa1♞) 14...♘f7♠ Kleiser-Neubauer, Zwettl 2012.

Black has also played 9...♘f7 10.♘c3 g5 11.dxe5 dxe5 12.♙c2± Mrkonjic-C. Foisor, Timisoara 2008.

10.dxe5 dxe5?!

10...♘xe5 is better, e.g. 11.♘c3 ♘xf3+ 12.♙xf3± or 10...g4 11.hxg4 fxg4 12.♘d4 ♘xe5 13.♘c3±.

11.♘c3 c6 12.♙c2



In another game against the same opponent a couple of months earlier, I chose the natural reply 12.♔d6, which is also good; White gained a decisive advantage, although the game eventually ended in a draw. When I came to analyse the game later, Houdini indicated that 12.♔c2 was better, with a clear advantage to White, so I opted to play it in this game.

12.♔d6 g4? (12...♗f7 13.♔a3±) 13.hxg4?! (13.♗xe5! gxh3 (13...♗xe5 14.♗xe5 gxh3 15.gxh3±) 14.♗xd7 ♔xd7 15.♔xd7 ♗xd7 16.gxh3±) 13...♗xg4 14.♗g3 ♔e8 15.♗h2 ♗xh2 16.♗xh2± De Prado-Strikovic, A Coruña 2013.

12...♔e7 13.a3

The idea is to play b2-b4 and c4-c5, but the correct plan in this position is to control the d-file as quickly as possible. So 13.♖ad1! is better, e.g. 13...♔h8 (13...g4 14.hxg4 ♗xg4 15.♗g3±) 14.♖d2 (14.a3±) 14...a5 15.♗a4 g4 16.hxg4 fxg4 17.♗e1± Yurtseven-Berkes, Skopje 2013.

13...g4 14.hxg4 ♗xg4

If 14...fxg4?! then after 15.♗d2± White can exploit the weakened e4-square.

15.♗g3 ♗df6 16.♗h4

A good alternative was 16.♖ad1±

16...♔h8 17.b4?



This move loses the advantage. It is better to play 17.♖fd1, e.g. 17...♖g8 18.e4! f4 19.♖d2 ♗h6 20.♖ad1 ♔g7 21.♖d8 ♗e6 22.♖xa8 ♖xa8 23.♔d3 ♖g8 24.♔d6± and now not 24...♗xf2? (24...♗e3 25.♗xf6 ♔xf6 26.fxe3; 24...♗c8 25.c5±) 25.♔xf2 ♔xg2+ 26.♔e1+–.

17...♖g8 18.c5 ♗h6 19.♗c4 ♗e6 20.♗xe6 ♔xe6 21.♔a2

21.e4 would lead to equality after 21...fxe4 (21...f4 22.♖fd1±) 22.♗xe4 ♔f5

23. ♖ae1 ♜xf3 24.gxf3 ♜e3+ 25.♙g3 ♜xc2 26.♙xf6+ ♜g7 27.♙xg7+ ♜xg7 28.♜xe5=.

21... ♜e8 22.♜ad1?

Another inaccurate move; 22.g3 ♜g6 23.♜ae1= was better.

22...e4 23.♙h2 ♜e5?!

It was better to play 23... ♜h5! 24.♙xf6+ (24.♙xg4 ♜xg4 25.♙g3 ♜g7) 24... ♜xf6 25.♙e2 (25.g3 f4 26.exf4 ♜xf4 27.♙e2 ♜e5) 25... ♜g6 26.♜c4 ♜ag8 27.♙g3 ♜xg3 28.fxg3 ♜xe3+ 29.♜h1 f4 30.gxf4 ♜xf4 31.♜xf4 ♜xd1+ 32.♜f1.

24.♙xf6+ ♜xf6?

And here 24... ♙xf6 25.♙e2 ♜d5 was better.

25.♙xg4! ♜xg4 26.♙e2



Now White is fine; the knight will defend the kingside well from e2 or g3.

26...a5?

Here 26... ♜ag8 was better, with equal chances, e.g. 27.g3 ♜h4 28.♜d2 ♜h3 29.♜f7 ♜xg3+ 30.♙xg3 ♜xg3+ 31.fxg3 ♜xg3+ 32.♜g2 ♜xe3+ 33.♜f2 ♜xf2+ 34.♜f1 ♜d3+ 35.♜xf2 ♜d2+ 36.♜g3 ♜g5+=.

27.♜d6

I saw the variation 27.♜a1 ♜g7 28.♜xf6 ♜xf6 29.♜d7 ♜g7 30.♜fd1 axb4 31.axb4, where White is in no danger of losing, but I thought that this move was better and I played to win.

Here the move 27.bxa5! was good, for instance:

A) 27... ♜xa5? 28.♜d6 ♜g5 29.♜f7 ♜xg2+ 30.♜h1 ♜g4 31.♜e8+ ♜g8 32.♜xg8+ ♜xg8 33.♜xh6+;

B) 27... ♜ag8 28.g3 ♜h4 29.♜g2 ♜h5 (29... ♜xe3? 30.♜b2+ ♜4g7

31.fxe3+–; or 30... ♖g7 31.fxe3 ♖xg3+ 32. ♗xg3 ♗xg3+ 33. ♕h1+–) 30. ♗f4 ♗h4 and now:

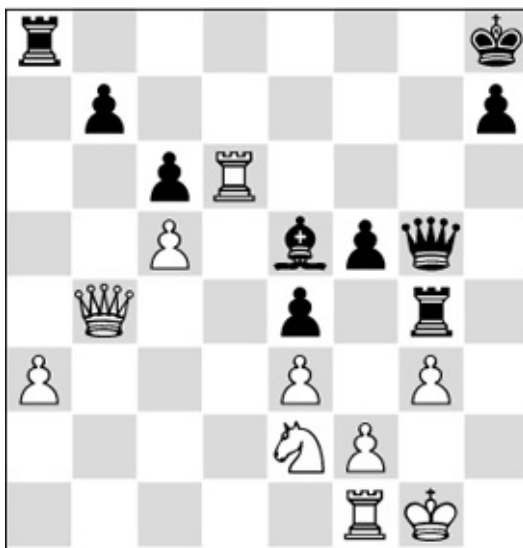
B1) 31. ♗e2 ♗h5 32. ♖h1 ♖xg3+ 33. ♗xg3 ♖xg3+ 34. ♕xg3 (34.fxg3 ♗f3+ 35. ♕h2 ♗h5+ 36. ♕g2=) 34... ♗g4+ 35. ♕h2 ♗h4+ 36. ♕g2 ♗g4+=;

B2) 31. ♗b2+! ♗g7 32. ♗d2 ♗e5 33. ♗e1, with a slight advantage to White.

27... ♗g5 28.g3 axb4 29. ♗b2+

29. ♗b3!? was interesting: 29... bxa3 30. ♖a1 ♖g8 31. ♖xa3 ♗h5 32. ♗b2+ ♗g7 33. ♗a2 ♗e5 34. ♖a8 ♖xa8 35. ♗xa8+ ♖g8 36. ♖d8 ♗f7 37. ♖xg8+ ♗xg8 38. ♗xb7±.

29... ♗g7 30. ♗xb4 ♗e5



31. ♗xb7

It was correct to sacrifice the exchange with 31. ♖fd1! ♗xd6 (31... ♗h4 32. ♗xb7 ♖ag8 33. ♕f1 ♗h3+ (33... ♗h1+ 34. ♗g1±) 34. ♕e1 ♗xd6 (34... ♗h1+ 35. ♕d2±) 35.cxd6±) 32.cxd6 ♖d8 33. ♗xb7 ♗g7 34.d7±.

31... ♖g8 32. ♖d7?

It was essential to play 32. ♖b1! and now:

A) 32... ♗xg3 ends in a draw after 33. ♗xg3 ♖xg3+ 34. ♕f1! ♗h5= (34... ♖g1+ 35. ♕e2 ♗h5+ 36. ♕d2±);

B) 32... ♗xd6? 33.cxd6 ♗h5 34. ♗c7 ♗h4 35. ♖b8 ♗f6 (35... hxc3? 36. ♖xg8+ ♗xg8 37.d7 gxf2+ 38. ♕xf2 ♖g2+ 39. ♕f1+–) 36.d7±;

C) 32... ♗h4! 33. ♗b8!.



analysis diagram

A good move that guarantees the draw for White:

C1) 33... ♖xg3 34.fxg3 ♜xg3+ 35.♗xg3 ♛xg3+ 36.♔f1 ♜f3+ 37.♔e1 ♜xe3+ 38.♔d1 ♜f3+ with a draw by perpetual check;

C2) Or 33... ♖xd6 34.♜b2+ ♜4g7 35.cxd6±;

C3) 33... ♜xb8 34.♜xb8+ ♔g7 35.♜b7+ ♔f8 36.♜b8+ ♔f7 37.♜b7+, with a draw by perpetual check.

32... ♜h6 33.♔g2?

This loses. It was essential to try to save the position an exchange down by playing 33. ♜fd1 ♖xg3! 34. ♜xh7+ (34. ♗xg3?? loses to 34... ♜xg3+--+) 34... ♜xh7 35. ♜xh7+ ♔xh7 36. ♗xg3 f4 (36... ♜xg3+ 37.fxg3 ♜xg3+ 38.♔f2=) 37.exf4 ♜xf4 38. ♜e1 and Black is clearly better but White has some drawing chances.

33... ♜h4 34. ♜g1 ♜h2+ 35.♔f1 ♜b8!-+

The move I had missed. Now White has to sacrifice the queen to prevent the check on b1, but the position remains lost.

36. ♜xb8+ ♖xb8 37. ♜d8+ ♔g7 38. ♜xb8 ♜e6 39. ♜b7+ ♔f6 40. ♜b6 ♜a2

White resigned.

SUMMARY

In this game we saw that when when Black plays ...d7-d6, ... ♗d7 and ... g7-g6 White has options of playing ♗c3 and e2-e4, transposing to the Pirc or Modern Defence. Remaining within the pattern of the London System, we looked at White's most popular alternative, which is 6. ♗h2 (instead of

6.dxe5, which we covered in the previous game). Black employed a typical King's Indian plan with 6...♗h6 and advanced his pawns with 8...f5 and 9...g5. In theory this favours White, who obtains a clear advantage with either 12.♙d6 or 12.♙c2, as played in the game. White's plan is based on occupying the d-file as soon as possible. The black attack looks more dangerous than it actually is. White defended well and gained the advantage. In the game, after mistakes by both sides, an interesting position was reached, which White should not have lost.

Game 63

Old Indian Defence

Nigel Short

2660

Garry Kasparov

2775

Skelleftea 1989

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 c6

Another, more normal, move order for playing the Old Indian Defence is 2...d6 3.♗f4 ♗bd7 4.c3 e6 and now:

A) 5.h3 g6 (5...♗e7 6.e3 0-0 7.♗e2 ♖e8 8.0-0 ♗f8 9.♗h2 b6 10.♙c2 ♗b7 11.♖d1± Petrovic-Blagojevic, Novi Sad 1996) 6.e3 ♗g7 7.♗e2 b6 8.a4 a6 9.♗a3 ♗b7 10.0-0 0-0= Rebane-Kir.Georgiev, Puhajarve 2013;

B) 5.♗bd2 ♙e7 6.♗g3 h6 7.e4 ♗h5 8.♗d3 g6 9.♙e2 ♗g7 10.e5 ♗b6 11.♗e4 ♗xg3 12.fxg3 ♗d7 13.0-0= Hebden-Rowson, Edinburgh 2009.

3.♗f4 d6



Here we have an Old Indian set-up against the London System.

4.h3

There are other options, such as:

A) 4.e3 ♘h5 5.♙g5 h6 6.♙h4 g5 7.♘fd2 ♘f6 8.♙g3=;

B) White can also play 4.c3 g6 5.h3 ♘b6 6.♙c1 ♙g7 7.a4 ♘a6 8.♘bd2± Bellon-Gonzalez, Las Palmas 1999;

C) Another perfectly good alternative is 4.♘c3 ♙a5 5.♙d2 b5 (5...♘bd7 6.h3 e5 7.♙h2±) 6.♘e4 (6.a3±) 6...♙xd2+ 7.♘exd2= Caceres-Salinas, Talcahuano 2012;

D) Finally there is also 4.♘bd2 ♘h5 5.♙e3 (5.♙g3=) 5...g6 (5...♘f6 6.h3±) 6.g3 ♙g7 7.c4 0-0 8.♙g2=.

4...♙b6!?

An interesting move that we have already seen in many other variations. Alternatives include:

A) 4...g6 5.e3 ♙g7 6.♙e2 0-0 7.0-0 ♘bd7 8.c4 ♘e8 9.♘c3 ♘c7 10.♙h2 b6 11.b4 ♙b7 12.♙b3± Grachev-Movsesian, Moscow 2010;

B) But perhaps the best is 4...♙f5 5.♘bd2 ♘bd7 6.e3± Frank-Moyano, cr 1997;

C) A typical Old Indian line would be 4...♘bd7 5.e3 (5.♘bd2 ♙a5 6.c3 g6 7.e3 (7.e4±) 7...♙g7 8.♙e2 0-0 9.0-0± Heinzel-Schönhof, Duisburg 2000) 5...♙c7 6.♙e2 e5 7.♙h2 ♙e7 8.0-0 0-0 9.a4 (9.c4±) 9...b6 10.♘bd2± Sitnikov-Petrov, Donetsk 2010.



5.b3!?

It is not good to play 5.♙c1 c5 6.e3 cxd4 7.exd4 ♘c6=.

The best move is to offer the pawn with 5.♘bd2! ♙xb2 (taking the pawn is

critical; the alternatives are inferior: 5...♘d5 6.♙c4! ♜b4+ 7.♙d2 ♜xc4 8.e4 ♜a4 9.a3!±, 5...♙f5 6.♙c4 ♜c7 7.e3±, or 5...c5 6.e3±) 6.e4! ♜c3 (6...♜b6 7.♞b1 ♜c7 8.♙c4± is similar to the Vaganian Gambit that we saw in the chapter on the Benoni; White has a lot of compensation for the pawn) 7.♙d3 ♙bd7 8.0-0 e5 9.♙h2 exd4 10.♙c4±.

5...c5

Also possible are 5...♙f5 6.e3 ♙d5 7.♙d3 ♜b4+ 8.♙e2= Frometa-Dominguez, Cienfuegos 1996, and 5...♙bd7 6.e3 g6 (6...♜a5+ 7.c3±) 7.♙h2 ♙g7 8.♙d3 0-0 9.0-0±.

6.dxc5

If 6.d5!? then 6...g6 7.c4 ♙g7 8.♙c3 ♙f5 9.♞c1=. It seems better to play 6.e3, e.g. 6...♙c6 7.c3 (7.d5 ♙b4 8.♙c3 ♙f5 9.♞c1 ♜a5 10.♙b5+ ♙d8 11.0-0 ♙bxd5 12.♙xd5 ♜xb5 13.c4☞) 7...g6 8.♙c4 ♙g7 9.0-0 0-0=.

6...♜xc5 7.c4 g6 8.♙c3 ♙g7 9.♞c1 ♙f5

Another option was 9...0-0 10.♜d2 (10.e4 ♙xe4 11.♙xe4 ♜f5☞) 10...♙c6 11.e4 b6 12.♙e2 ♙b7=.

10.♙e3 ♜a5 11.♙d2 ♜d8 12.♙d4

Here 12.♙g5!? was playable, e.g. 12...h6 (12...0-0 13.e4) 13.e4 hxg5 (13...♙c8 14.♙f3±) 14.exf5 gxf5 15.♙xg5=.



12...♙e4 13.e3

If 13.♙xe4 then 13...♙xe4 14.e3 ♙c6 15.♜c2 ♙xd2 16.♜xd2=, or 13.f3 ♙c6 (13...♙c6 14.e3 ♙xd4 15.exd4 ♙c6 16.♙e3±) 14.e3 0-0 15.♙e2=.

13...♙c6 14.♙de2?!

It was better to play 14.f3! ♙xd4 (14...e5 15.♙db5 ♙f5 16.e4±) 15.exd4 ♙c6 16.d5 ♙d7 17.♙e3±.

14... ♖d3 15. ♗f4 ♖xf1 16. ♕xf1 0-0

Black has emerged in very good shape from the opening, after White failed to play the correct move 5. ♗bd2.

17. g3 e6 18. ♕g2 d5?!

18...a6 19. ♖e2 ♖e7 20. h4 h6= was better.

19. cxd5 exd5 20. ♖f3 d4!?



Black could have defended the pawn indirectly with 20... ♖e8! 21. ♗fxd5 ♗xd5 22. ♖xd5 ♖xd5+ 23. ♗xd5 ♖ad8 24. ♖c5 ♖e5 25. e4 ♖xe4 26. ♗e3 ♗d4=.

21. ♗cd5

It was better to take, because in the endgame this pawn will cause White problems: 21. exd4 ♗xd4 22. ♖xb7 ♖b8 23. ♖xa7 ♖a8 24. ♖b7 ♖b8 25. ♖a6 ♗xb3 26. axb3 ♖xd2 27. ♖hd1 ♖b2=.

21... ♗xd5 22. ♖xd5 ♖e7 23. ♖he1 ♖ad8 24. ♖c5 ♖d7 25. e4 ♗e5 26. ♖ed1

Here 26. ♖xa7!? was interesting, e.g. 26... g5 27. ♗d5 ♗d3 28. ♖c7 ♗xe1+ 29. ♗xe1 ♖b5 30. ♗b4 ♖fe8 31. ♗e7+ ♖h8 32. ♖xb7 ♖xb7 33. ♖xb7 d3 34. ♗d2, with good compensation.

26...b6 27. ♖c7?!

It was better to play 27. ♖d5, with equality.

27... ♖b5 28. ♖xa7?

This is losing. White could stay in the game with 28. ♖f1 ♖fe8 29. f3∞.

28...g5!-+



With this move Black decides the game: the white king is weak and the pawn on d4 is strong.

29. ♖a4

This loses a piece, but if 29. ♘h5 then 29... ♔e2!–+, or if 29. ♘d5 then 29... ♔d3–+.

29... ♖xa4 30. bxa4 gxf4 31. gxf4 ♘d3

Black keeps his extra piece and although White has two pawns for it, that is not enough here.

32. ♖c6 ♘b2 33. ♖b1 ♘xa4 34. f5

More tenacious was 34. e5 f6 (34... ♖a8 35. ♖b4 ♖fd8 36. ♖cc4 ♘c5 37. ♖xd4 ♖xd4 38. ♖xd4 ♖f8) 35. e6 ♖fe8 36. ♖b4 ♘c5 37. f5 (37. ♖bxb6 ♘e4 38. ♘b4 d3–+) 37... ♘f8 38. ♖bxb6 ♖d5–+.

34... ♖fe8 35. f3 ♖a8 36. ♖h1 ♘c5 37. ♖g1

If 37. ♖cxb6 ♘d7 38. ♖6b3 ♖xa2–+.

37... ♖h8 38. ♖c7 ♖f8 39. ♘f4 ♖ac8 40. ♖e7 ♖ce8 41. ♖c7 ♘d3 42. ♘d6 ♖g8 43. ♖xf7 ♘e5 44. ♖xg8+ ♖xg8 45. ♖d7??

This allows mate, but there was no defence. If 45. ♘xe5+ then 45... ♘xe5 46. ♖c7 ♘xf3 47. ♖c1 d3–+.

45... ♘f2 mate

SUMMARY

In this game we looked at the Old Indian Defence with ...d7-d6, ...c7-c6, ...♘f6 and ...♘bd7 against the London System. White chose to play 4.h3, although there are other options such as 4.c3, 4.e3, 4.♘c3 or 4.♘bd2. After 4... ♖b6, attacking the b2-pawn, White played 5.b3, but the best is

5. ♖bd2, sacrificing a pawn, which gives White the advantage. Black equalised the game and in the middlegame, after the critical 20...d4, White should have taken the pawn, with equality, but then after a couple of mistakes White was lost, thanks to the strength of Black's d4-pawn and the weakness of the white king.

Game 64

Polish Defence
Vladimir Kramnik

2791

Magnus Carlsen

2823

Moscow 2011 (5)
1.d4 b5



The Polish Defence!

We shall complete our theoretical survey by looking at some irregular openings for Black against 1.d4:

1...e5 The Englund Gambit does not have a very good reputation; 2.dxe5 ♖c6 (2...d6 3. ♖f3 ♖c6 4. ♙g5 transposes) 3. ♖f3 ♙e7 (3...d6 4. ♙g5 (4. ♙f4) 4... ♙e7 (4... ♙d7 5.exd6 ♙xd6 6. ♖c3±) 5. ♙xe7 ♙xe7 6.exd6 cxd6 7. ♖c3± (7.e3±)) 4. ♙g5 (4. ♖c3 ♖xe5 5.e4 d6 6. ♙e2 ♖xf3+ 7. ♙xf3 ♙e6 8.0-0± Kvon-Saidov, Tashkent 2011) 4... ♙b4+ 5. ♖c3 ♙xb2 6. ♙d2 ♙b4 7. ♙b1 ♙a3 8. ♖d5 ♙xd2+ 9. ♙xd2 ♙d8 10.e4± St.Hansen-Toll, Rynia 2013.

1...a6



A few strong grandmasters, such as the French grandmaster Christian Bauer, play this irregular defence. Against 1.e4, 1...a6 is called the St. George, but in response to 1.d4 it does not appear to have a name; perhaps it should be called the Bauer Defence.

White can play:

A) 2.e4 b5 (2...e6 3.c4 (3.♘c3 d5 transposes to a good French for White) 3...d5 4.exd5 exd5 5.♘c3 ♙b4 (5...♘f6) 6.♘f3 (6.cxd5 ♙xd5 7.♘f3±) 6...♘f6 7.♙d3 0-0 8.0-0 dxc4 9.♙xc4= Meier-Bauer, Biel 2012) 3.♙d3 (3.a4, 3.♘f3) 3...♙b7 4.♘f3 e6 5.0-0 ♘f6 6.♙e2± Grachev-Pridorozhni, Olginka 2011;

B) 2.♙f4 d5 3.e3 ♘f6 4.♘f3 ♙g4 5.c4 dxc4 (5...c6 6.♘c3± Gibiec-Velicka, Pribram 2000) 6.♙xc4 e6 7.h3 ♙xf3 8.♙xf3 ♘c6 9.♘c3± Cebalo-Feletar, Belisce 1999;

C) 2.c4 b5 3.cxb5 (3.e4! ♙b7 4.d5 (4.♘d2±) 4...e6 5.♘f3± Fluvia Potatos-Shengelia, Banyoles 2007) 3...axb5 4.e4 ♙b7 (4...b4) 5.♙xb5 ♙xe4 6.♘f3 ♘f6 7.♘c3= Gajewski-Bauer, France tt 2013.

1...b6 The English Defence



This often transposes to the Queen's Indian, the Réti Reversed or the Dutch, or, if White plays an early e2-e4, to Owen's Defence.

A) 2.e4 ♖b7 3.♙d3 e6 4.♘f3 c5 5.c3 ♘f6 6.♔e2 (6.e5! ♘d5 7.0-0 ♘c6 8.♙e4± Ni Hua-Khairullin, Khanty-Mansiysk 2011) 6...d5 7.e5 ♘fd7 8.0-0 ♙e7= Moiseenko-Bauer, Bilbao 2004;

B) 2.♙f4 ♙b7 3.♘f3 (3.♘d2 f5 4.e3 ♘f6 5.♘gf3 e6 6.h3 ♙e7 7.g4∞ Kotic-Hoang Thanh Trang, Budapest 2006; 3.e3 f5 4.♘f3 e6) 3...e6 (3...♘f6 4.e3 e6 5.♘bd2 ♙e7 6.h3 reaches the normal line of the Queen's Indian against the London System) 4.e3 f5 5.♙d3 ♘f6 6.0-0 (6.♘bd2 ♙d6 7.♙xd6 cxd6 8.♔e2 0-0 Barnaure-Miezis, Dubai 2004) 6...♙e7 7.c4 0-0 8.♘c3 d6 9.h3± Walaszczyk-Szromba, Polanica Zdroj 2004;

C) 2.♘c3 ♙b7 3.e4 ♘f6 4.♙d3 e6 5.♘ge2 d5 6.e5 ♘fd7 7.♘f4 g6 8.♔g4± Oral-Gawehns, Hamburg 1999.

1...♘c6 The Lundin Defence



2.d5 (2. ♖f4) 2... ♗e5 and now:

A) 3.f4 ♗g6 4.e4 e5 5.dxe6 fxe6 6. ♗f3 (6. ♗c3± Hartl-Steiner, Austria Bundesliga B 2012/13) 6...b6 7. ♖d3 ♖b7 8. ♜e2± Istratescu-Petenyi, Legnica Ech 2013;

B) 3.e4 e6 and now:

B1) 4.dxe6 dxe6 (4...fxe6 5. ♗c3 b6 6. ♗f3 ♗xf3+ 7. ♜xf3 ♖b7 8. ♜h5+ (8. ♜g3± Spacek-Gross, Trier 1997) 8...g6 9. ♜e5 ♗f6 10. ♖b5 c6 11. ♖e2± Volkov-Savchenko, Moscow 2006) 5. ♜xd8+ ♜xd8 6.f4 ♗g6 7. ♗f3± Karpov-Berlandier, Cannes Internet simul 1998;

B2) 4.f4 exd5!? (4... ♗g6 5. ♗c3±) 5.fxe5 (5. ♗c3±) 5... ♜h4+ 6. ♜e2 ♜h5+ 7. ♜d2 ♜h6+ 8. ♜c3 ♜c6+ 9. ♜d2 ♜h6+ 10. ♜d3 ♜a6+ 11. ♜d2 ♜h6+ 12. ♜e1 ♜h4+ 13. ♜d2 ♜f4+ 14. ♜c3 ♜xe5+ 15. ♜d4 ♖b4+ (15... ♜xe4) 16. ♜d3 dxe4+ 17. ♜xe4 ♜xe4+ 18. ♜xe4 ♗f6+± Erdös-Rapport, Hungary tt 2011/12.

C) 3. ♗c3 e6 4.e4 exd5 5.exd5 (better is 5.f4! ♖b4 (5... ♗g6 6. ♜xd5±, 5...d4 6. ♜xd4 ♗c6 7. ♜c4±) 6. ♗e2 ♗g6 7. ♜xd5 ♗f6 8. ♜d3±) 5... ♖c5 6. ♗e4 ♜e7± Van Wely-Zagema, Dortmund 1992;

D) 3. ♖f4?! ♗g6 4. ♖g3 ♗f6 5. ♗c3 e5= Bacrot-Bauer, Ajaccio 2007. Another irregular defence is 1...c6 2. ♖f4 ♜b6 3. ♗f3 (3.b3=; 3. ♗c3 ♜xb2 4. ♖d2) 3... ♜xb2 4. ♗bd2 ♗f6 5. ♖b1 ♜xa2 6.e4±.

2. ♗f3



A) The engines consider the best move here to be 2.e4! ♖b7 (2...c6 3.♘f3 e6 4.a4 b4± Cheparinov-Pesotsky, Bastia 2011) 3.♘d2 (3.♙d3 ♘f6 4.♙e2 c5 5.dxc5 ♘a6 6.♘f3 ♘xc5= Wojtaszek-Pakleza, Warsaw 2010; or 3.♙xb5! ♙xe4 4.♘f3, transposing to the game) 3...a6 and now:

A1) 4.a4 b4 5.c4 (5.♘gf3±, 5.♙d3±) 5...bxc3 6.bxc3± Lputian-Alexandria, Biel 1997;

A2) 4.♘gf3 e6 5.♙d3 ♘f6 (5...c5 6.dxc5 ♙xc5 7.a4 ♘f6 (7...♘c6±) 8.0-0 bxa4? (8...♙c7± Cosma-Scekic, Subotica 2002) 9.e5 ♘g4 10.♙xa4+- Leita-Dominguez, Menden 2009) 6.0-0 c5 7.c3 ♘c6± Karjakin-Popov, Panormo 2002;

A3) 4.♙d3 e6 5.a4 c5 6.dxc5 ♙xc5 7.♘gf3±;

A4) 4.b3! (the alternatives above are better) 4...e6 5.♙b2 d6 6.♘gf3 ♘d7 7.c4± Dreev-Kossobudzki, Warsaw 2013.

B) Another option is 2.♙f4, intending to play a London System set-up.



For instance, 2... ♖b7 3.e3 ♗f6 4.h3 e6 5.♗f3 a6 6.♕d3 ♗c6 7.c3 ♗e7 8.♗bd2 ♗g6 9.♕h2± Cebalo-Vasiukov, Condino 2009.

2... ♖b7

Or 2... ♗f6 3.♕g5 (3.♗bd2 ♖b7 4.e4; 3.♕f4 ♖b7 4.e3±) 3... ♖b7 4.♗bd2 a6 5.c3 e6 6.e4 h6 7.♕xf6 ♗xf6± Wang Yue-Ponkratov, Zurich 2010.

3.e4

Other options are:

A) 3.g3 ♗f6 4.♕g2 e6 5.0-0 c5 6.c3= Yakovenko-Pridorozhni, Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013;

B) 3.♕f4 ♗f6 4.e3±;

C) 3.e3 a6 4.♕d3 d6 5.a4 b4 6.0-0 ♗d7 7.e4± Sambuev-Howell, Ottawa 2007.

3... ♕xe4

If 3...a6 then 4.♕d3±.

4. ♕xb5 ♗f6 5.0-0 e6

If 5...c6 then 6.♕a4 d5 7.♗e5 ♗b6 8.c4±, or 5... ♖b7 6.c4 e6 7.♗c3±.

6.c4 ♕e7 7.♗c3 ♖b7



White is better, with a space advantage. The position is a reversed Sokolsky Opening (1.b4 e5 2.♖b2 ♕xb4 3.♕xe5) with an extra tempo for White.

8.d5

White gains more space; 8.♕a4 0-0 9.♕c2 d6 10.♗e1± or 8.♗e1± are more common.

8...0-0 9.♕f4

Here 9.♕a4 has been played more often, e.g. 9... ♗a6 (9... ♖b4 10.♕g5 ♕xc3 11.bxc3 h6± Speelman-Hodgson, London 2007) 10.♗e1 (10.a3 ♗c5 11.♕c2 a5

12. ♖e3 exd5 13.cxd5± Wojtkiewicz-Bronstein, Reykjavik 1994) 10... ♖b4
 11. ♖g5 ♗c5 12. ♖c2 ♖xc3? (12...h6=) 13.bxc3 d6 14. ♖h4 h6 15. ♗d4 exd5?
 16. ♗f5+– Eingorn-Semeniuk, USSR 1984.

9... ♗a6

Let us examine a few alternatives:

A) 9...c6? 10.d6! cxb5 11.dxe7 ♖xe7 12. ♖d6±;

B) 9...d6 is better: 10. ♖e1 (10. ♗d4 e5 11. ♗f5 exf4 12. ♖e1±) 10...c6
 11.dxc6 ♗xc6 12. ♖xc6 ♖xc6 13. ♗d4 ♖b7 14. ♗db5 ♗e8= Piasetski-
 Ramirez, Alajuela 2014;

C) 9... ♖d6 10. ♖g5 (10. ♖xd6 cxd6 11. ♖d4 e5 12. ♖e3±) 10...h6 11. ♖h4
 g5 12. ♖g3± Velikanov-Gubanov, Kolomna 2012;

D) 9... ♖e8 10. ♖e1 ♖f8 11. ♗d4 (11. a3±; 11.dxe6±) 11...c6 12.dxc6
 ♗xc6= Mackle-Arkell, Paignton 2011.

10. ♖e1 ♖c8 11. ♗d4 ♖b4 12. ♖g5!±



Exploiting the shortage of black pieces on the kingside.

12... ♗e8?

It was better to play 12... ♖xc3 13. ♖xf6 ♖xd4 (13...gxf6 14.bxc3+–, 13...
 ♖xb2 14. ♖g4+–) 14. ♖xd4±.

13. ♖e3

The most human and natural move, preparing an attack on the black king. But
 White could have won here with the move 13. ♖a4!, e.g. 13... ♖xc3 14. ♖xd7
 ♗c5 15. ♖xc8 ♗xa4 16. ♖xb7 ♖b8 17.bxc3 ♖xb7 18. ♖e7+–.

13...c6 14. ♖xa6 ♖xa6 15. ♖h5! f6

If 15... ♖xc4 then 16. ♖h3 h6 17. ♖xh6+–, or 15...g6 16. ♖h4 ♖xc3 17.bxc3
 c5 18. ♖h3 h5 19. ♗f3±.

16. ♖h3!

White's attack is unstoppable now; Black's pieces are situated too far away from their king.



16...fxg5

If 16... ♖xc3 then 17. ♗xh7+ ♔f7 18. ♖xc3 fxg5 19.dxe6+ dxe6 20. ♗f3 ♔e7 21. ♖e1 and the black king will not survive.

17. ♗xh7+ ♔f7 18. ♗h5+

Here 18.dxe6+ dxe6 19. ♗e4 was also winning.

18... ♗g8

If 18... ♗e7 then 19. ♗xg5+ ♔f7 20. ♗h5+ ♔e7 21. ♗h4+ ♗f6 (21... ♖f6 22.dxe6 dxe6 23. ♗e4+-; 21... ♗f7 22.dxe6+ dxe6 23. ♗e4+-) 22.dxe6 dxe6 23. ♖e1 ♔f7 24. ♗f3, and wins.

19. ♗h7+ ♔f7 20. ♗e4 ♖xc4 21. ♗h5+ ♔e7

If 21... ♗g8 then 22. ♗xg5 with unstoppable mate, or 21...g6 22. ♗h7+ ♗g7 23. ♖f3+-.

22. ♗xg5+ ♔f7 23. ♗h5+ ♔e7 24. ♗g5+ ♔f7 25.dxe6+ dxe6 26. ♗f3+-



The knight regroup, threatening to land the decisive blow on e5.

26... ♖g8 27. ♗h4 ♜xf3 28. ♗h7+ ♜f8 29. ♜xf3+ ♜e7 30. ♗h4+

And Black resigned, in view of 30... ♜f6 31. ♜xf6 gxf6 32. ♗xc4+–, or 30... ♜d7 31. ♜f7+ ♜e7 32. ♗xe7 mate.

SUMMARY

In this final game we have examined various irregular, or not very common, replies for Black to 1.d4. Against most of these we can employ a specific series of moves, which, as we explained, are simply the best. Nevertheless, we can also try to play a London System just the same. The majority of these irregular defences do not pose a problem if White is at least minimally prepared. In the main game we saw the Polish Defence with 1... b5, which is normally played using the move order 1.d4 ♜f6 2. ♜f3 b5. White decided to exchange the b5-pawn for the one on e4 and then, after playing c2-c4, he gained a good advantage in development. Black played rather passively and White exploited this to mount a strong attack against the black king, including a piece sacrifice. This was a very good victory by Kramnik, playing aggressively against Carlsen, who rarely loses in this manner.

CONCLUSION

In this final chapter we have looked at Black's less common options against 1.d4. In Games 61 and 62 we analysed Black's move order with ...d7-d6,

...g7-g6, ...♘d7 and ...♙g7, intending a quick ...e7-e5. If White tries to play a normal London System, the positions that arise are typical of the King's Indian. White has two options after ...e7-e5: dxe5, which we saw in Game 61, and ♙h2, as in Game 62. White's plan consists of playing in the centre, especially along the d-file and on the queenside. Black often advances his kingside pawns, as in Game 62, but White should not be afraid of this, since his position is in no danger and, if he plays well, he should retain the advantage. We should also keep in mind that against this move order by Black it is also good to play e2-e4 or ♘c3, when the game turns into a Pirc or Modern Defence. White can also play ♙d2 and 0-0-0.

In Game 63 we saw the Old Indian Defence with ...d7-d6, ...c7-c6, ...♘f6 and ...♙b6, with the typical plan to attack b2. We also looked at the other options, without ...♙b6. The best plan for White is to sacrifice the b2-pawn with 5. ♘bd2. In the game White played 5.b3 and Black equalised.

Within Game 64 we examined some rarer defences for Black against 1.d4, such as 1...e5, the Englund Gambit, the defence 1...a6, the Lundin Defence with 1...♘c6, the English Defence with 1...b6, the nameless 1...c6, with the idea of a quick ...♙b6, and the Polish Defence with 1...b5, as played in the main game. White responded with the exchange of the b5-pawn for the e4-pawn, emerging from the opening with a big advantage and going on to win with a strong attack.

FINAL CONCLUSIONS

With this chapter we conclude the theoretical survey of all the lines available to Black to face the London System. As we explained in the introduction, this system is a universal opening, which is playable against almost any reply by Black. White tries to play a solid scheme with a few very concrete and clear ideas, without having to memorise a lot of theory or keep up to date with the latest theoretical novelties.

It is certain that there are some nuances that we need to know well, so as not to lose the advantage of playing with white. First of all, the move order recommended in this book is 2. ♙f4, rather than 2. ♘f3. The present state of theory supports this. If, nevertheless, White prefers to play 2. ♘f3, then he should be prepared to play 3.c3 (rather than 3. ♙f4), as we saw in Chapter 8.

Another important nuance is when to play the move h2-h3 and when not. We have tried to make this clear in every chapter, because in some lines h2-

h3 is necessary, but in others it can amount to an important waste of a tempo. If we are going to allow the exchange of our dark-squared bishop, we need to ensure that we get something in return, such as a weakening of Black's kingside, or a half-open h-file if Black is castled.

Another important aspect is the precise move order needed in some lines to prevent annoying variations. For instance, in many variations Black has the very common plan of attacking the b2-pawn with ...♝b6. It is important for White to have a good knowledge of each position, because in the majority of cases Black cannot safely capture the pawn, so White has no need to defend it, in which case the black queen will not be well placed on b6.

Another idea worth highlighting is White's play on the queenside. It is often here that White will gain the advantage. Remember especially that if Black plays ...c5-c4, White should be looking to break quickly with b2-b3. In other openings, such as the Indian defences, it is on this wing that we are going to gain the advantage.

The exchange of queens is also a frequent occurrence. If White plays well he can avoid having to exchange queens on b6, which usually leads to endgames which are either equal or good for Black. However, it is good to know that in Slav-type variations where White, having already played c2-c4, plays ♙b3, if Black replies with ...♝b6 it is good for White to play the advance c4-c5, and after the exchange of queens on b3 this endgame is very good for White.

Against the black systems with ...d7-d5 and ...e7-e6, White usually has good attacking chances, with his bishop on d3, knight on e5 backed up with f2-f4, followed by sending the queen or the other knight to the kingside and breaking with g2-g4. We also saw several examples of winning sacrifices, such as ♙xh7+.

I should like to remind you that it is a good idea to be familiar with the Slav Exchange Variation, because Black can transpose to it. In general several of the resulting positions resemble the Slav, or the Queen's Gambit Declined, with ♙f4.

Finally there is a collection of variations which depart somewhat from the traditional style of the London System but which I recommend learning, so that we can vary our play and surprise our opponents, such as the Barry Attack against the King's Indian or the Grünfeld, the Vaganian Gambit in the Benoni, the Morris Gambit with 3.e4 against the ...d7-d5, ...c7-c5 line. Also interesting are the dangerous Pereyra Attack with ♙e5 and h2-h4 against the Orthodox systems, and the so-called Jobava Attack with d2-d4,

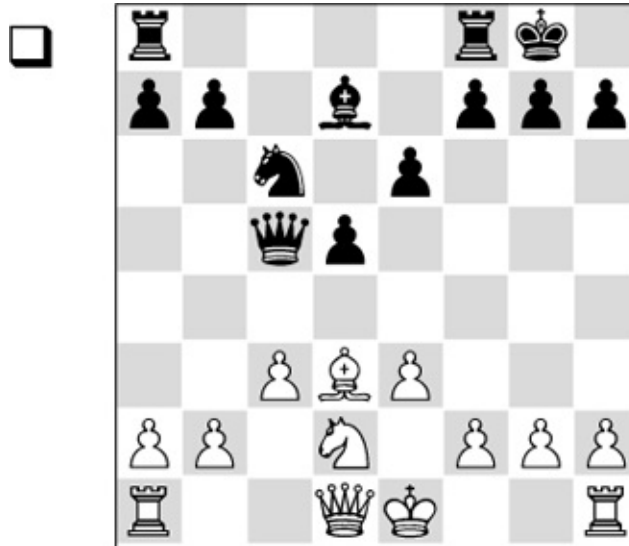
♙f4 and ♘c3, a cross between the Richter-Veresov and the London System. There are several other systems with ♘c3 for White in various lines, and these are even recommended by Houdini. Another option is to take on c5 at an early stage.

Chapter 11

Part 1: Tactics exercises

Next we present you with various tactics exercises, based on games using the London System; many, but not all, are taken from games in the book. The difficulty level is random: they range from the very simple to the quite complex; some involve a mating attack, while others are based on simply gaining a material advantage. The solutions can be found at the back of the book. These positions will help the reader become familiar with typical combinations. Good luck!

Exercise 1



(solution on page 292)

Exercise 2



(solution on page 292)

Exercise 3



(solution on page 293)

Exercise 4



(solution on page 293)

Exercise 5



(solution on page 293)

Exercise 6



(solution on page 294)

Exercise 7



(solution on page 294)

Exercise 8



(solution on page 294)

Exercise 9



(solution on page 295)

Exercise 10



(solution on page 295)

Exercise 11



(solution on page 295)

Exercise 12



(solution on page 296)

Exercise 13



(solution on page 296)

Exercise 14



(solution on page 297)

Exercise 15



(solution on page 297)

Exercise 16



(solution on page 297)

Exercise 17



(solution on page 298)

Exercise 18



(solution on page 298)

Exercise 19



(solution on page 299)

Exercise 20



(solution on page 299)

Exercise 21



(solution on page 299)

Exercise 22



(solution on page 300)

Exercise 23



(solution on page 300)

Exercise 24



(solution on page 300)

Exercise 25



(solution on page 300)

Exercise 26



(solution on page 301)

Exercise 27



(solution on page 301)

Exercise 28



(solution on page 301)

Exercise 29



(solution on page 301)

Exercise 30

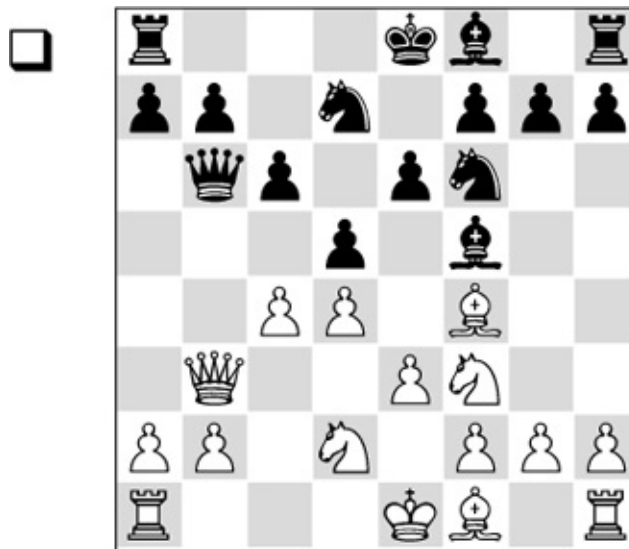


(solution on page 302)

Part 2: Strategy exercises

In this section we have set you some exercises in strategy, based on the London System. You are asked to find the best move or plan, appropriate to the position and in the spirit of this opening. Many of the examples are from games in the book. You will need to remember some of the key points, which might be right in the opening or might be more of a middlegame character, but all of which you will need to know very well, in order to play the London System in the correct manner.

Exercise 31



(solution on page 303)

Exercise 32



(solution on page 303)

Exercise 33



(solution on page 303)

Exercise 34



(solution on page 304)

Exercise 35



(solution on page 304)

Exercise 36



(solution on page 304)

Exercise 37



(solution on page 305)

Exercise 38



(solution on page 305)

Exercise 39



(solution on page 305)

Exercise 40



(solution on page 305)

Exercise 41



(solution on page 306)

Exercise 42



(solution on page 306)

Exercise 43



(solution on page 307)

Exercise 44



(solution on page 307)

Exercise 45



(solution on page 307)

Exercise 46



(solution on page 308)

Exercise 47



(solution on page 308)

Exercise 48



(solution on page 308)

Exercise 49



(solution on page 309)

Exercise 50



(solution on page 309)

Exercise 51



(solution on page 309)

Exercise 52



(solution on page 310)

Exercise 53



(solution on page 310)

Exercise 54



(solution on page 310)

Exercise 55



(solution on page 311)

Exercise 56



(solution on page 311)

Exercise 57



(solution on page 311)

Exercise 58



(solution on page 312)

Exercise 59



(solution on page 312)

Exercise 60



(solution on page 312).

Chapter 12

Solutions to the Tactics Exercises

Exercise 1

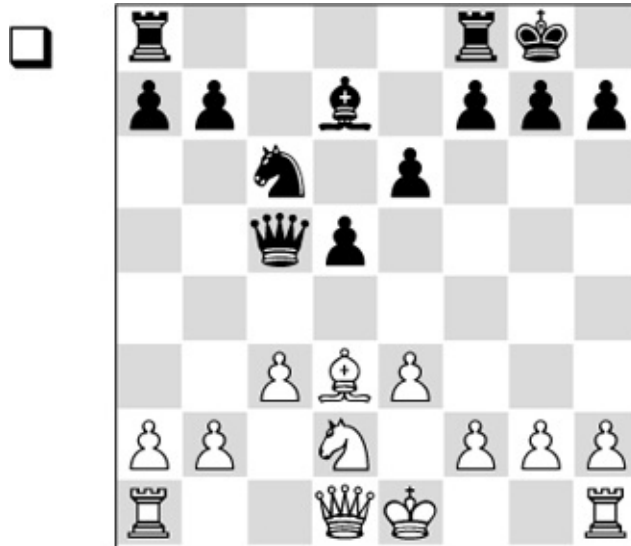
Eric Prié

2513

Dmitry Svetushkin

2590

France tt 2009



13. ♕xh7+!!

This sacrifice was investigated by grandmaster Prié in his home analysis. The analysis engines have difficulty in finding it, but once it is pointed out to them they award White a clear advantage.

13... ♖xh7 14. ♗h5+ ♖g8 15. ♘e4 ♗c4

15... ♗b5 is similar after 16. ♘g5 ♖fd8 17. ♗xf7+ ♖h8 18. ♗h5+ ♖g8 19. ♗h7+ (19.0-0-0!) 19... ♖f8 20. ♗h8+ ♖e7 21. ♗xg7+ ♖d6 22. ♘f7+ ♖c7 23. ♘xd8 ♗xd8 24.0-0-0±.

16. ♘g5 ♖fd8

If 16... ♗d3 17.e4+- ♖fd8 18. ♖d1 ♗c4 19. ♗xf7+ ♖h8 20. ♗g6 ♖g8 21.f4 followed by ♗h1-f1-f3+-, or 16... ♖fe8 17. ♗xf7+ ♖h8 18. ♗xd7±.

17. ♗xf7+ ♖h8 18. ♗h5+ ♖g8 19. ♗f7+ ♖h8 20.h4! ♘e5

20... ♖e8 21. ♗xd7 ♖e7 22. ♗d6.

21. ♖h5+ ♜g8 22.0-0-0!

With a decisive advantage; see Game 52.

Exercise 2

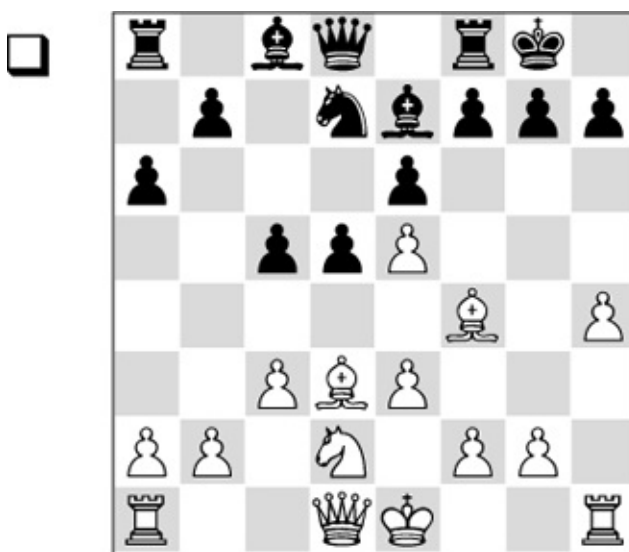
Daniel Gonzalez Eiris

1471

David Ramon Losada

1835

Spain tt 2014 (6)



11. ♖h7+!

Once again the thematic sacrifice on h7, which gives White a decisive attack.

11... ♖h7 12. ♖h5+ ♜g8 13. ♖f3 ♜e8

Here 13...fxg6 seems to be a better defence, but this also loses after 14. ♖g5!! fxg5 15.hxg5 and now:

A) 15... ♜f5 16. ♖h7+ ♜f7 (16... ♜f8 17. ♖g6) 17.g6+ ♜e8 18. ♖xg7 ♖f8 19. ♖h8;

B) 15... ♖xg5 16. ♖xg5 ♜b6 (16... ♜c7 17.f4 c4 18.0-0-0 ♜c5 19. ♖h7+ ♜f7 20.f5) 17. ♖h7+ ♜f7 18. ♖h4 ♖xe5 (18... ♖xb2 19. ♖f4+ ♖f6 20. ♖xf6+) 19. ♖f4+ ♜e8 20. ♖xg7 ♖d3+ (20... ♖f7 21. ♖h6 ♖d6 22. ♖g6 ♖d7 23.0-0-0 ♖e7 24. ♖xf8 ♖xf8 25. ♖h1 ♜e7 26. ♖f6+ ♜e8 27. ♖h7; 20... ♖d6 21. ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 22. ♖xe5) 21. ♜f1 ♖d6 22. ♖g6+ ♜d7 23. ♖xd3±.

14. ♖g5! ♖xg5

If 14... ♖f8 15. ♖xf7+ ♜h8 16.h5 ♖xg5 17.h6! g6 (17... ♖xh6 18. ♖xh6 mates) 18. ♖xg5 ♖xg5 19. ♖xe8 ♖g7 20. ♖h3.

15.hxg5 ♜f8 16.g6! ♜e7

If 16...fxg6 then 17. ♖xg6; 16... ♜a5 17. ♖g5 f6 18.exf6 ♖xf6 19. ♖d6+ ♜g8

20. ♖h4.

17.gxf7! ♜f8 18.♙g5+! ♚f6

Which takes us to the next exercise...

Exercise 3

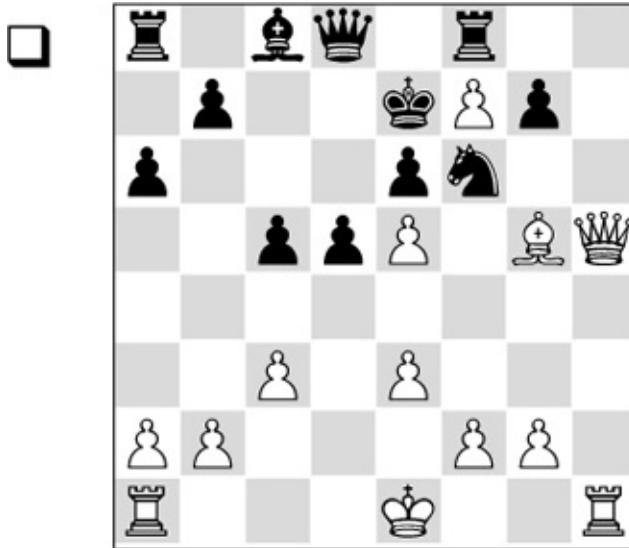
Daniel Gonzalez Eiris

1471

David Ramon Losada

1835

Skelleftea 1999 (8)



19. ♖g6!!

An excellent move. White does not rush to regain material and makes way for the rook to invade along the h-file.

19... ♜xf7 20. ♜h7!

The complement to White's previous move; there is no way out for Black now. There was also another way to win here: 20.exf6+ ♜d6 21. ♜h7 ♜d6 (21... ♜f8 22. ♜xf6+; 21... ♜xh7 22. ♙xf6+ ♜d6 23. ♙xd8 ♜h1+ 24. ♜d2 ♜xa1 25. ♜f7) 22. ♙f4+ e5 23. ♜xf7 exf4 24.0-0-0+.

20... ♜f8

If 20... ♜g8 then 21.exf6+ ♜d6 22. ♙f4+ ♜c6 23.fxg7 ♜d7 24. ♙e5 and there is no defence against 25. ♜h8.

21.exf6+ ♜d6

If 21...gxf6 then 22. ♜xf6+; or 21...♜d7 22.fxg7 ♜g8 23. ♜xf7+ ♜xf7 24.g8 ♜.

22.fxg7 ♜g8 23. ♙h6

1-0

There is no defence against 24. ♖h8; an excellent game by White, see Game 59.

Exercise 4

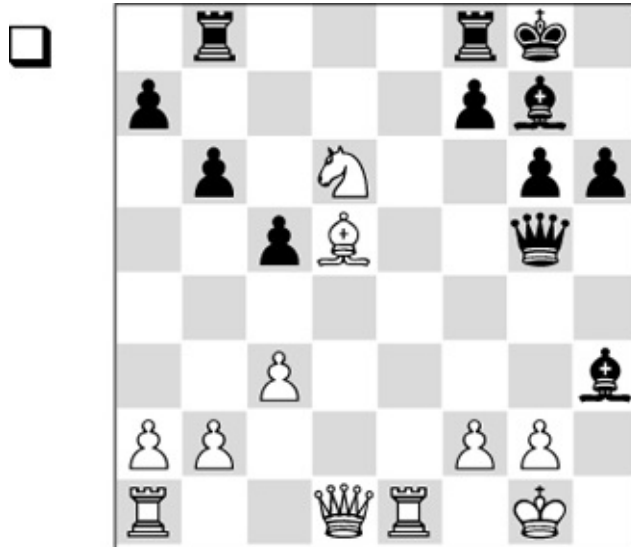
Andrey Kharlov

2615

Tiger Hillarp Persson

2507

Spain tt 2014 (6)



20. ♖xf7! ♜xf7 21. ♘xf7+ ♔h7

If 21... ♜xf7 then 22. ♗f3+ ♜f5 (22... ♗f5 23. ♗xh3) 23. ♗d5+ ♔f8 24. ♗d6+ ♜f7 25. ♗xb8.

22. ♗d5

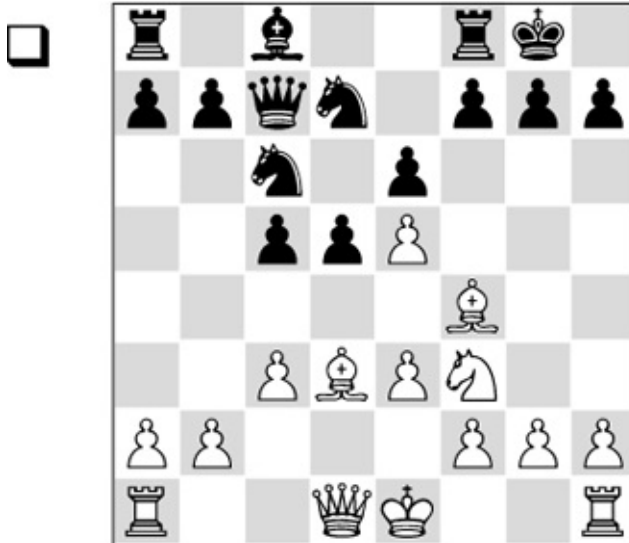
1-0 in 25 moves.

Exercise 5

Manuel Pereyra Puebla

Juan Cassani

cr 1982



11. ♖xh7+!

The thematic sacrifice, which gives White a decisive advantage here; this is the Pereyra Attack in its purest form.

11... ♜h8

If 11... ♜xh7 12. ♘g5+ ♜g8 (12... ♜g6 13. ♚c2+ f5 (13... ♜h6 14. ♙h7 mate, or 13... ♜h5 14. ♙h7+ ♜g4 15. f3 mate) 14. exf6+ ♜xf6 15. ♘h7+ ♜f7 16. ♙xc7 and wins) 13. ♙h5 ♜d8 14. ♙xf7+ ♜h8 15. ♙h5+ ♜g8 16. ♙h7+ ♜f8 17. ♙h8+ ♜e7 18. ♙xg7+ ♜e8 19. ♙f7 mate.

12. ♘g5 ♘cxe5

12...g6 was the only move, but after 13.h4 ♘dxe5 14.h5 f6 15.hxg6 fxg5 16. ♙xg5 White has a winning attack.

13. ♙xe5 ♘xe5

If 13... ♙xe5 then 14. ♙h5 when ♙xg5 15. ♙xg5 ♜xh7+- is forced.

14. ♙h5 g6 15. ♙h6

1-0

It is mate in four (see Game 5).

Exercise 6

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2208

Jose Larrosa Vila

2265

Arteixo 2007 (7)



18. ♖g5!

This attack gives White a decisive advantage; Black is unable to parry White's threats to break in on f7 or sacrifice on e6.

18...e6

It was essential to accept the loss of the f7-pawn with 18... ♖c8 19. ♗xf7+ ♔h8, although White's advantage should be decisive after 20. ♗c4. Instead, 18... ♗c8!? 19. ♗xf7 b5 20. axb5 axb5 21. ♗xd6+ bxc4 22. ♗6xc4 ♕d8 23. ♗b6+ ♔f8 24. ♗xc8 ♖xc8 25. b5 would also give White a winning advantage.

19. ♗xe6! ♗b8

There was no salvation for Black with 19...fxe6 20. ♗xe6 ♕c8 (20... ♕c6 21. ♗d8+ ♕d5 22. ♗xb7) 21. ♗xf8+ ♕d5 22. ♗xg6 hxg6 23. ♕d3.

20. ♗xf7+ ♕xf7

If 20... ♔h8 then 21. ♗e6 ♕c6 22. d5.

21. ♗xd6!

1-0 in 25 moves (see Game 22).

Exercise 7

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

Marius Manolache

Ferrol 2010



11. ♖e5! dxe5 12.b4! ♜a6 13. ♙xc6+ ♘d7
 If 13... ♙fd7 then 14. ♙xb5 wins.
 14. ♙xa8 ♙xa8 15.dxe5 ♙g8 16.f4
 With a clear advantage to White.

Exercise 8

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2268

Pablo Fernandez Borrego

2318

Spain tt 2012 (1)



30.d5!

This pawn sacrifice proves decisive, since it allows the white queen to penetrate

the kingside, where Black has no defenders.

30...cxd5 31.♟f6

There was a more spectacular win with 31.♜xg6!! fxg6 32.♞xg6+ ♔xg6 33.♜g1+ ♚f7 34.♜g7+ ♚e8 35.♜h7, with unstoppable mate.

31...♞e8

If 31...♜g8 then 32.♟xf7+ ♜g7 33.♞xg6+ ♚h8 34.♟f4+–, or 31...dxe4 32.♟xf7+ ♚h8 33.♜xg6 and White wins.

32.♜g5! dxe4 33.♜cg1

More precise was the sacrifice 33.♜xh5+! gxh5 34.♜g1, with unstoppable mate.

33...♜b1+ 34.♚xb1 ♟d3+ 35.♚a1

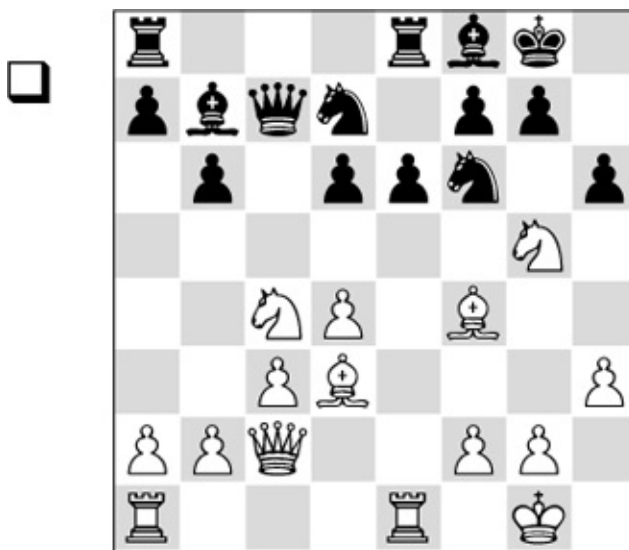
1-0

Exercise 9

B. Perez

J. Mejuto

Spain tt 2014



15.♞h7!+

Black resigned.

If 15...♚h8 then 16.♟xf7 mate, or 15...♜xh7 16.♟xh7 mate.

Exercise 10

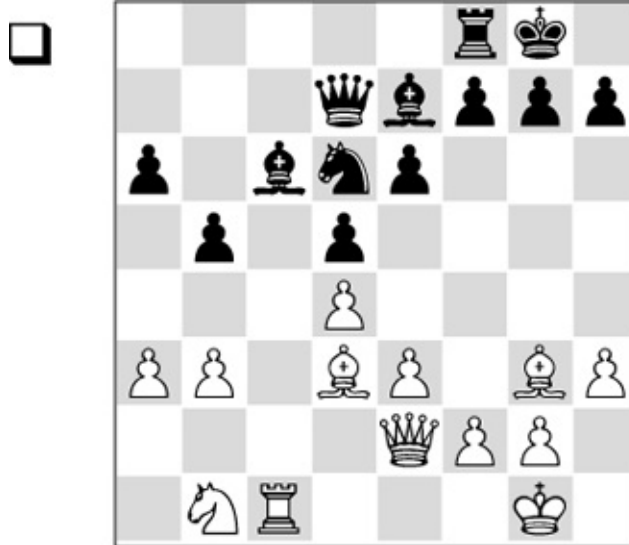
Eric Prié

Anatoly Karpov

2532

2670

Ajaccio Ech blitz 2007 (25)



24. ♔xh7+!

Correct; White wins a pawn with this ‘little combination’.

24... ♖xh7 25. ♕c2+

It was more precise to play 25. ♕xd6 ♖xd6 26. ♕c2+ ♔g8 27. ♕xc6 and White’s advantage is clear.

25... ♗e4 26. ♕xc6 ♖xc6 27. ♕xc6±

The game was drawn in 33 moves (see Game 28).

Exercise 11

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2326

Robert Patiño

2220

Spain tt 2011 (3)



18. ♕xh6!

Attacking the black king. This sacrifice should win. But it was essential to calculate accurately what happens if Black does not capture the piece right away and plays 18...e5 instead.

18...e5

The hardest thing for me to calculate was how to respond to the annoying 18... ♖h8; White has to find 19. ♕f4!!, and then if 19...e5 20. ♖e2!! – this is the hidden idea; the queen goes to h5, with a mating attack, e.g. 20...exd4 (20... exf4 21. ♗g5! g6 22. ♗ge6 ♕xe6 (22... ♖c8 23. ♕xg6 with mate in five moves) 23. ♕xg6 ♗g7 24. ♗xe6 ♖d7 25. ♖g4 and Black has to give up a lot of material to prevent mate) 21. ♗g5 g6 22. ♕xg6 ♗g7 23. ♗f7+ ♖xf7 24. ♕xf7 and White's advantage is decisive: he has a rook and two pawns (with more to follow) and an attack, for two passive pieces.

Taking the piece does not save Black: 18...gxf6 19. ♕h7+ ♖h8 20. ♖g6 ♕xc5 21. ♖xh6 ♖e7 22. ♕b1+ ♖g8 23. ♖xc5 ♕xa4? 24. ♗xe6.

19. ♕h7+ ♖h8 20. ♖g6! ♖f7

If 20...gxf6 then 21. ♕g8 and mate is unstoppable, while if 20... ♖g8 then 21. ♕f4!! is winning again with the same idea as before.

21. ♕f4!!

The winning move once more. The idea is to clear the h-file for the white queen.

21...exf4

If 21...exd4 then 22. ♗h4!! (but not 22. ♖h5? ♕g4!) 22... ♕g4 23. ♖xf7 ♖xh7 24. ♖g6+ ♖g8 25. ♖xg4+–.

22. ♖h5?!

This wins, but the pretty 22. ♗h4!! was more direct, e.g. 22...f5 (22... ♕g4 23. ♗df5) 23. ♖h5 ♕xh4 24. ♕g6+ ♖g8 25. exf4!! ♗f6 26. ♕xf7+ ♖f8

27. ♖h8+ ♔xf7 (27... ♔e7 28. ♜fe1+, with a decisive advantage; the idea of 25.exf4 is now clear) 28. ♖xd8, and wins.

22... ♗g4 23. ♖xf7 ♔xh7 24. ♕h4±

1-0 in 29 moves (see Game 31).

Exercise 12

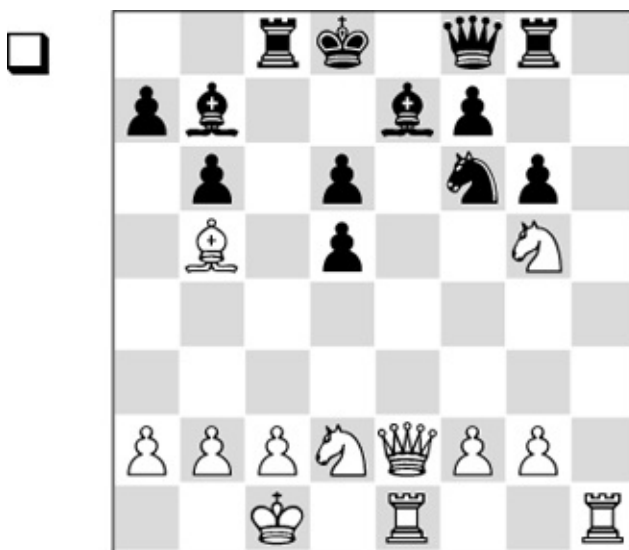
Pavel Blatny

2495

Josef Jurek

2320

Czechoslovakia tt 1990/91



21. ♖e6!

Pretty, but less effective than the spectacular 21. ♜h7!!, with the unstoppable threat of 22. ♜xf7, since if 21... ♕xh7 then 22. ♕xh7, and the black queen cannot move, owing to the mate on e7.

21... ♜xc2+

The only defence; if 21... ♜g7 then 22. ♜h8!; and of course not 21... fxe6, which allows 22. ♕xe6 mate.

22. ♖xc2 fxe6 23. ♕xe6+ ♔c8 24. ♕xf8 ♗xf8 25. ♕b3

1-0 in 53 moves (see Game 29).

Exercise 13

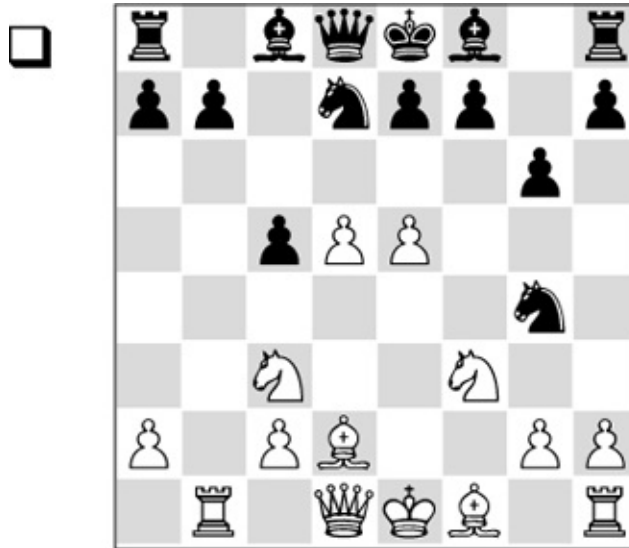
Jacobo Caselas Cabanas

2400

Ibragim Khamrakulov

2515

Ortigueira 2005 (6)



14.e6!

A key move, opening the position; all the black pieces are still at home, except for the knight on g4, which will soon come under attack.

14...fxe6

If 14... ♖df6 then 15. ♕b5+-; or 14... ♗b6 15. ♕b5+-.

15. ♗g5! ♗df6

Everything loses.

If 15... ♗gf6 then 16. ♗xe6 ♗a5 17. ♖b5 ♗a3 18. ♗c7+- . If 15... ♗ge5 then 16. ♗xe6 ♗a5 17. ♖b5, or 15... ♗de5 16. ♕b5+ ♗d7 17. ♗xe6.

16. ♕b5+ ♗d7 17. ♗xe6

1-0 in 29 moves.

Exercise 14

Carlos Garcia Palermo

2459

Marco Corvi

2325

Frascati 2005 (9)



17. ♘xf5! exf5

If 17... ♘e4 then 18. ♙h4 and White wins, for example: 18... exf5 (18... ♙xf5 19. ♙xd5 exd5 20. ♖xg7) 19. ♙xd5 ♙xd5 20. ♖xg7.

18. ♙xf6 ♙xf6

White recovers the piece after 18... ♙xf6 19. ♙f3 with a decisive advantage.

19. ♙h5+ ♙e7 20. ♙xd5

1-0 in 36 moves (see Game 35).

Exercise 15

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

J.P. Garcia

Spain tt 2014



12. ♖c7! ♗xc7

If 12... ♕c6 then 13. ♗e5 ♕e8 14. ♖xh5+.

13. a5! ♕c6 14. ♗e5 ♗xb5

Black has to give up his queen for two pieces. If 14... ♗a6 then 15. ♗xc7+ or 14... ♕e8 15. ♗xc7+.

15. ♗xc6 bxc6 16. ♖xh5+–

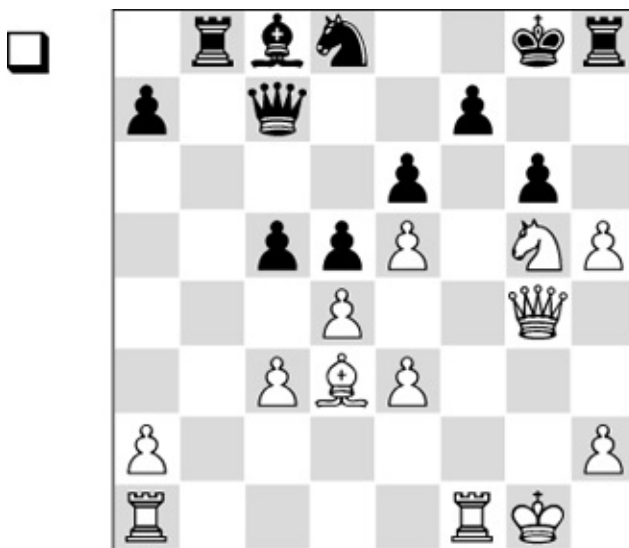
1-0 in 66 moves.

Exercise 16

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

Antanas Stanoev

Arteixo 2007



23. hxg6

There was an immediate win with 23. ♗xf7! ♗xf7 24. ♖xg6! (24. ♗xg6+ ♕f8 25. ♖xf7+ ♕xf7 26. ♖f1 ♖b7 27. ♖xf7+ ♖xf7 28. ♗g5 ♖g8 29. ♖g6+–) 24... ♗d8 (24... ♖h7 25. ♖xf7+ ♕f8 26. ♗g8+) 25. ♖h7+ ♕xh7 26. ♗g6 #.

23... f5! 24. ♗g3

Not 24. exf6?? ♕xh2 mate.

24... ♗g7 25. ♗h7

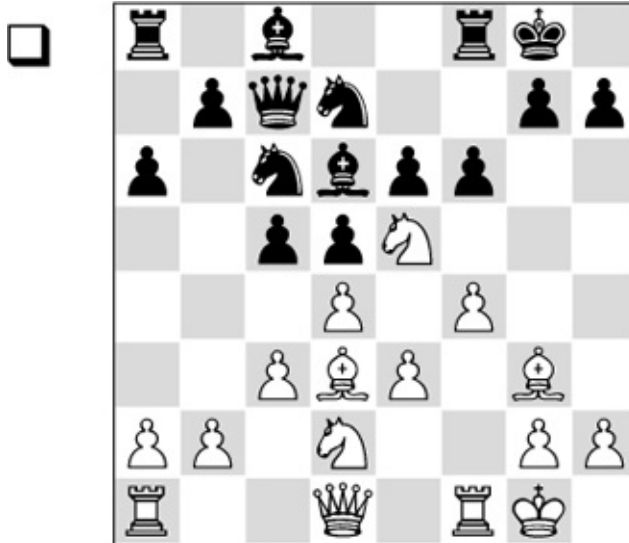
With a decisive advantage. 1-0 in 28 moves.

Exercise 17

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

D. Perez

Ferrol 2012



12. ♖xh7+!?

The piece sacrifice is interesting; although it brings no objective advantage, it complicates the game and in a practical game Black's defence is difficult.

12... ♜xh7 13. ♔h5+ ♜g8 14. ♖g6 ♜d8

Another option was 14... ♜e8 15.e4 ♖e7 16.e5 ♖xg6 17.exd6 ♜c6 18. ♜xg6 ♖f8 19. ♜d3±.

If 14... cxd4 then 15.exd4 ♜d8 16. ♖f3, with compensation.

15. ♖f3

15.e4! cxd4 (15... f5 16.e5 ♖e7 17. ♖f3±) 16.exd5 ♖f8 (16... ♖e7 17. ♖xe7+ ♖xe7 18.dxe6±; 16... exd5 17. ♜xd5+ ♜h7 18. ♜h5+ ♜g8 19. ♖e4±) 17.dxc6 ♖xg6 18. ♜xg6 dxc3 19. ♖e4 ♖e7 is unclear.

15... ♖f8 16. ♜h8+ ♜f7 17. ♖g5+?

This move is a bad one.

White could have continued with 17. ♖gh4! ♜e8 18. ♖g5! ♖e7 19. ♜xg7 fxe5 20.fxe5 ♖xg3 21. ♜xf8+ ♜d7 22.hxg3 ♜xf8 23. ♜xf8 ♜xg3 24. ♖f3, with good compensation: two pawns for the piece, including a passed pawn on g5, and the black king still in the centre.

Even better was 17. ♖ge5+!, e.g. 17... ♜e8 (17... ♖xe5 18.fxe5 f5 19. ♖h4 ♜e8 20. ♖g5∞; 17... fxe5 18.fxe5+-) 18. ♖h4 fxe5 19.fxe5 ♖e7 20. ♜xg7. Despite being two pieces down White has full compensation here, as Black's king and other pieces are blocked in. White has many threats and is going to regain material.

17... ♜xg6

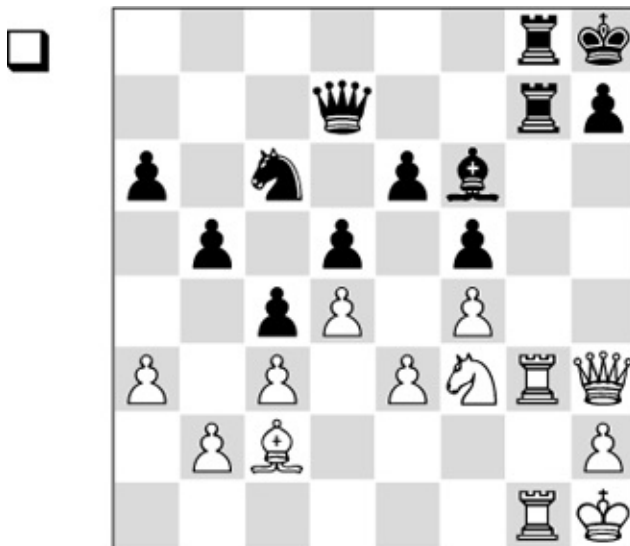
Black is winning now, however he lost in 23 moves.

Exercise 18

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

D. Perez

Spain tt 2013



27. ♔xh7+!! ♔xh7

Or 27... ♖xh7 28. ♖xg8 mate.

28. ♖h3+ ♜h4 29. ♖xh4 mate.

In the game White missed the mate and played 27. ♔h6?=.
(1-0 in 44 moves)

Exercise 19

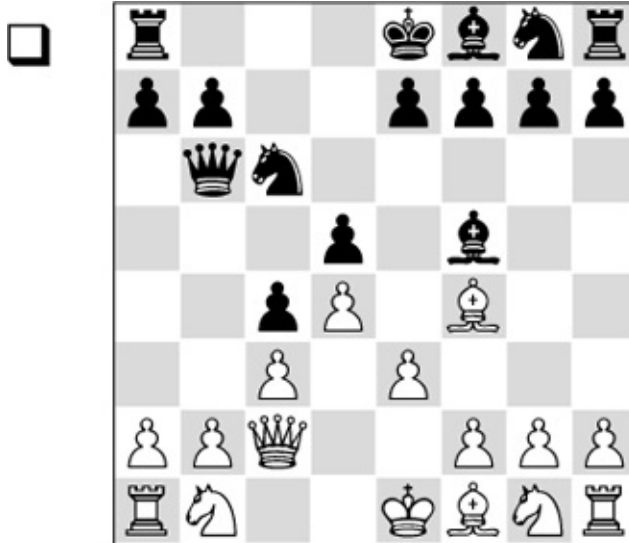
Nikola Sedlak

2589

Oliver Mihok

2445

Hungary tt 2011/12 (10)



7. ♖xf5!

This move works when White can capture the d5-pawn on the next move. Otherwise White must play ♖c1.

7... ♜xb2 8. ♖xd5 ♜xa1

8... ♜c1+ is no better, e.g. 9. ♔e2 ♜b2+ 10. ♕d2! ♜xa1 11. ♜b5 0-0-0 12. g3±; if 8... e6 then 9. ♜xc4 ♜xa1 10. ♜b3±; finally if 8... ♕f6 then 9. ♜xc4 ♕e4 10. ♜b5!+–.

9. ♜b5

White has the advantage, 1-0 in 29 moves (see game 44).

Exercise 20

Baadur Jobava

2706

Boris Savchenko

2556

Minsk 2014



33. ♕g6!! ♖xf6

If 33... ♜xg6 then 34. ♖h8+ ♔f7 35. ♜h7+ ♜g7 36. ♜xg7+ ♔f6 37. ♖f8+ ♜f7 38. ♖xf7 mate.

34. ♖h8+ ♔f7 35. ♜f1+

1-0

Since if 35... ♔e7 then 36. ♖f8 mate (Game 49).

Exercise 21

Antoaneta Stefanova

2444

Rafael Rodriguez

2326

Mondariz Balneario 1999 (5)



21. ♖xg6!

A fairly obvious sacrifice that decides the game.

21... ♜xf1?

If 21... hxg6?? then 22. ♔xg6+ ♚h8 23. ♔g7 mate.

It was more tenacious to play 21... ♖e4 22. ♜xe4 dxe4 23. ♔xe4 ♜xf1 24. ♜xf1 ♜d6 (24... ♜f6 25. ♖g5! ♜xg5 26. ♜f7!! with unstoppable mate) 25. ♖g5 ♜e7 26. ♜f8+ ♔xf8 27. ♜xf8 ♜xf8 28. ♖xe6 ♜fe8 29.d5.

22. ♖xh7+ ♚h8

If 22... ♖xh7 then 23. ♔g6+ ♚h8 24. ♔g7 mate.

23. ♖e5

Black resigned.

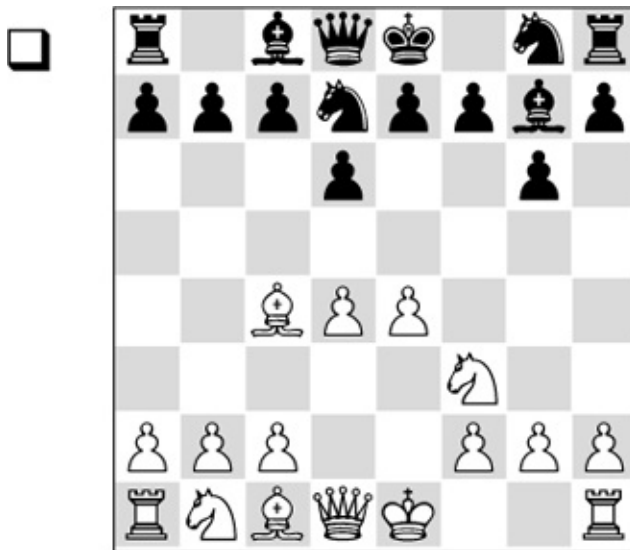
He will have to give up a lot of material to prevent mate, (see Game 57).

Exercise 22

Ildar Ibrahimov

V. Zhelnin

Moscow 1998



5. ♜xf7+!

Black resigned.

If 5... ♔xf7 then 6. ♖g5+ ♚e8 (6... ♔f6 7. ♔f3 mate) 7. ♖e6.

Exercise 23

Mark Hebden

Nathan Birnboim

Rishon-le-Zion 1992 (13)



10. ♕xg5! hxg5 11.h6 ♕h8

If 11... ♕xh6 then 12. ♖xh6±.

12.h7+ ♖g7

For 12... ♘xh7, see the next exercise.

13.f4!

In the game White played the inferior move 13. ♕d3=, but still the game finished 1-0 in 26 moves.

Exercise 24

Mark Hebden

Nathan Birnboim

Rishon-le-Zion 1992 (13)



13. ♖a6!!

And if 13... ♗xa6 or 13... ♕xa6, then 14. ♜h5 forces mate.

Exercise 25

Danny Franke

Matthias Krallmann

Bad Zwesten 2006 (1)



10. ♗b3!! ♜a6

If 10... cxb3 then 11. axb3.

11. ♗d2 b5?

If 11... ♜c8 then 12. b3±.

12. a4! bxa4 13. b3

In the game White played 13. ♗xc6±; 1-0 in 21 moves.

Exercise 26

Slobodan Kovacevic

2314

Alberto De Luna Butz

1837

Madrid 2005 (1)



17. ♖xc6!

Even better was 17. ♖xc6!! bxc6 18.b7 ♖xe5 (18... ♗b8 19. ♖xd7 ♗a7 20.bxa8 ♗xa8 21. ♖xf8) 19.bxc8 ♗xc8 20. ♖xe5.

17... ♖xb6

If 17...bxc6 then 18.b7.

18. ♖xd8 ♗xd8 19. ♖c7

1-0

Exercise 27

Nikola Mitkov

Yury Shulman

Bolingbrook 2005 (4)



22. ♖xc4! dxc4?

22... ♖d7 was better; 23. ♖e1±.

23. ♜d6!

With the threat of ♜f8+!.

23... ♖d7 24. ♜xd7

1-0 in 29 moves.

Exercise 28

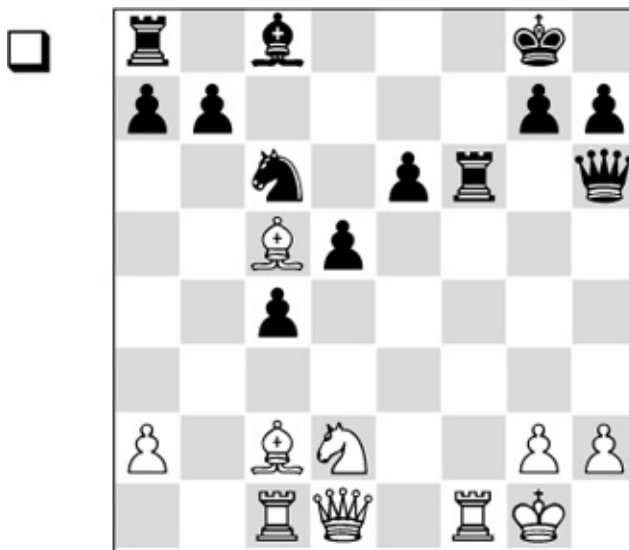
Heinz Wirthensohn

2411

Philipp Keller

1878

Saas Almagell 2005 (2)



14.g4! ♘g7

If 14... ♖xe5 then 15.dxe5 ♘g7 16.♘g5, or 14... ♖g7 15.♖xg7 ♘xg7 16.♘g5.

15.♘g5! ♜e8

If 15... ♖xg5? then 16.♜xg7 mate.

16.♜xh7+ ♜f8 17.♜h8+ ♜e7 18.♖xf6+

Black resigned.

If 18... ♜xf6 19.♘h7+ ♜e7 20.♜xg7.

Exercise 29

Jesus Nogueiras Santiago

Goran Todorovic

Internet 2005



19. ♖e7+! ♔h8 20. ♕xh7+!! ♔xh7 21. ♜h5#

Exercise 30

S. Mohsen

D. Morteza

Iran 2005



12. ♕xh5! gxh5 13. ♖xf7! ♔xf7 14. ♜xh5+ ♔g8 15. ♜h3!

With the idea of 16. ♜e6 mate!

15... ♜b6 16. ♜xd7 ♜c8

If 16... ♜g6 then 17. ♜g4 ♔f7 18. ♜f5 ♜c6 19. ♜e5 ♜g8 20. ♜xh7+.

17. ♖xd5 ♜b7?

17... ♜g6 was also losing: 18. ♜xg6+ hxg6 19. ♜c6 ♜a7 20. dxc5, with the idea

of ♔b8.

18. ♖xe7+ ♗xe7 19. ♔e8+

1-0

Solutions to the Strategy Exercises

Exercise 31

Guillermo Soppe

A. Kovaliov

Los Polvorines ch-ARG sf 2005



8.c5! ♖xb3 9.axb3 a6

If 9... ♗h5 then 10.b4 ♗xf4 11.exf4 ♕e7 12.b5, with advantage to White.

10.h3 ♕e7 11.b4! ♖c8 12.♗b3 ♗d8 13.♗a5 ♗xa5 14.bxa5

In this way White saddles Black with a backward pawn on b7, which can be attacked with a rook lift.

14... ♖a8 15.♖a4!±

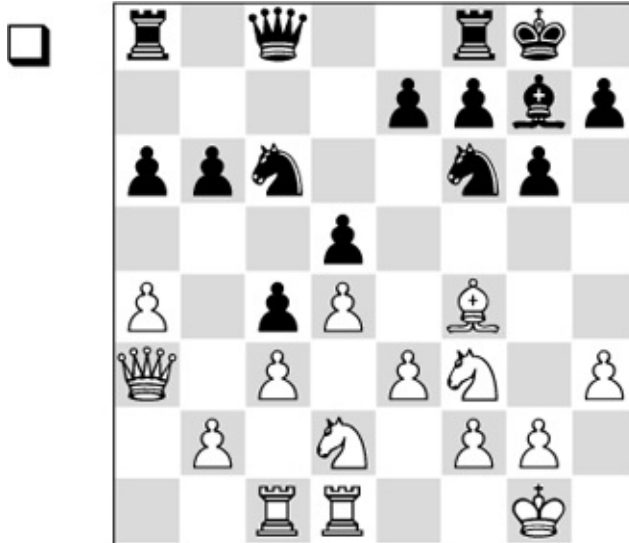
1-0 in 30 moves.

Exercise 32

Christian Bauer

Romain Edouard

Calvi 2011 (8)



16.b3!

Correct; in such positions this is the thematic break, which should be memorised.

16...b5

16...cxb3 17. ♖xb3 gives White a clear advantage, due to the weakness of Black's b-pawn.

17.axb5?!=

Drawn in 51 moves, (see Game 12).

It was better to play 17.bxc4 bxc4 18. ♖b1!, and White is better, owing to his control of the b-file, especially since his bishop on f4 prevents the black rooks from going to b8 to contest the b-file. To add to Black's woes, he has no light-squared bishop to prevent White from putting a rook on b1; the other white rook can go to e1 and support e4, which will undermine Black's pawn on c4.

Exercise 33

Tomasz Markowski

Grzegorz Gajewski

Chorzow ch-POL 2013 (7)



8.dxc5!±

Against Black's move order, this move is not only playable but good, since although it gives up the centre and allows Black to play ...e7-e5, it is not easy for Black to regain the pawn.

8...a5

There are other options for Black, analysed in Game 9.

9.a4! ♖h5 10.♗g5! h6 11.♗h4 g5 12.♖d4!±

0-1 in 36 moves (see Game 9).

Exercise 34

James Mason

Alexander Wittek

Vienna 1882 (18)



10. ♖f3!

Another typical plan for White: restrain Black's ... ♗e4 and initiate the transfer of White's queen to the kingside (f3-h3) to attack the black king.

10... ♜e8 11. ♖h3±

1-0 in 44 moves (see Game 1).

Exercise 35

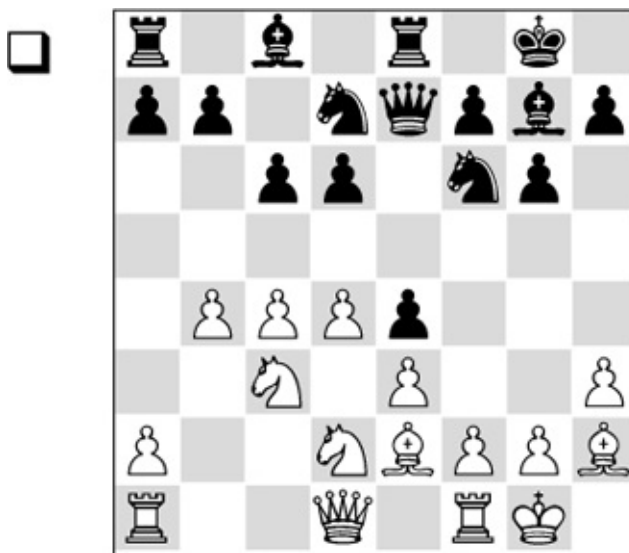
Renier Vazquez Igarza

2535

Jose Candela Perez

2390

Madrid 2010 (6)



13. c5±

The typical pawn break in such positions; the bishop on h2 comes to life again with the opening of the h2-b8 diagonal. This is typical of the London System; often it seems that the bishop on h2 is not doing much, but suddenly it is transformed into a key piece.

13... d5

If 13... dxc5 then 14. bxc5 b6 15. ♗d6 ♜d8 16. ♜b1±.

14. b5! ♗f8 15. bxc6 bxc6 16. ♖a4±

1-0 in 43 moves (see Game 14).

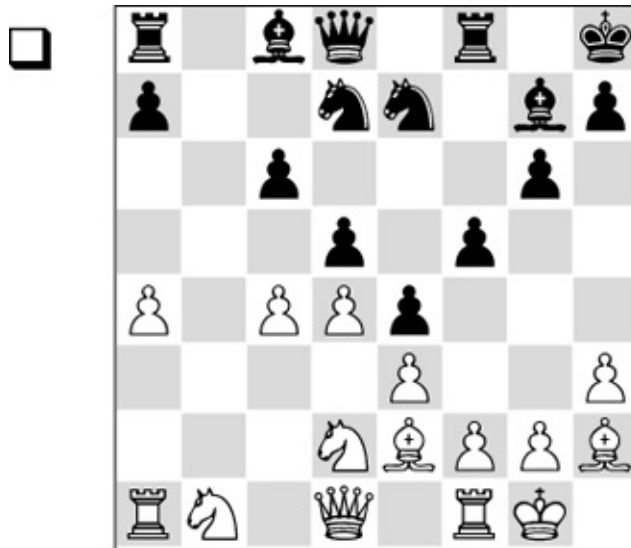
White has managed to saddle Black with pawn weaknesses on c6 and a7, and his pieces are better. Moreover, his bishop on f4 is much better than the one on g7, which is usually passive.

Exercise 36

Gata Kamsky

Abdul Rahman Saleh Salem

Khanty-Mansiysk Wch blitz 2013 (17)



16.cxd5?

16. ♖c3! g5 (16... ♕a6 17.cxd5 (17. ♖c1±) 17... ♕xe2 18. ♗xe2 cxd5 19. ♖b5 ±) 17. ♖c1 (17.cxd5 cxd5 18. ♗b3 ♖f6 19. ♕e5±) 17...f4 18.cxd5 cxd5 19. ♖b5 ♗b6 20. ♗c2 a6 21.a5 ♗g6 22. ♖c7±.

16...cxd5?

Here Black should have played 16... ♖xd5! (preventing 17. ♖c3) followed by ...c6-c5, with equality.

17. ♖c3 ♖f6 18. ♖b5 a6 19. ♖d6±

1-0 in 30 moves (see Game 16).

Exercise 37

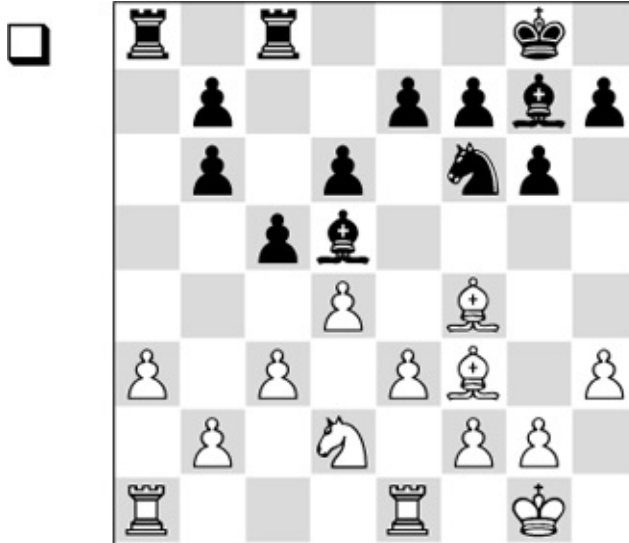
Enrique Alvarez Fernandez

2337

Manuel Bazan Solera

2068

Infiesto 2008 (1)



17.e4! ♖c6 18.d5! ♗b5 19.e5!

The advance of the centre pawns and the e4-e5 break constitute the correct plan.

19... ♗e8

Here 19... dxe5 20. ♗xe5 ♗a6 21. ♖ad1 was slightly better, but White maintains the advantage.

20.exd6 exd6 21. ♖e7! ±

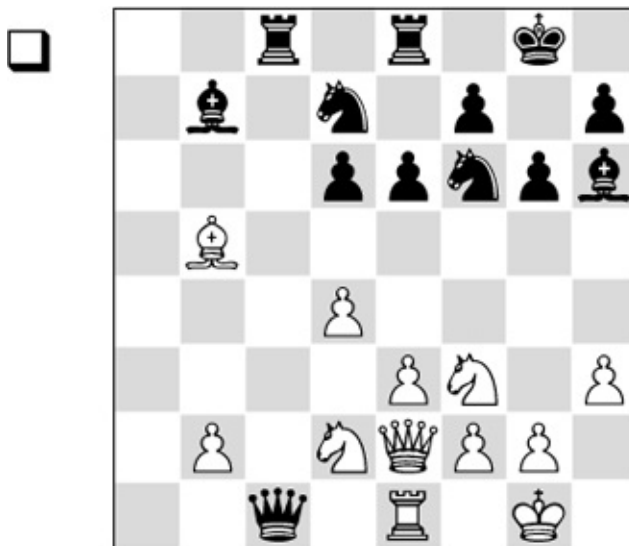
In the game White played the slightly inferior 20. ♗g4± and the game was drawn in 42 moves.

Exercise 38

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

Dragan Barlov

Perrol 2012



21. ♖c4!

This zwischenzug prevents the black rooks from entering White's camp and at the same time attacks d6.

21... ♜xe1+ 22. ♖xe1 ♜c6 23. ♖xd6 ♜xb5 24. ♖xb5+-

White played the inferior 21. ♜xc1? ♜xc1+ 22. ♖f1= (0-1 in 34 moves).

Exercise 39

Gata Kamsky

Peter Svidler

Russia tt 2013 (3)



15. ♖c4!

Heading for the weak square b5; a common plan which should be memorised.

15... ♜7f6 16. ♖a3 ♜f4 17. ♜xf4

17. ♖b5 ♜xh2+ 18. ♖xh2± was playable.

17... ♖xf4 18. ♖b5 ♖e6 19. ♖h2±

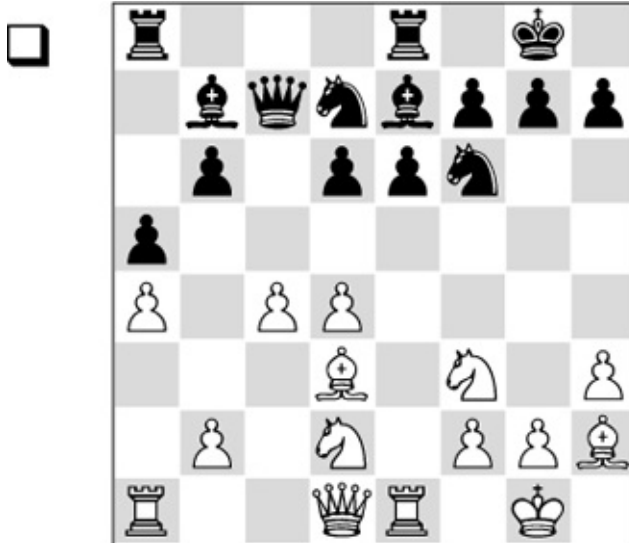
In Game 21 White played 18.g3= and the game was drawn in 64 moves.

Exercise 40

Gata Kamsky

Sergey Tiviakov

Montreal 2007 (4)



15. ♖b1!

Kamsky recycles his knight towards the b5-square. Once again this plan is good for White.

15... ♜d8 16. ♗c3

White is a bit better, with a space advantage, pressure on d6 and possession of the b5-square.

16... d5 17. b3 ♙b4 18. ♖c1 ♜c8 19. ♜e3!

From here the rook can go to the queen-side via c3, or to the kingside via g3.

19... ♗f8 20. ♗b5±

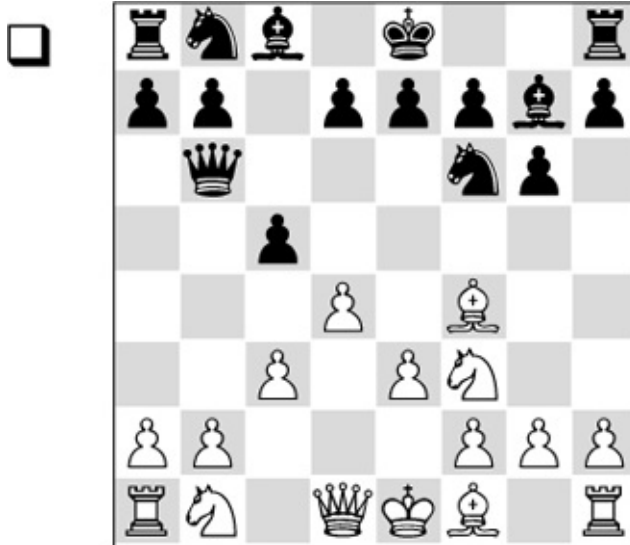
1-0 in 38 moves (see Game 25).

Exercise 41

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

J. Leira

Spain tt 2010



6. ♖a3! ♜xb2?

6...cxd4 is better, e.g. 7. ♖c4 ♜d8 8. exd4±. If 6...d5 then 7. ♖b5 ♖a6 8. dxc5 (8. a4±) 8... ♜xc5 9. ♕e5 0-0 10. ♕d4 ♜c6 11. ♖xa7±.

7. ♖c4! ♜xc3+

If 7... ♜b5 then 8. ♖d6+ wins.

8. ♖fd2 cxd4?!

Here 8...b5 was a slight improvement, but White is better after 9. ♖c1 ♜b4 10. ♖b1 bxc4 11. ♖xb4 cxb4 12. ♕xc4 0-0 13. ♜a4±. If 8... ♜b4 then 9. ♖b1 ♜c3 10. ♖b3+–.

9. ♖c1 d5

A sad necessity; if 9... ♜b4 then 10. a3 ♜c5 11. ♖e5+–.

10. ♖e5! 0-0 11. ♖xc3 dxc3 12. ♖b3+–

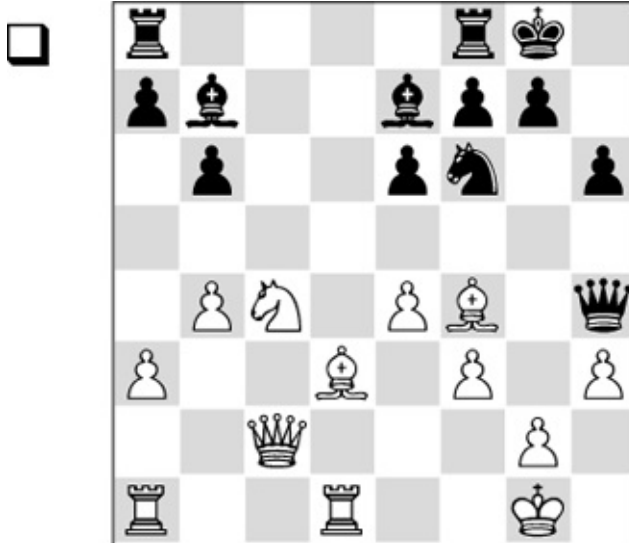
1-0 in 35 moves.

Exercise 42

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

M. Garcia

Spain tt 2009



19.g3!

White wants to hunt the black queen and offers a pawn. The quieter 19. ♖d6! was also good, e.g. 19... ♜fe8 (19... ♞h5 20. ♜f2±) 20. ♜f2 ♜xf2+ 21. ♜xf2 ♞a6 22. ♞xe7 ♜xe7 23. ♜ac1±.

19... ♜xh3

Or 19... ♜h5 20. ♜g2 (20. ♜f2) 20... ♜ac8 21. ♜e2±.

20. ♜d2!

Threatening 21. ♜h2 to win the queen.

20...e5?

Here 20... ♜h5 was necessary, and after 21. ♞e5, even though Black has to give up his queen he gains some counterplay with 21... ♜fc8 22. ♞c4 (22. ♜a2 ♞d6 23.g4 ♞xe5 24.gxh5 ♞xf4±) 22... ♞a6 23. ♜h2 ♞xc4 24. ♜xh5 ♞xh5 25. ♞xh6 ♞f6 26. ♞f4±. Less good was 21... ♞d6 22.g4 ♞xe5 (22... ♜h4 23. ♜h2 ♞xe5 24. ♜xh4 ♞xa1 25. ♞xh6±) 23.gxh5 ♞xf4 (23... ♞xa1 24. ♜c7 ♜ab8 25. ♞b5+–) 24. ♜dd1±.

21. ♞xe5±

1-0 in 45 moves (see Game 30).

Exercise 43

Oscar De Prado Rodriguez

R. Martinez

Spain tt 2013



9.a5!

When Black fails to play ...a7-a6, in order to answer a4-a5 with ...b6-b5, this advance is good and gives White a slight advantage.

9...a6 10.axb6 cxb6 11.c4

White is better, with the half-open a-file and the better pawn structure, since a6 and b6 are weak. 1-0 in 33 moves.

Exercise 44

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

S. Villar

Spain tt 2011



6.♘bd2!

In the game White played the inferior 6. ♖a3?, which is not appropriate when Black has a pawn on d6. The game continued 6... ♜xb2 7. ♖b5 ♜b4+ 8. c3 ♜a5, with advantage to Black.

6... ♜xb2?

If 6... cxd4 then 7. exd4 ♜xb2 8. ♖c4 ♜c3+ 9. ♕d2+–; Black's best line is 6... ♕g7 7. ♕d3 0-0 8. 0-0=.

7. dxc5 dxc5?!

If 7... d5 then 8. ♖b1±.

8. ♖b1 ♜xa2?

If 8... ♜c3 then 9. ♕b5+ ♕d7 10. 0-0±.

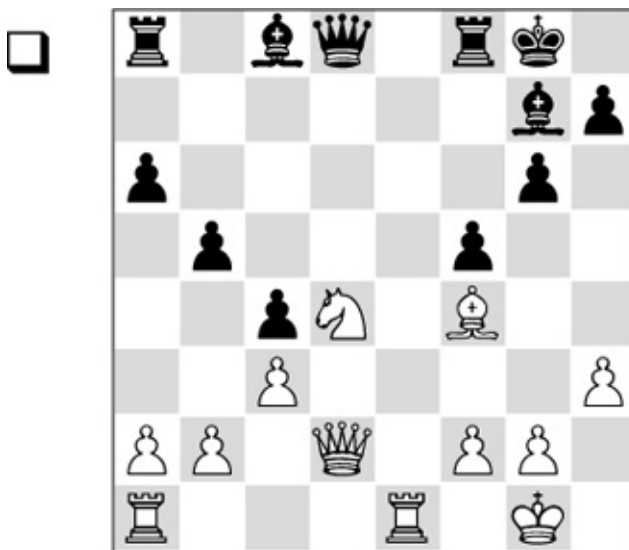
9. ♖c4+–

Exercise 45

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

W. Lopez

Ferrol 2003



19. ♕e5!

White eliminates the dark-squared bishop, leaving himself with a good knight versus a bad bishop, and at the same time leaving Black weak on the dark squares. 19. ♖ad1± was also good.

19... ♕xe5 20. ♖xe5 ♜e8?!

If 20... ♕d7 then 21. ♖d1±.

21. ♖xe8+ ♜xe8 22. ♖e1 ♜d8 23. ♜e3 ♕d7?

Here 23... ♜f8 was a slight improvement, but White is clearly better after 24. ♜e5 ♕b7 25. ♜c7 ♕e4 26. f3 ♕d5 27. ♖e7±.

24. ♜e5+– ♖c8 25. ♜d5+

1-0

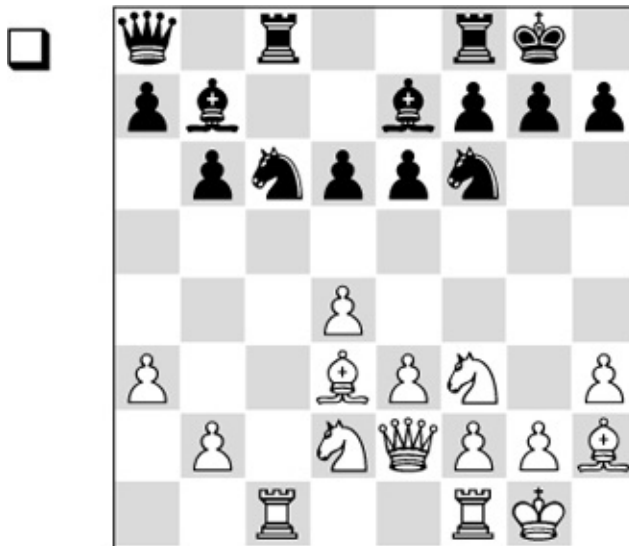
If 25...♔g7 (or 25...♔f8) then 26.♖e6+–, while if 25...♔h8 then 26.♚f7 wins.

Exercise 46

Eric Prié

Sergio Garza Marco

Castell de Sant Ferran 2008 (6)



15.e4!

The correct plan. White occupies the centre and threatens to advance at some point with e4-e5; at the same time he blocks the h1-a8 diagonal.

15...d5?

This response is a clear strategic mistake, since it completely blocks the long diagonal and gives White a free hand to attack the black king. It was better to play 15...♖fd8±.

16.e5! ♘d7 17.h4±

White takes advantage of the shortage of black pieces on the kingside to start an attack there. The idea is to support the move ♘g5 and create weaknesses. With the same idea it was also good to play 17.♙f4 or 17.♚e3.

1-0 in 33 moves (see Game 27).

Exercise 47

Jose Ortega Ruiz

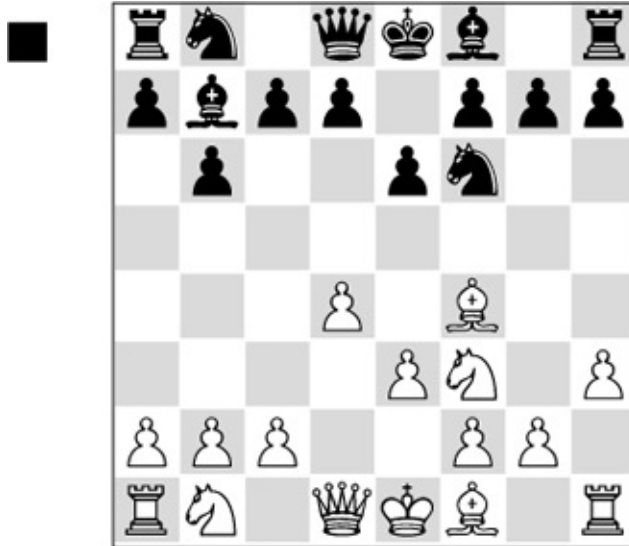
2346

Igor Naumkin

2453

Gallipoli 2013 (8)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f3 e6 3.♙f4 b6 4.h3 ♘b7 5.e3



5... ♙d6!=

Whether to play h2-h3 or not is one of the decisions that players of the London System get wrong most frequently.

Against the Queen's Indian, h2-h3 should be played only when Black has played ... ♙e7 and is threatening ... ♗h5. If White plays h2-h3 prematurely, Black can equalise with the text move, since White has nothing better than to exchange on d6. White cannot play ♗g3, since he would stand badly after ... ♙xg3, when he has to recapture with the f-pawn. In contrast, with the pawn still on h2 White can recapture with the h-pawn, opening the h-file.

6. ♙xd6 cxd6 7.a4 ♗c6 8. ♗bd2 d5 9. ♗b3 a5=

0-1 in 40 moves.

Exercise 48

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

J.P. Garcia

Spain tt 2014



5. ♖a3!

Once again, indirect defence of the b-pawn. In this precise position it is best to play the knight to a3, because it has the extra option of ♖c4. In many games White has played 5. ♖c3, but this is inferior, due to 5...a6!= (if 5...d5 6. ♖b5±).

5...d5

If 5...a6 then 6. ♖c4±, or if 5...cxd4 then 6. ♖b5 ♖a6 7.exd4±.

And now we move on to the following exercise...

Exercise 49

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

R. Patiño

Spain tt 2011



6. ♖b5!

The right move, which gives White a clear advantage. In the game White played the inferior 6.a3.

The idea of a2-a3 is thematic in many variations of the London System, because it defends the b2-pawn indirectly, since in the event of 6... ♙xb2 the move 7. ♖a4 traps the black queen (see Game 31).

6... ♗a6 7.a4 c4 8.c3 ♗e7

If 8... ♗d7 9.b3 ♗xb5 10.axb5 ♙xb5 11.bxc4 dxc4 12. ♙b1±.

9.b3±

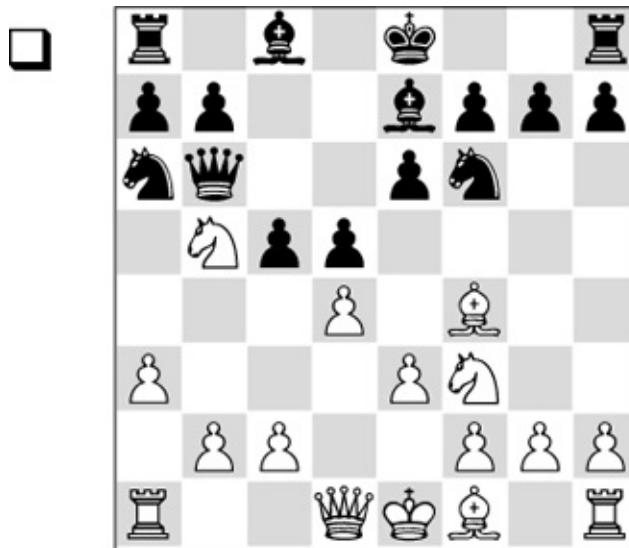
1-0 in 66 moves.

Exercise 50

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

R. Patiño

Spain tt 2011



8.dxc5! ♗xc5

8... ♙xc5 9.b4 ♙b6 10.c4 is similar.

9.b4! ♗e7 10.c4!± ♙d8?!

Better was 10...dxc4, but White gains the advantage with 11. ♗xc4 or 11. ♖d6+.

11.c5±

White's pieces are more active, square d6 is weak and the c5-pawn is very strong. Black's knight is passive on a6 and the c8-bishop and the a8-rook have poor prospects. White can move his bishop to d3 and attack on the kingside. Black's only chance at counterplay is to advance eventually with ...f7-f6 and ...e6-e5. 1-0 in 29 moves (see Game 31).

Exercise 51

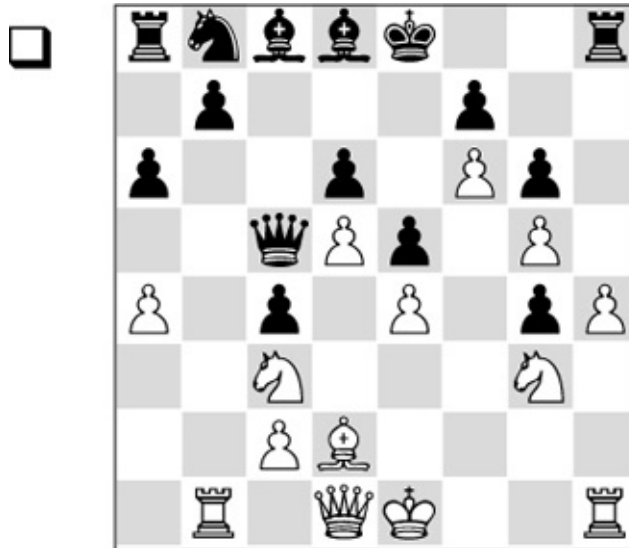
Eric Prié

2490

Nicolas Tripoteau

2392

Pau ch-FRA 2012 (7)



19. ♔e2!! ±

A really great move by Prié. The king advances into the centre but, since the position is fairly closed, there is no risk involved. White wants to connect his rook and his queen and he is planning to play h4-h5. In this position White already has a clear, perhaps decisive, advantage; the engines do not think so at first, but the longer they are left to analyse the clearer the advantage becomes.

19... ♘a5

19... ♔d7 was better, but after 20.h5! gxh5 21. ♖xh5 ♖f8 (21... ♖xh5 22. ♗xh5 ♔c7 23. ♗e3) 22. ♖h7, White has a clear advantage.

20.h5! gxh5 21. ♗xh5

1-0 in 27 moves (see Game 33).

Exercise 52

Vladimir Georgiev

2540

Francisco Vallejo Pons

2450

Elgoibar 1998 (7)



8. ♖e2!±

White recycles the knight, defending f4 and making way for White to advance with c2-c4.

8... ♗e4

If 8... ♗bd7 then 9.c4 dxc4 10. ♙xc4 ♗b6 11. ♙b3 a5 12.a3 ♗bd5 13.h3±.

9.c4 ♙d7 10. ♙b3±

1-0 in 35 moves (see Game 36).

Exercise 53

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2233

Jorge Rodriguez Guillen

2110

A Coruña 2013 (3)



6. ♖b3! c4

If 6... ♖xb3 then 7.axb3 cxd4 8.exd4±; the main alternative is 6... ♕f5 7.dxc5 ♖xb3 8.axb3 e5 9. ♕g3 ♕xc5 10. ♗gf3!±.

Now we move on to the following exercise...

Exercise 54

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2233

Jorge Rodriguez Guillen

2110

A Coruña 2013 (3)



7. ♖c2!

The endgame following the exchange of queens is fine for Black, e.g. 7. ♖xb6

axb6 8.a3 b5 9. ♖c1 ♗f5 10.h3 (10. ♘gf3=) 10...e6 11. ♘gf3 (11.g4) 11...h6=

De Prado-Obregon, Ferrol 2012.

7... ♗g4
And we move on to the next exercise...

Exercise 55

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

2233

Jorge Rodriguez Guillen

2110

A Coruña 2013 (3)



8.b3!±

The thematic break on b3. After ...c5-c4 by Black, this is usually the best plan for White and in this position it is the best move.

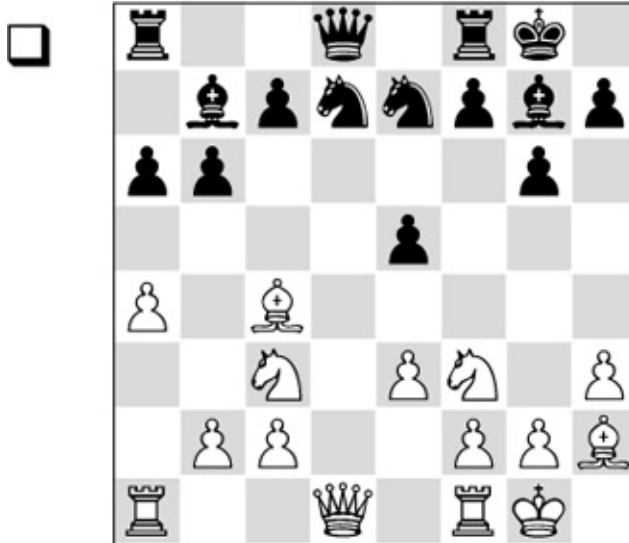
1-0 in 72 moves (see Game 45).

Exercise 56

Oscar de Prado Rodriguez

P. Garcia Castro

Padron 2012



12.e4!±

A typical move, blocking the diagonal of the b7-bishop, controlling d5 and hindering a future advance of the black pawns with ...f7-f5. The position now looks like a king's pawn opening.

12...c6?

This is already a clear mistake: it leaves the b7-bishop passive and weakens the d6-square.

It was better to play 12... ♖c6 13. ♘d5, with advantage to White, but still with everything to play for.

13. ♘g5

With ideas of playing ♘e6 and also f2-f4, putting pressure on f7. Here 13. ♙d2! was also good.

13... ♙c8 14. ♙d2±

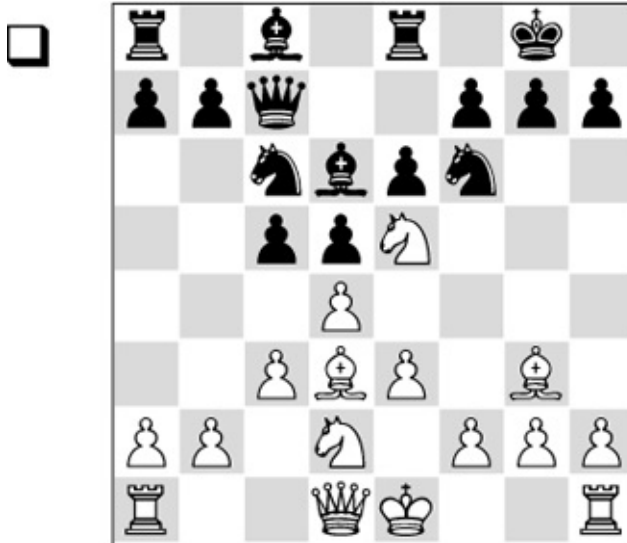
1-0 in 24 moves (see Game 61).

Exercise 57

Pavel Blatny

Wolfgang Seifried

Triberg 1991 (9)



10.f4!

A typical move, supporting the knight on e5 and setting up the aggressive scheme of the so-called Stonewall Attack, but in a superior version here, since the normally problematic queen's bishop is already outside the pawn chain.

10... ♗d7?

This is a serious error that loses a pawn; 10...b6 and 10...g6 were both better.

11. ♖xh7+! ♔f8

If 11... ♔xh7 then 12. ♕h5+ ♔g8 13. ♕xf7+ ♔h7 14. ♕xe8.

12. ♕c2±

1-0 in 18 moves.

Exercise 58

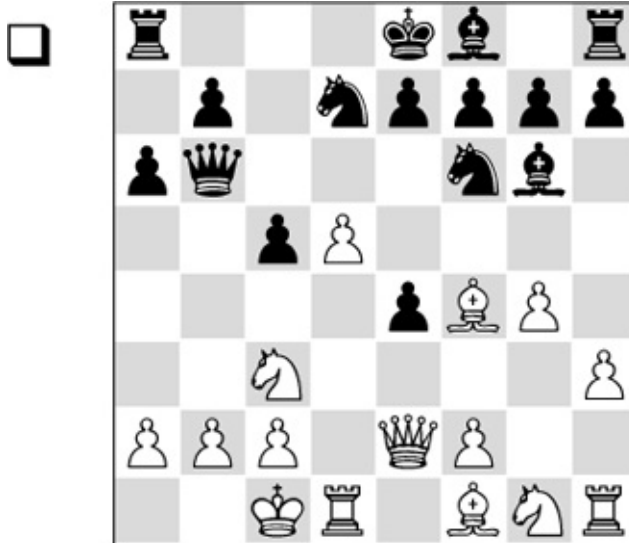
Luc Winants

2535

Oleg Korneev

2611

Warsaw 2005 (3)



10.f3!±

White opens lines, since he is ahead in development and has a lot of compensation for the pawn; in fact he has the advantage.

10...e5

Black tries to develop; the problem after 10...exf3 11.♘xf3± is his lack of development on the kingside, and if he tries 11...0-0-0 then after 12.♘h4 ♘e8 13.♔b1 ♘d6 14.♙f3 White maintains excellent compensation.

11.dxe6 fxe6 12.fxe4±

1-0 in 29 moves (see Game 43).

Exercise 59

Krasimir Rusev

Marjan Mitkov

Sunny Beach 2010 (7)



7.c5! ♔xb3 8.axb3±

The endgame is favourable to White; this idea is similar to the one that Black often uses, with ...c5-c4. White has the half-open a-file and the plan of b4-b5 and ♕f3-d2-b3-a5.

8... ♖bd7 9.b4±

1-0 in 21 moves.

Exercise 60

Nigel Short

Garry Kasparov

Skelleftea 1989



5. ♖bd2!

Once again we see an indirect defence of the b2-pawn. But in the game White played 5.b3!? (5. ♖c1 c5 6.e3 cxd4 7.exd4 ♘c6=) 5...c5 (see Game 63).

5... ♙xb2 6.e4! ♙c3

If 6... ♙b6 then 7. ♖b1 ♙c7 8. ♙c4± is similar to the Vaganian Gambit that we saw in the chapter on the Benoni, where White has a lot of compensation for the pawn.

7. ♙d3 ♘bd7 8.0-0 e5 9. ♙h2 exd4 10. ♘c4

White is better.

Chapter 13

The Pereyra Attack

The Pereyra-London System was the name given to the favourite opening scheme of the Mendoza (Argentina) champion Manuel Pereyra Puebla. At first this name for the opening was confined to only a small group of players but the games of various chess players from Mendoza enabled its usage to spread. The present writer has published four books on this system, gaining recognition for the name of Pereyra and for the style of this scheme as a contribution from Mendoza to the history and theory of chess world-wide.

By way of an introduction

The method of naming an opening in chess theory has been faithfully maintained in accordance with a principle which is similar to that observed in palaeontology: it is named after its discoverer, its analyst, its inventor, the place where it occurred for the first time or where it was practised assiduously. In chess, especially, consideration is given to those who have made a substantial contribution to certain positions. This honourable custom is a form of tribute to those who have dedicated their efforts and, above all, that most valuable thing a man can possess as he goes through this world: their time. I am not speaking about moral or ethical values, I am speaking about time in the physical sense. The hours of analysis and practice have their reward when some variation bears our mark; it makes us feel more at peace because our contribution will keep us alive, even after our inevitable physical disappearance. It is related to a very human feeling of transcendence.

The cold technical language of the old Yugoslav Encyclopaedia designates the Pereyra Attack as D00 to D02. In Mendoza, for many years a player called Manuel Pereyra Puebla played above all a series of moves which, because of his faith in it, came to be called the Pereyra System. This name was recognised on a national and international level in various publications, especially by LADAC (Liga Argentina de Ajedrez por Correspondencia – the Argentinean Correspondence Chess League) and by Inforchess. Pereyra was not just any old chess player: he was a finalist in the World Correspondence Chess Championship, he was the Argentinean postal chess champion once and runner-up several times; twice he was champion of Mendoza province (situated at the

foot of the highest peak in the Andes, Mount Aconcagua, 6996 metres high), and he also won a number of over-the-board tournaments during his lengthy career. Invariably, almost without exception, he opened with the same opening. 1.d4, 2.♘f3, 3.♙f4. And this was enough to take him to the World Correspondence Chess Championship! It is clear that the system was not all that passive.

The idea of the bishop sortie is a very old one, lost in the mists of time; a Frenchman, De Labourdonnais, used the bishop move to f4 in his match against McDonnell, in London, in 1834. Towards the middle of the nineteenth century it appears in the hands of the New Yorker James Mason (how much we owe to the magnificent book by the Asturian Fernandez Rua!) and also in the hands of the English champion Joseph Henry Blackburne. At the start of the twentieth century the brilliant Polish player Akiba Rubinstein employed it a lot, as did the Italian Massimiliano Romi.

Originally, in Argentina it was known as the ‘Trenza de ocho’ or the ‘Portela¹ System’, and more commonly as the Queen’s Pawn Opening. It was also the weapon of big names such as José Raul Capablanca, Alexander Alekhine, Aron Nimzowitsch, Osip Bernstein, Alexander Kotov, David Bronstein, Bent Larsen, and more recently Vlatko Kovacevic, Gata Kamsky, Judit Polgar and, very occasionally, Garry Kasparov, amongst various other grandmasters, as can be verified in the three works published by Inforchess in the first decade of the twenty-first century and in this book. In 2015 even the World Champion Magnus Carlsen played it. English-speaking chess players have named it after London, and it even has a direct relationship with Emmanuel Lasker’s New York System. It has points in common with different defences, such as the Orthodox Queen’s Gambit, the Slav and Semi-Slav, the Stonewall Opening, and even the Caro-Kann!

However one arrives at the Pereyra, one does not leave it. The system is best understood if you follow the normal route of all players: king’s pawn (open games), queen’s pawn (closed games), tactics, strategy, endgames. Knowing the schemes of the Queen’s Pawn (Colle, Zukertort, Stonewall) and of the Queen’s Gambit is useful for achieving the best transpositions and as a way of benefiting from the ideas of these set-ups within the London. It must not be forgotten that one makes progress by playing the best variations within these schemes, not by avoiding those continuations; for that reason I do not advise teaching it to people who have begun to play chess only recently. It is a scheme for people who do not have much time available for study, not for those who need to construct a complete chess framework.

I began to analyse this scheme in the nineties, as something to play against the best players. Argentina is a country of great distances and is a long way from the

world's chess centres. In spite of the rich and extensive chess history which it possesses, the distances have their influence outside of that great capital Buenos Aires and the disadvantages of 'not being up to the minute with theory' make themselves felt. Tigran Vartanovich Petrosian already said as much in a marvellous article, 'Why I like ♔g5'², as did the great Mikhail Botvinnik himself in his memoirs and in a number of his articles: you have to create and perfect particular opening schemes. Since those distant times I have obtained some great victories with it and it has always served me faithfully. In Mendoza many colleagues have played it and continue to do so, and joining this club is a kind of cult. Now we are sharing it with you.

Characteristics

It is a system of healthy piece development, a scheme that follows simple guidelines, with a central idea that is easy to grasp. As with everything, simplicity requires being alert to the variations and versatility shown on the part of your opponent, in order to respond in the best way. Its strength lies in that possibility. Do not try to learn the variations by heart; try to understand the positions, the ideas, the concepts. The well-remembered 'Gordo' Roberto Grau would be happy if you achieve that.

There are always general guidelines, so let's look at the pieces:

- The queen's rook: this can go to b1 to defend the b-pawn; it can go to the second rank after castling on either wing, or to the h-file to attack. It can also go to d1 or e1 to play in the centre along semi-open files.
- The queen's knight can take one of two routes: a) a3-c2 or a3-b5, attacking on the queenside, or b) d2, heading for e4 or f3, looking towards the kingside.
- The queen's bishop: this remains outside the pawn chain on the h2-b8 diagonal; it might go via g3 to h4 and exert pressure from there.
- The king stays in the centre as long as possible, to be certain of the best place for it to go.
- The queen plays along the d1-h5 diagonal, or goes via f3 to h3, or sits on e2 to support the e4 advance.
- The king's bishop, the real star of this set-up, goes to d3 to attack on the kingside along the b1-h7 diagonal; or to e2, to support a timely h4-h5, as in the Barry Attack, or to go to f3 to contest the long diagonal h1-a8, or to g2 directly as a result of a white expansion on the kingside.
- The king's knight is the co-star and heads for e5, a strong outpost in the centre, or to g5, eyeing the enemy king.
- The king's rook usually operates along the h-file.

As regards the pawns:

- On the kingside: the h-pawn advances to h4 or supports g4 from h3. The g-pawn joins in White's expansion on that wing. The f-pawn usually goes to f4 to support the knight on e5, as in the Stonewall Attack.
- In the centre: the d-pawn supports e5 and can dislodge the knight from f6. The king's pawn fights to advance to e4 or else supports f4 and d4.
- On the queenside: the c-pawn advances to c3 to support d4 and provide a retreat for the d3-bishop. The b-pawn, the Achilles Heel of this set-up, as a result of the bishop coming out so early, can look after itself (b2-b3), can advance to b4 as part of a queenside expansion, or can even be sacrificed to speed up development. But do not do that unless it is absolutely necessary and make sure that your decision is the exception that proves the rule. As regards the a-pawn, there is not much to say.

The present article concerns playing against Orthodox set-ups. Remember that there are plans such as:

- Create a strongpoint on e5 and attack on the kingside.
- Take on e5 or c5 and play your e-pawn to e4, to contest the centre.
- Keep control of the centre.
- Development means bringing the pieces to good, active squares.
- Remember the differences in quality between the pieces: good knight vs. bad bishop, bishop obstructed by its own pawns, strong outposts, weak squares in Black's pawn structure, etc.
- Don't lose patience or control; the Pereyra System has no structural weaknesses. If you don't create any, you can't lose because of them.

How did Manuel Pereyra play?

Before going into the ins and outs of the system, we shall look at a couple of examples of how this distinguished master from Mendoza played 'his' system:

Game 1

Manuel Pereyra Puebla

Mario Anaya

cr Argentina 1975

1. d4 e6 2. ♘f3 ♘f6 3. ♙f4 d5 4. e3 ♘d6 5. ♘e5



Inevitably Pereyra plays 'his system'.

5...0-0 6. ♖d2 c5 7.c3

There is also 7. ♕g3!?

7... ♖c6 8. ♕d3 ♜c7 9. ♖df3 b6

It was possible to maintain the pressure on e5 with 9... ♖d7!?, but this involves entering very dangerous paths:

A) 10. ♕xh7+!? ♜xh7 11. ♖xd7 (11. ♖g5+ ♜g8 12. ♖xd7 ♕xf4 13. exf4 ♜xd7 14. ♜h5 ♖e8 15. dxc5 e5 16. ♜h7+ ♜f8 17. ♜h8+ ♜e7 18. ♜xg7 ♜f5 19. h4 ♜xf4 20. ♖d1 ♕g4 21. f3 ♕h5) 11... ♜xd7 (11... ♕xf4 12. ♖xf8+) 12. ♖g5+ ♜g6 13. ♜g4 ♕xf4 14. exf4 ♖e8 15. dxc5 f6 (15... e5 16. ♖e6+ ♜f6 17. ♜g5+ ♜xe6 18. f5#) 16. ♖e4+ ♜h7 17. 0-0-0∞;

B) 10. ♖g5!± ♖f6 11. ♖g4.

10. h4 ♕b7 11. ♜e2

11. ♖g5?! h6.

11...c4 12. ♕c2 ♖fe8 13.g4!?

Or 13. ♖h3.

13...b5

If 13... ♕xe5 then 14. ♖xe5 (14. dxe5 ♖d7) 14... ♖xe5 15. ♕xe5 ♜e7 16. g5±.

14. ♖xc6 ♕xf4 15. exf4 ♕xc6 16. ♖e5 ♖d7 17.g5 ♖xe5 18. fxe5

White has a clear advantage. The continuation was:

18...g6 19.h5 ♜e7 20. ♜g4 ♜f8 21. ♖h3 ♖e7 22. ♖f3 ♜g7 23.0-0-0 ♕e8 24. ♖h1 a5 25. ♖fh3 ♜f8 26. ♜f4 ♖aa7 27. ♜f6 b4 28.h6 bxc3 29.bxc3 ♖eb7 30. ♜g7+! ♜xg7 31.hxg7 h5 32.gxh6 ♜h7 33. ♖f3 f5 34.exf6 ♕f7 35. ♖g1

Black resigned.

Game 2

Manuel Pereyra Puebla

Vladimir Zaitsev

cr ICCF 1981

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 e6 3.♙f4 ♘d6 4.e3

Sometimes Manuel played in this way. It does not seem good to exchange bishops: 4.♙xd6 ♙xd6 (4...cxd6 5.c3 ♘f6 6.♘bd2 0-0 7.♙c2 ♘c6 8.e3 e5 9.dxe5 dxe5 10.e4 d4 11.♙b5= Michaud-Constantineau, Quebec 2001) 5.c3 c5 6.e3 ♘f6 7.♘bd2 ♘c6 8.♙d3 (8.♙b5 0-0 9.0-0 ♘e7 10.♘e5 a6 11.♙d3± Ipek-Kose, Istanbul 2001) 8...0-0 9.0-0 ♙d7 10.a3 a6 11.b4 cxd4 12.cxd4 ♘a7 13.♙b3 ♜fc8 14.♜fc1 ♜xc1+ ½-½ Stenhouse-McLeod, Eastleigh 2001.



4...♙d7

A) 4...♙xf4 5.exf4 is an alternative:

A1) 5...c5

A11) It feels wrong to play 6.c3 cxd4?! 7.♙xd4 (7.♙xd4 ♙f6 8.♙a3 ♘c6 9.♙b5 ♙d7 10.♙e3= Köhler-Drent, Soest 1999) 7...♙c6 8.♙xc6 bxc6 9.♙d2 ♙b6 10.b3 ♙f6 11.♙d3 ♙a6= Diehl-Schröder, Senden 1999;

A12) 6.dxc5 ♙a5+ 7.c3 ♙xc5 8.♙d3 ♙f6 9.0-0 0-0= Bogoljubow-Marshall, New York 1924.

A2) 5...♙f6 6.♙d3 ♙d6 7.♙c1 c5 8.dxc5 ♙xc5 9.0-0 0-0 10.♘bd2 ♙c6 11.♙b3 ♙d6 12.c3= Montenegro Monteiro-Gomes Brandao, Fortaleza 1999;

A3) 5...♙d6 6.♙c1 (6.♙d2 ♙e7 7.♙d3 c5 8.dxc5 ♙xc5± Del Bosco-Marques, Sao Paulo 1999) 6...♙d7 7.♙d3 c5 8.0-0 ♙gf6 9.c3 0-0 10.♜e1 ♜e8 11.♙e5!? ♙f8 ± Alekhine-Rivier, Berne 1932.

B) 4...♙f6 5.♙g5 (5.♙d3 c5 6.dxc5 ♙xc5 7.0-0 ♙c6 8.♘bd2 0-0 9.e4= Wohl-Pecorelli Garcia, Santa Clara 2001) 5...♘bd7 6.♘bd2 e5 7.e4 exd4 8.♙xd4 h6↔ Graf-Stevenson-Mora Iturralde, Buenos Aires 1939;

C) Or 4...c5 5.♖c3 ♘xf4 6.exf4 ♙a5 7.♘b5+ ♘d7 8.♙e2 cxd4 9.♗xd4 ♗f6 ± Schlechter-Johner, Bad Pistyan 1912.

5.♗bd2 ♙e7 6.c3 e5 7.dxe5 ♗xe5 8.♗xe5 ♘xe5 9.♘xe5
9.♘d3 could also be considered: 9...♘xf4 10.♙a4+ c6 11.♙xf4±.
9...♙xe5 10.♙a4+ c6 11.♘d3 ♗f6 12.0-0-0 0-0 13.h3 ♙e8 14.♗he1 b5 15.♙h4 ♙h5
16.♙xh5 ♗xh5 17.g4 ♗f6



18.e4! ♘b7 19.exd5 ♙xe1 20.♙xe1 ♗xd5 21.♗b3 ♙d8 22.♘e4 ♙f8? 23.♙d1 ♙e7
24.♘d5 cxd5 25.♗d4 a6 26.♙e1+ ♙f8 27.♙d2 ♘c8 28.f4 ♙e8 29.♙xe8+ ♙xe8 30.♙e3
h5 31.♙f3 ♙e7 32.♙g3 hxg4 33.hxg4 ♘d7 34.b4 ♙d6 35.♙h4 ♘c8 36.♙g5 ♙e7 37.♗c2
♘e6 38.a3 ♙f8 39.♗e3 f6+ 40.♙g6 ♘f7+ 41.♙h7 ♘g8+ 42.♙h8 ♘e6 43.g5 fxg5 44.fxg5
♙f7 45.♙h7 g6 46.♙h6

1-0

The following game went round the world and appeared in various magazines. Manuel held it in high regard above all because it was against the defence which he considered his nightmare: the Indian set-ups with the king's fianchetto. To my way of thinking, this present one is the best of Manuel Pereyra's games.

Game 3

Manuel Pereyra Puebla

Oystein Sande

cr XI World Championship Final 1984

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f3 g6 3.♘f4 ♘g7 4.♗c3 d5 5.♙d2 0-0

After 5...♗e4 6.♗xe4 dxe4 7.♗e5 g5 8.♘xg5 f6 9.♘h6 ♘xh6 10.♙xh6 fxe5
11.♙h5+ White has a big initiative according to Gennady Nesis.

Now comes the familiar knight manoeuvre.

6.♗e5 c5 7.dxc5 d4

‘Up to this moment I was firmly convinced that I was better, so much so that I believed I had a winning position. My opponent was certainly of a different opinion’ (Sande, in *Postsjakk*, number 5, 1984).

8.0-0-0 ♖h5 9.e3!

An interesting sacrifice, says Nesis. If 9. ♖f3 then 9... ♖xf4 10. ♗xf4 dxc3! 11. ♖xd8 cxb2+ 12. ♔b1 ♖xd8 13. ♖e5 ♕e6 14. ♖d3 ♖d4 15.e4 ♕xa2+!.

9...g5

‘If it had been at all possible I would have preferred some other way to retain the “advantage”, but I couldn’t see how, for example 9... ♖xf4 10.exf4 ♖c6 11. ♖xc6 bxc6 12. ♖a4± grants Black very slight compensation for the lost pawn’ (Sande).

10. ♕xg5 ♕xe5



11.g4!!

‘The first of many unexpected moves that struck me with blow after blow until the final knock-out’ (Sande).

11... ♖g7

If 11... ♖xg4 then 12. ♖g1 ♕xd1 (12... ♗d7 13.exd4) 13. ♕xe7+ ♔h8 14. ♕xd8 wins.

12.exd4 ♕xg4

‘It looks dangerous to open the g-file but I didn’t want to go down without a fight and I thought that this move gave me real chances of salvation’ (Sande). If 12... ♕f6 then 13. ♕xf6 exf6 14.h3 (Nesis); or 12... ♕c7 13. ♕h6 (Nesis).

13.dxe5 ♕xd1 14. ♖d5! f6



‘This is the move I was relying on and I expected the reply 15.exf6 with a very unclear position, but...’ (Sande). Not 14... ♖f3 15. ♗xe7+ ♔h8 16. ♕d3! ♕xh1 17. ♕f6.

15. ♗g1!!

‘Here I was taken by surprise! White is a rook down but doesn’t flinch from sacrificing more pieces’ (Sande).

15... ♕f3

If 15...fxg5 then 16. ♗xg5 ♖f7 17.e6 ♗f8 18.exf7+ ♗xf7 19. ♕c4; or 15... ♔h8 16. ♕h6 ♖g8 17. ♗xd1.

16. ♕xf6 exf6

An elegant variation arises, according to Nesis, after 16... ♗xd5: 17. ♗xg7+ ♔h8 18. ♖g8+ ♗xg8 19. ♗g5+ ♗f7 20. ♗g7+ ♗e6 21. ♕h3+; Or 16... ♕xd5 17. ♗xg7+ ♔h8 18. ♖xh7+ ♗xh7 19. ♕d3+ ♗g8 20. ♗g5+ ♗f7 21. ♗g6+ ♗e6 22. ♕f5#.

17. ♗h6 ♖f7

Or 17... ♗d7 18.e6!.

18.e6! ♗xd5

If 18... ♖e7 then 19. ♕xf6+ ♗f8 20. ♕xh7+ ♗g8 21. ♕f6+ ♗f8 22. ♗h8#.

19.exf7+ ♗xf7

Not 19... ♗xf7 20. ♕c4!.

20. ♗xg7+

1-0

After 20... ♗e8 21. ♗h8+ ♗d7 22. ♖g7+ ♗c6 23. ♗c8# is mate.

Game 4

Manuel Pereyra Puebla

Fidel Alvertoni

cr 1979

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 e6 3.♙f4 ♘f6 4.e3 c5 5.♙bd2 ♙c6 6.c3 ♘e7 7.♙d3 0-0 8.h4 ♘h5

A) It is better to play 8...cxd4 9.exd4 ♖e8 10.♗e2 ♘d6 11.♙e5 ♘xe5 12.dxe5 ♙d7 13.♙f3 ♙f8 14.h5 d4 15.c4 ♙b4 16.a3 (16.0-0) 16...♙xd3+ 17.♗xd3 b5! 1-0 (46) Kovacevic-Durao, Loures jr 1998;

B) Also, 8...♘d6 9.♙e5 cxd4 (9...♗c7!? 10.♙df3 ♙e4) 10.exd4 ♗c7 11.♙df3 ♙h5? 12.♙xh7+- McCarter-Whitworth, Detroit 1994;

C) 8...h6? is bad, e.g. 9.♙e5 cxd4 10.exd4 ♙xe5 11.dxe5 ♙d7 12.♗h5 f5 13.g4 ♙c5 14.♙c2 ♗e8 15.♗xe8 ♖xe8 16.gxf5 exf5 17.0-0-0 with advantage to White, Pahor-Kavcic, Slovenia jr 1993;

D) Black has also played 8...b6 9.♙g5 ♘d6 10.♙xd6 ♗xd6 11.f4 Lind-Luosto, Helsinki 1998.



9.♙xh7+!!

The difference with the idea mentioned in the notes above is that there is a key move later, without which the sacrifice would not work.

9...♗xh7 10.♙g5+ ♗g6 11.♙e5!

The key!

11...f6?

A better defence was 11...f5 or first 11...cxd4 followed by the exchange on e5 and then ...f7-f5.

12.♗c2+! f5 13.g4 ♙xe5

Or 13...♙f6 14.h5+ ♗h6 15.♙f4 ♗a5 16.♙xe6+ ♗h7 17.♗xf5+ ♗g8 18.h6 ♗f7 19.g5 and wins.

14.gxh5+ ♗h6

If 14...♗xh5 then 15.dxe5.

15.dxe5 ♖e8 16.0-0-0 ♗xh5 17.♖dg1 ♗e2?! 18.♗h3! ♙d7 19.♖g6+! ♜h7 20.♖hg1 ♖f7
21.♖g6g2 d4 22.♗f4 ♗a6 23.♗d1! dxc3 24.♗h5+

Black resigned.

A classic from Manuel.

The Pereyra Attack against the Orthodox set-up

The Pereyra System is basically designed to combat Black's Orthodox Queen's Gambit set-up. But in the time between its first appearance and the latest work, Black's defence has been much improved. It is precisely this fact that guarantees the soundness of White's set-up and maintains its validity. The Pereyra has passed the 'quality control' of the user.

Against 1.d4 d5 2.♙f4 Black has several alternatives, but what constitutes the Orthodox set-up is 2...e6. Black decides to play with his queen's bishop 'inside' the pawn chain. As is well known, the 'ominous queen's bishop', to quote Roberto Grau, is needed for the defence of Black's queenside. This idea constitutes a large part of the problematic nature of this set-up, because in many variations this positional factor can be exploited to help White decide how to proceed. An endgame against a bad bishop is a strong possibility and can be an enduring advantage. We shall not go into this idea deeply here, but to clarify what we mean, we consider a bishop to be 'bad' when it is restricted by its own pawns in fixed chains. The more fixed the pawn structure is, the more static and enduring is the disadvantage of having a bad bishop.

Another option is to transfer the weight of the struggle to a much more dynamic middlegame by exchanging on c5 and then advancing with e3-e4, opening up the game and establishing a pawn majority on the opposite wing from the kings, which can also become an important factor in various endgames, since it is known that static advantages are more easily exploitable when there are fewer pieces left on the board.

Another plan consists of setting up an attack on the kingside, starting with the construction of a series of goals which ensure the advantage. These goals are based on establishing a strongpoint, an outpost on e5, normally a knight, but we shall also see that it can be the bishop or even a pawn. In all three cases the idea is similar, but not identical: a knight on e5 facilitates ample play on the light squares in Black's camp, it allows a timely advance with f2-f4 and the consolidation of a strongpoint which can be of decisive help to the attack; if this knight is exchanged, a pawn takes its place and this generally dislodges the defender from f6 or creates a support point to reach f6. When the piece going to e5 is the bishop, the threat against f6 is renewed through a timely exchange. When a pawn recaptures on e5 we again see the idea of dislodging the

defender's knight from f6 and the resulting advantage in space ensures the possibility of transferring more forces to the kingside. For these reasons, if White fails to establish an outpost on e5, to use Nimzowitsch's term, he gains no advantage and must choose another plan.

The big question that arises after looking at a lot of the material is knowing when White should occupy the e5-outpost. In the early days, when the opening began to be played as the London System, White took his time about occupying e5, which allowed Black to defend successfully, and gradually this set-up acquired the reputation of being unambitious. One of the contributions of master Pereyra was to plant his knight on e5 as early as possible, and he gained a large number of wins with this. My own experience with this opening indicates that Black's move order is very important in deciding when the outpost should be occupied. It can thus be appreciated that the annotations are demanding in this respect. White must be attentive to achieving the consolidation of any e5 outpost.

Another important point is to play with imagination and without fear of sacrificing material. The reader will see several games where White plays passively and wastes opportunities.

Any opening system requires a good 'nose' for the various transpositions and variations that can occur. It is therefore not so important to know all the fine details; what is needed is a wider and more attentive approach.

Moving directly on to the set-up we shall put forward the structure of the article and following considerations. The following sections comprise the Pereyra Attack against the opponent's Queen's Pawn Opening; since it is possible for the white knight to occupy the outpost on e5 via different move orders, it is more useful for educational purposes to choose different dispositions of the black pieces. Therefore, basically we include the title, a screenshot of the line and supplementary games or else immediately the games themselves, annotated in detail, analysing the various alternatives which relate to the problems which a Pereyra player faces. I have been as impartial as possible in evaluating the positions; many of them, even when the assessment is unfavourable, I have played myself, or I like them for a practical game, but I have left the choice up to the reader's judgment. I ask the esteemed reader to be as considerate as possible and to indulge me for daring to use some of my own games as illustrations; I give my word that I have tried to do this when it is indispensable, for there is not a great deal of material on the Pereyra properly speaking, that is, played in the original spirit of the master from Mendoza. As its name indicates, the Pereyra is an attack; it is played without fear of sacrificing or of complicated play,

unbalanced material, or castling delayed as long as possible, since the safety of the king is not a premise in this scheme.

The Pereyra System is also a question of attitude; whoever plays it should be convinced of its benefits, since chess is an intellectual struggle but with the support of the heart, and as the philosopher Pascal used to say: 'The heart has its reasons that reason knows not'.

Next we shall consider as examples three complete games and a game-fragment.

Game 5

Vlatko Kovacevic

2540

Thomas O'Donnell

2410

Toronto 1990 (7)

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 e6 3.♙f4 ♘f6 4.e3 ♙e7 5.♙bd2 0-0 6.♙d3 b6 7.♙e5 ♙b7 8.♙f3 ♙bd7 9.h4 ♙xe5

If 9...c5 then 10.0-0-0 ♙c8 11.g4 → .

10.dxe5 ♙d7 11.0-0-0

Here the sacrifice should be examined; commentators have overlooked it, or were they keeping it to themselves?

11.♙xh7+ ♙xh7 12.♙h5+ ♙g8 13.♙f3 f6 14.♙g5 fxg5 15.hxg5 ♙f5 16.♙h7+ ♙f7 17.g6+ ♙e8 18.♙xg7 ♙b4+ 19.c3 ♙f8 20.♙h8 ♙g5 21.♙g8 ♙xe5 22.♙xe5 ♙d7 23.♙h7+ ♙e7 24.♙g7 ♙xg2 25.♙f1 ♙g5 26.f4 with very interesting play.

11... ♙c5



12.♙xh7+!? ♙xh7 13.♙h5+ ♙g8 14.♙f3 f6

The move 14...g6? is futile: 15. ♖h6 ♜e8 16. ♗g5.



15. ♗g5! fxg5 16.hxg5 ♜f5

If 16... ♗xg5 then 17. ♗xg5 ♜e8 18. ♖h7+ ♜f7 19. ♗h6 is fatal for Black; and 16... ♗xf4 can be ruled out in view of 17.exf4 ♜e8 18. ♖h8+ ♜f7 and now White mates with 19.g6+ ♜xg6 20. ♖h5#.

17.g4

Or 17. ♖h7+ ♜f7 (if 17... ♜f8 then 18. ♖g6 wins) 18.g6+ ♜e8 19. ♖xg7 ♜d7 and the king seems to escape.

17... ♗xg5 18. ♗xg5 ♗xg5 19.f4

The bishop will be captured and White will stand better.

If, e.g., 19. ♖h8+ ♜f7 20. ♖h5+ ♜g8 21. ♖h7+ ♜f7 22.f4 ♗e7 23. ♖h5+ g6 24. ♖h7+ ♜e8 25. ♖xg6+ ♜d7 26. ♗h7 (26.b4 ♗a4 27. ♗h6 ♖g8) 26... ♖e8 27. ♗f7 Black seems to escape, but this needs further investigation.

If 19... ♗e7 then 20.g5 and the attack cannot be parried.

Of course, 19... ♗e4? loses to 20.fxg5 ♗xg5 21. ♗df1.

19... ♗h6 20.g5 ♖e8 21. ♖h4 ♜h7

If 21... ♜f7 then 22.gxh6 gxh6 23. ♗dg1±.

22. ♗dg1 ♗e4

Not 22...d4? because of 23.gxh6 ♗xh1 24.hxg7+ ♜g8 25. ♖h8+ ♜f7 26.g8 ♖+ ♖xg8 27. ♖f6+ and wins.

23. ♗g4 d4 24.gxh6 g5

If 24...g6 then 25. ♗hg1 dxe3 26. ♗xg6 ♖xg6 27. ♖e7+ ♜xh6 28. ♗h1+ ♖h5 29. ♖xe6+.

25.fxg5 ♖g6 26.exd4

Here 26. ♗d1!? is interesting, e.g. 26... ♗f8 27. ♗xd4 ♗f1+ 28. ♗d1 ♗xd1+

29. ♔xd1±.

26... ♖f2 27. ♜f1

Now 27. ♜xf2 fails to 27... ♙xh1 28. ♜f6 ♜e8; but the simple 27. ♜f4 ♙xh1 28. ♜f6 is good enough to win, e.g. 28... ♜g8 29.g6+.

27... ♖xg4 28. ♜xg4 ♜g8



29. ♜f6! ♜xg5+ 30. ♜xg5 ♜xg5 31. ♜xe6 ♙e4 32. ♜e7+ ♜xh6 33. ♜xc7

It is very difficult for White to win this; not only that, he has to exercise some care, in view of the weakness of his king, which is too exposed.

33...a5 34.c4 ♜g2 35.b3 ♜g6

If 35... ♜xa2 then 36.d5. It was worth trying 35... ♜c2+ 36. ♜d1 ♜xa2 37.e6 ♙c2+ 38. ♜c1 ♙xb3 39.e7 ♜e2 40.d5 ♜g6 41.d6 ♜f7 42. ♜c8 ♙a4.

36.e6 ♜f6 37.d5 ♜g8 38. ♜b7 ♜e5! 39. ♜xb6 ♜d4 40.e7 ♜c3

Or 40... ♜g1+ 41. ♜b2 ♜g2+ 42. ♜a3 ♙b1 43. ♜a4 ♜xa2+ 44. ♜b5 ♜e2 45.d6 ♙f5 46.c5.

41. ♜d1 ♜d3

If 41... ♙d3 then 42. ♜e6 ♜g1+ 43. ♜e1 ♙c2+ 44. ♜e2.

42. ♜e1 ♜e3 43. ♜f6! a4

If 43... ♙d3 then 44. ♜e6+ ♙e4 45. ♜xe4+ ♜xe4 46.d6 ♜e3 47. ♜f1 ♜f3 48.d7 ♜h8 49. ♜e1 ♜e3 50.e8 ♜+.

44.b4 a3 45.b5 ♜c8 46. ♜a6! ♜h8 47. ♜xa3+ ♙d3 48. ♜xd3+ ♜xd3 49. ♜f2

1-0

A wonderful game.

Game 6

Hermann Brameyer
Wolfgang Dietze

Strausberg ch-GDR 1971 (18)

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 e6 3.♙f4 ♘f6 4.e3 ♙e7 5.♘bd2 ♘bd7 6.♙d3 0-0 7.♘e5! ♚e8

Maybe 7...♘e8!?. Black does not seem to be aware of the threats he is facing.

8.♙f3 ♘f8 9.g4!

With the threat of g4-g5: notice that the square f7 is insufficiently protected.

9...♘g6

Black is accumulating pieces in the threatened sector, but it is in vain.

10.g5 ♘xe5

Forced. If 10...♘d7 11.♘xf7! ♚xf7 12.♙xc7+, winning the queen.

11.♙xe5 ♘d7



12.♙xh7+!!

An original variation on the theme.

12...♚xh7 13.♙xf7

Isn't chess wonderful! A position as if in suspense. White has sacrificed material and there are threats on all sides. A very strong attack is coming.

13...♘xe5

This seems forced.. If 13...♙f8 then 14.♙h5+ ♚g8 15.g6! and wins.

14.♙h5+! ♚g8 15.dxe5

Threatening 16.g6.

15...♙c5

Opening a path for the king; 15...♙xg5 fails to 16.♙g1 ♙e7 17.♙xg7+! ♚xg7 18.0-0-0 ♙g8 19.♙g1+ ♚f8 20.♙h6+ ♚f7 21.♙h7+ and White wins.

16.g6 ♙d7

With only a single attacking piece it would seem that White does not have much here, but that is what makes this game remarkable. If 16...c6 then 17.♙h7+ ♚f8 18.♙h8+ ♚e7 19.♙xg7#.

17. ♖g1!!



Threatening ♖g3-f3.

17... ♗b5

Giving the king more air. 17... ♔f8 loses to 18. ♗h8+ ♔e7 19. ♗h4+ ♔f8 20. ♖g3 ♗b5 21. ♖f3+ ♔g8 22. ♗h7#.

18. ♖g3 ♗f8

If 18... ♗xb2 then 19. ♖f3! ♗xa1+ 20. ♔e2 and the mate is unstoppable..

19. ♗h4!

Cutting off the retreat.

19... ♗d7

Nothing can save Black now.

20. ♖f3+

And Black resigned.

Game 7

Alejandro Needleman

Fabian Vega

Buenos Aires 1996 (5)

1. ♖f3 ♗f6 2. d4 d5 3. ♗f4 e6 4. e3 c5 5. ♗bd2 ♗c6 6. c3 ♗d6 7. ♗e5

À la Pereyra.

7... 0-0 8. ♗d3 ♗c7 9. ♗df3 ♗e4!

Black must occupy e4.

10. ♗g3 g6

With this move Black forces White to do something about the threat of 11... ♗xg3, followed by 11... ♗xe5, winning a pawn.

If 10... ♗xg3 then White plays 11. ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 12. hxg3+ ♔g8 13. ♗g5 g6 and

now:

A) 14. ♖g4 f6 15. ♔c2 f5 (15... ♗e7 16. ♗h7 f5 17. ♗gf6+ ♔f7 18. ♗xf8 ♔xf6 19. ♗h7+ ♔g7 20. ♗g5±) 16.dxc5 fxg4 (16... ♕xc5? 17. ♗h6+ ♔g7 18. ♗xf5+!) 17.cxd6 ♔g7 18.f4 gxf3 19.gxf3 ♖f5 (19...e5 20. ♔b3!) 20.f4 ♖xg5 21.fxg5 ♗e5 22. ♖f1 ♕d7 is unclear;

B) 14. ♔g4!? f6 15. ♗xe6 ♗xe5 16.dxe5 ♔g7 17.exd6 ♔f7 18. ♗g5+ ♔g8 19. ♗e6.



11. ♗xe4!?

‘White departs from the spirit of combinational play and attack on the black king, in order to reach an endgame with a knight against Black’s bad queen’s bishop’ (Needleman).

11...dxe4 12. ♗d2

Here 12. ♗g5!? looks very interesting, e.g. 12...f5 (12... ♗xe5 13. ♗xe4!±) 13. ♗xc6 ♔xc6 14. ♕xd6 ♔xd6 15.h4 cxd4 16. ♔xd4 ♔xd4 17.cxd4∞. 13. ♗c4 is also playable, with advantage.

12...cxd4!

If 12... ♗xe5 then 13.dxe5 ♕xe5 14. ♗xe4 and the weak dark squares can be exploited by the knight.

13. ♗xc6

Trying to set problems. Instead, 13.exd4!? ♗xe5 14.dxe5 ♕xe5 15. ♗xe4 is similar to the previous note, but in this case everything depends on Black’s advance 15...f5.

13...dxe3

13... ♔xc6 14. ♕xd6 ♔xd6 15. ♗xe4 favours White.

14. ♗xe4 ♕xg3 15.hxg3 ♔xc6?

Doing White a favour. In reality Black did not see his opponent's twentieth move.

He needed to play 15...exf2+! 16.♔xf2 ♚xc6 17.♗f6+ ♚g7 18.♗xh7 ♚c5+ 19.♚d4+ ♚xd4+ 20.cxd4 ♖h8 21.♗g5 ♚d7 22.♖xh8 (22.♖ac1 ♖xh1 23.♖xh1 ♖f8 24.g4 ♚c6) 22... ♖xh8 23.♖c1 ♚c6.

16.♗f6+ ♚g7 17.♚d4 e5 18.♚xe5 exf2+ 19.♔f1 ♚a6+



20.c4!!

Forcing Black to misplace his queen. The rest is simple.

20...♚xc4+ 21.♔xf2 ♚c2+ 22.♔g1 ♖h8

And White forces mate. Black resigned.

Game 8

Josef Pribyl

2455

Jonathan Penrose

2450

Nice ol 1974 (10)

1.d4 d5 2.♗f4 ♗f6 3.e3 e6 4.♗d2 ♗e7 5.♗d3 0-0 6.♗gf3 c5 7.c3 b6 8.♗e5 ♗b7 9.♚f3 ♗c6 10.♚h3 g6

10...h6 11.♗xc6!? ♗xc6 12.g4 ♗e4 13.f3 ♗xd2 14.♔xd2 cxd4 15.♗xh6 dxc3+ 16.bxc3 g6 17.♗xf8 ♚xf8∞.

11.♗h6 ♖e8 12.f4

And here we have reached a familiar position.

12...♗d7

12...♗xe5 13.fxe5 ♗e4 (13...♗d7 seems more tenacious for Black, although equally inadequate) 14.♗xe4 dxe4 15.0-0 ♗g5 16.♗xg5 ♚xg5 17.♖xf7 and

White wins.

13.0-0±



13...f5!? 14.♘df3 ♘cxe5

14...♘f6? 15.♘g5.

15.fxe5

A Stonewall with White's queen's bishop outside the pawn chain. Black's well-known 'counter-Stonewall' (...f7-f5) confronts White with the necessity of attacking by advancing with his g-pawn (g2-g4) at an opportune moment..

15...♗f8

Defensive needs force Black to make this exchange, but now he is left with his 'bad' bishop, while White still has his 'good' bishop.

16.♘g5 ♗xh6 17.♙xh6 ♘f8

The defence of his delicate position requires accuracy on the part of the English master Penrose. After 17...♙e7 White would immediately execute the thematic advance 18.g4!, with a strong attack that Black cannot repel with 18...♙g7? because of 19.♙xg7+ ♙xg7 20.♗b5 ♖ad8 21.gxf5 gxf5 22.♘h3, with a decisive positional advantage to White.

18.♗f3 ♙e7?

18...♙e7 was a better defence.

19.g4

The standard advance. Grandmaster Vlastimil Hort had no doubts about evaluating White's attack as decisive from this point on



19... ♖g7 20. ♜af1 ♘d7 21. ♙h1 ♚e7 22.h4 ♞c8

If 22...a6?! then 23.gxf5 exf5 24. ♞xf5! gxf5 25. ♜xf5, followed by ♜f7, wins.

23. ♜g3 a5 24. ♜fg1 ♜a7 25. ♞h3 ♘d8 26. ♞f4 c4 27. ♞e2 ♜af7 28.gxf5 exf5 29. ♞f3

Not 29. ♞h5? ♙xh4+.

29... ♞e6 30. ♙g5! ♙xg5

30... ♙d7 31.h5.

31. ♜xg5 ♜d7 32.h5 ♙f7

32...h6 33. ♜xg6.

33. ♜1g2 ♙e8 34.hxg6 hxg6 35. ♙g1 ♙d8 36. ♞h5 ♜h7 37. ♞xg6 ♜h3 38. ♞xh3

Black resigned.

This game was published in *Chess Informant* 17/102, annotated by GM Vlastimil Hort.

CONCLUSIONS

We have come to the end of this short chapter. A statement by that great and tireless chessboard worker, Lev Polugaevsky, goes like this: ‘Victory is always the result of a great effort’; an effort that starts long before the game and concludes long afterwards. The Pereyra System has simple ideas and clear motives; in general the process might be: first and foremost, place a piece in a strong position, most particularly the knight on e5; next, gain space on the kingside; afterwards, bring the most important pieces into the attack; if I need time, I give up as much material as is necessary for it; at the right moment, I make pawn breaks intended to demolish the black king’s fortress; and finally, I move on to the final attack. Put like that it seems simple, doesn’t it?

There is a difference between studying opening schemes and studying variations. In the first case, you know what are the steps to follow and their order is adapted according to the set-up, the opponent or the importance of the result. In the second, you need to know the sequences of moves exactly. The Pereyra is studied as an opening scheme and the development of the pieces and pawns is very straightforward, which is why it is so pleasing.

Other concepts, advice or tips, as they like to say nowadays, that you need to keep in mind are the following:

- Black is the one who has to equalise and this is difficult when the opposing set-up is structurally sound and without weaknesses; observe that there are no pieces in the air in the Pereyrian set-up.

- The white king is most often safest in the centre. Castling queenside allows a furious black counterattack and leaves us exposed. Castling kingside is a good measure when you need to bring the rook into action on the king's bishop's file. Often the white king takes refuge 'on foot', via f1 and g2.

- As soon as you can, complicate matters. Pereyra loved playing with unequal forces; these imbalances are beneficial for the struggle for the full point that is being contested. Truth in chess is established by analysis, but chess is an intellectual struggle, which takes place within a limited period of time. Do not try to have truth always on your side. What is being fought for is the point, not the truth.

- Slowly, as and when you can, extend your repertoire. Try out new ideas in your favourite set-ups and 'dip your toe' into similar ones, learning that the greatest advantage of the Pereyra-London is the possibility of transposition.

- Knowing Manuel Pereyra, the argument over which is the best second move makes no sense. For him it was undoubtedly 2. ♘f3; if you were to tell him it is 2. ♙f4 he would shake his head. When I began to play the Pereyra Attack the second move was with the knight and when faced with certain Indian set-ups I did not use the bishop sortie at all. Consequently I used the attack against Queen's Pawn systems, which is where it works best. Later nuances owing to the wider use of the London System and to the art of defence make the possibility of 2. ♙f4 very important. Sometimes this decision depends on what your opponent plays. Try, therefore, to know who you are playing and what he usually plays. This will allow you to make the correct choice in developing your pieces.

Dear readers, in these parts we usually say that to play the Pereyra you need to get permission (or a licence) from a select club of exponents. From this

distant city, Mendoza, I invite you to become part of that community.

*Jorge Luis Fernandez
Mendoza, February 2016*

Footnotes

1 Carlos Portela was a well-known writer, journalist and chess master in Buenos Aires in the first half of the twentieth century. His numerous works include a magnificent book on the match between Najdorf and Reshevsky.

2 ‘There is nothing new under the sun’: Tigran V. Petrosian-Egor Chukaev, Vilnius 1951: 1.d4 ♘f6 2.♗f3 e6 3.♗g5 d5 4.e3 ♗e7 5.♗bd2 0-0 6.♗d3 c5 7.c3 ♗c6 8.♗e5 ♗e8 9.♗f4 ♗d7 10.h4 ♖c8 11.♗df3 cxd4 12.exd4 ♗f6 13.♗g5 ♗e8 14.♖h3 ♜a5 15.♜f1 b5 16.a3 ♜b6 17.♖g3 g6 18.h5 ♗d8 19.♗xh7 ♗xh7 20.hxg6 fxg6 21.♗xg6 ♗xg6 22.♖xg6+ ♜h8 23.♖h6 ♖xf4 24.♖xh7+ ♜g8 25.♜h5 ♗f7 26.♗g6 e5 27.♗xf7+ ♜f8 28.♖h8+ ♜g7 1-0.

Index of main variations

This index is a general guide to the main variations, using the most common move orders, but there are many different ways to arrive at the same position by transposition. We recommend looking in the chapter that you are interested in and then searching within each game to find a particular move, or concrete move order. In the games, the main and best variations for both sides are presented.

VERSUS THE GRÜNFELD (Chapter 2)

1.d4 ♘f6 2.♘f4 g6 3.e3 ♗g7 4.♗f3 0-0



5.♗e2
5.♘bd2
5.♗d3
5...d5
5...♘h5
6.0-0
6.♗c3
6.h3
6...c5 7.c3 ♘c6
7...b6
7...cxd4

7... ♖b6
 8. ♘bd2
 8.dxc5
 8... ♖b6
 8...b6
 8...cxd4
 9. ♖b3 c4 10. ♖a3

VERSUS THE KING'S INDIAN (Chapter 3)

1.d4 ♘f6 2. ♘f4 g6 3. ♘f3 ♘g7



4.e3
 4. ♘c3
 4...0-0 5. ♘e2 d6
 5...c5
 6.0-0
 6.h3
 6...c5
 6... ♘bd7; 6... ♘c6; 6... ♘fd7; 6...b6
 7.c3
 7.h3
 7...b6
 7...cxd4
 7... ♖b6 (7... ♘e6, 7... ♘h5)
 8. ♘bd2
 8. ♖b3

8.h3 ♖b7 9.♗bd2 ♗bd7
 9...♗c6
 10.a4
 10.♖e1
 10...a6 11.♗h2
 11.♗b3; 11.♖e1
 11...♗c7
 11...♖c8; 11...♖a7; 11...♗b8

VERSUS THE QUEEN'S INDIAN (Chapter 4)

1.d4 ♗f6 2.♗f4 e6 3.♗f3
 3...c5 4.e3 b6 5.♗c3
 3...♗e7 4.h3 b6 5.e3 ♗e4
 3...b6



4.e3 ♗b7 5.♗d3
 5.♗bd2; 5.h3
 5...♗e7 6.h3 c5 7.c3 0-0
 7...cxd4 8.cxd4
 8.♗bd2 cxd4 9.exd4 d6 10.0-0 ♗bd7
 10...♗c6
 11.♖e1

VERSUS THE BENONI (Chapter 5)

1.d4 ♗f6
 1...c5 2.c3 cxd4 3.cxd4 d5

2. ♖f4
 2...e6
 2...c5



3.e3
 3.d5; 3.dxc5; 3.c3
 3...e6
 3...♔b6; 3...cxd4; 3...♘d5
 4. ♗f3 ♕b6
 4...d5
 5. ♗c3
 5. ♗a3
 5...d5
 5...♕xb2; 5...a6
 6. ♗b5
 6.a3
 6...♗a6
 7.a4

VERSUS THE DUTCH (Chapter 6)

1.d4 f5 2. ♗f3
 2. ♗c3 d5 3. ♖f4
 2... ♗f6 3. ♖f4



3...d6

3...e6; 3...g6

4.h3

4.e3

4...g6 5.e3

5.c3

5...♘g7 6.♙c4

6.♙e2; 6.♘bd2

VERSUS THE SLAV (Chapter 7)

1.d4 d5

1...c5 2.c3 cxd4 3.cxd4 d5 4.♙f4 (4.♘c3)

1...♘f6 2.♘f3 c5 3.c3 cxd4 4.cxd4 d5

2.♙f4 ♘f6

2...♙f5; 2...c6

3.e3 ♙f5 4.c4



4...c6

4...♘c6; 4...e6

5.♘c3 e6 6.♙b3 b6

6...♙b6; 6...♙c8

VERSUS SYSTEMS WITH ...d7-d5 BUT WITHOUT AN EARLY ...e7-e6 (Chapter 8)

1.d4 d5

1...♘f6

2.♙f4

2.♘c3 ♘f6 3.♙f4



3...a6 and ...e7-e6; 3...♙f5; 3...c5 2.♘f3 ♘f6 or 2...c5 3.c3

2... ♖f6
 2...c5
 3.e4; 3.e3
 3.e3 c5
 3... ♖c6
 4.c3 ♖c6
 4... ♔b6
 5. ♖d2 ♗b6
 5... ♕f5; 5...cxd4
 6. ♗b3



6...c4
 6... ♕f5
 7. ♗c2
 7. ♗xb6
 7... ♕g4

VERSUS SYSTEMS WITH ...d7-d5 AND AN EARLY ...e7-e6 (Chapter 9)

1.d4 d5 2. ♕f4 ♖f6 3.e3 e6 4. ♖f3



4...Qd6

4...Qe7; 4...c5

5.Qg3 c5

5...dxe4; 5...Qxg3

6.c3 dxc6

6...b6

7.dbd2 0-0 8.Qd3 e8

8...a6

9.dxe5

OTHER BLACK DEFENCES (Chapter 10)

1.d4



1...g6

1...d6

1...♘f6 2.♙f4 d6 3.♘f3 c6 or 3...♘bd7

1...b5

1...e5; 1...a6; 1...b6; 1...♘c6; 1...c6

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